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Second Canto

Chapter One

The First Step in God Realization

INVOCATION

ॐ NaMaae >aGavTae vaSaudevaYa))

oà namo bhagavate vāsudevāya

oà—O my Lord; *namaù*—my respectful obeisances unto You; *bhagavate*—unto the Personality of Godhead; *vāsudevāya*—unto Lord Kṛṣṇa, the son of Vasudeva.

TRANSLATION

O my Lord, the all-pervading Personality of Godhead, I offer my respectful obeisances unto You.

PURPORT

Vāsudevāya means “to Kṛṣṇa, the son of Vasudeva.” Since by chanting the name of Kṛṣṇa, Vāsudeva, one can achieve all the good results of charity, austerity and penances, it is to be understood that by the chanting of this mantra, *oà namo bhagavate vāsudevāya*, the author or the speaker or any one of the readers of *Srimad-Bhagavatam* is offering respectful obeisances unto the Supreme Lord, Kṛṣṇa, the reservoir of all pleasure. In the First Canto of *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, the principles of creation are described, and thus the First Canto may be called “Creation.”

Similarly, in the Second Canto, the post-creation cosmic manifestation is described. The different planetary systems are described in the Second Canto as different parts of the universal body of the Lord. For this reason, the Second Canto may be called “The Cosmic Manifestation.” There are ten chapters in the Second Canto, and in these ten chapters the purpose of *Srimad-Bhagavatam* and the different symptoms of this purpose are narrated. The first chapter describes the glories of chanting, and it hints at the process by which the neophyte devotees may perform meditation on the universal form of the Lord. In the first verse, Sukadeva Gosvami replies to the questions of Maharaja Pariksit, who asked him about one’s duties at the point of death. Maharaja Pariksit was glad to receive Sukadeva Gosvami, and he was proud of being a descendant of Arjuna, the intimate friend of Kṛṣṇa. personally, he was very humble and meek, but he expressed his gladness that Lord Kṛṣṇa was very kind to his grandfathers, the sons of Pāṇḍu, especially his own grandfather, Arjuna. And because Lord Kṛṣṇa was always pleased with Maharaja Pariksit’s family, at the verge of Maharaja Pariksit’s death Sukadeva Gosvami was sent to help him in the process of self-realization. Maharaja Pariksit was a devotee of Lord Kṛṣṇa from his childhood, so he had natural affection for Kṛṣṇa. Sukadeva Gosvami could understand his devotion. Therefore, he welcomed the questions about the King’s duty. Because the King hinted that worship of Lord Kṛṣṇa is the ultimate function of every living entity, Sukadeva Gosvami welcomed the suggestion and said, “Because you have raised questions about Kṛṣṇa, your question is most glorious.” The translation of the first verse is as follows.

TEXT 1

é[quéuk- ovac
 vrqYaaNaez Tae Pa[én" k*-Taae l/aek-ihTa& Na*Pa)
 AaTMaivTSaMMaTa" Pau&Saa& é[aeTaVYaaidzu Ya" Par")) 1))

çré-çuka uvāca

varéyān eña te praçnaù

kāto loka-hitaà nāpa

ätmavit-sammataù puàsäà

çrotavyädiñu yaù paraù

SYNONYMS

çré-çukaù uväca—Sri Sukadeva Gosvami said; *varéyän*—glorious; *eñàù*—this; *te*—your; *praçnaù*—question; *kâtaù*—made by you; *loka-hitam*—beneficial for all men; *nâpa*—O King; *ätmavit*—transcendentalist; *sammataù*—approved; *puàsäm*—of all men; *çrotavya-ädiñu*—in all kinds of hearing; *yaù*—what is; *paraù*—the supreme.

TRANSLATION

Sri Sukadeva Gosvami said: My dear King, your question is glorious because it is very beneficial to all kinds of people. The answer to this question is the prime subject matter for hearing, and it is approved by all transcendentalists.

PURPORT

Even the very question is so nice that it is the best subject matter for hearing. Simply by such questioning and hearing, one can achieve the highest perfectional stage of life. Because Lord Kṛṣṇa is the original Supreme Person, any question about Him is original and perfect. Lord Sri Caitanya Mahāprabhu said that the highest perfection of life is to achieve the transcendental loving service of Kṛṣṇa. Because questions and answers about Kṛṣṇa elevate one to that transcendental position, the questions of Maharaja Parikṣit about Kṛṣṇa philosophy are greatly glorified. Maharaja Parikṣit wanted to absorb his mind completely in Kṛṣṇa, and such absorption can be effected simply by hearing about the uncommon activities of Kṛṣṇa. For instance, in the *Bhagavad-gita* it is stated that simply by understanding the transcendental nature of Lord Kṛṣṇa's appearance, disappearance, and activities, one can immediately return home, back to Godhead, and never come back to this miserable condition of material existence. It is very auspicious, therefore, to hear always about Kṛṣṇa. So Maharaja Parikṣit requested Sukadeva Gosvami to narrate the activities of

Kṛṣṇa so that he could engage his mind in Kṛṣṇa. The activities of Kṛṣṇa are nondifferent from Kṛṣṇa Himself. As long as one is engaged in hearing such transcendental activities of Kṛṣṇa, he remains aloof from the conditional life of material existence. The topics of Lord Kṛṣṇa are so auspicious that they purify the speaker, the hearer and the inquirer. They are compared to the Ganges waters, which flow from the toe of Lord Kṛṣṇa. Wherever the Ganges waters go, they purify the land and the person who bathes in them. Similarly, *Kṛṣṇa-katha*, or the topics of Kṛṣṇa, are so pure that wherever they are spoken, the place, the hearer, the inquirer, the speaker and all concerned become purified.

TEXT 2

é[aeTaVYaadqiNa raJaeNd] Na*<aa& SaiNTa SahóXa")
APaXYaTaaMaaTMaTatv& Ga*hezu Ga*hMaeiDaNaaMa()) 2))

çrotavyädéni räjendra

nâëää santi sahasraçaù

apaçyatäm ätma-tattvaà

gāheñu gāha-medhinām

SYNONYMS

çrotavya-ädéni—subject matters for hearing; *räjendra*—O Emperor; *nâëäm*—of human society; *santi*—there are; *sahasraçaù*—hundreds and thousands; *apaçyatäm*—of the blind; *ätma-tattvam*—knowledge of self, the ultimate truth; *gāheñu*—at home; *gāha-medhinām*—of persons too materially engrossed.

TRANSLATION

Those persons who are materially engrossed, being blind to the knowledge of ultimate truth, leave many subject matters for hearing in human society, O Emperor.

PURPORT

In the revealed scriptures there are two nomenclatures for the householder's life. One is *grhastha*, and the other is *grhamedhi*. The *grhasthas* are those who live together with wife and children but live transcendently for realizing the ultimate truth. The *grhamedhis*, however, are those who live only for the benefit of the family members, extended or centralized, and thus are envious of others. The word *medhé* indicates jealousy of others. The *grhamedhis*, being interested in family affairs only, are certainly envious of others. Therefore, one *grhamedhi* is not on good terms with another *grhamedhi*, and in the extended form, one community, society or nation is not on good terms with another counterpart of selfish interest. In the age of Kali, all the householders are jealous of one another because they are blind to the knowledge of ultimate truth. They have many subject matters for hearing—political, scientific, social, economic and so on—but due to a poor fund of knowledge, they set aside the question of the ultimate miseries of life, namely miseries of birth, death, old age and disease. Factually, the human life is meant for making an ultimate solution to birth, death, old age and disease, but the *grhamedhis*, being illusioned by the material nature, forget everything about self-realization. The ultimate solution to the problems of life is to go back home, back to Godhead, and thus, as stated in the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (8.16), the miseries of material existence—birth, death, old age and disease—are removed.

The process of going back home, back to Godhead, is to hear about the Supreme Lord and His name, form, attributes, pastimes, paraphernalia and variegatedness. Foolish people do not know this. They want to hear something about the name, form, etc., of everything temporary, and they do not know how to utilize this propensity of hearing for the ultimate good. Misguided as they are, they also create some false literatures about the name, form, attributes, etc., of the ultimate truth. One should not, therefore, become a *grhamedhi* simply to exist for envying others; one should become a real householder in terms of the scriptural injunctions.

TEXT 3

iNad]Yaa ihṛYaTae Naç&- VYavaYaeNa c va vYa")

idva caQaeRhYaa raJaNa(ku-ṣu=Mb>ar<aeNa va)) 3))

nidrayā hriyate naktā

vyavāyena ca vā vayaù

divā cārthehayā rājan

kuōumba-bharaēena vā

SYNONYMS

nidrayā—by sleeping; *hriyate*—wastes; *naktam*—night; *vyavāyena*—sex indulgence; *ca*—also; *vā*—either; *vayaù*—duration of life; *divā*—days; *ca*—and; *artha*—economic; *éhayā*—development; *rājan*—O King; *kuōumba*—family members; *bharaēena*—maintaining; *vā*—either.

TRANSLATION

The lifetime of such an envious householder is passed at night either in sleeping or in sex indulgence, and in the daytime either in making money or maintaining family members.

PURPORT

The present human civilization is primarily based on the principles of sleeping and sex indulgence at night and earning money in the day and spending the same for family maintenance. Such a form of human civilization is condemned by the *Bhāgavata* school.

Because human life is a combination of matter and spirit soul, the whole process of Vedic knowledge is directed at liberating the spirit soul from the contamination of matter. The knowledge concerning this is called *ātma-tattva*. Those men who are too materialistic are unaware of this knowledge and are more inclined to economic development for material enjoyment. Such materialistic men are called *karmis*, or fruitive laborers, and they are allowed regulated economic development or association of woman for sex

indulgence. Those who are above the *karmis*, that is, the *jnanis*, *yogis* and devotees, are strictly prohibited from sex indulgence. The *karmis* are more or less devoid of *ätma-tattva* knowledge, and as such, their life is spent without spiritual profit. The human life is not meant for hard labor for economic development, nor is it meant for sex indulgence like that of the dogs and hogs. It is specially meant for making a solution to the problems of material life and the miseries thereof. So the *karmis* waste their valuable human life by sleeping and sex indulgence at night, and by laboring hard in the daytime to accumulate wealth, and after doing so, they try to improve the standard of materialistic life. The materialistic way of life is described herein in a nutshell, and how foolishly men waste the boon of human life is described as follows.

TEXT 4

**dehaPaTYak-I/}aaaidZvaTMaSaENYaeZvSaTSviPa)
Taeza& Pa[Mataae iNaDaNa& PaXYaàiPa Na PaXYaiTa)) 4))**

dehäpatya-kalaträdiñv

ätma-sainyeñv asatsv api

teñää pramatto nidhanaà

paçyann api na paçyati

SYNONYMS

deha—body; *apatya*—children; *kalatra*—wife; *ädiñu*—and in everything in relation to them; *ätma*—own; *sainyeñu*—fighting soldiers; *asatsu*—fallible; *api*—in spite of; *teñäm*—of all of them; *pramattaù*—too attached; *nidhanam*—destruction; *paçyan*—having been experienced; *api*—although; *na*—does not; *paçyati*—see it.

TRANSLATION

Persons devoid of *ätma-tattva* do not inquire into the problems of life,

being too attached to the fallible soldiers like the body, children and wife. Although sufficiently experienced, they still do not see their inevitable destruction.

PURPORT

This material world is called the world of death. Every living being, beginning from Brahmā, whose duration of life is some thousands of millions of years, down to the germs who live for a few seconds only, is struggling for existence. Therefore, this life is a sort of fight with material nature, which imposes death upon all. In the human form of life, a living being is competent enough to come to an understanding of this great struggle for existence, but being too attached to family members, society, country, etc., he wants to win over the invincible material nature by the aid of bodily strength, children, wife, relatives, etc. Although he is sufficiently experienced in the matter by dint of past experience and previous examples of his deceased predecessors, he does not see that the so-called fighting soldiers like the children, relatives, society members and countrymen are all fallible in the great struggle. One should examine the fact that his father or his father's father has already died, and that he himself is therefore also sure to die, and similarly, his children, who are the would be fathers of their children, will also die in due course. No one will survive in this struggle with material nature. The history of human society definitely proves it, yet the foolish people still suggest that in the future they will be able to live perpetually, with the help of material science. This poor fund of knowledge exhibited by human society is certainly misleading, and it is all due to ignoring the constitution of the living soul. This material world exists only as a dream, due to our attachment to it. Otherwise, the living soul is always different from the material nature. The great ocean of material nature is tossing with the waves of time, and the so-called living conditions are something like foaming bubbles, which appear before us as bodily self, wife, children, society, countrymen, etc. Due to a lack of knowledge of self, we become victimized by the force of ignorance and thus spoil the valuable energy of human life in a vain search after permanent living conditions, which are impossible in this material world.

Our friends, relatives and so-called wives and children are not only fallible,

but also bewildered by the outward glamor of material existence. As such, they cannot save us. Still we think that we are safe within the orbit of family, society or country.

The whole materialistic advancement of human civilization is like the decoration of a dead body. Everyone is a dead body flapping only for a few days, and yet all the energy of human life is being wasted in the decoration of this dead body. Sukadeva Gosvami is pointing out the duty of the human being after showing the actual position of bewildered human activities. Persons who are devoid of the knowledge of *ätma-tattva* are misguided, but those who are devotees of the Lord and have perfect realization of transcendental knowledge are not bewildered.

TEXT 5

**TaSMaaÜarTa SavaRTMaa >aGavaNaqirae hir")
é[aeTaVYa" k-liTaRTaVYaê SMaTaRVYaêeC^Taa>aYaMa()) 5))**

tasmäd bhärata sarvätmä

bhagavän éçvaro hariù

çrotavyaù kértitavyaç ca

smartavyaç cecchatäbhayam

SYNONYMS

tasmät—for this reason; *bhärata*—O descendant of Bharata; *sarvätmä*—the Supersoul; *bhagavän*—the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *éçvaraù*—the controller; *hariù*—the Lord, who vanquishes all miseries; *çrotavyaù*—is to be heard; *kértitavyaù*—to be glorified; *ca*—also; *smartavyaù*—to be remembered; *ca*—and; *icchatä*—of one who desires; *abhayam*—freedom.

TRANSLATION

O descendant of King Bharata, one who desires to be free from all

miserics must hear about, glorify and also remember the Personality of Godhead, who is the Supersoul, the controller and the savior from all miseries.

PURPORT

In the previous verse, Sri Sukadeva Gosvami has described how the foolish materially attached men are wasting their valuable time in the improvement of the material conditions of life by sleeping, indulging in sex life, developing economic conditions and maintaining a band of relatives who are to be vanquished in the air of oblivion. Being engaged in all these materialistic activities, the living soul entangles himself in the cycle of the law of fruitive actions. This entails the chain of birth and death in the 8,400,000 species of life: the aquatics, the vegetables, the reptiles, the birds, the beasts, the uncivilized man, and then again the human form, which is the chance for getting out of the cycle of fruitive action. Therefore, if one desires freedom from this vicious circle, then one must cease to act as a *karmé* or enjoyer of the results of one's own work, good or bad. One should not do anything, either good or bad, on his own account, but must execute everything on behalf of the Supreme Lord, the ultimate proprietor of everything that be. This process of doing work is recommended in the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (9.27) also, where instruction is given for working on the Lord's account. Therefore, one should first of all hear about the Lord. When one has perfectly and scrutinizingly heard, one must glorify His acts and deeds, and thus it will become possible to remember constantly the transcendental nature of the Lord. Hearing about and glorifying the Lord are identical with the transcendental nature of the Lord, and by so doing, one will be always in the association of the Lord. This brings freedom from all sorts of fear. The Lord is the Supersoul (Paramātmā) present in the hearts of all living beings, and thus by the above hearing and glorifying process, the Lord invites the association of all in His creation. This process of hearing about and glorifying the Lord is applicable for everyone, whoever he may be, and it will lead one to the ultimate success in everything in which one may be engaged by providence. There are many classes of human beings: the fruitive workers, the empiric philosophers, the mystic *yogis*, and ultimately, the unalloyed devotees. For all of them, one and the same process is applicable for achieving the desired success. Everyone

wants to be free from all kinds of fear, and everyone wants the fullest extent of happiness in life. The perfect process for achieving this, here and now, is recommended in the *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, which is uttered by such a great authority as Srila Sukadeva Gosvami. By hearing about and glorifying the Lord, all a person's activities become molded into spiritual activities, and thus all conceptions of material miseries become completely vanquished.

TEXT 6

**WTaavaNa(Saa&:YaYaaeGaa>Yaa& SvDaMaRPairiNaïYaa)
JaNMai/a>a" Par" Pau&SaaMaNTae NaaraYa<aSMa*iTa")) 6))**

etävān sāikhya-yogābhyā

sva-dharma-pariniñohayā

janma-lābhaù paraù puàsām

ante nārāyaëa-smātiù

SYNONYMS

etävān—all these; *sāikhya*—complete knowledge of matter and spirit; *yogābhyām*—knowledge of mystic power; *sva-dharma*—particular occupational duty; *pariniñohayā*—by full perception; *janma*—birth; *lābhaù*—gain; *paraù*—the supreme; *puàsām*—of a person; *ante*—at the end; *nārāyaëa*—the Personality of Godhead; *smātiù*—remembrance.

TRANSLATION

The highest perfection of human life, achieved either by complete knowledge of matter and spirit, by practice of mystic powers, or by perfect discharge of occupational duty, is to remember the Personality of Godhead at the end of life.

PURPORT

Nārāyaṇa is the transcendental Personality of Godhead beyond the material creation. Everything that is created, sustained, and at the end annihilated is within the compass of the *mahat-tattva* (material principle) and is known as the material world. The existence of Nārāyaṇa, or the Personality of Godhead, is not within the jurisdiction of this *mahat-tattva*, and as such, the name, form, attributes, etc. of Nārāyaṇa are beyond the jurisdiction of the material world. By the speculation of empiric philosophy, which discerns matter from spirit, or by cultivation of mystic powers, which ultimately helps the performer to reach any planet of the universe or beyond the universe, or by discharge of religious duties, one can achieve the highest perfection, provided one is able to reach the stage of *nārāyaṇa-smṛti*, or constant remembrance of the Personality of Godhead. This is possible only by the association of a pure devotee, who can give a finishing touch to the transcendental activities of all *jñānis*, *yogis*, or *karmīs*, in terms of prescribed duties defined in the scriptures. There are many historical instances of the achievement of spiritual perfection, such as that of the Sanakādi Rsis or the nine celebrated Yogendras, who attained perfection only after being situated in the devotional service of the Lord. None of the devotees of the Lord ever deviated from the path of devotional service by taking to other methods as adopted by the *jñānis* or *yogis*. Everyone is anxious to achieve the highest perfection of his particular activity, and it is indicated herein that such perfection is *nārāyaṇa-smṛti*, for which everyone must endeavor his best. In other words, life should be molded in such a manner that one is able to progressively remember the personality of Godhead in every step of life.

TEXT 7

**Pa[aYae<a MauNaYaae raJaiàv*taa iviDazeDaTa")
NaEGauR<YaSQaa rMaNTae SMA Gau<aaNauk-QaNae hre")) 7))**

prāyeṇa munayo rājan

nivāṭṭa vidhi-ñedhataù

nairguṇya-sthā ramante sma

guëänukathane hareù

SYNONYMS

präyeëa—mainly; *munayaù*—all sages; *räjan*—O King; *nivåttäù*—above; *vidhi*—regulative principles; *sedhataù*—from restrictions; *nairguëya-sthäù*—transcendentally situated; *ramante*—take pleasure in; *sma*—distinctly; *guëa-anukathane*—describing the glories; *hareù*—of the Lord.

TRANSLATION

O King Pariksit, mainly the topmost transcendentalists, who are above the regulative principles and restrictions, take pleasure in describing the glories of the Lord.

PURPORT

The topmost transcendentalist is a liberated soul and is therefore not within the purview of the regulative principles. A neophyte, who is intended to be promoted to the spiritual plane, is guided by the spiritual master under regulative principles. He may be compared to a patient who is treated by various restrictions under medical jurisdiction. Generally, liberated souls also take pleasure in describing the transcendental activities. As mentioned above, since Nārāyaṇa, Hari, the Personality of Godhead, is beyond the material creation, His form and attributes are not material. The topmost transcendentalists or the liberated souls realize Him by advanced experience of transcendental knowledge, and therefore they take pleasure in the discussion of the transcendental qualities of the Lord's pastimes. In the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (4.9), the personality of Godhead declares that His appearance and activities are all *divyam*, or transcendental. The common man, who is under the spell of material energy, takes it for granted that the Lord is like one of us, and therefore he refuses to accept the transcendental nature of the Lord's form, name, etc. The topmost transcendentalist is not interested in anything material, and his taking interest in the matter of the Lord's activities is definite proof that the Lord is not like one of us in the material world. In the Vedic literatures also, it is confirmed that the Supreme Lord is one, but that He is engaged in His

transcendental pastimes in the company of His unalloyed devotees and that simultaneously He is present as the Supersoul, an expansion of Baladeva, in the heart of all living entities. Therefore, the highest perfection of transcendental realization is to take pleasure in hearing and describing the transcendental qualities of the Lord and not in merging into His impersonal Brahman existence, for which the impersonalist monist aspires. Real transcendental pleasure is realized in the glorification of the transcendental Lord, and not in the feeling of being situated in His impersonal feature. But there are also others who are not the topmost transcendentalists but are in a lower status, and who do not take pleasure in describing the transcendental activities of the Lord. Rather, they discuss such activities of the Lord formally with the aim of merging into His existence.

TEXT 8

wd& >aaGavTa& NaaMa Paura<a& b]øSaiMMaTaMa()
ADaQTavaNa(ÜaParadaE iPaTauÜCEPaaYaNaadhMa()) 8))

idaà bhāgavatā nāma

purāṇā brahma-sammitam

adhétavān dvāparādau

pitur dvaipāyanād aham

SYNONYMS

idam—this; *bhāgavatam*—*Srimad-Bhagavatam*; *nāma*—of the name; *purāṇam*—Vedic supplement; *brahma-sammitam*—approved as the essence of the *Vedas*; *adhétavān*—studied; *dvāpara-adau*—at the end of the Dvāpara-yuga; *pitur*—from my father; *dvaipāyanāt*—Dvaipāyana Vyāsadeva; *aham*—myself.

TRANSLATION

At the end of the Dvāpara-yuga, I studied this great supplement of Vedic literature named *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, which is equal to all the Vedas, from my father, Srila Dvaipāyana Vyāsadeva.

PURPORT

The statement made by Srila Sukadeva Gosvami that the topmost transcendentalist, who is beyond the jurisdiction of regulations and restrictions, mainly takes to the task of hearing about and glorifying the Personality of Godhead, is verified by his personal example. Sukadeva Gosvami, being a recognized liberated soul and the topmost transcendentalist, was accepted by all of the topmost sages present in the meeting during the last seven days of Maharaja Parikṣit. He cites from the example of his life that he himself was attracted by the transcendental activities of the Lord, and he studied *Srimad-Bhagavatam* from his great father, Sri Dvaipāyana Vyāsadeva. *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, or, for that matter, any other scientific literature, cannot be studied at home by one's own intellectual capacity. Medical books of anatomy or physiology are available in the market, but no one can become a qualified medical practitioner simply by reading such books at home. One has to be admitted to the medical college and study the books under the guidance of learned professors. Similarly, *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, the postgraduate study of the science of Godhead, can only be learned by studying it at the feet of a realized soul like Srila Vyāsadeva. Although Sukadeva Gosvami was a liberated soul from the very day of his birth, he still had to take lessons of *Srimad-Bhagavatam* from his great father, Vyāsadeva, who compiled the *Srimad-Bhagavatam* under the instruction of another great soul, Sri Nārada Muni. Lord Sri Caitanya Mahāprabhu instructed a learned *brahmana* to study *Srimad-Bhagavatam* from a personal *bhāgavata*. *Srimad-Bhagavatam* is based on the transcendental name, form, attributes, pastimes, entourage and variegatedness of the Supreme Person, and it is spoken by the incarnation of the Personality of Godhead, Srila Vyāsadeva. Pastimes of the Lord are executed in cooperation with His pure devotees, and consequently historical incidences are mentioned in this great literature because they are related to Kṛṣṇa. It is called *brahma-sammitam* because it is the sound representative of Lord Kṛṣṇa—like the *Bhagavad-gita*. *Bhagavad-gita* is the sound incarnation of the Lord because it is

spoken by the Supreme Lord, and *Srimad-Bhagavatam* is the sound representative of the Lord because it was spoken by the incarnation of the Lord about the activities of the Lord. As stated in the beginning of this book, it is the essence of the Vedic desire tree and the natural commentation on the *Brahma-sūtras*, the topmost philosophical thesis on the subject matter of Brahman. Vyāsadeva appeared at the end of Dvāpara-yuga as the son of Satyavati, and therefore the word *dvapara-adau*, or “the beginning of Dvāpara-yuga,” in this context means just prior to the beginning of the Kali-yuga. The logic of this statement, according to Srila Jiva Gosvami, is comparable to that of calling the upper portion of the tree the beginning. The root of the tree is the beginning of the tree, but in common knowledge the upper portion of the tree is first seen. In that way the end of the tree is accepted as its beginning.

TEXT 9

**PairiNaïiTaae_iPa NaEGauR<Ya otaMaëaek-I/II/Yaa)
Ga*hqTaceTaa raJazeR Aa:YaaNa& YadDaqTavaNa()) 9))**

pariniñöhito 'pi nairguëya

uttama-çloka-lélayä

gāhéta-cetä räjarñe

äkhyänaà yad adhétavän

SYNONYMS

pariniñöhitaù—fully realized; *api*—in spite of; *nairguëye*—in transcendence; *uttama*—enlightened; *çloka*—verse; *lélayä*—by the pastimes; *gāhéta*—being attracted; *cetäù*—attention; *räjarñe*—O saintly King; *äkhyänam*—delineation; *yat*—that; *adhétavän*—I have studied.

TRANSLATION

O saintly King, I was certainly situated perfectly in transcendence, yet I

was still attracted by the delineation of the pastimes of the Lord, who is described by enlightened verses.

PURPORT

The Absolute Truth is realized as the impersonal Brahman at the first instance by philosophical speculation and later as the Supersoul by further progress of transcendental knowledge. But if, by the grace of the Lord, an impersonalist is enlightened by the superior statements of *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, he is also converted into a transcendental devotee of the Personality of Godhead. With a poor fund of knowledge, we cannot adjust to the idea of the personality of the Absolute Truth, and the personal activities of the Lord are deplored by the less intelligent impersonalists; but reasons and arguments together with the transcendental process of approaching the Absolute Truth help even the staunch impersonalist to become attracted by the personal activities of the Lord. A person like Sukadeva Gosvami cannot be attracted by any mundane activity, but when such a devotee is convinced by a superior method, he is certainly attracted by the transcendental activities of the Lord. The Lord is transcendental, as are His activities. He is neither inactive nor impersonal.

TEXT 10

Tadh& Tae_i>aDaaSYaaiMa MahaPaaEâizk-ae >avaNa()
YaSYa é[ÖDaTaaMaaéu SYaaNMauku-Nde MaiTa" SaTaq)) 10))

tad ahaà te 'bhidhäsyañi

mahä-pauruñiko bhavän

yasya çraddadhatäm äçu

syän mukunde matiù saté

SYNONYMS

tat—that; *aham*—I; *te*—unto you; *abhidhäsyañi*—shall recite; *mahä-*

pauruṇika—the most sincere devotee of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *bhavān*—your good self; *yasya*—of which; *çraddadhatām*—of one who gives full respect and attention; *āçu*—very soon; *syāt*—it so becomes; *mukunde*—unto the Lord, who awards salvation; *matīu*—faith; *saté*—unflinching.

TRANSLATION

That very Srimad-Bhagavatam I shall recite before you because you are the most sincere devotee of Lord Kṛṣṇa. One who gives full attention and respect to hearing Srimad-Bhagavatam achieves unflinching faith in the Supreme Lord, the giver of salvation.

PURPORT

Srimad-Bhagavatam is recognized Vedic wisdom, and the system of receiving Vedic knowledge is called *avaroha-panthā*, or the process of receiving transcendental knowledge through bona fide disciplic succession. For advancement of material knowledge there is a need for personal ability and researching aptitude, but in the case of spiritual knowledge, all progress depends more or less on the mercy of the spiritual master. The spiritual master must be satisfied with the disciple; only then is knowledge automatically manifest before the student of spiritual science. The process should not, however, be misunderstood to be something like magical feats whereby the spiritual master acts like a magician and injects spiritual knowledge into his disciple, as if surcharging him with an electrical current. The bona fide spiritual master reasonably explains everything to the disciple on the authorities of Vedic wisdom. The disciple can receive such teachings not exactly intellectually, but by submissive inquiries and a service attitude. The idea is that both the spiritual master and the disciple must be bona fide. In this case, the spiritual master, Sukadeva Gosvami, is ready to recite exactly what he has learned from his great father Srila Vyāsadeva, and the disciple, Maharaja Parikṣit, is a great devotee of Lord Kṛṣṇa. A devotee of Lord Kṛṣṇa is he who believes sincerely that by becoming a devotee of the Lord one becomes fully equipped with everything spiritual. This teaching is imparted by the Lord Himself in the pages of the *Bhagavad-gītā*, in which it is clearly described that the Lord (Sri Kṛṣṇa) is everything, and that to surrender unto Him solely and wholly

makes one the most perfectly pious man. This unflinching faith in Lord Kṛṣṇa prepares one to become a student of *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, and one who hears *Srimad-Bhagavatam* from a devotee like Sukadeva Gosvami is sure to attain salvation at the end, as Maharaja Parikṣit did. The professional reciter of *Srimad-Bhagavatam* and the pseudodevotees whose faith is based on one week's hearing are different from Sukadeva Gosvami and Maharaja Parikṣit. Srila Vyāsadeva explained *Srimad-Bhagavatam* unto Sukadeva Gosvami from the very beginning of the *janmādy asya* [SB 1.1.1] verse, and so Sukadeva Gosvami also explained it to the King. Lord Kṛṣṇa is described as the Mahāpuruṣa in the *Srimad-Bhagavatam* (Canto Eleven) in His devotional feature as Lord Sri Caitanya Mahāprabhu. Sri Caitanya Mahāprabhu is Lord Kṛṣṇa Himself in His devotional attitude, descended on earth to bestow special favors upon the fallen souls of this age of Kali. There are two verses particularly suitable to offer as prayers to this Mahāpuruṣa feature of Lord Kṛṣṇa.

*dhyeyaà sadā paribhava-ghnam abhēñña-dohaà
térthāspadaà śiva-virīci-nutaà śaraēyam
bhātyārti-haà praēata-pāla bhavābdhi-potaà
vande mahā-puruṣa te caraēāravindam*

*tyaktvā su-dustya-ja-surepsita-rājya-lakṣmēà
dharmiñña ārya-vacasā yad agād araēyam
māyā-māgaà dayitayepsitam anvadhavad
vande mahā-puruṣa te caraēāravindam*

(Bhāg. 11.5.33–34)

In other words, *puruṣa* means the enjoyer, and *mahāpuruṣa* means the supreme enjoyer, or the Supreme Personality of Godhead Sri Kṛṣṇa. One who deserves to approach the Supreme Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa is called the *mahā-pauruṇika*. Anyone who hears *Srimad-Bhagavatam* attentively from its bona fide reciter is sure to become a sincere devotee of the Lord, who is able to award liberation. There was none so attentive as Maharaja Parikṣit in the matter of hearing *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, and there was none so qualified as Sukadeva Gosvami to recite the text of *Srimad-Bhagavatam*. Therefore, anyone who follows in the footsteps of either the ideal reciter or

the ideal hearer, Sukadeva Gosvami and Maharaja Parikṣit respectively, will undoubtedly attain salvation like them. Maharaja Parikṣit attained salvation by hearing only, and Sukadeva Gosvami attained salvation only by reciting. Recitation and hearing are two processes out of nine devotional activities, and by strenuously following the principles, either in all or by parts, one can attain the absolute plane. So the complete text of *Srīmad-Bhagavatam*, beginning with the *janmādy asya* [SB 1.1.1] verse up to the last one in the Twelfth Canto, was spoken by Sukadeva Gosvami for the attainment of salvation by Maharaja Parikṣit. In the *Padma Purāṇa*, it is mentioned that Gautama Muni advised Maharaja Ambarīṣa to hear regularly *Srīmad-Bhagavatam* as it was recited by Sukadeva Gosvami, and herein it is confirmed that Maharaja Ambarīṣa heard *Srīmad-Bhagavatam* from the very beginning to the end, as it was spoken by Sukadeva Gosvami. One who is actually interested in the *Bhāgavatam*, therefore, must not play with it by reading or hearing a portion from here and a portion from there; one must follow in the footsteps of great kings like Maharaja Ambarīṣa or Maharaja Parikṣit and hear it from a bona fide representative of Sukadeva Gosvami.

TEXT 11

WTaiàivRÛMaaNaaNaaiMaC^TaaMaku-Taae>aYaMa()
YaaeiGaNa& Na*Pa iNa<asTa& hreNaaRMaaNauk-ITaRNaMa()) 11))

etan nirvidyamānānām

icchatām akuto-bhayam

yoginā nāpa nirēta

harer nāmānukērtanam

SYNONYMS

etat—it is; *nirvidyamānānām*—of those who are completely free from all material desires; *icchatām*—of those who are desirous of all sorts of material enjoyment; *akutaù-bhayam*—free from all doubts and fear; *yoginām*—of all who are self-satisfied; *nāpa*—O King; *nirētam*—decided

truth; *hareù*—of the Lord, Sri Kṛṣṇa; *näma*—holy name; *anu*—after someone, always; *kértanam*—chanting.

TRANSLATION

O King, constant chanting of the holy name of the Lord after the ways of the great authorities is the doubtless and fearless way of success for all, including those who are free from all material desires, those who are desirous of all material enjoyment, and also those who are self-satisfied by dint of transcendental knowledge.

PURPORT

In the previous verse, the great necessity for attaining attachment to Mukunda has been accredited. There are different types of persons who desire to attain success in different varieties of pursuits. Generally the persons are materialists who desire to enjoy the fullest extent of material gratification. Next to them are the transcendentalists, who have attained perfect knowledge about the nature of material enjoyment and thus are aloof from such an illusory way of life. More or less, they are satisfied in themselves by self-realization. Above them are the devotees of the Lord, who neither aspire to enjoy the material world nor desire to get out of it. They are after the satisfaction of the Lord, Sri Kṛṣṇa. In other words, the devotees of the Lord do not want anything on their personal account. If the Lord desires, the devotees can accept all sorts of material facilities, and if the Lord does not desire this, the devotees can leave aside all sorts of facilities, even up to the limit of salvation. Nor are they self-satisfied, because they want the satisfaction of the Lord only. In this verse, Sri Sukadeva Gosvami recommends the transcendental chanting of the holy name of the Lord. By offenseless chanting and hearing of the holy name of the Lord, one becomes acquainted with the transcendental form of the Lord, and then with the attributes of the Lord, and then with the transcendental nature of His pastimes, etc. Here it is mentioned that one should constantly chant the holy name of the Lord after hearing it from authorities. This means that hearing from the authorities is the first essential. Hearing of the holy name gradually promotes one to the stage of hearing about His form, about His attributes, His pastimes and so on, and

thus the necessity of the chanting of His glories develops successively. This process is recommended not only for the successful execution of devotional service, but also even for those who are materially attached. According to Sri Sukadeva Gosvami, this way of attaining success is an established fact, concluded not only by him, but also by all other previous *ācāryas*. Therefore, there is no need of further evidence. The process is recommended not only for the progressive students in different departments of ideological success, but also for those who are already successful in their achievement as fruitive workers, as philosophers or as devotees of the Lord.

Srila Jiva Gosvami instructs that chanting of the holy name of the Lord should be loudly done, and it should be performed offenselessly as well, as recommended in the *Padma Purana*. One can deliver himself from the effects of all sins by surrendering himself unto the Lord. One can deliver himself from all offenses at the feet of the Lord by taking shelter of His holy name. But one cannot protect himself if one commits an offense at the feet of the holy name of the Lord. Such offenses are mentioned in the *Padma Purana* as being ten in number. The first offense is to vilify the great devotees who have preached about the glories of the Lord. The second offense is to see the holy names of the Lord in terms of worldly distinction. The Lord is the proprietor of all the universes, and therefore He may be known in different places by different names, but that does not in any way qualify the fullness of the Lord. Any nomenclature which is meant for the Supreme Lord is as holy as the others because they are all meant for the Lord. Such holy names are as powerful as the Lord, and there is no bar for anyone in any part of the creation to chant and glorify the Lord by the particular name of the Lord as it is locally understood. They are all auspicious, and one should not distinguish such names of the Lord as material commodities. The third offense is to neglect the orders of the authorized *ācāryas* or spiritual masters. The fourth offense is to vilify scriptures or Vedic knowledge. The fifth offense is to define the holy name of the Lord in terms of one's mundane calculation. The holy name of the Lord is identical with the Lord Himself, and one should understand the holy name of the Lord to be nondifferent from Him. The sixth offense is to interpret the holy name. The Lord is not imaginary, nor is His holy name. There are persons with a poor fund of knowledge who think the Lord to be

an imagination of the worshiper and therefore think His holy name to be imaginary. Such a chanter of the name of the Lord cannot achieve the desired success in the matter of chanting the holy name. The seventh offense is to commit sins intentionally on the strength of the holy name. In the scriptures it is said that one can be liberated from the effects of all sinful actions simply by chanting the holy name of the Lord. One who takes advantage of this transcendental method and continues to commit sins on the expectation of neutralizing the effects of sins by chanting the holy name of the Lord is the greatest offender at the feet of the holy name. Such an offender cannot purify himself by any recommended method of purification. In other words, one may be a sinful man before chanting the holy name of the Lord, but after taking shelter in the holy name of the Lord and becoming immune, one should strictly restrain oneself from committing sinful acts with a hope that his method of chanting the holy name will give him protection. The eighth offense is to consider the holy name of the Lord and His chanting method to be equal to some material auspicious activity. There are various kinds of good works for material benefits, but the holy name and His chanting are not mere auspicious holy services. Undoubtedly the holy name is holy service, but He should never be utilized for such purposes. Since the holy name and the Lord are of one and the same identity, one should not try to bring the holy name into the service of mankind. The idea is that the Supreme Lord is the supreme enjoyer. He is no one's servant or order supplier. Similarly, since the holy name of the Lord is identical with the Lord, one should not try to utilize the holy name for one's personal service.

The ninth offense is to instruct those who are not interested in chanting the holy name of the Lord about the transcendental nature of the holy name, if such instruction is imparted to an unwilling audience, the act is considered to be an offense at the feet of the holy name. The tenth offense is to become uninterested in the holy name of the Lord even after hearing of the transcendental nature of the holy name. The effect of chanting the holy name of the Lord is perceived by the chanter as liberation from the conception of false egoism. False egoism is exhibited by thinking oneself to be the enjoyer of the world and thinking everything in the world to be meant for the enjoyment of one's self only. The whole materialistic world is moving under such false egoism of "I" and "mine," but the factual effect of

chanting the holy name is to become free from such misconceptions.

TEXT 12

ik&- Pa[MataSYa bhui>a" Parae+aEhaRYaNaEirh)
vr& MauhUTa| ividTa& ga\$=Tae é[eYaSae YaTa")) 12))

kià pramattasya bahubhiù

parokñair häyanair iha

varaà muhūrtaà viditaà

ghaöate çreyase yataù

SYNONYMS

kim—what is; *pramattasya*—of the bewildered; *bahubhiù*—by many; *parokñaiù*—inexperienced; *häyanaiù*—years; *iha*—in this world; *varam*—better; *muhūrtam*—a moment; *viditam*—conscious; *ghaöate*—one can try for; *çreyase*—in the matter of the supreme interest; *yataù*—by that.

TRANSLATION

What is the value of a prolonged life which is wasted, inexperienced by years in this world? Better a moment of full consciousness, because that gives one a start in searching after his supreme interest.

PURPORT

Srila Sukadeva Gosvami instructed Maharaja Pariksit about the importance of the chanting of the holy name of the Lord by every progressive gentleman. In order to encourage the Ding, who had only seven remaining days of life, Srila Sukadeva Gosvami asserted that there is no use in living hundreds of years without any knowledge of the problems of life—better to live for a moment with full consciousness of the supreme interest to be fulfilled. The supreme interest of life is eternal, with full knowledge and

bliss. Those who are bewildered by the external features of the material world and are engaged in the animal propensities of the eat-drink-and-be-merry type of life are simply wasting their lives by the unseen passing away of valuable years. We should know in perfect consciousness that human life is bestowed upon the conditioned soul to achieve spiritual success, and the easiest possible procedure to attain this end is to chant the holy name of the Lord. In the previous verse, we have discussed this point to a certain extent, and we may further be enlightened on the different types of offenses committed unto the feet of the holy name. Srila Jiva Gosvami Prabhu has quoted many passages from authentic scriptures and has ably supported the statements in the matter of offenses at the feet of the holy name. From *Viṣṇu-yāmala Tantra*, Srila Jiva Gosvami has proven that one can be liberated from the effects of all sins simply by chanting the holy name of the Lord. Quoting from the *Markandeya Purana*, Sri Gosvamijé says that one should neither blaspheme the devotee of the Lord nor indulge in hearing others who are engaged in belittling a devotee of the Lord. A devotee should try to restrict the vilifier by cutting out his tongue, and being unable to do so, one should commit suicide rather than hear the blaspheming of the devotee of the Lord. The conclusion is that one should neither hear nor allow vilification of a devotee of the Lord. As far as distinguishing the Lord's holy name from the names of the demigods, the revealed scriptures disclose (Bg. 10.41) that all extraordinarily powerful beings are but parts and parcels of the supreme energetic, Lord Kṛṣṇa. Except for the Lord Himself, everyone is subordinate; no one is independent of the Lord. Since no one is more powerful than or equal to the energy of the Supreme Lord, no one's name can be as powerful as that of the Lord. By chanting the Lord's holy name, one can derive all the stipulated energy synchronized from all sources. Therefore, one should not equalize the supreme holy name of the Lord with any other name. Brahmā, Siva or any other powerful god can never be equal to the Supreme Lord Viṣṇu. The powerful holy name of the Lord can certainly deliver one from sinful effects, but one who desires to utilize this transcendental potency of the holy name of the Lord in one's sinister activities is the most degraded person in the world. Such persons are never excused by the Lord or by any agent of the Lord. One should, therefore, utilize one's life in glorifying the Lord by all means, without any offense. Such activity of life, even for a moment, is never to be compared to a prolonged life of ignorance, like the

lives of the tree and other living entities who may live for thousands of years without prosecuting spiritual advancement.

TEXT 13

%Èa®ae NaaMa raJaizRjaRTveYataaiMahaYauz")
MauhUTaaRTSavRMauTSa*JYa GaTavaNa>aYa& hirMa()) 13))

khaöväiga nāma rājarñir

jīatveyattām ihāyuñau

muhürtāt sarvam utsājya

gatavān abhayaà harim

SYNONYMS

khaöväiga—King Khaöväiga; *nāma*—name; *rāja-āñiù*—saintly king; *jīātvā*—by knowing; *iyattām*—duration; *iha*—in this world; *āyuñau*—of one's life; *muhürtāt*—within only a moment; *sarvam*—everything; *utsājya*—leaving aside; *gatavān*—had undergone; *abhaya*—fully safe; *harim*—the Personality of Godhead.

TRANSLATION

The saintly King Khaöväiga, after being informed that the duration of his life would be only a moment more, at once freed himself from all material activities and took shelter of the supreme safety, the Personality of Godhead.

PURPORT

A fully responsible man should always be conscious of the prime duty of the present human form of life. The activities to meet the immediate necessities of material life are not everything. One should always be alert in his duty for attainment of the best situation in the next life. Human life is

meant for preparing ourselves for that prime duty. Maharaja Khaöväiga is mentioned herein as a saintly king because even within the responsibility of the state management, he was not at all forgetful of the prime duty of life. Such was the case with other *räjarñis* (saintly kings), like Maharaja Yudhiñöhira and Maharaja Pariksit. They were all exemplary personalities on account of their being alert in discharging their prime duty. Maharaja Khaöväiga was invited by the demigods in the higher planets to fight demons, and as a king he fought the battles to the full satisfaction of the demigods. The demigods, being fully satisfied with him, wanted to give him some benediction for material enjoyment, but Maharaja Khaöväiga, being very much alert to his prime duty, inquired from the demigods about his remaining duration of life. This means that he was not as anxious to accumulate some material benediction from the demigods as he was to prepare himself for the next life. He was informed by the demigods, however, that his life would last only a moment longer. The king at once left the heavenly kingdom, which is always full of material enjoyment of the highest standard, and coming down to this earth, took ultimate shelter of the all-safe Personality of Godhead. He was successful in his great attempt and achieved liberation. This attempt, even for a moment, by the saintly king, was successful because he was always alert to his prime duty. Maharaja Pariksit was thus encouraged by the great Sukadeva Gosvami, even though he had only seven days left in his life to execute the prime duty of hearing the glories of the Lord in the form of *Srimad-Bhagavatam*. By the will of the Lord, Maharaja Pariksit instantly met the great Sukadeva Gosvami, and thus the great treasure of spiritual success left by him is nicely mentioned in the *Srimad-Bhagavatam*.

TEXT 14

**TavaPYaeTaihR k-aErVYa Saáah& JaqivTaaviDa")
oPak-LPaYa TaTSav| TaavÛTSaaMParaiYak-Ma()) 14))**

taväpy etarhi kauravya

saptähaà jévitävadhiù

upakalpaya tat sarvaà

tävad yat sämparäyikam

SYNONYMS

tava—your; *api*—also; *etarhi*—therefore; *kauravya*—O one born in the family of Kuru; *saptāham*—seven days; *jévita*—duration of life; *avadhiù*—up to the limit of; *upakalpaya*—get them performed; *tat*—those; *sarvam*—all; *tävat*—so long; *yat*—which are; *sämparäyikam*—rituals for the next life.

TRANSLATION

Maharaja Pariksit, now your duration of life is limited to seven more days, so during this time you can perform all those rituals which are needed for the best purpose of your next life.

PURPORT

Sukadeva Gosvami, after citing the example of Maharaja Khaöväiga, who prepared himself for the next life within a very short time, encouraged Maharaja Pariksit by saying that since he still had seven days at his disposal, he could easily take advantage of the time to prepare himself for the next life. Indirectly, the Gosvami told Maharaja Pariksit that he should take shelter of the sound representation of the Lord for the seven days still remaining in the duration of his life and thus get himself liberated. In other words, everyone can best prepare himself for the next life simply by hearing *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, as it was recited by Sukadeva Gosvami to Maharaja Pariksit. The rituals are not formal, but there are also some favorable conditions, which are required to be carried out, as instructed hereafter.

TEXT 15

**ANTak-ale/ Tau Pauáz AaGaTae GaTaSaaßSa")
i^NÛadSa®Xañe<a SPa*ha& dehe_Nau Yae c TaMa()) 15))**

anta-käle tu puruṣa

ägate gata-sādhvasaù

chindyäd asaiga-çastreëa

spåhää dehe 'nu ye ca tam

SYNONYMS

anta-käle—at the last stage of life; *tu*—but; *puruṣaù*—a person; *ägate*—having arrived; *gata-sādhvasaù*—without any fear of death; *chindyät*—must cut off; *asaiga*—nonattachment; *çastreëa*—by the weapon of; *spåhäm*—all desires; *dehe*—in the matter of the material tabernacle; *anu*—pertaining; *ye*—all that; *ca*—also; *tam*—them.

TRANSLATION

At the last stage of one's life, one should be bold enough not to be afraid of death. But one must cut off all attachment to the material body and everything pertaining to it and all desires thereof.

PURPORT

The foolishness of gross materialism is that people think of making a permanent settlement in this world, although it is a settled fact that one has to give up everything here that has been created by valuable human energy. Great statesmen, scientists, philosophers, etc., who are foolish, without any information of the spirit soul, think that this life of a few years only is all in all and that there is nothing more after death. This poor fund of knowledge, even in the so-called learned circles of the world, is killing the vitality of human energy, and the awful result is being keenly felt. And yet the foolish materialistic men do not care about what is going to happen in the next life. The preliminary instruction in the *Bhagavad-gita* is that one should know that the identity of the individual living entity is not lost even after the end of this present body, which is nothing but an outward dress only. As one changes an old garment, so the individual living being also changes his body, and this change of body is called death. Death is therefore a process of changing the body at the end of the duration of the

present life. An intelligent person must be prepared for this and must try to have the best type of body in the next life. The best type of body is a spiritual body, which is obtained by those who go back to the kingdom of God or enter the realm of Brahman. In the second chapter of this canto, this matter will be broadly discussed, but as far as the change of body is concerned, one must prepare now for the next life. Foolish people attach more importance to the present temporary life, and thus the foolish leaders make appeals to the body and the bodily relations. The bodily relations extend not only to this body but also to the family members, wife, children, society, country and so many other things which end at the end of life. After death one forgets everything about the present bodily relations; we have a little experience of this at night when we go to sleep. While sleeping, we forget everything about this body and bodily relations, although this forgetfulness is a temporary situation for only a few hours. Death is nothing but sleeping for a few months in order to develop another term of bodily encagement, which we are awarded by the law of nature according to our aspiration. Therefore, one has only to change the aspiration during the course of this present body, and for this there is need of training in the current duration of human life. This training can be begun at any stage of life, or even a few seconds before death, but the usual procedure is for one to get the training from very early life, from the stage of *brahmacarya*, and gradually progress to the *grhastha*, *vānaprastha* and *sannyāsa* orders of life. The institution which gives such training is called *varēācrama-dharma*, or the system of *sanātana-dharma*, the best procedure for making the human life perfect. One is therefore required to give up the attachment to family or social or political life just at the age of fifty years, if not earlier, and the training in the *vānaprastha* and *sannyāsa-ācramas* is given for preparation of the next life. Foolish materialists, in the garb of leaders of the people in general, stick to family affairs without attempting to cut off relations with them, and thus they become victims of nature's law and get gross bodies again, according to their work. Such foolish leaders may have some respect from the people at the end of life, but that does not mean that such leaders will be immune to the natural laws under which everyone is tightly bound by the hands and feet. The best thing is, therefore, that everyone voluntarily give up family relations by transferring attachment from family, society, country, and everything thereof to the devotional service of the Lord. It is stated herein that one

should give up all desires of family attachment. One must have a chance for better desires; otherwise there is no chance of giving up such morbid desires. Desire is the concomitant factor of the living entity. The living entity is eternal, and therefore his desires, which are natural for a living being, are also eternal. One cannot, therefore, stop desiring, but the subject matter for desires can be changed. So one must develop the desires for returning back home, back to Godhead, and automatically the desires for material gain, material honor and material popularity will diminish in proportion to the development of devotional service. A living being is meant for service activities, and his desires are centered around such a service attitude. Beginning from the top executive head of the state down to the insignificant pauper in the street, all are rendering some sort of service to others. The perfection of such a service attitude is only attained simply by transferring the desire of service from matter to spirit, or from Satan to God.

TEXT 16

Ga*haTa(Pa[v]iJaTaae Daqr" Pau<YaTaqQaRJal/aPlu/Ta")
éucaE ivivç- AaSaqNaae iviDavTk-iLPaTaaSaNaE)) 16))

gāhāt pravrajito dhēraù

puëya-tértha-jaläplutaù

çucau vivikta äséno

vidhivat kalpitäsane

SYNONYMS

gāhāt—from one's home; *pravrajitaù*—having gone out; *dhēraù*—self-controlled; *puëya*—pious; *tértha*—sacred place; *jala-äplutaù*—fully washed; *çucau*—cleansed; *vivikte*—solitary; *äsénaù*—seated; *vidhivat*—according to regulations; *kalpita*—having done; *äsane*—on a sitting place.

TRANSLATION

One should leave home and practice self-control. In a sacred place he should bathe regularly and sit down in a lonely place duly sanctified.

PURPORT

To prepare oneself for the better next life, one must get out of one's so-called home. The system of *varëāçrama-dharma*, or *sanātana-dharma*, prescribes retirement from family encumbrances as early as possible after one has passed fifty years of age. Modern civilization is based on family comforts, the highest standard of amenities, and therefore after retirement everyone expects to live a very comfortable life in a well-furnished home decorated with fine ladies and children, without any desire to get out of such a comfortable home. High government officers and ministers stick to their prize posts until death, and they neither dream nor desire to get out of homely comforts. Bound by such hallucinations, materialistic men prepare various plans for a still more comfortable life, but suddenly cruel death comes without mercy and takes away the great planmaker against his desire, forcing him to give up the present body for another body. Such a planmaker is thus forced to accept another body in one of the 8,400,000 species of life according to the fruits of the work he has performed. In the next life, persons who are too much attached to family comforts are generally awarded lower species of life on account of sinful acts performed during a long duration of sinful life, and thus all the energy of the human life is spoiled. In order to be saved from the danger of spoiling the human form of life and being attached to unreal things, one must take warning of death at the age of fifty, if not earlier. The principle is that one should take it for granted that the death warning is already there, even prior to the attainment of fifty years of age, and thus at any stage of life one should prepare himself for a better next life. The system of the *sanātana-dharma* institution is so made that the follower is trained for the better next life without any chance that the human life will be spoiled. The holy places all over the world are meant for the residential purposes of retired persons getting ready for a better next life. Intelligent persons must go there at the end of life, and for that matter, after fifty years of age, to live a life of spiritual regeneration for the sake of being freed from family attachment, which is considered to be the shackle of material life. One is recommended to quit home just to get rid of material attachment because one who sticks

to family life until death cannot get rid of material attachment and as long as one is materially attached one cannot understand spiritual freedom. One should not, however, become self-complacent simply by leaving home or by creating another home at the holy place, either lawfully or unlawfully. Many persons leave home and go to such holy places, but due to bad association, again become family men by illicit connection with the opposite sex. The illusory energy of matter is so strong that one is apt to be under such illusion at every stage of life, even after quitting one's happy home. Therefore, it is essential that one practice self-control by celibacy without the least desire for sex indulgence. For a man desiring to improve the condition of his existence, sex indulgence is considered suicidal, or even worse. Therefore, to live apart from family life means to become self-controlled in regard to all sense desires, especially sex desires. The method is that one should have a duly sanctified sitting place made of straw, deerskin and carpet, and thus sitting on it one should chant the holy name of the Lord without offense, as prescribed above. The whole process is to drag the mind from material engagements and fix it on the lotus feet of the Lord. This simple process alone will help one advance to the highest stage of spiritual success.

TEXT 17

**A>YaSaeNMaNaSaa éuÖ& i}av*d(b]øa+ar& ParMa()
MaNaæ YaC^eiÂTaiaSaae b]øbqJaMaivSMarNa()) 17))**

abhyasen manasā çuddhaà

trivåd-brahmākñaraà param

mano yacchej jita-çvāso

brahma-béjam avismaran

SYNONYMS

abhyaset—one should practice; *manasā*—by the mind; *çuddham*—sacred; *tri-våt*—composed of the three; *brahma-akñaram*—transcendental letters;

param—the supreme; *manaù*—mind; *yacchet*—get under control; *jita-çvāsaù*—by regulating the breathing air; *brahma*—absolute; *béjam*—seed; *avismaran*—without being forgotten.

TRANSLATION

After sitting in the above manner, make the mind remember the three transcendental letters [a-u-m], and by regulating the breathing process, control the mind so as not to forget the transcendental seed.

PURPORT

Oàkāra, or the *praëava*, is the seed of transcendental realization, and it is composed of the three transcendental letters *a-u-m*. By its chanting by the mind, in conjunction with the breathing process, which is a transcendental but mechanical way of getting into trance, as devised by the experience of great mystics, one is able to bring the mind, which is materially absorbed, under control. This is the way of changing the habit of the mind. The mind is not to be killed. Mind or desire cannot be stopped, but to develop a desire to function for spiritual realization, the quality of engagement by the mind has to be changed. The mind is the pivot of the active sense organs, and as such if the quality of thinking, feeling and willing is changed, naturally the quality of actions by the instrumental senses will also change. *Oàkāra* is the seed of all transcendental sound and it is only the transcendental sound which can bring about the desired change of the mind and the senses. Even a mentally deranged man can be cured by treatment of transcendental sound. In the *Bhagavad-gita*, the *praëava* (*oàkāra*) has been accepted as the direct, literal representation of the Supreme Absolute Truth. One who is not able to chant directly the holy name of the Lord, as recommended above, can easily chant the *praëava* (*oàkāra*). This *oàkāra* is a note of address, such as “O my Lord,” just as *oà hari om* means “O my Lord, the Supreme Personality of Godhead.” As we have explained before, the Lord’s holy name is identical with the Lord Himself. So also is *oàkāra*. But persons who are unable to realize the transcendental personal form or name of the Lord on account of their imperfect senses (in other words, the neophytes) are trained to the practice of self-realization by this mechanical process of regulating the

breathing function and simultaneously repeating the *praëava* (*oàkàra*) within the mind. As we have several times expressed, since the transcendental name, form, attributes, pastimes, etc., of the Personality of Godhead are impossible to understand with the present material senses, it is necessary that through the mind, the center of sensual activities, such transcendental realization be set into motion. The devotees directly fix their minds on the Person of the Absolute Truth. But one who is unable to accommodate such personal features of the Absolute is disciplined in impersonality to train the mind to make further progress.

TEXT 18

iNaYaC^eiÜzYae>Yaae_+aaNMaNaSaa buiÖSaariQa")
MaNa" k-MaRi>arai+aa& éu>aaQaeR DaarYaeiÖYaa)) 18))

niyacched viñayebhyo 'kñän

manasä buddhi-sārathiù

manaù karmabhir äkñiptaà

çubhärthe dhārayed dhiyā

SYNONYMS

niyacchet—withdraw; *viñayebhyaù*—from sense engagements; *akñän*—the senses; *manasä*—by dint of the mind; *buddhi*—intelligence; *sārathiù*—driver; *manaù*—the mind; *karmabhiù*—by the fruitive work; *äkñiptam*—being absorbed in; *çubha-arthe*—for the sake of the Lord; *dhārayet*—hold up; *dhiyā*—in full consciousness.

TRANSLATION

Gradually, as the mind becomes progressively spiritualized, withdraw it from sense activities, and by intelligence the senses will be controlled. The mind too absorbed in material activities can be engaged in the service of the Personality of Godhead and become fixed in full transcendental

consciousness.

PURPORT

The first process of spiritualizing the mind by mechanical chanting of the *praëava* (*oàkàra*) and by control of the breathing system is technically called the mystic or yogic process of *präëäyāma*, or fully controlling the breathing air. The ultimate state of this *präëäyāma* system is to be fixed in trance, technically called *samādhi*. But experience has proven that even the *samādhi* stage also fails to control the materially absorbed mind. For example, the great mystic Viçvämitra Muni, even in the stage of *samadhi*, became a victim of the senses and cohabited with Menakä. History has already recorded this. The mind, although ceasing to think of sensual activities at present, remembers past sensual activities from the subconscious status and thus disturbs one from cent percent engagement in self-realization. Therefore, Sukadeva Gosvami recommends the next step of assured policy, namely to fix one's mind in the service of the Personality of Godhead. Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, the Supreme Personality of Godhead, also recommends this direct process in the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (6.47). Thus, the mind being spiritually cleansed, one should at once engage himself in the transcendental loving service of the Lord by the different devotional activities of hearing, chanting, etc. If performed under proper guidance, that is the surest path of progress, even for the disturbed mind.

TEXT 19

Ta}aEk-avYav& DYaaYaedVYauic^àeNa ceTaSaa)
MaNaæe iNaivRzYa& Yau᳚-a TaTa" ik-ÄNa Na SMareTa()
Pad& TaTParMa& ivZ<aaæMaRNææ Ya}a Pa[SaqdiTa)) 19))

tatraikāvayavaà dhyäyed

avyucchinna cetasä

mano nirviñayaà yuktvä

tataù kiïcana na smaret

padaà tat paramaà viñëor

mano yatra prasédati

SYNONYMS

tatra—thereafter; *eka*—one by one; *avayavam*—limbs of the body; *dhyäyet*—should be concentrated upon; *avyucchinnena*—without being deviated from the complete form; *cetasä*—by the mind; *manaù*—mind; *nirviñayam*—without being contaminated by sense objects; *yuktvä*—being dovetailed; *tataù*—after that; *kiiicana*—anything; *na*—do not; *smaret*—think of; *padam*—personality; *tat*—that; *paramam*—Supreme; *viñëou*—of Viṣṇu; *manaù*—the mind; *yatra*—whereupon; *prasédati*—becomes reconciled.

TRANSLATION

Thereafter, you should meditate upon the limbs of Viṣṇu, one after another, without being deviated from the conception of the complete body. Thus the mind becomes free from all sense objects. There should be no other thing to be thought upon. Because the Supreme Personality of Godhead, Viṣṇu, is the Ultimate Truth, the mind becomes completely reconciled in Him only.

PURPORT

Foolish persons, bewildered by the external energy of Viṣṇu, do not know that the ultimate goal of the progressive search after happiness is to get in touch directly with Lord Viṣṇu, the Personality of Godhead. *Viṣṇu-tattva* is an unlimited expansion of different transcendental forms of the Personality of Godhead, and the supreme or original form of *viṣṇu-tattva* is Govinda, or Lord Kṛṣṇa, the supreme cause of all causes. Therefore, thinking of Viṣṇu or meditating upon the transcendental form of Viṣṇu, specifically upon Lord Kṛṣṇa, is the last word on the subject of meditation. This meditation may be begun from the lotus feet of the Lord. One should not, however, forget or be misled from the complete form of the Lord; thus one should practice thinking of the different parts of His transcendental body, one after

another. Here in this verse, it is definitely assured that the Supreme Lord is not impersonal. He is a person, but His body is different from those of conditioned persons like us. Otherwise, meditation beginning from the *praëava* (*oàkàra*) up to the limbs of the personal body of Viṣṇu would not have been recommended by Sukadeva Gosvami for the attainment of complete spiritual perfection. The Viṣṇu forms of worship in great temples of India are not, therefore, arrangements of idol worship, as they are wrongly interpreted to be by a class of men with a poor fund of knowledge; rather, they are different spiritual centers of meditation on the transcendental limbs of the body of Viṣṇu. The worshipable Deity in the temple of Viṣṇu is identical with Lord Viṣṇu by the inconceivable potency of the Lord. Therefore, a neophyte's concentration or meditation upon the limbs of Viṣṇu in the temple, as contemplated in the revealed scriptures, is an easy opportunity for meditation for persons who are unable to sit down tightly at one place and then concentrate upon *praëava oàkàra* or the limbs of the body of Viṣṇu, as recommended herein by Sukadeva Gosvami, the great authority. The common man can benefit more by meditating on the form of Viṣṇu in the temple than on the *oàkàra*, the spiritual combination of *a-u-m* as explained before. There is no difference between *oàkàra* and the forms of Viṣṇu, but persons unacquainted with the science of Absolute Truth try to create dissension by differentiating between the forms of Viṣṇu and that of *oàkàra*. Here it is indicated that the Viṣṇu form is the ultimate goal of meditation, and as such it is better to concentrate upon the forms of Viṣṇu than on impersonal *oàkàra*. The latter process is also more difficult than the former.

TEXT 20

**rJaSTaMaae>YaaMaai+aá& ivMaU!& MaNa AaTMaNa")
YaC^eÖar<aYaa Daqrae hiNTa Yaa TaTk*-Ta& Mal/Ma()) 20))**

rajas-tamobhyām ākñiptaà

vimüðhaà mana ātmanaù

yacched dhāraëayā dhéro

hanti yä tat-kātaà malam

SYNONYMS

rajaù—the passionate mode of nature; *tamobhyäm*—as well as by the ignorant mode of material nature; *äkñiptam*—agitated; *vimüòham*—bewildered; *manaù*—the mind; *ätmanaù*—of one’s own; *yacchet*—get it rectified; *dhāraëyā*—by conception (of Viṣṇu); *dhéraù*—the pacified; *hanti*—destroys; *yä*—all those; *tat-kātam*—done by them; *malam*—dirty things.

TRANSLATION

One’s mind is always agitated by the passionate mode of material nature and bewildered by the ignorant mode of nature. But one can rectify such conceptions by the relation of Viṣṇu and thus become pacified by cleansing the dirty things created by them.

PURPORT

Persons generally conducted by the modes of passion and ignorance cannot be bona fide candidates for being situated in the transcendental stage of God realization. Only persons conducted by the mode of goodness can have the knowledge of the Supreme Truth. Effects of the modes of passion and ignorance are manifested by too much hankering after wealth and women. And those who are too much after wealth and women can rectify their leanings only by constant remembrance of Viṣṇu in His potential impersonal feature. Generally the impersonalists or monists are influenced by the modes of passion and ignorance. Such impersonalists think of themselves as liberated souls, but they have no knowledge of the transcendental personal feature of the Absolute Truth. Actually they are impure in heart on account of being devoid of knowledge of the personal feature of the Absolute. In the *Bhagavad-gita*, it is said that after many hundreds of births, the impersonal philosopher surrenders unto the Personality of Godhead. To acquire such a qualification of God realization in the personal feature, the neophyte impersonalist is given a chance to realize the relation of the Lord in everything by the philosophy of

pantheism.

Pantheism in its higher status does not permit the student to form an impersonal conception of the Absolute Truth, but it extends the conception of the Absolute Truth into the field of the so-called material energy. Everything created by the material energy can be dovetailed with the Absolute by an attitude of service, which is the essential part of living energy. The pure devotee of the Lord knows the art of converting everything into its spiritual existence by this service attitude, and only in that devotional way can the theory of pantheism be perfected.

TEXT 21

YaSYaa& SaNDaaYaRMaa<aaYaa& YaaeiGaNaee >aiç-l/+a<a")
Aaéu SaMPaÛTae YaaeGa Aaé[Ya& >ad]Maq+aTa")) 21))

yasyää sandhāryamäëäyää

yogino bhakti-lakñäëaù

äçu sampadyate yoga

äçrayaà bhadram ékñataù

SYNONYMS

yasyām—by such systematic remembrance; *sandhāryamäëäyām*—and thus being fixed in the habit of; *yoginaù*—the mystics; *bhakti-lakñäëaù*—being practiced to the devotional system; *äçu*—very soon; *sampadyate*—attains success; *yogaù*—connection by devotional service; *äçrayam*—under the shelter of; *bhadram*—the all-good; *ékñataù*—which seeing that.

TRANSLATION

O King, by this system of remembrance and by being fixed in the habit of seeing the all-good personal conception of the Lord, one can very soon attain devotional service to the Lord, under His direct shelter.

PURPORT

Success of mystic performances is achieved only by the help of the devotional attitude. Pantheism, or the system of feeling the presence of the Almighty everywhere, is a sort of training of the mind to become accustomed to the devotional conception, and it is this devotional attitude of the mystic that makes possible the successful termination of such mystic attempts. One is not, however, elevated to such a successful status without the tinge of mixture in devotional service. The devotional atmosphere created by pantheistic vision develops into devotional service in later days, and that is the only benefit for the impersonalist. It is confirmed in the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (12.5) that the impersonal way of self-realization is more troublesome because it reaches the goal in an indirect way, although the impersonalist also becomes obsessed with the personal feature of the Lord after a long time.

TEXT 22

raJaaevac

YaQaa SaNDaaYaRTae b]øNa(Daar<aa Ya}a SaMMaTaa)
Yaad*Xaq va hredaéu PauåzSYa MaNaaeMal/Ma()) 22))

räjovāca

yathā sandhāryate brahman

dhāraëä yatra sammatä

yädâçé vā hared āçu

puruṣasya mano-malam

SYNONYMS

räjä uvāca—the fortunate King said; *yathā*—as it is; *sandhāryate*—the conception is made; *brahman*—O *brahmana*; *dhāraëä*—conception; *yatra*—where and how; *sammata*—in a summary; *yädâçé*—the way by

which; *vä*—or; *haret*—extricated; *äçu*—without delay; *puruṣasya*—of a person; *manaù*—of the mind; *malam*—dirty things.

TRANSLATION

The fortunate King Pariksit, inquiring further, said: O brahmana, please describe in full detail how and where the mind has to be applied and how the conception can be fixed so that the dirty things in a person's mind can be removed.

PURPORT

The dirty things in the heart of a conditioned soul are the root cause of all troubles for him. A conditioned soul is surrounded by the manifold miseries of material existence, but on account of his gross ignorance he is unable to remove the troubles due to dirty things in the heart, accumulated during the long prison life in the material world. He is actually meant to serve the will of the Supreme Lord, but on account of the dirty things in the heart, he likes to serve his concocted desires. These desires, instead of giving him any peace of mind, create new problems and thus bind him to the cycle of repeated birth and death. These dirty things of fruitive work and empiric philosophy can be removed only by association with the Supreme Lord. The Lord, being omnipotent, can offer His association by His inconceivable potencies. Thus persons who are unable to pin their faith on the personal feature of the Absolute are given a chance to associate with His *virāṭ-rūpa*, or the cosmic impersonal feature of the Lord. The cosmic impersonal feature of the Lord is a feature of His unlimited potencies. Since the potent and potencies are identical, even the conception of His impersonal cosmic feature helps the conditioned soul to associate with the Lord indirectly and thus gradually rise to the stage of personal contact.

Maharaja Pariksit was already directly connected with the personal feature of the Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, and as such he had no need to inquire from Sukadeva Gosvami about where and how to apply the mind in the impersonal *virāṭ-rūpa* of the Lord. But he inquired after a detailed description of the matter for the benefit of others, who are unable to conceive of the transcendental personal feature of the Lord as the form of eternity, knowledge and bliss.

The nondevotee class of men cannot think of the personal feature of the Lord. Because of their poor fund of knowledge, the personal form of the Lord, like Rāma or Kṛṣṇa, is completely revolting to them. They have a poor estimation of the potency of the Lord. In the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (9.11) it is explained by the Lord Himself that people with a poor fund of knowledge deride the supreme personality of the Lord, taking Him to be a common man. Such men are ignorant of the inconceivable potency of the Lord. By the inconceivable potency of the Lord, He can move in human society or any other society of living beings and yet remain the same omnipotent Lord, without deviating in the slightest from His transcendental position. So, for the benefit of men who are unable to accept the Lord in His personal eternal form, Maharaja Parikṣit inquired from Sukadeva Gosvami how to fix the mind on Him in the beginning, and the Gosvami replied in detail as follows.

TEXT 23

é[qéuk- ovac
iJaTaaSaNaæ iJaTaiaSaae iJaTaSa®æ iJaTaeiNd]Ya")
SQaUle/ >aGavTaaæ æPae MaNa" SaN DaarYaeiÖYaa)) 23))

çré-çuka uvāca

jitāsano jita-çvāso

jita-saigo jitendriyaù

sthüle bhagavato rūpe

manaù sandhārayed dhiyā

SYNONYMS

çré-çukaù uvāca—Sukadeva Gosvami said; *jita-āsanaù*—controlled sitting posture; *jita-çvāsaù*—controlled breathing process; *jita-saigaù*—controlled association; *jita-indriyaù*—controlled senses; *sthüle*—in the gross matter; *bhagavataù*—unto the Personality of Godhead; *rūpe*—in the feature of;

manaù—the mind; *sandhārayet*—must apply; *dhiyā*—by intelligence.

TRANSLATION

Sukadeva Gosvami answered: One should control the sitting posture, regulate the breathing process by the yogic *prāëyāma* and thus control the mind and senses and with intelligence apply the mind to the gross potencies of the Lord [called the *virāṭ-rūpa*].

PURPORT

The materially absorbed mind of the conditioned soul does not allow him to transcend the limit of the bodily conception of self, and thus the *yoga* system for meditation (controlling the sitting posture and breathing process and fixing the mind upon the Supreme) is prescribed in order to mold the character of the gross materialist. Unless such materialists are able to cleanse the materially absorbed mind, it is impossible for them to concentrate upon thoughts of transcendence. And to do so one may fix one's mind on the gross material or external feature of the Lord. The different parts of the gigantic form of the Lord are described in the following verses. The materialistic men are very anxious to have some mystic powers as a result of such a controlling process, but the real purpose of yogic regulations is to eradicate the accumulated dirty things like lust, anger, avarice and all such material contaminations. If the mystic *yogé* is diverted by the accompanying feats of mystic control, then his mission of yogic success is a failure, because the ultimate aim is God realization. He is therefore recommended to fix his gross materialistic mind by a different conception and thus realize the potency of the Lord. As soon as the potencies are understood to be instrumental manifestations of the transcendence, one automatically advances to the next step, and gradually the stage of full realization becomes possible for him.

TEXT 24

**ivXaezSTaSYa dehae_Ya& SQaivië SQavqYaSaaMa()
Ya}aed& VYaJYaTae ivi& >aUTa& >aVYa& >avÀ SaTa()) 24))**

viṣeṇas tasya deho 'yaà

sthaviñöhaç ca sthavéyasäm

yatreäà vyajyate viçvaà

bhütaà bhavyaà bhavac ca sat

SYNONYMS

viṣeṇa—personal; *tasya*—His; *deha*—body; *aya*—this; *sthaviñöha*—grossly material; *ca*—and; *sthavéyasäm*—of all matter; *yatra*—wherein; *idam*—all these phenomena; *vyajyate*—is experienced; *viçvam*—universe; *bhütam*—past; *bhavyam*—future; *bhavat*—present; *ca*—and; *sat*—resultant.

TRANSLATION

This gigantic manifestation of the phenomenal material world as a whole is the personal body of the Absolute Truth, wherein the universal resultant past, present and future of material time is experienced.

PURPORT

Anything, either material or spiritual, is but an expansion of the energy of the Supreme Personality of Godhead, and as stated in the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (13.13), the omnipotent Lord has His transcendental eyes, heads and other bodily parts distributed everywhere. He can see, hear, touch or manifest Himself anywhere and everywhere, for He is present everywhere as the Supersoul of all infinitesimal souls, although He has His particular abode in the absolute world. The relative world is also His phenomenal representation because it is nothing but an expansion of His transcendental energy. Although He is in His abode, His energy is distributed everywhere, just as the sun is localized as well as expanded everywhere, since the rays of the sun, being nondifferent from the sun, are accepted as expansions of the sun disc. In the ***Viṣṇu Purana*** (1.22.52) it is said that as fire expands its rays and heat from one place, similarly the Supreme Spirit, the Personality

of Godhead, expands Himself by His manifold energy everywhere and anywhere. The phenomenal manifestation of the gigantic universe is only a part of His *virāḍ* body. Less intelligent men cannot conceive of the transcendental all-spiritual form of the Lord, but they are astounded by His different energies, just as the aborigines are struck with wonder by the manifestation of lightning, a gigantic mountain or a hugely expanded banyan tree. The aborigines praise the strength of the tiger and the elephant because of their superior energy and strength. The *asuras* cannot recognize the existence of the Lord, although there are vivid descriptions of the Lord in the revealed scriptures, although the Lord incarnates and exhibits His uncommon strength and energy, and although He is accepted as the Supreme Personality of Godhead by learned scholars and saints like Vyāsadeva, Nārada, Asita and Devala in the past and by Arjuna in the *Bhagavad-gita*, as also by the *ācāryas* like Čaikara, Rāmānuja, Madhva and Lord Sri Caitanya in the modern age. The *asuras* do not accept any evidential proof from the revealed scriptures, nor do they recognize the authority of the great *ācāryas*. They want to see with their own eyes at once. Therefore they can see the gigantic body of the Lord as *virāḍ*, which will answer their challenge, and since they are accustomed to paying homage to superior material strength like that of the tiger, elephant and lightning, they can offer respect to the *virāṭ-rūpa*. Lord Kṛṣṇa, by the request of Arjuna, exhibited His *virāṭ-rūpa* for the *asuras*. A pure devotee of the Lord, being unaccustomed to looking into such a mundane gigantic form of the Lord, requires special vision for the purpose. The Lord, therefore, favored Arjuna with special vision for looking into His *virāṭ-rūpa*, which is described in the Eleventh Chapter of the *Bhagavad-gita*. This *virāṭ-rūpa* of the Lord was especially manifested, not for the benefit of Arjuna, but for that unintelligent class of men who accept anyone and everyone as an incarnation of the Lord and so mislead the general mass of people. For them, the indication is that one should ask the cheap incarnation to exhibit his *virāṭ-rūpa* and thus be established as an incarnation. The *virāṭ-rūpa* manifestation of the Lord is simultaneously a challenge to the atheist and a favor for the *asuras*, who can think of the Lord as *virāḍ* and thus gradually cleanse the dirty things from their hearts in order to become qualified to actually see the transcendental form of the Lord in the near future. This is a favor of the all-merciful Lord to the atheists and the gross materialists.

TEXT 25

A<@k-aeXae Xarqre_iSMaNa(Saáavr<aSa&YauTae)
vEraJa" Pauåzae Yaae_SaaE >aGavaNa(Daar<aaé[Ya")) 25))

aëða-koçe çarére 'smin

saptāvaraëa-saàyute

vairājaù puruño yo 'sau

bhagavān dhāraëäçrayaù

SYNONYMS

aëða-koçe—within the universal shell; *çarére*—in the body of; *asmin*—this; *sapta*—sevenfold; *āvaraëa*—coverings; *saàyute*—having so done; *vairājaù*—the gigantic universal; *puruṣaù*—form of the Lord; *yaù*—that; *asau*—He; *bhagavān*—the Personality of Godhead; *dhāraëä*—conception; *äçrayaù*—object of.

TRANSLATION

The gigantic universal form of the Personality of Godhead, within the body of the universal shell, which is covered by sevenfold material elements, is the subject for the viräo conception.

PURPORT

Simultaneously, the Lord has multifarious other forms, and all of them are identical with the original fountainhead form of the Lord, Sri Kṛṣṇa. In the *Bhagavad-gita*, it has been proven that the original transcendental and eternal form of the Lord is Sri Kṛṣṇa, the Absolute Personality of Godhead, but by His inconceivable internal potency, *ātma-māyā*, He can expand Himself by multifarious forms and incarnations simultaneously, without being diminished in His full potency. He is complete, and although innumerable complete forms emanate from Him, He is still complete,

without any loss. That is His spiritual or internal potency. In the Eleventh Chapter of the *Bhagavad-gita*, the personality of Godhead, Lord Kṛṣṇa, manifested His *virāṭ-rūpa* just to convince the less intelligent class of men, who cannot conceive of the Lord as appearing just like a human being, that He factually has the potency of His claim to be the Supreme Absolute person without any rival or superior. Materialistic men can think, although very imperfectly, of the huge universal space, comprehending an innumerable number of planets as big as the sun. They can see only the circular sky overhead, without any information that this universe, as well as many other hundreds of thousands of universes, are each covered by sevenfold material coverings of water, fire, air, sky, ego, noumenon and material nature, just like a huge football, pumped and covered, floating on the water of the Causal Ocean, wherein the Lord is lying as Mahā-Viṣṇu. All the universes in seed are emanating from the breathing of the Mahā-Viṣṇu, who is but part of a partial expansion of the Lord, and all the universes presided over by the Brahmās vanish when the Mahā-Viṣṇu withdraws His great breath. In this way, the material worlds are being created and vanished by the supreme will of the Lord. The poor foolish materialist can just imagine how ignorantly he puts forward an insignificant creature to become His rival incarnation, simply on the allegations of a dying man. The *virāṭ-rūpa* was particularly exhibited by the Lord just to give lessons to such foolish men, so that one can accept a person as the incarnation of Godhead only if such a person is able to exhibit such a *virāṭ-rūpa* as Lord Kṛṣṇa did. The materialistic person may concentrate his mind upon the *virāṭ* or gigantic form of the Lord in his own interest and as recommended by Sukadeva Gosvami, but he must be on his guard not to be misled by pretenders who claim to be the identical person as Lord Kṛṣṇa but are not able to act like Him or exhibit the *virāṭ-rūpa*, comprehending the whole of the universe.

TEXT 26

PaaTaal/MaeTaSYa ih PaadMaUI&/
Pa#=iNTa PaaIZ<aRPa[Pade rSaaTal/Ma()
MahaTal&/ iviSa*Jaae_Qa GauLf-aE
Tal/aTal&/ vE PauåzSYa Jaºe)) 26))

pätālam etasya hi päda-mūlaà

paöhanti pärñëi-prapade rasätalam

mahätalaà viçva-sājo 'tha gulphau

talätalaà vai puruṣasya jaìghe

SYNONYMS

pätālam—the planets at the bottom of the universe; *etasya*—of His; *hi*—exactly; *päda-mūlam*—soles of the feet; *paöhanti*—they study it; *pärñëi*—the heels; *prapade*—the toes; *rasätalam*—the planets named Rasätala; *mahätalam*—the planets named Mahätala; *viçva-sājaù*—of the creator of the universe; *atha*—thus; *gulphau*—the ankles; *talätalam*—the planets named Talätala; *vai*—as they are; *puruṣasya*—of the gigantic person; *jaìghe*—the shanks.

TRANSLATION

Persons who have realized it have studied that the planets known as Pätäla constitute the bottoms of the feet of the universal Lord, and the heels and the toes are the Rasätala planets. The ankles are the Mahätala planets, and His shanks constitute the Talätala planets.

PURPORT

Outside the bodily existence of the Supreme Personality of Godhead, the manifested cosmic existence has no reality. Everything and anything of the manifested world rests on Him, as confirmed in the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (9.4), but that does not imply that everything and anything in the vision of a materialist is the Supreme Personality. The conception of the universal form of the Lord gives a chance to the materialist to think of the Supreme Lord, but the materialist must know for certain that his visualization of the world in a spirit of lording over it is not God realization. The materialistic view of exploitation of the material resources is occasioned by the illusion of the external energy of the Lord, and as such, if anyone wants to realize

the Supreme Truth by conceiving of the universal form of the Lord, he must cultivate the service attitude. Unless the service attitude is revived, the conception of *virāḍ* realization will have very little effect on the seer. The transcendental Lord, in any conception of His form, is never a part of the material creation. He keeps His identity as Supreme Spirit in all circumstances and is never affected by the three material qualities, for everything material is contaminated. The Lord always exists by His internal energy.

The universe is divided into fourteen planetary systems. Seven planetary systems, called Bhūr, Bhuvar, Svar, Mahar, Janas, Tapas and Satya, are upward planetary systems, one above the other. There are also seven planetary systems downward, known as Atala, Vitala, Sutala, Talātala, Mahātala, Rasātala and Pātāla, gradually, one below the other. In this verse, the description begins from the bottom because it is in the line of devotion that the Lord’s bodily description should begin from His feet. Sukadeva Gosvami is a recognized devotee of the Lord, and he is exactly correct in the description.

TEXT 27

Üe JaaNauNaq SauTal&/ iviMaUTaeR,
æåÜYa& ivTal&/ caTal&/ c)
MahqTal&/ TaÂgaNa& MahqPaTae
Na>aSTal&/ Naai>aSarae Ga*<aiNTa)) 27))

dve jänuné sutalāḥ viçva-mūrter

üru-dvayaḥ vitalaḥ cātalaḥ ca

mahétalaḥ taj-jaghanaḥ mahépate

nabhastalaḥ nābhi-saro gāḇanti

SYNONYMS

dve—two; *jänuné*—two knees; *sutalam*—the planetary system named

Sutala; *viçva-mürteu*—of the universal form; *üru-dvayam*—the two thighs; *vitalam*—the planetary system named Vitala; *ca*—also; *atalam*—the planets named Atala; *ca*—and; *mahétalam*—the planetary system named Mahétala; *tat*—of that; *jaghanam*—the hips; *mahépate*—O King; *nabhastalam*—outer space; *näbhi-saraù*—the depression of the navel; *gãëanti*—they take it so.

TRANSLATION

The knees of the universal form are the planetary system of the name Sutala, and the two thighs are the Vitala and Atala planetary systems. The hips are Mahétala, and outer space is the depression of His navel.

TEXT 28

or"SQal&/ JYaaeiTarNaqk-MaSYa
Ga]qva MahvRdNa& vE JaNaae_SYa)
TaPaae vra\$q& ivduraidPau&Sa"
SaTYa& Tau XaqzaRi<a SahóXaqZ<aR")) 28))

uraù-sthalaà jyotir-anékam asya

grévä mahar vadanaà vai jano 'sya

tapo varäöéà vidur ädi-puàsaù

satyaà tu çérñäëi sahasra-çérñëaù

SYNONYMS

uraù—high; *sthalam*—place (the chest); *jyotiù-anékam*—the luminary planets; *asya*—of Him; *grévä*—the neck; *mahaù*—the planetary system above the luminaries; *vadanam*—mouth; *vai*—exactly; *janaù*—the planetary system above Mahar; *asya*—of Him; *tapaù*—the planetary system above the Janas; *varäöém*—forehead; *viduù*—is known; *ädi*—the original; *puàsaù*—personality; *satyam*—the topmost planetary system; *tu*—but; *çérñäëi*—the head; *sahasra*—one thousand; *çérñëaù*—one with heads.

TRANSLATION

The chest of the Original Personality of the gigantic form is the luminary planetary system, His neck is the Mahar planets, His mouth is the Janas planets, and His forehead is the Tapas planetary system. The topmost planetary system, known as Satyaloka, is the head of He who has one thousand heads.

PURPORT

The effulgent luminary planets like the sun and the moon are situated almost in the midplace of the universe, and as such they are to be known as the chest of the original gigantic form of the Lord. And above the luminary planets, called also the heavenly places of the universal directorate demigods, are the Mahar, Janas and Tapas planetary systems, and, above all, the Satyaloka planetary system, where the chief directors of the modes of material nature reside, namely Viṣṇu, Brahmā and Siva. This Viṣṇu is known as the Kṣīrodakaśāyī Viṣṇu, and He acts as the Supersoul in every living being. There are innumerable universes floating on the Causal Ocean, and in each of them the representation of the *virāḍ* form of the Lord is there along with innumerable suns, moons, heavenly demigods, Brahmās, Viṣṇus and Sivas, all of them situated in one part of the inconceivable potency of Lord Kṛṣṇa, as stated in the ***Bhagavad-gīta*** (10.42).

TEXT 29

wNd]adYaae bahv Aahuāóá"
k-<aaŒ idXa" é[ae}aMaMauZYa XaBd")
NaaSaTYadóáE ParMaSYa NaaSae
ga]a<aae_SYa GaNDaae Mau%MaiGanirÖ")) 29))

indrādayo bāhava āhur usrāu

karēau diçau çrotram amuñya çabdau

nāsatya-dasrau paramasya nāse

ghrăëo 'sya gandho mukham agnir iddhaù

SYNONYMS

indra-ādayaù—demigods headed by the heavenly king, Indra; *bāhavaù*—arms; *āhuù*—are called; *usrāù*—the demigods; *karēau*—the ears; *diçaù*—the four directions; *çrotram*—the sense of hearing; *amuñya*—of the Lord; *çabdaù*—sound; *nāsatya-dasrau*—the demigods known as the Açviné-kumāras; *paramasya*—of the Supreme; *nāse*—nostrils; *ghrăëaù*—the sense of smell; *asya*—of Him; *gandhaù*—fragrance; *mukham*—the mouth; *agniù*—fire; *iddhaù*—blazing.

TRANSLATION

His arms are the demigods headed by Indra, the ten directional sides are His ears, and physical sound is His sense of hearing. His nostrils are the two Açviné-kumāras, and material fragrance is His sense of smell. His mouth is the blazing fire.

PURPORT

The description of the gigantic form of the Personality of Godhead made in the Eleventh Chapter of the *Bhagavad-gita* is further explained here in the *Srimad-Bhagavatam*. The description in the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (11.30) runs as follows: “O Viṣṇu, I see You devouring all people in Your blazing mouths and covering all the universe by Your immeasurable rays. Scorching the worlds, You are manifest.” In that way, *Srimad-Bhagavatam* is the postgraduate study for the student of the *Bhagavad-gita*. Both of them are the science of Kṛṣṇa, the Absolute Truth, and so they are interdependent.

The conception of the *viräo-puruṣa*, or the gigantic form of the Supreme Lord, is said to include all the dominating demigods as well as the dominated living beings. Even the minutest part of a living being is controlled by the empowered agency of the Lord. Since the demigods are included in the gigantic form of the Lord, worship of the Lord, whether in His gigantic material conception or in His eternal transcendental form as Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, also appeases the demigods and all the other parts and

parcels, as much as watering the root of a tree distributes energy to all of the tree's other parts. Consequently, for a materialist also, worship of the universal gigantic form of the Lord leads one to the right path. One need not risk being misled by approaching many demigods for fulfillment of different desires. The real entity is the Lord Himself, and all others are imaginary, for everything is included in Him only.

TEXT 30

ÛaEri+a<aq c+aur>aUTPaTa®"
Pa+Maai<a ivZ<aaerhNaq o>ae c)
Tad(>a]UivJa*M>a" ParMaeiiiDaZ<Ya,
MaaPaae_SYa TaalU/ rSa Wv iJaûa)) 30))

dyaaur akñiëé cakñur abhüt pataigaù

pakñmäëi viñëor ahané ubhe ca

tad-bhrü-vijåmbhaù parameñöhi-dhiñëyam

äpo 'sya tälü rasa eva jihvä

SYNONYMS

dyaauù—the sphere of outer space; *akñiëé*—the eyeballs; *cakñuù*—of eyes (senses); *abhüt*—it so became; *pataigaù*—the sun; *pakñmäëi*—eyelids; *viñëouù*—of the personality of Godhead, Sri Viṣṇu; *ahané*—day and night; *ubhe*—both; *ca*—and; *tat*—His; *bhrü*—eyebrows; *vijåmbhaù*—movements; *parameñöhi*—the supreme entity (Brahmä); *dhiñëyam*—post; *äpaù*—Varuëa, the director of water; *asya*—His; *tälü*—palate; *rasaù*—juice; *eva*—certainly; *jihvä*—the tongue.

TRANSLATION

The sphere of outer space constitutes His eyepits, and the eyeball is the sun as the power of seeing. His eyelids are both the day and night, and in the movements of His eyebrows, the Brahmä and similar supreme

personalities reside. His palate is the director of water, Varuëa, and the juice or essence of everything is His tongue.

PURPORT

To common sense the description in this verse appears to be somewhat contradictory because sometimes the sun has been described as the eyeball and sometimes as the outer space sphere. But there is no room for common sense in the injunctions of the *sastras*. We must accept the description of the *sastras* and concentrate more on the form of the *virāt-rūpa* than on common sense. Common sense is always imperfect, whereas the description in the *sastras* is always perfect and complete. If there is any incongruity, it is due to our imperfection and not the *sastras*'. That is the method of approaching Vedic wisdom.

TEXT 31

^Nda&SYaNaNTaSYa iXarae Ga*<aiNTa
d&í\ a YaMa" òehk-l/a iÜJaaiNa)
haSaae JaNaaeNMaadk-rq c MaaYaa
durNTaSaGaaeR YadPaa®Maae+a")) 31))

chandäàsy anantasya çiro gâëanti

daàñörä yamaù sneha-kalä dvijäni

häso janonmäda-karé ca mäyä

duranta-sargo yad-apäiga-mokñau

SYNONYMS

chandäàsi—the Vedic hymns; *anantasya*—of the Supreme; *çiraù*—the cerebral passage; *gâëanti*—they say; *daàñöräù*—the jaws of teeth; *yamaù*—Yamarāja, the director of sinners; *sneha-kaläù*—the art of affection; *dvijäni*—the set of teeth; *häsaù*—smile; *jana-unmäda-karé*—the most alluring; *ca*—also; *mäyä*—illusory energy; *duranta*—unsurpassable;

sargaù—the material creation; *yat-apäiga*—whose glance; *mokñau*—casting over.

TRANSLATION

They say that the Vedic hymns are the cerebral passage of the Lord, and His jaws of teeth are Yama, god of death, who punishes the sinners. The art of affection is His set of teeth, and the most alluring illusory material energy is His smile. This great ocean of material creation is but the casting of His glance over us.

PURPORT

According to Vedic assertion, this material creation is the result of the Lord's casting a glance over the material energy, which is described herein as the most alluring illusory energy. The conditioned souls who are allured by such materialism should know that the material temporary creation is simply an imitation of the reality and that those who are captivated by such alluring glances of the Lord are put under the direction of the controller of sinners called Yamarāja. The Lord smiles affectionately, displaying His teeth. The intelligent person who can grasp these truths about the Lord becomes a soul fully surrendered unto Him.

TEXT 32

**v]q@aetaraEiae_Dar Wv l/ae>aae
DaMaR" STaNaae_DaMaRPaQaae_SYa Pa*iMa()
k-STaSYa Mae!\& v*z<aaE c iMa}aaE
ku-i+a" SaMaud]a iGarYaae_iSQaSa")) 32))**

vréòottarauñöho 'dhara eva lobho

dharmau stano 'dharma-patho 'sya pñöham

kas tasya meðhraà vñäëau ca mitrau

kukñiù samudrä girayo 'sthi-saighäu

SYNONYMS

vrèḍa—modesty; *uttara*—upper; *oñḍhaù*—lip; *adharaù*—chin; *eva*—certainly; *lobhaù*—hankering; *dharmaù*—religion; *stanaù*—breast; *adharma*—irreligion; *pathaù*—way; *asya*—His; *pāñḍham*—back; *kaù*—Brahmā; *tasya*—His; *meḍhram*—genitals; *vāñḍaëau*—testicles; *ca*—also; *mitrau*—the Mitrā-varuëas; *kukñiù*—waist; *samudrāù*—the oceans; *girayaù*—the hills; *asthi*—bones; *saighäù*—stack.

TRANSLATION

Modesty is the upper portion of His lips, hankering is His chin, religion is the breast of the Lord, and irreligion is His back. Brahmäjé, who generates all living beings in the material world, is His genitals, and the Mitrā-varuëas are His two testicles. The ocean is His waist, and the hills and mountains are the stacks of His bones.

PURPORT

The Supreme Lord is not impersonal, as misconceived by less intelligent thinkers. Rather, He is the Supreme person, as confirmed in all authentic Vedic literatures. But His personality is different from what we can conceive. It is stated here that Brahmäjé acts as His genitals and that the Mitrā-varuëas are His two testicles. This means that as a person He is complete with all bodily organs, but they are of different types with different potencies. When the Lord is described as impersonal, therefore, it should be understood that His personality is not exactly the type of personality found within our imperfect speculation. One can, however, worship the Lord even by seeing the hills and mountains or the ocean and the sky as different parts and parcels of the gigantic body of the Lord, the *virāḍ-puruṣa*. The *virāṭ-rūpa*, as exhibited by Lord Kṛṣṇa to Arjuna, is a challenge to the unbelievers.

TEXT 33

**NaŪae_SYa Naa@yae_Qa TaNaUāhai<a
Mahqāha iviTaNaaeNa*RPaeNd])**

**ANaNTavqYaR" iSaTa& MaaTairia
GaiTavRYa" k-MaR Gau<aPa[vah")) 33))**

nadyo 'sya näòyo 'tha tanü-ruhäëi

mahé-ruhä viçva-tanor nâpendra

ananta-véryaù çvasitaà mätariçvâ

gatir vayaù karma guëa-pravähaù

SYNONYMS

nadyaù—the rivers; *asya*—of Him; *näòyaù*—veins; *atha*—and thereafter; *tanü-ruhäëi*—hairs on the body; *mahé-ruhäù*—the plants and trees; *viçva-tanoù*—of the universal form; *nâpa-indra*—O King; *ananta-véryaù*—of the omnipotent; *çvasitam*—breathing; *mätariçvâ*—air; *gatiù*—movement; *vayaù*—passing ages; *karma*—activity; *guëa-pravähaù*—reactions of the modes of nature.

TRANSLATION

O King, the rivers are the veins of the gigantic body, the trees are the hairs of His body, and the omnipotent air is His breath. The passing ages are His movements, and His activities are the reactions of the three modes of material nature.

PURPORT

The Personality of Godhead is not a dead stone, nor is He inactive, as is poorly thought by some schools. He moves with the progress of time, and therefore He knows all about the past and future, along with His present activities. There is nothing unknown to Him. The conditioned souls are driven by the reactions of the modes of material nature, which are the activities of the Lord. As stated in the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (7.12), the modes of nature act under His direction only, and as such no natural functions are blind or automatic. The power behind the activities is the supervision of the

Lord, and thus the Lord is never inactive as is wrongly conceived. The *Vedas* say that the Supreme Lord has nothing to do personally, as is always the case with superiors, but everything is done by His direction. As it is said, not a blade of grass moves without His sanction. In the ***Brahma-saṁhitā*** (5.48), it is said that all the universes and the heads of them (the Brahmās) exist only for the duration of His breathing period. The same is confirmed here. The air on which the universes and the planets within the universes exist is nothing but a bit of the breath of the unchallengeable *virāḍ-puruṣa*. So even by studying the rivers, trees, air and passing ages, one can conceive of the Personality of Godhead without being misled by the formless conception of the Lord. In the ***Bhagavad-gīta*** (12.5) it is stated that those who are much inclined to the formless conception of the Supreme Truth are more troubled than those who can intelligently conceive of the personal form.

TEXT 34

wRXaSYa ke-XaaNa(ivdurMbuvaNa(
vaSaSTau SaNDYaa& ku-âvYaR >aUMa")
AVYaç-MaahuôRdYa& MaNaê
Sa cNd]Maa" SavRivk-ark-aeXa")) 34))

éçasya keçän vidur ambuvähän

väsas tu sandhyäà kuru-varya bhümnaù

avyaktam ähur hâdayaà manaç ca

sa candramäù sarva-vikära-koçaù

SYNONYMS

éçasya—of the supreme controller; *keçän*—hairs on the head; *viduù*—you may know it from me; *ambu-vähän*—the clouds which carry water; *väsau tu*—the dress; *sandhyäm*—termination of day and night; *kuru-varya*—O best of the Kurus; *bhümnaù*—of the Almighty; *avyaktam*—the prime cause of material creation; *ähuù*—it is said; *hâdayam*—intelligence; *manaù ca*—

and the mind; *saù*—He; *candramäù*—the moon; *sarva-vikära-koçaù*—the reservoir of all changes.

TRANSLATION

O best amongst the Kurus, the clouds which carry water are the hairs on His head, the terminations of days or nights are His dress, and the supreme cause of material creation is His intelligence. His mind is the moon, the reservoir of all changes.

TEXT 35

ivjaNaXaiç&- MaihMaaMaNaiNTa
SavaRTMaNaee_NTa"k-r<a& iGair}aMa()
AiaìTaYauRí\GaJaa Na%aiNa
SaveR Ma*Gaa" PaXav" é[aei<adeXae)) 35))

vijjāna-çaktià mahim āmananti

sarvātmano ’ntaù-karaëaà giritram

açvāçvatary-uñöra-gajä nakhäni

sarve mågäù paçavaù çroëi-deçe

SYNONYMS

vijjāna-çaktim—consciousness; *mahim*—the principle of matter; *āmananti*—they call it so; *sarva-ātmanaù*—of the omnipresent; *antaù-karaëam*—ego; *giritram*—Rudra (Siva); *açva*—horse; *açvatari*—mule; *uñöra*—camel; *gajäù*—elephant; *nakhäni*—nails; *sarve*—all other; *mågäù*—stags; *paçavaù*—quadrupeds; *çroëi-deçe*—on the region of the belt.

TRANSLATION

The principle of matter [mahat-tattva] is the consciousness of the omnipresent Lord, as asserted by the experts, and Rudradeva is His ego.

The horse, mule, camel and elephant are His nails, and wild animals and all quadrupeds are situated in the belt zone of the Lord.

TEXT 36

vYaa&iSa TaÜyak-r<a& ivic}a&
MaNauMaRNAqza MaNauJaae iNavaSa")
GaNDavRivÛaDarcara<aaPSar"
SvrSMa*TaqrSauraNaqk-vqYaR")) 36))

vayäàsi tad-vyäkaraëaà vicitraà

manur manéñä manujo niväsaù

gandharva-vidyädhara-cäraëäpsaraù

svara-smâtér asuränéka-véryaù

SYNONYMS

vayäàsi—varieties of birds; *tat-vyäkaraëam*—vocables; *vicitram*—artistic; *manuù*—the father of mankind; *manéñä*—thoughts; *manujaù*—mankind (the sons of Manu); *niväsaù*—residence; *gandharva*—the human beings named Gandharvas; *vidyädhara*—the Vidyädharas; *cäraëa*—the Cäraëas; *apsaraù*—the angels; *svara*—musical rhythm; *smâtéù*—remembrance; *asura-anéka*—the demoniac soldiers; *véryaù*—prowess.

TRANSLATION

Varieties of birds are indications of His masterful artistic sense. Manu, the father of mankind, is the emblem of His standard intelligence, and humanity is His residence. The celestial species of human beings, like the Gandharvas, Vidyädharas, Cäraëas and angels, all represent His musical rhythm, and the demoniac soldiers are representations of His wonderful prowess.

PURPORT

The aesthetic sense of the Lord is manifested in the artistic, colorful creation of varieties of birds like the peacock, parrot and cuckoo. The celestial species of human beings, like the Gandharvas and Vidyādharas, can sing wonderfully and can entice even the minds of the heavenly demigods. Their musical rhythm represents the musical sense of the Lord. How then can He be impersonal? His musical taste, artistic sense and standard intelligence, which is never fallible, are different signs of His supreme personality. The *Manu-saṅhitā* is the standard lawbook for humanity, and every human being is advised to follow this great book of social knowledge. Human society is the residential quarters for the Lord. This means that the human being is meant for God realization and association with God. This life is a chance for the conditioned soul to regain his eternal God consciousness and thus fulfill the mission of life. Maharaja Prahlāda is the right type of representative of the Lord in the family of *asuras*. None of the living beings is away from the Lord's gigantic body. Each and every one has a particular duty in relation to the supreme body. Disruption in the matter of discharging the specific duty assigned to each and every living being is the cause of disharmony between one living being and another, but when the relation is reestablished in relation with the Supreme Lord, there is complete unity between all living beings, even up to the limit of the wild animals and human society. Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu displayed this living unity in the jungle of Madhya Pradesh, where even the tigers, elephants and many other ferocious animals perfectly cooperated in glorifying the Supreme Lord. That is the way to peace and amity all over the world.

TEXT 37

**b]øaNaNa& +a}a>auJaae MahaTMaa
iv@Uårx(iga]ié[Tak*-Z<av<aR")
NaaNaai>aDaa>aqJYaGa<aaePaPaàae
d]VYaaTMak-" k-MaR ivTaaNaYaaeGa")) 37))**

brahmānanaà kñātra-bhujo mahātmā

viò ūrur aìghri-çrita-kāñēa-varēau

nänābhīdhābhējya-gaēopapanno

dravyātmakau karma vitāna-yogau

SYNONYMS

brahma—the *brahmanas*; *ānanam*—the face; *kñātra*—the *kṣatriyas*; *bhujaù*—the arms; *mahātmā*—the *virāo-puruṣa*; *viō*—the *vaśyas*; *ūruù*—the thighs; *aighri-çrita*—under the protection of His feet; *kāñēa-varēau*—the *sudras*; *nānā*—various; *abhīdhā*—by names; *abhējya-gaēa*—the demigods; *upapannaù*—being overtaken; *dravya-ātmakau*—with feasible goods; *karma*—activities; *vitāna-yogau*—performances of sacrifice.

TRANSLATION

The virāo-puruṣa’s face is the brahmanas, His arms are the kṣatriyas, His thighs are the vaśyas, and the sudras are under the protection of His feet. All the worshipable demigods are also overtaken by Him, and it is the duty of everyone to perform sacrifices with feasible goods to appease the Lord.

PURPORT

Monotheism is practically suggested here. Offering sacrifices to many demigods under different names is mentioned in the Vedic literatures, but the suggestion made in this verse is that all those varieties of demigods are included in the form of the Supreme Personality of Godhead; they are only the parts and parcels of the original whole. Similarly, the divisions of the orders of human society, namely the *brahmanas* (the intelligent class), the *kṣatriyas* (the administrators), the *vaśyas* (the mercantile community) and the *sudras* (the laborer class), are all included in the body of the Supreme. As such, sacrifice by every one of them in terms of pleasing the Supreme by feasible goods is recommended. Generally, the sacrifice is offered with clarified butter and grains, but with the progress of time, human society has produced varieties of goods by transforming materials supplied by God’s material nature. Human society, therefore, *must learn to offer sacrifices not only with clarified butter, but also with other manufactured*

goods in the propagation of the Lord's glory, and that will bring about perfection in human society. The intelligent class of men, or *brahmanas*, may give direction for such sacrifices in consultation with the previous *ācāryas*; the administrators may give all facilities to perform such sacrifices; the *vaiçya* class or mercantile community, who produce such goods, may offer them for sacrifice; and the *çūdra* class may offer their manual labor for the successful termination of such sacrifice. Thus by the cooperation of all classes of human beings, the sacrifice recommended in this age, namely the sacrifice of congregational chanting of the holy name of the Lord, may be executed for the common welfare of all the people of the world.

TEXT 38

wYaaNaSaavqirivGa]hSYa
Ya" SaiàveXa" k-iQaTaae MaYaa Tae)
SaNDaaYaRTae_iSMaNa(vPauiz SQaivie
MaNa" SvbuÖya Na YaTaae_iSTa ik-iÄTa()) 38))

iyän asäv éçvara-vigrahasya

yaù sanniveçaù kathito mayä te

sandhāryate 'smin vapuñi sthaviñöhe

manaù sva-buddhyä na yato 'sti kīcit

SYNONYMS

iyän—all these; *asau*—that; *éçvara*—Supreme Lord; *vigrahasya*—of the form; *yaù*—whatsoever; *sanniveçaù*—as they are located; *kathitaù*—explained; *mayä*—by me; *te*—unto you; *sandhāryate*—one may concentrate; *asmin*—in this; *vapuñi*—form of *viräö*; *sthaviñöhe*—in the gross; *manaù*—mind; *sva-buddhyä*—by one's intelligence; *na*—not; *yataù*—beyond Him; *asti*—there is; *kīcit*—anything else.

TRANSLATION

I have thus explained to you the gross material gigantic conception of the Personality of Godhead. One who seriously desires liberation concentrates his mind on this form of the Lord, because there is nothing more than this in the material world.

PURPORT

In the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (9.10), the Supreme Personality of Godhead has verily explained that the material nature is only an order-carrying agent of His. She is one of the different potencies of the Lord, and she acts under His direction only. As the supreme transcendental Lord, He simply casts a glance over the material principle, and thus the agitation of matter begins, and the resultant actions are manifested one after another by six kinds of gradual differentiations. All material creation is moving in that way, and thus it appears and disappears in due course.

Less intelligent persons with a poor fund of knowledge cannot accommodate the thought of this inconceivable potency of the Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, by which He appears just like a human being (Bg. 9.11). His appearance in the material world as one of us is also His causeless mercy upon the fallen souls. He is transcendental to all material conceptions, but by His unbounded mercy upon His pure devotees, He comes down and manifests Himself as the personality of Godhead. Materialistic philosophers and scientists are too much engrossed with atomic energy and the gigantic situation of the universal form, and they offer respect more seriously to the external phenomenal feature of material manifestations than to the noumenal principle of spiritual existence. The transcendental form of the Lord is beyond the jurisdiction of such materialistic activities, and it is very difficult to conceive that the Lord can be simultaneously localized and all-pervasive, because the materialistic philosophers and scientists think of everything in terms of their own experience. Because they are unable to accept the personal feature of the Supreme Lord, the Lord is kind enough to demonstrate the *virāḍ* feature of His transcendental form, and herein Srila Sukadeva Gosvami has vividly described this form of the Lord. He concludes that there is nothing beyond this gigantic feature of the Lord. None of the materialistic thoughtful men can go beyond this conception of the gigantic form. The minds of the materialistic men are flickering and

constantly changing from one aspect to another. Therefore, one is advised to think of the Lord by thinking of any part of His gigantic body, and by one's intelligence only one can think of Him in any manifestation of the material world—the forest, the hill, the ocean, the man, the animal, the demigod, the bird, the beast or anything else. Each and every item of the material manifestation entails a part of the body of the gigantic form, and thus the flickering mind can be fixed in the Lord only and nothing else. This process of concentrating on the different bodily parts of the Lord will gradually diminish the demoniac challenge of godlessness and bring about gradual development of devotional service to the Lord. Everything being a part and parcel of the Complete Whole, the neophyte student will gradually realize the hymns of *Éçopaniñad* which state that the Supreme Lord is everywhere, and thus he will learn the art of not committing any offense to the body of the Lord. This sense of God-mindedness will diminish one's pride in challenging the existence of God. Thus one can learn to show respect to everything, for all things are parts and parcels of the supreme body.

TEXT 39

**Sa SavRDaqv*tYaNau>aUTaSavR
AaTMaa YaQaa SvPanJaNaei+aTaEk-")
Ta& SaTYaMaaNaNdiNaiDa& >aJaeTa
NaaNYa}a SaÂed(YaTa AaTMaPaaTa")) 39))**

sa sarva-dhé-våtti-anubhüta-sarva

ätmä yathä svapna-janekñitaikaù

taà satyam änanda-nidhià bhajeta

nänyatra sajjed yata ätma-pätaù

SYNONYMS

saù—He (the Supreme Person); *sarva-dhé-våtti*—the process of realization by all sorts of intelligence; *anubhüta*—cognizant; *sarve*—everyone; *ätmä*—

the Supersoul; *yathā*—as much as; *svapna-jana*—a person dreaming; *ékñīta*—seen by; *ekaù*—one and the same; *tam*—unto Him; *satyam*—the Supreme Truth; *ānanda-nidhim*—the ocean of bliss; *bhajeta*—must one worship; *na*—never; *anyatra*—anything else; *sajjet*—be attached; *yataù*—whereby; *ātma-pātaù*—degradation of oneself.

TRANSLATION

One should concentrate his mind upon the Supreme Personality of Godhead, who alone distributes Himself in so many manifestations just as ordinary persons create thousands of manifestations in dreams. One must concentrate the mind on Him, the only all-blissful Absolute Truth. Otherwise one will be misled and will cause his own degradation.

PURPORT

In this verse, the process of devotional service is indicated by the great Gosvami, Srila Sukadeva. He tries to impress upon us that instead of diverting our attention to several branches of self-realization, we should concentrate upon the Supreme Personality of Godhead as the supreme object of realization, worship and devotion. Self-realization is, as it were, offering a fight for eternal life against the material struggle for existence, and therefore by the illusory grace of the external energy, the *yogé* or the devotee is faced with many allurements which can entangle a great fighter again in the bondage of material existence. A *yogé* can attain miraculous successes in material achievements, such as *aëimä* and *laghimä*, by which one can become more minute than the minutest or lighter than the lightest, or in the ordinary sense, one may achieve material benedictions in the shape of wealth and women. But one is warned against such allurements because entanglement again in such illusory pleasure means degradation of the self and further imprisonment in the material world. By this warning, one should follow one's vigilant intelligence only.

The Supreme Lord is one, and His expansions are various. He is therefore the Supersoul of everything. When a man sees anything, he must know that his seeing is secondary and the Lord's seeing is primary. One cannot see anything without the Lord's having first seen it. That is the instruction of

the *Vedas* and the *Upaniñads*. So whatever we see or do, the Supersoul of all acts of seeing or doing is the Lord. This theory of simultaneous oneness and difference between the individual soul and the Supersoul is propounded by Lord Sri Caitanya Mahāprabhu as the philosophy of *acintya-bhedābheda-tattva*. The *virāṭ-rūpa*, or the gigantic feature of the Supreme Lord, includes everything materially manifested, and therefore the *virāṭ* or gigantic feature of the Lord is the Supersoul of all living and nonliving entities. But the *virāṭ-rūpa* is also the manifestation of Nārāyaṇa or Viṣṇu, and going further on and on one will eventually see that Lord Kṛṣṇa is the ultimate Supersoul of everything that be. The conclusion is that one should unhesitatingly become a worshiper of Lord Kṛṣṇa, or, for that matter, His plenary expansion Nārāyaṇa, and none else. In the Vedic hymns, it is clearly said that first of all Nārāyaṇa cast a glance over matter and thus there was creation. Before creation, there was neither Brahmā nor Siva, and what to speak of others. Sripāda Čaikarācārya has definitely accepted this, that Nārāyaṇa is beyond the material creation and that all others are within the material creation. The whole material creation, therefore, is one with and different from Nārāyaṇa, simultaneously, and this supports the *acintya-bhedābheda-tattva* philosophy of Lord Sri Caitanya Mahāprabhu. Being an emanation from the glancing potency of Nārāyaṇa, the whole material creation is nondifferent from Him. But because it is the effect of His external energy (*bahiraṅgā māyā*) and is aloof from the internal potency (*ātma-māyā*), the whole material creation is different from Him at the same time. The example given in this verse very nicely is that of the dreaming man. The dreaming man creates many things in his dream, and thus he himself becomes the entangled seer of the dream and is also affected by the consequences. This material creation is also exactly a dreamlike creation of the Lord, but He, being the transcendental Supersoul, is neither entangled nor affected by the reactions of such a dreamlike creation. He is always in His transcendental position, but essentially He is everything, and nothing is apart from Him. As a part of Him, one should therefore concentrate on Him only, without deviation; otherwise one is sure to be overcome by the potencies of the material creation, one after another. It is confirmed in the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (9.7) as follows:

*sarva-bhūtāni kaunteya
prakāṣāṇi yānti māmikām*

*kalpa-kñaye punas täni
kalpādaṁ viśājāmy aham*

“O son of Kunté, at the end of the millennium every material manifestation enters into My nature, and at the beginning of another millennium, by My potency, I again create.”

The human life, however, is an opportunity to get out of this repetition of creation and annihilation. It is a means whereby one may escape the Lord’s external potency and enter into His internal potency.

Thus end the Bhaktivedanta purports of the Second Canto, First Chapter, of the Srimad-Bhagavatam, entitled “The First Step in God Realization.”

Chapter Two

The Lord in the Heart

TEXT 1

é[qéuk- ovac
Wv& Paura Daar<aYaaTMaYaaeiNa,
NaRíá& SMa*iTa& Pa[TYavåDYa TauíaTa()
TaQaa SaSaJaeRdMaMaaegad*ií,
YaRQaaPYaYaaTa(Pa[aGa(VYavSaaYabuiÖ")) 1))

çré-çuka uvāca

evaṁ purā dhāraēyātma-yonir

nañöä smātiā pratyavarudhya tuñöät

tathā sasarjedam amogha-dāñöir

yathāpyayāt prāg vyavasāya-buddhiṁ

SYNONYMS

ṣré-ṣukaù uvāca—Sri Sukadeva Gosvami said; *evam*—just in the same way; *purā*—prior to the manifestation of the cosmos; *dhāraëyā*—by such a conception; *ātma-yoniù*—of Brahmäjé; *nañöäm*—lost; *smātim*—remembrance; *pratyavarudhya*—by regaining consciousness; *tuñöät*—because of appeasing the Lord; *tathā*—thereafter; *sasarja*—created; *idam*—this material world; *amogha-dāñöiù*—one who has attained clear vision; *yathā*—as; *apyayāt*—created; *prak*—as formerly; *vyavasāya*—ascertained; *buddhiù*—intelligence.

TRANSLATION

Sri Sukadeva Gosvami said: Formerly, prior to the manifestation of the cosmos, Lord Brahmä, by meditating on the virāt-rūpa, regained his lost consciousness by appeasing the Lord. Thus he was able to rebuild the creation as it was before.

PURPORT

The example cited herein of Sri Brahmäjé is one of forgetfulness. Brahmäjé is the incarnation of one of the mundane attributes of the Lord. Being the incarnation of the passion mode of material nature, he is empowered by the Lord to generate the beautiful material manifestation. Yet due to his being one of the numerous living entities, he is apt to forget the an of his creative energy. This forgetfulness of the living being—beginning from Brahmä down to the lowest insignificant ant—is a tendency which can be counteracted by meditation on the *virāt-rūpa* of the Lord. This chance is available in the human form of life, and if a human being follows the instruction of *Srimad-Bhagavatam* and begins to meditate upon the *virāt-rūpa*, then revival of his pure consciousness and counteraction of the tendency to forget his eternal relationship with the Lord can follow simultaneously. And as soon as this forgetfulness is removed, the *vyavasāya-buddhi*, as mentioned here and in the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (2.41), follows at once. This ascertained knowledge of the living being leads to loving service to the Lord, which the living being requires. The kingdom of God is unlimited; therefore the number of the assisting hands of the Lord is

also unlimited. The ***Bhagavad-gita*** (13.14) asserts that the Lord has His hands, legs, eyes and mouths in every nook and corner of His creation, This means that the expansions of differentiated parts and parcels, called *jivas* or living entities, are assisting hands of the Lord, and all of them are meant for rendering a particular pattern of service to the Lord. The conditioned soul, even in the position of a Brahmä, forgets this by the influence of illusory, material energy generated out of false egoism. One can counteract such false egoism by invoking God consciousness. Liberation means getting out of the slumber of forgetfulness and becoming situated in the real loving service of the Lord, as exemplified in the case of Brahmä. The service of Brahmä is the sample of service in liberation distinguished from the so-called altruistic services full of mistakes and forgetfulness. Liberation is never inaction, but service without human mistakes.

TEXT 2

XaaBdSYa ih b]ø<a Wz PaNQaa
 YaàaMai>aDYaaRYaiTa DaqrPaaQaCE")
 Pair>a]Ma&STa}a Na ivNdTae_QaaRNA(
 MaaYaaMaYae vaSaNaYaa XaYaaNa")) 2))

çäbdasya hi brahmaëa eña panthä

yan nāmabhir dhyäyati dhér apärthaiù

paribhramaàs tatra na vindate ’rthän

mäyämaya väsanayä çayänaù

SYNONYMS

çäbdasya—of the Vedic sound; *hi*—certainly; *brahmaëaù*—of the *Vedas*; *eñaù*—these; *panthäù*—the way; *yat*—what is; *nāmabhiù*—by different names; *dhyäyati*—ponders; *dhéù*—intelligence; *apärthaiù*—by meaningless ideas; *paribhraman*—wandering; *tatra*—there; *na*—never; *vindate*—enjoys; *arthän*—realities; *mäyä-maya*—in illusory things; *väsanayä*—by different desires; *çayänaù*—as if dreaming in sleep.

TRANSLATION

The way of presentation of the Vedic sounds is so bewildering that it directs the intelligence of the people to meaningless things like the heavenly kingdoms. The conditioned souls hover in dreams of such heavenly illusory pleasures, but actually they do not relish any tangible happiness in such places.

PURPORT

The conditioned soul is always engaged in laying out plans for happiness within the material world, even up to the end of the universal limit. He is not even satisfied with available amenities on this planet earth, where he has exploited the resources of nature to the best of his ability. He wants to go to the moon or the planet Venus to exploit resources there. But the Lord has warned us in the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (8.16) about the worthlessness of all the innumerable planets of this universe, as well as those planets within other systems. There are innumerable universes and also innumerable planets in each of them. But none of them is immune to the chief miseries of material existence, namely the pangs of birth, the pangs of death, the pangs of old age and the pangs of disease. The Lord says that even the topmost planet, known as the Brahmaloka or Satyaloka, (and what to speak of other planets, like the heavenly planets) is not a happy land for residential purposes, due to the presence of material pangs, as above mentioned. Conditioned souls are strictly under the laws of fruitive activities, and as such they sometimes go up to Brahmaloka and again come down to Pātāla, as if they were unintelligent children on a merry-go-round. The real happiness is in the kingdom of God, where no one has to undergo the pangs of material existence. Therefore, the Vedic ways of fruitive activities for the living entities are misleading. One thinks of a superior way of life in this country or that, or on this planet or another, but nowhere in the material world can he fulfill his real desire of life, namely eternal life, full intelligence and complete bliss. Indirectly, Srila Sukadeva Gosvami affirms that Maharaja Parikṣit, in the last stage of life, should not desire to transfer himself to the so-called heavenly planets, but should prepare himself for going back home, back to Godhead. None of the material planets, nor the amenities available there for living conditions, is

everlasting; therefore one must have a factual reluctance to enjoy such temporary happiness as they afford.

TEXT 3

ATa" k-ivNaaRMaSau YaavdQaR"
SYaadPa[Mataae VYavSaaYabuiÖ")
iSaÖe_NYaQaaQaeR Na YaTaeTa Ta}a
Pairé[Ma& Ta}a SaMaq+aMaa<a")) 3))

ataù kavir nāmasu yāvad arthaù

syād apramatto vyavasāya-buddhiù

siddhe 'nyathārthe na yateta tatra

pariçramaà tatra samékñamäëaù

SYNONYMS

ataù—for this reason; *kaviù*—the enlightened person; *nāmasu*—in names only; *yāvat*—minimum; *arthaù*—necessity; *syāt*—must be; *apramattaù*—without being mad after them; *vyavasāya-buddhiù*—intelligently fixed; *siddhe*—for success; *anyathä*—otherwise; *arthe*—in the interest of; *na*—should never; *yateta*—endeavor for; *tatra*—there; *pariçramam*—laboring hard; *tatra*—there; *samékñamäëaù*—one who sees practically.

TRANSLATION

For this reason the enlightened person should endeavor only for the minimum necessities of life while in the world of names. He should be intelligently fixed and never endeavor for unwanted things, being competent to perceive practically that all such endeavors are merely hard labor for nothing.

PURPORT

The *bhāgavata-dharma*, or the cult of *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, is perfectly distinct from the way of fruitive activities, which are considered by the devotees to be merely a waste of time. The whole universe, or for that matter all material existence, is moving on as *jagat*, simply for planning business to make one's position very comfortable or secure, although everyone sees that this existence is neither comfortable nor secure and can never become comfortable or secure at any stage of development. Those who are captivated by the illusory advancement of material civilization (following the way of phantasmagoria) are certainly madmen. The whole material creation is a *jugglery of names* only; in fact, it is nothing but a bewildering creation of matter like earth, water and fire. The buildings, furniture, cars, bungalows, mills, factories, industries, peace, war or even the highest perfection of material science, namely atomic energy and electronics, are all simply bewildering names of material elements with their concomitant reactions of the three modes. Since the devotee of the Lord knows them perfectly well, he is not interested in creating unwanted things for a situation which is not at all reality, but simply names of no more significance than the babble of sea waves. The great kings, leaders and soldiers fight with one another in order to perpetuate their names in history. They are forgotten in due course of time, and they make a place for another era in history. But the devotee realizes how much history and historical persons are useless products of flickering time. The fruitive worker aspires after a big fortune in the matter of wealth, woman and worldly adoration, but those who are fixed in perfect reality are not at all interested in such false things. For them it is all a waste of time. Since every second of human life is important, an enlightened man should be very careful to utilize time very cautiously. One second of human life wasted in the vain research of planning for happiness in the material world can never be replaced, even if one spends millions of coins of gold. Therefore, the transcendentalist desiring freedom from the clutches of *māyā*, or the illusory activities of life, is warned herewith not to be captivated by the external features of fruitive actors. Human life is never meant for sense gratification, but for self-realization. *Srimad-Bhagavatam* instructs us solely on this subject from the very beginning to the end. Human life is simply meant for self-realization. The civilization which aims at this utmost perfection never indulges in creating unwanted things, and such a perfect civilization prepares men only to accept the bare necessities of life or to

follow the principle of the best use of a bad bargain. Our material bodies and our lives in that connection are bad bargains because the living entity is actually spirit, and spiritual advancement of the living entity is absolutely necessary. Human life is intended for the realization of this important factor, and one should act accordingly, accepting only the bare necessities of life and depending more on God's gift without diversion of human energy for any other purpose, such as being mad for material enjoyment. The materialistic advancement of civilization is called "the civilization of the demons," which ultimately ends in wars and scarcity. The transcendentalist is specifically warned herewith to be fixed in mind, so that even if there is difficulty in plain living and high thinking he will not budge even an inch from his stark determination. For a transcendentalist, it is a suicidal policy to be intimately in touch with the sense gratifiers of the world, because such a policy will frustrate the ultimate gain of life. Sukadeva Gosvami met Maharaja Pariksit when the latter felt a necessity for such a meeting. It is the duty of a transcendentalist to help persons who desire real salvation and to support the cause of salvation. One might note that Sukadeva Gosvami never met Maharaja Pariksit while he was ruling as a great king. For a transcendentalist, the mode of activities is explained in the next *çloka*.

TEXT 4

SaTYaa& i+aTaaE ik&- k-iXaPaaE" Pa[YaaSaE,
 baRhaE SviSaÖe ùuPabhR<aE" ik-Ma()
 SaTYaÅI/aE ik&- PauåDaaàPaa}Yaa
 idGvLk-l/adaE SaiTa ik&- dukU-IE/")) 4))

satyää kñitau kià kaçipoù prayäsair

bähau svasiddhe hy upabarhaëaiù kim

saty aijalau kià purudhänna-pätryä

dig-valkalädau sati kià dukulaiù

SYNONYMS

satyām—being in possession; *kñītau*—earthly flats; *kim*—where is the necessity; *kaṣipoù*—of beds and cots; *prayāsaiù*—endeavoring for; *bāhau*—the arms; *sva-siddhe*—being self-sufficient; *hi*—certainly; *upabarhaëaiù*—bed and bedstead; *kim*—what is the use; *sati*—being present; *ājjalau*—the palms of the hands; *kim*—what is the use; *purudhā*—varieties of; *anna*—eatables; *pātryā*—by the utensils; *dik*—open space; *valkala-ādau*—skins of trees; *sati*—being existent; *kim*—what is the use of; *dukūlaiù*—clothes.

TRANSLATION

When there are ample earthly flats to lie on, what is the necessity of cots and beds? When one can use his own arms, what is the necessity of a pillow? When one can use the palms of his hands, what is the necessity of varieties of utensils? When there is ample covering, or the skins of trees, what is the necessity of clothing?

PURPORT

The necessities of life for the protection and comfort of the body must not be unnecessarily increased. Human energy is spoiled in a vain search after such illusory happiness. If one is able to lie down on the floor, then why should one endeavor to get a good bedstead or soft cushion to lie on? If one can rest without any pillow and make use of the soft arms endowed by nature, there is no necessity of searching after a pillow. If we make a study of the general life of the animals, we can see that they have no intelligence for building big houses, furniture, and other household paraphernalia, and yet they maintain a healthy life by lying down on the open land. They do not know how to cook or prepare foodstuff, yet they still live healthy lives more easily than the human being. This does not mean that human civilization should revert to animal life or that the human being should live naked in the jungles without any culture, education and sense of morality. An intelligent human cannot live the life of an animal; rather, man should try to utilize his intelligence in arts and science, poetry and philosophy. In such a way he can further the progressive march of human civilization. But here the idea given by Srila Sukadeva Gosvami is that the reserve energy of human life, which is far superior to that of animals, should simply be utilized for self-realization. Advancement of human civilization must be

towards the goal of establishing our lost relationship with God, which is not possible in any form of life other than the human. One must realize the nullity of the material phenomenon, considering it a passing phantasmagoria, and must endeavor to make a solution to the miseries of life. Self-complacency with a polished type of animal civilization geared to sense gratification is delusion, and such a “civilization” is not worthy of the name. In pursuit of such false activities, a human being is in the clutches of *māyā*, or illusion. Great sages and saints in the days of yore were not living in palatial buildings furnished with good furniture and so-called amenities of life. They used to live in huts and groves and sit on the flat ground, and yet they have left immense treasures of high knowledge with all perfection. Srila Rūpa Gosvami and Srila Sanātana Gosvami were high-ranking ministers of state, but they were able to leave behind them immense writings on transcendental knowledge, while residing only for one night underneath one tree. They did not live even two nights under the same tree, and what to speak of well-furnished rooms with modern amenities. And still they were able to give us most important literatures of self-realization. So-called comforts of life are not actually helpful for progressive civilization; rather, they are detrimental to such progressive life. In the system of *sanātana-dharma*, of four divisions of social life and four orders of progressive realization, there are ample opportunities and sufficient directions for a happy termination of the progressive life, and the sincere followers are advised therein to accept a voluntary life of renunciation in order to achieve the desired goal of life. If one is not accustomed to abiding by the life of renunciation and self-abnegation from the beginning, one should try to get into the habit at a later stage of life as recommended by Srila Sukadeva Gosvami, and that will help one to achieve the desired success.

TEXT 5

cqrai<a ik&- PaiQa Na SaiNTa idXaiNTa i>a+aa&
NaEvax(iga]Paa" Par>a*Ta" SairTaae_PYaéuZYaNa()
åÖa Gauha" ik-MaiJaTaae_viTa NaaePaSaàaNa(
k-SMaad(>aJaiNTa k-vYaae DaNaduMaRdaNDaaNa()) 5))

céräëi kià pathi na santi diçanti bhikñää

naiväìghripäù para-bhâtaù sarito 'py açuñyan

ruddhä guhäù kim ajito 'vati nopasannän

kasmäd bhajanti kavayo dhana-durmadändhän

SYNONYMS

céräëi—torn clothes; *kim*—whether; *pathi*—on the road; *na*—not; *santi*—there is; *diçanti*—give in charity; *bhikñäm*—alms; *na*—not; *eva*—also; *aìghripäù*—the trees; *para-bhâtaù*—one who maintains others; *saritaù*—the rivers; *api*—also; *açuñyan*—have dried up; *ruddhäù*—closed; *guhäù*—caves; *kim*—whether; *ajitaù*—the Almighty Lord; *avati*—give protection; *na*—not; *upasannän*—the surrendered soul; *kasmät*—what for, then; *bhajanti*—flatters; *kavayaù*—the learned; *dhana*—wealth; *durmada-andhän*—too intoxicated by.

TRANSLATION

Are there no torn clothes lying on the common road? Do the trees, which exist for maintaining others, no longer give alms in charity? Do the rivers, being dried up, no longer supply water to the thirsty? Are the caves of the mountains now closed, or, above all, does the Almighty Lord not protect the fully surrendered souls? Why then do the learned sages go to flatter those who are intoxicated by hard-earned wealth?

PURPORT

The renounced order of life is never meant for begging or living at the cost of others as a parasite. According to the dictionary, a parasite is a sycophant who lives at the cost of society without making any contribution to that society. The renounced order is meant for contributing something substantial to society and not depending on the earnings of the householders. On the contrary, acceptance of alms from the householders by the bona fide mendicant is an opportunity afforded by the saint for the tangible benefit of the donor. In the *sanätana-dharma* institution, alms-giving to the mendicant is part of a householder's duty, and it is advised in

the scriptures that the householders should treat the mendicants as their family children and should provide them with food, clothing, etc., without being asked. Pseudomendicants, therefore, should not take advantage of the charitable disposition of the faithful householders. The first duty of a person in the renounced order of life is to contribute some literary work for the benefit of the human being in order to give him realized direction toward self-realization. Amongst the other duties in the renounced order of life of Srila Sanātana, Srila Rūpa and the other Gosvamis of Våndāvana, the foremost duty discharged by them was to hold learned discourses amongst themselves at Sevākuīja, Våndāvana (the spot where Sri Rādhā-Dāmodara Temple was established by Srila Jiva Gosvami and where the actual *samādhi* tombs of Srila Rūpa Gosvami and Srila Jiva Gosvami are laid). For the benefit of all in human society, they left behind them immense literatures of transcendental importance. Similarly, all the *ācāryas* who voluntarily accepted the renounced order of life aimed at benefiting human society and not at living a comfortable or irresponsible life at the cost of others. However, those who cannot give any contribution should not go to the householders for food, for such mendicants asking bread from the householders are an insult to the highest order. Sukadeva Gosvami gave this warning especially for those mendicants who adopt this line of profession to solve their economic problems. Such mendicants are in abundance in the age of Kali. When a man becomes a mendicant willfully or by circumstances, he must be of firm faith and conviction that the Supreme Lord is the maintainer of all living beings everywhere in the universe. Why, then, would He neglect the maintenance of a surrendered soul who is cent percent engaged in the service of the Lord? A common master looks to the necessities of his servant, so how much more would the all-powerful, all-opulent Supreme Lord look after the necessities of life for a fully surrendered soul. The general rule is that a mendicant devotee will accept a simple small loincloth without asking anyone to give it in charity. He simply salvages it from the rejected torn cloth thrown in the street. When he is hungry he may go to a magnanimous tree which drops fruits, and when he is thirsty he may drink water from the flowing river. He does not require to live in a comfortable house, but should find a cave in the hills and not be afraid of jungle animals, keeping faith in God, who lives in everyone's heart. The Lord may dictate to tigers and other jungle animals not to disturb His devotee. Haridāsa Ōhākura, a great devotee of Lord Sri Caitanya, used to

live in such a cave, and by chance a great venomous snake was a co-partner of the cave. Some admirer of Öhäkura Haridäsa who had to visit the Öhäkura every day feared the snake and suggested that the Öhäkura leave that place. Because his devotees were afraid of the snake and they were regularly visiting the cave, Öhäkura Haridäsa agreed to the proposal on their account. But as soon as this was settled, the snake actually crawled out of its hole in the cave and left the cave for good before everyone present. By the dictation of the Lord, who lived also within the heart of the snake, the snake gave preference to Haridäsa and decided to leave the place and not disturb him. So this is a tangible example of how the Lord gives protection to a bona fide devotee like Öhäkura Haridäsa. According to the regulations of the *sanätana-dharma* institution, one is trained from the beginning to depend fully on the protection of the Lord in all circumstances. The path of renunciation is recommended for acceptance by one who is fully accomplished and fully purified in his existence. This stage is described also in the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (16.5) as *daivé sampat*. A human being is required to accumulate *daivé sampat*, or spiritual assets; otherwise, the next alternative, *äsuré sampat*, or material assets, will overcome him disproportionately, and thus one will be forced into the entanglement of different miseries of the material world. A *sannyäse* should always live alone, without company, and he must be fearless. He should never be afraid of living alone, although he is never alone. The Lord is residing in everyone's heart, and unless one is purified by the prescribed process, one will feel that he is alone. But a man in the renounced order of life must be purified by the process; thus he will feel the presence of the Lord everywhere and will have nothing to fear (such as being without any company). Everyone can become a fearless and honest person if his very existence is purified by discharging the prescribed duty for each and every order of life. One can become fixed in one's prescribed duty by faithful aural reception of Vedic instructions and assimilation of the essence of Vedic knowledge by devotional service to the Lord.

TEXT 6

Wv& Svictae SvTa Wv iSaÖ
AaTMaa iPa[Yaae_QaaeR >aGavaNaNaNTa")
Ta& iNav*RTaae iNaYaTaaQaaeR >aJaeTa

Sa&SaarheTaUParMaê Ya}a)) 6))

evaà sva-citte svata eva siddha

ätmä priyo 'rtho bhagavän anantaù

taà nirvâto niyatârtho bhajeta

saàsära-hetüparamaç ca yatra

SYNONYMS

evam—thus; *sva-citte*—in one's own heart; *svataù*—by His omnipotency; *eva*—certainly; *siddhaù*—fully represented; *ätmä*—the Supersoul; *priyaù*—very dear; *arthaù*—substance; *bhagavän*—the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *anantaù*—the eternal unlimited; *tam*—unto Him; *nirvâtaù*—being detached from the world; *niyata*—permanent; *arthaù*—the supreme gain; *bhajeta*—one must worship; *saàsära-hetu*—the cause of the conditioned state of existence; *uparamaù*—cessation; *ca*—certainly; *yatra*—in which.

TRANSLATION

Thus being fixed, one must render service unto the Supersoul situated in one's own heart by His omnipotency. Because He is the Almighty Personality of Godhead, eternal and unlimited, He is the ultimate goal of life, and by worshipping Him one can end the cause of the conditioned state of existence.

PURPORT

As confirmed in ***Bhagavad-gita*** (18.61), the Supreme Personality of Godhead Sri Kṛṣṇa is the all-pervading omnipresent Supersoul. Therefore one who is a *yogé* can worship only Him because He is the substance and not illusion. Every living creature is engaging in the service of something else. A living being's constitutional position is to render service, but in the atmosphere of *mäyâ*, or illusion, or the conditional state of existence, the

conditioned soul seeks the service of illusion. A conditioned soul works in the service of his temporary body, bodily relatives like the wife and children, and the necessary paraphernalia for maintaining the body and bodily relations, such as the house, land, wealth, society and country, but he does not know that all such renderings of service are totally illusory. As we have discussed many times before, this material world is itself an illusion, like a mirage in the desert. In the desert there is an illusion of water, and the foolish animals become entrapped by such an illusion and run after water in the desert, although there is no water at all. But because there is no water in the desert, one does not conclude that there is no water at all. The intelligent person knows well that there is certainly water, water in the seas and oceans, but such vast reservoirs of water are far, far away from the desert. One should therefore search for water in the vicinity of seas and oceans and not in the desert. Every one of us is searching after real happiness in life, namely eternal life, eternal or unlimited knowledge and unending blissful life. But foolish people who have no knowledge of the substance search after the reality of life in the illusion. This material body does not endure eternally, and everything in relation with this temporary body, such as the wife, children, society and country, also changes along with the change of body. This is called *saàsāra*, or repetition of birth, death, old age and disease. We would like to find a solution for all these problems of life, but we do not know the way. Herein it is suggested that anyone who wants to make an end to these miseries of life, namely repetition of birth, death, disease, and old age, must take to this process of worshiping the Supreme Lord and not others, as it is also ultimately suggested in the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (18.65). If we at all want to end the cause of our conditioned life, we must take to the worship of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, who is present in everyone's heart by His natural affection for all living beings, who are actually the parts and parcels of the Lord (Bg. 18.61). The baby in the lap of his mother is naturally attached to the mother, and the mother is attached to the child. But when the child grows up and becomes overwhelmed by circumstances, he gradually becomes detached from the mother, although the mother always expects some sort of service from the grown-up child and is equally affectionate toward her child, even though the child is forgetful. Similarly, because we are all part and parcel of the Lord, the Lord is always affectionate to us, and He always tries to get us back home, back to Godhead. But we, the conditioned souls, do not care

for Him and run instead after the illusory bodily connections. We must therefore extricate ourselves from all illusory connections of the world and seek reunion with the Lord, trying to render service unto Him because He is the ultimate truth. Actually we are hankering after Him as the child seeks the mother. And to search out the Supreme Personality of Godhead, we need not go anywhere else, because the Lord is within our hearts. This does not suggest, however, that we should not go to the places of worship, namely the temples, churches and mosques. Such holy places of worship are also occupied by the Lord because the Lord is omnipresent. For the common man these holy places are centers of learning about the science of God. When the temples are devoid of activities, the people in general become uninterested in such places, and consequently the mass of people gradually become godless, and a godless civilization is the result. Such a hellish civilization artificially increases the conditions of life, and existence becomes intolerable for everyone. The foolish leaders of a godless civilization try to devise various plans to bring about peace and prosperity in the godless world under a patent trademark of materialism, and because such attempts are illusory only, the people elect incompetent, blind leaders, one after another, who are incapable of offering solutions. If we want at all to end this anomaly of a godless civilization, we must follow the principles of revealed scriptures like the *Srimad-Bhagavatam* and follow the instruction of a person like Sri Sukadeva Gosvami who has no attraction for material gain.

TEXT 7

**k-STaa& TvNaad*TYa ParaNauicNTaa,
Ma*Tae PaéUNaSaTaq& NaaMa ku-YaaRTa()
PaXYaÅNa& PaiTaTa& vETar<Yaa&
Svk-MaRJaaNa(PairTaaPaaÅza<aMa()) 7))**

kas tää tv anädâtya paränucintäm

âte paçün asatéà nâma kuryät

paçyaï janaà patitaà vaitaraëyää

sva-karmajän paritäpäi juñäëam

SYNONYMS

kaù—who else; *täm*—that; *tu*—but; *anädåtya*—by neglecting; *para-anucintäm*—transcendental thoughts; *åte*—without; *paçün*—the materialists; *asatém*—in the nonpermanent; *nāma*—name; *kuryät*—will adopt; *paçyan*—seeing definitely; *janam*—the general mass of people; *patitam*—fallen; *vaitaraëyäm*—in Vaitaraëé, the river of suffering; *sva-karma-jän*—produced from one’s own work; *paritäpän*—suffering; *juñäëam*—being overtaken by.

TRANSLATION

Who else but the gross materialists will neglect such transcendental thought and take to the nonpermanent names only, seeing the mass of people fallen in the river of suffering as the consequence of accruing the result of their own work?

PURPORT

In the *Vedas* it is said that persons who are attached to demigods to the exclusion of the Supreme Personality of Godhead are like the animals who follow the herdsman even though they are taken to the slaughterhouse. The materialists, like animals, also do not know how they are being misdirected by neglecting the transcendental thought of the Supreme person. No one can remain vacant of thought. It is said that an idle brain is a devil’s workshop because a person who cannot think in the right way must think of something which may bring about disaster. The materialists are always worshiping some minor demigods, although this is condemned in the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (7.20). As long as a person is illusioned by material gains, he petitions the respective demigods to draw some particular benefit which is, after all, illusory and nonpermanent. The enlightened transcendentalist is not captivated by such illusory things; therefore he is always absorbed in the transcendental thought of the Supreme in different stages of realization, namely Brahman, Paramåtmå and Bhagavån. In the previous verse it is suggested that one should think of the Supersoul, which

is one step higher than the impersonal thought of Brahman, as it was suggested in the case of contemplating the *virāṭ-rūpa* of the personality of Godhead.

Intelligent persons who can see properly may look into the general conditions of the living entities who are wandering in the cycle of the It is said that there is an everlasting belt of water called the River Vaitaraëé at the entrance of the plutonic planet of Yamarāja, who punishes sinners in different manners. After being subjected to such sufferings, a sinner is awarded a particular species of life according to his deeds in the past. Such living entities as are punished by Yamarāja are seen in different varieties of conditioned life. Some of them are in heaven, and some of them are in hell. Some of them are *brahmanas*, and some of them are misers. But no one is happy in this material world, and all of them are either class A, B or C prisoners suffering because of their own deeds. The Lord is impartial to all circumstances of the sufferings of the living entities, but to one who takes shelter at His lotus feet, the Lord gives proper protection, and He takes such a living entity back home, back to Himself.

TEXT 8

ke-icTa(SvdehaNTaôRdYaavk-aXae
Pa[adeXaMaa}a& Pauâz& vSaNTaMa()
cTau>auRJa& k-ÅrQaa®Xa«,
GadaDar& Daar<aYaa SMariNTa)) 8))

kecit sva-dehāntar-hādayāvakāṣe

prādeṣa-mātraà puruṣaà vasantam

catur-bhujaà kaīja-rathāiga-ṣaikhā-

gadā-dharaà dhāraëyā smaranti

SYNONYMS

kecit—others; *sva-deha-antaù*—within the body; *hādaya-avakāṣe*—in the

region of the heart; *prādeṣa-mātram*—measuring only eight inches; *puruṣam*—the Personality of Godhead; *vasantam*—residing; *catuḥ-bhujam*—with four hands; *kaija*—lotus; *ratha-aṅga*—the wheel of a chariot; *ṣaṅkha*—conchshell; *gadā-dharam*—and with a club in the hand; *dhāraṇī*—conceiving in that way; *smaranti*—do meditate upon Him.

TRANSLATION

Others conceive of the Personality of Godhead residing within the body in the region of the heart and measuring only eight inches, with four hands carrying a lotus, a wheel of a chariot, a conchshell and a club respectively.

PURPORT

The all-pervading personality of Godhead resides as Paramātmā in the heart of each and every living entity. The measurement of the localized Personality of Godhead is estimated to expand from the ring finger to the end of the thumb, more or less eight inches. The form of the Lord described in this verse with distribution of different symbols—beginning from the lower right hand up and down to the lower left hand with lotus, wheel of a chariot, conchshell and club respectively—is called Janārdana, or the plenary portion of the Lord who controls the general mass. There are many other forms of the Lord with varied situations of the symbols of lotus, conchshell, etc., and they are differently known as Puruṣottama, Acyuta, Narasiṅha, Trivikrama, Haṅkṣha, Keṣava, Mādhava, Aniruddha, Pradyumna, Saṅkarṣṇa, Sridhara, Vāsudeva, Dāmodara, Janārdana, Nārāyaṇa, Hari, Padmanābha, Vāmana, Madhusūdana, Govinda, Kṛṣṇa, Viṣṇumūrti, Adhokṣaja and Upendra. These twenty-four forms of the localized Personality of Godhead are worshiped in different parts of the planetary system, and in each system there is an incarnation of the Lord having a different Vaikuntha planet in the spiritual sky, which is called the *paravyoma*. There are many other hundreds and scores of different forms of the Lord, and each and every one of them has a particular planet in the spiritual sky, of which this material sky is only a fragmental offshoot. The Lord exists as *puruṣa*, or the male enjoyer, although there is no comparing Him to any male form in the material world. But all such forms are *advaita*, nondifferent from one another, and each of them is eternally young. The

young Lord with four hands is nicely decorated, as described below.

TEXT 9

Pa[**Saàv£&- Nail/NaaYaTae+a<a&**
k-dMbik-ÅLk-iPaXa®vaSaSaMa()
I/SaNMaharÒihr<MaYaa®d&
Sfu-rNMaharÒik-rq\$=ku-<@I/Ma()) 9))

prasanna-vaktraà nalinäyatekñäëà

kadamba-kijjalka-piçaiga-vāsasam

lasan-mahä-ratna-hiraëmayäigadaà

sphuran-mahä-ratna-kiréöa-kuëòalam

SYNONYMS

prasanna—expresses happiness; *vaktram*—mouth; *nalina-äyata*—spread like the petals of a lotus; *ékñäëam*—eyes; *kadamba*—*kadamba* flower; *kijjalka*—saffron; *piçaiga*—yellow; *vāsasam*—garments; *lasat*—hanging; *mahä-ratna*—valuable jewels; *hiraëmaya*—made of gold; *aigadam*—ornament; *sphurat*—glowing; *mahä-ratna*—valuable jewels; *kiréöa*—head dress; *kuëòalam*—earrings.

TRANSLATION

His mouth expresses His happiness. His eyes spread like the petals of a lotus, and His garments, yellowish like the saffron of a kadamba flower, are bedecked with valuable jewels. His ornaments are all made of gold, set with jewels, and He wears a glowing head dress and earrings.

TEXT 10

oiàd]ôTPa³Jak-i<aRk-al/Yae
YaaeGaeiraSQaaiPaTaPaadPaçvMa()

é[ql/+a<a& k-aESTau>arÒk-NDar,
MaãaNal/+MYaa vNaMaal/YaaicTaMa()) 10))

unnidra-hât-paìkaja-karëikālaye

yogeçvarāsthāpita-pāda-pallavam

çré-lakñāëaà kaustubha-ratna-kandharam

amlāna-lakñmyā vana-mālayācitam

SYNONYMS

unnidra—blooming; *hât*—heart; *paìkaja*—lotus flower; *karëikā-ālaye*—on the surface of the whorl; *yoga-éçvara*—the great mystics; *āsthāpita*—placed; *pāda-pallavam*—lotus feet; *çré*—the goddess of fortune, or a beautiful calf; *lakñāëam*—marked in that way; *kaustubha*—the Kaustubha jewel; *ratna*—other jewels; *kandharam*—on the shoulder; *amlāna*—quite fresh; *lakñmyā*—beauty; *vana-mālayā*—by a flower garland; *ācitam*—spread over.

TRANSLATION

His lotus feet are placed over the whorls of the lotuslike hearts of great mystics. On His chest is the Kaustubha jewel, engraved with a beautiful calf, and there are other jewels on His shoulders. His complete torso is garlanded with fresh flowers.

PURPORT

The ornaments, flowers, clothing and all the other decorations on the transcendental body of the Personality of Godhead are identical with the body of the Lord. None of them are made of material ingredients; otherwise there would be no chance of their decorating the body of the Lord. As such, in the *paravyoma*, spiritual varieties are also distinguished from the material variegatedness.

TEXT 11

iv>aUizTa& Mae%l/Yaax(Gaul/IYakE-,
MaRhaDaNaENaURPaurk-³<aaidi>a")
iòGDaaMal/aku-iÄTaNaql/ku-NTalE/,
ivRraecMaaNaaNaNahaSaPaeXal/Ma()) 11))

vibhüñitaà mekhalayäìguléyakair

mahä-dhanair nüpura-kaïkaëädibhiù

snigdhämaläkuïcita-néla-kuntalair

virocamänänana-häsa-peçalam

SYNONYMS

vibhüñitam—well decorated; *mekhalayä*—with an ornamental wreath about the waist; *aìguléyakaiù*—by finger rings; *mahä-dhanaiù*—all highly valuable; *nüpura*—ringing leglets; *kaïkaëa-ädibhiù*—also by bangles; *snigdha*—slick; *amala*—spotless; *äkuïcita*—curling; *néla*—bluish; *kuntalaiù*—hair; *virocamäna*—very pleasing; *änana*—face; *häsa*—smile; *peçalam*—beautiful.

TRANSLATION

He is well decorated with an ornamental wreath about His waist and rings studded with valuable jewels on His fingers. His leglets, His bangles, His oiled hair, curling with a bluish tint, and His beautiful smiling face are all very pleasing.

PURPORT

The Supreme Personality of Godhead is the most beautiful person amongst all others, and Srila Sukadeva Gosvami describes every part of His transcendental beauty, one after another, in order to teach the impersonalist that the Personality of Godhead is not an imagination by the

devotee for facility of worship, but is the Supreme Person in fact and figure. The impersonal feature of the Absolute Truth is but His radiation, as the sun rays are but radiations from the sun.

TEXT 12

AdqNal/Il/ahiSaTae+a<aaeçSad(
>a]U>a®Sa&SaUicTa>aUYaRNauGa]hMa()
wR+aeTa icNTaaMaYaMaeNaMaqir&
YaavNMaNaee Daar<aYaaviTaiTae)) 12))

adéna-lila-hasitekñāëollasad-

bhrü-bhaiga-saäsücita-bhüry-anugraham

ékñeta cintāmayam enam éçvaraà

yävan mano dhāraëayävatiñöhate

SYNONYMS

adéna—very magnanimous; *lila*—pastimes ; *hasita*—smiling; *ékñāëa*—by glancing over; *ullasat*—glowing; *bhrü-bhaiga*—signals of the eyebrow; *saäsücita*—indicated; *bhüri*—extensive; *anugraham*—benediction; *ékñeta*—one must concentrate on; *cintāmayam*—transcendental; *enam*—this particular; *éçvaram*—the Supreme Lord; *yävat*—as long as; *manaù*—the mind; *dhāraëayä*—by meditation; *avatiñöhate*—can be fixed.

TRANSLATION

The Lord’s magnanimous pastimes and the glowing glancing of His smiling face are all indications of His extensive benedictions. One must therefore concentrate on this transcendental form of the Lord, as long as the mind can be fixed on Him by meditation.

PURPORT

In ***Bhagavad-gita*** (12.5) it is said that the impersonalist undergoes a series of difficult programs on account of his impersonal meditation. But the devotee, due to the Lord's personal service, progresses very easily. Impersonal meditation is therefore a source of suffering for the impersonalist. Here, the devotee has an advantage over the impersonalist philosopher. The impersonalist is doubtful about the personal feature of the Lord, and therefore he always tries to meditate upon something which is not objective. For this reason there is an authentic statement in the *Bhāgavatam* regarding the positive concentration of the mind on the factual form of the Lord.

The process of meditation recommended herein is *bhakti-yoga*, or the process of devotional service after one is liberated from the material conditions. *Jñāna-yoga* is the process of liberation from the material conditions. After one is liberated from the conditions of material existence, i.e., when one is *nivāṭṭa*, as previously stated herein, or when one is freed from all material necessities, one becomes qualified to discharge the process of *bhakti-yoga*. Therefore *bhakti-yoga* includes *jñāna-yoga*, or, in other words, the process of pure devotional service simultaneously serves the purpose of *jñāna-yoga*; liberation from material conditions is automatically achieved by the gradual development of pure devotional service. These effects of *bhakti-yoga* are called *anartha-nivāṭṭi*. Things which are artificially acquired gradually disappear along with the progress of *bhakti-yoga*. Meditation on the lotus feet of the personality of Godhead, the first processional step, must show its effect by *anartha-nivāṭṭi*. The grossest type of *anartha* which binds the conditioned soul in material existence is sex desire, and this sex desire gradually develops in the union of the male and female. When the male and female are united, the sex desire is further aggravated by the accumulation of buildings, children, friends, relatives and wealth. When all these are acquired, the conditioned soul becomes overwhelmed by such entanglements, and the false sense of egoism, or the sense of "myself" and "mine," becomes prominent, and the sex desire expands to various political, social, altruistic, philanthropic and many other unwanted engagements, resembling the foam of the sea waves, which becomes very prominent at one time and at the next moment vanishes as quickly as a cloud in the sky. The conditioned soul is encircled by such products, as well as products of sex desire, and therefore *bhakti-*

yoga leads to gradual evaporation of the sex desire, which is summarized in three headings, namely *profit*, *adoration* and *distinction*. All conditioned souls are mad after these different forms of sex desire, and one shall see for himself how much he has been freed from such material hankerings based primarily on the sex desire. As a person feels his hunger satisfied after eating each morsel of foodstuff, he must similarly be able to see the degree to which he has been freed from sex desire. The sex desire is diminished along with its various forms by the process of *bhakti-yoga* because *bhakti-yoga* automatically, by the grace of the Lord, effectively results in knowledge and renunciation, even if the devotee is not materially very well educated. Knowledge means knowing things as they are, and if by deliberation it is found that there are things which are at all unnecessary, naturally the person who has acquired knowledge leaves aside such unwanted things. When the conditioned soul finds by culture of knowledge that material necessities are unwanted things, he becomes detached from such unwanted things. This stage of knowledge is called *vairāgya*, or detachment from unwanted things. We have previously discussed that the transcendentalist is required to be self-sufficient and should not beg from the rich blind persons to fulfill the bare necessities of life. Sukadeva Gosvami has suggested some alternatives for the bare necessities of life, namely the problem of eating, sleeping and shelter, but he has not suggested any alternative for sex satisfaction. One who has the sex desire still with him should not at all try to accept the renounced order of life. For one who has not attained to this stage, there is no question of a renounced order of life. So by the gradual process of devotional service under the guidance of a proper spiritual master, and following the principles of the *Bhāgavatam*, one must be able at least to control the gross sex desire before one accepts the renounced order of life factually.

So purification means getting free gradually from sex desire, and this is attained by meditation on the person of the Lord as described herein, beginning from the feet. One should not try to go upwards artificially without seeing for himself how much he has been released from the sex desire. The smiling face of the Lord is the Tenth Canto of *Srimad-Bhāgavatam*, and there are many upstarts who at once try to begin with the Tenth Canto and especially with the five chapters which delineate the *rāsa-līlā* of the Lord. This is certainly improper. By such improper study or

hearing of *Bhāgavatam*, the material opportunists have played havoc by indulgence in sex life in the name of *Bhāgavatam*. This vilification of *Bhāgavatam* is rendered by the acts of the so-called devotees; one should be free from all kinds of sex desire before he tries to make a show of recital of *Bhāgavatam*. Sri Visvanatha Cakravarti Ōhākura clearly defines the import of purification as cessation from sex indulgence. He says, *yathā yathā dhéç ca çudhyati viñaya-lāmpaöyaa tyajati, tathā tathā dhārayed iti citta-çuddhi-tāratamyenaiva dhyāna-tāratamyam uktam*. And as one gets free from the intoxication of sex indulgence by purification of intelligence, one should step forward for the next meditation, or in other words, the progress of meditation on the different limbs of the transcendental body of the Lord should be enhanced in proportion to the progress of purification of the heart. The conclusion is that those who are still entrapped by sex indulgence should never progress to meditation above the feet of the Lord; therefore recital of *Srimad-Bhagavatam* by them should be restricted to the First and Second Cantos of the great literature. One must complete the purificatory process by assimilating the contents of the first nine cantos. Then one should be admitted into the realm of the Tenth Canto of *Srimad-Bhagavatam*.

TEXT 13

WkE-k-Xaae_®aiNa iDaYaaNau>aavYaeTa(
 Paadaid YaavÖiSaTa& Gada>a*Ta")
 iJaTa& iJaTa& SQaaNaMaPaaeù DaarYaeTa(
 Par& Par& éuÖyiTa DaqYaRQaa YaQaa)) 13))

ekaikaço 'igāni dhiyānubhāvayet

pādādi yāvad dhasitaà gadābhātaù

jitaà jitaà sthānam apohya dhārayet

paraà paraà çuddhyati dhér yathā yathā

SYNONYMS

eka-ekaṣaṭ—one to one, or one after another; *aṅgāni*—limbs; *dhiyā*—by attention; *anubhāvayet*—meditate upon; *pāda-ādi*—legs, etc.; *yāvat*—until; *hasitam*—smiling; *gadā-bhātaṭ*—the personality of Godhead; *jītam jītam*—gradually controlling the mind; *sthānam*—place; *apohya*—leaving; *dhārayet*—meditate upon; *param param*—higher and higher; *çuddhyati*—purified; *dhéu*—intelligence; *yathā yathā*—as much as.

TRANSLATION

The process of meditation should begin from the lotus feet of the Lord and progress to His smiling face. The meditation should be concentrated upon the lotus feet, then the calves, then the thighs, and in this way higher and higher. The more the mind becomes fixed upon the different parts of the limbs, one after another, the more the intelligence becomes purified.

PURPORT

The process of meditation recommended in the *Srimad-Bhagavatam* is not to fix one's attention on something impersonal or void. The meditation should concentrate on the person of the Supreme Godhead, either in His *virāṭ-rūpa*, the gigantic universal form, or in His *sac-cid-ānanda-vigraha* [Bs. 5.1], as described in the scriptures. There are authorized descriptions of Viṣṇu forms, and there are authorized representations of Deities in the temples. Thus one can practice meditating upon the Deity, concentrating his mind on the lotus feet of the Lord and gradually rising higher and higher, up to His smiling face.

According to the *Bhāgavata* school, the Lord's *rāsa* dancing is the smiling face of the Lord. Since it is recommended in this verse that one should gradually progress from the lotus feet up to the smiling face, we shall not jump at once to understand the Lord's pastimes in the *rāsa* dance. It is better to practice concentrating our attention by offering flowers and *tulasī* to the lotus feet of the Lord. In this way, we gradually become purified by the *arcanā* process. We dress the Lord, bathe Him, etc., and all these transcendental activities help us purify our existence. When we reach the higher standard of purification, if we see the smiling face of the Lord or

hear the *rāsa* dance pastimes of the Lord, then we can relish His activities. In the *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, therefore, the *rāsa* dance pastimes are delineated in the Tenth Canto (Chapters 29–34).

The more one concentrates on the transcendental form of the Lord, either on the lotus feet, the calves, the thighs or the chest, the more one becomes purified. In this verse it is clearly stated, “the more the intelligence becomes purified,” which means the more one becomes detached from sense gratification. Our intelligence in the present conditioned state of life is impure due to being engaged in sense gratification. The result of meditation on the transcendental form of the Lord will be manifested by one’s detachment from sense gratification. Therefore, the ultimate purpose of meditation is purification of one’s intelligence.

Those who are too engrossed in sense gratification cannot be allowed to participate in *arcanā* or to touch the transcendental form of the Rādhā-Kṛṣṇa or Viṣṇu Deities. For them it is better to meditate upon the gigantic *virāṭ-rūpa* of the Lord, as recommended in the next verse. The impersonalists and the voidists are therefore recommended to meditate upon the universal form of the Lord, whereas the devotees are recommended to meditate on the Deity worship in the temple. Because the impersonalists and the voidists are not sufficiently purified in their spiritual activities, *arcanā* is not meant for them.

TEXT 14

Yaavà JaaYaeTa Paravre_iSMaNa(
ivieire d]iir >aiç-YaaeGa")
TaavTa(SQavqYa" PauåzSYa æPa&
iṣ-YaavSaaNae Pa[YaTa" SMareTa)) 14))

yāvan na jāyeta parāvare 'smin

viçveçvare drañöari bhakti-yogaù

tāvat sthavéyaù puruṣasya rūpaà

kriyāvasāne prayataù smareta

SYNONYMS

yāvat—as long as; *na*—does not; *jāyeta*—develop; *para*—transcendental; *avare*—mundane; *asmin*—in this form of; *viçva-éçvare*—the Lord of all worlds; *drañöari*—unto the seer; *bhakti-yogaù*—devotional service; *tāvat*—so long; *sthavéyaù*—the gross materialist; *puruşasya*—of the *viräö-puruşa*; *rüpam*—universal form; *kriyā-avasāne*—at the end of one’s prescribed duties; *prayataù*—with proper attention; *smareta*—one should remember.

TRANSLATION

Unless the gross materialist develops a sense of loving service unto the Supreme Lord, the seer of both the transcendental and material worlds, he should remember or meditate upon the universal form of the Lord at the end of his prescribed duties.

PURPORT

The Supreme Lord is the seer of all worlds, both material and transcendental. In other words, the Supreme Lord is the ultimate beneficiary and enjoyer of all worlds, as confirmed in the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (5.29). The spiritual world is the manifestation of His internal potency, and the material world is the manifestation of His external potency. The living entities are also His marginal potency, and by their own choice they can live in either the transcendental or material worlds. The material world is not a fit place for living entities because they are spiritually one with the Lord and in the material world the living entities become conditioned by the laws of the material world. The Lord wants all living entities, who are His parts and parcels, to live with Him in the transcendental world, and for enlightening conditioned souls in the material world, all the *Vedas* and the revealed scriptures are there—expressly to recall the conditioned souls back home, back to Godhead. Unfortunately, the conditioned living entities, although suffering continually the threefold miseries of conditioned life, are not very serious about going back to Godhead. It is due to their misguided way of living, complicated by sins and virtues. Some of them who are virtuous by

deeds begin to reestablish the lost relation with the Lord, but they are unable to understand the personal feature of the Lord. The real purpose of life is to make contact with the Lord and be engaged in His service. That is the natural position of living entities. But those who are impersonalists and are unable to render any loving service to the Lord have been advised to meditate upon His impersonal feature, the *virāṭ-rūpa*, or universal form. Some way or other, one must try to reestablish one's forgotten relation with the Lord if one at all desires to gain real happiness in life, and to reclaim his natural unfettered condition. For the less intelligent beginners, meditation on the impersonal feature, the *virāṭ-rūpa*, or universal form of the Lord, will gradually qualify one to rise to personal contact. One is advised herewith to meditate upon the *virāṭ-rūpa* specified in the previous chapters in order to understand how the different planets, seas, mountains, rivers, birds, beasts, human beings, demigods and all that we can conceive are but different parts and limbs of the Lord's *virāṭ* form. This sort of thinking is also a type of meditation on the Absolute Truth, and as soon as such meditation begins, one develops one's godly qualities, and the whole world appears to be a happy and peaceful residence for all the people of the world. Without such meditation on God, either personal or impersonal, all good qualities of the human being become covered with misconceptions regarding his constitutional position, and without such advanced knowledge, the whole world becomes a hell for the human being.

TEXT 15

iSQar& Sau%& caSaNaMaaiSQaTaae YaiTa,
 YaRda iJahaSauirMaMa® I/aek-Ma()
 k-ale/ c deXae c MaNaae Na SaÂYaeTa(
 Pa[a<aaNa(iNaYaC^eNMaNaSaa iJaTaaSau")) 15))

sthiraà sukhaà cāsanam āsthito yatir

yadā jihāsuraṁ imam aṅgaṁ lokam

kāle ca deḥe ca mano na sajjayet

prāḍhānīyaṁ manasā jitaṁ

SYNONYMS

sthiram—without being disturbed; *sukham*—comfortable; *ca*—also; *āsanam*—sitting accommodation; *āsthitaù*—being situated; *yatiù*—the sage; *yadä*—whenever; *jihäsuù*—desires to give up; *imam*—this; *aìga*—O King; *lokam*—this body; *käle*—in time; *ca*—and; *deçe*—in a proper place; *ca*—also; *manaù*—the mind; *na*—not; *sajjayet*—may not be perplexed; *präëän*—the senses; *niyacchet*—must control; *manasä*—by the mind; *jita-asuù*—conquering the life air.

TRANSLATION

O King, whenever the yogé desires to leave this planet of human beings, he should not be perplexed about the proper time or place, but should comfortably sit without being disturbed and, regulating the life air, should control the senses by the mind.

PURPORT

In the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (8.14) it is clearly stated that a person who is totally engaged in the transcendental loving service of the Lord, and who constantly remembers Him at every step, easily obtains the mercy of the Lord by entering into His personal contact. Such devotees do not need to seek an opportune moment to leave the present body. But those who are mixed devotees, alloyed with fruitive action or empirical philosophical speculation, require an opportune moment for quitting this body. For them the opportune moments are stated in the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (8.23–26). But these opportune moments are not as important as one's being a successful *yogé* who is able to quit his body as he likes. Such a *yogé* must be competent to control his senses by the mind. The mind is easily conquered simply by engaging it at the lotus feet of the Lord. Gradually, by such service, all the senses become automatically engaged in the service of the Lord. That is the way of merging into the Supreme Absolute.

TEXT 16

MaNa" SvbuÖyaMal/Yaa iNaYaMYa

+ae}aj WTaa& iNaNaYaeTa(TaMaaTMaiNa)
AaTMaaNaMaaTMaNYavâDYa Daqrae
I/BDaaePaXaaiNTaivRrMaeTa k*-TYaaTa()) 16))

manaù sva-buddhyämalayä niyamyä

kñetra-jïa etäà ninayet tam ätmani

ätmānam ätmany avarudhya dhéro

labdhopaçāntir virameta kātyāt

SYNONYMS

manaù—the mind; *sva-buddhyä*—by his own intelligence; *amalayä*—unalloyed; *niyamyä*—by regulating; *kñetra-jïe*—unto the living entity; *etām*—all of them; *ninayet*—merge; *tam*—that; *ätmani*—the self; *ätmānam*—the self; *ätmani*—in the Superself; *avarudhya*—being locked up; *dhéraù*—the fully satisfied; *labdha-upaçāntiù*—one who has attained full bliss; *virameta*—ceases from; *kātyāt*—all other activities.

TRANSLATION

Thereafter, the yogé should merge his mind, by his unalloyed intelligence, into the living entity, and then merge the living entity into the Superself. And by doing this, the fully satisfied living entity becomes situated in the supreme stage of satisfaction, so that he ceases from all other activities.

PURPORT

The functions of the mind are thinking, feeling and willing. When the mind is materialistic, or absorbed in material contact, it acts for material advancement of knowledge, destructively ending in discovery of nuclear weapons. But when the mind acts under spiritual urge, it acts wonderfully for going back home, back to Godhead, for life in complete bliss and eternity. Therefore the mind has to be manipulated by good and unalloyed intelligence. Perfect intelligence is to render service unto the Lord. One

should be intelligent enough to understand that the living being is, in all circumstances, a servant of the circumstances. Every living being is serving the dictates of desire, anger, lust, illusion, insanity and enviousness—all materially affected. But even while executing such dictations of different temperaments, he is perpetually unhappy. When one actually feels this and turns his intelligence to inquiring about it from the right sources, he gets information of the transcendental loving service of the Lord. Instead of serving materially for the abovementioned different humors of the body, the living entity's intelligence then becomes freed from the unhappy illusion of materialistic temperament, and thus, by unalloyed intelligence, the mind is brought into the service of the Lord. The Lord and His service are identical, being on the absolute plane. Therefore the unalloyed intelligence and the mind are merged into the Lord, and thus the living entity does not remain a seer himself but becomes seen by the Lord transcendently. When the living entity is directly seen by the Lord, the Lord dictates to him to act according to His desire, and when the living entity follows Him perfectly, the living entity ceases to discharge any other duty for his illusory satisfaction. In his pure unalloyed state, the living being attains the stage of full bliss, *labdhopaçänti*, and ceases all material hankerings.

TEXT 17

Na Ya}a k-al/ae_iNaiMaza& Par" Pa[>au"
ku-Taae Nau deva JaGaTaa& Ya wRiXare)
Na Ya}a Satv& Na rJaSTaMaê
Na vE ivk-arae Na MahaNa(Pa[DaaNaMa()) 17))

na yatra kälo 'nimiñää paraù prabhuù

kuto nu devä jagatää ya éçire

na yatra sattvaà na rajas tamaç ca

na vai vikäro na mahän pradhänam

SYNONYMS

na—not; *yatra*—wherein; *kāla*—destructive time; *animiñām*—of the heavenly demigods; *para*—superior; *prabhu*—controller; *kuta*—where is there; *nu*—certainly; *devā*—the demigods; *jagatām*—the mundane creatures; *ye*—those; *éçire*—rules; *na*—not; *yatra*—therein; *sattvam*—mundane goodness; *na*—nor; *raja*—mundane passion; *tama*—mundane ignorance; *ca*—also; *na*—nor; *vai*—certainly; *vikāra*—transformation; *na*—nor; *mahān*—the material Causal Ocean; *pradhānam*—material nature.

TRANSLATION

In that transcendental state of labdhopaçānti, there is no supremacy of devastating time, which controls even the celestial demigods who are empowered to rule over mundane creatures. (And what to speak of the demigods themselves?) Nor is there the mode of material goodness, nor passion, nor ignorance, nor even the false ego, nor the material Causal Ocean, nor the material nature.

PURPORT

Devastating time, which controls even the celestial demigods by its manifestations of past, present and future, does not act on the transcendental plane. The influence of time is exhibited by the symptoms of birth, death, old age and disease, and these four principles of material conditions are present everywhere in any part of the material cosmos up to the planet Brahmāloka, where the duration of life of the inhabitants appears to us to be fabulous. Insurmountable time even brings about the death of Brahmā, so what to speak of other demigods like Indra, Candā, Sūrya, Vāyu and Varuṇa? The astronomical influence directed by the different demigods over mundane creatures is also conspicuous by its absence. In material existence, the living entities are afraid of Satanic influence, but for a devotee on the transcendental plane there is no such fear at all. The living entities change their material bodies in different shapes and forms under the influence of the different modes of material nature, but in the transcendental state the devotee is *guṇa-tēta*, or above the material modes of goodness, passion and ignorance. Thus the false ego of “I am the lord of all I survey” does not arise there. In the material world

the false ego of the living being trying to lord it over the material nature is something like the moth's falling in a blazing fire. The moth is captivated by the glaring beauty of the fire, and when he comes to enjoy it, the blazing fire consumes him. In the transcendental state the living being is pure in his consciousness, and as such he has no false ego to lord it over the material nature. Rather, his pure consciousness directs him to surrender unto the Supreme Lord, as stated in the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (7.19): *vāsudevaù sarvam iti sa mahātmā sudurlabhaù*. All this indicates that in the transcendental state there is neither material creation nor the Causal Ocean for material nature.

The above-mentioned state of affairs is factual on the transcendental plane, but is factually revealed in a transcendentalist's knowledge of the advanced state of pure consciousness. Such transcendentalists are of two types, namely the impersonalists and the devotees. For the impersonalist the ultimate goal or destination is the *brahmajyoti* of the spiritual sky, but for the devotees the ultimate goal is the Vaikuntha planets. The devotees experience the above-mentioned state of affairs by attainment of spiritual forms for activity in the transcendental loving service of the Lord. But the impersonalist, because of his neglecting the association of the Lord, does not develop a spiritual body for spiritual activity, but remains a spiritual spark only, merged in the effulgent spiritual rays of the Supreme Personality of Godhead. The Lord is the full-fledged form of eternity, bliss and knowledge, but the formless *brahmajyoti* is simply eternity and knowledge. The Vaikuntha planets are also forms of eternity, bliss and knowledge, and therefore the devotees of the Lord, who are admitted into the abode of the Lord, also get bodies of eternity, bliss and knowledge. As such there is no difference between one and another. The Lord's abode, name, fame, entourage, etc., are of the same transcendental quality, and how this transcendental quality differs from the material world is explained herewith in this verse. In the *Bhagavad-gita*, three principal subjects have been explained by Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, namely *karma-yoga*, *jñāna-yoga* and *bhakti-yoga*, but one can reach the Vaikuntha planets by the practice of *bhakti-yoga* only. The other two are incompetent in helping one reach the Vaikunthalokas, although they can, however, conveniently take one to the effulgent *brahmajyoti*, as described above.

TEXT 18

Par& Pad& vEZ<avMaaMaNaiNTa Tad(
YaàeiTa NaeTaqTYaTaduiTSaSa*+av")
ivSa*JYa daEraTMYaMaNaNYaSaaEôda
ôdaePaGauùahRPad& Pade Pade)) 18))

paraà padaà vaiñëavam ämananti tad

yan neti netéty atad utsisâkñavaù

visâjya daurätmyam ananya-sauhâdä

hâdopaguhyârha-padaà pade pade

SYNONYMS

param—the supreme; *padam*—situation; *vaiñëavam*—in relation with the personality of Godhead; *ämananti*—do they know; *tat*—that; *yat*—which; *na iti*—not this; *na iti*—not this; *iti*—thus; *atat*—godless; *utsisâkñavaù*—those who desire to avoid; *visâjya*—giving it up completely; *daurätmyam*—perplexities; *ananya*—absolutely; *sauhâdäù*—in good will; *hâdä upaguhyä*—taking them into his heart; *arha*—that which is only worshipable; *padam*—lotus feet; *pade pade*—at every moment.

TRANSLATION

The transcendentalists desire to avoid everything godless, for they know that supreme situation in which everything is related with the Supreme Lord Viṣṇu. Therefore a pure devotee who is in absolute harmony with the Lord does not create perplexities, but worships the lotus feet of the Lord at every moment, taking them into his heart.

PURPORT

In the *Bhagavad-gita*, *mad-dhāma* (“My abode”) is mentioned several times, and according to the version of the Supreme Personality of Godhead Sri Kṛṣṇa there exists the unlimited spiritual sky, wherein the planets are called Vaikunthas, or the abode of the Personality of Godhead. In that sky,

which is far, far beyond the material sky and its sevenfold coverings, there is no need of the sun or the moon, nor is there necessity of electricity for illumination, because the planets are self-illuminating and more brilliant than the material suns. pure devotees of the Lord are absolutely in harmony with the Personality of Godhead, or in other words, they always think of the Lord as their only dependable friend and well-wisher. They do not care for any mundane creature, up to the status of Brahmā, the lord of the universe. Only they can definitely have a clear vision of the Vaikuntha planets. Such pure devotees, being perfectly directed by the Supreme Lord, do not create any artificial perplexity in the matter of transcendental understanding by wasting time in discussing what is Brahman and what is non-Brahman, or *māyā*, nor do they falsely think of themselves as one with the Lord, or argue that there is no existence of the Lord separately, or that there is no God at all, or that living beings are themselves God, or that when God incarnates Himself He assumes a material body. Nor do they concern themselves with many obscure speculative theories, which are in actuality so many stumbling blocks on the path of transcendental understanding. Apart from the class of impersonalists or nondevotees, there are also classes who pose themselves as devotees of the Lord but at heart maintain the idea of salvation by becoming one with the impersonal Brahman. They wrongly manufacture their own way of devotional service by open debauchery and mislead others who are simpletons or debauchees like themselves. All these nondevotees and debauchees are, according to Visvanatha Cakravarti, *durātmās*, or crooked souls in the dress of *mahātmās*, or great souls. Such nondevotees and debauchees are completely excluded from the list of transcendentalists by the presentation of this particular verse by Sukadeva Gosvami.

So the Vaikuntha planets are factually the supreme residential places called the *paraà padam*. The impersonal *brahmajyoti* is also called the *paraà padam* due to its being the rays of the Vaikuntha planets, as the sun rays are the rays of the sun. In the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (14.27) it is clearly said that the impersonal *brahmajyoti* rests on the person of the Lord, and because everything rests on the *brahmajyoti* directly and indirectly, everything is generated from the Lord, everything rests on Him, and after annihilation, everything is merged in Him only. Therefore, nothing is independent of Him. A pure devotee of the Lord no longer wastes valuable time in

discriminating the Brahman from non-Brahman because he knows perfectly well that the Lord Parabrahman, by His Brahman energy, is interwoven in everything, and thus everything is looked upon by a devotee as the property of the Lord. The devotee tries to engage everything in His service and does not create perplexities by falsely lording it over the creation of the Lord. He is so faithful that he engages himself, as well as everything else, in the transcendental loving service of the Lord. In everything, the devotee sees the Lord, and he sees everything in the Lord. The specific disturbance created by a *durātmā*, or crooked soul, is due to his maintaining that the transcendental form of the Lord is something material.

TEXT 19

**wTQa& MauiNaSTaUParMaed(VYaviSQaTaae
ivjaNad*GvqYaRSauriNDaTaaXaYa")
SvPaiZ<aRNaaPaq@y Gaud& TaTaae_iNal&/
SQaaNaezu z\$(SaUàMaYaeiÂTa©-Ma")) 19))**

itthaà munis tüparamed vyavasthito

vijjāna-dāg-vérya-surandhitāçayaù

sva-pārñēināpéòya gudaà tato 'nilaà

sthāneñu ñaösünnamayej jita-klamaù

SYNONYMS

ittham—thus, by Brahman realization; *muniù*—the philosopher; *tu*—but; *uparamet*—should retire; *vyavasthitaù*—well situated; *vijjāna-dāk*—by scientific knowledge; *vérya*—strength; *su-randhita*—well regulated; *āçayaù*—aim of life; *sva-pārñēinā*—with the heel of one's foot; *āpéòya*—by blocking; *gudam*—the air hole; *tataù*—thereafter; *anilam*—life air; *sthāneñu*—in the places; *ñāösu*—six primary; *unnamayet*—must be lifted; *jita-klamaù*—by extinguishing material desires.

TRANSLATION

By the strength of scientific knowledge, one should be well situated in absolute realization and thus be able to extinguish all material desires. One should then give up the material body by blocking the air hole [through which stool is evacuated] with the heel of one's foot and by lifting the life air from one place to another in the six primary places.

PURPORT

There are many *durātmās* who claim to have realized themselves as Brahman and yet are unable to conquer material desires. In the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (18.54) it is clearly explained that an absolutely self-realized soul becomes completely aloof from all material desires. Material desires are based on the false ego of the living being and are exhibited by his childish and useless activities to conquer the laws of material nature and by his desire to lord it over the resources of the five elements. With such a mentality, one is led to believe in the strength of material science, with its discovery of atomic energy and space travel by mechanical vehicles, and by such tiny advancements in material science the false egoist tries to challenge even the strength of the Supreme Lord, who can finish all man's tiny endeavors in less than a second. The well-situated self, or Brahman-realized soul, perfectly understands that the Supreme Brahman, or the personality of Godhead, is the all-powerful Vāsudeva and that he (the self-realized living being) is a part and parcel of the supreme whole. As such, his constitutional position is to cooperate with Him in all respects in the transcendental relation of the served and the servitor. Such a self-realized soul ceases to exhibit his useless activities of attempting to lord it over material nature. Being scientifically well informed, he fully engages himself in faithful devotion to the Lord.

The expert *yogé* who has thoroughly practiced the control of the life air by the prescribed method of the *yoga* system is advised to quit the body as follows. He should plug up the evacuating hole with the heel of the foot and then progressively move the life air on and on to six places: the navel, abdomen, heart, chest, palate, eyebrows and cerebral pit. Controlling the life air by the prescribed yogic process is mechanical, and the practice is more or less a physical endeavor for spiritual perfection. In olden days such practice was very common for the transcendentalist, for the mode of life

and character in those days were favorable. But in modern days, when the influence of Kali Age is so disturbing, practically everyone is untrained in this art of bodily exercise. Concentration of the mind is more easily attained in these days by the chanting of the holy name of the Lord. The results are more effective than those derived from the inner exercise of the life air.

TEXT 20

Naa>Yaa& iSQaTa& ôÛiDaraePYa TaSMaa,
dudaNaGaTYaaeriSa Ta& NaYaeNMauiNa")
TaTaae_NauSaNDaaYa iDaYaa MaNaSvq
SvTaalu/MaUl&/ XaNakE-NaRYaeTa)) 20))

nābhyāà sthitaà hādy adhiropya tasmād

udāna-gatyorasi taà nayan muniù

tato 'nusandhāya dhiyā manasvé

sva-tālu-mūlaà ṇanakair nayeta

SYNONYMS

nābhyām—on the navel; *sthitam*—situated; *hādi*—in the heart;
adhiropya—by placing; *tasmāt*—from there; *udāna*—soaring; *gatya*—force;
urasi—on the chest; *tam*—thereafter; *nayet*—should draw; *muniù*—the
meditative devotee; *tataù*—them; *anusandhāya*—just to search out;
dhiyā—by intelligence; *manasvé*—the meditative; *sva-tālu-mūlam*—at the
root of the palate; *ṇanakaiù*—slowly; *nayeta*—may be brought in.

TRANSLATION

The meditative devotee should slowly push up the life air from the navel to the heart, from there to the chest and from there to the root of the palate. He should search out the proper places with intelligence.

PURPORT

There are six circles of the movement of the life air, and the intelligent *bhakti-yogé* should search out these places with intelligence and in a meditative mood. Among these, mentioned above is the *svādhiññöhāna-cakra*, or the powerhouse of the life air, and above this, just below the abdomen and navel, is the *maëi-püraka-cakra*. When upper space is further searched out in the heart, one reaches the *anāhata-cakra*, and further up, when the life air is placed at the root of the palate, one reaches the *viçuddhi-cakra*.

TEXT 21

TaSMaad(>a]uvaerNTarMauàYaeTa
iNaãÖSaáaYaTaNaae_NaPae+a")
iSQaTva MauhUTaaRDaRMaku-<#=#d*í,
iNaRi>aRÛ MaUDaRNa(ivSa*JaeTPar& GaTa")) 21))

tasmäd bhruvor antaram unnayeta

niruddha-saptäyatano 'napekñau

sthitvä muhürtärdham akuëöha-dãñöir

nirbhidyā mürdhan visåjet paraà gataù

SYNONYMS

tasmät—from there; *bhruvoù*—of the eyebrows; *antaram*—in between; *unnayeta*—should be brought in; *niruddha*—by blocking; *sapta*—seven; *äyatanaù*—outlets of the life air; *anapekñau*—independent of all material enjoyment; *sthitvä*—by keeping; *muhürta*—of a moment; *ardham*—half; *akuëöha*—back home, back to Godhead; *dãñöiù*—one whose aim is targeted like that; *nirbhidyā*—punching; *mürdhan*—the cerebral hole; *visåjet*—should give up his body; *param*—the Supreme; *gataù*—having gone to.

TRANSLATION

Thereafter the bhakti-yogé should push the life air up between the eyebrows, and then, blocking the seven outlets of the life air, he should maintain his aim for going back home, back to Godhead. If he is completely free from all desires for material enjoyment, he should then reach the cerebral hole and give up his material connections, having gone to the Supreme.

PURPORT

The process of giving up all material connections and returning home, back to Godhead, the Supreme, is recommended herein. The condition is that one should be completely freed from desire for material enjoyment. There are different grades of material enjoyments in respect to duration of life and sensual gratification. The highest plane of sensual enjoyment for the longest period of life is mentioned in the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (9.20). All are but material enjoyments, and one should be thoroughly convinced that he has no need of such a long duration of life, even in the Brahmaloṅka planet. He must return home, back to Godhead, and must not be attracted by any amount of material facilities. In the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (2.59) it is said that this sort of material detachment is possible to attain when one is acquainted with the supreme association of life. *Paraṁ dāṇḍvā nivartate*. One cannot be freed from material attraction unless he has complete understanding of the nature of spiritual life. The propaganda by a certain class of impersonalists that spiritual life is void of all varieties is dangerous propaganda to mislead the living beings into becoming more and more attracted by material enjoyments. As such, persons with a poor fund of knowledge cannot have any conception of the *param*, the Supreme; they try to stick to the varieties of material enjoyments, although they may flatter themselves as being Brahman-realized souls. Such less intelligent persons cannot have any conception of the *param*, as mentioned in this verse, and therefore they cannot reach the Supreme. The devotees have full knowledge of the spiritual world, the Personality of Godhead and His transcendental association in unlimited spiritual planets called Vaikunthalokas. Herein *akuṣṭha-dāṇḍi* is mentioned. *Akuṣṭha* and *vaikuṣṭha* convey the same import, and only one who has his aim fixed upon that spiritual world and personal association with the Godhead can give up his material connections even while living in the material world.

This *param* and the *paraà dhäma* mentioned in several places in the *Bhagavad-gita* are one and the same thing. One who goes to the *paraà dhäma* does not return to the material world. This freedom is not possible even by reaching the topmost *loka* of the material world.

The life air passes through seven openings, namely two eyes, two nostrils, two ears and one mouth. Generally it passes through the mouth at the time of an ordinary man's death. But the *yogé*, as above mentioned, who controls the life air in his own way, generally releases the life air by puncturing the cerebral hole in the head. The *yogé* therefore blocks up all the above-mentioned seven openings, so that the life air will naturally burst forth through the cerebral hole. This is the sure sign of a great devotee's leaving the material connection.

TEXT 22

Yaid Pa[YaaSYaNa(Na*Pa PaarMaeïy&
vEhaYaSaaNaaMauTa Yad(ivharMa()
AíaiDaPaTYa& Gau<aSaiàvaYae
SahEv GaC^eNMaNaSaeiNd]YaEê)) 22))

yadi prayäsyān nāpa pārameñöhyaà

vaihäyasānām uta yad vihāram

añöädhīpatyaà guëa-sanniväye

sahaiva gacchen manasendriyaiç ca

SYNONYMS

yadi—however; *prayäsyān*—maintaining a desire; *nāpa*—O King; *pārameñöhyam*—the governing planet of the material world; *vaihäyasānām*—of the beings known as the Vaihäyāsa; *uta*—it is said; *yad*—what is; *vihāram*—place of enjoyment; *añöa-ädhīpatyam*—lording it over with eightfold achievements; *guëa-sanniväye*—in the world of three modes of nature; *saha*—along with; *eva*—certainly; *gacchet*—should go;

manasä—accompanied by the mind; *indriyaiù*—and the senses; *ca*—also.

TRANSLATION

However, O King, if a yogé maintains a desire for improved material enjoyments, like transference to the topmost planet, Brahmaloka, or the achievement of the eightfold perfections, travel in outer space with the Vaihäyasas, or a situation in one of the millions of planets, then he has to take away with him the materially molded mind and senses.

PURPORT

In the upper status of the planetary systems there are facilities thousands and thousands of times greater for material enjoyments than in the lower planetary systems. The topmost planetary systems consist of planets like Brahmaloka and Dhruvaloka (the polestar), and all of them are situated beyond Maharloka. The inhabitants of those planets are empowered with eightfold achievements of mystic perfection. They do not have to learn and practice the mystic processes of *yoga* perfection and achieve the power of becoming small like a particle (*aëimä-siddhi*), or lighter than a soft feather (*laghimä-siddhi*). They do not have to get anything and everything from anywhere and everywhere (*präpti-siddhi*), to become heavier than the heaviest (*mahimä-siddhi*), to act freely even to create something wonderful or to annihilate anything at will (*éçitva-siddhi*), to control all material elements (*vaçitva-siddhi*), to possess such power as will never be frustrated in any desire (*präkämya-siddhi*), or to assume any shape or form one may even whimsically desire (*kämävasäyitä-siddhi*). All these expedencies are as common as natural gifts for the inhabitants of those higher planets. They do not require any mechanical help to travel in outer space, and they can move and travel at will from one planet to any other planet within no time. The inhabitants of the earth cannot move even to the nearest planet except by mechanical vehicles like spacecraft, but the highly talented inhabitants of such higher planets can do everything very easily.

Since a materialist is generally inquisitive to experience what is actually in such planetary systems, he wants to see everything personally. As inquisitive persons tour all over the world to gain direct local experience,

the less intelligent transcendentalist similarly desires to have some experience of those planets about which he has heard so many wonderful things. The *yogé* can, however, easily fulfill his desire by going there with the present materialistic mind and senses. The prime inclination of the materialistic mind is to lord it over the material world, and all the *siddhis* mentioned above are features of domination over the world. The devotees of the Lord are not ambitious to dominate a false and temporary phenomenon. On the contrary, a devotee wants to be dominated by the supreme predominator, the Lord. A desire to serve the Lord, the supreme predominator, is spiritual or transcendental, and one has to attain this purification of the mind and the senses to get admission into the spiritual kingdom. With the materialistic mind one can reach the best planet in the universe, but no one can enter into the kingdom of God. Senses are called spiritually purified when they are not involved in sense gratification. Senses require engagements, and when the senses are engaged totally in the transcendental loving service of the Lord, they have no chance to become contaminated by material infections.

TEXT 23

**YaaeGaeira<aa& GaiTaMaahurNTa,
bRihiñl/aeKYaa" PavNaaNTaraTMaNaaMa()
Na k-MaRi>aSTaa& GaiTaMaaPanuviNTa
ivÛaTaPaaeYaaeGaSaMaaiDa>aaJaaMa()) 23))**

yogeçvaräëää gatim ähur antar-

bahis-tri-lokyäù pavanäntar-ätmanäm

na karmabhis täà gatim äpnuvanti

vidyā-tapo-yoga-samādhi-bhājām

SYNONYMS

yoga-éçvaräëäm—of the great saints and devotees; *gatim*—destination; *ähuù*—it is said; *antaù*—within; *bahiù*—without; *tri-lokyäù*—of the three

planetary systems; *pavana-antaù*—within the air; *ätmanäm*—of the subtle body; *na*—never; *karmabhiù*—by fruitive activities; *täm*—that; *gati*m—speed; *äpnuvanti*—achieve; *vidyā*—devotional service; *tapaù*—austerities; *yoga*—mystic power; *samādhi*—knowledge; *bhājām*—of those who entertain.

TRANSLATION

The transcendentalists are concerned with the spiritual body. As such, by the strength of their devotional service, austerities, mystic power and transcendental knowledge, their movements are unrestricted, within and beyond the material worlds. The fruitive workers, or the gross materialists, can never move in such an unrestricted manner.

PURPORT

The materialistic scientist's endeavor to reach other planets by mechanical vehicles is only a futile attempt. One can, however, reach heavenly planets by virtuous activities, but one can never expect to go beyond Svarga or Janaloka by such mechanical or materialistic activities, either gross or subtle. The transcendentalists who have nothing to do with the gross material body can move anywhere within or beyond the material worlds. Within the material worlds they move in the planetary systems of the Mahar-, Janas-, Tapas- and Satya-loka, and beyond the material worlds they can move in the Vaikunthas as unrestricted spacemen. Nārada Muni is one of the examples of such spacemen, and Durvāsā Muni is one of such mystics. By the strength of devotional service, austerities, mystic powers and transcendental knowledge, everyone can move like Nārada Muni or Durvāsā Muni. It is said that Durvāsā Muni traveled throughout the entirety of material space and part of spiritual space within one year only. The speed of the transcendentalists can never be attained by the gross or subtle materialists.

TEXT 24

**vEiaNar& YaaiTa ivhaYaSaa GaTa"
SauzuM<aYaa b]øPaQaeNa Xaaeicza)**

ivDaUTak-Lk-ae_Qa hreådSTaaTa(
Pa[YaaiTa cŞ&- Na*Pa XaEéuMaarMa()) 24))

vaiçvânaraà yäti vihäyasä gataù

suñumëayä brahma-pathena çociñä

vidhüta-kalko 'tha harer udastät

prayäti cakraà nâpa çaiçumäram

SYNONYMS

vaiçvânaram—the controlling deity of fire; *yäti*—goes; *vihäyasä*—by the path in the sky (the Milky Way); *gataù*—by passing over; *suñumëayä*—by the Suñumëä; *brahma*—Brahmaloka; *pathena*—on the way to; *çociñä*—illuminating; *vidhüta*—being washed off; *kalkaù*—dirt; *atha*—thereafter; *hareù*—of Lord Hari; *udastät*—upwards; *prayäti*—does reach; *cakram*—circle; *nâpa*—O King; *çaiçumäram*—named Çiçumära.

TRANSLATION

O King, when such a mystic passes over the Milky Way by the illuminating Suñumëä to reach the highest planet, Brahmaloka, he goes first to Vaiçvânara, the planet of the deity of fire, wherein he becomes completely cleansed of all contaminations, and thereafter he still goes higher, to the circle of Çiçumära, to relate with Lord Hari, the Personality of Godhead.

PURPORT

The polar star of the universe and the circle thereof is called the Çiçumära circle, and therein the local residential planet of the Personality of Godhead (Kṣīrodakaśāyī Viṣṇu) is situated. Before reaching there, the mystic passes over the Milky Way to reach Brahmaloka, and while going there he first reaches Vaiçvânara-loka, where the demigod controls fire. On Vaiçvânara-loka the *yogé* becomes completely cleansed of all dirty sins acquired while

in contact with the material world. The Milky Way in the sky is indicated herein as the way leading to Brahmaloka, the highest planet of the universe.

TEXT 25

**Tad(iviNaai>a& TviTavTYaR ivZ<aae,
r<aqYaSaa ivrJaeNaaTMaNaEk-")
NaMaSk*-Ta& b]øivdaMauPaEiT
k-LPaaYauzae Yad(ivbuDaa rMaNTae)) 25))**

tad viçva-nābhīā tv ativartya viñēor

aēéyasā virajenātmanaikaū

namaskātaā brahma-vidām upaiti

kalpāyuño yad vibudhā ramante

SYNONYMS

tat—that; *viçva-nābhīm*—navel of the universal Personality of Godhead; *tu*—but; *ativartya*—crossing over; *viñēoū*—of Lord Viṣṇu, the Personality of Godhead; *aēéyasā*—due to mystic perfection; *virajena*—by the purified; *ātmanā*—by the living entity; *ekaū*—alone; *namaskātam*—worshipable; *brahma-vidām*—by those who are transcendently situated; *upaiti*—reaches; *kalpa-āyuñāū*—a period of 4,300,000,000 solar years; *yad*—the place; *vibudhāū*—self-realized souls; *ramante*—do enjoy.

TRANSLATION

This Çiçumära is the pivot for the turning of the complete universe, and it is called the navel of Viṣṇu [Garbhodakaśāyī Viṣṇu]. The yogé alone goes beyond this circle of Çiçumära and attains the planet [Maharloka] where purified saints like Bhāgu enjoy a duration of life of 4,300,000,000 solar years. This planet is worshipable even for the saints who are transcendently situated.

TEXT 26

AQaae ANaNTaSYa Mau%aNale/Na
dNdùMaaNa& Sa iNarq+Ya iviMa()
iNaYaaRiTā iSaÖeìrYauíiDaZ<Ya&
Yad(ÜEParaDYa| Tadu PaarMaeïyMa()) 26))

atho anantasya mukhānalena

dandahyamānaà sa nirékñya viçvam

niryāti siddheçvara-yuñöa-dhiñëyaà

yad dvai-parärdhyaà tad u pärameñöhyam

SYNONYMS

atho—thereupon; *anantasya*—of Ananta, the resting incarnation of Godhead; *mukha-analena*—by the fire emanating from His mouth; *dandahyamānam*—burning to ashes; *saù*—he; *nirékñya*—by seeing this; *viçvam*—the universe; *niryāti*—goes out; *siddheçvara-yuñöa-dhiñëyam*—airplanes used by the great purified souls; *yat*—the place; *dvai-parärdhyam*—15,480,000,000,000 solar years; *tat*—that; *u*—the exalted; *pärameñöhyam*—Satyaloka, where Brahmā resides.

TRANSLATION

At the time of the final devastation of the complete universe [the end of the duration of Brahmā's life], a flame of fire emanates from the mouth of Ananta [from the bottom of the universe]. The yogé sees all the planets of the universe burning to ashes, and thus he leaves for Satyaloka by airplanes used by the great purified souls. The duration of life in Satyaloka is calculated to be 15,480,000,000,000 years.

PURPORT

It is indicated herein that the residents of Maharloka, where the purified

living entities or demigods possess a duration of life calculated to be 4,300,000,000 solar years, have airships by which they reach Satyaloka, the topmost planet of the universe. In other words, the *Srimad-Bhagavatam* gives us many clues about other planets far, far away from us which modern planes and spacecraft cannot reach, even by imaginary speeds. The statements of *Srimad-Bhagavatam* are accepted by great *äcäryas* like Sridhara Svämé, Rämänujácärya and Vallabhácärya. Lord Sri Caitanya Mahäprabhu specifically accepts *Srimad-Bhagavatam* as the spotless Vedic authority, and as such no sane man can ignore the statements of *Srimad-Bhagavatam* when it is spoken by the self-realized soul Srila Sukadeva Gosvami, who follows in the footsteps of his great father, Srila Vyäsadeva, the compiler of all Vedic literatures. In the creation of the Lord there are many wonderful things we can see with our own eyes every day and night, but we are unable to reach them equipped by modern materialistic science. We should not, therefore, depend on the fragmentary authority of materialistic science for knowing things beyond the range of scientific purview. For a common man, both modern science and Vedic wisdom are simply to be accepted because none of the statements either of modern science or of Vedic literature can be verified by him. The alternative for a common man is to believe either of them or both of them. The Vedic way of understanding, however, is more authentic because it has been accepted by the *äcäryas*, who are not only faithful and learned men, but are also liberated souls without any of the flaws of conditioned souls. The modern scientists, however, are conditioned souls liable to so many errors and mistakes; therefore the safe side is to accept the authentic version of Vedic literatures, like *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, which is accepted unanimously by the great *äcäryas*.

TEXT 27

Na Ya}a Xaaek-ae Na Jara Na Ma*TYau,
 NaaRiTaNar caeÜeGa %Tae ku-TaiêTa()
 YaiÀtaTae_d" k*-PaYaaiNad&ivda&
 durNTadu"%Pa[>avaNaudXaRNaaTa()) 27))

na yatra çoko na jarä na mät̥yur

närtir na codvega âte kutaçcit

yac cit tato 'daù kâpayänidaà-vidäà

duranta-duùkha-prabhavänudarçanät

SYNONYMS

na—never; *yatra*—there are; *çokaù*—bereavement; *na*—nor; *jarä*—old age; *na*—nor; *mâtyuù*—death; *na*—nor; *artiù*—pains; *na*—nor; *ca*—also; *udvegaù*—anxieties; *âte*—save and except; *kutaçcit*—sometimes; *yat*—because of; *cit*—consciousness; *tataù*—therefore; *adaù*—compassion; *kâpayä*—out of heartfelt sympathy; *an-idam-vidäm*—of those who are ignorant of the process of devotional service; *duranta*—unsurpassable; *duùkha*—misery; *prabhava*—repeated birth and death; *anudarçanät*—by successive experience.

TRANSLATION

In that planet of Satyaloka, there is neither bereavement, nor old age nor death. There is no pain of any kind, and therefore there are no anxieties, save that sometimes, due to consciousness, there is a feeling of compassion for those unaware of the process of devotional service, who are subjected to unsurpassable miseries in the material world.

PURPORT

Foolish men of materialistic temperament do not take advantage of successive authorized knowledge. The Vedic knowledge is authorized and is acquired not by experiment but by authentic statements of the Vedic literatures explained by bona fide authorities. Simply by becoming an academic scholar one cannot understand the Vedic statements; one has to approach the real authority who has received the Vedic knowledge by disciplic succession, as clearly explained in the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (4.2). Lord Kṛṣṇa affirmed that the system of knowledge as explained in the *Bhagavad-gita* was explained to the sun-god, and the knowledge descended by disciplic succession from the sun-god to his son Manu, and from Manu to

King Ikṣvāku (the forefather of Lord Rāmacandra), and thus the system of knowledge was explained down the line of great sages, one after another. But in due course of time the authorized succession was broken, and therefore, just to reestablish the true spirit of the knowledge, the Lord again explained the same knowledge to Arjuna, who was a bona fide candidate for understanding due to his being a pure devotee of the Lord. *Bhagavad-gita*, as it was understood by Arjuna, is also explained (Bg. 10.12–13), but there are many foolish men who do not follow in the footsteps of Arjuna in understanding the spirit of *Bhagavad-gita*. They create instead their own interpretations, which are as foolish as they themselves, and thereby only help to put a stumbling block on the path of real understanding, misdirecting the innocent followers who are less intelligent, or the *sudras*. It is said that one should become a *brahmana* before one can understand the Vedic statements, and this stricture is as important as the stricture that no one shall become a lawyer who has not qualified himself as a graduate. Such a stricture is not an impediment in the path of progress for anyone and everyone, but it is necessary for an unqualified understanding of a particular science. Vedic knowledge is misinterpreted by those who are not qualified *brahmanas*. A qualified *brahmana* is one who has undergone strict training under the guidance of a bona fide spiritual master.

The Vedic wisdom guides us to understanding our relation with the Supreme Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa and to acting accordingly in order to achieve the desired result of returning home, back to Godhead. But materialistic men do not understand this. They want to make a plan to become happy in a place where there is no happiness. For false happiness they try to reach other planets, either by Vedic rituals or by spacecraft, but they should know for certain that any amount of materialistic adjustment for becoming happy in a place which is meant for distress cannot benefit the misguided man because, after all, the whole universe with all its paraphernalia will come to an end after a certain period. Then all plans of materialistic happiness will automatically come to an end. The intelligent person therefore makes a plan to return home, back to Godhead. Such an intelligent person surpasses all the pangs of material existence, like birth, death, disease and old age. He is actually happy because he has no anxieties of material existence, but as a compassionate sympathizer he feels unhappiness for the suffering

materialistic men, and thus he occasionally comes before the materialistic men to teach them the necessity of going back to Godhead. All the bona fide *äcäryas* preach this truth of returning home, back to Godhead, and warn men not to make a false plan for happiness in a place where happiness is only a myth.

TEXT 28

TaTaae ivXaez& Pa[iTaPaÛ iNa>aRYa,
STaeNaaTMaNaaPaae_Nal/MaUiTaRrTvrNa()
JYaaeiTaMaRYaae vaYauMauPaeTYa k-ale/
vaYvaTMaNaa %& b*hdaTMail/®Ma()) 28))

tato viçeññaà pratipadya nirbhayas

tenätmanäpo 'nala-mürtir atvaran

jyotirmayo väyüm upetya käle

väyv-ätmanä khaà bāhad ātma-liṅgam

SYNONYMS

tataù—thereafter; *viçeñnam*—particularly; *pratipadya*—by obtaining; *nirbhayaù*—without any doubt; *tena*—by that; *ätmanä*—pure self; *äpaù*—water; *anala*—fire; *mürtiù*—forms; *atvaran*—by surpassing; *jyotiù-mayaù*—effulgent; *väyüm*—atmosphere; *upetya*—having reached there; *käle*—in due course of time; *väyu*—air; *ätmanä*—by the self; *kham*—ethereal; *bāhat*—great; *ätma-liṅgam*—the real form of the self.

TRANSLATION

After reaching Satyaloka, the devotee is specifically able to be incorporated fearlessly by the subtle body in an identity similar to that of the gross body, and one after another he gradually attains stages of existence from earthly to watery, fiery, glowing and airy, until he reaches the ethereal stage.

PURPORT

Anyone who can reach Brahmaloḥa, or Satyaloka, by dint of spiritual perfection and practice is qualified to attain three different types of perfection. One who has attained a specific planet by dint of pious activities attains places in terms of his comparative pious activities. One who has attained the place by dint of *virāḍ* or Hiraṇyagarbha worship is liberated along with the liberation of Brahmā. But one who attains the place by dint of devotional service is specifically mentioned here, in relation to how he can penetrate into the different coverings of the universe and thus ultimately disclose his spiritual identity in the absolute atmosphere of supreme existence.

According to Śrīla Jīva Gosvāmī, all the universes are clustered together up and down, and each and every one of them is separately sevenfold-covered. The watery portion is beyond the sevenfold coverings, and each covering is ten times more expansive than the previous covering. The personality of Godhead who creates all such universes by His breathing period lies above the cluster of the universes. The water of the Causal Ocean is differently situated than the covering water of the universe. The water that serves as covering for the universe is material, whereas the water of the Causal Ocean is spiritual. As such, the watery covering mentioned herein is considered to be the false egoistic covering of all living entities, and the gradual process of liberation from the material coverings, one after another, as mentioned herein, is the gradual process of being liberated from false egoistic conceptions of the material gross body, and then being absorbed in the identification of the subtle body till the attainment of the pure spiritual body in the absolute realm of the kingdom of God.

Śrīla Śrīdhara Svāmī confirms that a part of the material nature, after being initiated by the Lord, is known as the *mahat-tattva*. A fractional portion of the *mahat-tattva* is called the false ego. A portion of the ego is the vibration of sound, and a portion of sound is atmospheric air. A portion of the airy atmosphere is turned into forms, and the forms constitute the power of electricity or heat. Heat produces the smell of the aroma of the earth, and the gross earth is produced by such aroma. And all these

combined together constitute the cosmic phenomenon. The extent of the cosmic phenomenon is calculated to be diametrically (both ways) four billion miles. Then the coverings of the universe begin. The first stratum of the covering is calculated to extend eighty million miles, and the subsequent coverings of the universe are respectively of fire, effulgence, air and ether, one after another, each extending ten times further than the previous. The fearless devotee of the Lord penetrates each one of them and ultimately reaches the absolute atmosphere where everything is of one and the same spiritual identity. Then the devotee enters one of the Vaikuntha planets, where he assumes exactly the same form as the Lord and engages in the loving transcendental service of the Lord. That is the highest perfection of devotional life. Beyond this there is nothing to be desired or achieved by the perfect *yogé*.

TEXT 29

ga]a<aeNa GaNDa& rSaNaNa vE rSa&
æPa& c d*íya ìSaNa& TvcEv)
é[ae}ae<a caePaeTYa Na>aaeGau<aTv&
Pa[a<aeNa cakU-iTaMauPaEiTa YaaeGaq)) 29))

ghrääena gandhaà rasanena vai rasaà

rüpaà ca dāñöyā çvasanaà tvacaiva

çrotreëa copetya nabho-guëatvaà

präëena cäkütim upaiti yogé

SYNONYMS

ghrääena—by smelling; *gandham*—aroma; *rasanena*—by taste; *vai*—exactly; *rasam*—palate; *rüpam*—forms; *ca*—also; *dāñöyā*—by vision; *çvasanam*—contact; *tvacā*—touch; *eva*—as it were; *çrotreëa*—by vibration of the ear; *ca*—also; *upetya*—by achieving; *nabhaù-guëatvam*—identification of ether; *präëena*—by sense organs; *ca*—also; *äkütim*—material activities; *upaiti*—attains; *yogé*—the devotee.

TRANSLATION

The devotee thus surpasses the subtle objects of different senses like aroma by smelling, the palate by tasting, vision by seeing forms, touch by contacting, the vibrations of the ear by ethereal identification, and the sense organs by material activities.

PURPORT

Beyond the sky there are subtle coverings, resembling the elementary coverings of the universes. The gross coverings are a development of partial ingredients of the subtle causes. So the *yogé* or devotee, along with liquidation of the gross elements, relinquishes the subtle causes like aroma by smelling. The pure spiritual spark, the living entity, thus becomes completely cleansed of all material contamination to become eligible for entrance into the kingdom of God.

TEXT 30

Sa >aUTaSaU+MaeiNd]YaSaiàk-z|
MaNaaeMaYa& devMaYa& ivk-aYaRMa()
Sa&SaaÛ GaTYaa Sah TaeNa YaaïTa
ivjaNaTatv& Gau<aSaiàraeDaMa()) 30))

sa bhüta-sükñmendra-ya-sannikarñaa

manomayaà devamayaà vikäryam

saäsädya gatyä saha tena yäti

vijñāna-tattvaà guëa-sannirodham

SYNONYMS

saù—he (the devotee); *bhüta*—the gross; *sükñma*—and the subtle; *indriya*—senses; *sannikarñam*—the point of neutralization; *manaù-mayam*—the mental plane; *deva-mayam*—in the mode of goodness;

vikāryam—egoism; *saàsādyā*—surpassing; *gatyā*—by the progress; *saha*—along with; *tena*—them; *yāti*—goes; *vijñāna*—perfect knowledge; *tattvam*—truth; *guṇā*—the material modes; *sannirodham*—completely suspended.

TRANSLATION

The devotee, thus surpassing the gross and the subtle forms of coverings, enters the plane of egoism. And in that status he merges the material modes of nature [ignorance and passion] in this point of neutralization and thus reaches egoism in goodness. After this, all egoism is merged in the mahat-tattva, and he comes to the point of pure self-realization.

PURPORT

Pure self-realization, as we have several times discussed, is the pure consciousness of admitting oneself to be the eternal servitor of the Lord. Thus one is reinstated in his original position of transcendental loving service to the Lord, as will be clearly explained in the following verse. This stage of rendering transcendental loving service to the Lord without any hopes of emolument from the Lord, or any other way, can be attained when the material senses are purified and the original pure state of the senses is revived. It is suggested herein that the process of purifying the senses is by the yogic way, namely the gross senses are merged in the mode of ignorance, and the subtle senses are merged in the mode of passion. The mind belongs to the mode of goodness and therefore is called *devamaya*, or godly. perfect purification of the mind is made possible when one is fixed in the conviction of being the eternal servitor of the Lord. Therefore simple attainment of goodness is also a material mode; one has to surpass this stage of material goodness and reach the point of purified goodness, or *vasudeva-sattva*. This *vasudeva-sattva* helps one to enter into the kingdom of God.

We may also remember in this connection that the process of gradual emancipation by the devotees in the manner mentioned above, although authoritative, is not viable in the present age because of people's being primarily unaware of *yoga* practice. The so-called *yoga* practice by the professional protagonists may be physiologically beneficial, but such small

successes cannot help one in the attainment of spiritual emancipation as mentioned herein. Five thousand years ago, when the social status of human society was in perfect Vedic order, the *yoga* process mentioned herein was a common affair for everyone because everyone, and especially the *brahmana* and *kñatriya*, was trained in the transcendental art under the care of the spiritual master far away from home, in the status of *brahmacarya*. Modern man, however, is incompetent to understand it perfectly.

Lord Sri Caitanya, therefore, made it easier for the prospective devotee of the present age in the following specific manner. Ultimately there is no difference in the result. The first and foremost point is that one must understand the prime importance of *bhakti-yoga*. The living beings in different species of life are undergoing different terms of encagement according to their fruitive actions and reactions. But in the execution of different activities, one who secures some resources in *bhakti-yoga* can understand the importance of service to the Lord through the causeless mercy of the Lord, as well as that of the spiritual master. A sincere soul is helped by the Lord through meeting a bona fide spiritual master, the representative of the Lord. By the instruction of such a spiritual master, one gets the seed of *bhakti-yoga*. Lord Sri Caitanya Mahāprabhu recommends that the devotee sow the seed of *bhakti-yoga* in his heart and nurture it by the watering of hearing and chanting the holy name, fame, etc., of the Lord. The simple process of offenselessly chanting and hearing the holy name of the Lord will gradually promote one very soon to the stage of emancipation. There are three stages in chanting the holy name of the Lord. The first stage is the offensive chanting of the holy name, and the second is the reflective stage of chanting the holy name. The third stage is the offenseless chanting of the holy name of the Lord. In the second stage only, the stage of reflection, between the offensive and offenseless stages, one automatically attains the stage of emancipation. And in the offenseless stage, one actually enters into the kingdom of God, although physically he may apparently be within the material world. To attain the offenseless stage, one must be on guard in the following manner.

When we speak of hearing and chanting, it means that not only should one chant and hear of the holy name of the Lord as Rāma, Kṛṣṇa (or

systematically the sixteen names Hare Kṛṣṇa, Hare Kṛṣṇa, Kṛṣṇa Kṛṣṇa, Hare Hare/ Hare Rāma, Hare Rāma, Rāma Rāma, Hare Hare), but one should also read and hear the *Bhagavad-gita* and *Srimad-Bhagavatam* in the association of devotees. The primary practice of *bhakti-yoga* will cause the seed already sowed in heart to sprout, and by a regular watering process, as mentioned above, the *bhakti-yoga* creeper will begin to grow. By systematic nurturing, the creeper will grow to such an extent that it will penetrate the coverings of the universe, as we have heard in the previous verses, reach the effulgent sky, the *brahmajyoti*, and go farther and farther and reach the spiritual sky, where there are innumerable spiritual planets called Vaikunthalokas. Above all of them is Kṛṣṇaloka, or Goloka Vāṇḍāvana, wherein the growing creeper enters and takes repose at the lotus feet of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, the original Personality of Godhead. When one reaches the lotus feet of Lord Kṛṣṇa at Goloka Vāṇḍāvana, the watering process of hearing and reading, as also chanting of the holy name in the pure devotional stage, fructifies, and the fruits grown there in the form of love of God are tangibly tasted by the devotee, even though he is here in this material world. The ripe fruits of love of God are relished only by the devotees constantly engaged in the watering process as described above. But the working devotee must always be mindful so that the creeper which has so grown will not be cut off. Therefore he should be mindful of the following considerations:

(1) Offense by one at the feet of a pure devotee may be likened to the mad elephant who devastates a very good garden if it enters.

(2) One must be very careful to guard himself against such offenses at the feet of pure devotees, just as one protects a creeper by all-around fencing.

(3) It so happens that by the watering process some weeds are also grown, and unless such weeds are uprooted, the nurturing of the main creeper, or the creeper of *bhakti-yoga*, may be hampered.

(4) Actually these weeds are material enjoyment, merging of the self in the Absolute without separate individuality, and many other desires in the field of religion, economic development, sense enjoyment and emancipation.

(5) There are many other weeds, like disobedience to the tenets of the revered scriptures, unnecessary engagements, killing animals, and hankering after material gain, prestige and adoration.

(6) If sufficient care is not taken, then the watering process may only help to breed the weeds, stunting the healthy growth of the main creeper and resulting in no fructification of the ultimate requirement: love of God.

(7) The devotee must therefore be very careful to uproot the different weeds in the very beginning. Only then will the healthy growth of the main creeper not be stunted.

(8) And by so doing, the devotee is able to relish the fruit of love of God and thus live practically with Lord Kṛṣṇa, even in this life, and be able to see the Lord in every step.

The highest perfection of life is to enjoy life constantly in the association of the Lord, and one who can relish this does not aspire after any temporary enjoyment of the material world via other media.

TEXT 31

TaeNaaTMaNaaTMaaNaMauPaEiTa XaaNTa,
MaaNaNdMaaNaNdMaYaae_vSaaNae)
WTaa& GaiTa& >aaGavTaq& GaTaae Ya"
Sa vE PauNaNaeRh ivzÂTae_®)) 31))

tenätmanätmänam upaiti çäntam

änandam änandamayo 'vasäne

etää gatià bhägavatéà gato yaù

sa vai punar neha viñajjate 'ga

SYNONYMS

tena—by that purified; *ätmanä*—by the self; *ätmänam*—the Supersoul; *upaiti*—attains; *çäntam*—rest; *änandam*—satisfaction; *änanda-mayaù*—naturally so being; *avasäne*—being freed from all material contamination; *etäm*—such; *gatim*—destination; *bhägavatém*—devotional; *gataù*—attained by; *yaù*—the person; *saù*—he; *vai*—certainly; *punaù*—again; *na*—never; *iha*—in this material world; *viñajjate*—becomes attracted; *aiga*—O Maharaja Pariksit.

TRANSLATION

Only the purified soul can attain the perfection of associating with the Personality of Godhead in complete bliss and satisfaction in his constitutional state. Whoever is able to renovate such devotional perfection is never again attracted by this material world, and he never returns.

PURPORT

We should specially note in this verse the description of *gatià bhägavatém*. To become merged in the rays of the Parabrahman, the Supreme Personality of Godhead, as desired by the *brahmavädé* impersonalist, is not *bhägavatém* perfection. The *bhägavatas* never accept merging in the impersonal rays of the Lord, but always aspire after personal association with the Supreme Lord in one of the Vaikuntha spiritual planets in the spiritual sky. The whole of the spiritual sky, of which the total number of the material skies is only an insignificant part, is full of unlimited numbers of Vaikuntha planets. The destination of the devotee (the *bhägavata*) is to enter into one of the Vaikuntha planets, in each of which the Personality of Godhead, in His unlimited personal expansions, enjoys Himself in the association of unlimited numbers of pure devotee associates. The conditioned souls in the material world, after gaining emancipation by devotional service, are promoted to these planets. But the number of ever-liberated souls is far, far greater than the number of conditioned souls in the material world, and the ever-liberated souls in the Vaikuntha planets never care to visit this miserable material world.

The impersonalists, who aspire to merge in the impersonal *brahmajyoti*

effulgence of the Supreme Lord but have no conception of loving devotional service to Him in His personal form in the spiritual manifestation, may be compared to certain species of fish, who, being born in the rivers and rivulets, migrate to the great ocean. They cannot stay in the ocean indefinitely, for their urge for sense gratification brings them back to the rivers and streams to spawn. Similarly, when the materialist becomes frustrated in his attempts to enjoy himself in the limited material world, he may seek impersonal liberation by merging either with the Causal Ocean or with the impersonal *brahmajyoti* effulgence. However, as neither the Causal Ocean nor the impersonal *brahmajyoti* effulgence affords any superior substitute for association and engagement of the senses, the impersonalist will fall again into the limited material world to become entangled once more in the wheel of births and deaths, drawn on by the inextinguishable desire for sensual engagement. But any devotee who enters the kingdom of God by transcendental engagement of his senses in devotional service, and who associates with the liberated souls and the Personality of Godhead there, will never be attracted to the limited surroundings of the material world.

In the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (8.15) also the same is confirmed, as the Lord says, “The great *mahātmās*, or the *bhakti-yogis*, after attaining My association, never come back to this material world, which is full of miseries and is nonpermanent.” The highest perfection of life, therefore, is to attain His association, and nothing else. The *bhakti-yogé*, being completely engaged in the Lord’s service, has no attraction for any other process of liberation like *jñāna* or *yoga*. A pure devotee is a one hundred percent devotee of the Lord and nothing more.

We should further note in this verse the two words *çāntam* and *ānandam*, which denote that devotional service of the Lord can really bestow upon the devotee two important benedictions, namely peace and satisfaction. The impersonalist is desirous of becoming one with the Supreme, or in other words, he wants to become the Supreme. This is a myth only. The mystic *yogis* become encumbered by various mystic powers and so have neither peace nor satisfaction. So neither the impersonalists nor the *yogi* can have real peace and satisfaction, but the devotee can become fully peaceful and satisfied because of his association with the complete whole.

Therefore, merging in the Absolute or attaining some mystic powers has no attraction for the devotee.

Attainment of love of Godhead means complete freedom from all other attractions. The conditioned soul has many aspirations such as becoming a religious man, a rich man, or a first-class enjoyer or becoming God himself, or becoming powerful like the mystics and acting wonderfully by getting anything or doing anything, but all these aspirations should be rejected by the prospective devotee who actually wants to revive his dormant love of God. The impure devotee aspires after all of the abovementioned material things by perfection of devotion. But a pure devotee has none of the tinges of the above contaminations, which are the influence of material desires, impersonal speculations and attainment of mystic powers. One can attain the stage of love of God by pure devotional service, or by “a learned labor of love,” for the sake of the devotee’s lovable object, the Personality of Godhead.

To be more clear, if one wants to attain the stage of love of Godhead, he must give up all desires for material enjoyment, he should refrain from worshiping any of the demigods, and he should devote himself only to the worship of the Supreme Personality of Godhead. He must give up the foolish idea of becoming one with the Lord and the desire to have some wonderful powers just to get the ephemeral adoration of the world. The pure devotee is only favorably engaged in the service of the Lord, without any hope of emolument. This will bring about love of Godhead, or the stage of *çäntam* and *änandam*, as stated in this verse.

TEXT 32

WTae Sa*Taq Tae Na*Pa vedGaqTae
TvYaai>aPa*íe c SaNaaTaNa c)
Yae vE Paura b]ø<a Aah Tauí
AaraiDaTae >aGavaNa(vaSaudev")) 32))

ete sâ té te nâpa veda-géte

tvayâbhipaññoe ca sanätane ca

ye vai purā brahmaëa äha tuñöa

ärädhito bhagavän väsudevaù

SYNONYMS

ete—all that is described; *sâté*—way; *te*—unto you; *nāpa*—O Maharaja Pariksit; *veda-géte*—according to the version of the *Vedas*; *tvayä*—by Your Majesty; *abhipañöe*—being properly inquired; *ca*—also; *sanätane*—in the matter of eternal truth; *ca*—verily; *ye*—which; *vai*—certainly; *purä*—before; *brahmaëe*—unto Lord Brahmä; *äha*—said; *tuñöaù*—being satisfied; *ärädhitaù*—being worshiped; *bhagavän*—the personality of Godhead; *väsudevaù*—Lord Kṛṣṇa.

TRANSLATION

Your Majesty Maharaja Pariksit, know that all that I have described in reply to your proper inquiry is just according to the version of the Vedas, and it is eternal truth. This was described personally by Lord Kṛṣṇa unto Brahmä, with whom the Lord was satisfied upon being properly worshiped.

PURPORT

The two different ways of reaching the spiritual sky and thereby getting emancipation from all material bondage, namely either the direct process of reaching the kingdom of God or the gradual process through the other higher planets of the universe, are set forth exactly according to the version of the *Vedas*. The Vedic versions in this connection are, *yadä sarve pramucyante kämä ye 'sya hädi çritäù/ atha martyo 'mâto bhavaty atra brahma samaçñute* (*Båhad-äraëyaka Upaniñad* 4.4.7) and *te 'rcir abhisambhavanti* (*Båhad-äraëyaka Upaniñad* 6.2.15): “Those who are free from all material desires, which are diseases of the heart, are able to conquer death and enter the kingdom of God through the Arci planets.” These Vedic versions corroborate the version of the *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, and the latter is further confirmed by Sukadeva Gosvami, who affirms that the truth was disclosed by the Supreme Personality of Godhead Lord Sri

Kṛṣṇa, Vāsudeva, to Brahmā, the first authority on the *Vedas*. The disciplic succession holds that the *Vedas* were uttered by Lord Kṛṣṇa to Brahmā, by Brahmā to Nārada, and by Nārada to Vyāsadeva, and then by Vyāsadeva to Sukadeva Gosvami and so on. So there is no difference between the versions of all the authorities. The truth is eternal, and as such there cannot be any new opinion about the truth. That is the way of knowing the knowledge contained in the *Vedas*. It is not a thing to be understood by one's erudite scholarship or by the fashionable interpretations of mundane scholars. There is nothing to be added and nothing to be subtracted, because the truth is the truth. One has to accept, after all, *some* authority. The modern scientists are also authorities for the common man for some scientific truths. The common man follows the version of the scientist. This means that the common man follows the authority. The Vedic knowledge is also received in that way. The common man cannot argue about what is beyond the sky or beyond the universe; he must accept the versions of the *Vedas* as they are understood by the authorized disciplic succession. In the *Bhagavad-gita* also the same process of understanding the *Gétā* is stated in the Fourth Chapter. If one does not follow the authoritative version of the *ācāryas*, he will vainly search after the truth mentioned in the *Vedas*.

TEXT 33

**Na ùTaae_NYa" iXav" PaNQaa ivXaTa" Sa&Sa*Taaivh)
vaSaudeve >aGaviTa >aiç-YaaeGaae YaTaae >aveTa()) 33))**

na hy ato 'nyaù çivaù panthä

viçataù saàsâtäv iha

väsudeve bhagavati

bhakti-yogo yato bhavet

SYNONYMS

na—never; *hi*—certainly; *ataù*—beyond this; *anyaù*—any other; *çivaù*—auspicious; *panthäù*—means; *viçataù*—wandering; *saàsâtau*—in the

material world; *iha*—in this life; *väsudeve*—unto Lord Väsudeva, Kṛṣṇa; *bhagavati*—the Personality of Godhead; *bhakti-yoga*—direct devotional service; *yata*—wherein; *bhavet*—may result in.

TRANSLATION

For those who are wandering in the material universe, there is no more auspicious means of deliverance than what is aimed at in the direct devotional service of Lord Kṛṣṇa.

PURPORT

As will be clarified in the next verse, devotional service, or direct *bhakti-yoga*, is the only absolute and auspicious means of deliverance from the grip of material existence. There are many indirect methods for deliverance from the clutches of material existence, but none of them is as easy and auspicious as *bhakti-yoga*. The means of *jñāna* and *yoga* and other allied disciplines are not independent in delivering a performer. Such activities help one to reach the stage of *bhakti-yoga* after many, many years. In the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (12.5) it is said that those who are attached to the impersonal feature of the Absolute are liable to many troubles in the pursuit of their desired goal, and the empiricist philosophers, searching after the Absolute Truth, realize the importance of Väsudeva realization as all in all after many, many births (Bg. 7.19). As far as *yoga* systems are concerned, it is also said in the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (6.47) that amongst the mystics who pursue the Absolute Truth, the one who is always engaged in the service of the Lord is the greatest of all. And the last instruction in the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (18.66) advises fully surrendering unto the Lord, leaving aside all other engagements or different processes for self-realization and liberation from material bondage. And the purport of all Vedic literatures is to induce one to accept the transcendental loving service of the Lord by all means.

As already explained in the texts of *Srimad-Bhagavatam* (First Canto), either direct *bhakti-yoga* or the means which ultimately culminate in *bhakti-yoga*, without any tinge of fruitive activity, constitutes the highest form of religion. Everything else is simply a waste of time for the performer.

Srila Sridhara Svämé and all other *äcäryas*, like Jiva Gosvami, agree that *bhakti-yoga* is not only easy, simple, natural and free from trouble, but is the only source of happiness for the human being.

TEXT 34

>aGavaNa(b]ø k-aTSNYaeRNA i}arNvq+Ya MaNaqzYaa)
TadDYavSYaTa(kU-Ş=SQaae riTaraTMaNa(YaTaae >aveTa()) 34))

bhagavän brahma kärtsnyena

trir anvékñya manéñayä

tad adhyavasyat küöa-stho

ratir ätman yato bhavet

SYNONYMS

bhagavän—the great personality Brahmä; *brahma*—the *Vedas*; *kärtsnyena*—by summarization; *triù*—three times; *anvékñya*—scrutinizingly examined; *manéñayä*—with scholarly attention; *tat*—that; *adhyavasyat*—ascertained it; *küöa-sthaù*—with concentration of the mind; *ratìù*—attraction; *ätman (ätmani)*—unto the Supreme Personality of Godhead Sri Kṛṣṇa; *yataù*—by which; *bhavet*—it so happens.

TRANSLATION

The great personality Brahmä, with great attention and concentration of the mind, studied the Vedas three times, and after scrutinizingly examining them, he ascertained that attraction for the Supreme Personality of Godhead Sri Kṛṣṇa is the highest perfection of religion.

PURPORT

Sri Sukadeva Gosvami is referring to the highest Vedic authority, Lord Brahmä, who is the qualitative incarnation of Godhead. The *Vedas* were

taught to Brahmäjé in the beginning of the material creation. Although Brahmäjé was to hear Vedic instructions directly from the personality of Godhead, in order to satisfy the inquisitiveness of all prospective students of the *Vedas*, Brahmäjé, just like a scholar, studied the *Vedas* three times, as generally done by all scholars. He studied with great attention, concentrating on the purpose of the *Vedas*, and after scrutinizingly examining the whole process, he ascertained that becoming a pure, unalloyed devotee of the Supreme Personality of Godhead Sri Kṛṣṇa is the topmost perfection of all religious principles. And this is the last instruction of the *Bhagavad-gita* directly presented by the Personality of Godhead. The Vedic conclusion is thus accepted by all *ācāryas*, and those who are against this conclusion are only *veda-vāda-ratas*, as explained in the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (2.42).

TEXT 35

>aGavaNa(SavR>aUTaezu I/i+aTa" SvaTMaNaa hir")
d*XYaEbuRÖyaidi>ad]Ría I/+a<aErNauMaaPakE-")) 35))

bhagavān sarva-bhūteṣu

lakṣitaṁ svātmanā hariṁ

dāṣyaṁ buddhi-ādibhir draṇō

lakṣaṇair anumāpakaiṁ

SYNONYMS

bhagavān—the Personality of Godhead; *sarva*—all; *bhūteṣu*—in the living entities; *lakṣitaṁ*—is visible; *sva-ātmanā*—along with the self; *hariṁ*—the Lord; *dāṣyaṁ*—by what is seen; *buddhi-ādibhiḥ*—by intelligence; *draṇō*—one who sees; *lakṣaṇaiḥ*—by different signs; *anumāpakaiḥ*—by hypothesis.

TRANSLATION

The Personality of Godhead Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa is in every living being along

with the individual soul. And this fact is perceived and hypothesized in our acts of seeing and taking help from the intelligence.

PURPORT

The general argument of the common man is that since the Lord is not visible to our eyes, how can one either surrender unto Him or render transcendental loving service unto Him? To such a common man, here is a practical suggestion given by Srila Sukadeva Gosvami as to how one can perceive the Supreme Lord by reason and perception. Actually the Lord is not perceivable by our present materialized senses, but when one is convinced of the presence of the Lord by a practical service attitude, there is a revelation by the Lord's mercy, and such a pure devotee of the Lord can perceive the Lord's presence always and everywhere. He can perceive that intelligence is the form-direction of the Paramātmā plenary portion of the Personality of Godhead. The presence of Paramātmā in everyone's company is not very difficult to realize, even for the common man. The procedure is as follows. One can perceive one's self-identification and feel positively that he exists. He may not feel it very abruptly, but by using a little intelligence, he can feel that he is not the body. He can feel that the hand, the leg, the head, the hair and the limbs are all his bodily parts and parcels, but as such the hand, the leg, the head, etc., cannot be identified with his self. Therefore just by using intelligence he can distinguish and separate his self from other things that he sees. So the natural conclusion is that the living being, either man or beast, is the seer, and he sees besides himself all other things. So there is a difference between the seer and the seen. Now, by a little use of intelligence we can also readily agree that the living being who sees the things beyond himself by ordinary vision has no power to see or to move independently. All our ordinary actions and perceptions depend on various forms of energy supplied to us by nature in various combinations. Our senses of perception and of action, that is to say, our five perceptive senses of (1) hearing, (2) touch, (3) sight, (4) taste and (5) smell, as well as our five senses of action, namely (1) hands, (2) legs, (3) speech, (4) evacuation organs and (5) reproductive organs, and also our three subtle senses, namely (1) mind, (2) intelligence and (3) ego (thirteen senses in all), are supplied to us by various arrangements of gross or subtle forms of natural energy. And it is equally evident that our objects of

perception are nothing but the products of the inexhaustible permutations and combinations of the forms taken by natural energy. As this conclusively proves that the ordinary living being has no independent power of perception or of motion, and as we undoubtedly feel our existence being conditioned by nature's energy, we conclude that he who sees is spirit, and that the senses as well as the objects of perception are material. The spiritual quality of the seer is manifest in our dissatisfaction with the limited state of materially conditioned existence. That is the difference between spirit and matter. There are some less intelligent arguments that matter develops the power of seeing and moving as a certain organic development, but such an argument cannot be accepted because there is no experimental evidence that matter has anywhere produced a living entity. Trust no future, however pleasant. Idle talks regarding future development of matter into spirit are actually foolish because no matter has ever developed the power of seeing or moving in any part of the world. Therefore it is definite that matter and spirit are two different identities, and this conclusion is arrived at by the use of intelligence. Now we come to the point that the things which are seen by a little use of intelligence cannot be animate unless we accept someone as the user of or director of the intelligence. Intelligence gives one direction like some higher authority, and the living being cannot see or move or eat or do anything without the use of intelligence. When one fails to take advantage of intelligence he becomes a deranged man, and so a living being is dependent on intelligence or the direction of a superior being. Such intelligence is all-pervading. Every living being has his intelligence, and this intelligence, being the direction of some higher authority, is just like a father giving direction to his son. The higher authority, who is present and residing within every individual living being, is the Superself.

At this point in our investigation, we may consider the following question: on the one hand we realize that all our perceptions and activities are conditioned by arrangements of material nature, yet we also ordinarily feel and say, "I am perceiving" or "I am doing." Therefore we can say that our material senses of perception and action are moving because we are identifying the self with the material body, and that the superior principle of Superself is guiding and supplying us according to our desire. By taking advantage of the guidance of Superself in the form of intelligence, we can

either continue to study and to put into practice our conclusion that “I am not this body,” or we can choose to remain in the false material identification, fancying ourselves to be the possessors and doers. Our freedom consists in orienting our desire either toward the ignorant, material misconception or the true, spiritual conception. We can easily attain to the true, spiritual conception by recognizing the Superself (Paramātmā) to be our friend and guide and by dovetailing our intelligence with the superior intelligence of Paramātmā. The Superself and the individual self are both spirit, and therefore the Superself and the individual self are both qualitatively one and distinct from matter. But the Superself and the individual self cannot be on an equal level because the Superself gives direction or supplies intelligence and the individual self follows the direction, and thus actions are performed properly. The individual is completely dependent on the direction of the Superself because in every step the individual self follows the direction of the Superself in the matter of seeing, hearing, thinking, feeling, willing, etc.

So far as common sense is concerned, we come to the conclusion that there are three identities, namely matter, spirit and Superspirit. Now if we go to the *Bhagavad-gita*, or the Vedic intelligence, we can further understand that all three identities, namely matter, individual spirit, and the Superspirit, are all dependent on the Supreme Personality of Godhead. The Superself is a partial representation or plenary portion of the Supreme Personality of Godhead. The *Bhagavad-gita* affirms that the Supreme Personality of Godhead dominates all over the material world by His partial representation only. God is great, and He cannot be simply an order supplier of the individual selves; therefore the Superself cannot be a full representation of the Supreme Self, Puruṇottama, the Absolute Personality of Godhead. Realization of the Superself by the individual self is the beginning of self-realization, and by the progress of such self-realization one is able to realize the Supreme Personality of Godhead by intelligence, by the help of authorized scriptures, and, principally, by the grace of the Lord. The *Bhagavad-gita* is the preliminary conception of the Personality of Godhead Sri Kṛṣṇa, and *Srimad-Bhagavatam* is the further explanation of the science of Godhead. So if we stick to our determination and pray for the mercy of the director of intelligence sitting within the same bodily tree, like a bird sitting with another bird (as explained in the *Upaniṣads*),

certainly the purport of the revealed information in the *Vedas* becomes clear to our vision, and there is no difficulty in realizing the Supreme Personality of Godhead, Vāsudeva. The intelligent man therefore, after many births of such use of intelligence, surrenders himself at the lotus feet of Vāsudeva, as confirmed by the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (7.19).

TEXT 36

**TaSMaaTa(SavaRTMaNaa raJaNa(hir" SavR}a SavRda)
é[aeTaVYa" k-liTaRTaVYaê SMaTaRVYaae >aGavaà*<aaMa()) 36))**

tasmät sarvätmanä räjan

hariù sarvatra sarvadä

çrotavyaù kértitavyaç ca

smartavyo bhagavän nâëäm

SYNONYMS

tasmät—therefore; *sarva*—all; *ätmanä*—soul; *räjan*—O King; *hariù*—the Lord; *sarvatra*—everywhere; *sarvadä*—always; *çrotavyaù*—must be heard; *kértitavyaù*—glorified; *ca*—also; *smartavyaù*—be remembered; *bhagavän*—the Personality of Godhead; *nâëäm*—by the human being.

TRANSLATION

O King, it is therefore essential that every human being hear about, glorify and remember the Supreme Lord, the Personality of Godhead, always and everywhere.

PURPORT

Srila Sukadeva Gosvami begins this verse with the word *tasmät*, or “therefore,” because in the previous verse he has already explained that there is no auspicious means for salvation other than the sublime process

of *bhakti-yoga*. The *bhakti-yoga* process is practiced by the devotees in different methods like hearing, chanting, remembering, serving the lotus feet of the Lord, worshiping, praying, rendering service in love, becoming friendly, and offering all that one may possess. All nine methods are bona fide methods, and either all of them, some of them or even one of them can bring about the desired result for the sincere devotee. But out of all the nine different methods, the first one, namely hearing, is the most important function in the process of *bhakti-yoga*. Without hearing sufficiently and properly, no one can make any progress by any of the methods of practice. And for hearing only, all the Vedic literatures are there, compiled by authorized persons like Vyāsadeva, who is the powerful incarnation of Godhead. And since it has been ascertained that the Lord is the Supersoul of everything, He should therefore be heard and glorified everywhere and always. That is the special duty of the human being. When the human being gives up the process of hearing about the all-pervading personality of Godhead, he becomes victim to hearing rubbish transmitted by man-made machines. Machinery is not bad because through the machine one can take advantage of hearing about the Lord, but because machinery is used for ulterior purposes, it is creating rapid degradation in the standard of human civilization. It is said here that it is incumbent upon the human beings to hear because the scriptures like *Bhagavad-gita* and *Srimad-Bhagavatam* are made for that purpose. Living beings other than human beings have no ability to hear such Vedic literatures. If human society gives itself to the process of hearing the Vedic literature, it will not become a victim to the impious sounds vibrated by impious men who degrade the standards of the total society. Hearing is solidified by the process of chanting. One who has perfectly heard from the perfect source becomes convinced about the all-pervading Personality of Godhead and thus becomes enthusiastic in glorifying the Lord. All the great *ācāryas*, like Rāmānuja, Madhva, Caitanya, Sarasvaté Ōhākura or even, in other countries, Muhammad, Christ and others, have all extensively glorified the Lord by chanting always and in every place. Because the Lord is all-pervading, it is essential to glorify Him always and everywhere. In the process of glorifying the Lord there should be no restriction of time and space. This is called *sanātana-dharma* or *bhāgavata-dharma*. *Sanātana* means eternal, always and everywhere. *Bhāgavata* means pertaining to Bhagavān, the Lord. The Lord is the master of all time and all space, and

therefore the Lord's holy name must be heard, glorified and remembered everywhere in the world. That will bring about the desired peace and prosperity so eagerly awaited by the people of the world. The word *ca* includes all the remaining processes or methods of *bhakti-yoga*, as mentioned above.

TEXT 37

**iPabiNTa Yae >aGavTa AaTMaNa" SaTaa&
k-QaaMa*Ta& é[v<aPau\$e=zu SaM>a*TaMa()
PauNaiNTa Tae ivzYaivdUizTaaXaYa&
v]JaiNTa TaÂr<aSaraeâhaiNTak-Ma()) 37))**

pibanti ye bhagavata âtmanaù satâà

kathâamâtaà çravaëa-puöeñu sambhâtam

punanti te viñaya-vidüñitâçayaà

vrajanti tac-caraëa-saroruhântikam

SYNONYMS

pibanti—who drink; *ye*—those; *bhagavataù*—of the Personality of Godhead; *âtmanaù*—of the most dear; *satâm*—of devotees; *kathâ-amâtam*—the nectar of the messages; *çravaëa-puöeñu*—within the earholes; *sambhâtam*—fully filled; *punanti*—purify; *te*—their; *viñaya*—material enjoyment; *vidüñita-âçayam*—polluted aim of life; *vrajanti*—do go back; *tat*—the Lord's; *caraëa*—feet; *saroruha-antikam*—near the lotus.

TRANSLATION

Those who drink through aural reception, fully filled with the nectarean message of Lord Kṛṣṇa, the beloved of the devotees, purify the polluted aim of life known as material enjoyment and thus go back to Godhead, to the lotus feet of Him [the Personality of Godhead].

PURPORT

The sufferings of human society are due to a polluted aim of life, namely lording it over the material resources. The more human society engages in the exploitation of undeveloped material resources for sense gratification, the more it will be entrapped by the illusory, material energy of the Lord, and thus the distress of the world will be intensified instead of diminished. The human necessities of life are fully supplied by the Lord in the shape of food grains, milk, fruit, wood, stone, sugar, silk, jewels, cotton, salt, water, vegetables, etc., in sufficient quantity to feed and care for the human race of the world as well as the living beings on each and every planet within the universe. The supply source is complete, and only a little energy by the human being is required to get his necessities into the proper channel. There is no need of machines and tools or huge steel plants for artificially creating comforts of life. Life is never made comfortable by artificial needs, but by plain living and high thinking. The highest perfectional thinking for human society is suggested here by Sukadeva Gosvami, namely, sufficiently hearing *Srimad-Bhagavatam*. For men in this age of Kali, when they have lost the perfect vision of life, this *Srimad-Bhagavatam* is the torchlight by which to see the real path. Srila Jiva Gosvami Prabhupāda has commented on the *kathāmātam* mentioned in this verse and has indicated *Srimad-Bhagavatam* to be the nectarean message of the Personality of Godhead. By sufficient hearing of *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, the polluted aim of life, namely lording it over matter, will subside, and the people in general in all parts of the world will be able to live a peaceful life of knowledge and bliss.

For a pure devotee of the Lord, any topics in relation with His name, fame, quality, entourage, etc., are all pleasing, and because such topics have been approved by great devotees like Nārada, Hanumān, Nanda Maharaja and other inhabitants of Vāndāvana, certainly such messages are transcendental and pleasing to the heart and soul.

And by the constant hearing of the messages of the *Bhagavad-gita*, and later of *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, one is assured herein by Srila Sukadeva Gosvami that he will reach the Personality of Godhead and render Him transcendental loving service in the spiritual planet of the name Goloka Vāndāvana, which resembles a huge lotus flower.

Thus by the process of *bhakti-yoga*, directly accepted, as suggested in this verse, by sufficient hearing of the transcendental message of the Lord, the material contamination is directly eliminated without one's attempting to contemplate the impersonal *virāḍ* conception of the Lord. And by practicing *bhakti-yoga*, if the performer is not purified from the material contamination, he must be a pseudodevotee. For such an imposter there is no remedy for being freed from material entanglement.

Thus end the Bhaktivedanta purports of the Second Canto, Second Chapter, of the Srimad-Bhagavatam, entitled "The Lord in the Heart."

Chapter Three

Pure Devotional Service: The Change in Heart

TEXT 1

é[quéuk- ovac
WvMaeTaiàGaidTa& Pa*ívaNa(YaÙvaNa(MaMa)
Na*<aa& YaiNMa]YaMaa<aaNaa& MaNauZYaezu MaNaqiz<aaMa()) 1))

çré-çuka uvāca

evam etan nigaditā

pñöavān yad bhavān mama

nāëā yan mriyamäëänā

manuñyeñu manéñiëäm

SYNONYMS

çré-çuka—Sri Sukadeva Gosvami said; *evam*—so; *etat*—all these; *nigaditam*—answered; *pñöavān*—as you inquired; *yad*—what; *bhavān*—your good self; *mama*—unto me; *nāëäm*—of the human being; *yad*—one;

mriyamäëänäm—on the threshold of death; *manuñyeñu*—amongst the human beings; *manéñiëäm*—of the intelligent men.

TRANSLATION

Sri Sukadeva Gosvami said: Maharaja Pariksit, as you have inquired from me as to the duty of the intelligent man who is on the threshold of death, so I have answered you.

PURPORT

In human society all over the world there are millions and billions of men and women, and almost all of them are less intelligent because they have very little knowledge of spirit soul. Almost all of them have a wrong conception of life, for they identify themselves with the gross and subtle material bodies, which they are not, in fact. They may be situated in different high and low positions in the estimation of human society, but one should know definitely that unless one inquires about his own self beyond the body and the mind, all his activities in human life are total failures. Therefore out of thousands and thousands of men, one may inquire about his spirit self and thus consult the revealed scriptures like *Vedānta-sūtras*, *Bhagavad-gita* and *Srimad-Bhagavatam*. But in spite of reading and hearing such scriptures, unless one is in touch with a realized spiritual master, he cannot actually realize the real nature of self, etc. And out of thousands and hundreds of thousands of men, someone may know what Lord Kṛṣṇa is in fact. In the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta* (**Madhya** 20.122–123) it is said that Lord Kṛṣṇa, out of His causeless mercy, prepared the Vedic literatures in the incarnation of Vyāsadeva for reading by the intelligent class of men in a human society which is almost totally forgetful of the genuine relation with Kṛṣṇa. Even such an intelligent class of men may be forgetful in their relation with the Lord. The whole *bhakti-yoga* process is therefore a revival of the lost relation. This revival is possible in the human form of life, which is obtained only out of the evolutionary cycle of 8,400,000 species of life. The intelligent class of human being must take a serious note of this opportunity. Not all human beings are intelligent, so the importance of human life is not always understood. Therefore *manéñiëäm*, meaning “thoughtful,” is particularly used here. A *manéñiëäm*

person, like Maharaja Parikṣit, must therefore take to the lotus feet of Lord Kṛṣṇa and fully engage himself in devotional service, hearing, chanting, etc., of the holy name and pastimes of the Lord, which are all *hari-kathāmāta*. This action is especially recommended when one is preparing for death.

TEXTS 2–7

b]øvcRSak-aMaSTau YaJaeTa b]ø<a" PaiTaMa()
wNd]iMaiNd]Yak-aMaSTau Pa[Jaak-aMa" Pa[JaaPaTaqNa()) 2))
devq& MaaYaa& Tau é[qk-aMaSTaeJaSk-aMaae iv>aavSauMa()
vSauk-aMaae vSaUNa(åd]aNa(vqYaRk-aMaae_Qa vqYaRvaNa()) 3))
AàaÛk-aMaSTvidiTa& SvGaRk-aMaae_idTae" SauTaaNa()
iviaNdevaNa(raJYak-aMa" SaaDYaaNSa&SaaDak-ae ivXaaMa()) 4))
AaYauZk-aMaae_ïiNaaE devaE Pauiík-aMa wl/a& YaJaeTa()
Pa[iTaïak-aMa" Pauåzae raedSaq l/aek-MaaTaraE)) 5))
æPaai>ak-aMaae GaNDavaRNa(ñqk-aMaae_PSar ovRXaqMa()
AaiDaPaTYak-aMa" SaveRza& YaJaeTa ParMaeiïNaMa()) 6))
Yaj& YaJaed(YaXaSk-aMa" k-aeXak-aMa" Pa[ceTaSaMa()
ivÛak-aMaSTau iGairXa& daMPaTYaaQaR oMaa& SaTaqMa()) 7))

brahma-varcasa-kāmas tu

yajeta brahmaēaù patim

indram indriya-kāmas tu

prajā-kāmaù prajāpatén

devéà mâyäà tu çré-kāmas

tejas-kāmo vibhāvasum

vasu-kāmo vasün rudrān

vérya-kāmo 'tha véryavān

annādyā-kāmas tv aditiā

svarga-kāmo 'diteu sutān
viçvān devān rājya-kāmau
sādhyān saāsādhako viçām
āyuiñ-kāmo 'çvinau devau
puññi-kāma ilāa yajet
pratiññā-kāmau puruñña
rodasé loka-mātarau
rüpābhikāmo gandharvān
stré-kāmo 'psara urvaçém
ādhipatya-kāmau sarveññāa
yajeta parameññāhinam
yajñāa yajed yaças-kāmau
koça-kāmau pracetasam
vidyā-kāmas tu giriçāa
dāmpatyārtha umāa satém

SYNONYMS

brahma—the absolute; *varcasa*—effulgence; *kāmau tu*—but one who desires in that way; *yajeta*—do worship; *brahmaēa*—of the Vedas; *patim*—the master; *indram*—the King of heaven; *indriya-kāmau tu*—but one who desires strong sense organs; *prajā-kāmau*—one who desires many offspring; *prajāpatén*—the Prajāpatis; *devém*—the goddess; *māyām*—unto

the mistress of the material world; *tu*—but; *çré-kāmaù*—one who desires beauty; *tejaù*—power; *kāmaù*—one who so desires; *vibhāvasum*—the fire-god; *vasu-kāmaù*—one who wants wealth; *vasün*—the Vasu demigods; *rudrān*—the Rudra expansions of Lord Siva; *vérya-kāmaù*—one who wants to be very strongly built; *atha*—therefore; *véryavān*—the most powerful; *anna-adya*—grains; *kāmaù*—one who so desires; *tu*—but; *aditim*—Aditi, mother of the demigods; *svarga*—heaven; *kāmaù*—so desiring; *aditeù sutān*—the sons of Aditi; *viçvān*—Viçvadeva; *devān*—demigods; *rājya-kāmaù*—those who hanker for kingdoms; *sādhyañ*—the Sādhya demigods; *saàsādhakaù*—what fulfills the wishes; *viçām*—of the mercantile community; *äyüù-kāmaù*—desirous of long life; *açvinau*—the two demigods known as the Açviné brothers; *devau*—the two demigods; *puññi-kāmaù*—one who desires a strongly built body; *ilām*—the earth; *yajet*—must worship; *pratiññā-kāmaù*—one who desires good fame, or stability in a post; *puruṣaù*—such men; *rodasé*—the horizon; *loka-mātarau*—and the earth; *rūpa*—beauty; *abhikāmaù*—positively aspiring for; *gandharvān*—the residents of the Gandharva planet, who are very beautiful and are expert in singing; *stré-kāmaù*—one who desires a good wife; *apsaraù urvaçém*—the society girls of the heavenly kingdom; *ādhipatya-kāmaù*—one who desires to dominate others; *sarveññām*—everyone; *yajeta*—must worship; *parameññānām*—Brahmā, the head of the universe; *yajiam*—the Personality of Godhead; *yajet*—must worship; *yaçaù-kāmaù*—one who desires to be famous; *koça-kāmaù*—one who desires a good bank balance; *pracetasañ*—the treasurer of heaven, known as Varuëa; *vidyā-kāmaù tu*—but one who desires education; *giriçam*—the lord of the Himalayas, Lord Siva; *dāmpatya-arthaù*—and for conjugal love; *umām satém*—the chaste wife of Lord Siva, known as Umä.

TRANSLATION

One who desires to be absorbed in the impersonal brahmajyoti effulgence should worship the master of the Vedas [Lord Brahmā or Bāhaspati, the learned priest], one who desires powerful sex should worship the heavenly King, Indra, and one who desires good progeny should worship the great progenitors called the Prajāpatis. One who desires good fortune should worship Durgādevé, the superintendent of the material world. One desiring to be very powerful should worship fire, and one who

aspires only after money should worship the Vasus. One should worship the Rudra incarnations of Lord Siva if he wants to be a great hero. One who wants a large stock of grains should worship Aditi. One who desires to attain the heavenly planets should worship the sons of Aditi. One who desires a worldly kingdom should worship Viçvadeva, and one who wants to be popular with the general mass of population should worship the Sādhya demigod. One who desires a long span of life should worship the demigods known as the Açviné-kumāras, and a person desiring a strongly built body should worship the earth. One who desires stability in his post should worship the horizon and the earth combined. One who desires to be beautiful should worship the beautiful residents of the Gandharva planet, and one who desires a good wife should worship the Apsarās and the Urvaçé society girls of the heavenly kingdom. One who desires domination over others should worship Lord Brahmā, the head of the universe. One who desires tangible fame should worship the Personality of Godhead, and one who desires a good bank balance should worship the demigod Varuëa. If one desires to be a greatly learned man he should worship Lord Siva, and if one desires a good marital relation he should worship the chaste goddess Umä, the wife of Lord Siva.

PURPORT

There are different modes of worship for different persons desiring success in particular subjects. The conditioned soul living within the purview of the material world cannot be an expert in every type of materially enjoyable asset, but one can have considerable influence over a particular matter by worshipping a particular demigod, as mentioned above. Ravana was made a very powerful man by worshipping Lord Siva, and he used to offer severed heads to please Lord Siva. He became so powerful by the grace of Lord Siva that all the demigods were afraid of him, until he at last challenged the Personality of Godhead Sri Rāmacandra and thus ruined himself. In other words, all such persons who aspire after gaining some or all of the material objects of enjoyment, or the gross materialistic persons, are on the whole less intelligent, as confirmed in the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (7.20). It is said there that those who are bereft of all good sense, or those whose intelligence is withdrawn by the deluding energy of *mäyā*, aspire to achieve all sorts of material enjoyment in life by pleasing the various demigods, or by

advancing in material civilization under the heading of scientific progress. The real problem of life in the material world is to solve the question of birth, death, old age and disease. No one wants to change his birthright, no one wants to meet death, no one wants to be old or invalid, and no one wants diseases. But these problems are solved neither by the grace of any demigod nor by the so-called advancement of material science. In the *Bhagavad-gita*, as well as in the *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, such less intelligent persons have been described as devoid of all good sense. Sukadeva Gosvami said that out of the 8,400,000 species of living entities, the human form of life is rare and valuable, and out of those rare human beings those who are conscious of the material problems are rarer still, and the still more rare persons are those who are conscious of the value of the *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, which contains the messages of the Lord and His pure devotees. Death is inevitable for everyone, intelligent or foolish. But Pariksit Maharaja has been addressed by the Gosvami as the *manéñé*, or the man of highly developed mind, because at the time of death he left all material enjoyment and completely surrendered unto the lotus feet of the Lord by hearing His messages from the right person, Sukadeva Gosvami. But aspirations for material enjoyment by endeavoring persons are condemned. Such aspirations are something like the intoxication of the degraded human society. Intelligent persons should try to avoid these aspirations and seek instead the permanent life by returning home, back to Godhead.

TEXT 8

**DaMaaRQaR otaMaëaek&- TaNTau" TaNvNa(iPaTa>Na(YaJaeTa()
r+aak-aMa" Pau<YaJaNaaNaaJaSk-aMaae MaåÓ<aaNa()) 8))**

dharmārtha uttama-çlokaà

tantuù tanvan pitèn yajet

rakñä-kämaù puëya-janän

ojas-kämo marud-gaëän

SYNONYMS

dharma-arthau—for spiritual advancement; *uttama-çlokaṁ*—the Supreme Lord or persons attached to the Supreme Lord; *tantu*—for offspring; *tanvan*—and for their protection; *pitèn*—the residents of Pitåloka; *yajet*—must worship; *rakñā-kāmau*—one who desires protection; *puëya-janān*—pious persons; *ojaù-kāmau*—one who desires strength should worship; *marut-gaëän*—the demigods.

TRANSLATION

One should worship Lord Viṣṇu or His devotee for spiritual advancement in knowledge, and for protection of heredity and advancement of a dynasty one should worship the various demigods.

PURPORT

The path of religion entails making progress on the path of spiritual advancement, ultimately reviving the eternal relation with Lord Viṣṇu in His impersonal effulgence, His localized Paramātmā feature, and ultimately His personal feature by spiritual advancement in knowledge. And one who wants to establish a good dynasty and be happy in the progress of temporary bodily relations should take shelter of the Pitās and the demigods in other pious planets. Such different classes of worshipers of different demigods may ultimately reach the respective planets of those demigods within the universe, but he who reaches the spiritual planets in the *brahmajyoti* achieves the highest perfection.

TEXT 9

**raJYak-aMaae MaNaUNa(devaNa(iNa%oRiT& Tvi>acrNa(YaJaeTa()
k-aMak-aMaae YaJaeTa(SaaeMaMak-aMa" Pauåz& ParMa()) 9))**

rājya-kāmo manün devān

nirātīa tv abhicaran yajet

kāma-kāmo yajet somam

akāmaù puruṣaà param

SYNONYMS

rājya-kāmaù—anyone desiring an empire or kingdom; *manün*—the Manus, semi-incarnations of God; *devān*—demigods; *nirātim*—demons; *tu*—but; *abhicaran*—desiring victory over the enemy; *yajet*—should worship; *kāma-kāmaù*—one who desires sense gratification; *yajet*—should worship; *somam*—the demigod named Candra; *akāmaù*—one who has no material desires to be fulfilled; *puruṣam*—the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *param*—the Supreme.

TRANSLATION

One who desires domination over a kingdom or an empire should worship the Manus. One who desires victory over an enemy should worship the demons, and one who desires sense gratification should worship the moon. But one who desires nothing of material enjoyment should worship the Supreme Personality of Godhead.

PURPORT

For a liberated person, all the enjoyments listed above are considered to be absolutely useless. Only those who are conditioned by the material modes of external energy are captivated by different types of material enjoyment. In other words, the transcendentalist has no material desires to be fulfilled, whereas the materialist has all types of desires to be fulfilled. The Lord has proclaimed that the materialists, who desire material enjoyment and thus seek the favor of different demigods, as above mentioned, are not in control of their senses and so give themselves to nonsense. One should therefore not desire any sort of material enjoyment, being sensible enough to worship the Supreme Personality of Godhead. The leaders of nonsensical persons are still more nonsensical because they preach openly and foolishly that one can worship any form of demigod and get the same result. This sort of preaching is not only against the teachings of the *Bhagavad-gita*, or

those of the *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, but is also foolish, just as it is foolish to claim that with the purchase of any travel ticket one may reach the same destination. No one can reach Bombay from Delhi by purchasing a ticket for Baroda. It is clearly defined herein that persons impregnated with different desires have different modes of worship, but one who has no desire for material enjoyment should worship the Supreme Lord, Sri Kṛṣṇa, the Personality of Godhead. And this worshiping process is called devotional service. Pure devotional service means service to the Lord without any tinge of material desires, including desire for fruitive activity and empiric speculation. For fulfillment of material desires one may worship the Supreme Lord, but the result of such worship is different, as will be explained in the next verse. Generally the Lord does not fulfill anyone's material desires for sense enjoyment, but He awards such benedictions to worshipers of the Lord, for they ultimately come to the point of not desiring material enjoyment. The conclusion is that one must minimize the desires for material enjoyment, and for this one should worship the Supreme Personality of Godhead, who is described here as *param*, or beyond anything material. Sripāda Ṇāṇkarācārya has also stated, *nārāyaṇaḥ para-vyaktāt*: the Supreme Lord is beyond the material encirclement.

TEXT 10

**Ak-aMa" SavRk-aMae va Maae+ak-aMa odarDaq")
Taqv]e<a >aiĉ-YaaeGaeNa YaJaeTa Pauāz& ParMa()) 10))**

akāmaḥ sarva-kāma vā

mokṣa-kāma udāra-dhēu

tēvreṇa bhakti-yogena

yajeta puruṣaḥ param

SYNONYMS

akāmaḥ—one who has transcended all material desires; *sarva-kāmaḥ*—one who has the sum total of material desires; *vā*—either; *mokṣa-kāmaḥ*—one

who desires liberation; *udāra-dhéu*—with broader intelligence; *tévreëa*—with great force; *bhakti-yogena*—by devotional service to the Lord; *yajeta*—should worship; *puruṣam*—the Lord; *param*—the supreme whole.

TRANSLATION

A person who has broader intelligence, whether he be full of all material desire, without any material desire, or desiring liberation, must by all means worship the supreme whole, the Personality of Godhead.

PURPORT

The Supreme Personality of Godhead Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa is described in the *Bhagavad-gita* as *puruṇottama*, or the Supreme Personality. It is He only who can award liberation to the impersonalists by absorbing such aspirants in the *brahmajyoti*, the bodily rays of the Lord. The *brahmajyoti* is not separate from the Lord, as the glowing sun ray is not independent of the sun disc. Therefore one who desires to merge into the supreme impersonal *brahmajyoti* must also worship the Lord by *bhakti-yoga*, as recommended here in the *Srimad-Bhagavatam*. *Bhakti-yoga* is especially stressed here as the means of all perfection. In the previous chapters it has been stated that *bhakti-yoga* is the ultimate goal of both *karma-yoga* and *jñāna-yoga*, and in the same way in this chapter it is emphatically declared that *bhakti-yoga* is the ultimate goal of the different varieties of worship of the different demigods. *Bhakti-yoga*, thus being the supreme means of self-realization, is recommended here. Everyone must therefore seriously take up the methods of *bhakti-yoga*, even though one aspires for material enjoyment or liberation from material bondage.

Akāmaù is one who has no material desire. A living being, naturally being the part and parcel of the supreme whole *puruṣaà pürëam*, has as his natural function to serve the Supreme Being, just as the parts and parcels of the body, or the limbs of the body, are naturally meant to serve the complete body. Desireless means, therefore, not to be inert like the stone, but to be conscious of one's actual position and thus desire satisfaction only from the Supreme Lord. Srila Jiva Gosvami has explained this desirelessness as *bhajanéya-parama-puruṣa-sukha-mātra-sva-sukhatvam*

in his *Sandarbha*. This means that one should feel happy only by experiencing the happiness of the Supreme Lord. This intuition of the living being is sometimes manifested even during the conditioned stage of a living being in the material world, and such intuition is expressed in the manner of altruism, philanthropy, socialism, communism, etc., by the undeveloped minds of less intelligent persons. In the mundane field such an outlook of doing good to others in the form of society, community, family, country or humanity is a partial manifestation of the same original feeling in which a pure living entity feels happiness by the happiness of the Supreme Lord. Such superb feelings were exhibited by the damsels of Vrajabhūmi for the happiness of the Lord. The *gopés* loved the Lord without any return, and this is the perfect exhibition of the *akāma* spirit. *Kāma* spirit, or the desire for one's own satisfaction, is fully exhibited in the material world, whereas the spirit of *akāma* is fully exhibited in the spiritual world.

Thoughts of becoming one with the Lord, or being merged in the *brahmajyoti*, can also be exhibitions of *kāma* spirit if they are desires for one's own satisfaction to be free from the material miseries. A pure devotee does not want liberation so that he may be relieved from the miseries of life. Even without so-called liberation, a pure devotee is aspirant for the satisfaction of the Lord. Influenced by the *kāma* spirit, Arjuna declined to fight in the Kurukñetra battlefield because he wanted to save his relatives for his own satisfaction. But being a pure devotee, he agreed to fight on the instruction of the Lord because he came to his senses and realized that satisfaction of the Lord at the cost of his own satisfaction was his prime duty. Thus he became *akāma*. That is the perfect stage of a perfect living being.

Udāra-dhéu means one who has a broader outlook. people with desires for material enjoyment worship small demigods, and such intelligence is condemned in the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (7.20) as *hāta jñāna*, the intelligence of one who has lost his senses. One cannot obtain any result from demigods without getting sanction from the Supreme Lord. Therefore a person with a broader outlook can see that the ultimate authority is the Lord, even for material benefits. Under the circumstances, one with a broader outlook, even with the desire for material enjoyment or for liberation, should take to the worship of the Lord directly. And everyone, whether an *akāma* or

sakāma or *mokñā-kāma*, should worship the Lord with great expedience. This implies that *bhakti-yoga* may be perfectly administered without any mixture of *karma* and *jñāna*. As the unmixed sun ray is very forceful and is therefore called *tévra*, similarly unmixed *bhakti-yoga* of hearing, chanting, etc., may be performed by one and all regardless of inner motive.

TEXT 11

**WTaavaNaev YaJaTaaiMah iNa"é[eYaSaaedYa")
>aGavTYacl/ae >aavae Yad(>aaGavTaSa®Ta")) 11))**

etävän eva yajatäm

iha niùçreyasodayaù

bhagavaty acalo bhävo

yad bhägavata-saigataù

SYNONYMS

etävän—all these different kinds of worshipers; *eva*—certainly; *yajatäm*—while worshiping; *iha*—in this life; *niùçreya*—the highest benediction; *udayaù*—development; *bhagavati*—unto the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *acalaù*—unflinching; *bhävau*—spontaneous attraction; *yat*—which; *bhägavata*—the pure devotee of the Lord; *saigataù*—association.

TRANSLATION

All the different kinds of worshipers of multidemigods can attain the highest perfectional benediction, which is spontaneous attraction unflinchingly fixed upon the Supreme Personality of Godhead, only by the association of the pure devotee of the Lord.

PURPORT

All living entities in different statuses of life within the material creation,

beginning from the first demigod, Brahmā, down to the small ant, are conditioned under the law of material nature, or the external energy of the Supreme Lord. The living entity in his pure state is conscious of the fact that he is a part and parcel of the Lord, but when he is thrown into the material world on account of his desire to lord it over material energy, he becomes conditioned by the three modes of material nature and thus struggles for existence for the highest benefit. This struggle for existence is something like following the will-o'-the-wisp under the spell of material enjoyment. All plans for material enjoyment, either by worship of different demigods as described in the previous verses of this chapter or by modernized advancement of scientific knowledge without the help of God or demigod, are illusory only, for despite all such plans for happiness, the conditioned living being within the compass of material creation can never solve the problems of life, namely birth, death, old age and disease. The history of the universe is full of such planmakers, and many kings and emperors come and go, leaving a planmaking story only. But the prime problems of life remain unsolved despite all endeavors by such planmakers.

Actually human life is meant for making a solution to the problems of life. One can never solve such problems by satisfying the different demigods, by different modes of worship, or by so-called scientific advancement in knowledge without the help of God or the demigods. Apart from the gross materialists, who care very little either for God or for the demigods, the *Vedas* recommend worship of different demigods for different benefits, and so the demigods are neither false nor imaginary. The demigods are as factual as we are, but they are much more powerful due to their being engaged in the direct service of the Lord in managing different departments in the universal government. The *Bhagavad-gita* affirms this, and the different planets of the demigods are mentioned there, including the one of the supreme demigod, Lord Brahmā. The gross materialists do not believe in the existence of God or the demigods. Nor do they believe that different planets are dominated by different demigods. They are creating a great commotion about reaching the closest celestial body, Candraloka, or the moon, but even after much mechanical research they have only very scanty information of this moon, and in spite of much false advertisement for selling land on the moon, the puffed-up scientists or gross materialists cannot live there, and what to speak of reaching the other planets, which

they are unable even to count. However, the followers of the *Vedas* have a different method of acquiring knowledge. They accept the statements of the Vedic literatures as authority *in toto*, as we have already discussed in Canto One, and therefore they have full and reasonable knowledge of God and demigods and of their different residential planets situated within the compass of the material world and beyond the limit of the material sky. The most authentic Vedic literature, accepted by the great Indian *ācāryas* like Çaikara, Rāmānuja, Madhva, Viṣṇusvāmé, Nimbārka and Caitanya and studied by all important personalities of the world, is the *Bhagavad-gita*, in which the worship of the demigods and their respective residential planets are mentioned. The ***Bhagavad-gita*** (9.25) affirms:

*yānti deva-vratā devān
pitṛaṁ yānti pitṛa-vratāḥ
bhūtāni yānti bhūtejya
yānti mad-yājino 'pi mām*

“The worshipers of demigods reach the respective planets of the demigods, and the worshipers of forefathers reach the planets of the forefathers. The gross materialist remains in the different material planets, but the devotees of the Lord reach the kingdom of God.”

We also have information from the *Bhagavad-gita* that all the planets within the material world, including Brahmāloka, are but temporarily situated, and after a fixed period they are all annihilated. Therefore the demigods and their followers are all annihilated at the period of devastation, but one who reaches the kingdom of God gets a permanent share in eternal life. That is the verdict of Vedic literature. The worshipers of the demigods have one facility more than the unbelievers due to their being convinced of the Vedic version, by which they can get information of the benefit of worshiping the Supreme Lord in the association of the devotees of the Lord. The gross materialist, however, without any faith in the Vedic version, remains eternally in darkness, driven by a false conviction on the basis of imperfect experimental knowledge, or so-called material science, which can never reach into the realm of transcendental knowledge.

Therefore unless the gross materialists or the worshipers of the temporary demigods come in contact with a transcendentalist like the pure devotee of the Lord, their attempts are simply a waste of energy. Only by the grace of the divine personalities, the pure devotees of the Lord, can one achieve pure devotion, which is the highest perfection of human life. Only a pure devotee of the Lord can show one the right way of progressive life. Otherwise both the materialistic way of life, without any information of God or the demigods, and the life engaged in the worship of demigods, in pursuit of temporary material enjoyments, are different phases of phantasmagoria. They are nicely explained in the *Bhagavad-gita* also, but the *Bhagavad-gita* can be understood in the association of pure devotees only, and not by the interpretations of politicians or dry philosophical speculators.

TEXT 12

jaNa& YadaPa[iTaiNav*taGau<aaeiMaRc\$,
MaaTMaPa[Saad oTa Ya}a Gau<aeZvSa®")
kE-vLYaSaMMaTaPaQaSTvQa >aiÇ-YaaeGa"
k-ae iNav*RTaae hirk-QaaSau riTa& Na ku-YaaRTa()) 12))

jïānaà yad āpratinivāṭṭa-guëormi-cakram

ātma-prasāda uta yatra guëeñv asaigaù

kaivalya-sammata-pathas tv atha bhakti-yogaù

ko nirvāto hari-kathäsu ratià na kuryät

SYNONYMS

jïānam—knowledge; *yat*—that which; *ā*—up to the limit of; *pratinivāṭṭa*—completely withdrawn; *guëa-ürmi*—the waves of the material modes; *cakram*—whirlpool; *ātma-prasādaù*—self-satisfaction; *uta*—moreover; *yatra*—where there is; *guëeñu*—in the modes of nature; *asaigaù*—no attachment; *kaivalya*—transcendental; *sammata*—approved; *pathaù*—path; *tu*—but; *atha*—therefore; *bhakti-yogaù*—devotional service; *kaù*—

who; *nirvātau*—absorbed in; *hari-kathāsu*—in the transcendental topics of the Lord; *ratim*—attraction; *na*—shall not; *kuryāt*—do.

TRANSLATION

Transcendental knowledge in relation with the Supreme Lord Hari is knowledge resulting in the complete suspension of the waves and whirlpools of the material modes. Such knowledge is self-satisfying due to its being free from material attachment, and being transcendental it is approved by authorities. Who could fail to be attracted?

PURPORT

According to *Bhagavad-gītā* (10.9) the characteristics of pure devotees are wonderful. The complete functional activities of a pure devotee are always engaged in the service of the Lord, and thus the pure devotees exchange feelings of ecstasy between themselves and relish transcendental bliss. This transcendental bliss is experienced even in the stage of devotional practice (*sādhana-avasthā*), if properly undertaken under the guidance of a bona fide spiritual master. And in the mature stage the developed transcendental feeling culminates in realization of the particular relationship with the Lord by which a living entity is originally constituted (up to the relationship of conjugal love with the Lord, which is estimated to be the highest transcendental bliss). Thus *bhakti-yoga*, being the only means of God realization, is called *kaivalya*. Śrīla Jīva Gosvāmī quotes the Vedic version (*eko nārāyaṇo devaù, parāvarāṇāṁ parama āste kaivalya-saṁjītaù*) in this connection and establishes that Nārāyaṇa, the Personality of Godhead, is known as *kaivalya*, and the means which enables one to approach the Lord is called the *kaivalya-panthā*, or the only means of attainment of Godhead. This *kaivalya-panthā* begins from *çravaṇa*, or hearing those topics that relate to the Personality of Godhead, and the natural consequence of hearing such *hari-kathā* is attainment of transcendental knowledge, which causes detachment from all mundane topics, for which a devotee has no taste at all. For a devotee, all mundane activities, social and political, become unattractive, and in the mature state such a devotee becomes uninterested even in his own body, and what to speak of bodily relatives. In such a state of affairs one is not agitated by the

waves of the material modes. There are different modes of material nature, and all mundane functions in which a common man is very much interested or in which he takes part become unattractive for the devotee. This state of affairs is described herein as *pratinivāṭṭa-guṇormi*, and it is possible by *ātma-prasāda*, or complete self-satisfaction without any material connection. The first-class devotee of the Lord attains this stage by devotional service, but despite his loftiness, for the Lord's satisfaction he may play the voluntary part of a preacher of the Lord's glory and dovetail all into devotional service, even mundane interest, just to give the neophytes a chance to transform mundane interest into transcendental bliss. Śrīla Rūpa Gosvami has described this action of a pure devotee as *nirbandhaṁ kṣāṇḍa-sambandhe yuktaṁ vairāgyam ucyate*. Even mundane activities dovetailed with service to the Lord are also calculated to be transcendental or approved *kaivalya* affairs.

TEXT 13

XaaENak- ovac

**wTYai>aVYaaôTa& raJaa iNaXaMYa >arTazR>a")
ik-MaNYaTPa*ívaNa(>aUYaae vEYaaSaik-Ma*iz& k-ivMa()) 13))**

ṣaunaka uvāca

ity abhivyāhātāṁ rājā

niṣamya bharatarñabhaṁ

kim anyat pññāvān bhūyo

vaiyāsakim āññā kavim

SYNONYMS

ṣaunakaṁ uvāca—Ṣaunaka said; *iti*—thus; *abhivyāhātāṁ*—all that was spoken; *rājā*—the King; *niṣamya*—by hearing; *bharata-āññabhaṁ*—Maharaja Parikṣit; *kim*—what; *anyat*—more; *pññāvān*—did he inquire from him; *bhūyaṁ*—again; *vaiyāsakim*—unto the son of Vyāsadeva; *āññim*—one who is

well versed; *kavim*—poetic.

TRANSLATION

Çaunaka said: The son of Vyāsadeva, Srila Sukadeva Gosvami, was a highly learned sage and was able to describe things in a poetic manner. What did Maharaja Parikṣit again inquire from him after hearing all that he had said?

PURPORT

A pure devotee of the Lord automatically develops all godly qualities, and some of the prominent features of those qualities are as follows: he is kind, peaceful, truthful, equable, faultless, magnanimous, mild, clean, nonpossessive, a well-wisher to all, satisfied, surrendered to Kṛṣṇa, without hankering, simple, fixed, self-controlled, a balanced eater, sane, mannerly, prideless, grave, sympathetic, friendly, *poetic*, expert and silent. Out of these twenty-six prominent features of a devotee, as described by Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja in his *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*, the qualification of being poetic is especially mentioned herein in relation to Sukadeva Gosvami. The presentation of *Srimad-Bhagavatam* by his recitation is the highest poetic contribution. He was a self-realized learned sage. In other words, he was a poet amongst the sages.

TEXT 14

**WTaC^ué[UzTaa& ivÜNa(SaUTa Naae_hRiSa >aaizTauMa()
k-Qaa hirk-Qaaedk-aR" SaTaa& SYau" SadiSa Da]uvMa()) 14))**

etac chuçrũñatää vidvan

sũta no 'rhasi bhãñitum

kathä hari-kathodarkäù

satää syuù sadasi dhruvam

SYNONYMS

etat—this; *çuçrũñatām*—of those eager to hear; *vidvan*—O learned; *sūta*—Sūta Gosvami; *naù*—unto us; *arhasi*—may you do it; *bhãñitum*—just to explain it; *kathäù*—topics; *hari-kathä-udarkäù*—result in the topics of the Lord; *satām*—of the devotees; *syuù*—may be; *sadasī*—in the assembly of; *dhruvam*—certainly.

TRANSLATION

O learned Sūta Gosvami! Please continue to explain such topics to us because we are all eager to hear. Besides that, topics which result in the discussion of the Lord Hari should certainly be discussed in the assembly of devotees.

PURPORT

As we have already quoted above from the *Bhakti-rasāmāta-sindhu* of Rūpa Gosvami, even mundane things, if dovetailed in the service of the Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, are accepted as transcendental. For example, the epics or the histories of *Ramayana* and *Mahābhārata*, which are specifically recommended for the less intelligent classes (women, *sudras* and unworthy sons of the higher castes), are also accepted as Vedic literature because they are compiled in connection with the activities of the Lord.

Mahābhārata is accepted as the fifth division of the *Vedas* after its first four divisions, namely *Sāma*, *Yajur*, *Āg* and *Atharva*. The less intelligent do not accept *Mahābhārata* as part of the *Vedas*, but great sages and authorities accept it as the fifth division of the *Vedas*. *Bhagavad-gītā* is also part of the *Mahābhārata*, and it is full of the Lord's instruction for the less intelligent class of men. Some less intelligent men say that *Bhagavad-gītā* is not meant for householders, but such foolish men forget that *Bhagavad-gītā* was explained to Arjuna, a *grhastha* (family man), and spoken by the Lord in His role as a *grhastha*. So *Bhagavad-gītā*, although containing the high philosophy of the Vedic wisdom, is for the beginners in the transcendental science, and *Srimad-Bhagavatam* is for graduates and postgraduates in the transcendental science. Therefore literatures like *Mahābhārata*, the, *purāṇas* and similar other literatures which are full of the pastimes of the

Lord, are all transcendental literatures, and they should be discussed with full confidence in the society of great devotees.

The difficulty is that such literatures, when discussed by professional men, appear to be mundane literature like histories or epics because there are so many historical facts and figures. It is said here, therefore, that such literatures should be discussed in the assembly of devotees. Unless they are discussed by devotees, such literatures cannot be relished by the higher class of men. So the conclusion is that the Lord is not impersonal in the ultimate issue. He is the Supreme Person, and He has His different activities. He is the leader of all living entities, and He descends at His will and by His personal energy to reclaim the fallen souls. Thus He plays exactly like the social, political or religious leaders. Because such roles ultimately culminate in the discussion of topics of the Lord, all such preliminary topics are also transcendental. That is the way of spiritualizing the civic activities of human society. Men have inclinations for studying history and many other mundane literatures—stories, fiction, dramas, magazines, newspapers, etc.—so let them be dovetailed with the transcendental service of the Lord, and all of them will turn to the topics relished by all devotees. The propaganda that the Lord is impersonal, that He has no activity and that He is a dumb stone without any name and form has encouraged people to become godless, faithless demons, and the more they deviate from the transcendental activities of the Lord, the more they become accustomed to mundane activities that only clear their path to hell instead of return them home, back to Godhead.^{i*} *Srimad-Bhagavatam* begins from the history of the Pāṇḍavas (with necessary politics and social activities), and yet *Srimad-Bhagavatam* is said to be the *Pāramahansa-saṅhitā*, or the Vedic literature meant for the topmost transcendentalist, and it describes *paraṁ jñānam*, the highest transcendental knowledge. pure devotees of the Lord are all *paramahamsas*, and they are like the swans, who know the art of sucking milk out of a mixture of milk and water.

TEXT 15

Sa vE >aaGavTaae raJaa Paa<@veYaae MaharQa")
bal/§-I@NakE-" §-I@Na(k*-Z<a§-I@a& Ya Aadde)) 15))

sa vai bhāgavato rājā

pāṇḍaveya mahā-rathau

bāla-kṛṇānakaiḥ kṛṇān

kāñḍa-kṛṇām ya ādāde

SYNONYMS

saḥ—he; *vai*—certainly; *bhāgavataḥ*—a great devotee of the Lord; *rājā*—Maharaja Parikṣit; *pāṇḍaveyaḥ*—grandson of the Pāṇḍavas; *mahā-rathau*—a great fighter; *bāla*—while a child; *kṛṇānakaiḥ*—with play dolls; *kṛṇān*—playing; *kāñḍa*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *kṛṇām*—activities; *yaḥ*—who; *ādāde*—accepted.

TRANSLATION

Maharaja Parikṣit, the grandson of the Pāṇḍavas, was from his very childhood a great devotee of the Lord. Even while playing with dolls, he used to worship Lord Kṛṣṇa by imitating the worship of the family Deity.

PURPORT

In the ***Bhagavad-gītā*** (6.41) it is stated that even a person who has failed in the proper discharge of *yoga* practice is given a chance to take birth in the house of devout *brahmanas* or in the houses of rich men like *kṣatriya* kings or rich merchants. But Maharaja Parikṣit was more than that because he had been a great devotee of the Lord since his previous birth, and as such he took his birth in an imperial family of the Kurus, and especially that of the Pāṇḍavas. So from the very beginning of his childhood he had the chance to know intimately the devotional service of Lord Kṛṣṇa in his own family. The Pāṇḍavas, all being devotees of the Lord, certainly venerated family Deities in the royal palace for worship. Children who appear in such families fortunately generally imitate such worship of the Deities, even in the way of childhood play. By the grace of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, we had the chance of being born in a Vaiṣṇava family, and in our childhood we

imitated the worship of Lord Kṛṣṇa by imitating our father. Our father encouraged us in all respects to observe all functions such as the Ratha-yātrā and Dola-yātrā ceremonies, and he used to spend money liberally for distributing *prasāda* to us children and our friends. Our spiritual master, who also took his birth in a Vaiñṇēava family, got all inspirations from his great Vaiñṇēava father, Öhäkura Bhaktivinoda. That is the way of all lucky Vaiñṇēava families. The celebrated Mērä Bäé was a staunch devotee of Lord Kṛṣṇa as the great lifter of Govardhana Hill.

The life history of many such devotees is almost the same because there is always symmetry between the early lives of all great devotees of the Lord. According to Jiva Gosvami, Maharaja Parikṣit must have heard about the childhood pastimes of Lord Kṛṣṇa at Vāṇḍāvana, for he used to imitate the pastimes with his young playmates. According to Sridhara Svāmé, Maharaja Parikṣit used to imitate the worship of the family Deity by elderly members. Srila Visvanatha Cakravarti also confirms the viewpoint of Jiva Gosvami. So accepting either of them, Maharaja Parikṣit was naturally inclined to Lord Kṛṣṇa from his very childhood. He might have imitated either of the above-mentioned activities, and all of them establish his great devotion from his very childhood, a symptom of a *mahā-bhāgavata*. Such *mahā-bhāgavatas* are called *nitya-siddhas*, or souls liberated from birth. But there are also others, who may not be liberated from birth but who develop a tendency for devotional service by association, and they are called *sādhana-siddhas*. There is no difference between the two in the ultimate issue, and so the conclusion is that everyone can become a *sādhana-siddha*, a devotee of the Lord, simply by association with the pure devotees. The concrete example is our great spiritual master Sri Nārada Muni. In his previous life he was simply a boy of a maidservant, but through association with great devotees he became a devotee of the Lord of his own standard, unique in the history of devotional service.

TEXT 16

**vEYaaSaik-ê >aGavaNa(vaSaudevParaYa<a")
oâGaaYaGau<aedara" SaTaa& SYauihR SaMaaGaMae)) 16))**

vaiyāsakiṣ ca bhagavān

vāsudeva-parāyaēaù

urugāya-guëodäräù

satäà syur hi samägame

SYNONYMS

vaiyäsakiù—the son of Vyāsadeva; *ca*—also; *bhagavän*—full in transcendental knowledge; *vāsudeva*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *parāyaēaù*—attached to; *urugāya*—of the Personality of Godhead Sri Kṛṣṇa, who is glorified by great philosophers; *guëa-udäräù*—great qualities; *satäm*—of the devotees; *syuù*—must have been; *hi*—as a matter of fact; *samägame*—by the presence of.

TRANSLATION

Sukadeva Gosvami, the son of Vyāsadeva, was also full in transcendental knowledge and was a great devotee of Lord Kṛṣṇa, son of Vasudeva. So there must have been discussion of Lord Kṛṣṇa, who is glorified by great philosophers and in the company of great devotees.

PURPORT

The word *satäm* is very important in this verse. *Satäm* means the pure devotees, who have no other desire than to serve the Lord. Only in the association of such devotees are the transcendental glories of Lord Kṛṣṇa properly discussed. It is said by the Lord that His topics are all full of spiritual significance, and once one properly hears about Him in the association of the *satäm*, certainly one senses the great potency and so automatically attains to the devotional stage of life. As already described, Maharaja Pariksit was a great devotee of the Lord from his very birth, and so was Sukadeva Gosvami. Both of them were on the same level, although it appeared that Maharaja Pariksit was a great king accustomed to royal facilities whereas Sukadeva Gosvami was a typical renouncer of the world, so much so that he did not even put a cloth on his body. Superficially, Maharaja Pariksit and Sukadeva Gosvami might seem to be opposites, but

basically they were both unalloyed pure devotees of the Lord. When such devotees are assembled together, there can be no topics save discussions of the glories of the Lord, or *bhakti-yoga*. In the *Bhagavad-gita* also, when there were talks between the Lord and His devotee Arjuna, there could not be any topic other than *bhakti-yoga*, however the mundane scholars may speculate on it in their own ways. The use of the word *ca* after *vaiyāsakiu* suggests, according to Srila Jiva Gosvami, that both Sukadeva Gosvami and Maharaja Parikṣit were of the same category, settled long before, although one was playing the part of the master and the other the disciple. Since Lord Kṛṣṇa is the center of the topics, the word *vāsudeva-parāyaṇa*, or “devotee of Vāsudeva,” suggests devotee of Lord Kṛṣṇa, the common aim. Although there were many others who assembled at the place where Maharaja Parikṣit was fasting, the natural conclusion is that there was no topic other than the glorification of Lord Kṛṣṇa, because the principal speaker was Sukadeva Gosvami and the chief audience was Maharaja Parikṣit. So *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, as it was spoken and heard by two principal devotees of the Lord, is only for the glorification of the Supreme Lord, the Personality of Godhead, Sri Kṛṣṇa.

TEXT 17

**AaYauhRriTa vE Pau&SaaMauÛàSTa& c YaàSaaE)
TaSYaTaeR YaT+a<aae NaqTa otaMaëaek-vaTaRYaa)) 17))**

äyur harati vai puàsäm

udyann astaà ca yann asau

tasyarte yat-kñäëo néta

uttama-çloka-värtayä

SYNONYMS

äyuu—duration of life; *harati*—decreases; *vai*—certainly; *puàsäm*—of the people; *udyann*—rising; *astam*—setting; *ca*—also; *yann*—moving; *asau*—the sun; *tasya*—of one who glorifies the Lord; *äte*—except; *yat*—by whom;

kñāḍaù—time; *nṛtaù*—utilized; *uttama-çloka*—the all-good Personality of Godhead; *vārtayä*—in the topics of.

TRANSLATION

Both by rising and by setting, the sun decreases the duration of life of everyone, except one who utilizes the time by discussing topics of the all-good Personality of Godhead.

PURPORT

This verse indirectly confirms the greater importance of utilizing the human form of life to realize our lost relationship with the Supreme Lord by acceleration of devotional service. Time and tide wait for no man. So the time indicated by the sunrise and the sunset will be uselessly wasted if such time is not properly utilized for realizing identification of spiritual values. Even a fraction of the duration of life wasted cannot be compensated by any amount of gold. Human life is simply awarded to a living entity (*jéva*) so that he can realize his spiritual identity and his permanent source of happiness. A living being, especially the human being, is seeking happiness because happiness is the natural situation of the living entity. But he is vainly seeking happiness in the material atmosphere. A living being is constitutionally a spiritual spark of the complete whole, and his happiness can be perfectly perceived in spiritual activities. The Lord is the complete spirit whole, and His name, form, quality, pastimes, entourage and personality are all identical with Him. Once a person comes into contact with any one of the above-mentioned energies of the Lord through the proper channel of devotional service, the door to perfection is immediately opened. In the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (2.40) the Lord has explained such contact in the following words: “Endeavors in devotional service are never baffled. Nor is there failure. A slight beginning of such activities is sufficient even to deliver a person from the great ocean of material fears.” As a highly potent drug injected intravenously acts at once on the whole body, the transcendental topics of the Lord injected through the ear of the pure devotee of the Lord can act very efficiently. Aural realization of the transcendental messages implies total realization, just as fructification of one part of a tree implies fructification of all other parts. This realization for

a moment in the association of pure devotees like Sukadeva Gosvami prepares one's complete life for eternity. And thus the sun fails to rob the pure devotee of his duration of life, inasmuch as he is constantly busy in the devotional service of the Lord, purifying his existence. Death is a symptom of the material infection of the eternal living being; only due to material infection is the eternal living entity subjected to the law of birth, death, old age and disease.

The materialistic way of pious activities like charity is recommended in the *sm̐ti-sastras* as quoted by Srila Visvanatha Cakravarti Öhäkura. Money given in charity to a suitable person is guaranteed bank balance in the next life. Such charity is recommended to be given to a *brahmana*. If the money is given in charity to a non-*brahmana* (without brahminical qualification) the money is returned in the next life in the same proportion. If it is given in charity to a half-educated *brahmana*, even then the money is returned double. If the money is given in charity to a learned and fully qualified *brahmana*, the money is returned a hundred and a thousand times, and if the money is given to a *veda-päraga* (one who has factually realized the path of the *Vedas*), it is returned by unlimited multiplication. The ultimate end of Vedic knowledge is realization of the Personality of Godhead, Lord Kṛṣṇa, as stated in the *Bhagavad-gita* (*vedaiç ca sarvair aham eva vedyau* [Bg. 15.15]). There is a guarantee of money's being returned if given in charity, regardless of the proportion. Similarly, a moment passed in the association of a pure devotee by hearing and chanting the transcendental messages of the Lord is a perfect guarantee for eternal life, for returning home, back to Godhead. *Mad-dhāma gatvā punar janma na vidyate*. In other words, a devotee of the Lord is guaranteed eternal life. A devotee's old age or disease in the present life is but an impetus to such guaranteed eternal life.

TEXT 18

Tarv" ik&- Na JaqviNTa >aña" ik&- Na ìSaNTYauTa)
Na %adiNTa Na MaehiNTa ik&- Ga]aMae PaXavae_Pare)) 18))

taravaù kià na jévanti

bhasträù kià na çvasanty uta

na khädanti na mehanti

kià gräme paçavo 'pare

SYNONYMS

taravaù—the trees; *kim*—whether; *na*—do not; *jévanti*—live; *bhasträù*—bellows; *kim*—whether; *na*—do not; *çvasanti*—breathe; *uta*—also; *na*—do not; *khädanti*—eat; *na*—do not; *mehanti*—discharge semen; *kim*—whether; *gräme*—in the locality; *paçavaù*—beastly living being; *apare*—others.

TRANSLATION

Do the trees not live? Do the bellows of the blacksmith not breathe? All around us, do the beasts not eat and discharge semen?

PURPORT

The materialistic man of the modern age will argue that life, or part of it, is never meant for discussion of theosophical or theological arguments. Life is meant for the maximum duration of existence for eating, drinking, sexual intercourse, making merry and enjoying life. The modern man wants to live forever by the advancement of material science, and there are many foolish theories for prolonging life to the maximum duration. But the *Srimad-Bhagavatam* affirms that life is not meant for so-called economic development or advancement of materialistic science for the hedonistic philosophy of eating, mating, drinking and merrymaking. Life is solely meant for *tapasya*, for purifying existence so that one may enter into eternal life just after the end of the human form of life.

The materialists want to prolong life as much as possible because they have no information of the next life. They want to get the maximum comforts in this present life because they think conclusively that there is no life after death. This ignorance about the eternity of the living being and the change

of covering in the material world has played havoc in the structure of modern human society. Consequently there are many problems, multiplied by various plans of modernized man. The plans for solving the problems of society have only aggravated the troubles. Even if it is possible to prolong life more than one hundred years, advancement of human civilization does not necessarily follow. The *Bhāgavatam* says that certain trees live for hundreds and thousands of years. At Våndāvana there is a tamarind tree (the place is known as Imlitala) which is said to have existed since the time of Lord Kṛṣṇa. In the Calcutta Botanical Garden there is a banyan tree said to be older than five hundred years, and there are many such trees all over the world. Svāmé Čaìkaräcärya lived only thirty-two years, and Lord Caitanya lived forty-eight years. Does it mean that the prolonged lives of the abovementioned trees are more important than Čaìkara or Caitanya? Prolonged life without spiritual value is not very important. One may doubt that trees have life because they do not breathe. But modern scientists like Bose have already proved that there is life in plants, so breathing is no sign of actual life. The *Bhāgavatam* says that the bellows of the blacksmith breathes very soundly, but that does not mean that the bellows has life. The materialist will argue that life in the tree and life in the man cannot be compared because the tree cannot enjoy life by eating palatable dishes or by enjoying sexual intercourse. In reply to this, the *Bhāgavatam* asks whether other animals like the dogs and hogs, living in the same village with human beings, do not eat and enjoy sexual life. The specific utterance of *Srimad-Bhagavatam* in regard to “other animals” means that persons who are simply engaged in planning a better type of animal life consisting of eating, breathing and mating are also animals in the shape of human beings. A society of such polished animals cannot benefit suffering humanity, for an animal can easily harm another animal but rarely do good.

TEXT 19

ïivÍrahaeí\%rE" Sa&STauTa" Pauâz" Paéu")
Na YaTk-<aRPaQaaePaeTaae JaaTau NaaMa GadaGa]Ja")) 19))

çva-viò-varähoñöra-kharaiù

saàstutaù puruṣaù paçuù

na yat-karëa-pathopeto

jätu näma gadägrajaù

SYNONYMS

çva—a dog; *viö-varäha*—the village hog who eats stool; *uñöra*—the camel; *kharaiù*—and by the asses; *saàstutaù*—perfectly praised; *puruṣaù*—a person; *paçuù*—animal; *na*—never; *yat*—of him; *karëa*—ear; *patha*—path; *upetaù*—reached; *jätu*—at any time; *näma*—the holy name; *gadägrajaù*—Lord Kṛṣṇa, the deliver from all evils.

TRANSLATION

Men who are like dogs, hogs, camels and asses praise those men who never listen to the transcendental pastimes of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, the deliverer from evils.

PURPORT

The general mass of people, unless they are trained systematically for a higher standard of life in spiritual values, are no better than animals, and in this verse they have particularly been put on the level of dogs, hogs, camels and asses. Modern university education practically prepares one to acquire a doggish mentality with which to accept the service of a greater master. After finishing a so-called education, the so-called educated persons move like dogs from door to door with applications for some service, and mostly they are driven away, informed of no vacancy. As dogs are negligible animals and serve the master faithfully for bits of bread, a man serves a master faithfully without sufficient rewards.

Persons who have no discrimination in the matter of foodstuff and who eat all sorts of rubbish are compared to hogs. Hogs are very much attached to eating stools. So stool is a kind of foodstuff for a particular type of animal. And even stones are eatables for a particular type of animal or bird. But the human being is not meant for eating everything and anything; he is meant to eat grains, vegetables, fruits, milk, sugar, etc. Animal food is not meant

for the human being. For chewing solid food, the human being has a particular type of teeth meant for cutting fruits and vegetables. The human being is endowed with two canine teeth as a concession for persons who will eat animal food at any cost. It is known to everyone that one man's food is another man's poison. Human beings are expected to accept the remnants of food offered to Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, and the Lord accepts foodstuff from the categories of leaves, flowers, fruits, etc. (Bg. 9.26). As prescribed by Vedic scriptures, no animal food is offered to the Lord. Therefore, a human being is meant to eat a particular type of food. He should not imitate the animals to derive so-called vitamin values. Therefore, a person who has no discrimination in regard to eating is compared to a hog.

The camel is a kind of animal that takes pleasure in eating thorns. A person who wants to enjoy family life or the worldly life of so-called enjoyment is compared to the camel. Materialistic life is full of thorns, and so one should live only by the prescribed method of Vedic regulations just to make the best use of a bad bargain. Life in the material world is maintained by sucking one's own blood. The central point of attraction for material enjoyment is sex life. To enjoy sex life is to suck one's own blood, and there is not much more to be explained in this connection. The camel also sucks its own blood while chewing thorny twigs. The thorns the camel eats cut the tongue of the camel, and so blood begins to flow within the camel's mouth. The thorns, mixed with fresh blood, create a taste for the foolish camel, and so he enjoys the thorn-eating business with false pleasure. Similarly, the great business magnates, industrialists who work very hard to earn money by different ways and questionable means, eat the thorny results of their actions mixed with their own blood. Therefore the *Bhāgavatam* has situated these diseased fellows along with the camels.

The ass is an animal who is celebrated as the greatest fool, even amongst the animals. The ass works very hard and carries burdens of the maximum weight without making profit for itself. ^{Footnote.} The ass is generally engaged by the washerman, whose social position is not very respectable. And the special qualification of the ass is that it is very much accustomed to being kicked by the opposite sex. When the ass begs for sexual intercourse, he is kicked by the fair sex, yet he still follows the female for such sexual pleasure. A henpecked man is compared, therefore, to the ass. The general

mass of people work very hard, especially in the age of Kali. In this age the human being is actually engaged in the work of an ass, carrying heavy burdens and driving *öhelä* and rickshaws. The so-called advancement of human civilization has engaged a human being in the work of an ass. The laborers in great factories and workshops are also engaged in such burdensome work, and after working hard during the day, the poor laborer has to be again kicked by the fair sex, not only for sex enjoyment but also for so many household affairs.

So *Srimad-Bhagavatam's* categorization of the common man without any spiritual enlightenment into the society of dogs, hogs, camels and asses is not at all an exaggeration. The leaders of such ignorant masses of people may feel very proud of being adored by such a number of dogs and hogs, but that is not very flattering. The *Bhägavatam* openly declares that although a person may be a great leader of such dogs and hogs disguised as men, if he has no taste for being enlightened in the science of Kṛṣṇa, such a leader is also an animal and nothing more. He may be designated as a powerful, strong animal, or a big animal, but in the estimation of *Srimad-Bhagavatam* he is never given a place in the category of man, on account of his atheistic temperament. Or, in other words, such godless leaders of dogs and hoglike men are bigger animals with the qualities of animals in greater proportion.

TEXT 20

ible/ bTaaeåš-Maivš-MaaNa(Yae
Na é*<vTa" k-<aRPau\$e= NarSYa)
iJaûaSaTaq daduRirke-v SaUTa
Na caePaGaaYaTYauåGaaYaGaaQaa")) 20))

bile batorukrama-vikramän ye

na çåëvataù karëa-puöe narasya

jihväsaté därdurikeva süta

na copagäyaty urugäya-gäthäù

SYNONYMS

bile—snake holes; *bata*—like; *urukrama*—the Lord, who acts marvelously; *vikramān*—prowess; *ye*—all these; *na*—never; *çāëvataù*—heard; *karëa-puë*—the earholes; *narasya*—of the man; *jihvā*—tongue; *asaté*—useless; *därdurikä*—of the frogs; *iva*—exactly like that; *süta*—O Süta Gosvami; *na*—never; *ca*—also; *upagäyati*—chants loudly; *urugäya*—worth singing; *gäthäù*—songs.

TRANSLATION

One who has not listened to the messages about the prowess and marvelous acts of the Personality of Godhead and has not sung or chanted loudly the worthy songs about the Lord is to be considered to possess earholes like the holes of snakes and a tongue like the tongue of a frog.

PURPORT

Devotional service to the Lord is rendered by all limbs or parts of the body. It is the transcendental dynamic force of the spirit soul; therefore a devotee is engaged one hundred percent in the service of the Lord. One can engage in devotional service when the senses of the body are purified in relation with the Lord, and one can render service to the Lord with the help of all the senses. As such, the senses and the action of the senses are to be considered impure or materialistic as long as they are employed only in sense gratification. The purified senses are engaged not in sense gratification but in the service of the Lord *in toto*. The Lord is the Supreme with all senses, and the servitor, who is part and parcel of the Lord, also has the same senses. Service to the Lord is the completely purified use of the senses, as described in the *Bhagavad-gita*. The Lord imparted instructions with full senses, and Arjuna received them with full senses, and thus there was a perfect exchange of sensible and logical understanding between the master and the disciple. Spiritual understanding is nothing like an electrical charge from the master to the disciple, as foolishly claimed by some propaganda-mongers. Everything is full of sense and logic, and the exchange of views between the master and disciple is possible only when

the reception is submissive and real. In the *Caitanya-caritāmāta* it is said that one should receive the teaching of Lord Caitanya with intellect and full senses so that one can logically understand the great mission.

In the impure state of a living being, the various senses are fully engaged in mundane affairs. If the ear is not engaged in the service of the Lord by hearing about Him from *Bhagavad-gita* or *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, certainly the holes of the ear will be filled with some rubbish. Therefore the messages of *Bhagavad-gita* and *Srimad-Bhagavatam* should be preached all over the world very loudly. That is the duty of a pure devotee who has actually heard about them from the perfect sources. Many want to speak something to others, but because they are not trained to speak on the subject matter of Vedic wisdom they are all speaking nonsense, and people are receiving them with no sense. There are hundreds and thousands of sources for distributing mundane news of the world, and people of the world are also receiving it. Similarly, the people of the world should be taught to hear the transcendental topics of the Lord, and the devotee of the Lord must speak loudly so that they can hear. The frogs loudly croak, with the result that they invite the snakes to eat them. The human tongue is especially given for chanting the Vedic hymns and not for croaking like frogs. The word *asaté* used in this verse is also significant. *Asaté* means a woman who has become a prostitute. A prostitute has no reputation for good womanly qualities. Similarly, the tongue, which is given to the human being for chanting the Vedic hymns, will be considered a prostitute when engaged in chanting some mundane nonsense.

TEXT 21

>aar" Par& PaÆik-rq\$=Jauí,
MaPYautaMaa® & Na NaMaeNMauku-NdMa()
XaavaE k-raE NaaE ku-åTae SaPaYaa|
hrelR/SaTk-aÄNak-ª<aaE va)) 21))

bhāraù paraà paööa-kiréöa-juñöam

apy uttamäigaà na namen mukundam

çävau karau no kurute saparyää

harer lasat-käicana-kaikaëau vä

SYNONYMS

bhāraù—a great burden; *param*—heavy; *paööa*—silk; *kiréöa*—turban; *juñöam*—dressed with; *api*—even; *uttama*—upper; *aigam*—parts of the body; *na*—never; *namet*—bow down; *mukundam*—Lord Kṛṣṇa, the deliverer; *çävau*—dead bodies; *karau*—hands; *no*—do not; *kurute*—do; *saparyäm*—worshiping; *hareù*—of the Personality of Godhead; *lasat*—glittering; *käicana*—made of gold; *kaikaëau*—bangles; *vä*—even though.

TRANSLATION

The upper portion of the body, though crowned with a silk turban, is only a heavy burden if not bowed down before the Personality of Godhead who can award mukti [freedom]. And the hands, though decorated with glittering bangles, are like those of a dead man if not engaged in the service of the Personality of Godhead Hari.

PURPORT

As stated hereinbefore, there are three kinds of devotees of the Lord. The first-class devotee does not at all see anyone who is not in the service of the Lord, but the second-class devotee makes distinctions between devotees and nondevotees. The second-class devotees are therefore meant for preaching work, and as referred to in the above verse, they must loudly preach the glories of the Lord. The second-class devotee accepts disciples from the section of third-class devotees or nondevotees. Sometimes the first-class devotee also comes down to the category of the second-class devotee for preaching work. But the common man, who is expected to become at least a third-class devotee, is advised herein to visit the temple of the Lord and bow down before the Deity, even though he may be a very rich man or even a king with a silk turban or crown. The Lord is the Lord of everyone, including the great kings and emperors, and men who are rich in the estimation of mundane people must therefore make it a point to visit

the temple of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa and regularly bow down before the Deity. The Lord in the temple in the worshipable form is never to be considered to be made of stone or wood, for the Lord in His *arcā* incarnation as the Deity in the temple shows immense favor to the fallen souls by His auspicious presence. By the hearing process, as mentioned hereinbefore, this realization of the presence of the Lord in the temple is made possible. As such, the first process in the routine work of devotional service—hearing—is the essential point. Hearing by all classes of devotees from the authentic sources like *Bhagavad-gita* and *Srimad-Bhagavatam* is essential. The common man who is puffed up with his material position and does not bow down before the Deity of the Lord in the temple, or who defies temple worship without any knowledge of the science, must know that his so-called turban or crown will only succeed in further drowning him in the water of the ocean of material existence. A drowning man with a heavy weight on his head is sure to go down more swiftly than those who have no heavy weight. A foolish, puffed-up man defies the science of God and says that God has no meaning for him, but when he is in the grip of God's law and is caught by some disease like cerebral thrombosis, that godless man sinks into the ocean of nescience by the weight of his material acquisition. Advancement of material science without God consciousness is a heavy load on the head of human society, and so one must take heed of this great warning.

The common man, if he has no time to worship the Lord, may at least engage his hands for a few seconds in washing or sweeping the Lord's temple. Maharaja Pratāparudra, the greatly powerful king of Orissa, was always very busy with heavy state responsibilities, yet he made it a point to sweep the temple of Lord Jagannātha at Puré once a year during the festival of the Lord. The idea is that however important a man one may be he must accept the supremacy of the Supreme Lord. This God consciousness will help a man even in his material prosperity. Maharaja Pratāparudra's subordination before Lord Jagannātha made him a powerful king, so much so that even the great Pathan in his time could not enter into Orissa on account of the powerful Maharaja Pratāparudra. And at last Maharaja Pratāparudra was graced by Lord Sri Caitanya on the very grounds of his acceptance of subordination to the Lord of the universe. So even though a rich man's wife has glittering bangles made of gold on her

hands, she must engage herself in rendering service to the Lord.

TEXT 22

**bhaRiYaTae Tae NaYaNae Nara<aa&
il/®aiNa ivZ<aaeNaR iNarq+aTaae Yae)
PaadaE Na*<aa& TaaE d]uMaJaNMaa>aaJaaE
+ae}aai<a NaaNauv]JaTaae hreYaaŒ)) 22))**

barhäyite te nayane naräëää

liigäni viñëor na nirékñato ye

pädau nãëää tau druma-janma-bhäjau

kñeträëi nānurvrajato harer yau

SYNONYMS

barhäyite—like plumes of a peacock; *te*—those; *nayane*—eyes; *naräëäm*—of men; *liigäni*—forms; *viñëor*—of the Personality of Godhead; *na*—does not; *nirékñatau*—look upon; *ye*—all such; *pädau*—legs; *nãëäm*—of men; *tau*—those; *druma-janma*—being born of the tree; *bhäjau*—like that; *kñeträëi*—holy places; *na*—never; *anuvrajatau*—goes after; *hareu*—of the Lord; *yau*—which.

TRANSLATION

The eyes which do not look at the symbolic representations of the Personality of Godhead Viṣṇu [His forms, name, quality, etc.] are like those printed on the plumes of the peacock, and the legs which do not move to the holy places [where the Lord is remembered] are considered to be like tree trunks.

PURPORT

Especially for the householder devotees, the path of Deity worship is

strongly recommended. As far as possible, every householder, by the direction of the spiritual master, must install the Deity of Viṣṇu, forms like Rādhā-Kṛṣṇa, Lakṣmī-Nārāyaṇa or Sita-Rāma especially, or any other form of the Lord, like Nṛsiṃha, Varāha, Gaura-Nitāi, Matsya, Kūrma, *çālagrāma-çilā* and many other forms of Viṣṇu, like Trivikrama, Keçava, Acyuta, Vāsudeva, Nārāyaṇa and Dāmodara, as recommended in the *Vaiṇēva-tantras* or *Puranas*, and one's family should worship strictly following the directions and regulations of *arcana-vidhi*. Any member of the family who is above twelve years of age should be initiated by a bona fide spiritual master, and all the members of the household should be engaged in the daily service of the Lord, beginning from morning (4 a.m.) till night (10 p.m.) by performing *maṅgala-ārātrika*, *niraijāna*, *arcana*, *pūjā*, *kértana*, *çālgāra*, *bhoga-vaikāli*, *sandhyā-ārātrika*, *pāōha*, *bhoga* (at night), *çayana-ārātrika*, etc. Engagement in such worship of the Deity, under the direction of a bona fide spiritual master, will greatly help the householders to purify their very existence and make rapid progress in spiritual knowledge. Simple theoretical book knowledge is not sufficient for a neophyte devotee. Book knowledge is theoretical, whereas the *arcana* process is practical. Spiritual knowledge must be developed by a combination of theoretical and practical knowledge, and that is the guaranteed way for attainment of spiritual perfection. The training of devotional service for a neophyte devotee completely depends on the expert spiritual master who knows how to lead his disciple to make gradual progress towards the path back home, back to Godhead. One should not become a pseudo spiritual master as a matter of business to meet one's family expenditures; one must be an expert spiritual master to deliver the disciple from the clutches of impending death. Srila Visvanatha Cakravarti Öhākura has defined the bona fide qualities of a spiritual master, and one of the verses in that description reads:

*çré-vigrahārādhana-nitya-nānā-
çālgāra-tan-mandira-mārjanāda
yuktasya bhaktāāç ca niyuijato 'pi
vande guroū çré-caraëāravindam ***

Sri-vigraha is the *arcā*, or suitable worshipable form of the Lord, and the disciple should be engaged in worshipping the Deity regularly by *çālgāra*, by

proper decoration and dressing, as also by *mandira-mārjana*, the matter of cleansing the temple. The spiritual master teaches the neophyte devotee all these kindly and personally to help him gradually in the realization of the transcendental name, quality, form, etc., of the Lord.

Only attention engaged in the service of the Lord, especially in dressing and decorating the temple, accompanied by musical *kértana* and spiritual instructions from scriptures, can save the common man from the hellish cinema attractions and rubbish sex-songs broadcast everywhere by radios. If one is unable to maintain a temple at home, he should go to another's temple where all the above performances are regularly executed. Visiting the temple of a devotee and looking at the profusely decorated forms of the Lord well dressed in a well-decorated, sanctified temple naturally infuse the mundane mind with spiritual inspiration. People should visit holy places like Våndāvana where such temples and worship of the Deity are specifically maintained. Formerly all rich men like kings and rich merchants constructed such temples under the direction of expert devotees of the Lord, like the six Gosvamis, and it is the duty of the common man to take advantage of these temples and festivals observed in the holy places of pilgrimage by following in the footsteps of great devotees (*anuvraja*). One should not visit all these sanctified pilgrimage places and temples with sightseeing in mind, but one must go to such temples and sanctified places immortalized by the transcendental pastimes of the Lord and be guided by proper men who know the science. This is called *anuvraja*. *Anu* means to follow. It is therefore best to follow the instruction of the bona fide spiritual master, even in visiting temples and the holy places of pilgrimage. One who does not move in that way is as good as a standing tree condemned by the Lord not to move. The moving tendency of the human being is misused by visiting places for sightseeing. The best purpose of such traveling tendencies could be fulfilled by visiting the holy places established by great *ācāryas* and thereby not being misled by the atheistic propaganda of moneymaking men who have no knowledge of spiritual matters.

TEXT 23

**JaqvH^vae >aaGavTaax(iga]re<au&
Na JaaTau MaTYaaeR_i>al/>aeTa YaSTau)**

é[qivZ<auPaÛa MaNauJaSTaul/SYaa"
ìSaH^vae YaSTau Na ved GaNDaMa()) 23))

jévaï chavo bhägavatä`ighri-reëuà

na jätu martyo `bhilabheta yas tu

çré-viṣṇu-padyä manujas tulasyäù

çvasaï chavo yas tu na veda gandham

SYNONYMS

jévan—while living; *çavaù*—a dead body; *bhägavata-a`ighri-reëum*—the dust of the feet of a pure devotee; *na*—never; *jätu*—at any time; *martyaù*—mortal; *abhilabheta*—particularly received; *yaù*—a person; *tu*—but; *çré*—with opulence; *viṣṇu-padyäù*—of the lotus feet of Viṣṇu; *manujaù*—a descendant of Manu (a man); *tulasyäù*—leaves of the *tulasi* tree; *çvasan*—while breathing; *çavaù*—still a dead body; *yaù*—who; *tu*—but; *na veda*—never experienced; *gandham*—the aroma.

TRANSLATION

The person who has not at any time received the dust of the feet of the Lord's pure devotee upon his head is certainly a dead body. And the person who has never experienced the aroma of the tulasé leaves from the lotus feet of the Lord is also a dead body, although breathing.

PURPORT

According to Srila Visvanatha Cakravarti Öhäkura, the breathing dead body is a ghost. When a man dies, he is called dead, but when he again appears in a subtle form not visible to our present vision and yet acts, such a dead body is called a ghost. Ghosts are always very bad elements, always creating a fearful situation for others. Similarly, the ghostlike nondevotees who have no respect for the pure devotees, nor for the Viṣṇu Deity in the temples, create a fearful situation for the devotees at all times. The Lord

never accepts any offering by such impure ghosts. There is a common saying that one should first love the dog of the beloved before one shows any loving sentiments for the beloved. The stage of pure devotion is attained by sincerely serving a pure devotee of the Lord. The first condition of devotional service to the Lord is therefore to be a servant of a pure devotee, and this condition is fulfilled by the statement “reception of the dust of the lotus feet of a pure devotee who has also served another pure devotee.” That is the way of pure disciplic succession, or devotional *paramparā*.

Maharaja Rahügaëa inquired from the great saint Jaòà Bharata as to how he had attained such a liberated stage of a *paramahamsa*, and in answer the great saint replied as follows (**Bhäg.** 5.12.12):

*rahügaëaitat tapasä na yäti
na cejyayä nirvapaëäd gähäd vä
na cchandasä naiva jalägni-süryair
vinä mahat-päda-rajo-’bhiñekam*

“O King Rahügaëa, the perfectional stage of devotional service, or the *paramahamsa* stage of life, cannot be attained unless one is blessed by *the dust of the feet of great devotees*. It is never attained by *tapasya* [austerity], the Vedic worshiping process, acceptance of the renounced order of life, the discharge of the duties of household life, the chanting of the Vedic hymns, or the performance of penances in the hot sun, within cold water or before the blazing fire.”

In other words, Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa is the property of His pure unconditional devotees, and as such only the devotees can deliver Kṛṣṇa to another devotee; Kṛṣṇa is never obtainable directly. Lord Caitanya therefore designated Himself as *gopé-bhartuà pada-kamalayor dāsa-dāsānudāsaù*, or “the most obedient servant of the servants of the Lord, who maintains the *gopé* damsels at Våndävana.” A pure devotee therefore never approaches the Lord directly, but tries to please the servant of the Lord’s servants, and thus the Lord becomes pleased, and only then can the devotee relish the taste of the *tulasé* leaves stuck to His lotus feet. In the *Brahma-saṁhitā* it is said that the Lord is never to be found by becoming a great scholar of the

Vedic literatures, but He is very easily approachable through His pure devotee. In Våndävana all the pure devotees pray for the mercy of Srimaté Rādhārāëé, the pleasure potency of Lord Kṛṣṇa. Srimaté Rādhārāëé is a tenderhearted feminine counterpart of the supreme whole, resembling the perfectional stage of the worldly feminine nature. Therefore, the mercy of Rādhārāëé is available very readily to the sincere devotees, and once She recommends such a devotee to Lord Kṛṣṇa, the Lord at once accepts the devotee's admittance into His association. The conclusion is, therefore, that one should be more serious about seeking the mercy of the devotee than that of the Lord directly, and by one's doing so (by the good will of the devotee) the natural attraction for the service of the Lord will be revived.

TEXT 24

**TadXMaSaar& ôdYa& bTaed&
Yad(Ga*ùMaa<aEhRirNaaMaDaeYaE")
Na iviṣ-YaeTaaQa Yada ivk-arae
Nae}ae Jal&/ Gaa}aãhezu hzR")) 24))**

tad açma-säraà hādayaà batedaà

yad gāhyamäëair hari-nāma-dheyaiù

na vikriyetātha yadä vikāro

netre jalaà gātra-ruheñu harñau

SYNONYMS

tat—that; *açma-sāram*—is steel-framed; *hādayam*—heart; *bata idam*—certainly that; *yat*—which; *gāhyamäëaiù*—in spite of chanting; *hari-nāma*—the holy name of the Lord; *dheyaiù*—by concentration of the mind; *na*—does not; *vikriyeta*—change; *atha*—thus; *yadä*—when; *vikārau*—reaction; *netre*—in the eyes; *jalām*—tears; *gātra-ruheñu*—at the pores; *harñau*—eruptions of ecstasy.

TRANSLATION

Certainly that heart is steel-framed which, in spite of one's chanting the holy name of the Lord with concentration, does not change when ecstasy takes place, tears fill the eyes and the hairs stand on end.

PURPORT

We should note with profit that in the first three chapters of the Second Canto a gradual process of development of devotional service is being presented. In the First Chapter the first step in devotional service for God consciousness by the process of hearing and chanting has been stressed, and a gross conception of the Personality of Godhead in His universal form for the beginners is recommended. By such a gross conception of God through the material manifestations of His energy, one is enabled to spiritualize the mind and the senses and gradually concentrate the mind upon Lord Viṣṇu, the Supreme, who is present as the Supersoul in every heart and everywhere, in every atom of the material universe. The system of *pañca-upāsanā*, recommending five mental attitudes for the common man, is also enacted for this purpose, namely gradual development, worship of the superior that may be in the form of fire, electricity, the sun, the mass of living beings, Lord Siva and, at last, the impersonal Supersoul, the partial representation of Lord Viṣṇu. They are all nicely described in the Second Chapter, but in the Third Chapter further development is prescribed after one has actually reached the stage of Viṣṇu worship, or pure devotional service, and the mature stage of Viṣṇu worship is suggested herein in relation to the change of heart.

The whole process of spiritual culture is aimed at changing the heart of the living being in the matter of his eternal relation with the Supreme Lord as subordinate servant, which is his eternal constitutional position. So with the progress of devotional service, the reaction of change in the heart is exhibited by gradual detachment from the sense of material enjoyment by a false sense of lording it over the world and an increase in the attitude of rendering loving service to the Lord. *Vidhi-bhakti*, or regulated devotional service by the limbs of the body (namely the eyes, the ears, the nose, the hands and the legs, as already explained hereinbefore), is now stressed herein in relation to the mind, which is the impetus for all activities of the limbs of the body. It is expected by all means that by discharging regulated

devotional service one must manifest the change of heart. If there is no such change, the heart must be considered steel-framed, for it is not melted even when there is chanting of the holy name of the Lord. We must always remember that hearing and chanting are the basic principles of discharging devotional duties, and if they are properly performed there will follow the reactional ecstasy with signs of tears in the eyes and standing of the hairs on the body. These are natural consequences and are the preliminary symptoms of the *bhāva* stage, which occurs before one reaches the perfectional stage of *prema*, love of Godhead.

If the reaction does not take place, even after continuous hearing and chanting of the holy name of the Lord, it may be considered to be due to offenses only. That is the opinion of the *Sandarbha*. In the beginning of chanting of the holy name of the Lord, if the devotee has not been very careful about evading the ten kinds of offenses at the feet of the holy name, certainly the reaction of feelings of separation will not be visible by tears in the eyes and standing of the hair on end.

The *bhāva* stage is manifested by eight transcendental symptoms, namely inertness, perspiration, standing of hairs on end, failing in the voice, trembling, paleness of the body, tears in the eyes and finally trance. *The Nectar of Devotion*, a summary study of Srila Rūpa Gosvami's *Bhakti-rasāmāta-sindhu*, explains those symptoms and vividly describes other transcendental developments, both in steady and accelerating manifestations.

Srila Visvanatha Cakravarti Ōhākura has very critically discussed all these *bhāva* displays in connection with some unscrupulous neophyte's imitating the above symptoms for cheap appreciation. Not only Visvanatha Cakravarti but also Srila Rūpa Gosvami treated them very critically. Sometimes all the above eight symptoms of ecstasy are imitated by the mundane devotees (*prākāta-sahajiyās*), but the pseudo symptoms are at once detected when one sees the pseudodevotee addicted to so many forbidden things. Even though decorated with the signs of a devotee, a person addicted to smoking, drinking or illegitimate sex with women cannot have all the above-mentioned ecstatic symptoms. But it is seen that sometimes these symptoms are willfully imitated, and for this reason Srila

Visvanatha Cakravarti accuses the imitators of being stonehearted men. They are sometimes even affected by the reflection of such transcendental symptoms, yet if they still do not give up the forbidden habits, then they are hopeless cases for transcendental realization.

When Lord Caitanya met Srila Rāmānanda Rāya of Kāvur on the bank of the Godāvaré, the Lord developed all these symptoms, but because of the presence of some nondevotee *brahmanas* who were attendants of the Rāya, the Lord suppressed these symptoms. So sometimes they are not visible even in the body of the first-class devotee for certain circumstantial reasons. Therefore real, steady *bhāva* is definitely displayed in the matter of cessation of material desires (*kñānti*), utilization of every moment in the transcendental loving service of the Lord (*avyārtha-kālatvam* [Cc.Madhya 23.18-19]), eagerness for glorifying the Lord constantly (*nāma-gāne sadā ruci* [Cc. Madhya 23.32]), attraction for living in the land of the Lord (*prétis tad-vasati sthale* *Prétis tad vasati sthāle*), complete detachment from material happiness (*virakti*), and pridelessness (*māna-ṣūnyatā*). One who has developed all these transcendental qualities is really possessed of the *bhāva* stage, as distinguished from the stonehearted imitator or mundane devotee.

The whole process can be summarized as follows: The advanced devotee who chants the holy name of the Lord in a perfectly offenseless manner and is friendly to everyone can actually relish the transcendental taste of glorifying the Lord. And the result of such realization is reflected in the cessation of all material desires, etc., as mentioned above. The neophytes, due to their being in the lower stage of devotional service, are invariably envious, so much so that they invent their own ways and means of devotional regulations without following the *ācāryas*. As such, even if they make a show of constantly chanting the holy name of the Lord, they cannot relish the transcendental taste of the holy name. Therefore, the show of tears in the eyes, trembling, perspiration or unconsciousness, etc., is condemned. They can, however, get in touch with a pure devotee of the Lord and rectify their bad habits; otherwise they shall continue to be stonehearted and unfit for any treatment. A complete progressive march on the return path home, back to Godhead, will depend on the instructions of the revealed scriptures directed by a realized devotee.

TEXT 25

AQaai>aDaeù® MaNaæ_NaukU-l&/
Pa[>aazSae >aaGavTaPa[DaaNa")
Yadah vEYaaSaik-raTMaivÛa,
ivXaardae Na*PaiTa& SaaDau Pa*î")) 25))

athäbhidhehy aiga mano-'nukülaà

prabhäñase bhägavata-pradhänaù

yad äha vaiyäsakir ätma-vidyä-

viçärado nãpatià sädhu pãñöaù

SYNONYMS

atha—therefore; *abhidhehi*—please explain; *aiga*—O Sūta Gosvami; *manaù*—mind; *anukūlam*—favorable to our mentality; *prabhäñase*—you do speak; *bhägavata*—the great devotee; *pradhänaù*—the chief; *yat äha*—what he spoke; *vaiyäsakiù*—Sukadeva Gosvami; *ätma-vidyä*—transcendental knowledge; *viçäradaù*—expert; *nãpatim*—unto the King; *sädhu*—very good; *pãñöaù*—being asked.

TRANSLATION

O Sūta Gosvami, your words are pleasing to our minds. Please therefore explain this to us as it was spoken by the great devotee Sukadeva Gosvami, who is very expert in transcendental knowledge, and who spoke to Maharaja Parikṣit upon being asked.

PURPORT

Knowledge explained by the previous *äcärya* like Sukadeva Gosvami and followed by the next like Sūta Gosvami is always powerful transcendental knowledge, and it is therefore penetrating and useful to all submissive students.

Thus end the Bhaktivedanta purports of the Second Canto, Third Chapter, of the Srimad-Bhagavatam, entitled "Pure Devotional Service: The Change in Heart."

Chapter Four

The Process of Creation

TEXT 1

SaUTa ovac
vEYaaSake-iriTa vcStatviNaêYaMaaTMaNa")
oPaDaaYaR MaiTa& k*-Z<ae AaEtareYa" SaTaq& VYaDaaTa()) 1))

süta uväca

vaiyäsaker iti vacas

tattva-niçcayam ätmanaù

upadhärya matia kãñëe

auttareyaù satéa vyadhät

SYNONYMS

sütaù uväca—Süta Gosvami said; *vaiyäsakeù*—of Sukadeva Gosvami; *iti*—thus; *vacaù*—speeches; *tattva-niçcayam*—that which verifies the truth; *ätmanaù*—in the self; *upadhärya*—just having realized; *matim*—concentration of the mind; *kãñëe*—unto Lord Kṛṣṇa; *auttareyaù*—the son of Uttarä; *satém*—chaste; *vyadhät*—applied.

TRANSLATION

Süta Gosvami said: Maharaja Pariksit, the son of Uttarä, after hearing the speeches of Sukadeva Gosvami, which were all about the truth of the self,

applied his concentration faithfully upon Lord Kṛṣṇa.

PURPORT

The word *satém* is very significant. This means “existing” and “chaste.” And both imports are perfectly applicable in the case of Maharaja Parikṣit. The whole Vedic adventure is to draw one’s attention entirely unto the lotus feet of Lord Kṛṣṇa without any diversion, as instructed in the ***Bhagavad-gīta*** (15.15). Fortunately Maharaja Parikṣit had already been attracted to the Lord from the very beginning of his body, in the womb of his mother. In the womb of his mother he was struck by the *brahmāstra* atomic bomb released by Aṣvatthāmā, but by the grace of the Lord he was saved from being burnt by the fiery weapon, and since then the King continuously concentrated his mind upon Lord Kṛṣṇa, which made him perfectly chaste in devotional service. So by natural sequence he was a chaste devotee of the Lord, and when he further heard from Srīla Sukadeva Gosvami that one should worship the Lord only and no one else, even though full of all desires or desireless, his natural affection for Kṛṣṇa was strengthened. We have already discussed these topics.

To become a pure devotee of Lord Kṛṣṇa, two things are very much essential, namely having a chance to be born in the family of a devotee and having the blessings of a bona fide spiritual master. By the grace of Lord Kṛṣṇa, Parikṣit Maharaja had both opportunities. He was born in a family of such devotees as the Pāṇḍavas, and just to continue the dynasty of the Pāṇḍavas and show them special favor, the Lord specifically saved Maharaja Parikṣit, who later on, by the arrangement of the Lord, was cursed by the boy of a *brahmana* and was able to get the association of such a spiritual master as Sukadeva Gosvami. In the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta* it is said that a fortunate person, by the mercy of the spiritual master and Lord Kṛṣṇa, achieves the path of devotional service. This was perfectly applicable in the case of Maharaja Parikṣit. By way of being born in a family of devotees, he automatically came in touch with Kṛṣṇa, and after being so contacted he constantly remembered Him. Consequently Lord Kṛṣṇa gave the King a further chance for development in devotional service by introducing him to Sukadeva Gosvami, a stalwart devotee of the Lord with perfect knowledge in self-realization. And by hearing from a bona fide

spiritual master, he was perfectly able to concentrate his chaste mind further upon Lord Kṛṣṇa, as a matter of course.

TEXT 2

AaTMaJaaYaaSauTaaGaarPaéud]iv<abNDauzu)
raJYae caivk-le/ iNaTYa& ivæ!a& MaMaTaa& JahaE)) 2))

ätma-jäyā-sutägāra-

paçu-draviëa-bandhuñu

räjye cävikale nityaà

virüòhää mamatää jahau

SYNONYMS

ätma—body; *jäyā*—wife; *suta*—son; *ägāra*—palace; *paçu*—horses and elephants; *draviëa*—treasury house; *bandhuñu*—unto friends and relatives; *räjye*—in the kingdom; *ca*—also; *avikale*—without being disturbed; *nityam*—constant; *virüòhäm*—deep-rooted; *mamatäm*—affinity; *jahau*—gave up.

TRANSLATION

Maharaja Pariksit, as a result of his wholehearted attraction for Lord Kṛṣṇa, was able to give up all deep-rooted affection for his personal body, his wife, his children, his palace, his animals like horses and elephants, his treasury house, his friends and relatives, and his undisputed kingdom.

PURPORT

To become liberated means to become free from *dehätma-buddhi*, the illusory attachment for personal bodily coverings and everything connected with the body, namely wife, children and all other entanglements. One selects a wife for bodily comforts, and the result is children. For wife and

children one requires a dwelling place, and as such a residential house is also necessary. Animals like horses, elephants, cows and dogs are all household animals, and a householder has to keep them as household paraphernalia. In modern civilization the horses and elephants have been replaced by cars and conveyances with considerable horsepower. To maintain all the household affairs, one has to increase the bank balance and be careful about the treasury house, and in order to display the opulence of material assets, one has to keep good relations with friends and relatives, as well as become very careful about maintaining the status quo. This is called material civilization of material attachment. Devotion for Lord Kṛṣṇa means negation of all material attachments as detailed above. By the grace of Lord Kṛṣṇa, Maharaja Parikṣit was awarded all material amenities and an undisputed kingdom in which to enjoy the undisturbed position of king, but by the grace of the Lord he was able to give up all connections with material attachment. That is the position of a pure devotee. Maharaja Parikṣit, due to his natural affection for Lord Kṛṣṇa as a devotee of the Lord, was always executing his royal duties on behalf of the Lord, and as a responsible king of the world he was always careful to see that the influence of Kali would not enter his kingdom. A devotee of the Lord never thinks of his household paraphernalia as his own, but surrenders everything for the service of the Lord. Thereby living entities under a devotee's care get the opportunity for God realization by the management of a devotee-master.

Attachment for household paraphernalia and for Lord Kṛṣṇa go poorly together. One attachment is the path of darkness, and the other attachment is the path of light. Where there is light, there is no darkness, and where there is darkness, there is no light. But an expert devotee can turn everything to the path of light by an attitude of service to the Lord, and the best example here is the Pāṇḍavas. Maharaja Yudhiṣṭhira and householders like him can turn everything to light by dovetailing so-called material assets in the service of the Lord, but one who is not trained or is unable to turn everything to the service of the Lord (*nirbandhaḥ kṣāṇa-sambandhe*) must give up all material connections before he can be fit to hear and chant the glories of the Lord, or in other words, one who has seriously heard *Srīmad-Bhagavatam* for even one day, like Maharaja Parikṣit, from a fit personality like Sukadeva Gosvami, may be able to lose

all affinity for material things. There is no utility simply in imitating Maharaja Parikṣit and hearing *Bhāgavatam* from professional men, even for seven hundred years. To take *Srīmad-Bhāgavatam* as a means of maintaining family expenditure is the grossest type of *nāmāparādha* offense at the feet of the Lord (*sarva-ṣubha-kriyā-sāmyam api pramādaù*).

TEXTS 3–4

PaPa[C^ ceMaMaevaQa | YaNMaa& Pa*C^Qa SataMaa")
k*-Z<aaNau>aavé[v<ae é[ÖDaaNaae MahaMaNaa")) 3))
Sa&SQaa& ivjaYa Sa&NYaSYa k-MaR }aEviGaRk&- c YaTa()
vaSaudeve >aGaviTa AaTMa>aav& d*!& GaTa")) 4))

papraccha cemam evārthaà

yan mää pācchatha sattamäù

kāññēanubhāva-ṣravaëe

ṣraddadhāno mahā-manäù

saàsthää vijjāya sannyasya

karma trai-vargikaà ca yat

väsudeve bhagavati

ätma-bhāvaà dāòhaà gataù

papraccha—asked; *ca*—also; *imam*—this; *eva*—exactly like; *artham*—purpose; *yat*—that; *mām*—unto me; *pācchatha*—you are asking; *sattamäù*—O great sages; *kāññēa-anubhāva*—rapt in thought of Kṛṣṇa; *ṣravaëe*—in hearing; *ṣraddadhānaù*—full of faith; *mahā-manäù*—the great soul; *saàsthām*—death; *vijjāya*—being informed; *sannyasya*—renouncing; *karma*—fruitive activities; *trai-vargikam*—the three principles religion, economic development and sense gratification; *ca*—also; *yat*—what it may be; *väsudeve*—unto Lord Kṛṣṇa; *bhagavati*—the Personality of Godhead;

ätma-bhävam—attraction of love; *dåòham*—firmly fixed; *gataù*—achieved.

TRANSLATION

O great sages, the great soul Maharaja Pariksit, constantly rapt in thought of Lord Kṛṣṇa, knowing well of his imminent death, renounced all sorts of fruitive activities, namely acts of religion, economic development and sense gratification, and thus fixed himself firmly in his natural love for Kṛṣṇa and asked all these questions, exactly as you are asking me.

PURPORT

The three activities of religion, economic development and sense gratification are generally attractive for conditioned souls struggling for existence in the material world. Such regulated activities prescribed in the *Vedas* are called the *karma-käëðéya* conception of life, and householders are generally recommended to follow the rules just to enjoy material prosperity both in this life and in the next. Most people are attracted by such activities. Even in the activities of their modern godless civilization, people are more concerned with economic development and sense gratification without any religious sentiments. As a great emperor of the world, Maharaja Pariksit had to observe such regulations of the Vedic *karma-käëðéya* section, but by his slight association with Sukadeva Gosvami he could perfectly understand that Lord Kṛṣṇa, the Absolute Personality of Godhead (Väsudeva), for whom he had a natural love since his birth, is everything, and thus he fixed his mind firmly upon Him, renouncing all modes of Vedic *karma-käëðéya* activities. This perfectional stage is attained by a *jñané* after many, many births. *The jnanis*, or the empiric philosophers endeavoring for liberation, are thousands of times better than the fruitive workers, and out of hundreds of thousands of such *jnanis* one is liberated factually. And out of hundreds of thousands of such liberated persons, even one person is rarely found who can firmly fix his mind unto the lotus feet of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, as declared by the Lord Himself in the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (7.19). Maharaja Pariksit is specially qualified with the word *mahä-manäù*, which puts him on an equal level with the *mahätmäs* described in the *Bhagavad-gita*. In the later age also there have been many *mahätmäs* of this type, and they also gave up all *karma-käëðéya*

conceptions of life' solely and wholly depending on the Supreme Personality of Godhead Kṛṣṇa. Lord Caitanya, who is Lord Kṛṣṇa Himself, taught us in His **Çikñäñöaka** (8):

*äçliñya vä päda-ratää pinañöu mäm
adarçanän marma-hatää karotu vä
yathä tathä vä vidadhätu lampaöo
mat-präëa-näthas tu sa eva näparaù*

“Lord Kṛṣṇa, who is the lover of many devotees (women), may embrace this fully surrendered maidservant or may trample me with His feet, or He may render me brokenhearted by not being present before me for a long duration of time, but still He is nothing less than the Absolute Lord of my heart.”

Srila Rüpa Gosvami spoke thus:

*viracaya mayi daëöaà déna-bandho dayämé vä
gatih iha na bhavattaù käcid anyä mamästi
nipatatu çata-koöi-nirbharaà vä navämbhaù
tad api kila-payodaù stüyate cätakena*

“O Lord of the poor, do what you like with me, give me either mercy or punishment, but in this world I have none to look to except Your Lordship. The *cätaka* bird always prays for the cloud, regardless of whether it showers rains or throws a thunderbolt.”

Srila Mädhavendra Puré, the grand-spiritual master of Lord Caitanya, took leave of all *karma-käëdéya* obligations in the following words:

*sandhyä-vandana bhadram astu bhavato bhoù snäna tubhyaà namo
bho deväù pitaraç ca tarpaëa-vidhau nähaà kñamaù kñamyatäm
yatra kväpi niñadya yädava-kulottamasya kaàsa-dviñau
smäraà smäram aghaà harämi tad alaà manye kim anyena me*

“O my evening prayer, all good unto you. O my morning bath, I bid you good-bye. O demigods and forefathers, please excuse me. I am unable to

perform any more offerings for your pleasure. Now I have decided to free myself from all reactions to sins simply by remembering anywhere and everywhere the great descendant of Yadu and the great enemy of Kaàsa [Lord Kṛṣṇa]. I think that this is sufficient for me. So what is the use of further endeavors?”

Srila Mādhavendra Puré said further:

*mugdhaà mää nigadantu néti-nipuëä bhräntaà muhur vaidikäu
mandaà bāndhava-saïcayä jaàa-dhiyaà muktādaräu sodaräu
unmattaà dhanino viveka-caturäu kämam mahä-dämbhikam
mokuà na kñāmate manäg api mano govinda-pāda-spāhäm*

“Let the sharp moralist accuse me of being illusioned; I do not mind. Experts in Vedic activities may slander me as being misled, friends and relatives may call me frustrated, my brothers may call me a fool, the wealthy mammonites may point me out as mad, and the learned philosophers may assert that I am much too proud; still my mind does not budge an inch from the determination to serve the lotus feet of Govinda, though I be unable to do it.”

And also Prahlāda Maharaja said:

*dharmārtha-kāma iti yo 'bhihitas trivarga
ékñä trayé naya-damau vividhä ca vārtä
manye tad etad akhilaà nigamasya satyaà
svātmārpaëäà sva-suhādaù paramasya puàsaù*

“Religion, economic development and sense gratification are celebrated as three means of attaining the path of salvation. Of these, *ékñä trayé* especially, i.e., knowledge of the self, knowledge of fruitive acts and logic and also politics and economics, are different means of livelihood. All these are different subjects of Vedic education, and therefore I consider them temporary engagements. On the other hand, surrendering unto the Supreme Lord Viṣṇu is a factual gain in life, and I consider it the ultimate truth.” (**Bhäg.** 7.6.26)

The whole matter is concluded in the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (2.41) as *vyavasäyātmikā buddhiù*, or the absolute path of perfection. Sri Baladeva Vidyābhūṇāēa, a great Vaiṇēava scholar, defines this as *bhagavad-arcanā-rūpaika-niñkāma-karmabhir viçuddha-cittaù*—accepting transcendental loving service to the Lord as the prime duty, free from fruitive reaction.

So Maharaja Parikṣit was perfectly right when he firmly accepted the lotus feet of Lord Kṛṣṇa, renouncing all *karma-kāēōēya* conceptions of life.

TEXT 5

raJaaevac

SaMaqcqNa& vcae b]øNa(SavRjSYa TavaNaga)
TaMaae ivXaqYaRTae Maù& hre" k-QaYaTa" k-QaaMa()) 5))

räjoväca

samécénaà vaco brahman

sarva-jīasya tavānagha

tamo viçéryate mahyaà

hareù kathayataù kathäm

SYNONYMS

räjä uväca—the King said; *samécénam*—perfectly right; *vacaù*—speeches; *brahman*—O learned *brahmana*; *sarva-jīasya*—one who knows all; *tava*—your; *anagha*—without any contamination; *tamaù*—the darkness of ignorance; *viçéryate*—gradually disappearing; *mahyam*—unto me; *hareù*—of the Lord; *kathayataù*—as you are speaking; *kathäm*—topics.

TRANSLATION

Maharaja Parikṣit said: O learned brahmana, you know everything because you are without material contamination. Therefore whatever

you have spoken to me appears perfectly right. Your speeches are gradually destroying the darkness of my ignorance, for you are narrating the topics of the Lord.

PURPORT

The practical experience of Maharaja Parikṣit is disclosed herein, revealing that transcendental topics of the Lord act like injections when received by the sincere devotee from a person who is perfectly uncontaminated by material tinges. In other words, reception of the messages of *Srīmad-Bhāgavatam* from professional men, heard by a *karma-kāṇḍeya* audience, never acts miraculously as stated here. Devotional hearing of the messages of the Lord is not like hearing ordinary topics; therefore the action will be felt by the sincere hearer by experience of the gradual disappearance of ignorance.

*yasya deve parā bhaktir
yathā deve tathā gurau
tasyaite kathitā hy arthāu
prakāṣante mahātmanaù*
[ÇU ⁱⁱⁱ6.23]

When a hungry man is given food to eat, he feels satiation of hunger and the pleasure of dining simultaneously. Thus he does not have to ask whether he has actually been fed or not. The crucial test of hearing *Srīmad-Bhāgavatam* is that one should get positive enlightenment by such an act.

TEXT 6

>aUYa Wv ivivTSaaiMa >aGavaNaaTMaMaaYaYaa)
YaQaed& Sa*JaTae ivi& duivR>aaVYaMaDaqirE")) 6))

bhūya eva vivitsāmi

bhagavān ātma-māyayā

yathedaà sājate viçvaà

durvibhāvyam adhéçvaraiù

SYNONYMS

bhüyaù—again; *eva*—also; *vivitsämi*—I wish to learn; *bhagavän*—the Personality of Godhead; *ätma*—personal; *māyayä*—by the energies; *yathä*—as; *idam*—this phenomenal world; *säjate*—does create; *viçvam*—universe; *durvibhāvyam*—inconceivable; *adhéçvaraiù*—by the great demigods.

TRANSLATION

I beg to know from you how the Personality of Godhead, by His personal energies, creates these phenomenal universes as they are, which are inconceivable even to the great demigods.

PURPORT

In every inquisitive mind the important question of the creation of the phenomenal world arises, and therefore for a personality like Maharaja Pariksit, who was to know all the activities of the Lord from his spiritual master, such an inquiry is not uncommon. For every unknown thing, we have to learn and inquire from a learned personality. The question of creation is also one of such inquiries to be made to the right person. The spiritual master, therefore, must be one who is *sama jñä*, as stated hereinbefore in connection with Sukadeva Gosvami. Thus all inquiries on God which are unknown to the disciple may be made from the qualified spiritual master, and here the practical example is set by Maharaja Pariksit. It was, however, already known to Maharaja Pariksit that everything we see is born out of the energy of the Lord, as we have all learned in the very beginning of *Srimad-Bhagavatam* (*janmädy asya yataù* [SB 1.1.1]). So Maharaja Pariksit wanted to know the process of creation. The origin of creation was known to him; otherwise he would not have inquired how the Personality of Godhead, by His different energies, creates this phenomenal world. The common man also knows that the creation is made by some creator and is not created automatically. We have no experience in the practical world that a thing is created automatically. Foolish people say that

the creative energy is independent and acts automatically, as electrical energy works. But the intelligent man knows that even the electrical energy is generated by an expert engineer in the localized powerhouse, and thus the energy is distributed everywhere under the resident engineer's supervision. The Lord's supervision in connection with creation is mentioned even in the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (9.10), and it is clearly said there that material energy is a manifestation of one of many such energies of the Supreme (*paräsya çaktir vividhaiva çrüyate*). An inexperienced boy may be struck with wonder by seeing the impersonal actions of electronics or many other wonderful things conducted by electrical energy, but an experienced man knows that behind the action is a living man who creates such energy. Similarly the so-called scholars and philosophers of the world may, by mental speculation, present so many utopian theories about the impersonal creation of the universe, but an intelligent devotee of the Lord, by studying the *Bhagavad-gita*, can know that behind the creation is the hand of the Supreme Lord, just as in the generating electrical powerhouse there is the resident engineer. The research scholar finds out the cause and the effect of everything, but research scholars as great as Brahmä, Siva, Indra and many other demigods are sometimes bewildered by seeing the wonderful creative energy of the Lord, so what to speak of the tiny mundane scholars dealing in petty things. As there are differences in the living conditions of different planets of the universe, and as one planet is superior to others, the brains of the living entities in those respective planets are also of different categorical values. As stated in the *Bhagavad-gita*, one can compare the long duration of life of the inhabitants of Brahmä's planet, which is inconceivable to the inhabitants of this planet earth, to the categorical value of the brain of Brahmäjé, also inconceivable to any great scientist of this planet. And with such high brain power, even Brahmäjé has described in his great *saàhitä* (***Brahma-saṁhitā*** 5.1) as follows:

*éçvaraù paramaù kãñëaù
sac-cid-änanda-vigrahaù
anädir ädir govindaù
sarva-käraëa-käraëam*

“There are many personalities possessing the qualities of Bhagavän, but

Kṛṣṇa is the supreme because none can excel Him. He is the Supreme Person, and His body is eternal, full of knowledge and bliss. He is the primeval Lord Govinda and the cause of all causes.”

Brahmājé admits Lord Kṛṣṇa to be the supreme cause of all causes. But persons with tiny brains within this petty planet earth think of the Lord as one of them. Thus when the Lord says in the *Bhagavad-gita* that He (Lord Kṛṣṇa) is all in all, the speculative philosophers and the mundane wranglers deride Him, and the Lord regretfully says:

*avajānanti mää müòhā
mänuñéà tanum āçritam
paraà bhāvam ajānanto
mama bhūta-maheçvaram*

“Fools deride Me when I descend in the human form. They do not know My transcendental nature and My supreme dominion over all that be.” (Bg. 9.11) Brahmā and Siva (and what to speak of other demigods) are *bhūtas*, or powerful created demigods who manage universal affairs, much like ministers appointed by a king. The ministers may be *éçvaras*, or controllers, but the Supreme Lord is *maheçvara*, or the creator of the controllers. Persons with a poor fund of knowledge do not know this, and therefore they have the audacity to deride Him because He comes before us by His causeless mercy occasionally as a human being. The Lord is not like a human being. He is *sac-cid-ānanda-vigraha* [Bs. 5.1], or the Absolute Personality of Godhead, and there is no difference between His body and His soul. He is both the power and the powerful.

Maharaja Parikṣit did not ask his spiritual master, Sukadeva Gosvami, to narrate Lord Kṛṣṇa’s pastimes in Våndāvana; he wanted to hear first about the creation of the Lord. Sukadeva Gosvami did not say that the King should hear about the direct transcendental pastimes of the Lord. The time was very short, and naturally Sukadeva Gosvami could have gone directly to the Tenth Canto to make a shortcut of the whole thing, as generally done by the professional reciters. But neither the King nor the great speaker of *Srimad-Bhagavatam* jumped up like the organizers of *Bhāgavatam*; both of them proceeded systematically, so that both future readers and hearers

might take lessons from the example of the procedure of reciting *Srimad-Bhagavatam*. Those who are in control of the external energy of the Lord, or in other words those who are in the material world, must first of all know how the external energy of the Lord is working under the direction of the Supreme Personality, and afterwards one may try to enter into the activities of His internal energy. The mundaners are mostly worshipers of Durgā-devé, the external energy of Kṛṣṇa, but they do not know that Durgā-devé is but the shadow energy of the Lord. Behind her astonishing display of material workings is the direction of the Lord, as confirmed in the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (9.10). The *Brahma-saṁhitā* affirms that Durgā-çakti is working by the direction of Govinda, and without His sanction the powerful Durgā-çakti cannot move even a blade of grass. Therefore the neophyte devotee, instead of jumping at once to the platform of transcendental pastimes presented by the internal energy of the Lord, may know how great the Supreme Lord is by inquiring about the process of His creative energy. In the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta* also, descriptions of the creative energy and the Lord's hand in it are explained, and the author of *Caitanya-caritāmṛta* has warned the neophyte devotees to be seriously on guard against the pitfall of neglecting knowledge about Kṛṣṇa in regard to how great He is. Only when one knows Lord Kṛṣṇa's greatness can one firmly put one's unflinching faith in Him; otherwise, like the common man, even the great leaders of men will mistake Lord Kṛṣṇa for one of the many demigods, or a historical personality, or a myth only. The transcendental pastimes of the Lord in Våndāvana, or even at Dvärakā, are relishable for persons who have already qualified themselves in advanced spiritual techniques, and the common man may be able to attain to such a plane by the gradual process of service and inquiries, as we shall see in the behavior of Maharaja Pariksit.

TEXT 7

YaQaa GaaePaaYaiTa iv>auYaRQaa Sa&YaC^Tae PauNa")
Yaa& Yaa& XaiÇ-MauPaaie[TYa PauåXaiÇ-" Par" PauMaaNa()
AaTMaaNa& \$-I@YaNa(\$-I@Na(k-raeiTa ivk-raeiTa c)) 7))

yathā gopāyati vibhur

yathä saàyacchate punaù

yäà yäà çaktim upäçritya

puru-çaktiù paraù pumän

ätmänaà kréòayan kréòan

karoti vikaroti ca

SYNONYMS

yathä—as; *gopäyati*—maintains; *vibhuù*—the great; *yathä*—as; *saàyacchate*—winds up; *punaù*—again; *yäm yäm*—as; *çaktim*—energies; *upäçritya*—by employing; *puru-çaktiù*—the all-powerful; *paraù*—the Supreme; *pumän*—Personality of Godhead; *ätmänam*—plenary expansion; *kréòayan*—having engaged them; *kréòan*—as also personally being engaged; *karoti*—does them; *vikaroti*—and causes to be done; *ca*—and.

TRANSLATION

Kindly describe how the Supreme Lord, who is all-powerful, engages His different energies and different expansions in maintaining and again winding up the phenomenal world in the sporting spirit of a player.

PURPORT

In the ***Kaöha Upaniñad*** (2.2.13) the Supreme Lord is described as the chief eternal being amongst all other eternal individual beings (*nityo nityänää cetanaç cetanänäm*) and the one Supreme Lord who maintains innumerable other individual living beings (*eko bahünää yo vidadhätì kämän*). So all living entities, both in the conditioned state and in the liberated state, are maintained by the Almighty Supreme Lord. Such maintenance is effected by the Lord through His different expansions of Self and three principal energies, namely the internal, external and marginal energies. The living entities are His marginal energies, and some of them, in the confidence of the Lord, are entrusted with the work of

creation also, as are Brahmä, Maréci, etc., and the acts of creation are inspired by the Lord unto them (*tene brahma hãdä*). The external energy (*mäyã*) is also impregnated with the *jivas*, or conditioned souls. The unconditioned marginal potency acts in the spiritual kingdom, and the Lord, by His different plenary expansions, maintains them in different transcendental relations displayed in the spiritual sky. So the one Supreme Personality of Godhead manifests Himself in many (*bahu syãm*), and thus all diversities are in Him, and He is in all diversities, although He is nevertheless different from all of them. That is the inconceivable mystic power of the Lord, and as such everything is simultaneously one with and different from Him by His inconceivable potencies (*acintya-bhedäbheda-tattva*).

TEXT 8

NaUNa& >aGavTaae b]øNa(hrerd(>auTak-MaR<a")
duivR>aaVYaiMava>aaiTa k-ivi>aêaiPa ceiíTaMa()) 8))

nünaà bhagavato brahman

harer adbhuta-karmaëaù

durvibhãvyam ivãbhãti

kavibhiç cãpi ceñöitam

SYNONYMS

nünam—still insufficient; *bhagavataù*—of the Personality of Godhead; *brahman*—O learned *brahmana*; *hareù*—of the Lord; *adbhuta*—wonderful; *karmaëaù*—one who acts; *durvibhãvyam*—inconceivable; *iva*—like that; *ãbhãti*—appears; *kavibhiù*—even by the highly learned; *ca*—also; *api*—in spite of; *ceñöitam*—being endeavored for.

TRANSLATION

O learned brahmana, the transcendental activities of the Lord are all

wonderful, and they appear inconceivable because even great endeavors by many learned scholars have still proved insufficient for understanding them.

PURPORT

The acts of the Supreme Lord, in the creation of just this one universe, appear inconceivably wonderful. And there are innumerable universes, and all of them aggregated together are known as the created material world. And this part of His creation is only a fractional portion of the complete creation. The material world stands as a part only (*ekāṇṇena sthito jagat*). Supposing that the material world is a display of one part of His energy, the remaining three parts consist of the *vaikuṇṭha jagat* or spiritual world described in the *Bhagavad-gita* as *mad-dhāma* or *sanātana-dhāma*, or the eternal world. We have marked in the previous verse that He creates and again winds up the creation. This action is applicable only in the material world because the other, greater part of His creation, namely the Vaikuntha world, is neither created nor annihilated; otherwise the Vaikuntha-dhāma would not have been called eternal. The Lord exists with *dhāma*; His eternal name, quality, pastimes, entourage and personality are all a display of His different energies and expansions. The Lord is called *anādi*, or having no creator, and *ādi*, or the origin of all. We think in our own imperfect way that the Lord is also created, but the *Vedānta* informs us that He is not created. Rather, everything else is created by Him (*nārāyaṇaḥ paro 'vyaktāt*). Therefore, for the common man these are all very wonderful matters for consideration. Even for great scholars they are inconceivable, and thus such scholars present theories contradictory to one another. Even for the insignificant part of His creation, this particular universe, they have no complete information as to how far this limited space extends, or how many stars and planets are there, or the different conditions of those innumerable planets. Modern scientists have insufficient knowledge of all this. Some of them assert that there are one hundred million planets scattered all over space. In a news release from Moscow dated 2/21/60, the following piece of knowledge was relayed:

“Russia’s well-known professor of astronomy Boris Vorontsov-Veliaminov said that there must be an infinite number of planets in the universe

inhabited by beings endowed with reason.

“It could be that life similar to that on earth flourishes on such planets.

“Doctor of Chemistry Nikolai Zhironov, covering the problem of atmosphere on other planets, pointed out that the organism of a Martian, for instance, could very well adapt itself to normal existence with a low body temperature.

“He said that he felt that the gaseous composition of Martian atmosphere was quite suitable to sustain life of beings which have become adapted to it.”

This adaptability of an organism to different varieties of planets is described in the *Brahma-saṃhitā* as *vibhūti-bhinna*; i.e., each and every one of the innumerable planets within the universe is endowed with a particular type of atmosphere, and the living beings there are more perfectly advanced in science and psychology because of a better atmosphere. *Vibhūti* means “specific powers,” and *bhinna* means “variegated.” Scientists who are attempting to explore outer space and are trying to reach other planets by mechanical arrangements must know for certain that organisms adapted to the atmosphere of earth cannot exist in the atmospheres of other planets (*Easy Journey to Other planets*). One has to prepare himself, therefore, to be transferred to a different planet after being relieved of the present body, as it is said in the ***Bhagavad-gītā*** (9.25):

*yānti deva-vratā devān
pitṛā yānti pitṛa-vratā
bhūtāni yānti bhūtejya
yānti mad-yājino 'pi mām*

“Those who worship the demigods will take birth among the demigods, those who worship ghosts and spirits will take birth among such beings, and those who worship Me will live with Me.”

Maharaja Parikṣit’s statement regarding the workings of the creative energy of the Lord discloses that he knew everything of the process of

creation. Why then did he ask Sukadeva Gosvami for such information? Maharaja Parikṣit, being a great emperor, a descendant of the Pāṇḍavas and a great devotee of Lord Kṛṣṇa, was quite able to know considerably about the creation of the world, but that much knowledge was not sufficient. He said therefore that even greatly learned scholars fail to know about that, even after great effort. The Lord is unlimited, and His activities are also unfathomed. With a limited source of knowledge and with imperfect senses, any living being, up to the standard of Brahmājé, the highest perfect living being within the universe, can never imagine knowing about the unlimited. We can know something of the unlimited when it is explained by the unlimited, as has been done by the Lord Himself in the unique statements of the *Bhagavad-gīta*, and it can also be known to some extent from realized souls like Sukadeva Gosvami, who learned it from Vyāsadeva, a disciple of Nārada, and thus the perfect knowledge can descend by the chain of disciplic succession only, and not by any form of experimental knowledge, old or modern.

TEXT 9

YaQaa Gau<aa&STau Pa[k*-TaeYauRGaPaTa(§-MaXaae_iPa va)
ib>aiTaR >aUirXaSTvek-" ku-vRNa(k-MaaRi<a JaNMai>a")) 9))

yathä guëääs tu prakâter

yugapat kramaço 'pi vä

bibharti bhüriças tv ekaù

kurvan karmäëi janmabhiù

SYNONYMS

yathä—as they are; *guëän*—the modes of; *tu*—but; *prakâteù*—of the material energy; *yugapat*—simultaneously; *kramaçaù*—gradually; *api*—also; *vä*—either; *bibharti*—maintains; *bhüriçaù*—many forms; *tu*—but; *ekaù*—the supreme one; *kurvan*—acting; *karmäëi*—activities; *janmabhiù*—by incarnations.

TRANSLATION

The Supreme Personality of Godhead is one, whether He alone acts with the modes of material nature, or simultaneously expands in many forms, or expands consecutively to direct the modes of nature.

TEXT 10

ivicik-iTSaTaMaeTaNMae b]vqTau >aGavaNa(YaQaa)
XaaBde b]øi<a iNaZ<aaTa" PariSMa&ê >avaN%lu/)) 10))

vicikitsitam etan me

bravétu bhagavän yathä

çäbde brahmaëi niñëätaù

parasmiàç ca bhavän khalu

SYNONYMS

vicikitsitam—doubtful inquiry; *etat*—this; *me*—of me; *bravétu*—just clear up; *bhagavän*—powerful like the Lord; *yathä*—as much as; *çäbde*—sound transcendental; *brahmaëi*—Vedic literature; *niñëätaù*—fully realized; *parasmin*—in transcendence; *ca*—also; *bhavän*—your good self; *khalu*—as a matter of fact.

TRANSLATION

Kindly clear up all these doubtful inquiries, because you are not only vastly learned in the Vedic literatures and self-realized in transcendence, but are also a great devotee of the Lord and are therefore as good as the Personality of Godhead.

PURPORT

In the *Brahma-saṁhitā* it is said that the Supreme Absolute Truth, Govinda,

the Personality of Godhead, although one without a second, is infallibly expanded by innumerable forms nondifferent from one another, and although He is the original person, He is still ever young with permanent youthful energy. He is very difficult to know simply by learning the transcendental science of the *Vedas*, but He is very easily realized by His pure devotees.

The expansions of different forms of the Lord, as from Kṛṣṇa to Baladeva to Saṅkarṣṇa, from Saṅkarṣṇa to Vāsudeva, from Vāsudeva to Aniruddha, from Aniruddha to Pradyumna and then again to second Saṅkarṣṇa and from Him to the Nārāyaṇa *puruṇāvatāras*, and innumerable other forms, which are compared to the constant flowing of the uncountable waves of a river, are all one and the same. They are like lamps of equal power which kindle from one lamp to another. That is the transcendental potency of the Lord. The *Vedas* say that He is so complete that even though the whole complete identity emanates from Him, He still remains the same complete whole (*pūrēasya pūrēam ādāya pūrēam evāvaçiṇyate*). As such, there is no validity in a material conception of the Lord produced by the mental speculator. Thus He remains always a mystery for the mundane scholar, even if he is vastly learned in the Vedic literatures (*vedeṇu durlabham adurlabham ātma-bhaktau* [Bs. 5.33]). Therefore, the Lord is beyond the limit of conception for mundane learned scholars, philosophers or scientists. He is easily understandable for the pure devotee because the Lord declares in the ***Bhagavad-gīta*** (18.54) that after surpassing the stage of knowledge, when one is able to be engaged in the devotional service of the Lord, then only can one know the true nature of the Lord. One cannot have any clear conception of the Lord or His holy name, form, attributes, pastimes, etc., unless one is engaged in His transcendental loving service. The statement of the *Bhagavad-gīta* that one must first of all surrender unto the Lord, being freed from all other engagements, means that one must become a pure, unconditional devotee of the Lord. Only then can one know Him by the strength of devotional service.

Maharaja Parikṣit admitted in the previous verse that the Lord is inconceivable even for the greatest learned scholars. Why then should he again request Sukadeva Gosvami to clarify his insufficient knowledge about the Lord? The reason is clear. Not only was Sukadeva Gosvami vastly

learned in the Vedic literatures, but he was also a great self-realized soul and a powerful devotee of the Lord. A powerful devotee of the Lord is, by the grace of the Lord, more than the Lord Himself. The Personality of Godhead Sri Rāmacandra attempted to bridge the Indian Ocean to reach the island of Laikā, but Sri Hanumānjé, the unalloyed devotee of the Personality of Godhead, could cross the ocean simply by jumping over it. The Lord is so merciful upon His pure devotee that He presents His beloved devotee as more powerful than Himself. The Lord expressed Himself to be unable to save Durvāsā Muni, although the Muni was so powerful that he could reach the Lord directly under material conditions. But Durvāsā Muni was saved by Maharaja Ambaréṇa, a devotee of the Lord. Therefore, not only is a devotee of the Lord more powerful than the Lord, but also worship of the devotee is considered more effective than direct worship of the Lord (*mad-bhakta-pūjābhyadhikā* [SB 11.19.21]).

The conclusion is, therefore, that a serious devotee must first approach a spiritual master who not only is well versed in the Vedic literatures but is also a great devotee with factual realization of the Lord and His different energies. Without the help of such a devotee spiritual master, one cannot make progress in the transcendental science of the Lord. And a bona fide spiritual master like Sukadeva Gosvami does not speak about the Lord only in the matter of His internal potencies, but also explains how He associates with His external potencies.

The Lord's pastimes in the internal potency are displayed in His activities in Vāndāvana, but His external potential works are directed in His features of Kāraëärëavaçäyë Viṣṇu, Garbhodakaśāyī Viṣṇu and Kṣīrodakaśāyī Viṣṇu. Srila Visvanatha Cakravarti offers his good counsel to the interested Vaiñëavas when he says that they should not be interested in hearing only about the Lord's activities (like *rāsa-līla*), but must be keenly interested in His pastimes in His features of the *puruñāvatāras* in connection with *sāññōi-tattva*, creational functions, following the examples of Maharaja Parikṣit, the ideal disciple, and Sukadeva Gosvami, the ideal spiritual master.

TEXT 11

SaUTa ovac

wTYauPaaMaiN}aTaae raja Gau<aaNauk-QaNae hre")
ôzqke-XaMaNauSMA*TYa Pa[iTavçu-& Pa[cṣ-Mae)) 11))

sūta uvāca

ity upāmantrito rājā

guḍānukathane hareṇ

hāñékeṣam anusmātya

prativaktuà pracakrame

SYNONYMS

sūtaṇ uvāca—Sūta Gosvami said; *iti*—thus; *upāmantritaṇ*—being requested; *rājā*—by the King; *guḍa-anukathane*—in describing the transcendental attributes of the Lord; *hareṇ*—of the personality of Godhead; *hāñékeṣam*—the master of the senses; *anusmātya*—properly remembering; *prativaktum*—just to reply; *pracakrame*—executed the preliminaries.

TRANSLATION

Sūta Gosvami said: When Sukadeva Gosvami was thus requested by the King to describe the creative energy of the Personality of Godhead, he then systematically remembered the master of the senses [Sri Kṛṣṇa], and to reply properly he spoke thus.

PURPORT

The devotees of the Lord, while delivering speeches and describing the transcendental attributes of the Lord, do not think that they can do anything independently. They think that they can speak only what they are induced to speak by the Supreme Lord, the master of the senses. The senses of the individual being are not his own; the devotee knows that such senses belong to the Supreme Lord and that they can be properly used

when they are employed for the service of the Lord. The senses are instruments, and elements are ingredients, all endowed by the Lord; therefore whatever an individual can do, speak, see, etc., is under the direction of the Lord only. The ***Bhagavad-gita*** (15.15) confirms this: *sarvasya cāhaà hādi sanniviñño mattaù smātir jñānam apohanaà ca*. No one is free to act freely and independently, and as such, one should always seek the permission of the Lord to act or eat or speak, and by the blessing of the Lord everything done by a devotee is beyond the principles of the four defects typical of the conditioned soul.

TEXT 12

é[quéuk- ovac
NaMa" ParSMaE PauâzaYa >aUYaSae
SaduÛvSQaaNaiNaraeDal/Il/Yaa)
Ga*hqTaXaiç-i}aTaYaaYa deihNaa,
MaNTa>aRvaYaaNauPal/+YavTMaRNae)) 12))

çré-çuka uvāca

namaù parasmai puruñāya bhüyase

sad-udbhava-sthāna-nirodha-lélayä

gāhéta-çakti-tritayāya dehinām

antarbhaväyanupalakñya-vartmane

SYNONYMS

çré-çukaù uvāca—Sri Sukadeva Gosvami said; *namaù*—offering obeisances; *parasmai*—the Supreme; *puruñāya*—personality of Godhead; *bhüyase*—unto the complete whole; *sad-udbhava*—the creation of the material world; *sthāna*—its maintenance; *nirodha*—and its winding up; *lélayä*—by the pastime of; *gāhéta*—having accepted; *çakti*—power; *tritayāya*—three modes; *dehinām*—of all who possess material bodies; *antaù-bhavāya*—unto He who resides within; *anupalakñya*—inconceivable; *vartmane*—one

who has such ways.

TRANSLATION

Sukadeva Gosvami said: Let me offer my respectful obeisances unto the Supreme Personality of Godhead who, for the creation of the material world, accepts the three modes of nature. He is the complete whole residing within the body of everyone, and His ways are inconceivable.

PURPORT

This material world is a manifestation of the three modes goodness, passion and ignorance, and the Supreme Lord, for the creation, maintenance and destruction of the material world, accepts three predominating forms as Brahmā, Viṣṇu and Ćaikara (Siva). As Viṣṇu He enters into every body materially created. As Garbhodakaśāyī Viṣṇu He enters into every universe, and as Kṣīrodakaśāyī Viṣṇu He enters the body of every living being. Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, being the origin of all *viṣṇu-tattvas*, is addressed here as *paraṁ pumān*, or Puruṇottama, as described in the *Bhagavad-gita* (15.18). He is the complete whole. The *puruṇāvatāras* are therefore His plenary expansions. *Bhakti-yoga* is the only process by which one can become competent to know Him. Because the empiric philosophers and mystic *yogis* cannot conceive of the Personality of Godhead, He is called *anupalakṇīya-vartmane*, the Lord of the inconceivable way, or *bhakti-yoga*.

TEXT 13

>aUYaae NaMa" Sad(v*iJaNaiC^de_SaTaa,
MaSaM>avaYaai%l/SatvMaUTaRYae)
Pau&Saa& PauNa" PaarMah&SYa Aaé[Mae
VYaviSQaTaaNaaMaNauMa*GYadaéuze)) 13))

bhūyo namaṁ sad-vājina-cchide 'satām

asambhavāyākhila-sattva-mūrtaye

puàsää punaù päramahaàsyä äçrame

vyavasthitänäm anumågya-däçuñe

SYNONYMS

bhüyaù—again; *namaù*—my obeisances; *sat*—of the devotees or the pious; *våjina*—distresses; *chide*—the liberator; *asatäm*—of the atheists, the nondevotee-demons; *asambhaväya*—cessation of further unhappiness; *akhila*—complete; *sattva*—goodness; *mürtaye*—unto the Personality; *puàsäm*—of the transcendentalists; *punaù*—again; *päramahaàsyä*—the highest stage of spiritual perfection; *äçrame*—in the status; *vyavasthitänäm*—particularly situated; *anumågya*—the destination; *däçuñe*—one who delivers.

TRANSLATION

I again offer my respectful obeisances unto the form of complete existence and transcendence, who is the liberator of the pious devotees from all distresses and the destroyer of the further advances in atheistic temperament of the nondevotee-demons. For the transcendentalists who are situated in the topmost spiritual perfection, He grants their specific destinations.

PURPORT

Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa is the complete form of all existence, both material and spiritual. *Akhila* means complete, or that which is not *khila*, inferior. As stated in the *Bhagavad-gita*, there are two kinds of nature (*prakåti*), namely the material nature and the spiritual nature, or the external and internal potencies of the Lord. The material nature is called *aparä*, or inferior, and the spiritual nature is called superior or transcendental. Therefore the form of the Lord is not of the inferior, material nature. He is complete transcendence. And He is *mürti*, or having transcendental form. The less intelligent men, who are unaware of His transcendental form, describe Him as impersonal Brahman. But Brahman is simply the rays of His transcendental body (*yasya prabhä* [Bs. 5.40]). The devotees, who are

aware of His transcendental form, render Him service; therefore the Lord also reciprocates by His causeless mercy and thus delivers His devotees from all distresses. The pious men who follow the rulings of the *Vedas* are also dear to Him, and therefore the pious men of this world are also protected by Him. The impious and the nondevotees are against the principles of the *Vedas*, and so such persons are always hampered from making advances in their nefarious activities. Some of them, who are specially favored by the Lord, are killed by Him personally, as in the cases of Ravana, Hiraṇyakaśipu and Kaàsa, and thus such demons get salvation and are thereby checked from further progress in their demoniac activities. Just like a kind father, either in His favor upon the devotees or His punishment of the demons He is ever kind to everyone because He is the complete existence for all individual existence.

The *paramahamsa* stage of existence is the highest perfectional stage of spiritual values. According to Srimaté Kuntédevé, the Lord is factually understood by the *paramahamsas* only. As there is gradual realization of the transcendence from impersonal Brahman to localized Paramātmā to the Personality of Godhead, Puruṇottama, Lord Kṛṣṇa, similarly there is gradual promotion of one's situation in the spiritual life of *sannyāsa*. *Kuöécaka*, *bahudaka*, *parivrajakacarya* and *paramahamsa* are gradual progressive stages in the renounced order of life, *sannyāsa*, and Queen Kuntédevé, the mother of the Pääòavas, has spoken about them in her prayers for Lord Kṛṣṇa (Canto One, Chapter Eight). The *paramahamsas* are generally found among both the impersonalists and the devotees, but according to *Srimad-Bhagavatam* (as clearly stated by Kuntédevé), pure *bhakti-yoga* is understood by the *paramahamsas*, and Kuntédevé has especially mentioned that the Lord descends (*pariträëäya sädhünäm*) especially to award *bhakti-yoga* to the *paramahamsas*. So ultimately the *paramahamsas*, in the true sense of the term, are unalloyed devotees of the Lord. Srila Jiva Gosvami has directly accepted that the highest destination is *bhakti-yoga*, by which one accepts the transcendental loving service of the Lord. Those who accept the path of *bhakti-yoga* are the factual *paramahamsas*.

Since the Lord is very kind to everyone, the impersonalists, who accept *bhakti* as the means of merging in the existence of the Lord in His

impersonal *brahmajyoti*, are also awarded their desired destination. He has assured everyone in the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (4.11): *ye yathä mää prapadyante*. According to Srila Visvanatha Cakravarti, there are two classes of *paramahamsas*, namely the *brahmānandés* (impersonalists) and the *premānandés* (devotees), and both are awarded their desired destinations, although the *premānandés* are more fortunate than the *brahmānandés*. But both the *brahmānandés* and the *premānandés* are transcendentalists, and they have nothing to do with the inferior, material nature full of the existential miseries of life.

TEXT 14

NaMaae NaMaSTae_STv*z>aaYa SaaTvTaa&
 ivdUrk-aïaYa Mauhu" ku-YaaeiGaNaMa()
 iNarSTaSaaMYaaITaXaYaeNa raDaSaa
 SvDaaMaiNa b]øi<a r&SYaTae NaMa")) 14))

namo namas te 'stv añabhäya sätvatäà

vidüra-käñöhäya muhuù kuyoginäm

nirasta-sämyätiçayena rädhasä

sva-dhämani brahmaëi raàsyate namaù

SYNONYMS

namaù namaù te—let me offer my obeisances unto You; *astu*—are; *añabhäya*—unto the great associate; *sätvatäm*—of the members of the Yadu dynasty; *vidüra-käñöhäya*—one who is far from mundane wranglers; *muhuù*—always; *ku-yoginäm*—of the nondevotees; *nirasta*—vanquished; *sämya*—equal status; *atiçayena*—by greatness; *rädhasä*—by opulence; *sva-dhämani*—in His own abode; *brahmaëi*—in the spiritual sky; *raàsyate*—enjoys; *namaù*—I do bow down.

TRANSLATION

Let me offer my respectful obeisances unto He who is the associate of the members of the Yadu dynasty and who is always a problem for the nondevotees. He is the supreme enjoyer of both the material and spiritual worlds, yet He enjoys His own abode in the spiritual sky. There is no one equal to Him because His transcendental opulence is immeasurable.

PURPORT

There are two sides of the transcendental manifestations of the Supreme Lord, Sri Kṛṣṇa. For the pure devotees He is the constant companion, as in the case of His becoming one of the family members of the Yadu dynasty, or His becoming the friend of Arjuna, or His becoming the associate neighbor of the inhabitants of Vāndāvana, as the son of Nanda-Yaçodā, the friend of Sudāmā, Sridāmā and Madhumaṅgala, or the lover of the damsels of Vrajabhūmi, etc. That is part of His personal features. And by His impersonal feature He expands the rays of the *brahmajyoti*, which is limitless and all-pervasive. Part of this all-pervasive *brahmajyoti*, which is compared to the sun rays, is covered by the darkness of the *mahat-tattva*, and this insignificant part is known as the material world. In this material world there are innumerable universes like the one we can experience, and in each of them there are hundreds of thousands of planets like the one we are inhabiting. The mundaners are more or less captivated by the unlimited expansion of the rays of the Lord, but the devotees are concerned more with His personal form, from which everything is emanating (*janmādy asya yataù* [SB 1.1.1]). As the sun rays are concentrated in the sun disc, the *brahmajyoti* is concentrated in Goloka Vāndāvana, the topmost spiritual planet in the spiritual sky. The immeasurable spiritual sky is full of spiritual planets, named Vaikunthas, far beyond the material sky. The mundaners have insufficient information of even the mundane sky, so what can they think of the spiritual sky? Therefore the mundaners are always far, far away from Him. Even if in the future they are able to manufacture some machine whose speed may be accelerated to the velocity of the wind or mind, the mundaners will still be unable to imagine reaching the planets in the spiritual sky. So the Lord and His residential abode will always remain a myth or a mysterious problem, but for the devotees the Lord will always be available as an associate.

In the spiritual sky His opulence is immeasurable. The Lord resides in all the spiritual planets, the innumerable Vaikuntha planets, by expanding His plenary portions along with His liberated devotee associates, but the impersonalists who want to merge in the existence of the Lord are allowed to merge as one of the spiritual sparks of the *brahmajyoti*. They have no qualifications for becoming associates of the Lord either in the Vaikuntha planets or in the supreme planet, Goloka Våndävana, described in the *Bhagavad-gita* as *mad-dhäma* and here in this verse as the *sva-dhäma* of the Lord.

This *mad-dhäma* or *sva-dhäma* is described in the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (15.6) as follows:

*na tad bhäsayate süryo
na çaçäiko na pävakaù
yad gatvä na nivartante
tad dhäma paramaà mama*

The Lord's *sva-dhäma* does not require any sunlight or moonlight or electricity for illumination. That *dhäma*, or place, is supreme, and whoever goes there never comes back to this material world.

The Vaikuntha planets and the Goloka Våndävana planet are all self-illuminating, and the rays scattered by those *sva-dhäma* of the Lord constitute the existence of the *brahmajyoti*. As further confirmed in the *Vedas* like the ***Muëðaka*** (2.2.10), ***Kaöha*** (2.2.15) and *Çvetäçvatara Upaniñads* (6.14):

*na tatra süryo bhäti na candra-tärakaà
nemä vidyuto bhänti kuto 'yam agniù
tam eva bhäntam anu bhäti sarvaà
tasya bhäsä sarvam idaà vibhäti*

In the *sva-dhäma* of the Lord there is no need of sun, moon or stars for illumination. Nor is there need of electricity, so what to speak of ignited lamps? On the other hand, it is because those planets are self-illuminating that all effulgence has become possible, and whatever there is that is

dazzling is due to the reflection of that *sva-dhāma*.

One who is dazzled by the effulgence of the impersonal *brahmajyoti* cannot know the personal transcendence; therefore in the *Ēṣopaniñad* (15) it is prayed that the Lord shift His dazzling effulgence so that the devotee can see the real reality. It is spoken thus:

*hiraëmayena pätreëa
satyasyäpihitaà mukham
tat tvaà püñann apävåëu
satya-dharmäya dāñöaye*

“O Lord, You are the maintainer of everything, both material and spiritual, and everything flourishes by Your mercy. Your devotional service, or *bhakti-yoga*, is the actual principle of religion, *satya-dharma*, and I am engaged in that service. So kindly protect me by showing Your real face. Please, therefore, remove the veil of Your *brahmajyoti* rays so that I can see Your form of eternal bliss and knowledge.”

TEXT 15

**YaTk-ITaRNa& YaTSMar<a& Yadq+a<a&
YaÜNdNa& YaC^\v<a& YadhR<aMa()
I/aek-SYa SaÛae ivDauNaaeiTa k-LMaz&
TaSMaE Sau>ad]é[vSae NaMaae NaMa")) 15))**

yat-kértanaà yat-smaraëaà yad-ékñäëaà

yad-vandanaà yac-chravaëaà yad-arhaëam

lokasya sadyo vidhunoti kalmañaà

tasmai subhadra-çravase namo namaù

SYNONYMS

yat—whose; *kértanam*—glorification; *yat*—whose; *smaraëam*—

remembrances; *yat*—whose; *ékñāëam*—audience; *yat*—whose; *vandanam*—prayers; *yat*—whose; *çravaëam*—hearing about; *yat*—whose; *arhaëam*—worshiping; *lokasya*—of all people; *sadyaù*—forthwith; *vidhunoti*—specifically cleanses; *kalmañam*—effects of sins; *tasmai*—unto Him; *subhadra*—all-auspicious; *çravase*—one who is heard; *namaù*—my due obeisances; *namaù*—again and again.

TRANSLATION

Let me offer my respectful obeisances unto the all-auspicious Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, about whom glorification, remembrances, audience, prayers, hearing and worship can at once cleanse the effects of all sins of the performer.

PURPORT

The sublime form of religious performances to free oneself from all reactions of sins is suggested herein by the greatest authority, Sri Sukadeva Gosvami. *Kértanam*, or glorifying the Lord, can be performed in very many ways, such as remembering, visiting temples to see the Deity, offering prayers in front of the Lord, and hearing recitations of glorification of the Lord as they are mentioned in the *Srimad-Bhagavatam* or in the *Bhagavad-gita*. *Kértanam* can be performed both by singing the glories of the Lord in accompaniment with melodious music and by recitation of scriptures like *Srimad-Bhagavatam* or *Bhagavad-gita*.

The devotees need not be disappointed in the physical absence of the Lord, though they may think of not being associated with Him. The devotional process of chanting, hearing, remembering, etc., (either all or some of them, or even one of them) can give us the desired result of associating with the Lord by discharging the transcendental loving service of the Lord in the above manner. Even the very sound of the holy name of Lord Kṛṣṇa or Rāma can at once surcharge the atmosphere spiritually. We must know definitely that the Lord is present wherever such pure transcendental service is performed, and thus the performer of offenseless *kértanam* has positive association with the Lord. Similarly, remembrance and prayers also can give us the desired result if they are properly done under expert

guidance. One should not concoct forms of devotional service. One may worship the form of the Lord in a temple, or one may impersonally offer the Lord devotional prayers in a mosque or a church. One is sure to get free from the reactions of sins provided one is very careful about not committing sins willingly in expectation of getting free from the reactions of sins by worshiping in the temple or by offering prayers in the church. This mentality of committing sins willfully on the strength of devotional service is called *nāmno balād yasya hi pāpa-buddhiù*, and it is the greatest offense in the discharge of devotional service. Hearing, therefore, is essential in order to keep oneself strictly on guard against such pitfalls of sins. And in order to give special stress to the hearing process, the Gosvami invokes all auspicious fortune in this matter.

TEXT 16

ivc+a<aa YaÀr<aaePaSaadNaaTa(
Sa® & VYaudSYaae>aYaTaae_NTaraTMaNa")
ivNdiNTa ih b]øGaiTa& GaTa©-Maa,
STaSMaE Sau>ad]é[vSae NaMaae NaMa")) 16))

vicakñāëù yac-caraëopasādanāt

saigaà vyudasyobhayato 'ntar-ātmanaù

vindanti hi brahma-gatià gata-klamäs

tasmai subhadra-çravase namo namaù

SYNONYMS

vicakñāëù—highly intellectual; *yat*—whose; *caraëa-upasādanāt*—simply dedicating oneself unto the lotus feet; *saigam*—attachment; *vyudasya*—giving up completely; *ubhayataù*—for present and future existence; *antaù-ātmanaù*—of the heart and soul; *vindanti*—moves progressively; *hi*—certainly; *brahma-gatim*—toward spiritual existence; *gata-klamäù*—without difficulty; *tasmai*—unto Him; *subhadra*—all-auspicious; *çravase*—unto one who is heard; *namaù*—my due obeisances; *namaù*—again and

again.

TRANSLATION

**Let me offer my respectful obeisances again and again unto the all-
auspicious Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa. The highly intellectual, simply by surrendering
unto His lotus feet, are relieved of all attachments to present and future
existences and without difficulty progress toward spiritual existence.**

PURPORT

Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa has repeatedly instructed Arjuna, or for that matter everyone concerned with becoming His unalloyed devotee. In the last phase of His instruction in the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (18.64–66) He instructed most confidentially as follows:

*sarva-guhyatamaà bhūyaù
çãëu me paramaà vacaù
iñöo 'si me dãòham iti
tato vakñyãmi te hitam*

*man-manã bhava mad-bhakto
mad-yãjé mãà namaskuru
mãm evaiñyasi satyaà te
pratijãne priyo 'si me
[Bg. 18.65]*

*sarva-dharmãn parityajya
mãm ekaà çaraëaà vraja
ahaà tväà sarva-pãpebhyo
mokñayiñyãmi mã çucaù*

“My dear Arjuna, you are very dear to Me, and therefore only for your good I will disclose the most secret part of My instructions. It is simply this: become a pure devotee of Mine and give yourself unto Me only, and I promise you full spiritual existence, by which you may gain the eternal right of transcendental loving service unto Me. Just give up all other ways of

religiosity and exclusively surrender unto Me and believe that I will protect you from your sinful acts, and I shall deliver you. Do not worry any more.”

Persons who are intelligent take serious notice of this last instruction of the Lord. Knowledge of the self is the first step in spiritual realization, which is called confidential knowledge, and a step further is God realization, which is called more confidential knowledge. The culmination of the knowledge of *Bhagavad-gita* is God realization, and when one attains this stage of God realization, he naturally, voluntarily becomes a devotee of the Lord to render Him loving transcendental service. This devotional service to the Lord is always based on love of God and is distinct from the nature of routine service as prescribed in *karma-yoga*, *jñāna-yoga* or *dhyāna-yoga*. In the *Bhagavad-gita* there are different instructions for such men of different categories, and there are various descriptions for *varëāçrama-dharma*, *sannyāsa-dharma*, *yati-dharma*, the renounced order of life, controlling the senses, meditation, perfection of mystic powers, etc., but one who fully surrenders unto the Lord to render service unto Him, out of spontaneous love for Him, factually assimilates the essence of all knowledge described in the *Vedas*. One who adopts this method very skillfully attains perfection of life at once. And this perfection of human life is called *brahma-gati*, or the progressive march in spiritual existence. As enunciated by Srila Jiva Gosvami on the basis of Vedic assurances, *brahma-gati* means to attain a spiritual form as good as that of the Lord, and in that form the liberated living being eternally lives on one of the spiritual planets situated in the spiritual sky. Attainment of this perfection of life is easily available to a pure devotee of the Lord without his undergoing any difficult method of perfection. Such a devotional life is full of *kértanam*, *smaraëam*, *ékñäëam*, etc., as mentioned in the previous verse. One must therefore adopt this simple way of devotional life in order to attain the highest perfection available in any category of the human form of life in any part of the world. When Lord Brahmā met Lord Kṛṣṇa as a playful child at Våndāvana, he offered his prayer in which he said:

*çreyaù-sâtià bhaktim udasya te vibho
kliçyanti ye kevala-bodha-labdhave
teñäm asau kleçala eva çinñyate
nänyad yathä sthüla-tuñävaghätinäm*

(*Bhäg.* 10.14.4)

Bhakti-yoga is the highest quality of perfection to be achieved by the intelligent person in lieu of performing a large quantity of spiritual activities. The example cited here is very appropriate. A handful of real paddy is more valuable than heaps of paddy skins without any substance within. Similarly, one should not be attracted by the jugglery of *karma-käëòa* or *jiäna-käëòa* or even the gymnastic performances of *yoga*, but skillfully should take to the simple performances of *kértanam*, *smaraëam*, etc., under a bona fide spiritual master, and without any difficulty attain the highest perfection.

TEXT 17

**TaPaiSvNaae daNaPara YaXaiSvNaae
MaNaiSvNaae MaN}aivd" SauMa®I/a")
+aeMa& Na ivNdiNTa ivNaa YadPaR<a&
TaSMaE Sau>ad]é[vSae NaMaae NaMa")) 17))**

tapasvino dāna-parā yaçasvino

manasvino mantra-vidāu sumaḡgalāu

kñemaà na vindanti vinā yat-arpaëaà

tasmai subhadra-çravase namo namaù

SYNONYMS

tapasvinaù—the great learned sages; *dāna-paräù*—the great performer of charity; *yaçasvinaù*—the great worker of distinction; *manasvinaù*—the great philosophers or mystics; *mantra-vidaù*—the great chanter of the Vedic hymns; *su-maḡgaläù*—strict followers of Vedic principles; *kñemam*—fruitful result; *na*—never; *vindanti*—attain; *vinä*—without; *yat-arpaëam*—dedication; *tasmai*—unto Him; *subhadra*—auspicious; *çravase*—hearing about Him; *namaù*—my obeisances; *namaù*—again and again.

TRANSLATION

Let me offer my respectful obeisances unto the all-auspicious Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa again and again because the great learned sages, the great performers of charity, the great workers of distinction, the great philosophers and mystics, the great chanters of the Vedic hymns and the great followers of Vedic principles cannot achieve any fruitful result without dedication of such great qualities to the service of the Lord.

PURPORT

Advancement of learning, a charitable disposition, political, social or religious leadership of human society, philosophical speculations, the practice of the *yoga* system, expertise in the Vedic rituals, and all similar high qualities in man serve one in the attainment of perfection only when they are employed in the service of the Lord. Without such dovetailing, all such qualities become sources of trouble for people in general. Everything can be utilized either for one's own sense gratification or in the service of one other than oneself. There are two kinds of self-interest also, namely personal selfishness and extended selfishness. But there is no qualitative difference between personal and extended selfishness. Theft for personal interest or for the family interest is of the same quality—namely, criminal. A thief pleading not guilty because of committing theft not for personal interest but for the interest of society or country has never been excused by the established law of any country. People in general have no knowledge that the self-interest of a living being attains perfection only when such an interest coincides with the interest of the Lord. For example, what is the interest of maintaining body and soul together? One earns money for maintenance of the body (personal or social), but unless there is God consciousness, unless the body is being properly maintained to realize one's relation with God, all good efforts to maintain body and soul together are similar to the attempts of the animals to maintain body and soul together. The purpose of maintaining the human body is different from that of the animals. Similarly, advancement of learning, economic development, philosophical research, study in the Vedic literature or even the execution of pious activities (like charity, opening of hospitals, and the distribution of food grains) should be done in relation with the Lord. The

aim of all such acts and endeavors must be the pleasure of the Lord and not the satisfaction of any other identity, individual or collective (*saàsiddhir hari-toñäëam* [SB 1.2.13]). In the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (9.27) the same principle is confirmed where it is said that whatever we may give in charity and whatever we may observe in austerity must be given over to the Lord or be done on His account only. The expert leaders of a godless human civilization cannot bring about a fruitful result in all their different attempts at educational advancement or economic development unless they are God conscious. And to become God conscious one has to hear about the all-auspicious Lord, as He is described in literature like the *Bhagavad-gita* and *Srimad-Bhagavatam*.

TEXT 18

ik-raTahU<aaNDa]Paul/NdPauLk-Xaa
 Aa>aqréuM>aa YavNaa" %SaadYa")
 Yae_NYae c PaaPaa YadPaaé[Yaaé[Yaa"
 éuDYaiNTa TaSMaE Pa[>aivZ<ave NaMa")) 18))

kirāta-hüëändhra-pulinda-pulkaçä

äbhéra-çumbhä yavanäu khasädayau

ye 'nye ca päpä yad-apäçrayäçrayäu

çudhyanti tasmai prabhaviñëave namaù

SYNONYMS

kirāta—a province of old Bhārata; *hüëa*—part of Germany and Russia; *ändhra*—a province of southern India; *pulinda*—the Greeks; *pulkaçäu*—another province; *äbhéra*—part of old Sind; *çumbhäù*—another province; *yavanäu*—the Turks; *khasa-ädayau*—the Mongolian province; *ye*—even those; *anye*—others; *ca*—also; *päpäù*—addicted to sinful acts; *yat*—whose; *apäçraya-äçrayäu*—having taken shelter of the devotees of the Lord; *çudhyanti*—at once purified; *tasmai*—unto Him; *prabhaviñëave*—unto the powerful Viṣṇu; *namaù*—my respectful obeisances.

TRANSLATION

Kirāta, Hübä, Āndhra, Pulinda, Pulkaça, Ābhära, Çumbha, Yavana, members of the Khasa races and even others addicted to sinful acts can be purified by taking shelter of the devotees of the Lord, due to His being the supreme power. I beg to offer my respectful obeisances unto Him.

PURPORT

Kirāta: A province of old Bhārata-varña mentioned in the *Bhéñma-parva* of *Mahābhārata*. Generally the Kirātas are known as the aboriginal tribes of India, and in modern days the Santal Parganas in Bihar and Chota Nagpur might comprise the old province named Kirāta.

Hübä: The area of East Germany and part of Russia is known as the province of the Hübäs. Accordingly, sometimes a kind of hill tribe is known as the Hübäs.

Āndhra: A province in southern India mentioned in the *Bhéñma-parva* of *Mahābhārata*. It is still extant under the same name.

Pulinda: It is mentioned in the *Mahābhārata* (*Ādi-parva* 174.38), viz., the inhabitants of the province of the name Pulinda. This country was conquered by Bhémasena and Sahadeva. The Greeks are known as Pulindas, and it is mentioned in the *Vana-parva* of *Mahābhārata* that the non-Vedic race of this part of the world would rule over the world. This Pulinda province was also one of the provinces of Bhārata, and the inhabitants were classified amongst the *kñātriya* kings. But later on, due to their giving up the brahminical culture, they were mentioned as *mlecchas* (just as those who are not followers of the Islamic culture are called *kafirs* and those who are not followers of the Christian culture are called heathens).

Ābhära: This name also appears in the *Mahābhārata*, both in the *Sabhā-parva* and *Bhéñma-parva*. It is mentioned that this province was situated on the River Sarasvaté in Sind. The modern Sind province formerly extended on the other side of the Arabian Sea, and all the inhabitants of

that province were known as the Äbhéras. They were under the domination of Maharaja Yudhiñöhira, and according to the statements of Markandeya the *mlecchas* of this part of the world would also rule over Bhārata. Later on this proved to be true, as in the case of the Pulindas. On behalf of the Pulindas, Alexander the Great conquered India, and on behalf of the Äbhéras, Muhammad Ghorī conquered India. These Äbhéras were also formerly *kṣatriyas* within the brahminical culture, but they gave up the connection. The *kṣatriyas* who were afraid of Paraçurāma and had hidden themselves in the Caucasian hilly regions later on became known as the Äbhéras, and the place they inhabited was known as Äbhéradeça.

Çumbhas or *Kaikas*: The inhabitants of the Kaika province of old Bhārata, mentioned in the *Mahābhārata*.

Yavanas: Yavana was the name of one of the sons of Maharaja Yayāti who was given the part of the world known as Turkey to rule. Therefore the Turks are Yavanas due to being descendants of Maharaja Yavana. The Yavanas were therefore *kṣatriyas*, and later on, by giving up the brahminical culture, they became *mleccha-yavanas*. Descriptions of the Yavanas are in the *Mahābhārata* (**Ädi-parva** 85.34). Another prince called Turvasu was also known as Yavana, and his country was conquered by Sahadeva, one of the Pääòavas. The western Yavana joined with Duryodhana in the Battle of Kurukñetra under the pressure of Karëa. It is also foretold that these Yavanas also would conquer India, and it proved to be true.

Khasa: The inhabitants of the Khasadeça are mentioned in the *Mahābhārata* (*Droëa-parva*). Those who have a stunted growth of hair on the upper lip are generally called Khasas. As such, the Khasa are the Mongolians, the Chinese and others who are so designated.

The above-mentioned historical names are different nations of the world. Even those who are constantly engaged in sinful acts are all corrigible to the standard of perfect human beings if they take shelter of the devotees of the Lord. Jesus Christ and Muhammad, two powerful devotees of the Lord, have done tremendous service on behalf of the Lord on the surface of the globe. And from the version of Srila Sukadeva Gosvami it appears that

instead of running a godless civilization in the present context of the world situation, if the leadership of world affairs is entrusted to the devotees of the Lord, for which a worldwide organization under the name and style of the International Society for Krishna Consciousness has already been started, then by the grace of the Almighty Lord there can be a thorough change of heart in human beings all over the world because the devotees of the Lord are able authorities to effect such a change by purifying the dust-worn minds of the people in general. The politicians of the world may remain in their respective positions because the pure devotees of the Lord are not interested in political leadership or diplomatic implications. The devotees are interested only in seeing that the people in general are not misguided by political propaganda and in seeing that the valuable life of a human being is not spoiled in following a type of civilization which is ultimately doomed. If the politicians, therefore, would be guided by the good counsel of the devotees, then certainly there would be a great change in the world situation by the purifying propaganda of the devotees, as shown by Lord Caitanya. As Sukadeva Gosvami began his prayer by discussing the word *yat-kértanam*, so also Lord Caitanya recommended that simply by glorifying the Lord's holy name, a tremendous change of heart can take place by which the complete misunderstanding between the human nations created by politicians can at once be extinguished. And after the extinction of the fire of misunderstanding, other profits will follow. The destination is to go back home, back to Godhead, as we have several times discussed in these pages.

According to the cult of devotion, generally known as the Vaiñëava cult, there is no bar against anyone's advancing in the matter of God realization. A Vaiñëava is powerful enough to turn into a Vaiñëava even the Kiräta, etc., as above mentioned. In the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (9.32) it is said by the Lord that there is no bar to becoming a devotee of the Lord (even for those who are lowborn, or women, *sudras* or *vaisyas*), and by becoming a devotee everyone is eligible to return home, back to Godhead. The only qualification is that one take shelter of a pure devotee of the Lord who has thorough knowledge in the transcendental science of Kṛṣṇa (*Bhagavad-gita* and *Srimad-Bhagavatam*). Anyone from any part of the world who becomes well conversant in the science of Kṛṣṇa becomes a pure devotee and a spiritual master for the general mass of people and may reclaim them by

purification of heart. Though a person be even the most sinful man, he can at once be purified by systematic contact with a pure Vaiñëava. A Vaiñëava, therefore, can accept a bona fide disciple from any part of the world without any consideration of caste and creed and promote him by regulative principles to the status of a pure Vaiñëava who is transcendental to brahminical culture. The system of caste, or *varëäçrama-dharma*, is no longer regular even amongst the so-called followers of the system. Nor is it now possible to reestablish the institutional function in the present context of social, political and economic revolution. Without any reference to the particular custom of a country, one can be accepted to the Vaiñëava cult spiritually, and there is no hindrance in the transcendental process. So by the order of Lord Sri Caitanya Mahäprabhu, the cult of *Srimad-Bhagavatam* or the *Bhagavad-gita* can be preached all over the world, reclaiming all persons willing to accept the transcendental cult. Such cultural propaganda by the devotees will certainly be accepted by all persons who are reasonable and inquisitive, without any particular bias for the custom of the country. The Vaiñëava never accepts another Vaiñëava on the basis of birthright, just as he never thinks of the Deity of the Lord in a temple as an idol. And to remove all doubts in this connection, Srila Sukadeva Gosvami has invoked the blessings of the Lord, who is all-powerful (*prabhaviñëave namaù*). As the all-powerful Lord accepts the humble service of His devotee in devotional activities of the *arcana* His form as the worshipable Deity in the temple, similarly the body of a pure Vaiñëava changes transcendently at once when he gives himself up to the service of the Lord and is trained by a qualified Vaiñëava. The injunction of Vaiñëava regulation in this connection runs as follows: *arcye viñëau çilä-dhër guruñu nara-matir vaiñëave jäti-buddhiù çré-viñëor nämni çabda-sämänya-buddhiù*, etc. "One should not consider the Deity of the Lord as worshiped in the temple to be an idol, nor should one consider the authorized spiritual master an ordinary man. Nor should one consider a pure Vaiñëava to belong to a particular caste, etc." (*Padma Purana*)

The conclusion is that the Lord, being all-powerful, can, under any and every circumstance, accept anyone from any part of the world, either personally or through His bona fide manifestation as the spiritual master. Lord Caitanya accepted many devotees from communities other than the varëäçramites, and He Himself declared, to teach us, that He does not

belong to any caste or social order of life, but that He is the eternal servant of the servant of the Lord who maintains the damsels of Våndävana (Lord Kṛṣṇa). That is the way of self-realization.

TEXT 19

Sa Wz AaTMaaTMavTaaMaDaqir,
S}aYaqMaYaae DaMaRMaYaSTaPaaeMaYa")
GaTaVYal/lkE-rJaXa³raidi>a,
ivRTaKYaRil/®ae >aGavaNa(Pa[SaqdTaaMa()) 19))

sa eña ätmätmavatäm adhécvaras

trayémayo dharmamayas tapomayaù

gata-vyalékair aja-çaìkarädibhir

vitarkya-liìgo bhagavän prasédatäm

SYNONYMS

saù—He; *eñaù*—it is; *ätmä*—the Supersoul; *ätmavatäm*—of the self-realized souls; *adhécvaraù*—the Supreme Lord; *trayé-mayaù*—personified *Vedas*; *dharmamayaù*—personified religious scripture; *tapaù-mayaù*—personified austerity; *gata-vyalékaiù*—by those who are above all pretensions; *aja*—Brahmäjé; *çaìkara-ädibhiù*—by Lord Siva and others; *vitarkya-liìgaù*—one who is observed with awe and veneration; *bhagavän*—the personality of Godhead; *prasédatäm*—be kind toward me.

TRANSLATION

He is the Supersoul and the Supreme Lord of all self-realized souls. He is the personification of the Vedas, religious scriptures and austerities. He is worshiped by Lord Brahmä and Siva and all those who are transcendental to all pretensions. Being so revered with awe and veneration, may that Supreme Absolute be pleased with me.

PURPORT

The Supreme Lord, the Personality of Godhead, although the Lord of all followers of different paths of self-realization, is knowable only by those who are above all pretensions. Everyone is searching for eternal peace or eternal life, and with an aim to this destination everyone is either studying the Vedic scriptures or other religious scriptures or undergoing severe austerity as empiric philosophers, as mystics *yogis* or as unalloyed devotees, etc. But the Supreme Lord is perfectly realized only by the devotees because they are above all pretensions. Those who are on the path of self-realization are generally classified as *karmis*, *jnanis*, *yogis*, or devotees of the Lord. The *karmis*, who are much attracted by the fruitive activities of the Vedic rituals, are called *bhukti-kāmé*, or those who desire material enjoyment. The *jnanis*, who try to become one with the Supreme by mental speculation, are called *mukti-kāmé*, or those who desire liberation from material existence. The mystic *yogis*, who practice different types of austerities for attainment of eight kinds of material perfection and who ultimately meet the Supersoul (Paramātmā) in trance, are called *siddhi-kāmé*, or those who desire the perfection of becoming finer than the finest, becoming heavier than the heaviest, getting everything desired, having control over everyone, creating everything liked, etc. All these are abilities of a powerful *yogé*. But the devotees of the Lord do not want anything like that for self-satisfaction. They want only to serve the Lord because the Lord is great and as living entities they are eternally subordinate parts and parcels of the Lord. This perfect realization of the self by the devotee helps him to become desireless, to desire nothing for his personal self, and thus the devotees are called *niñkāmé*, without any desire. A living entity, by his constitutional position, cannot be void of all desires (the *bhukti-kāmé*, *mukti-kāmé* and *siddhi-kāmé* all desire something for personal satisfaction), but the *niñkāmé* devotees of the Lord desire everything for the satisfaction of the Lord. They are completely dependent on the orders of the Lord and are always ready to discharge their duty for the satisfaction of the Lord.

In the beginning Arjuna placed himself as one of those who desire self-satisfaction, for he desired not to fight in the Battle of Kurukñetra, but to make him desireless the Lord preached the *Bhagavad-gita*, in which the

ways of *karma-yoga*, *jñāna-yoga*, *hāḥa-yoga* and also *bhakti-yoga* were explained. Because Arjuna was without any pretension, he changed his decision and satisfied the Lord by agreeing to fight (*kariṇye vacanaḥ tava*) [Bg. 18.73], and thus he became desireless.

The examples of Brahmā and Lord Siva are specifically cited here because Brahmājé, Lord Siva, Srimaté Lakṣmējé and the four Kumāras (Sanaka, Sanātana, etc.) are leaders of the four desireless Vaiṣṇava *sampradāyas*. They are all freed from all pretensions. Srila Jiva Gosvami interprets the word *gata-vyalékaiḥ* as *projjhita-kaitavaiḥ*, or those who are freed from all pretensions (the unalloyed devotees only). In the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta* (**Madhya** 19.149) it is said:

*kāñḍa-bhakta—niṅkāma, ata eva 'cānta'
bhukti-mukti-siddhi-kāmé, sakali 'aṇṇānta'*

Those who are after fruitive results for their pious activities, those who desire salvation and identity with the Supreme, and those who desire material perfections of mystic power are all restless because they want something for themselves, but the devotee is completely peaceful because he has no demand for himself and is always ready to serve the desire of the Lord. The conclusion is, therefore, that the Lord is for everyone because no one can achieve the result of his respective desires without His sanction, but as stated by the Lord in **Bhagavad-gītā** (8.9), all such results are awarded by Him only, for the Lord is *adhéçvara* (the original controller) of everyone, namely the Vedāntists, the great *karma-kāṇḍéyas*, the great religious leaders, the great performers of austerity and all who are striving for spiritual advancement. But ultimately He is realized by the pretensionless devotees only. Therefore special stress is given to the devotional service of the Lord by Srila Sukadeva Gosvami.

TEXT 20

ié[Ya" PaiTaYaRjPaiTa" Pa[JaaPaiTa,
iDaRYaa& PaiTa/aeRk-PaiTaDaRraPaiTa")
PaiTaGaRiTaeNDak-v*iZ<aSaaTvTaa&
Pa[SaqdTaa& Mae >aGavaNa(SaTaa& PaiTa")) 20))

çriyaù patir yajña-patiù prajā-patir

dhiyā patir loka-patir dharā-patiù

patir gatiç cāndhaka-vāññi-sātvatā

prasēdatā me bhagavān satā patiù

SYNONYMS

çriyaù—all opulence; *patiù*—the owner; *yajña*—of sacrifice; *patiù*—the director; *prajā-patiù*—the leader of all living entities; *dhiyām*—of intelligence; *patiù*—the master; *loka-patiù*—the proprietor of all planets; *dharā*—earth; *patiù*—the supreme; *patiù*—head; *gatiù*—destination; *ca*—also; *andhaka*—one of the kings of the Yadu dynasty; *vāññi*—the first king of the Yadu dynasty; *sātvatām*—the Yadus; *prasēdatām*—be merciful; *me*—upon me; *bhagavān*—Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa; *satām*—of all devotees; *patiù*—the Lord.

TRANSLATION

May Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, who is the worshipable Lord of all devotees, the protector and glory of all the kings like Andhaka and Vāññi of the Yadu dynasty, the husband of all goddesses of fortune, the director of all sacrifices and therefore the leader of all living entities, the controller of all intelligence, the proprietor of all planets, spiritual and material, and the supreme incarnation on the earth (the supreme all in all), be merciful upon me.

PURPORT

Since Sukadeva Gosvami is one of the prominent *gata-vyalékas*, who are freed from all misconceptions, he therefore expresses his own realized perception of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa as being the sum total of all perfection, the personality of Godhead. Everyone is seeking the favor of the goddess of fortune, but people do not know that Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa is the beloved husband of all goddesses of fortune. In the *Brahma-saṁhitā* it is said that the Lord,

in His transcendental abode Goloka Våndävana, is accustomed to herding the *surabhi* cows and is served there by hundreds of thousands of goddesses of fortune. All these goddesses of fortune are manifestations of His transcendental pleasure potency (*hlädiné-çakti*) in His internal energy, and when the Lord manifested Himself on this earth He partially displayed the activities of His pleasure potency in His *räsa-lila* just to attract the conditioned souls, who are all after the phantasmagoria pleasure potency in degraded sex enjoyment. The pure devotees of the Lord like Sukadeva Gosvami, who was completely detached from the abominable sex life of the material world, discussed this act of the Lord's pleasure potency certainly not in relation to sex, but to relish a transcendental taste inconceivable to the mundaners who are after sex life. Sex life in the mundane world is the root-cause of being conditioned by the shackles of illusion, and certainly Sukadeva Gosvami was never interested in the sex life of the mundane world. Nor does the manifestation of the Lord's pleasure potency have any connection with such degraded things. Lord Caitanya was a strict *sannyäsé*, so much so that He did not allow any woman to come near Him, not even to bow down and offer respects. He never even heard the prayers of the *deva-däsés* offered in the temple of Jagannätha because a *sannyäsé* is forbidden to hear songs sung by the fair sex. Yet even in the rigid position of a *sannyäsé* He recommended the mode of worship preferred by the *gopés* of Våndävana as the topmost loving service possible to be rendered to the Lord. And Srimaté Rädhäräëé is the principal head of all such goddesses of fortune, and therefore She is the pleasure counterpart of the Lord and is nondifferent from Kṛṣṇa.

In the Vedic rituals there are recommendations for performing different types of sacrifice in order to achieve the greatest benefit in life. Such benedictions as the results of performing great sacrifices are, after all, favors given by the goddess of fortune, and the Lord, being the husband or lover of the goddess of fortune, is factually the Lord of all sacrifices also. He is the final enjoyer of all kinds of *yajña*; therefore Yajna-pati is another name of Lord Viṣṇu. It is recommended in the *Bhagavad-gita* that everything be done for the Yajna-pati (*yajñärtät karmaëaù*), for otherwise one's acts will be the cause of conditioning by the law of material nature. Those who are not freed from all misconceptions (*vyalékam*) perform sacrifices to please the minor demigods, but the devotees of the Lord know very well that Lord

Sri Kṛṣṇa is the supreme enjoyer of all performances of sacrifice; therefore they perform the *saikértana-yajña* (*ṣravaëà kértanaà viñëò* [SB 7.5.23]), which is especially recommended in this age of Kali. In Kali-yuga, performance of other types of sacrifice is not feasible due to insufficient arrangements and inexpert priesthood.

We have information from the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (3.10–11) that Lord Brahmä, after giving rebirth to the conditioned souls within the universe, instructed them to perform sacrifices and to lead a prosperous life. With such sacrificial performances the conditioned souls will never be in difficulty in keeping body and soul together. Ultimately they can purify their existence. They will find natural promotion into spiritual existence, the real identity of the living being. A conditioned soul should never give up the practice of sacrifice, charity and austerity, in any circumstances. The aim of all such sacrifices is to please the Yajna-pati, the Personality of Godhead; therefore the Lord is also Prajā-pati. According to the *Kaöha Upaniñad*, the one Lord is the leader of the innumerable living entities. The living entities are maintained by the Lord (*eko bahünäà yo vidadhāti kāmān*). The Lord is therefore called the supreme Bhūta-bhāt, or maintainer of all living beings.

Living beings are proportionately endowed with intelligence in terms of their previous activities. All living beings are not equally endowed with the same quality of intelligence because behind such development of intelligence is the control of the Lord, as declared in the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (15.15). As Paramātmä, Supersoul, the Lord is living in everyone's heart, and from Him only does one's power of remembrance, knowledge and forgetfulness follow (*mattaù smätir jñanam apohanaà ca*). One person can sharply remember past activities by the grace of the Lord while others cannot. One is highly intelligent by the grace of the Lord, and one is a fool by the same control. Therefore the Lord is Dhiyām-pati, or the Lord of intelligence.

The conditioned souls strive to become lords of the material world. Everyone is trying to lord it over the material nature by applying his highest degree of intelligence. This misuse of intelligence by the conditioned soul is called madness. One's full intelligence should be applied to get free from the material clutches. But the conditioned soul, due to madness only,

engages his full energy and intelligence in sense gratification, and to achieve this end of life he willfully commits all sorts of misdeeds. The result is that instead of attaining an unconditional life of full freedom, the mad conditioned soul is entangled again and again in different types of bondage in material bodies. Everything we see in the material manifestation is but the creation of the Lord. Therefore He is the real proprietor of everything in the universes. The conditioned soul can enjoy a fragment of this material creation under the control of the Lord, but not self-sufficiently. That is the instruction in the *Ēcōpaniñad*. One should be satisfied with things awarded by the Lord of the universe. It is out of madness only that one tries to encroach upon another's share of material possessions.

The Lord of the universe, out of His causeless mercy upon the conditioned souls, descends by His own energy (*ātma-māyā*) to reestablish the eternal relation of the conditioned souls with Him. He instructs all to surrender unto Him instead of falsely claiming to be enjoyers for a certain limit under His control. When He so descends He proves how much greater is His ability to enjoy, and He exhibits His power of enjoyment by (for instance) marrying sixteen thousand wives at once. The conditioned soul is very proud of becoming the husband of even one wife, but the Lord laughs at this; the intelligent man can know who is the real husband. Factually, the Lord is the husband of all the women in His creation, but a conditioned soul under the control of the Lord feels proud to be the husband of one or two wives.

All these qualifications as the different types of *pati* mentioned in this verse are meant for Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, and Sukadeva Gosvami has therefore especially mentioned the *pati* and *gati* of the Yadu dynasty. The members of the Yadu dynasty knew that Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa is everything, and all of them intended to return to Lord Kṛṣṇa after He had finished His transcendental pastimes on the earth. The Yadu dynasty was annihilated by the will of the Lord because its members had to return home with the Lord. The annihilation of the Yadu dynasty was a material show created by the Supreme Lord; otherwise the Lord and the members of the Yadu dynasty are all eternal associates. The Lord is therefore the guide of all devotees, and as such, Sukadeva Gosvami offered Him due respects with love-laden feelings.

TEXT 21

Yadx(g]Yai>aDYaaNaSaMaaiDaDaaETaYaa
iDaYaaNauPaXYaiNTa ih TatvMaaTMaNa")
vdiNTa cETaTa(k-vYaae YaQaaâc&
Sa Mae Mauku-Ndae >aGavaNa(Pa[SaqdTaaMa()) 21))

yad-aìghry-abhidhyāna-samādhi-dhautayā

dhiyānupaçyanti hi tattvam ātmanaù

vadanti caitat kavayo yathā-rucaà

sa me mukundo bhagavān prasédatām

SYNONYMS

yat-aìghri—whose lotus feet; *abhidhyāna*—thinking of, at every second; *samādhi*—trance; *dhautayā*—being washed off; *dhiyā*—by such clean intelligence; *anupaçyanti*—does see by following authorities; *hi*—certainly; *tattvam*—the Absolute Truth; *ātmanaù*—of the Supreme Lord and of oneself; *vadanti*—they say; *ca*—also; *etat*—this; *kavayaù*—philosophers or learned scholars; *yathā-ruca*—as he thinks; *saù*—He; *me*—mine; *mukundaù*—Lord Kṛṣṇa (who gives liberation); *bhagavān*—the Personality of Godhead; *prasédatām*—be pleased with me.

TRANSLATION

It is the Personality of Godhead Sri Kṛṣṇa who gives liberation. By thinking of His lotus feet at every second, following in the footsteps of authorities, the devotee in trance can see the Absolute Truth. The learned mental speculators, however, think of Him according to their whims. May the Lord be pleased with me.

PURPORT

The mystic *yogis*, after a strenuous effort to control the senses, may be

situated in a trance of *yoga* just to have a vision of the Supersoul within everyone, but the pure devotee, simply by remembering the Lord's lotus feet at every second, at once becomes established in real trance because by such realization his mind and intelligence are completely cleansed of the diseases of material enjoyment. The pure devotee thinks himself fallen into the ocean of birth and death and incessantly prays to the Lord to lift him up. He only aspires to become a speck of transcendental dust at the lotus feet of the Lord. The pure devotee, by the grace of the Lord, absolutely loses all attraction for material enjoyment, and to keep free from contamination he always thinks of the lotus feet of the Lord. King Kulaçekhara, a great devotee of the Lord, prayed:

*kāñëa tvadéya-pada-paikaja-paijaräntam
adyaiva me viçatu mänasa-räja-haäsaü
präëa-prayäëa-samaye kapha-väta-pittaiü
kaëöhävarodhana-vidhau smaraëaà kutas te*

“My Lord Kṛṣṇa, I pray that the swan of my mind may immediately sink down to the stems of the lotus feet of Your Lordship and be locked in their network; otherwise at the time of my final breath, when my throat is choked up with cough, how will it be possible to think of You?”

There is an intimate relationship between the swan and the lotus stem. So the comparison is very appropriate: without becoming a swan, or *paramahamsa*, one cannot enter into the network of the lotus feet of the Lord. As stated in the *Brahma-saṃhitā*, the mental speculators, even by dint of learned scholarship, cannot even dream of the Absolute Truth by speculating over it for eternity. The Lord reserves the right of not being exposed to such mental speculators. And because they cannot enter into network stem of the lotus stem of the Lord, all material speculators differ in conclusions, and at the end they make a useless compromise by saying, “as many conclusions, as many ways,” according to one's own inclination. (*yathä-rucam*). But the Lord is not like a shopkeeper trying to please all sorts of customers in the mental speculator exchange. The Lord is what He is, the Absolute Personality of Godhead, and He demands absolute surrender unto Him only. The pure devotee, however, by following the ways of previous *äcäryas*, or authorities, can see the Supreme Lord through

the transparent medium of a bona fide spiritual master (*anupaçyanti*). The pure devotee never tries to see the Lord by mental speculation, but by following in the footsteps of the *äcäryas* (*mahäjano yena gataù sa panthäù*). Therefore there is no difference of conclusions amongst the Vaiñëava *äcäryas* regarding the Lord and the devotees. Lord Caitanya asserts that the living entity (*jéva*) is eternally the servitor of the Lord and that he is simultaneously one with and different from the Lord. This *tattva* of Lord Caitanya's is shared by all four *sampradäyas* of the Vaiñëava school (all accepting eternal servitude to the Lord even after salvation), and there is no authorized Vaiñëava *äcärya* who may think of the Lord and himself as one.

This humbleness of the pure devotee, who is one hundred percent engaged in His service, puts the devotee of the Lord in a trance by which to realize everything, because to the sincere devotee of the Lord, the Lord reveals Himself, as stated in the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (10.10). The Lord, being the Lord of intelligence in everyone (even in the nondevotee), favors His devotee with proper intelligence so that automatically the pure devotee is enlightened with the factual truth about the Lord and His different energies. the Lord is revealed not by one's speculative power or by one's verbal jugglery over the Absolute Truth. Rather, He reveals Himself to a devotee when He is fully satisfied by the devotee's service attitude. Sukadeva Gosvami is not a mental speculator or compromiser of the theory of "as many ways, as many conclusions." Rather, he prays to the Lord only, invoking His transcendental pleasure. That is the way of knowing the Lord.

TEXT 22

Pa[caeidTaa YaeNa Paura SarSvTaq
ivTaNVtaajSYa SaTaq& SMa*iTa& ôid)
Svl/+a<aa Pa[adur>aUTa(ik-l/aSYaTa"
Sa Mae %ozq<aaMa*z>a" Pa[SaqdTaaMa()) 22))

pracoditā yena purā sarasvaté

vitānvatājasya satéà smātiā hādi

sva-lakṣṇāḥ prādurabhūt kilāsyatau

sa me āñṣām āñabhaū prasēdatām

SYNONYMS

pracoditā—inspired; *yena*—by whom; *purā*—in the beginning of creation; *sarasvaté*—the goddess of learning; *vitāvatā*—amplified; *ajasya*—of Brahmā, the first created living being; *satém smātim*—potent memory; *hādi*—in the heart; *sva*—in his own; *lakṣṇāḥ*—aiming at; *prādurabhūt*—was generated; *kila*—as if; *āsyatau*—from the mouth; *saū*—he; *me*—unto me; *āñṣām*—of the teachers; *āñabhaū*—the chief; *prasēdatām*—be pleased.

TRANSLATION

May the Lord, who in the beginning of the creation amplified the potent knowledge of Brahmā from within his heart and inspired him with full knowledge of creation and of His own Self, and who appeared to be generated from the mouth of Brahmā, be pleased with me.

PURPORT

As we have already discussed hereinbefore, the Lord, as the Supersoul of all living beings from Brahmā to the insignificant ant, endows all with the required knowledge potent in every living being. A living being is sufficiently potent to possess knowledge from the Lord in the proportion of fifty sixty-fourths, or seventy-eight percent of the full knowledge acquirable. Since the living being is constitutionally part and parcel of the Lord, he is unable to assimilate all the knowledge that the Lord possesses Himself. In the conditioned state, the living being is subject to forget everything after a change of body known as death. This potent knowledge is again inspired by the Lord from within the heart of every living being, and it is known as the awakening of knowledge, for it is comparable to awakening from sleep or unconsciousness. This awakening of knowledge is under the full control of the Lord, and therefore we find in the practical world different grades of knowledge in different persons. This awakening of knowledge is neither an automatic nor a material interaction. The supply source is the Lord Himself

(*dhiyää patiù*), for even Brahmä is also subject to this regulation of the supreme creator. In the beginning of the creation, Brahmä is born first without any father and mother because before Brahmä there were no other living beings. Brahmä is born from the lotus which grows from the abdomen of the Garbhodakaśāyī Viṣṇu, and therefore he is known as Aja. This Brahmä, or Aja, is also a living being, part and parcel of the Lord, but being the most pious devotee of the Lord, Brahmä is inspired by the Lord to create, subsequent to the main creation by the Lord, through the agency of material nature. Therefore neither the material nature nor Brahmä is independent of the Lord. The material scientists can merely observe the reactions of the material nature without understanding the direction behind such activities, as a child can see the action of electricity without any knowledge of the powerhouse engineer. This imperfect knowledge of the material scientist is due to a poor fund of knowledge. The Vedic knowledge was therefore first impregnated within Brahmä, and it appears that Brahmä distributed the Vedic knowledge. Brahmä is undoubtedly the speaker of the Vedic knowledge, but actually he was inspired by the Lord to receive such transcendental knowledge, as it directly descends from the Lord. The *Vedas* are therefore called *apauruṇeya*, or not imparted by any created being. Before the creation the Lord was there (*nārāyaëaù paro 'vyaktät*), and therefore the words spoken by the Lord are vibrations of transcendental sound. There is a gulf of difference between the two qualities of sound, namely *präkåta* and *apräkåta*. The physicist can deal only with the *präkåta* sound, or sound vibrated in the material sky, and therefore we must know that the Vedic sounds recorded in symbolic expressions cannot be understood by anyone within the universe unless and until one is inspired by the vibration of supernatural (*apräkåta*) sound, which descends in the chain of disciplic succession from the Lord to Brahmä, from Brahmä to Nārada, from Nārada to Vyāsa and so on. No mundane scholar can translate or reveal the true import of the Vedic *mantras* (hymns). They cannot be understood unless one is inspired or initiated by the authorized spiritual master. The original spiritual master is the Lord Himself, and the succession comes down through the sources of *paramparä*, as clearly stated in the Fourth Chapter of the *Bhagavad-gita*. So unless one receives the transcendental knowledge from the authorized *paramparä*, one should be considered useless (*viphalä matäù*), even though one may be greatly qualified in the mundane advancements of arts

or science.

Sukadeva Gosvami is praying from the Lord by dint of being inspired from within by the Lord so that he could rightly explain the facts and figures of creation as inquired by Maharaja Parikṣit. A spiritual master is not a theoretical speculator, like the mundane scholar, but is *çrotriyàà brahma-niñöham* [MU ^{iv}1.2.12].

TEXT 23

>aUTaEMaRhiÜYaR wMaa" Paurae iv>au,
iNaRMaaRYa XaeTae YadMaUzu PaUåz")
>au»e Gau<aaNa(zae@Xa zae@XaaTMak-"
Saae_l/x(k*-zqí >aGavaNa(vca&iSa Mae)) 23))

bhütair mahadbhir ya imäù puro vibhur

nirmäya çete yad amüñu püruñau

bhuikte guëän ñoðaçä ñoðaçätmakaù

so 'laikåñéñöa bhagavän vacäàsi me

SYNONYMS

bhütaiù—by the elements; *mahadbhiù*—of material creation; *yaù*—He who; *imäù*—all these; *puraù*—bodies; *vibhuù*—of the Lord; *nirmäya*—for being set up; *çete*—lie down; *yad amüñu*—one who incarnated; *püruñau*—Lord Viṣṇu; *bhuikte*—causes to be subjected; *guëän*—the three modes of nature; *ñoðaçä*—in sixteen divisions; *ñoðaçä-ätmakaù*—being the generator of these sixteen; *saù*—He; *alaikåñéñöa*—may decorate; *bhagavän*—the Personality of Godhead; *vacäàsi*—statements; *me*—mine.

TRANSLATION

May the Supreme Personality of Godhead, who enlivens the materially created bodies of the elements by lying down within the universe, and

who in His puruṣa incarnation causes the living being to be subjected to the sixteen divisions of material modes which are his generator, be pleased to decorate my statements.

PURPORT

As a fully dependent devotee, Sukadeva Gosvami (unlike a mundane man who is proud of his own capability) invokes the pleasure of the Personality of Godhead so that his statements may be successful and be appreciated by the hearers. The devotee always thinks of himself as instrumental for anything successfully carried out, and he declines to take credit for anything done by himself. The godless atheist wants to take all credit for activities, not knowing that even a blade of grass cannot move without the sanction of the Supreme Spirit, the Personality of Godhead. Sukadeva Gosvami therefore wants to move by the direction of the Supreme Lord, who inspired Brahmā to speak the Vedic wisdom. The truths described in the Vedic literatures are not theories of mundane imagination, nor are they fictitious, as the less intelligent class of men sometimes think. The Vedic truths are all perfect descriptions of the factual truth without any mistake or illusion, and Sukadeva Gosvami wants to present the truths of creation not as a metaphysical theory of philosophical speculation, but as the actual facts and figures of the subject, since he would be dictated to by the Lord exactly in the same manner as Brahmājé was inspired. As stated in the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (15.15), the Lord is Himself the father of the *Vedānta* knowledge, and it is He only who knows the factual purport of the *Vedānta* philosophy. So there is no greater truth than the principles of religion mentioned in the *Vedas*. Such Vedic knowledge or religion is disseminated by authorities like Sukadeva Gosvami because he is a humble devotional servitor of the Lord who has no desire to become a self-appointed interpreter without authority. That is the way of explaining the Vedic knowledge, technically known as the *paramparā* system, or descending process.

The intelligent man can see without mistake that any material creation (whether one's own body or a fruit or flower) cannot beautifully grow up without the spiritual touch. The greatest intelligent man of the world or the greatest man of science can present everything very beautifully only insofar

as the spirit life is there or insomuch as the spiritual touch is there. Therefore the source of all truths is the Supreme Spirit, and not gross matter as wrongly conceived by the gross materialist. We get information from the Vedic literature that the Lord Himself first entered the vacuum of the material universe, and thus all things gradually developed one after another. Similarly, the Lord is situated as localized Paramātmā in every individual being; hence everything is done by Him very beautifully. The sixteen principal creative elements, namely earth, water, fire, air, sky, and the eleven sense organs, first developed from the Lord Himself and were thereby shared by the living entities. Thus the material elements were created for the enjoyment of the living entities. The beautiful arrangement behind all material manifestations is therefore made possible by the energy of the Lord, and the individual living entity can only pray to the Lord to understand it properly. Since the Lord is the supreme entity, different from Sukadeva Gosvami, the prayer can be offered to Him. The Lord helps the living entity to enjoy material creation, but He is aloof from such false enjoyment. Sukadeva prays for the mercy of the Lord, not only for being helped personally in presenting the truth, but also for helping others to whom he would like to speak.

TEXT 24

**NaMaSTaSMaE >aGavTae vaSaudevaYa veDaSae)
PaPaujaRNaMaYa& SaaEMYaa YaNMau%aMbuåhaSavMa()) 24))**

namas tasmai bhagavate

väsudeväya vedhase

papur jñānam ayaà saumyā

yan-mukhämburuhäsavam

SYNONYMS

namaù—my obeisances; *tasmai*—unto Him; *bhagavate*—unto the Personality of Godhead; *väsudeväya*—unto Väsudeva or His incarnations;

vedhase—the compiler of the Vedic literatures; *papuù*—drunk; *jïanam*—knowledge; *ayam*—this Vedic knowledge; *saumyäu*—the devotees, especially the consorts of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *yat*—from whose; *mukha-amburuha*—the lotuslike mouth; *äsavam*—nectar from His mouth.

TRANSLATION

I offer my respectful obeisances unto Srila Vyäsadeva, the incarnation of Väsudeva who compiled the Vedic scriptures. The pure devotees drink up the nectarean transcendental knowledge dropping from the lotuslike mouth of the Lord.

PURPORT

In pursuance of the specific utterance *vedhase*, or “the compiler of the system of transcendental knowledge,” Srila Sridhara Svämé has commented that the respectful obeisances are offered to Srila Vyäsadeva, who is the incarnation of Väsudeva. Srila Jiva Gosvami has agreed to this, but Srila Visvanatha Cakravarti Öhäkura has made a further advance, namely that the nectar from the mouth of Lord Kṛṣṇa is transferred to His different consorts, and thus they learn the finer arts of music, dance, dressing, decorations and all such things which are relished by the Lord. Such music, dance and decorations enjoyed by the Lord are certainly not anything mundane, because the Lord is addressed in the very beginning as *para*, or transcendental. This transcendental knowledge is unknown to the forgotten conditioned souls. Srila Vyäsadeva, who is the incarnation of the Lord, thus compiled the Vedic literatures to revive the lost memory of the conditioned souls about their eternal relation with the Lord. One should therefore try to understand the Vedic scriptures, or the nectar transferred by the Lord to His consorts in the conjugal humor, from the lotuslike mouth of Vyäsadeva or Sukadeva. By gradual development of transcendental knowledge, one can rise to the stage of the transcendental arts of music and dance displayed by the Lord in His *räsa-lila*. But without having the Vedic knowledge one can hardly understand the transcendental nature of the Lord’s *räsa* dance and music. The pure devotees of the Lord, however, can equally relish the nectar in the form of the profound philosophical discourses and in the form of kissing by the Lord in the *räsa* dance, as there

is no mundane distinction between the two.

TEXT 25

WTadevaTMa>aU raJaNa(NaardaYa ivPa*C^Tae)
vedGa>aaeR_>YaDaaTa(Saa+aad(Yadah hirraTMaNa")) 25))

etat evätma-bhü räjan

näradäya vipâcchate

veda-garbho 'bhyadhät sākñād

yad äha harir ätmanaù

SYNONYMS

etat—on this matter; *eva*—exactly; *ätma-bhüù*—the firstborn (Brahmäjé); *räjan*—my dear King; *näradäya*—unto Nārada Muni; *vipâcchate*—having inquired about it from; *veda-garbhaù*—one who is impregnated with Vedic knowledge from birth; *abhyadhät*—apprised; *sākñät*—directly; *yad äha*—what he spoke; *hariù*—the Lord; *ätmanaù*—unto His own (Brahmä).

TRANSLATION

My dear King, Brahmä, the firstborn, on being questioned by Nārada, exactly apprised him on this subject, as it was directly spoken by the Lord to His own son, who was impregnated with Vedic knowledge from his very birth.

PURPORT

As soon as Brahmä was born of the abdominal lotus petals of Viṣṇu, he was impregnated with Vedic knowledge, and therefore he is known as *veda-garbha*, or a Vedāntist from the embryo. Without Vedic knowledge, or perfect, infallible knowledge, no one can create anything. All scientific knowledge and perfect knowledge are Vedic. One can get all types of

information from the *Vedas*, and as such, Brahmā was impregnated with all-perfect knowledge so that it was possible for him to create. Thus Brahmā knew the perfect description of creation, as it was exactly apprised to him by the Supreme Lord Hari. Brahmā, on being questioned by Nārada, told Nārada exactly what he had heard directly from the Lord. Nārada again told exactly the same thing to Vyāsa, and Vyāsa also told Sukadeva exactly what he heard from Nārada. And Sukadeva was going to repeat the same statements as he had heard them from Vyāsa. That is the way of Vedic understanding. The language of the *Vedas* can be revealed only by the above-mentioned disciplic succession, and not otherwise.

There is no use in theories. Knowledge must be factual. There are many things that are complicated, and one cannot understand them unless they are explained by one who knows. The Vedic knowledge is also very difficult to know and must be learned by the above-mentioned system; otherwise it is not at all understood.

Sukadeva Gosvami, therefore, prayed for the mercy of the Lord so that he might be able to repeat the very same message that was spoken directly by the Lord to Brahmā, or what was directly spoken by Brahmā to Nārada. Therefore the statements of creation explained by Sukadeva Gosvami are not at all, as the mundaners suggest, theoretical, but are perfectly correct. One who hears these messages and tries to assimilate them gets perfect information of the material creation.

Thus end the Bhaktivedanta purports of the Second Canto, Fourth Chapter, of the Srimad-Bhagavatam, entitled “The process of Creation.”

Chapter Five

The Cause of All Causes

TEXT 1

Naard ovac

devdev NaMaSTae_STau >aUTa>aavNa PaUvRJa)

Tad(ivJaaNaqih YaJjaNaMaaTMaTatviNadXaRNaMa()) 1))

nārada uvāca

deva-deva namas te 'stu

bhūta-bhāvana pūrvaja

tad vijānéhi yaj jñānam

ātma-tattva-nidarṇanam

SYNONYMS

nārada—Sri Nārada said; *deva*—of all demigods; *deva*—the demigod; *nama*—obeisances; *te*—unto you as; *astu*—are; *bhūta-bhāvana*—the generator of all living beings; *pūrvaja*—the firstborn; *tad vijānéhi*—please explain that knowledge; *yaj jñānam*—which knowledge; *ātma-tattva*—transcendental; *nidarṇanam*—specifically directs.

TRANSLATION

Sri Nārada Muni asked Brahmājé: O chief amongst the demigods, O firstborn living entity, I beg to offer my respectful obeisances unto you. Please tell me that transcendental knowledge which specifically directs one to the truth of the individual soul and the Supersoul.

PURPORT

The perfection of the *paramparā* system, or the path of disciplic succession, is further confirmed. In the previous chapter it has been established that Brahmājé, the firstborn living entity, received knowledge directly from the Supreme Lord, and the same knowledge was imparted to Nārada, the next disciple. Nārada asked to receive the knowledge, and Brahmājé imparted it upon being asked. Therefore, asking for transcendental knowledge from the right person and receiving it properly is the regulation of the disciplic succession. This process is recommended in the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (4.2). The

inquisitive student must approach a qualified spiritual master to receive transcendental knowledge by surrender, submissive inquiries and service. Knowledge received by submissive inquiries and service is more effective than knowledge received in exchange for money. A spiritual master in the line of disciplic succession from Brahmā and Nārada has no demand for dollars and cents. A bona fide student has to satisfy him by sincere service to obtain knowledge of the relation and nature of the individual soul and the Supersoul.

TEXT 2

Yad]UPa& YadiDaiaNa& YaTa" Sa*iiMad& Pa[>aae)
YaTSa&SQa& YaTPar& YaÀ TaTa(Tatv& vd TatvTa")) 2))

yad rūpaà yad adhiñöhänaà

yataù sãñöam idaà prabho

yat saàsthaà yat paraà yac ca

tat tattvaà vada tattvataù

SYNONYMS

yat—what; *rūpam*—the symptoms of manifestation; *yat*—what; *adhiñöhänam*—background; *yataù*—from where; *sãñöam*—created; *idam*—this world; *prabho*—O my father; *yat*—in which; *saàstham*—conserved; *yat*—what; *param*—under control; *yat*—what are; *ca*—and; *tat*—of this; *tattvam*—the symptoms; *vada*—please describe; *tattvataù*—factually.

TRANSLATION

My dear father, please describe factually the symptoms of this manifest world. What is its background? How is it created? How is it conserved? And under whose control is all this being done?

PURPORT

The inquiries by Nārada Muni on the basis of factual cause and effect appear very reasonable. The atheists, however, put forward many self-made theories without any touch of cause and effect. The manifested world, as well as the spirit soul, is still unexplained by the godless atheists through the medium of experimental knowledge, although they have put forward many theories manufactured by their fertile brains. Contrary to such mental speculative theories of creation, however, Nārada Muni wanted to know all the facts of creation in truth, and not by theories.

Transcendental knowledge regarding the soul and the Supersoul includes knowledge of the phenomenal world and the basis of its creation. In the phenomenal world three things are factually observed by any intelligent man: the living beings, the manifest world, and the ultimate control over them. The intelligent man can see that neither the living entity nor the phenomenal world are creations of chance. The symmetry of creation and its regulative actions and reactions suggests the plan of an intelligent brain behind them, and by genuine inquiry one may find out the ultimate cause with the help of one who knows them factually.

TEXT 3

Sav| èTad(>avaNa(ved >aUTa>aVYa>avTPa[>au")
k-raMal/k-vd(ivi& ivjaNaaviSaTa& Tav)) 3))

sarvaà hy etad bhavän veda

bhüta-bhavya-bhavat-prabhuù

karāmalaka-vad viçvaà

vijñānāvasitaà tava

SYNONYMS

sarvam—all and everything; *hi*—certainly; *etat*—this; *bhavän*—your good

self; *veda*—know; *bhüta*—all that is created or born; *bhavya*—all that will be created or born; *bhavat*—all that is being created; *prabhuù*—you, the master of everything; *kara-ämalaka-vat*—just like a walnut within your grip; *viçvam*—the universe; *vijjāna-avasitam*—within your knowledge scientifically; *tava*—your.

TRANSLATION

My dear father, all this is known to you scientifically because whatever was created in the past, whatever will be created in the future, or whatever is being created at present, as well as everything within the universe, is within your grip, just like a walnut.

PURPORT

Brahmā is the direct creator of the manifested universe and everything within the universe. He therefore knows what happened in the past, what will happen in the future, and what is happening at present. Three principal items, namely the living being, the phenomenal world and the controller, are all in continuous action—past, present and future—and the direct manager is supposed to know everything of such actions and reactions, as one knows about a walnut within the grip of one's palm. The direct manufacturer of a particular thing is supposed to know how he learned the art of manufacturing, where he got the ingredients, how he set it up and how the products in the manufacturing process are being turned out. Because Brahmā is the firstborn living being, naturally he is supposed to know everything about creative functions.

TEXT 4

**YaiÜjaNaae YadaDaarae YaTParSTv& YadaTMak-")
Wk-" Sa*JaiSa >aUTaaiNa >aUTaErevaTMaMaaYaYaa)) 4))**

yad-vijjāno yad-ādhāro

yat-paras tvaà yad-ātmakaù

ekaù sãjasi bhütäni

bhütair evätma-mäyayä

SYNONYMS

yat-vijñānaù—the source of knowledge; *yat-ādhāraù*—under whose protection; *yat-paraù*—under whose subordination; *tvam*—you; *yat-ātmakaù*—in what capacity; *ekaù*—alone; *sãjasi*—you are creating; *bhütäni*—the living entities; *bhütaiù*—with the help of the material elements; *eva*—certainly; *ätma*—self; *mäyayä*—by potency.

TRANSLATION

My dear father, what is the source of your knowledge? Under whose protection are you standing? And under whom are you working? What is your real position? Do you alone create all entities with material elements by your personal energy?

PURPORT

It was known to Sri Nārada Muni that Lord Brahmä attained creative energy by undergoing severe austerities. As such, he could understand that there was someone else superior to Brahmäjé who invested Brahmä with the power of creation. Therefore he asked all the above questions. Discoveries of progressive scientific achievements are therefore not independent. The scientist has to attain the knowledge of a thing already existing by means of the wonderful brain made by someone else. A scientist can work with the help of such an awarded brain, but it is not possible for the scientist to create his own or a similar brain. Therefore no one is independent in the matter of any creation, nor is such creation automatic.

TEXT 5

**AaTMaNa(>aavYaSae TaaiNa Na Para>aavYaNa(SvYaMa()
AaTMaXaiç-Maví>Ya O<aRNAai>airva©-Ma")) 5))**

ätman bhävayase täni

na paräbhävayan svayam

ätma-çaktim avañöabhya

ürëanäbhir iväklamaù

SYNONYMS

ätman (*ätmani*)—by self; *bhävayase*—manifest; *täni*—all those; *na*—not; *paräbhävayan*—being defeated; *svayam*—yourself; *ätma-çaktim*—self-sufficient power; *avañöabhya*—being employed; *ürëa-näbhiù*—the spider; *iva*—like; *aklamaù*—without help.

TRANSLATION

As the spider very easily creates the network of its cobweb and manifests its power of creation without being defeated by others, so also you yourself, by employment of your self-sufficient energy, create without any other's help.

PURPORT

The best example of self-sufficiency is the sun. The sun does not require to be illuminated by any other body. Rather, it is the sun which helps all other illuminating agents, for in the presence of the sun no other illuminating agent becomes prominent. Nārada compared the position of Brahmā to the self-sufficiency of the spider, who creates its own field of activities without any other's help by employment of its own energetic creation of saliva.

TEXT 6

**Naah& ved Par& ùiSMAàaPar& Na SaMa& iv>aee)
NaaMaæPaGau<aE>aaRVYa& SadSaTa(ik-iÄdNYaTa")) 6))**

nähaà veda paraà hy asmin

näparaà na samaà vibho

näma-rüpa-guëair bhävyaa

sad-asat kiïcid anyataù

SYNONYMS

na—do not; *aham*—myself; *veda*—know; *param*—superior; *hi*—for; *asmin*—in this world; *na*—neither; *aparam*—inferior; *na*—nor; *samam*—equal; *vibho*—O great one; *näma*—name; *rüpa*—characteristics; *guëaiù*—by qualification; *bhävvyam*—all that is created; *sat*—eternal; *asat*—temporary; *kiïcit*—or anything like that; *anyataù*—from any other source.

TRANSLATION

Whatever we can understand by the nomenclature, characteristics and features of a particular thing—superior, inferior or equal, eternal or temporary—is not created from any source other than that of Your Lordship, thou so great.

PURPORT

The manifested world is full of varieties of created beings in others. In human society the human being is considered to be the superior living being, and amongst the human beings there are also different varieties: good, bad, equal, etc. But Nārada Muni took for granted that none of them has any source of generation besides his father, Brahmäjé. Therefore he wanted to know all about them from Lord Brahmä.

TEXT 7

**Sa >avaNacrd(gaaer& YaTa(TaPa" SauSaMaaihTa")
TaeNa %edYaSae NaSTv& ParaXa³a& c YaC^iSa)) 7))**

sa bhavän acarad ghoraà

yat tapaù susamāhitaù

tena khedayase nas tvaà

parä-çaikää ca yacchasi

SYNONYMS

saù—he; *bhavän*—your good self; *acarat*—undertook; *ghoram*—severe; *yat tapaù*—meditation; *su-samāhitaù*—in perfect discipline; *tena*—for that reason; *khedayase*—gives pain; *naù*—ourselves; *tvam*—your good self; *parä*—the ultimate truth; *çaikäm*—doubts; *ca*—and; *yacchasi*—giving us a chance.

TRANSLATION

Yet we are moved to wonder about the existence of someone more powerful than you when we think of your great austerities in perfect discipline, although your good self is so powerful in the matter of creation.

PURPORT

Following in the footsteps of Sri Nārada Muni, one should not blindly accept his spiritual master as God Himself. A spiritual master is duly respected on a par with God, but a spiritual master claiming to be God Himself should at once be rejected. Nārada Muni accepted Brahmā as the Supreme due to Lord Brahmā's wonderful acts in creation, but doubts arose in him when he saw that Lord Brahmā also worshiped some superior authority. The Supreme is supreme, and He has no worshipable superior. The *ahaìgrahopäsitä*, or the one who worships himself with the idea of becoming God Himself, is misleading, but the intelligent disciple can at once detect that the Supreme God does not need to worship anyone, including Himself, in order to become God. *Ahaìgrahopäsanä* may be one of the processes for transcendental realization, but the *ahaìgrahopäsitä* can never be God Himself. No one becomes God by undergoing a process of transcendental realization. Nārada Muni thought of Brahmäjé as the

Supreme Person, but when he saw Brahmäjé engaged in the process of transcendental realization, doubts arose in him. So he wanted to be clearly informed.

TEXT 8

WTaNMae Pa*^CTa" Sav| SavRj Sak-le/ir)
ivJaaNaqih YaQaEvedMah& buDYae_NauXaaiSaTa")) 8))

etan me pācchataù sarvaà

sarva-jīa sakaleçvara

vijānéhi yathaivedam

ahaà budhye 'nuçäsitaù

SYNONYMS

etat—all those; *me*—unto me; *pācchataù*—inquisitive; *sarvam*—all that is inquired; *sarva-jīa*—one who knows everything; *sakala*—over all; *éçvara*—the controller; *vijānéhi*—kindly explain; *yathā*—as; *eva*—they are; *idam*—this; *aham*—myself; *budhye*—can understand; *anuçäsitaù*—just learning from you.

TRANSLATION

My dear father, you know everything, and you are the controller of all. Therefore may all that I have inquired from you be kindly instructed to me so that I may be able to understand it as your student.

PURPORT

The inquiries made by Nārada Muni are very important for everyone concerned, and as such Nārada requested Brahmäjé to deem them suitable so that all others who may come in the line of disciplic succession of the Brahma-sampradāya may also know them properly without any difficulty.

TEXT 9

b]øaevac

SaMYak(- k-aâi<ak-SYaed& vTSa Tae ivicik-iTSaTaMa()
Yadh& caeidTa" SaaEMYa >aGavÜqYaRdXaRNae)) 9))

brahmavāca

samyak kārūṇikasyedaà

vatsa te vicikitsitam

yad ahaà coditaù saumya

bhagavad-vérya-darçane

SYNONYMS

brahmā uvāca—Lord Brahmā said; *samyak*—perfectly; *kārūṇikasya*—of you, who are very kind; *idam*—this; *vatsa*—my dear boy; *te*—your; *vicikitsitam*—inquisitiveness; *yat*—by which; *aham*—myself; *coditaù*—inspired; *saumya*—O gentle one; *bhagavat*—of the Personality of Godhead; *vérya*—prowess; *darçane*—in the matter of.

TRANSLATION

Lord Brahmā said: My dear boy Nārada, being merciful to all (including me) you have asked all these questions because I have been inspired to see into the prowess of the Almighty Personality of Godhead.

PURPORT

Brahmājé, being so questioned by Nārada-jé, congratulated him, for it is usual for the devotees to become very enthusiastic whenever they are questioned concerning the Almighty personality of Godhead. That is the sign of a pure devotee of the Lord. Such discourses on the transcendental activities of the Lord purify the atmosphere in which such discussions are

held, and the devotees thus become enlivened while answering such questions. It is purifying both for the questioners and for one who answers the questions. The pure devotees are not only satisfied by knowing everything about the Lord, but are also eager to broadcast the information to others, for they want to see that the glories of the Lord are known to everyone. Thus the devotee feels satisfied when such an opportunity is offered to him. This is the basic principle of missionary activities.

TEXT 10

**NaaNa*Ta& Tav TaÀaiPa YaQaa Maa& Pa[b]vqiz >aae")
AivjaYa Par& Mata WTaavtv& YaTaae ih Mae)) 10))**

nānātaà tava tac cāpi

yathā mää prabavéñi bhoù

avijjāya paraà matta

etāvat tvaà yato hi me

SYNONYMS

na—not; *anātam*—false; *tava*—of yours; *tat*—that; *ca*—also; *api*—as you have stated; *yathā*—in the matter of; *mäm*—of myself; *prabavéñi*—as you describe; *bhoù*—O my son; *avijjāya*—without knowing; *param*—the Supreme; *mattaù*—beyond myself; *etāvat*—all that you have spoken; *tvam*—yourself; *yataù*—for the reason of; *hi*—certainly; *me*—about me.

TRANSLATION

Whatever you have spoken about me is not false because unless and until one is aware of the Personality of Godhead, who is the ultimate truth beyond me, one is sure to be illusioned by observing my powerful activities.

PURPORT

“The frog in the well” logic illustrates that a frog residing in the atmosphere and boundary of a well cannot imagine the length and breadth of the gigantic ocean. Such a frog, when informed of the gigantic length and breadth of the ocean, first of all does not believe that there is such an ocean, and if someone assures him that factually there is such a thing, the frog then begins to measure it by imagination by means of pumping its belly as far as possible, with the result that the tiny abdomen of the frog bursts and the poor frog dies without any experience of the actual ocean. Similarly, the material scientists also want to challenge the inconceivable potency of the Lord by measuring Him with their froglike brains and their scientific achievements, but at the end they simply die unsuccessfully, like the frog.

Sometimes a materially powerful man is accepted as God or the incarnation of God without any knowledge of the factual God. Such a material assessment may be gradually extended, and the attempt may reach to the highest limit of Brahmäjé, who is the topmost living being within the universe and has a duration of life unimaginable to the material scientist. As we get information from the most authentic book of knowledge, the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (8.17), Brahmäjé’s one day and night is calculated to be some hundreds of thousands of years on our planet. This long duration of life may not be believed by “the frog in the well,” but persons who have a realization of the truths mentioned in the *Bhagavad-gita* accept the existence of a great personality who creates the variegatedness of the complete universe. It is understood from the revealed scriptures that the Brahmäjé of this universe is younger than all the other Brahmäs in charge of the many, many universes beyond this, but none of them can be equal to the Personality of Godhead.

Näradajé is one of the liberated souls, and after his liberation he was known as Nārada; otherwise, before his liberation, he was simply a son of a maidservant. The questions may be asked why Nārada-jé was not aware of the Supreme Lord and why he mis-conceived Brahmäjé to be the Supreme Lord, although factually he was not. A liberated soul is never bewildered by such a mistaken idea, so why did Nārada-jé ask all those questions just like an ordinary man with a poor fund of knowledge? There was such bewilderment in Arjuna also, although he is eternally the associate of the

Lord. Such bewilderment in Arjuna or in Nārada takes place by the will of the Lord so that other, nonliberated persons may realize the real truth and knowledge of the Lord. The doubt arising in the mind of Nārada about Brahmājé's becoming all-powerful is a lesson for the frogs in the well, that they may not be bewildered in misconceiving the identity of the Personality of Godhead (even by comparison to a personality like Brahmā, so what to speak of ordinary men who falsely pose themselves as God or an incarnation of God). The Supreme Lord is always the Supreme, and as we have tried to establish many times in these purports, no living being, even up to the standard of Brahmā, can claim to be one with the Lord. One should not be misled when people worship a great man as God after his death as a matter of hero worship. There were many kings like Lord Rāmacandra, the King of Ayodhyā, but none of them are mentioned as God in the revealed scriptures. To be a good king is not necessarily the qualification for being Lord Rāma, but to be a great personality like Kṛṣṇa is the qualification for being the Personality of Godhead. If we scrutinize the characters who took part in the Battle of Kurukṣetra, we may find that Maharaja Yudhiñöhira was no less a pious king than Lord Rāmacandra, and by character study Maharaja Yudhiñöhira was a better moralist than Lord Kṛṣṇa. Lord Kṛṣṇa asked Maharaja Yudhiñöhira to lie, but Maharaja Yudhiñöhira protested. But that does not mean that Maharaja Yudhiñöhira could be equal to Lord Rāmacandra or Lord Kṛṣṇa. The great authorities have estimated Maharaja Yudhiñöhira to be a pious man, but they have accepted Lord Rāma or Kṛṣṇa as the Personality of Godhead. The Lord is therefore a different identity in all circumstances, and no idea of anthropomorphism can be applied to Him. The Lord is always the Lord, and a common living being can never be equal to Him.

TEXT 11

**YaeNa Svraeicza ivi& raeicTa& raecYaaMYahMa()
YaQaak-aeR_iGanYaRQaa SaaeMaae YaQa+aRGa]hTaark-a")) 11))**

yena sva-rociñā viçvaà

rocitaà rocayāmy aham

yathārko 'gnir yathä somo

yatharkñā-graha-tārakäù

SYNONYMS

yena—by whom; *sva-rociñä*—by His own effulgence; *viçvam*—all the world; *rocitam*—already created potentially; *rocayämi*—do manifest; *aham*—I; *yathä*—as much; *arkaù*—the sun; *agniù*—fire; *yathä*—as; *somaù*—the moon; *yathä*—as also; *ākñā*—the firmament; *graha*—the influential planets; *tārakäù*—the stars.

TRANSLATION

I create after the Lord's creation by His personal effulgence [known as the *brahmajyoti*], just as when the sun manifests its fire, the moon, the firmament, the influential planets and the twinkling stars also manifest their brightness.

PURPORT

Lord Brahmäjé said to Nārada that his impression that Brahmä was not the supreme authority in the creation was correct. Sometimes less intelligent men have the foolish impression that Brahmä is the cause of all causes. But Nārada wanted to clear the matter by the statements of Brahmäjé, the supreme authority in the universe. As the decision of the supreme court of a state is final, similarly the judgment of Brahmäjé, the supreme authority in the universe, is final in the Vedic process of acquiring knowledge. As we have already affirmed in the previous verse, Nārada-jé was a liberated soul; therefore, he was not one of the less intelligent men who accept a false god or gods in their own ways. He represented himself as less intelligent and yet intelligently presented a doubt to be cleared by the supreme authority so that the uninformed might take note of it and be rightly informed about the intricacies of the creation and the creator.

In this verse Brahmäjé clears up the wrong impression held by the less intelligent and affirms that he creates the universal variegatedness after

the potential creation by the glaring effulgence of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa. Brahmäjä has also separately given this statement in the *saàhitä* known as the ***Brahma-saṃhitä*** (5.40), where he says:

*yasya prabhä prabhavato jagad-aëòà-koöi-
koöiñv açeña-vasudhädi-vibhüti-bhinnam
tad brahma niñkalam anantam açeña-bhütaà
govindam ädi-puruṣaà tam ahaà bhajämi*

“I serve the Supreme Personality of Godhead Govinda, the primeval Lord, whose transcendental bodily effulgence, known as the *brahmajyoti*, which is unlimited, unfathomed and all-pervasive, is the cause of the creation of unlimited numbers of planets, etc., with varieties of climates and specific conditions of life.”

The same statement is in the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (14.27). Lord Kṛṣṇa is the background of the *brahmajyoti* (*brahmaëo hi pratiñöhäham*). In the *Nirukti*, or Vedic dictionary, the import of *pratiñöhä* is mentioned as “that which establishes.” So the *brahmajyoti* is not independent or self-sufficient. Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa is ultimately the creator of the *brahmajyoti*, mentioned in this verse as *sva-rocîñä*, or the effulgence of the transcendental body of the Lord. This *brahmajyoti* is all-pervading, and all creation is made possible by its potential power; therefore the Vedic hymns declare that everything that exists is being sustained by the *brahmajyoti* (*sarvaà khalv idaà brahma*). Therefore the potential seed of all creation is the *brahmajyoti*, and the same *brahmajyoti*, unlimited and unfathomed, is established by the Lord. Therefore the Lord (Sri Kṛṣṇa) is ultimately the supreme cause of all creation (*ahaà sarvasya prabhavaù*).

One should not expect the Lord to create like a blacksmith with a hammer and other instruments. The Lord creates by His potencies. He has His multifarious potencies (*paräsya çaktir vividhaiva çrüyate*). Just as the small seed of a banyan fruit has the potency to create a big banyan tree, the Lord disseminates all varieties of seeds by His potential *brahmajyoti* (*sva-rocîñä*), and the seeds are made to develop by the watering process of persons like Brahmä. Brahmä cannot create the seeds, but he can manifest the seed into a tree, just as a gardener helps plants and orchards to grow by the

watering process. The example cited here of the sun is very appropriate. In the material world the sun is the cause of all illumination: fire, electricity, the rays of the moon, etc. All luminaries in the sky are creations of the sun, the sun is the creation of the *brahmajyoti*, and the *brahmajyoti* is the effulgence of the Lord. Thus the ultimate cause of creation is the Lord.

TEXT 12

**TaSMaE NaMaae >aGavTae vaSaudevaYa DaqMaih)
YaNMaaYaYaa duJaRYaYaa Maa& vdiNTa JaGad(GauāMa()) 12))**

tasmai namo bhagavate

vāsudevāya dhémahi

yan-māyayā durjayayā

māà vadanti jagad-gurum

SYNONYMS

tasmai—unto Him; *namaù*—offer my obeisances; *bhagavate*—unto the Personality of Godhead; *vāsudevāya*—unto Lord Kṛṣṇa; *dhémahi*—do meditate upon Him; *yat*—by whose; *māyayā*—potencies; *durjayayā*—invincible; *mām*—unto me; *vadanti*—they say; *jagat*—the world; *gurum*—the master.

TRANSLATION

I offer my obeisances and meditate upon Lord Kṛṣṇa [Vāsudeva], the Personality of Godhead, whose invincible potency influences them [the less intelligent class of men] to call me the supreme controller.

PURPORT

As will be more clearly explained in the next verse, the illusory potency of the Lord bewilders the less intelligent to accept Brahmājé, or for that

matter any other person, as the Supreme Lord. Brahmäjé, however, refuses to be called this, and he directly offers his respectful obeisances unto Lord Väsudeva, or Sri Kṛṣṇa, the Personality of Godhead, as he has already offered the same respects to Him in the ***Brahma-saṁhitā*** (5.1):

*éçvaraù paramaù kãñëaù
sac-cid-änanda-vigrahaù
anädir ädir govindaù
sarva-käraëa-käraëam*

“The Supreme Lord is the Personality of Godhead Sri Kṛṣṇa, the primeval Lord in His transcendental body, the ultimate cause of all causes. I worship that primeval Lord Govinda.”

Brahmäjé is conscious of his actual position, and he knows how less intelligent persons, bewildered by the illusory energy of the Lord, whimsically accept anyone and everyone as God. A responsible personality like Brahmäjé refuses to be addressed as the Supreme Lord by his disciples or subordinates, but foolish persons praised by men of the nature of dogs, hogs, camels and asses feel flattered to be addressed as the Supreme Lord. Why such persons take pleasure in being addressed as God, or why such persons are addressed as God by foolish admirers, is explained in the following verse.

TEXT 13

**ivl/ÂMaaNaYaa YaSYa SQaaTauMaq+aaPaQae_MauYaa)
ivMaaeihTaa ivk-TQaNTae MaMaahiMaiTa duiDaRYa")) 13))**

vilajjamānaya yasya

sthätum ékñä-pathe ’muyä

vimohitä vikatthante

mamāham iti durdhiyaù

SYNONYMS

vilajjamānaya—by one who is ashamed; *yasya*—whose; *sthātum*—to stay; *ékñā-pathe*—in front; *amuyā*—by the bewildering energy; *vimohitāu*—those who are bewildered; *vikatthante*—talk nonsense; *mama*—it is mine; *aham*—I am everything; *iti*—thus vituperating; *durdhiyaù*—thus ill conceived.

TRANSLATION

The illusory energy of the Lord cannot take precedence, being ashamed of her position, but those who are bewildered by her always talk nonsense, being absorbed in thoughts of “It is I” and “It is mine.”

PURPORT

The invincibly powerful deluding energy of the Personality of God, or the third energy, representing nescience, can bewilder the entire world of animation, but still she is not strong enough to be able to stand in front of the Supreme Lord. Nescience is behind the Personality of Godhead, where she is powerful enough to mislead the living beings, and the primary symptom of bewildered persons is that they talk nonsense. Nonsensical talks are not supported by the principles of Vedic literatures, and first-grade nonsense talk is “It is I, it is mine.” A godless civilization is exclusively conducted by such false ideas, and such persons, without any factual realization of God, accept a false God or falsely declare themselves to be God to mislead persons who are already bewildered by the deluding energy. Those who are before the Lord, however, and who surrender unto Him, cannot be influenced by the deluding energy; therefore they are free from the misconception of “It is I, it is mine,” and therefore they do not accept a false God or pose themselves as equal to the Supreme Lord. Identification of the bewildered person is distinctly given in this verse.

TEXT 14

**d]VYa& k-MaR c k-al/ê Sv>aavae Jaqv Wv c)
vaSaudevaTParae b]øà caNYaae_QaaER_iSTa TatvTa")) 14))**

dravyaà karma ca kâlaç ca

svabhävo jéva eva ca

väsudevät paro brahman

na cänyo 'rtho 'sti tattvataù

SYNONYMS

dravyam—the ingredients (earth, water, fire, air and sky); *karma*—the interaction; *ca*—and; *kâlaù*—eternal time; *ca*—also; *sva-bhävaù*—intuition or nature; *jévaù*—the living being; *eva*—certainly; *ca*—and; *väsudevät*—from Väsudeva; *paraù*—differentiated parts; *brahman*—O *brahmana*; *na*—never; *ca*—also; *anyaù*—separate; *arthaù*—value; *asti*—there is; *tattvataù*—in truth.

TRANSLATION

The five elementary ingredients of creation, the interaction thereof set up by eternal time, and the intuition or nature of the individual living beings are all differentiated parts and parcels of the Personality of Godhead, Väsudeva, and in truth there is no other value in them.

PURPORT

This phenomenal world is impersonally the representation of Väsudeva because the ingredients of its creation, their interaction and the enjoyer of the resultant action, the living being, are all produced by the external and internal energies of Lord Kṛṣṇa. This is confirmed in the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (7.4–5). The ingredients, namely earth, water, fire, air and sky, as well as the conception of material identity, intelligence and the mind, are produced of the external energy of the Lord. The living entity who enjoys the interaction of the above gross and subtle ingredients, as set up by eternal time, is an offshoot of internal potency, with freedom to remain either in the material world or in the spiritual world. In the material world the living entity is enticed by deluding nescience, but in the spiritual world

he is in the normal condition of spiritual existence without any delusion. The living entity is known as the marginal potency of the Lord. But in all circumstances, neither the material ingredients nor the spiritual parts and parcels are independent of the Personality of Godhead Vāsudeva, for all things, whether products of the external, internal or marginal potencies of the Lord, are simply displays of the same effulgence of the Lord, just as light, heat and smoke are displays of fire. None of them are separate from the fire—all of them combine together to be called fire; similarly, all phenomenal manifestations, as well as the effulgence of the body of Vāsudeva, are His impersonal features, whereas He eternally exists in His transcendental form called *sac-cid-ānanda-vigraha* [Bs. 5.1], distinct from all conceptions of the material ingredients mentioned above.

TEXT 15

**NaaraYa<aPara veda deva NaaraYa<aa®Jaa")
NaaraYa<aPara I/aek-a NaaraYa<aPara Ma%a")) 15))**

nārāyaṇa-parā vedā

devā nārāyaṇa-āṅga-jāṇ

nārāyaṇa-parā lokā

nārāyaṇa-parā makhāṇ

SYNONYMS

nārāyaṇa—the Supreme Lord; *parāṇ*—is the cause and is meant for; *vedāṇ*—knowledge; *devāṇ*—the demigods; *nārāyaṇa*—the Supreme Lord; *āṅga-jāṇ*—assisting hands; *nārāyaṇa*—the personality of Godhead; *parāṇ*—for the sake of; *lokāṇ*—the planets; *nārāyaṇa*—the Supreme Lord; *parāṇ*—just to please Him; *makhāṇ*—all sacrifices.

TRANSLATION

The Vedic literatures are made by and are meant for the Supreme Lord,

the demigods are also meant for serving the Lord as parts of His body, the different planets are also meant for the sake of the Lord, and different sacrifices are performed just to please Him.

PURPORT

According to the *Vedānta-sūtras* (*çāstra-yonitvāt*), the Supreme Lord is the author of all revealed scriptures, and all revealed scriptures are for knowing the Supreme Lord. *Veda* means knowledge that leads to the Lord. The *Vedas* are made just to revive the forgotten consciousness of the conditioned souls, and any literature not meant for reviving God consciousness is rejected at once by the *nārāyaṇa-pāra* devotees. Such deluding books of knowledge, not having Nārāyaṇa as their aim, are not at all knowledge, but are the playgrounds for crows who are interested in the rejected refuse of the world. Any book of knowledge (science or art) must lead to the knowledge of Nārāyaṇa; otherwise it must be rejected. That is the way of advancement of knowledge. The supreme worshipable Deity is Nārāyaṇa. The demigods are recommended secondarily for worship in relation to Nārāyaṇa because the demigods are assisting hands in the management of the universal affairs. As the officers of a kingdom are respected due to their relation to the king, the demigods are worshiped due to their relation to the Lord. Without the Lord's relation, worship of the demigods is unauthorized (*avidhi-pūrvakam*), just as it is improper to water the leaves and branches of a tree without watering its root. Therefore the demigods are also dependent on Nārāyaṇa. The *lokas*, or different planets, are attractive because they have different varieties of life and bliss partially representing the *sac-cid-ānanda-vigraha* [Bs. 5.1]. Everyone wants the eternal life of bliss and knowledge. In the material world such an eternal life of bliss and knowledge is progressively realized in the upper planets, but after reaching there one is inclined to achieve further progress along the path back to Godhead. Duration of life, with a proportionate quantity of bliss and knowledge, may be increased from one planet to another. One can increase the duration of life to thousands and hundreds of thousands of years in different planets, but nowhere is there eternal life. But one who can reach the highest planet, that of Brahmā, can aspire to reach the planets in the spiritual sky, where life is eternal. Therefore, the progressive journey from one planet to another culminates in reaching the supreme

planet of the Lord (*mad-dhāma*), where life is eternal and full of bliss and knowledge. All different kinds of sacrifice are performed just to satisfy Lord Nārāyaṇa with a view to reach Him, and the best sacrifice recommended in this age of Kali is *saikértana-yajña*, the mainstay of the devotional service of a *nārāyaṇa-para* devotee.

TEXT 16

**NaaraYa<aParae YaaeGaae NaaraYa<aPar& TaPa")
NaaraYa<aPar& jaNa& NaaraYa<aPara GaiTa")) 16))**

nārāyaṇa-para yogo

nārāyaṇa-paraṁ tapaṁ

nārāyaṇa-paraṁ jñānaṁ

nārāyaṇa-parā gatiṁ

SYNONYMS

nārāyaṇa-paraṁ—just to know Nārāyaṇa; *yogaṁ*—concentration of mind;
nārāyaṇa-param—just with an aim to achieve Nārāyaṇa; *tapaṁ*—austerity;
nārāyaṇa-param—just to realize a glimpse of Nārāyaṇa; *jñānam*—culture of
transcendental knowledge; *nārāyaṇa-parā*—the path of salvation ends by
entering the kingdom of Nārāyaṇa; *gatiṁ*—progressive path.

TRANSLATION

All different types of meditation or mysticism are means for realizing Nārāyaṇa. All austerities are aimed at achieving Nārāyaṇa. Culture of transcendental knowledge is for getting a glimpse of Nārāyaṇa, and ultimately salvation is entering the kingdom of Nārāyaṇa.

PURPORT

In meditation, there are two systems of *yoga*, namely *aññāṅga-yoga* and

sāikhya-yoga. *Aññāga-yoga* is practice in concentrating the mind, releasing oneself from all engagements by the regulative processes of meditation, concentration, sitting postures, blocking the movements of the internal circulation of air, etc. *Sāikhya-yoga* is meant to distinguish the truth from ephemerals. But ultimately both the systems are meant for realizing the impersonal Brahman, which is but a partial representation of Nārāyaṇa, the Personality of Godhead. As we have explained before, the impersonal Brahman effulgence is only a part of the Personality of Godhead. Impersonal Brahman is situated on the person of the Supreme Personality of Godhead, and as such, Brahman is the glorification of the personality of the Godhead. This is confirmed both in the *Bhagavad-gītā* and in the *Matsya Purāṇa*. *Gatī* refers to the ultimate destination, or the last word in liberation. Oneness with the impersonal *brahmajyoti* is not ultimate liberation; superior to that is the sublime association of the Personality of Godhead in one of the innumerable spiritual planets in the Vaikuntha sky. Therefore the conclusion is that Nārāyaṇa, or the Personality of Godhead, is the ultimate destination for all kinds of *yoga* systems as well as all kinds of liberation.

TEXT 17

TaSYaaiPa d]íurqXaSYa kU-Ṣ=SQaSYaai%/aTMaNa")
 Sa*JYa& Sa*JaaiMa Sa*íae_hMaq+aYaEvai>acaeidTa")) 17))

tasyāpi draññour éçasya

küöa-sthasyākhilātmanaù

sājyaà sājāmi sāñño 'ham

ékñayaivābhicoditaù

SYNONYMS

tasya—His; *api*—certainly; *draññouù*—of the seer; *éçasya*—of the controller; *küöa-sthasya*—of the one who is over everyone's intelligence; *akhilā-ātmanaù*—of the Supersoul; *sājyam*—that which is already created;

sājāmi—do I discover; *sāñña*—created; *aham*—myself; *ékñayā*—by glance over; *eva*—exactly; *abhicodita*—being inspired by Him.

TRANSLATION

Inspired by Him only, I discover what is already created by Him [Nārāyaṇa] under His vision as the all-pervading Supersoul, and I also am created by Him only.

PURPORT

Even Brahmā, the creator of the universe, admits that he is not the actual creator but is simply inspired by the Lord Nārāyaṇa and therefore creates under His superintendence those things already created by Him, the Supersoul of all living entities. Two identities of soul, the Supersoul and the individual soul, are admitted to be in the living entity, even by the greatest authority of the universe. The Supersoul is the Supreme Lord, the Personality of Godhead, whereas the individual soul is the eternal servitor of the Lord. The Lord inspires the individual soul to create what is already created by the Lord, and by the good will of the Lord a discoverer of something in the world is accredited as the discoverer. It is said that Columbus discovered the Western Hemisphere, but actually the tract of land was not created by Columbus. The vast tract of land was already there by the omnipotency of the Supreme Lord, and Columbus, by dint of his past service unto the Lord, was blessed with the credit of discovering America. Similarly, no one can create anything without the sanction of the Lord, since everyone sees according to his ability. This ability is also awarded by the Lord according to one's willingness to render service unto the Lord. One must therefore be voluntarily willing to render service unto the Lord, and thus the Lord will empower the doer in proportion to his surrender unto the lotus feet of the Lord. Lord Brahmā is a great devotee of the Lord; therefore he has been empowered or inspired by the Lord to create such a universe as the one manifested before us. The Lord also inspired Arjuna to fight in the field of Kurukṣetra as follows:

*tasmāt tvam uttiñōha yaço labhasva
jitvā çatrūn bhuikñva rājyaà samāddham*

*mayai vaite nihatäù pürvam eva
nimitta-mätträà bhava savyasäcin*

(Bg. 11.33)

The Battle of Kurukñetra, or any other battle at any place or at any time, is made by the will of the Lord, for no one can arrange such mass annihilation without the sanction of the Lord. The party of Duryodhana insulted Draupadé, a great devotee of Kṛṣṇa, and she appealed to the Lord as well as to all the silent observers of this unwarranted insult. Arjuna was then advised by the Lord to fight and take credit; otherwise the party of Duryodhana would be killed anyway by the will of the Lord. So Arjuna was advised just to become the agent and take the credit for killing great generals like Bhéñma and Karëa.

In the Vedic writings such as the *Kaöha Upaniñad*, the Lord is described as the *sarva-bhüta-antarätmä*, or the Personality of Godhead who resides in everyone's body and who directs everything for one who is a soul surrendered unto Him. Those who are not surrendered souls are put under the care of the material nature (*bhrämayan sarva-bhütäni yanträrüòhäni mäyayä* [Bg. 18.61]); therefore, they are allowed to do things on their own account and suffer the consequences themselves. Devotees like Brahmä and Arjuna do not do anything on their own account, but as fully surrendered souls they always await indications from the Lord; therefore they attempt to do something which appears very wonderful to ordinary vision. One of the Lord's names is Urukrama, or one whose actions are very wonderful and are beyond the imagination of the living being, so the actions of His devotees sometimes appear very wonderful due to the direction of the Lord. Beginning from Brahmä, the topmost intelligent living entity within the universe, down to the smallest ant, every living entity's intelligence is overseen by the Lord in His transcendental position as the witness of all actions. The subtle presence of the Lord is felt by the intelligent man who can study the psychic effects of thinking, feeling and willing.

TEXT 18

Satv& rJaSTaMa wiTa iNaGauR<aSYa Gau<aañYa")
iSQaiTaSaGaRiNaraeDaezu Ga*hqTaa MaaYaYaa iv>aee")) 18))

sattvaà rajas tama iti

nirguëasya guëäs trayaù

sthiti-sarga-nirodheñu

gâhétä mäyayä vibhoù

SYNONYMS

sattvam—the mode of goodness; *rajaù*—the mode of passion; *tamaù*—the mode of ignorance; *iti*—all these; *nirguëasya*—of the Transcendence; *guëäù trayaù*—are three qualities; *sthiti*—maintenance; *sarga*—creation; *nirodheñu*—in destruction; *gâhétäù*—accepted; *mäyayä*—by the external energy; *vibhoù*—of the Supreme.

TRANSLATION

The Supreme Lord is pure spiritual form, transcendental to all material qualities, yet for the sake of the creation of the material world and its maintenance and annihilation, He accepts through His external energy the material modes of nature called goodness, passion and ignorance.

PURPORT

The Supreme Lord is the master of the external energy manifested by the three material modes, namely goodness, passion and ignorance, and as master of this energy He is ever unaffected by the influence of such bewildering energy. The living entities, the *jivas*, however, are affected by or susceptible to being influenced by such modes of material nature—that is the difference between the Lord and the living entities. The living entities are subjected by those qualities, although originally the living entities are qualitatively one with the Lord. In other words, the material modes of nature, being products of the energy of the Lord, are certainly connected

with the Lord, but the connection is just like that between the master and the servants. The Supreme Lord is the controller of the material energy, whereas the living entities, who are entangled in the material world, are neither masters nor controllers. Rather, they become subordinate to or controlled by such energy. Factually the Lord is eternally manifested by His internal potency or spiritual energy just like the sun and its rays in the clear sky, but at times He creates the material energy, as the sun creates a cloud in the clear sky. As the sun is ever increasingly unaffected by a spot of cloud, so also the unlimited Lord is unaffected by the spot of material energy manifested at times in the unlimited span of the Lord's rays of *brahmajyoti*.

TEXT 19

**k-aYaRk-ar<ak-Ta*RTve d]VYajaNaiṣ-Yaaé[Yaa")
bDNaiNTa iNaTYada Mauç&- MaaiYaNa& Pauâz& Gau<aa")) 19))**

kärya-käraëa-kartâtve

dravya-jïäna-kriyâçrayäù

badhnanti nityadä muktaà

mäyinaà puruṣaà guëäù

SYNONYMS

kärya—effect; *käraëa*—cause; *kartâtve*—in activities; *dravya*—material; *jïäna*—knowledge; *kriyâ-çrayäù*—manifested by such symptoms; *badhnanti*—conditions; *nityadä*—eternally; *mukta*—transcendental; *mäyina*—affected by material energy; *puruṣa*—the living entity; *guëäù*—the material modes.

TRANSLATION

These three modes of material nature, being further manifested as matter, knowledge and activities, put the eternally transcendental living

entity under conditions of cause and effect and make him responsible for such activities.

PURPORT

Because they are between the internal and external potencies, the eternally transcendental living entities are called the marginal potency of the Lord. Factually, the living entities are not meant to be so conditioned by material energy, but due to their being affected by the false sense of lording it over the material energy, they come under the influence of such potency and thus become conditioned by the three modes of material nature. This external energy of the Lord covers up the pure knowledge of the living entity's eternally existing with Him, but the covering is so constant that it appears that the conditioned soul is eternally ignorant. Such is the wonderful action of *māyā*, or external energy manifested as if materially produced. By the covering power of the material energy, the material scientist cannot look beyond the material causes, but factually, behind the material manifestations, there are *adhibhūta*, *adhyātma* and *adhidaiva* actions, which the conditioned soul in the mode of ignorance cannot see. The *adhibhūta* manifestation entails repetitions of births and deaths with old age and diseases, the *adhyātma* manifestation conditions the spirit soul, and the *adhidaiva* manifestation is the controlling system. These are the material manifestations of cause and effect and the sense of responsibility of the conditioned actors. They are, after all, manifestations of the conditioned state, and the human being's freedom from such a conditioned state is the highest perfectional attainment.

TEXT 20

Sa Wz >aGavaicm®Eiñi>areTaErDaae+aJa")
Svl/i+aTaGaiTab]RøNa(SaveRza& MaMa ceir")) 20))

sa eña bhagavâu liṅgais

tribhir etair adhokñajau

svalakñita-gatir brahman

sarveñää mama ceçvaraù

SYNONYMS

saù—He; *eñaù*—this; *bhagavän*—the Personality of Godhead; *liìgaiù*—by the symptoms; *tribhiù*—by the three; *etaiù*—by all these; *adhokñajaù*—the Superseer Transcendence; *su-alakñita*—veritably unseen; *gatiù*—movement; *brahman*—O Nārada; *sarveñäm*—of everyone; *mama*—mine; *ca*—as also; *éçvaraù*—the controller.

TRANSLATION

O Brähmaëa Nārada, the Superseer, the transcendent Lord, is beyond the perception of the material senses of the living entities because of the above-mentioned three modes of nature. But He is the controller of everyone, including me.

PURPORT

In the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (7.24–25) the Lord has declared very clearly that the impersonalist, who gives more importance to the transcendental rays of the Lord as *brahmajyoti* and who concludes that the Absolute Truth is ultimately impersonal and only manifests a form at a time of necessity, is less intelligent than the personalist, however much the impersonalist may be engaged in studying the *Vedānta*. The fact is that such impersonalists are covered by the above-mentioned three modes of material nature; therefore, they are unable to approach the transcendental Personality of the Lord. The Lord is not approachable by everyone because He is curtailed by His *yogamäyā* potency. But one should not wrongly conclude that the Lord was formerly unmanifested and has now manifested Himself in the human form. This misconception of the formlessness of the Supreme Personality of Godhead is due to the *yogamäyā* curtain of the Lord and can be removed only by the Supreme Will, as soon as the conditioned soul surrenders unto Him. The devotees of the Lord who are transcendental to the above-mentioned three modes of material nature can see the all-blissful transcendental form of the Lord with their vision of love in the attitude of pure devotional service.

TEXT 21

k-al&/ k-MaR Sv>aav& c MaaYaeXaae MaaYaYaa SvYaa)
AaTMaNa(Yad*C^Yaa Pa[aá& ivbu>aUzuåPaadde)) 21))

kālaà karma svabhāvaà ca

māyeço māyayā svayā

ātman yadācchayā prāptaà

vibubhūñur upādade

SYNONYMS

kālam—eternal time; *karma*—the fate of the living entity; *svabhāvam*—nature; *ca*—also; *māyā*—potency; *éçaù*—the controller; *māyayā*—by the energy; *svayā*—of His own; *ātman* (*ātmani*)—unto His Self; *yadācchayā*—independently; *prāptam*—being merged in; *vibubhūñuù*—appearing differently; *upādade*—accepted for being created again.

TRANSLATION

The Lord, who is the controller of all energies, thus creates, by His own potency, eternal time, the fate of all living entities, and their particular nature, for which they were created, and He again merges them independently.

PURPORT

The creation of the material world, wherein the conditioned souls are allowed to act subordinately by the Supreme Lord, takes place again and again after being repeatedly annihilated. The material creation is something like a cloud in the unlimited sky. The real sky is the spiritual sky, eternally filled with the rays of the *brahmajyoti*, and a portion of this unlimited sky is covered by the *mahat-tattva* cloud of the material creation, in which the conditioned souls, who want to lord it against the will of the Lord, are put

into play as they desire under the control of the Lord by the agency of His external energy. As the rainy season appears and disappears regularly, the creation takes place and is again annihilated under the control of the Lord, as confirmed in the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (8.19). So the creation and annihilation of the material worlds is a regular action of the Lord just to allow the conditioned souls to play as they like and thereby create their own fate of being differently created again in terms of their independent desires at the time of annihilation. The creation, therefore, takes place at a historical date (as we are accustomed to think of everything which has a beginning in our tiny experience). The process of creation and annihilation is called *anādi*, or without reference to date regarding the time the creation first took place, because the duration of even a partial creation is 8,640,000,000 years. The law of creation is, however, as mentioned in the Vedic literatures, that it is created at certain intervals and is again annihilated by the will of the Lord. The whole material or even the spiritual creation is a manifestation of the energy of the Lord, just as the light and heat of a fire are different manifestations of the fire's energy. The Lord therefore exists in His impersonal form by such expansion of energy, and the complete creation rests on His impersonal feature. Nonetheless He keeps Himself distinct from such creation as the *pūrëam* (or complete), and so no one should wrongly think that His personal feature is not existent due to His impersonal unlimited expansions. The impersonal expansion is a manifestation of His energy, and He is always in His personal feature despite His innumerable unlimited expansions of impersonal energies (Bg. 9.5–7). For human intelligence it is very difficult to conceive how the whole creation rests on His expansion of energy, but the Lord has given a very good example in the *Bhagavad-gita*. It is said that although the air and the atoms rest within the huge expansion of the sky, which is like the resting reservoir of everything materially created, still the sky remains separate and unaffected. Similarly although the Supreme Lord maintains everything created by His expansion of energy, He always remains separate. This is accepted even by Çaikarācārya, the great advocate of the impersonal form of the Absolute. He says *nārāyaëau paro 'vyaktät*, or Nārāyaṇa exists separately, apart from the impersonal creative energy. The whole creation thus merges within the body of transcendental Nārāyaṇa at the time of annihilation, and the creation emanates from His body again with the same unchanging categories of fate and individual nature. The individual living

entities, being parts and parcels of the Lord, are sometimes described as *ātmā*, qualitatively one in spiritual constitution. But because such living entities are apt to be attracted to the material creation, actively and subjectively, they are therefore different from the Lord.

TEXT 22

**k-al/ad(Gau<aVYaiTak-r" Pair<aaMa" Sv>aavTa")
k-MaR<aae JaNMa MahTa" PauâzaiDaiïTaad>aUTa()) 22))**

käläd guëa-vyatikaraù

pariëämaù svabhävataù

karmaëo janma mahataù

puruñädhiñöhität abhüt

SYNONYMS

kälät—from eternal time; *guëa-vyatikaraù*—transformation of the modes by reaction; *pariëämaù*—transformation; *svabhävataù*—from the nature; *karmaëaù*—of activities; *janma*—creation; *mahataù*—of the *mahat-tattva*; *puruṣa-adhiñöhität*—because of the *puruṣa* incarnation of the Lord; *abhüt*—it took place.

TRANSLATION

After the incarnation of the first puruṣa [Käraëärëavaçäyë Viṣṇu], the mahat-tattva, or the principles of material creation, take place, and then time is manifested, and in course of time the three qualities appear. Nature means the three qualitative appearances. They transform into activities.

PURPORT

By the omnipotency of the Supreme Lord, the whole material creation

evolves by the process of transformation and reactions one after another, and by the same omnipotency, they are wound up again one after another and conserved in the body of the Supreme. *Kāla*, or time, is the synonym of nature and is the transformed manifestation of the principles of material creation. As such, *kāla* may be taken as the first cause of all creation, and by transformation of nature different activities of the material world become visible. These activities may be taken up as the natural instinct of each and every living being, or even of the inert objects, and after the manifestation of activities there are varieties of products and by-products of the same nature. Originally these are all due to the Supreme Lord. The *Vedānta-sūtras* and the *Bhāgavatam* thus begin with the Absolute Truth as the beginning of all creations (*janmādy asya yataù* [SB 1.1.1]).

TEXT 23

**MahTaSTau ivku-vaR<aad]Ja"SatvaePab*&ihTaaTa()
TaMa"Pa[DaaNaSTv>avd(d]VYajaNai§-YaaTMak-")) 23))**

mahatas tu vikurväëäd

rajaù-sattvopabâàhität

tamaù-pradhānas tv abhavad

dravya-jīāna-kriyātmakaù

SYNONYMS

mahataù—of the *mahat-tattva*; *tu*—but; *vikurväëät*—being transformed; *rajaù*—the material mode of passion; *sattva*—the mode of goodness; *upabâàhität*—because of being increased; *tamaù*—the mode of darkness; *pradhānaù*—being prominent; *tu*—but; *abhavat*—took place; *dravya*—matter; *jīāna*—material knowledge; *kriyā-ātmakaù*—predominantly material activities.

TRANSLATION

Material activities are caused by the mahat-tattva's being agitated. At first there is transformation of the modes of goodness and passion, and later—due to the mode of ignorance—matter, its knowledge, and different activities of material knowledge come into play.

PURPORT

Material creations of every description are more or less due to the development of the mode of passion (*rajas*). The *mahat-tattva* is the principle of material creation, and when it is agitated by the will of the Supreme at first the modes of passion and goodness are prominent, and afterwards the mode of passion, being generated in due course by material activities of different varieties, becomes prominent, and the living entities are thus involved more and more in ignorance. Brahmā is the representation of the mode of passion, and Viṣṇu is the representation of the mode of goodness, while the mode of ignorance is represented by Lord Siva, the father of material activities. Material nature is called the mother, and the initiator for materialistic life is the father, Lord Siva. All material creation by the living entities is therefore initiated by the mode of passion. With the advancement of the duration of life in a particular millennium, the different modes act by gradual development. In the age of Kali (when the mode of passion is most prominent) material activities of different varieties, in the name of advancement of human civilization, take place, and the living entities become more and more involved in forgetting their real identity—the spiritual nature. By a slight cultivation of the mode of goodness, a glimpse of spiritual nature is perceived, but due to the prominence of the mode of passion, the mode of goodness becomes adulterated. Therefore one cannot transcend the limits of the material modes, and therefore realization of the Lord, who is always transcendental to the modes of material nature, becomes very difficult for the living entities, even though prominently situated in the mode of goodness through cultivation of the various methods. In other words, the gross matters are *adhibhūtam*, their maintenance is *adhidaivam*, and the initiator of material activities is called *adhyātmam*. In the material world these three principles act as prominent features, namely as raw material, its regular supplies, and its use in different varieties of material creations for sense enjoyment by the bewildered entities.

TEXT 24

Saae_h³ar wiTa Pa[aeç-ae ivku-vRNa(SaMa>aUiT}aDaa)
vEk-airk-STaEJaSaê TaaMaSaêeiTa YaiÛda)
d]VYaXaiç-" iṣ-YaaXaiç-jaRNaXaiç-iriTa Pa[>aae)) 24))

so 'haikāra iti prokto

vikurvan samabhūt tridhā

vaikārikas taijasaç ca

tāmasaç ceti yad-bhidā

dravya-çaktiù kriyā-çaktir

jñāna-çaktir iti prabho

SYNONYMS

saù—the very same thing; *ahaikāraù*—ego; *iti*—thus; *proktaù*—said; *vikurvan*—being transformed; *samabhūt*—became manifested; *tridhā*—in three features; *vaikārikaù*—in the mode of goodness; *taijasaù*—in the mode of passion; *ca*—and; *tāmasaù*—in the mode of ignorance; *ca*—also; *iti*—thus; *yat*—what is; *bhidā*—divided; *dravya-çaktiù*—powers that evolve matter; *kriyā-çaktiù*—initiation that creates; *jñāna-çaktiù*—intelligence that guides; *iti*—thus; *prabho*—O master.

TRANSLATION

The self-centered materialistic ego, thus being transformed into three features, becomes known as the modes of goodness, passion and ignorance in three divisions, namely the powers that evolve matter, knowledge of material creations, and the intelligence that guides such materialistic activities. Nārada, you are quite competent to understand this.

PURPORT

Materialistic ego, or the sense of identification with matter, is grossly self-centered, devoid of clear knowledge of the existence of God. And this self-centered egoism of the materialistic living entities is the cause of their being conditioned by the other paraphernalia and continuing their bondage of material existence. In the *Bhagavad-gita* this self-centered egoism is very nicely explained in the Seventh Chapter (verses 24 through 27). The self-centered impersonalist, without a clear conception of the personality of Godhead, concludes in his own way that the personality of Godhead takes a material shape from His original impersonal spiritual existence for a particular mission. And this misleading conception of the Supreme Lord by the self-centered impersonalist continues, even though he is seen to be very interested in the Vedic literatures such as the *Brahma-sūtras* and other highly intellectual sources of knowledge. This ignorance of the personal feature of the Lord is due simply to ignorance of the mixture of different modes. The impersonalist thus cannot conceive of the Lord's eternal spiritual form of eternal knowledge, bliss and existence. The reason is that the Lord reserves the right of not exposing Himself to the nondevotee who, even after a thorough study of literature like the *Bhagavad-gita*, remains an impersonalist simply by obstinacy. This obstinacy is due to the action of *yogamāyā*, a personal energy of the Lord that acts like an aide-de-camp by covering the vision of the obstinate impersonalist. Such a bewildered human being is described as *mūḍha*, or grossly ignorant, because he is unable to understand the transcendental form of the Lord as being unborn and unchangeable. If the Lord takes a form or material shape from His original impersonal feature, then it means that He is born and changeable from impersonal to personal. But He is not changeable. Nor does He ever take a new birth like a conditioned soul. The conditioned soul may take a form birth after birth due to his conditional existence in matter, but the self-centered impersonalists, by their gross ignorance, accept the Lord as one of them because of self-centered egoism, even after so-called advancement of knowledge in the *Vedānta*. The Lord, being situated in the heart of every individual living entity, knows very well the tendency of such conditioned souls in terms of past, present and future, but the bewildered conditioned soul hardly can know Him in His eternal form. By the will of the Lord, therefore, the impersonalist, even

after knowing the Brahman and Paramātmā features of the Lord, remains ignorant of His eternal personal feature as ever-existent Nārāyaṇa, transcendental to all material creation.

The cause of such gross ignorance is constant engagement by the materialistic man in the matter of artificially increasing material demands. To realize the Supreme Personality of Godhead, one has to purify the materialistic senses by devotional service. The mode of goodness, or the brahminical culture recommended in the Vedic literatures, is helpful to such spiritual realization, and thus the *jñāna-çakti* stage of the conditioned soul is comparatively better than the other two stages, namely *dravya-çakti* and *kriyā-çakti*. The whole material civilization is manifested by a huge accumulation of materials, or, in other words, raw materials for industrial purposes, and the industrial enterprises (*kriyā-çakti*) are all due to gross ignorance of spiritual life. In order to rectify this great anomaly of materialistic civilization, based on the principles of *dravya-çakti* and *kriyā-çakti*, one has to adopt the process of devotional service of the Lord by adoption of the principles of *karma-yoga*, mentioned in the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (9.27) as follows:

*yat karoṇi yad aṇāsi
yaj juhoṇi dadāsi yat
yat tapasyasi kaunteya
tat kuruṇva mad-arpaṇam*

“O son of Kunté, all that you do, all that you eat, all that you offer and give away, as well as all austerities that you may perform, should be done as an offering unto Me.”

TEXT 25

TaaMaSaadiPa >aUTaadeivRku-vaR<aad>aUà>a")
TaSYa Maa}aa Gau<a" XaBdae il/®& Yad(d]í*d*XYaYaae")) 25))

tāmasād api bhūtāder

vikurvāēd abhūn nabhaù

tasya mātrā guëaù çabdo

liìgaà yad drañöå-dåçyayouù

SYNONYMS

tāmasāt—from the darkness of false ego; *api*—certainly; *bhūta-ādeu*—of the material elements; *vikurvāëät*—because of transformation; *abhūt*—generated; *nabhaù*—the sky; *tasya*—its; *mātrā*—subtle form; *guëaù*—quality; *çabdaù*—sound; *liìgam*—characteristics; *yat*—as its; *drañöå*—the seer; *dåçyayouù*—of what is seen.

TRANSLATION

From the darkness of false ego, the first of the five elements, namely the sky, is generated. Its subtle form is the quality of sound, exactly as the seer is in relationship with the seen.

PURPORT

The five elements, namely sky, air, fire, water and earth, are all but different qualities of the darkness of false ego. This means that the false ego in the sum total form of *mahat-tattva* is generated from the marginal potency of the Lord, and due to this false ego of lording it over the material creation, ingredients are generated for the false enjoyment of the living being. The living being is practically the dominating factor over the material elements as the enjoyer, though the background is the Supreme Lord. Factually, save and except the Lord, no one can be called the enjoyer, but the living entity falsely desires to become the enjoyer. This is the origin of false ego. When the bewildered living being desires this, the shadow elements are generated by the will of the Lord, and the living entities are allowed to run after them as after a phantasmagoria.

It is said that first the *tan-mātrā* sound is created and then the sky, and in this verse it is confirmed that actually it is so, but sound is the subtle form of the sky, and the distinction is like that between the seer and the seen. The sound is the representation of the actual object, as the sound produced

speaking of the object gives an idea of the description of the object. Therefore sound is the subtle characteristic of the object. Similarly, sound representation of the Lord, in terms of His characteristics, is the complete form of the Lord, as was seen by Vasudeva and Maharaja Daçaratha, the fathers of Lord Kṛṣṇa and Lord Rāma. The sound representation of the Lord is nondifferent from the Lord Himself because the Lord and His representation in sound are absolute knowledge. Lord Caitanya has instructed us that in the holy name of the Lord, as sound representation of the Lord, all the potencies of the Lord are invested. Thus one can immediately enjoy the association of the Lord by the pure vibration of the sound representation of His holy name, and the concept of the Lord is immediately manifested before the pure devotee. A pure devotee, therefore, is not aloof from the Lord even for a moment. The holy name of the Lord, as recommended in the *sastras*—Hare Kṛṣṇa, Hare Kṛṣṇa, Kṛṣṇa Kṛṣṇa, Hare Hare/ Hare Rāma, Hare Rāma, Rāma Rāma, Hare Hare—may therefore be constantly chanted by the devotee aspiring to be constantly in touch with the Supreme Lord. One who is thus able to associate with the Lord is sure to be delivered from the darkness of the created world, which is a product of false ego (*tamasi mā jyotir gama*).

TEXTS 26–29

Na>aSaae_Qa ivku-vaR<aad>aUTa(SPaXaRGau<aae_iNaI/")
 ParaNvYaaC^Bdva&ê Pa[a<a AaeJa" Sahae bl/Ma()) 26))
 vaYaaeriPa ivku-vaR<aaTa(k-al/k-MaRSv>aavTa")
 odPaÛTa TaeJaae vE æPavTa(SPaXaRXaBdvTa()) 27))
 TaeJaSaSTau ivku-vaR<aadaSaqdM>aae rSaaTMak-Ma()
 æPavTa(SPaXaRvÀaM>aae gaaevÀ ParaNvYaaTa()) 28))
 ivXaezSTau ivku-vaR<aadM>aSaae GaNDavaNa>aUTa()
 ParaNvYaad(rSaSPaXaRXaBdæPaGau<aaINvTa")) 29))

nabhaso 'tha vikurväëäd

abhüt sparça-guëo 'nilaù

paränvayäc chabdaväàç ca

präëa ojaù saho balam

väyor api vikurväëät

käla-karma-svabhävataù

udapadyata tejo vai

rüpavat sparça-çabdavat

tejasas tu vikurväëäd

äséd ambho rasätmakam

rüpavat sparçavac cāmbho

ghoñavac ca parānvayät

viçeñas tu vikurväëäd

ambhaso gandhavān abhüt

parānvayäd rasa-sparça-

çabda-rüpa-guëānvitaù

SYNONYMS

nabhasaù—of the sky; *atha*—thus; *vikurväëät*—being transformed; *abhüt*—generated; *sparça*—touch; *guëaù*—quality; *anilaù*—air; *para*—previous; *anvayät*—by succession; *çabdavān*—full of sound; *ca*—also; *präëaù*—life; *ojaù*—sense perception; *sahaù*—fat; *balam*—strength; *väyoù*—of the air; *api*—also; *vikurväëät*—by transformation; *käla*—time; *karma*—reaction of the past; *svabhävataù*—on the basis of nature; *udapadyata*—generated; *tejaù*—fire; *vai*—duly; *rüpavat*—with form; *sparça*—touch; *çabdavat*—with sound also; *tejasau*—of the fire; *tu*—but; *vikurväëät*—on being transformed; *äsét*—it so happened; *ambhaù*—water;

rasa-ätmakam—composed of juice; *rüpavat*—with form; *sparçavat*—with touch; *ca*—and; *ambhaù*—water; *ghoñavat*—with sound; *ca*—and; *para*—previous; *anvayät*—by succession; *viçeñaù*—variegatedness; *tu*—but; *vikurväëät*—by transformation; *ambhasaù*—of water; *gandhavän*—odorous; *abhüt*—became; *para*—previous; *anvayät*—by succession; *rasa*—juice; *sparça*—touch; *çabda*—sound; *rüpa-guëa-anvitaù*—qualitative.

TRANSLATION

Because the sky is transformed, the air is generated with the quality of touch, and by previous succession the air is also full of sound and the basic principles of duration of life: sense perception, mental power and bodily strength. When the air is transformed in course of time and nature’s course, fire is generated, taking shape with the sense of touch and sound. Since fire is also transformed, there is a manifestation of water, full of juice and taste. As previously, it also has form and touch and is also full of sound. And water, being transformed from all variegatedness on earth, appears odorous and, as previously, becomes qualitatively full of juice, touch, sound and form respectively.

PURPORT

The whole process of creation is an act of gradual evolution and development from one element to another, reaching up to the variegatedness of the earth as so many trees, plants, mountains, rivers, reptiles, birds, animals and varieties of human beings. The quality of sense perception is also evolutionary, namely generated from sound, then touch, and from touch to form. Taste and odor are also generated along with the gradual development of sky, air, fire, water and earth. They are all mutually the cause and effect of one another, but the original cause is the Lord Himself in plenary portion, as Mahä-Viṣṇu lying in the causal water of the *mahat-tattva*. As such, Lord Kṛṣṇa is described in the *Brahma-saṃhitā* as the cause of all causes, and this is confirmed in the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (10.8) as follows:

*ahaà sarvasya prabhavo
mattaù sarvaà pravartate*

*iti matvä bhajante mää
budhä bhäva-samanvitäù*

The qualities of sense perception are fully represented in the earth, and they are manifested in other elements to a lesser extent. In the sky there is sound only, whereas in the air there are sound and touch. In the fire there are sound, touch and shape, and in the water there is taste also, along with the other perceptions, namely sound, touch and shape. In the earth, however, there are all the above-mentioned qualities with an extra development of odor also. Therefore on the earth there is a full display of variegatedness of life, which is originally started with the basic principle of air. Diseases of the body take place due to derangement of air within the earthly body of the living beings. Mental diseases result from special derangement of the air within the body, and as such, yogic exercise is especially beneficial to keep the air in order so that diseases of the body become almost nil by such exercises. When they are properly done the duration of life also increases, and one can have control over death also by such practices. A perfect *yogé* can have command over death and quit the body at the right moment, when he is competent to transfer himself to a suitable planet. The *bhakti-yogi*, however, surpasses all the *yogis* because, by dint of his devotional service, he is promoted to the region beyond the material sky and is placed in one of the planets in the spiritual sky by the supreme will of the Lord, the controller of everything.

TEXT 30

**vEk-airk-aNMaNaæ Jaje deva vEk-airk-a dXa)
idGvaTaakR-Pa[ceTaaë_ïivöqNd]æPaeNd]iMa}ak-a")) 30))**

vaikārikān mano jajīe

devā vaikārikā daça

dig-vätārka-praceto 'çvi-

vahnéndropendra-mitra-käù

SYNONYMS

vaikārikāt—from the mode of goodness; *manaù*—the mind; *jajïe*—generated; *deväù*—demigods; *vaikārikäù*—in the mode of goodness; *daça*—ten; *dik*—the controller of directions; *vāta*—the controller of air; *arka*—the sun; *pracetaù*—Varuëa; *açvi*—the Açviné-kumāras; *vahni*—the fire-god; *indra*—the King of heaven; *upendra*—the deity in heaven; *mitra*—one of the twelve Ādityas; *käù*—Prajāpati Brahmä.

TRANSLATION

From the mode of goodness the mind is generated and becomes manifest, as also the ten demigods controlling the bodily movements. Such demigods are known as the controller of directions, the controller of air, the sun-god, the father of Dakña Prajāpati, the Açviné-kumāras, the fire-god, the King of heaven, the worshipable deity in heaven, the chief of the Ādityas, and Brahmäjé, the Prajāpati. All come into existence.

PURPORT

Vaikārika is the neutral stage of creation, and *tejas* is the initiative of creation, while *tamas* is the full display of material creation under the spell of the darkness of ignorance. Manufacture of the “necessities of life” in factories and workshops, excessively prominent in the age of Kali, or in the age of the machine, is the summit stage of the quality of darkness. Such manufacturing enterprises by human society are in the mode of darkness because factually there is no necessity for the commodities manufactured. Human society primarily requires food for subsistence, shelter for sleeping, defense for protection, and commodities for satisfaction of the senses. The senses are the practical signs of life, as will be explained in the next verse. Human civilization is meant for purifying the senses, and objects of sense satisfaction should be supplied as much as absolutely required, but not for aggravating artificial sensory needs. Food, shelter, defense and sense gratification are all needs in material existence. Otherwise, in his pure, uncontaminated state of original life, the living entity has no such needs. The needs are therefore artificial, and in the pure state of life there are no such needs. As such, increasing the artificial needs, as is the standard of

material civilization, or advancing the economic development of human society, is a sort of engagement in darkness, without knowledge. By such engagement, human energy is spoiled, because human energy is primarily meant for purifying the senses in order to engage them in satisfying the senses of the Supreme Lord. The Supreme Lord, being the supreme possessor of spiritual senses, is the master of the senses, *Hāñékeça*. *Hāñéka* means the senses, and *éça* means the master. The Lord is not the servant of the senses, or, in other words, He is not directed by the dictation of the senses, but the conditioned souls or the individual living entities *are* servants of the senses. They are conducted by the direction or dictation of the senses, and therefore material civilization is a kind of engagement in sense gratification only. The standard of human civilization should be to cure the disease of sense gratification, and one can do this simply by becoming an agent for satisfying the spiritual senses of the Lord. The senses are never to be stopped in their engagements, but one should purify them by engaging them in the pure service of sense gratification of the master of the senses. This is the instruction of the whole *Bhagavad-gita*. Arjuna wanted first of all to satisfy his own senses by his decision not to fight with his kinsmen and friends, but Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa taught him the *Bhagavad-gita* just to purify Arjuna's decision for sense gratification. Therefore Arjuna agreed to satisfy the senses of the Lord, and thus he fought the Battle of Kurukñetra, as the Lord desired.

The *Vedas* instruct us to get out of the existence of darkness and go forward on the path of light (*tamasi mā jyotir gama*). The path of light is therefore to satisfy the senses of the Lord. Misguided men, or less intelligent men, follow the path of self-realization without any attempt to satisfy the transcendental senses of the Lord by following the path shown by Arjuna and other devotees of the Lord. On the contrary, they artificially try to stop the activities of the senses (*yoga* system), or they deny the transcendental senses of the Lord (*jñāna* system). The devotees, however, are above the *yogis* and the *jnanis* because pure devotees do not deny the senses of the Lord; they want to satisfy the senses of the Lord. Only because of the darkness of ignorance do the *yogis* and *jnanis* deny the senses of the Lord and thus artificially try to control the activities of the diseased senses. In the diseased condition of the senses there is too much engagement of the senses in increasing material needs. When one comes

to see the disadvantage of aggravating the sense activities, one is called a *jñānē*, and when one tries to stop the activities of the senses by the practice of yogic principles, he is called a *yogi*, but when one is fully aware of the transcendental senses of the Lord and tries to satisfy His senses, one is called a devotee of the Lord. The devotees of the Lord do not try to deny the senses of the Lord, nor do they artificially stop the actions of the senses. But they do voluntarily engage the purified senses in the service of the master of the senses, as was done by Arjuna, thereby easily attaining the perfection of satisfying the Lord, the ultimate goal of all perfection.

TEXT 31

TaEJaSaaTa(Tau ivku-vaR<aaidiNd]Yaai<a dXaa>avNa()
jaNaXaiç-" iṣ-YaaXaiç-buRiÖ" Pa[a<aê TaEJaSaaE)
é[ae}a& TvGga]a<ad*iGJaûa vaGdaeMaeR!\ax(iga]PaaYav")) 31))

taijasāt tu vikurvääd

indriyäëi daçäbhavan

jñāna-çaktiù kriyā-çaktir

buddhiù prāëaç ca taijasau

çrotraà tvag-ghrāëa-dåg-jihvä

väg-dor-meòhräighri-päyavaù

SYNONYMS

taijasāt—by the passionate egoism; *tu*—but; *vikurvääd*—transformation of; *indriyäëi*—the senses; *daça*—ten; *abhavan*—generated; *jñāna-çaktiù*—the five senses for acquiring knowledge; *kriyā-çaktiù*—the five senses of activities; *buddhiù*—intelligence; *prāëaù*—the living energy; *ca*—also; *taijasau*—all products of the mode of passion; *çrotram*—the sense for hearing; *tvak*—the sense for touching; *ghrāëa*—the sense for smelling; *dåk*—the sense for seeing; *jihväù*—the sense for tasting; *väk*—the sense for

speaking; *dou*—the sense for handling; *meòhra*—the genitals; *aìghri*—the legs; *päyavaù*—the sense for evacuating.

TRANSLATION

By further transformation of the mode of passion, the sense organs like the ear, skin, nose, eyes, tongue, mouth, hands, genitals, legs, and the outlet for evacuating, together with intelligence and living energy, are all generated.

PURPORT

The living condition in material existence depends more or less on one's intelligence and powerful living energy. Intelligence to counteract the hard struggle for existence is assisted by the senses for acquiring knowledge, and the living energy maintains himself by manipulating the active organs, like the hands and legs. But on the whole, the struggle for existence is an exertion of the mode of passion. Therefore all the sense organs, headed by intelligence and the living energy, *präëa*, are different products and by-products of the second mode of nature, called passion. This mode of passion, however, is the product of the air element, as described before.

TEXT 32

**YadETae_Sa®Taa >aava >aUTaeiNd]YaMaNaaeGau<aa")
YadaYaTaNaNaMaaR<ae Na Xaeku-b]RøivtaMa)) 32))**

yadaite 'saìgatä bhävä

bhütendriya-mano-guëäù

yadäyatana-nirmäëe

na çekur brahma-vittama

SYNONYMS

yadä—as long as; *ete*—all these; *asaìgatäù*—without being assembled; *bhäväù*—remained so situated; *bhüta*—elements; *indriya*—senses; *manaù*—mind; *guëäù*—modes of nature; *yadä*—so long; *äyatana*—the body; *nirmäëe*—in being formed; *na çekuù*—was not possible; *brahma-vit-tama*—O Nārada, the best knower of transcendental knowledge.

TRANSLATION

O Nārada, best of the transcendentalists, the forms of the body cannot take place as long as these created parts, namely the elements, senses, mind and modes of nature, are not assembled.

PURPORT

The different types of bodily construction of the living entities are exactly like different types of motorcars manufactured by assembling the allied motor parts. When the car is ready, the driver sits in the car and moves it as he desires. This is also confirmed in the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (18.61): the living entity is as if seated on the machine of the body, and the car of the body is moving by the control of material nature, just as the railway trains are moving under the direction of the controller. The living entities, however, are not the bodies; they are separate from the cars of the body. But the less intelligent material scientist cannot understand the process of assembling the parts of the body, namely the senses, the mind and the qualities of the material modes. Every living entity is a spiritual spark, part and parcel of the Supreme Being, and by the kindness of the Lord, for the Father is kind to His sons, the individual living beings are given a little freedom to act according to their will to lord it over the material nature. Just as a father gives some playthings to the crying child to satisfy him, the whole material creation is made possible by the will of the Lord to allow the bewildered living entities to lord it over things as they desire, although under the control of the agent of the Lord. The living entities are exactly like small children playing the material field under the control of the maidservant of the Lord (nature). They accept the *mäyä*, or the maidservant, as all in all and thus wrongly conceive the Supreme Truth to be feminine (goddess Durgä, etc.). The foolish, childlike materialists cannot reach beyond the conception of the maidservant, material nature, but the intelligent grown-

up sons of the Lord know well that all the acts of material nature are controlled by the Lord, just as a maidservant is under the control of the master, the father of the undeveloped children.

The parts of the body, such as the senses, are the creation of the *mahat-tattva*, and when they are assembled by the will of the Lord, the material body comes into existence, and the living entity is allowed to use it for further activities. This is explained as follows.

TEXT 33

**Tada Sa&hTYa caNYaaeNYa& >aGavC^iç-caeidTaa")
SadSatvMauPaadaYa cae>aYa& SaSa*JauùRd")) 33))**

tadä saàhatya cānyonyaà

bhagavac-chakti-coditäu

sad-asattvam upädäya

cobhayaà sasåjur hy adaù

SYNONYMS

tadä—all those; *saàhatya*—being assembled; *ca*—also; *anyonyam*—one another; *bhagavat*—by the Personality of Godhead; *çakti*—energy; *coditäu*—being applied; *sat-asattvam*—primarily and secondarily; *upädäya*—accepting; *ca*—also; *ubhayam*—both; *sasåjuù*—came into existence; *hi*—certainly; *adaù*—this universe.

TRANSLATION

Thus when all these became assembled by force of the energy of the Supreme Personality of Godhead, this universe certainly came into being by accepting both the primary and secondary causes of creation.

PURPORT

In this verse it is clearly mentioned that the Supreme Personality of Godhead exerts His different energies in the creation; it is not that He Himself is transformed into material creations. He expands Himself by His different energies, as well as by His plenary portions. In a corner of the spiritual sky of *brahmajyoti* a spiritual cloud sometimes appears, and the covered portion is called the *mahat-tattva*. The Lord then, by His plenary portion as Mahā-Viṣṇu, lies down within the water of the *mahat-tattva*, and the water is called the Causal Ocean (Kāraṇa-jala). While Mahā-Viṣṇu sleeps within the Causal Ocean, innumerable universes are generated along with His breathing. These universes are floating, and they are scattered all over the Causal Ocean. They stay only during the breathing period of Mahā-Viṣṇu. In each and every universal globe, the same Mahā-Viṣṇu enters again as Garbhodakaśāyī Viṣṇu and lies there on the serpentlike Ćeña incarnation. From His navel sprouts a lotus stem, and on the lotus, Brahmā, the lord of the universe, is born. Brahmā creates all forms of living beings of different shapes in terms of different desires within the universe. He also creates the sun, moon and other demigods.

Therefore the chief engineer of the material creation is the Lord Himself, as confirmed in the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (9.10). It is He only who directs the material nature to produce all sorts of moving and nonmoving creations.

There are two modes of material creation: the creation of the collective universes, as stated above, done by the Mahā-Viṣṇu, and the creation of the single universe. Both are done by the Lord, and thus the universal shape, as we can see, takes place.

TEXT 34

vzRPaUGaSahóaN^Taē Tad<@Maudke-XaYaMa()
k-al/k-MaRSv>aavSQaaē Jaqvae_Ja^qvMaJa^qvYaTa()) 34))

varña-pūga-sahasrānte

tad aēòam u^dake çayam

kāla-karma-svabhāva-stho

jévo 'jévam ajévayat

SYNONYMS

varña-püga—many years; *sahasra-ante*—of thousands of years; *tat*—that; *aëðam*—the universal globe; *udake*—in the causal water; *çayam*—being drowned; *käla*—eternal time; *karma*—action; *svabhäva-sthaù*—according to the modes of nature; *jévaù*—the Lord of the living beings; *ajévam*—nonanimated; *ajévayat*—caused to be animated.

TRANSLATION

Thus all the universes remained thousands of eons within the water [the Causal Ocean], and the Lord of living beings, entering in each of them, caused them to be fully animated.

PURPORT

The Lord is described here as the *jéva* because He is the leader of all other *jivas* (living entities). In the *Vedas* He is described as the *nitya*, the leader of all other *nityas*. The Lord's relation with the living entities is like that of the father with the sons. The sons and the father are qualitatively equal, but the father is never the son, nor is the son ever the father who begets. So, as described above, the Lord as Garbhodakaśāyī Viṣṇu or Hiraëyagarbha Supersoul enters into each and every universe and causes it to be animated by begetting the living entities within the womb of the material nature, as confirmed in the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (14.3). After each annihilation of the material creation, all the living entities are merged within the body of the Lord, and after creation they are again impregnated within the material energy. In material existence, therefore, the material energy is seemingly the mother of the living entities, and the Lord is the father. When, however, the animation takes place, the living entities revive their own natural activities under the spell of time and energy, and thus the varieties of living beings are manifested. The Lord, therefore, is ultimately the cause of all animation in the material world.

TEXT 35

Sa Wv PauåzSTaSMaad<@& iNai>aRÛ iNaGaRTa")
SahóaeVRx(iga]baû+a" SahóaNaNaxaqzRvaNa()) 35))

sa eva puruṣas tasmād

aëðaañ nirbhidyā nirgatau

sahasrorv-aighri-bāhv-akñau

sahasrānana-çérñavān

SYNONYMS

saù—He (the Lord); *eva*—Himself; *puruṣau*—the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *tasmāt*—from within the universe; *aëðam*—Hiraëyagarbha; *nirbhidyā*—dividing; *nirgatau*—came out; *sahasra*—thousands; *üru*—thighs; *aighri*—legs; *bāhu*—arms; *akñau*—eyes; *sahasra*—thousands of; *ānana*—mouths; *çérñavān*—with heads also.

TRANSLATION

The Lord [Mahā-Viṣṇu], although lying in the Causal Ocean, came out of it, and dividing Himself as Hiraëyagarbha, He entered into each universe and assumed the *virāṭ-rūpa*, with thousands of legs, arms, mouths, heads, etc.

PURPORT

The expansions of the planetary systems within each and every universe are situated in the different parts of the *virāṭ-rūpa* (universal form) of the Lord, and they are described as follows.

TEXT 36

YaSYaehavYavEI/aeRk-aNa(k-LPaYaiNTa MaNaqiz<a")
k-Şyaidi>arDa" Saá Saáaeß| JagaNaaidi>a")) 36))

yasyehāvayavair lokān

kalpayanti manéñiëaù

kaöy-ädibhir adhaù sapta

saptordhvaà jaghanädibhiù

SYNONYMS

yasya—whose; *iha*—in the universe; *avayavaiù*—by the limbs of the body; *lokän*—all the planets; *kalpayanti*—imagine; *manéñiëaù*—great philosophers; *kaöi-ädibhiù*—down from the waist; *adhaù*—downwards; *sapta*—seven systems; *sapta ürdhvam*—and seven systems upwards; *jaghana-ädibhiù*—front portion.

TRANSLATION

Great philosophers imagine that the complete planetary systems in the universe are displays of the different upper and lower limbs of the universal body of the Lord.

PURPORT

The word *kalpayanti*, or “imagine,” is significant. The *viräö* universal form of the Absolute is an imagination of the speculative philosophers who are unable to adjust to the eternal two-handed form of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa. Although the universal form, as imagined by the great philosophers, is one of the features of the Lord, it is more or less imaginary. It is said that the seven upper planetary systems are situated above the waist of the universal form, whereas the lower planetary systems are situated below His waist. The idea impressed herein is that the Supreme Lord is conscious of every part of His body, and nowhere in the creation is there anything beyond His control.

TEXT 37

**PauâzSYa Mau%& b]ø +a}aMaeTaSYa bahv")
OvaeRvCEXYaae >aGavTa" PaÜya& éUd]ae VYaJaaYaTa)) 37))**

puruṣasya mukhaà brahma

kñātram etasya bāhavaù

ürvor vaiçyo bhagavataù

padbhyäà çüdro vyajāyata

SYNONYMS

puruṣasya—of the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *mukham*—mouth; *brahma*—is the *brahmanas*; *kñātram*—the royal order; *etasya*—of Him; *bāhavaù*—the arms; *ürvoù*—the thighs; *vaiçyaù*—are the mercantile men; *bhagavataù*—of the Personality of Godhead; *padbhyäm*—from His legs; *çüdraù*—the laborer class; *vyajāyata*—became manifested.

TRANSLATION

The brahmanas represent His mouth, the kṣatriyas His arms, the vaiśyas His thighs, and the sudras are born of His legs.

PURPORT

All living beings are stated to be the parts and parcels of the Supreme Lord, and how they are so is explained in this verse. The four divisions of human society, namely the intelligent class (the *brahmanas*), the administrative class (the *kṣatriyas*), the mercantile class (the *vaiśyas*), and the laborer class (the *sudras*), are all in different parts of the body of the Lord. As such, no one is different from the Lord. The mouth of the body and the legs of the body are nondifferent constitutionally, but the mouth or the head of the body is qualitatively more important than the legs. At the same time, the mouth, the legs, the arms and the thighs are all component parts of the body. These limbs of the body of the Lord are meant to serve the complete whole. The mouth is meant for speaking and eating, the arms are meant for the protection of the body, the legs are meant for carrying the body, and the waist of the body is meant for maintaining the body. The intelligent class in society, therefore, must speak on behalf of the body, as well as

accept foodstuff to satisfy the hunger of the body. The hunger of the Lord is to accept the fruits of sacrifice. The *brahmanas*, or the intelligent class, must be very expert in performing such sacrifices, and the subordinate classes must join in such sacrifices. To speak for the Supreme Lord means to glorify the Lord by means of propagating the knowledge of the Lord as it is, broadcasting the factual nature of the Lord and the factual position of all other parts of the whole body. The *brahmanas*, therefore, are required to know the *Vedas*, or the ultimate source of knowledge. *Veda* means knowledge, and *anta* means the end of it. According to *Bhagavad-gita*, the Lord is the source of everything (*ahaà sarvasya prabhavaù*), and thus the end of all knowledge (*Vedänta*) is to know the Lord, to know our relationship with Him and to act according to that relationship only. The parts of the body are related to the body; similarly, the living being must know his relationship with the Lord. The human life is especially meant for this purpose, namely to know the factual relationship of every living being with the Supreme Lord. Without knowing this relationship, the human life is spoiled. The intelligent class of men, the *brahmanas*, are therefore especially responsible for broadcasting this knowledge of our relationship with the Lord and leading the general mass of people to the right path. The administrative class is meant for protecting the living beings so that they can serve this purpose; the mercantile class is meant for producing food grains and distributing them to the complete human society so that the whole population is given a chance to live comfortably and discharge the duties of human life. The mercantile class is also required to give protection to the cows in order to get sufficient milk and milk products, which alone can give the proper health and intelligence to maintain a civilization perfectly meant for knowledge of the ultimate truth. And the laborer class, who are neither intelligent nor powerful, can help by physical services to the other higher classes and thus be benefited by their cooperation. Therefore the universe is a complete unit in relationship with the Lord, and without this relationship with the Lord the whole human society is disturbed and is without any peace and prosperity. This is confirmed in the *Vedas*: *brähmaëo 'sya mukham äséd, bähü räjänyaù kåtaù*.

TEXT 38

>aUI/aeRk-" k-iLPaTa" PaÜya& >auvl/aeRk-ae_SYa Naai>aTa")

ôda SvI/aeRk- orSaa Mahl/aeRk-ae MahaTMaNa")) 38))

bhürlokaù kalpitaù padbhyäà

bhuvarloko 'sya näbhitaù

hådä svarloka urasä

maharloko mahätmanaù

SYNONYMS

bhüù—the lower planetary systems up to the stratum of the earth; *lokaù*—the planets; *kalpitaù*—it is so imagined or said; *padbhyäm*—out of the legs; *bhuvaù*—the upper; *lokaù*—the planetary system; *asya*—of Him (the Lord); *näbhitaù*—from the navel abdomen; *hådä*—by the heart; *svarlokaù*—the planetary systems occupied by the demigods; *urasä*—by the chest; *maharlokaù*—the planetary system occupied by great sages and saints; *mahä-ätmanaù*—of the Supreme Personality of Godhead.

TRANSLATION

The lower planetary systems, up to the limit of the earthly stratum, are said to be situated in His legs. The middle planetary systems, beginning from Bhuvārloka, are situated in His navel. And the still higher planetary systems, occupied by the demigods and highly cultured sages and saints, are situated in the chest of the Supreme Lord.

PURPORT

There are fourteen spheres of planetary systems within this universe. The lower systems are called Bhürloka, the middle systems are called Bhuvarloka, and the higher planetary systems, up to Brahmaloka, the highest planetary system of the universe, are called Svarloka. And all of them are situated on the body of the Lord. In other words, no one within this universe is without a relationship with the Lord.

TEXT 39

Ga]qvaYaa& JaNal/aek-ae_SYa TaPaael/aek-" STaNaÜYaaTa()
MaUDaRi>a" SaTYal/aek-STau b]øl/aek-" SaNaaTaNa")) 39))

gréväyää janaloko 'sya

tapolokaù stana-dvayät

mürdhabhiù satyalokas tu

brahmalokaù sanätanaù

SYNONYMS

gréväyäm—up to the neck; *janalokaù*—the Janaloka planetary system; *asya*—of Him; *tapolokaù*—the Tapoloka planetary system; *stana-dvayät*—beginning from the breast; *mürdhabhiù*—by the head; *satyalokaù*—the Satyaloka planetary system; *tu*—but; *brahmalokaù*—the spiritual planets; *sanätanaù*—eternal.

TRANSLATION

From the forefront of the chest up to the neck of the universal form of the Lord are situated the planetary systems named Janaloka and Tapoloka, whereas Satyaloka, the topmost planetary system, is situated on the head of the form. The spiritual planets, however, are eternal.

PURPORT

Many times in these pages we have discussed the spiritual planets situated beyond the material sky, and the description is corroborated in this verse. The word *sanätana* is significant. This very idea of eternity is expressed in the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (8.20), where it is said that beyond the material creation is the spiritual sky, where everything is eternal. Sometimes Satyaloka, the planet in which Brahmä resides, is also called Brahmaloka. But the Brahmaloka mentioned here is not the same as the Satyaloka

planetary system. This Brahmaloka is eternal, whereas the Satyaloka planetary system is not eternal. And to distinguish between the two, the adjective *sanātana* has been used in this case. According to Srila Jiva Gosvami, this Brahmaloka is the *loka* or abode of Brahman, or the Supreme Lord. In the spiritual sky all the planets are as good as the Lord Himself. The Lord is all spirit, and His name, fame, glories, qualities, pastimes, etc., are all nondifferent from Him because He is absolute. As such, the planets in the kingdom of God are also nondifferent from Him. In those planets there is no difference between the body and the soul, nor is there any influence of time as we experience it in the material world. And in addition to there being no influence of time, the planets in, Brahmaloka, due to being spiritual, are never annihilated. All variegatedness in the spiritual planets is also one with the Lord, and therefore the Vedic aphorism *ekam evādvitéyam* is fully realized in that *sanātana* atmosphere of spiritual variegatedness. This material world is only a shadow phantasmagoria of the spiritual kingdom of the Lord, and because it is a shadow it is never eternal; the variegatedness in the material world of duality (spirit and matter) cannot be compared to that of the spiritual world. Because of a poor fund of knowledge, less intelligent persons sometimes mistake the conditions of the shadow world to be equivalent to those of the spiritual world, and thus they mistake the Lord and His pastimes in the material world to be one with the conditioned souls and their activities. The Lord condemns such less intelligent persons in the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (9.11):

*avajānanti māṃ mūḍhā
mānuṣṇéa tanum āçritam
paraṃ bhāvam ajānanto
mama bhūta-maheçvaram*

Whenever the Lord incarnates, He does so in His full internal potency (*ātma-māyā*), and less intelligent persons mistake Him to be one of the material creations. Srila Sridhara Svāmé, therefore, rightly commenting on this verse, says that the Brahmaloka mentioned here is Vaikuntha, the kingdom of God, which is *sanātana*, or eternal, and is therefore not exactly like the material creations described above. The *virāḍ* universal form of the Lord is an imagination for the material world. It has nothing to do with the spiritual world, or the kingdom of God.

TEXTS 40–41

TaTk-Ṣya& caTal&/ œáMaUå>Yaa& ivTal&/ iv>aae")
JaaNau>Yaa& SauTal&/ éuÖ& Jaªa>Yaa& Tau Tal/aTal/Ma()) 40))
MahaTal&/ Tau GauLf-a>Yaa& Pa[Pada>Yaa& rSaaTal/Ma()
PaaTaal&/ PaadTal/Ta wiTa l/aek-MaYa" PauMaaNa()) 41))

tat-kaöyää cātalaà kṛptam

ūrubhyāà vitalaà vibhoù

jānubhyāà sutalaà çuddhaà

jaighābhyāà tu talātaḥ

mahātalaà tu gulphābhyāà

prapadābhyāà rasātaḥ

pātālaà pāda-talata

iti lokamayaù pumān

tat—in His; *kaöyām*—waist; *ca*—also; *atalam*—the first planetary system below the earth; *kṛptam*—situated; *ūrubhyām*—on the thighs; *vitalam*—the second planetary system below; *vibhoù*—of the Lord; *jānubhyām*—on the ankles; *sutalam*—the third planetary system below; *çuddham*—purified; *jaighābhyām*—on the joints; *tu*—but; *talātaḥ*—the fourth planetary system below; *mahātalam*—the fifth planetary system below; *tu*—but; *gulphābhyām*—situated on the calves; *prapadābhyām*—on the upper or front portion of the feet; *rasātaḥ*—the sixth planetary system below; *pātālam*—the seventh planetary system below; *pāda-talataù*—on the bottom or soles of the feet; *iti*—thus; *loka-mayaù*—full of planetary systems; *pumān*—the Lord.

TRANSLATION

My dear son Nārada, know from me that there are seven lower planetary systems out of the total fourteen. The first planetary system, known as Atala, is situated on the waist; the second, Vitala, is situated on the thighs; the third, Sutala, on the knees; the fourth, Talātala, on the shanks; the fifth, Mahātala, on the ankles; the sixth, Rasātala, on the upper portion of the feet; and the seventh, Pātāla, on the soles of the feet. Thus the virāḍ form of the Lord is full of all planetary systems.

PURPORT

Modern enterprisers (the astronauts who travel in space) may take information from *Srimad-Bhagavatam* that in space there are fourteen divisions of planetary systems. The situation is calculated from the earthly planetary system, which is called Bhūrloka. Above Bhūrloka is Bhuvarloka, and the topmost planetary system is called Satyaloka. These are the upper seven *lokas*, or planetary systems. And similarly, there are seven lower planetary systems, known as Atala, Vitala, Sutala, Talātala, Mahātala, Rasātala and Pātāla *lokas*. All these planetary systems are scattered over the complete universe, which occupies an area of two billion times two billion square miles. The modern astronauts can travel only a few thousand miles away from the earth, and therefore their attempt to travel in the sky is something like child's play on the shore of an expansive ocean. The moon is situated in the third status of the upper planetary system, and in the Fifth Canto of *Srimad-Bhagavatam* we shall be able to know the distant situation of the various planets scattered over the vast material sky. There are innumerable universes beyond the one in which we are put, and all these material universes cover only an insignificant portion of the spiritual sky, which is described above as *sanātana* Brahmaloka. The Supreme Lord very kindly invites the intelligent human beings to return home, back to Godhead, in the following verse of the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (8.16):

*ä-brahma-bhuvanäl lokäù
punar ävartino 'rjuna
mäm upetya tu kaunteya
punar janma na vidyate*

Beginning from Satyaloka, the topmost planet of the universe, situated just

below the eternal Brahmaloka, as described above, all the planets are material. And one's situation in any of the many material planets is still subject to the laws of material nature, namely birth, death, old age and disease. But one can get complete liberation from all the above-mentioned material pangs when one enters into the eternal Brahmaloka *sanātana* atmosphere, the kingdom of God. Therefore liberation, as contemplated by the speculative philosophers and the mystics, is possible only when one becomes a devotee of the Lord. Anyone who is not a devotee cannot enter into the kingdom of God. Only by attainment of a service attitude in the transcendental position can one enter into the kingdom of Godhead. Therefore the speculative philosophers, as well as the mystics, must first of all be attracted to the devotional cult before they can factually attain liberation.

TEXT 42

>aUI/aeRk-" k-iLPaTa" PaÛya& >auvl/aeRk-ae_SYa Naai>aTa")
Svl/aeRk-" k-iLPaTaae MaUDNaaR wiTa va l/aeK-k-LPaNaa)) 42))

bhūrlokaù kalpitaù padbhyäà

bhuvarloko 'sya nābhitaù

svarlokaù kalpito mürdhnä

iti vä loka-kalpanä

SYNONYMS

bhūrlokaù—the entire planetary system from Pätäla to the earthly planetary system; *kalpitaù*—imagined; *padbhyäm*—situated on the legs; *bhuvarlokaù*—the Bhuvarloka planetary system; *asya*—of the universal form of the Lord; *nābhitaù*—out of the navel abdomen; *svarlokaù*—the higher planetary system, beginning with the heavenly planets; *kalpitaù*—imagined; *mürdhnä*—from the chest to the head; *iti*—thus; *vä*—either; *loka*—the planetary systems; *kalpanä*—imagination.

TRANSLATION

Others may divide the whole planetary system into three divisions, namely the lower planetary systems on the legs [up to the earth], the middle planetary systems on the navel, and the upper planetary systems [Svarloka] from the chest to the head of the Supreme Personality.

PURPORT

The three divisions of the complete planetary systems are here mentioned; fourteen are imagined by others, and that is also explained.

Thus end the Bhaktivedanta purports of the Second Canto, Fifth Chapter, of the Srimad-Bhagavatam, entitled "The Cause of All Causes."

Chapter Six

Puruña-sūkta Confirmed

TEXT 1

b]øaevac

vaca& vöeMauR%& +ae}a& ^NdSaa& Saá DaaTav")
hVYak-VYaaMa*TaaàaNaa& iJaûa SavRrSaSYa c)) 1))

brahmaväca

väcäà vahner mukhaà kñetraà

chandasäà sapta dhätavaù

havya-kavyämâtännänäà

jihvä sarva-rasasya ca

SYNONYMS

brahmā uvāca—Lord Brahmā said; *vācām*—of the voice; *vahneù*—of fire; *mukham*—the mouth; *kñetram*—the generating center; *chandasām*—of the Vedic hymns, such as Gāyatrī; *sapta*—seven; *dhātavaù*—skin and six other layers; *havya-kavya*—offerings for the demigods and the forefathers; *amāta*—food for human beings; *annānām*—of all sorts of foodstuffs; *jihvā*—the tongue; *sarva*—all; *rasasya*—of all delicacies; *ca*—also.

TRANSLATION

Lord Brahmā said: The mouth of the virāo-puruṣa [the universal form of the Lord] is the generating center of the voice, and the controlling deity is fire. His skin and six other layers are the generating centers of the Vedic hymns, and His tongue is the productive center of different foodstuffs and delicacies for offering to the demigods, the forefathers and the general mass of people.

PURPORT

The opulences of the universal form of the Lord are described herein. It is said that His mouth is the generating center of all kinds of voices, and its controlling deity is the fire demigod. And His skin and other six layers of bodily construction are the representative generating centers of the seven kinds of Vedic hymns, like the Gāyatrī. Gāyatrī is the beginning of all Vedic *mantras*, and it is explained in the first volume of *Srimad-Bhagavatam*. Since the generating centers are the different parts of the universal form of the Lord, and since the form of the Lord is transcendental to the material creation, it is to be understood that the voice, the tongue, the skin, etc., suggest that the Lord in His transcendental form is not without them. The material voice, or the energy of taking in foodstuff, is generated originally from the Lord; such actions are but perverted reflections of the original reservoirs—the transcendental situation is not without spiritual variegatedness. In the spiritual world, all the perverted forms of material variegatedness are fully represented in their original spiritual identity. The only difference is that material activities are contaminated by the three modes of material nature, whereas the potencies in the spiritual world are all pure because they are engaged in the unalloyed transcendental loving service of the Lord. In the spiritual world, the Lord is the sublime enjoyer of

everything, and the living entities there are all engaged in His transcendental loving service without any contamination of the modes of material nature. The activities in the spiritual world are without any of the inebrieties of the material world, but there is no question of impersonal voidness on the spiritual platform, as suggested by the impersonalists. Devotional service is defined in the *Nārada-pāicarātra* as follows:

*sarvopādhi-vinirmuktaà
tat-paratvena nirmalam
hãñékeëa hãñékeça-
sevanaà bhaktir ucyate
[Cc. Madhya 19.170]*

Originally, since all the senses are produced of the Lord's reservoir of senses, the sensual activities of the material world are to be purified by the process of devotional service, and thus the perfection of life can be attained simply by purifying the present position of our material activities. And the purifying process begins from the stage of being liberated from the conception of different designations. Every living entity is engaged in some sort of service, either for the self, or for the family, or for the society, country, etc., but, unfortunately, all such services are rendered due to material attachment. The attachments of the material affinity may be simply changed to the service of the Lord, and thus the treatment of being freed from material attachment begins automatically. The process of liberation is therefore easier through devotional service than by any other methods, for in the *Bhagavad-gita* (12.5) it is said that one is subjected to various kinds of tribulations if one is impersonally attached: *kleço 'dhikataras teñäm avyaktäsakta-cetasäm*.

TEXT 2

**SavaRSaUNaa& c vaYaaeê TaàaSae ParMaaYa<ae)
AiiNaaeraezDaqNaa& c ga]a<aae MaaedPa[MaaedYaae")) 2))**

sarväsünää ca väyoç ca

tan-näse paramäyaëe

açvinor oñadhénää ca

ghräëo moda-pramodayoù

SYNONYMS

sarva—all; *asünäm*—different kinds of life air; *ca*—and; *väyòu*—of the air; *ca*—also; *tat*—His; *näse*—in the nose; *parama-äyaëe*—in the transcendental generating center; *açvinoù*—of the Açviné-kumära demigods; *oñadhénäm*—of all medicinal herbs; *ca*—also; *ghräëaù*—His smelling power; *moda*—pleasure; *pramodayoù*—specific sport.

TRANSLATION

His two nostrils are the generating centers of our breathing and of all other airs, His smelling powers generate the Açviné-kumära demigods and all kinds of medicinal herbs, and His breathing energies produce different kinds of fragrance.

TEXT 3

æPaa<aa& TaeJaSaa& c+auidRv" SaUYaRSYa cai+a<aq)
k-<aaŒ idXaa& c TaqQaaRNaa& é[ae}aMaak-aXaXaBdYaae")) 3))

rüpäëää tejasää cakñur

divaù süryasya cäkñiëé

karëau diçää ca térthänää

çrotram äkäça-çabdayoù

SYNONYMS

rüpäëäm—for all kinds of forms; *tejasäm*—of all that is illuminating; *cakñuù*—the eyes; *divaù*—that which glitters; *süryasya*—of the sun; *ca*—also; *akñiëé*—the eyeballs; *karëau*—the ears; *diçäm*—of all directions; *ca*—

and; *térthänäm*—of all the *Vedas*; *çrotram*—the sense of hearing; *äkäça*—the sky; *çabdayo*—of all sounds.

TRANSLATION

His eyes are the generating centers of all kinds of forms, and they glitter and illuminate. His eyeballs are like the sun and the heavenly planets. His ears hear from all sides and are receptacles for all the Vedas, and His sense of hearing is the generating center of the sky and of all kinds of sound.

PURPORT

The word *térthänäm* is sometimes interpreted to mean the places of pilgrimage, but Srila Jiva Gosvami says that it means the reception of the Vedic transcendental knowledge. The propounders of the Vedic knowledge are also known as the *térthas*.

TEXT 4

**TaÓa}a& vSTauSaara<aa& SaaE>aGaSYa c >aaJaNaMa()
TvGaSYa SPaXaRvaYaaeê SavRMaeDaSYa cEv ih)) 4))**

tad-gätra à vastu-säräëää

saubhagasya ca bhājanam

tvag asya sparça-vāyoç ca

sarva-medhasya caiva hi

SYNONYMS

tat—His; *gätram*—bodily surface; *vastu-säräëäm*—of the active principles of all articles; *saubhagasya*—of all auspicious opportunities; *ca*—and; *bhājanam*—the field of production; *tvak*—skin; *asya*—His; *sparça*—touch; *vāyo*—of the moving airs; *ca*—also; *sarva*—all kinds of; *medhasya*—of

sacrifices; *ca*—also; *eva*—certainly; *hi*—exactly.

TRANSLATION

His bodily surface is the breeding ground for the active principles of everything and for all kinds of auspicious opportunities. His skin, like the moving air, is the generating center for all kinds of sense of touch and is the place for performing all kinds of sacrifice.

PURPORT

The air is the moving agent of all the planets, and as such the generating centers for promotion to the deserving planets, the sacrifices, are His bodily surface and are naturally the origin of all auspicious opportunities.

TEXT 5

raeMaa<YauîÛÂJaaTaqNaa& YaEvaR YajSTau SaM>a*Ta")
ke-XaXMaé[uNa%aNYaSYa iXal/al/aeha>a]ivÛuTaaMa()) 5))

romäëy udbhijja-jäténää

yair vä yajïas tu sambhâtaù

keça-çmaçru-nakhäny asya

çilä-lohābhra-vidyutām

SYNONYMS

romäëi—hairs on the body; *udbhijja*—vegetables; *jäténām*—of the kingdoms; *yaiù*—by which; *vä*—either; *yajïaù*—sacrifices; *tu*—but; *sambhâtaù*—particularly served; *keça*—hairs on the head; *çmaçru*—facial hair; *nakhäni*—nails; *asya*—of Him; *çilä*—stones; *loha*—iron ores; *abhra*—clouds; *vidyutām*—electricity.

TRANSLATION

The hairs on His body are the cause of all vegetation, particularly of those trees which are required as ingredients for sacrifice. The hairs on His head and face are reservoirs for the clouds, and His nails are the breeding ground of electricity, stones and iron ores.

PURPORT

The polished nails of the Lord generate electricity, and the clouds rest on the hairs of His head. One can therefore collect all sorts of necessities of life from the person of the Lord, and therefore the *Vedas* affirm that everything that is produced is caused by the Lord. The Lord is the supreme cause of all causes.

TEXT 6

bahvae l/aek-Paal/aNaa& Pa[aYaXa" +aeMak-MaR<aaMa()) 6))

bāhavo loka-pālānā

prāyaçaù kñema-karmaëäm

SYNONYMS

bāhavaù—arms; *loka-pālānām*—of the governing deities of the planets, the demigods; *prāyaçaù*—almost always; *kñema-karmaëäm*—of those who are leaders and protectors of the general mass.

TRANSLATION

The Lord's arms are the productive fields for the great demigods and other leaders of the living entities who protect the general mass.

PURPORT

This important verse of *Srimad-Bhagavatam* is corroborated and nicely explained in the *Bhagavad-gita* (10.41–42) as follows:

*yad yad vibhūtimat sattvaà
çrémad ūrjitam eva vā
tat tad evāvagaccha tvaà
mama tejo-’àça-sambhavam*

*athavā bahunaitena
kiā jīātena tavārjuna
viññābhyāham idaā kātsnam
ekāāçena sthito jagat*

There are many powerful kings, leaders, learned scholars, scientists, artists, engineers, inventors, excavators, archaeologists, industrialists, politicians, economists, business magnates, and many more powerful deities or demigods like Brahmā, Siva, Indra, Candra, Sūrya, Varuëa and Marut, who are all protecting the interest of the universal affairs of maintenance, in different positions, and all of them are different powerful parts and parcels of the Supreme Lord. The Supreme Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa is the father of all living entities, who are placed in different high and low positions according to their desires or aspirations. Some of them, as particularly mentioned above, are specifically endowed with powers by the will of the Lord. A sane person must know for certain that a living being, however powerful he may be, is neither absolute nor independent. All living beings must accept the origin of their specific power as mentioned in this verse. And if they act accordingly, then simply by discharging their respective occupational duties they can achieve the highest perfection of life, namely eternal life, complete knowledge and inexhaustible blessings. As long as the powerful men of the world do not accept the origin of their respective powers, namely the Personality of Godhead, the actions of *māyā* (illusion) will continue to act. The actions of *māyā* are such that a powerful person, misled by the illusory, material energy, wrongly accepts himself as all in all and does not develop God consciousness. As such, the false sense of egoism (namely myself and mine) has become overly prominent in the world, and there is a hard struggle for existence in human society. The intelligent class of men, therefore, must admit the Lord as the ultimate source of all energies and thus pay tribute to the Lord for His good blessings. Simply by accepting the Lord as the supreme proprietor of everything, since He is actually so, one can achieve the highest perfection

of life. Whatever a person may be in the estimation of the social order of things, if a person tries to reciprocate a feeling of love towards the Supreme Personality of Godhead and is satisfied with the blessings of the Lord, he will at once feel the highest peace of mind for which he is hankering life after life. Peace of mind, or in other words the healthy state of mind, can be achieved only when the mind is situated in the transcendental loving service of the Lord. The parts and parcels of the Lord are endowed with specific powers for rendering service unto the Lord, just as a big business magnate's sons are empowered with specific powers of administration. The obedient son of the father never goes against the will of the father and therefore passes life very peacefully in concurrence with the head of the family, the father. Similarly, the Lord being the father, all living beings should fully and satisfactorily discharge the duty and will of the father, as faithful sons. This very mentality will at once bring peace and prosperity to human society.

TEXT 7

ivṣ-Maae >aU>auRv" Svê +aeMaSYa Xar<aSYa c)
SavRk-aMavrSYaaiPa hreêr<a AaSPadMa()) 7))

vikramo bhūr bhuvaù svaç ca

kñemasya çaraëasya ca

sarva-käma-varasyäpi

hareç caraëa äspadam

SYNONYMS

vikramaù—forward steps; *bhüù bhuvaù*—of the lower and upper planets; *svaù*—as well as of heaven; *ca*—also; *kñemasya*—of protection of all that we have; *çaraëasya*—of fearlessness; *ca*—also; *sarva-käma*—all that we need; *varasya*—of all benedictions; *api*—exactly; *hareù*—of the Lord; *caraëaù*—the lotus feet; *äspadam*—shelter.

TRANSLATION

Thus the forward steps of the Lord are the shelter for the upper, lower and heavenly planets, as well as for all that we need. His lotus feet serve as protection from all kinds of fear.

PURPORT

For absolute protection from all sorts of fear, as well as for all our needs of life, we must take shelter of the lotus feet of the Lord, not only in this planet but also in all the upper, lower and heavenly planets. This absolute dependence on the lotus feet of the Lord is called pure devotional service, and it is directly hinted at within this passage. No one should have any kind of doubt in this matter, nor should one be inclined to seek the help of any other demigods, because all of them are dependent on Him only. Everyone, except the Lord Himself, is dependent on the mercy of the Lord; even the all-pervading Supersoul is also dependent on the supreme aspect of Bhagavān, the Personality of Godhead.

TEXT 8

APaa& vqYaRSYa SaGaRSYa PaJaRNYaSYa Pa[JaaPaTae")
Pau&Sa" iXaén oPaSQaSTau Pa[JaaTYaaNaNdiNav*RTae")) 8))

apāà véryasya sargasya

parjanyaasya prajāpateù

puàsaù çigna upasthas tu

prajāty-ānanda-nirvāteù

SYNONYMS

apām—of water; *véryasya*—of the semen; *sargasya*—of the generative; *parjanyaasya*—of rains; *prajāpateù*—of the creator; *puàsaù*—of the Lord; *çignaù*—the genitals; *upasthaù tu*—the place where the genitals are

situated; *prajāti*—due to begetting; *ānanda*—pleasure; *nirvāṇa*—cause.

TRANSLATION

From the Lord's genitals originate water, semen, generatives, rains, and the procreators. His genitals are the cause of a pleasure that counteracts the distress of begetting.

PURPORT

The genitals and the pleasure of begetting counteract the distresses of family encumbrances. One would cease to generate altogether if there were not, by the grace of the Lord, a coating, a pleasure-giving substance, on the surface of the generative organs. This substance gives a pleasure so intense that it counteracts fully the distress of family encumbrances. A person is so captivated by this pleasure-giving substance that he is not satisfied by begetting a single child, but increases the number of children, with great risk in regard to maintaining them, simply for this pleasure-giving substance. This pleasure-giving substance is not false, however, because it originates from the transcendental body of the Lord. In other words, the pleasure-giving substance is a reality, but it has taken on an aspect of pervertedness on account of material contamination. In the material world, sex life is the cause of many distresses on account of material contact. Therefore, the sex life in the material world should not be encouraged beyond the necessity. There is a necessity for generating progeny even in the material world, but such generation of children must be carried out with full responsibility for spiritual values. The spiritual values of life can be realized in the human form of material existence, and the human being must adopt family planning with reference to the context of spiritual values, and not otherwise. The degraded form of family restriction by use of contraceptives, etc., is the grossest type of material contamination. Materialists who use these devices want to fully utilize the pleasure potency of the coating on the genitals by artificial means, without knowing the spiritual importance. And without knowledge of spiritual values, the less intelligent man tries to utilize only the material sense pleasure of the genitals.

TEXT 9

PaaYauYaRMaSYa iMa}aSYa PairMaae+aSYa Naard)
ih&SaaYaa iNa%oRTaeMa*RTYaaeiNaRrYaSYa Gaud& SMa*Ta")) 9))

päyur yamasya mitrasya

parimokñasya nārada

hiäsäyā nirāter māt̐yor

nirayasya gudaà smātaù

SYNONYMS

päyuù—the evacuating outlet; *yamasya*—the controlling deity of death; *mitrasya*—of Mitra; *parimokñasya*—of the evacuating hole; *nārada*—O Nārada; *hiäsäyāù*—of envy; *nirāteù*—of misfortune; *māt̐yoù*—of death; *nirayasya*—of hell; *gudam*—the rectum; *smātaù*—is understood.

TRANSLATION

O Nārada, the evacuating outlet of the universal form of the Lord is the abode of the controlling deity of death, Mitra, and the evacuating hole and the rectum of the Lord is the place of envy, misfortune, death, hell, etc.

TEXT 10

Para>aUTaerDaMaRSYa TaMaSaêaiPa PaiêMa")
Naa@yae NadNadqNaa& c Gaae}aa<aaMaiSQaSa&hiTa")) 10))

parābhūter adharmasya

tamasaç cāpi paçcimaù

näòyo nada-nadénäà ca

goträäm asthi-saàhatiù

SYNONYMS

parābhūteù—of frustration; *adharmasya*—of immorality; *tamasaù*—of ignorance; *ca*—and; *api*—as also; *paçcimaù*—the back; *nāòyaù*—of the intestines; *nada*—of the great rivers; *nadénām*—of the rivulets; *ca*—also; *goträäm*—of the mountains; *asthi*—bones; *saàhatiù*—accumulation.

TRANSLATION

The back of the Lord is the place for all kinds of frustration and ignorance, as well as for immorality. From His veins flow the great rivers and rivulets, and on His bones are stacked the great mountains.

PURPORT

In order to defy the impersonal conception of the Supreme Personality of Godhead, a systematic analysis of the physiological and anatomical constitution of His transcendental body is given here. It is clear from the available description of the body of the Lord (His universal form) that the form of the Lord is distinct from the forms of ordinary mundane conception. In any case, He is never a formless void. Ignorance is the back of the Lord, and therefore the ignorance of the less intelligent class of men is also not separate from His bodily conception. Since His body is the complete whole of everything that be, one cannot assert that He is impersonal only. On the contrary, the perfect description of the Lord holds that He is both impersonal and personal simultaneously. The Personality of Godhead is the original feature of the Lord, and His impersonal emanation is but the reflection of His transcendental body. Those who are fortunate enough to have a view of the Lord from the front can realize His personal feature, whereas those who are frustrated and are thus kept on the ignorance side of the Lord, or, in other words, those who have the view of the Lord from the back, realize Him in His impersonal feature.

TEXT 11

AVYaç-rSaiSaNDaUNaa& >aUTaaNaa& iNaDaNaSYa c)
odr& ividTa& Pau&Saae ôdYa& MaNaSa" PadMa()) 11))

avyakta-rasa-sindhünää

bhütänää nidhanasya ca

udaraà viditaà puàso

hådayaà manasaù padam

SYNONYMS

avyakta—the impersonal feature; *rasa-sindhünäm*—of the seas and oceans of water; *bhütänäm*—of those who take birth in the material world; *nidhanasya*—of the annihilation; *ca*—also; *udaram*—His belly; *viditam*—is known by the intelligent class of men; *puàsaù*—of the great personality; *hådayam*—the heart; *manasaù*—of the subtle body; *padam*—the place.

TRANSLATION

The impersonal feature of the Lord is the abode of great oceans, and His belly is the resting place for the materially annihilated living entities. His heart is the abode of the subtle material bodies of living beings. Thus it is known by the intelligent class of men.

PURPORT

In the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (8.17–18) it is stated that according to human calculations one day of Brahmä is equal to one thousand ages of four millenniums (4,300,000 years) each, and the same period is calculated to be his night also. A Brahmä lives for one hundred such years and then dies. A Brahmä, who is generally a great devotee of the Lord, attains liberation after such a downfall. The universe (called the *brahmäëòa*, or the round football-like domain controlled by a Brahmä) is thus annihilated, and thus the inhabitants of a particular planet, or of the whole universe, are also annihilated. *Avyakta*, mentioned here in this verse, means the night of

Brahmā, when partial annihilation takes place and the living entities of that particular *brahmāëòà*, up to the planets of Brahmaloka, along with the big oceans, etc., all repose in the belly of the *viräò-puruṣa*. At the end of a Brahmā's night, the creation again takes place, and the living entities, reserved within the belly of the Lord, are let loose to play their respective parts as if being awakened from a deep slumber. Since the living entities are never destroyed, the annihilation of the material world does not annihilate the existence of the living entities, but until liberation is attained one has to accept one material body after another, again and again. The human life is meant for making a solution to this repeated change of bodies and thereby attaining a place in the spiritual sky, where everything is eternal, blissful and full of knowledge. In other words, the subtle forms of the living entities take place in the heart of the Supreme Being, and such forms take tangible shape at the time of creation.

TEXT 12

DaMaRSYa MaMa Tau>Ya& c ku-Maara<aa& >avSYa c)
ivjaNaSYa c SatvSYa ParSYaaTMaa ParaYa<aMa()) 12))

dharmasya mama tubhyaà ca

kumäräëää bhavasya ca

vijñānasya ca sattvasya

parasyätmä paräyaëam

SYNONYMS

dharmasya—of religious principles, or of Yamarāja; *mama*—mine; *tubhyam*—of yours; *ca*—and; *kumäräëäm*—of the four Kumāras; *bhavasya*—Lord Siva; *ca*—and also; *vijñānasya*—of transcendental knowledge; *ca*—also; *sattvasya*—of truth; *parasya*—of the great personality; *ätmä*—consciousness; *paräyaëam*—dependent.

TRANSLATION

Also, the consciousness of that great personality is the abode of religious principles—mine, yours, and those of the four bachelors Sanaka, Sanātana, Sanat-kumāra and Sanandana. That consciousness is also the abode of truth and transcendental knowledge.

TEXTS 13–16

Ah& >avaNa(>avêEv Ta wMae MauNaYaae_Ga]Jaa")
SauraSaurNara NaaGaa" %Gaa Ma*GaSarqSa*Paa")) 13))
GaNDavaRPSarSaae Ya+aa r+aae>aUTaGa<aaerGaa")
PaXav" iPaTar" iSaÖa ivÛaDa]aêar<aa d]uMaa")) 14))
ANYae c ivivDaa Jaqva Jal/SQal/Na>aaEk-Sa")
Ga]h+aRke-TavSTaaraSTai@Ta" STaNaiYaÖv")) 15))
Sav| Pauâz Wved& >aUTa& >aVYa& >avÀ YaTa()
TaeNaedMaav*Ta& ivi& ivTaiSTaMaiDaiTaiïTa)) 16))

ahaà bhavän bhavaç caiva

ta ime munayo 'grajäù

suräsurā-narā nāgäù

khagä māga-sarésāpäù

gandharväpsaraso yakñä

rakñō-bhūta-gaëoragäù

paçavaù pitaraù siddhä

vidyädhräç cāraëä drumäù

anye ca vividhä jévā

jala-sthala-nabhaukasaù

graharkñā-ketavas tārās

taòitaù stanayitnavaù

sarvaà puruṣa evedaà

bhütaà bhavyaà bhavac ca yat

tenedam ävâtaà viçvaà

vitastim adhitiñöhati

SYNONYMS

aham—myself; *bhavän*—yourself; *bhavaù*—Lord Siva; *ca*—also; *eva*—certainly; *te*—they; *ime*—all; *munayaù*—the great sages; *agra-jäù*—born before you; *sura*—the demigods; *asura*—the demons; *naräù*—the human beings; *nägäù*—the inhabitants of the Nāga planet; *khagäù*—birds; *māga*—beasts; *sarésâpäù*—reptiles; *gandharva-apsarasaù*, *yakñäù*, *rakñäù-bhüta-gaëa-uragäù*, *paçavaù*, *pitaraù*, *siddhäù*, *vidyädhräù*, *cäraëäù*—all inhabitants of different planets; *drumäù*—the vegetable kingdom; *anye*—many others; *ca*—also; *vividhäù*—of different varieties; *jéväù*—living entities; *jala*—water; *sthala*—land; *nabha-okasaù*—the inhabitants of the sky, or the birds; *graha*—the asteroids; *ākñä*—the influential stars; *ketavaù*—the comets; *täräù*—the luminaries; *taòitaù*—the lightning; *stanayitnavaù*—the sound of the clouds; *sarvam*—everything; *puruṣaù*—the Personality of Godhead; *eva idam*—certainly all these; *bhütam*—whatever is created; *bhavyam*—whatever will be created; *bhavat*—and whatever was created in the past; *ca*—also; *yat*—whatever; *tena idam*—it is all by Him; *ävâtam*—covered; *viçvam*—universally comprehending; *vitastim*—half a cubit; *adhitiñöhati*—situated.

TRANSLATION

Beginning from me [Brahmā] down to you and Bhava [Siva], all the great sages who were born before you, the demigods, the demons, the Nāgas, the human beings, the birds, the beasts, as well as the reptiles, etc., and all phenomenal manifestations of the universes, namely the planets, stars, asteroids, luminaries, lightning, thunder, and the inhabitants of the

different planetary systems, namely the Gandharvas, Apsarās, Yakñas, Rakñas, Bhūtagaēas, Uragas, Paçus, Pitās, Siddhas, Vidyādharaś, Cāraēas, and all other different varieties of living entities, including the birds, beasts, trees and everything that be, are all covered by the universal form of the Lord at all times, namely past, present and future, although He is transcendental to all of them, eternally existing in a form not exceeding nine inches.

PURPORT

The Supreme Personality of Godhead, by His partial representation, measuring not more than nine inches as Supersoul, expands by His potential energy in the shape of the universal form, which includes everything manifested in different varieties of organic and inorganic materials. The manifested varieties of the universe are therefore not different from the Lord, just as golden ornaments of different shapes and forms are nondifferent from the original stock reserve of gold. In other words, the Lord is the Supreme Person who controls everything within the creation, and still He remains the supreme separate identity, distinct from all manifested material creation. In the ***Bhagavad-gīta*** (9.4–5) He is therefore said to be Yogesvara. Everything rests on the potency of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, and still the Lord is different from and transcendental to all such identities. In the Vedic *Puruṇa-sūkta* of the *Āg mantra*, this is also confirmed. This philosophical truth of simultaneous oneness and difference was propounded by Lord Sri Caitanya Mahāprabhu, and it is known as *acintya-bhedābheda-tattva*. Brahmā, Nārada and all others are simultaneously one with the Lord and different from the Supreme Lord. We are all one with Him, just as the gold ornaments are one in quality with the stock gold, but the individual gold ornament is never equal in quantity with the stock gold. The stock gold is never exhausted even if there are innumerable ornaments emanating from the stock because the stock is *pūrēam*, complete; even if *pūrēam* is deducted from the *pūrēam*, still the supreme *pūrēam* remains the same *pūrēam*. This fact is inconceivable to our present imperfect senses. Lord Caitanya therefore defined His theory of philosophy as *acintya* (inconceivable), and as confirmed in the *Bhagavad-gīta* as well as in the *Bhāgavatam*, Lord Caitanya’s theory of *acintya-bhedābheda-tattva* is the perfect philosophy of the Absolute Truth.

TEXT 17

**SviDaZ<Ya& Pa[TaPaNa(Pa[a<aae bihê Pa[TaPaTYaSaaE)
Wv& ivraJa& Pa[TaPa&STaPaTYaNTabRih" PauMaaNa()) 17))**

sva-dhiñëyaà pratapan präëo

bahiç ca pratapaty asau

evaà viräjaà pratapaàs

tapaty antar bahiù pumän

SYNONYMS

sva-dhiñëyam—radiation; *pratapan*—by expansion; *präëaù*—living energy; *bahiù*—external; *ca*—also; *pratapati*—illuminated; *asau*—the sun; *evam*—in the same way; *viräjam*—the universal form; *pratapan*—by expansion of; *tapati*—enlivens; *antaù*—internally; *bahiù*—externally; *pumän*—the Supreme Personality.

TRANSLATION

The sun illuminates both internally and externally by expanding its radiation; similarly, the Supreme Personality of Godhead, by expanding His universal form, maintains everything in the creation both internally and externally.

PURPORT

The universal form of the Lord, or the impersonal feature of the Lord known as the *brahmajyoti*, is clearly explained here and compared to the radiation of the sun. The sunshine may expand all over the universe, but the source of the sunshine, namely the sun planet or the deity known as Sürya-näräyaëa, is the basis of such radiation. Similarly, the Supreme Personality of Godhead Lord Kṛṣṇa is the basis of the impersonal *brahmajyoti* radiation, or the impersonal feature of the Lord. This is

confirmed in the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (14.27). So the universal form of the Lord is the secondary imagination of the impersonal form of the Lord, but the primary form of the Lord is Çyāmasundara, with two hands, playing on His eternal flute. Seventy-five percent of the expansive radiation of the Lord is manifested in the spiritual sky (*tripād-vibhūti*), and twenty-five percent of His personal radiation comprehends the entire expansion of the material universes. This is also explained and stated in the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (10.42). Thus the seventy-five percent expansion of His radiation is called His internal energy, whereas the twenty-five percent expansion is called the external energy of the Lord. The living entities, who are residents of the spiritual as well as the material expansions, are His marginal energy (*taöastha-çakti*), and they are at liberty to live in either of the energies, external or internal. Those who live within the spiritual expansion of the Lord are called liberated souls, whereas the residents of the external expansion are called the conditioned souls. We can just make an estimate of the number of the residents of the internal expansions in comparison with the number of residents in the external energy and may easily conclude that the liberated souls are far more numerous than the conditioned souls.

TEXT 18

Saae_Ma*TaSYaa>aYaSYaeXaae MaTYaRMaa& YadTYaGaaTa()
 MaihMaEz TaTaae b]øNa(PauåzSYa durTYaYa")) 18))

so 'mâtasyābhayasyeço

martyam annaà yad atyagät

mahimaiña tato brahman

puruşasya duratyayaù

SYNONYMS

saù—He (the Lord); *amâtasya*—of deathlessness; *abhayasya*—of fearlessness; *éçaù*—the controller; *martyam*—dying; *annam*—fruitive

action; *yat*—one who has; *atyagät*—has transcended; *mahimä*—the glories; *eñau*—of Him; *tatau*—therefore; *brahman*—O *brahmana* Nārada; *puruṣasya*—of the Supreme Personality; *duratyayaù*—immeasurable.

TRANSLATION

The Supreme Personality of Godhead is the controller of immortality and fearlessness, and He is transcendental to death and the fruitive actions of the material world. O Nārada, O brahmana, it is therefore difficult to measure the glories of the Supreme Person.

PURPORT

The glories of the Lord, in the transcendental seventy-five percent of the Lord's internal potency, are stated in the *Padma Purana (Uttara-khaṇḍa)*. It is said there that those planets in the spiritual sky, which comprises the seventy-five percent expansion of the internal potency of the Lord, are far, far greater than those planets in the total universes composed of the external potency of the Lord. In the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*, the total universes in the external potency of the Lord are compared to a bucketful of mustard seeds. One mustard seed is calculated to be a universe itself. In one of the universes, in which we are now living, the number of planets cannot be counted by human energy, and so how can we think of the sum total in all the universes, which are compared to a bucketful of mustard seeds? And the planets in the spiritual sky are at least three times the number of those in the material sky. Such planets, being spiritual, are in fact transcendental to the material modes; therefore they are constituted in the mode of unalloyed goodness only. The conception of spiritual bliss (*brahmānanda*) is fully present in those planets. Each of them is eternal, indestructible and free from all kinds of inebrieties experienced in the material world. Each of them is self-illuminating and more powerfully dazzling than (if we can imagine) the total sunshine of millions of mundane suns. The inhabitants of those planets are liberated from birth, death, old age and diseases and have full knowledge of everything; they are all godly and free from all sorts of material hankerings. They have nothing to do there except to render transcendental loving service to the Supreme Lord Nārāyaṇa, who is the predominating Deity of such Vaikuntha planets. Those

liberated souls are engaged incessantly in singing songs mentioned in the *Sāma Veda* (*vedaiù säga-pada-kramopaniñadair gäyanti yaà sämagäù*). All of them are personifications of the five *Upaniñads*. *Tripäd-vibhüti*, or the seventy-five percent known as the internal potency of the Lord, is to be understood as the kingdom of God far beyond the material sky; and when we speak of *päda-vibhüti*, or the twenty-five percent comprising His external energy, we should understand that this refers to the sphere of the material world. It is also said in the *Padma Purana* that the kingdom of *tripäd-vibhüti* is transcendental, whereas the *päda-vibhüti* is mundane; *tripäd-vibhüti* is eternal, whereas the *päda-vibhüti* is transient. The Lord and His eternal servitors in the transcendental kingdom all have eternal forms which are auspicious, infallible, spiritual and eternally youthful. In other words, there is no birth, death, old age and disease. That eternal land is full of transcendental enjoyment and full of beauty and bliss. This very fact is also corroborated in this verse of *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, and the transcendental nature is described as *amāta*. As described in the *Vedas*, *utāmātatvasyeçānaù*: the Supreme Lord is the Lord of immortality, or in other words, the Lord is immortal, and because He is the Lord of immortality He can award immortality to His devotees. In the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (8.16) the Lord also assures that whoever may go to His abode of immortality shall never return to this mortal land of threefold miseries. The Lord is not like the mundane lord. The mundane master or lord never enjoys equally with his subordinates, nor is a mundane lord immortal, nor can he award immortality to his subordinate. The Supreme Lord, who is the leader of all living entities, can award all the qualities of His personality unto His devotees, including immortality and spiritual bliss. In the material world there is always anxiety or fearfulness in the hearts of all living entities, but the Lord, being Himself the supreme fearless, also awards the same quality of fearlessness to His pure devotees. Mundane existence is itself a kind of fear because in all mundane bodies the effects of birth, death, old age and disease always keep a living being compact in fear. In the mundane world, there is always the influence of time, which changes things from one stage to another, and the living entity, originally being *avikāra*, or unchangeable, suffers a great deal on account of changes due to the influence of time. The changing effects of eternal time are conspicuously absent in the immortal kingdom of God, which should therefore be understood to have no influence of time and therefore no fear

whatsoever. In the material world, so-called happiness is the result of one's own work. One can become a rich man by dint of one's own hard labor, and there are always fear and doubts as to the duration of such acquired happiness. But in the kingdom of God, no one has to endeavor to attain a standard of happiness. Happiness is the nature of the spirit, as stated in the *Vedānta-sūtras: ānandamayo 'bhyāsāt*—the spirit is by nature full of happiness. Happiness in spiritual nature always increases in volume with a new phase of appreciation; there is no question of decreasing the bliss. Such unalloyed spiritual bliss is nowhere to be found within the orbit of the material universe, including the Janaloka planets, or, for that matter, the Maharloka or Satyaloka planets, because even Lord Brahmā is subject to the laws of fruitive actions and the law of birth and death. It is therefore stated here: *duratyayaù*, or, in other words, spiritual happiness in the eternal kingdom of God cannot be imagined even by the great *brahmacārés* or *sannyāsés* who are eligible to be promoted to the planets beyond the region of heaven. Or, the greatness of the Supreme Lord is so great that it cannot be imagined even by the great *brahmacārés* or *sannyāsés*, but such happiness is factually attained by the unalloyed devotees of the Lord, by His divine grace.

TEXT 19

**Paadezu SavR>aUTaaiNa Pau&Sa" iSQaiTaPadae ivdu")
AMa*Ta& +aeMaMa>aYa& i}aMaUDNaaeR_DaaiYa MaUDaRSau)) 19))**

pādeñu sarva-bhütāni

puàsaù sthiti-pado viduù

amātaà kñemam abhayaà

tri-mürdhno 'dhäyi mürdhasu

SYNONYMS

pādeñu—in the one fourth; *sarva*—all; *bhütāni*—living entities; *puàsaù*—of the Supreme Person; *sthiti-padaù*—the reservoir of all material opulence;

viduù—you should know; *amātam*—deathlessness; *kñemam*—all happiness, free from the anxiety of old age, diseases, etc.; *abhayam*—fearlessness; *tri-mūrdhnaù*—beyond the three higher planetary systems; *adhāyi*—exist; *mūrdhasu*—beyond the material coverings.

TRANSLATION

The Supreme Personality of Godhead is to be known as the supreme reservoir of all material opulences by the one fourth of His energy in which all the living entities exist. Deathlessness, fearlessness and freedom from the anxieties of old age and disease exist in the kingdom of God, which is beyond the three higher planetary systems and beyond the material coverings.

PURPORT

Out of the total manifestations of the *sandhiné* energy of the Lord, one fourth is displayed in the material world, and three fourths are displayed in the spiritual world. The Lord's energy is divided into three component parts, namely *sandhiné*, *saàvit* and *hlādiné*; in other words, He is the full manifestation of existence, knowledge and bliss. In the material world such a sense of existence, knowledge and pleasure is meagerly exhibited, and all living entities, who are minute parts and parcels of the Lord, are eligible to relish such consciousness of existence, knowledge and bliss very minutely in the liberated stage, whereas in the conditioned stage of material existence they can hardly appreciate what is the factual, existential, cognizable and pure happiness of life. The liberated souls, who exist in far greater numerical strength than those souls in the material world, can factually experience the potency of the above-mentioned *sandhiné*, *saàvit* and *hlādiné* energies of the Lord in the matter of deathlessness, fearlessness and freedom from old age and disease.

In the material world, the planetary systems are arranged in three spheres, called *triloka*, or Svarga, Martya and Pātāla, and all of them constitute only one fourth of the total *sandhiné* energy. Beyond that is the spiritual sky where the Vaikuntha planets exist beyond the coverings of seven material strata. In none of the *triloka* planetary systems can one experience the

status of immortality, full knowledge and full bliss. The upper three planetary systems are called *sāttvika* planets because they provide facilities for a long duration of life and relative freedom from disease and old age, as well as a sense of fearlessness. The great sages and saints are promoted beyond the heavenly planets to Maharloka, but that also is not the place of complete fearlessness because at the end of one *kalpa* the Maharloka is annihilated and the inhabitants have to transport themselves to still higher planets. Yet even on these planets no one is immune to death. There may be a comparative extension of life, expansion of knowledge and sense of full bliss, but factual deathlessness, fearlessness and freedom from old age, diseases, etc., are possible only beyond the material spheres of the coverings of the material sky. Such things are situated on the head (*adhäyi mürdhasu*).

TEXT 20

**PaadañYaae bihêaSaàPa[JaaNaa& Ya Aaé[Maa")
ANTaiñl/aeKYaaSTvParae Ga*hMaeDaae_b*hd(v]Ta")) 20))**

pädäs trayo bahiç cäsann

aprajänää ya äçramäù

antas tri-lokyäs tv aparo

gāha-medho 'bāhad-vrataù

SYNONYMS

pädäù trayau—the cosmos of three fourths of the Lord's energy; *bahiù*—thus situated beyond; *ca*—and for all; *äsan*—were; *aprajänäm*—of those who are not meant for rebirth; *ye*—those; *äçramäù*—status of life; *antaù*—within; *tri-lokyäù*—of the three worlds; *tu*—but; *aparaù*—others; *gāha-medhaù*—attached to family life; *abāhat-vrataù*—without strictly following a vow of celibacy.

TRANSLATION

The spiritual world, which consists of three fourths of the Lord's energy, is situated beyond this material world, and it is especially meant for those who will never be reborn. Others, who are attached to family life and who do not strictly follow celibacy vows, must live within the three material worlds.

PURPORT

The climax of the system of *varëäçrama-dharma*, or *sanätana-dharma*, is clearly expressed here in this particular verse of *Srimad-Bhagavatam*. The highest benefit that can be awarded to a human being is to train him to be detached from sex life, particularly because it is only due to sex indulgence that the conditioned life of material existence continues birth after birth. Human civilization in which there is no control of sex life is a fourth-class civilization because in such an atmosphere there is no liberation of the soul encaged in the material body. Birth, death, old age and disease are related to the material body, and they have nothing to do with the spirit soul. But as long as the bodily attachment for sensual enjoyment is encouraged, the individual spirit soul is forced to continue the repetition of birth and death on account of the material body, which is compared to garments subjected to the law of deterioration.

In order to award the highest benefit of human life, the *varëäçrama* system trains the follower to adopt the vow of celibacy beginning from the order of *brahmacäre*. The *brahmacäre* life is for students who are educated to follow strictly the vow of celibacy. Youngsters who have had no taste of sex life can easily follow the vow of celibacy, and once fixed in the principle of such a life, one can very easily continue to the highest perfectional stage, attaining the kingdom of the three-fourths energy of the Lord. It is already explained that in the cosmos of three-fourths energy of the Lord there is neither death nor fear, and one is full of the blissful life of happiness and knowledge. A householder attached to family life can easily give up such a life of sex indulgence if he has been trained in the principles of the life of a *brahmacäre*. A householder is recommended to quit home at the end of fifty years (*pañcaçordhvaà vanaà vrajet*) and live a life in the forest; then, being fully detached from family affection, he may accept the order of renunciation as a *sannyäse* fully engaged in the service of the Lord. Any

form of religious principles in which the followers are trained to pursue the vow of celibacy is good for the human being because only those who are trained in that way can end the miserable life of material existence. The principles of *nirvāṇa*, as recommended by Lord Buddha, are also meant for ending the miserable life of material existence. And this process, in the highest degree, is recommended here in the *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, with clear perception of ideal perfection, although basically there is no difference between the process of Buddhists, Čaikarites and Vaiṇāvites. For promotion to the highest status of perfection, namely freedom from birth and death, anxiety and fearfulness, not one of these processes allows the follower to break the vow of celibacy.

The householders and persons who have deliberately broken the vow of celibacy cannot enter into the kingdom of deathlessness. The pious householders or the fallen *yogis* or the fallen transcendentalists can be promoted to the higher planets within the material world (one fourth of the energy of the Lord), but they will fail to enter into the kingdom of deathlessness. *Abāhad-vratas* are those who have broken the vow of celibacy. The *vānaprasthas*, or those retired from family life, and the *sannyāsés*, or the renounced persons, cannot break the vow of celibacy if they want success in the process. The *brahmacārés*, *vānaprasthas* and *sannyāsés* do not intend to take rebirth (*apraja*), nor are they meant for secretly indulging in sex life. Such a falldown by the spiritualist may be compensated by another chance for human life in good families of learned *brahmanas* or of rich merchants for another term of elevation, but the best thing is to attain the highest perfection of deathlessness as soon as the human form of life is attained; otherwise the whole policy of human life will prove to be a total failure. Lord Caitanya was very strict in advising His followers in this matter of celibacy. One of His personal attendants, Choā Haridāsa, was severely punished by Lord Caitanya because of his failure to observe the vow of celibacy. For a transcendentalist, therefore, who at all wants to be promoted to the kingdom beyond material miseries, it is worse than suicide to deliberately indulge in sex life, especially in the renounced order of life. Sex life in the renounced order of life is the most perverted form of religious life, and such a misguided person can only be saved if, by chance, he meets a pure devotee.

TEXT 21

Sa*Taq ivcṣ-Mae iviṣ(SaaXaNaaNaXaNae o>ae)
YadivŪa c ivŪa c PauāzSTaU>aYaaé[Ya")) 21))

sâté vicakrame viṣvam

sāṣanānaṣane ubhe

yad avidyā ca vidyā ca

puruṣas tūbhayāṣrayaù

SYNONYMS

sâté—the destination of the living entities; *vicakrame*—exists comprehensively; *viṣvaì*—the all-pervading Personality of Godhead; *sāṣana*—activities of lording it over; *anaṣane*—activities in devotional service; *ubhe*—both; *yat*—what is; *avidyā*—nescience; *ca*—as well as; *vidyā*—factual knowledge; *ca*—and; *puruṣaù*—the Supreme Person; *tu*—but; *ubhaya*—for both of them; *āṣrayaù*—the master.

TRANSLATION

By His energies, the all-pervading Personality of Godhead is thus comprehensively the master in the activities of controlling and in devotional service. He is the ultimate master of both nescience and factual knowledge of all situations.

PURPORT

The word *viṣvaì* is significant in this verse. One who travels perfectly in every field of activity is called the *puruṣa* or *kñetrajña*. These two terms, *kñetrajña* and *puruṣa*, are equally applicable to both the individual self and the Supreme Self, the Lord. In the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (13.3) the matter is explained as follows:

*kñetrajiaà cäpi mää viddhi
sarva-kñetreñu bhārata
kñetra-kñetrajīayor jīānaà
yat taj jīānaà mataà mama*

kñetra means the place, and one who knows the place is called the *kñetrajia*. The individual self knows about his limited field of activities, but the Supreme Self, the Lord, knows about the unlimited field of activities. The individual soul knows about his own thinking, feeling and willing activities, but the Supersoul, or the Paramātmā, the supreme controller, being present everywhere, knows everyone's thinking, feeling and willing activities, and as such the individual living entity is the minute master of his personal affairs whereas the Supreme Personality of Godhead is the master of everyone's affairs, past, present and future (*vedāhaà samatétāni*, etc.). Only the ignorant person does not know this difference between the Lord and the living entities. The living entities, as distinguished from incognizant matter, may be qualitatively equal to the Lord in cognizance, but the living entity can never be equal to the Lord in full knowledge of past, present and future.

And because the living entity is partially cognizant, he is therefore sometimes forgetful of his own identity. This forgetfulness is specifically manifested in the field of the *ekapād-vibhūti* of the Lord, or in the material world, but in the *tripād-vibhūti* field of actions, or in the spiritual world, there is no forgetfulness by the living entities, who are free from all kinds of contaminations resulting from the forgetful state of existence. The material body is the symbol of the gross and subtle form of forgetfulness; therefore the whole atmosphere of the material world is called *avidyā*, or nescience, whereas the whole atmosphere of the spiritual world is called *vidyā*, or full of knowledge. There are different stages of *avidyā*, and they are called *dharma*, *artha* and *mokṣa*. The idea of *mokṣa*, or liberation, held by the monist in the matter of oneness of the living entity and the Lord by ultimate merging in one, is also the last stage of materialism or forgetfulness. Knowledge of the qualitative oneness of the self and Superself is partial knowledge and ignorance also because there is no knowledge of quantitative difference, as explained above. The individual self can never be equal to the Lord in cognizance; otherwise he could not

be placed in the state of forgetfulness. So, because there is a stage of forgetfulness of the individual selves, or the living entities, there is always a gulf of difference between the Lord and the living entity, as between the part and the whole. The part is never equal to the whole. So the conception of one hundred percent equality of the living being with the Lord is also nescience.

In the field of nescience, activities are directed toward lording it over the creation. In the material world, therefore, everyone is engaged in acquiring material opulence to lord it over the material world. Therefore there is always clash and frustration, which are the symptoms of nescience. But in the field of knowledge, there is devotional service to the Lord (*bhakti*). Therefore there is no chance of being contaminated by the influence of nescience or forgetfulness (*avidyā*) in the liberated stage of devotional activities. The Lord is thus the proprietor of the fields both of nescience and of cognition, and it remains the choice of the living entity to exist in either of the above regions.

TEXT 22

YaSMaad<@& ivra@ (Jaje >aUTaeiNd]YaGau<aaTMak-")
Tad(d]VYaMaTYaGaad(ivi& Gaei>a" SaUYaR wvaTaPaNa()) 22))

yasmād aëòaa viräò jajïe

bhütendriya-guëätmakaù

tad dravyam atyagäd viçvaà

gobhiù sürya ivätapan

SYNONYMS

yasmät—from whom; *aëòam*—the universal globes; *viräò*—and the gigantic universal form; *jajïe*—appeared; *bhüta*—elements; *indriya*—senses; *guëa-ätmakaù*—qualitative; *tad dravyam*—the universes and the universal form, etc.; *atyagät*—surpassed; *viçvam*—all the universes;

gobhiù—by the rays; *sūryaù*—the sun; *iva*—like; *ātapan*—distributed rays and heat.

TRANSLATION

From that Personality of Godhead, all the universal globes and the universal form with all material elements, qualities and senses are generated. Yet He is aloof from such material manifestations, like the sun, which is separate from its rays and heat.

PURPORT

The supreme truth has been ascertained in the previous verse as *puruṣa* or the *puruṇottama*, the Supreme person. The Absolute person is the *éçvara*, or the supreme controller, by His different energies. The *ekapād-vibhūti* manifestation of the material energy of the Lord is just like one of the many mistresses of the Lord, by whom the Lord is not so much attracted, as indicated in the language of the *Gétā (bhinnā prakātiù)*. But the region of the *tripād-vibhūti*, being a pure spiritual manifestation of the energy of the Lord, is, so to speak, more attractive to Him. The Lord, therefore, generates the material manifestations by impregnating the material energy, and then, within the manifestation, He expands Himself as the gigantic form of the *viçva-rūpa*. The *viçva-rūpa*, as it was shown to Arjuna, is not the original form of the Lord. The original form of the Lord is the transcendental form of Puruṇottama, or Kṛṣṇa Himself. It is very nicely explained herein that He expands Himself just like the sun. The sun expands itself by its terrible heat and rays, yet the sun is always aloof from such rays and heat. The impersonalist takes into consideration the rays of the Lord without any information of the tangible, transcendental, eternal form of the Lord, known as Kṛṣṇa. Therefore Kṛṣṇa, in His supreme personal form, with two hands and flute, is bewildering for the impersonalists who can accommodate only the gigantic *viçva-rūpa* of the Lord. They should know that the rays of the sun are secondary to the sun, and similarly the impersonal gigantic form of the Lord is also secondary to the personal form as Puruṇottama. The ***Brahma-saṃhitā*** (5.37) confirms this statement as follows:

*änanda-cinmaya-rasa-pratibhāvitābhis
tābhir ya eva nija-rūpatayā kalābhiù
goloka eva nivasaty akhilātma-bhūto
govindam ādi-puruṣaà tam ahaà bhajāmi*

“The Supreme Personality of Godhead, Govinda, the one who enlivens the senses of everyone by His personal bodily rays, resides in His transcendental abode, called Goloka. Yet He is present in every nook and corner of His creation by expansion of happy spiritual rays, equal in power to His personal potency of bliss.” He is therefore simultaneously personal and impersonal by His inconceivable potency, or He is the one without a second, displaying complete unity in a diversity of material and spiritual manifestations. He is separate from everything, and still nothing is different from Him.

TEXT 23

**YadaSYa Naa>Yaaàil/NaadhMaaSa& MahaTMaNa")
Naaivd& YajSaM>aaraNa(PauāzavYavaNa*Tae)) 23))**

yadāsya nābhyān nalinād

aham āsaà mahātmanaù

nāvidaà yajña-sambhārān

puruñāvayavān āte

SYNONYMS

yadā—at the time of; *asya*—His; *nābhyāt*—from the abdomen; *nalināt*—from the lotus flower; *aham*—myself; *āsam*—took my birth; *mahā-ātmanaù*—of the great person; *na avidam*—did not know; *yajña*—sacrificial; *sambhārān*—ingredients; *puruṣa*—of the Lord; *avayavān*—personal bodily limbs; *āte*—except.

TRANSLATION

When I was born from the abdominal lotus flower of the Lord [Mahā-Viṣṇu], the great person, I had no ingredients for sacrificial performances except the bodily limbs of the great Personality of Godhead.

PURPORT

Lord Brahmā, the creator of the cosmic manifestation, is known as Svayambhū, or one who is born without father and mother. The general process is that a living creature is born out of the sex combination of the male father and the female mother. But Brahmā, the firstborn living being, is born out of the abdominal lotus flower of the Mahā-Viṣṇu plenary expansion of Lord Kṛṣṇa. The abdominal lotus flower is part of the Lord's bodily limbs, and Brahmā is born out of the lotus flower. Therefore Lord Brahmā is also a part of the Lord's body. Brahmā, after his appearance in the gigantic hollow of the universe, saw darkness and nothing else. He felt perplexity, and from his heart he was inspired by the Lord to undergo austerity, thereby acquiring the ingredients for sacrificial performances. But there was nothing besides the two of them, namely the Personality of Mahā-Viṣṇu and Brahmā himself, born of the bodily part of the Lord. For sacrificial performances many ingredients were in need, especially animals. The animal sacrifice is never meant for killing the animal, but for achieving the successful result of the sacrifice. The animal offered in the sacrificial fire is, so to speak, destroyed, but the next moment it is given a new life by dint of the Vedic hymns chanted by the expert priest. When such an expert priest is not available, the animal sacrifice in the fire of the sacrificial altar is forbidden. Thus Brahmā created even the sacrificial ingredients out of the bodily limbs of the Garbhodakaśāyī Viṣṇu, which means that the cosmic order was created by Brahmā himself. Also, nothing is created out of nothing, but everything is created from the person of the Lord. The Lord says in the ***Bhagavad-gītā*** (10.8), *ahaṁ sarvasya prabhavo mattaṁ sarvaṁ pravartate*. "Everything is made from My bodily limbs, and I am therefore the original source of all creations."

The impersonalists argue that there is no use in worshipping the Lord when everything is nothing but the Lord Himself. The personalist, however, worships the Lord out of a great sense of gratitude, utilizing the ingredients born out of the bodily limbs of the Lord. The fruits and flowers are available

from the body of the earth, and yet mother earth is worshiped by the sensible devotee with ingredients born from the earth. Similarly, mother Ganges is worshiped by the water of the Ganges, and yet the worshiper enjoys the result of such worship. Worship of the Lord is also performed by the ingredients born from the bodily limbs of the Lord, and yet the worshiper, who is himself a part of the Lord, achieves the result of devotional service to the Lord. While the impersonalist wrongly concludes that he is the Lord himself, the personalist, out of a great gratitude, worships the Lord in devotional service, knowing perfectly well that nothing is different from the Lord. The devotee therefore endeavors to apply everything in the service of the Lord because he knows that everything is the property of the Lord and that no one can claim anything as one's own. This perfect conception of oneness helps the worshiper in being engaged in His loving service, whereas the impersonalist, being falsely puffed up, remains a nondevotee forever, without being recognized by the Lord.

TEXT 24

Taezu YajSYa PaXav" SavNaSPaTaYa" ku-Xaa")
wd& c devYaJaNa& k-al/êaeåGau<aaINvTa")) 24))

teñu yajñasya paçavaù

savanaspatayaù kuçäù

idaà ca deva-yajanaà

kälaç coru-guëänvitaù

SYNONYMS

teñu—in such sacrifices; *yajñasya*—of the sacrificial performance; *paçavaù*—the animals or the sacrificial ingredients; *sa-vanaspatayaù*—along with flowers and leaves; *kuçäù*—the straw; *ida*—all these; *ca*—as also; *deva-yajanam*—the sacrificial altar; *käla*—a suitable time; *ca*—as also; *uru*—great; *guëa-anvitaù*—qualified.

TRANSLATION

For performing sacrificial ceremonies, one requires sacrificial ingredients, such as flowers, leaves and straw, along with the sacrificial altar and a suitable time [spring].

TEXT 25

vSTaUNYaaezDaYa" òeha rSal/aeHMa*dae Jal/Ma()
%œcae YaJaU&iz SaaMaaiNa caTauhaeR}a& c SataMa)) 25))

vastüny oñadhayaù snehä

rasa-loha-mādo jalam

āca yajüàñi sāmāni

cätur-hotraà ca sattama

SYNONYMS

vastüni—utensils; *oñadhayaù*—grains; *snehäù*—clarified butter; *rasa-loha-mādaù*—honey, gold and earth; *jalam*—water; *ācaù*—the Åg Veda; *yajüàñi*—the Yajur Veda; *sāmāni*—the Sāma Veda; *cätuù-hotram*—four persons conducting the performance; *ca*—all these; *sattama*—O most pious one.

TRANSLATION

Other requirements are utensils, grains, clarified butter, honey, gold, earth, water, the Åg Veda, Yajur Veda and Sāma Veda and four priests to perform the sacrifice.

PURPORT

To perform a sacrifice successfully, at least four expert priests are needed: one who can offer (*hotä*), one who can chant (*udgätä*), one who can kindle

the sacrificial fire without the aid of separate fire (*adhvaryu*), and one who can supervise (*brahmä*). Such sacrifices were conducted from the birth of *Brahmä*, the first living creature, and were carried on till the reign of Maharaja Yudhiñöhira. But such expert *brahmana* priests are very rare in this age of corruption and quarrel, and therefore in the present age only the *yajña* of chanting the holy name of the Lord is recommended. The scriptures enjoin:

*harer nāma harer nāma
harer nāmaiva kevalam
kalau nāsty eva nāsty eva
nāsty eva gatir anyathā*
[Adi 17.21]

TEXT 26

**NaaMaDaeYaaiNa MaN}aaê di+a<aaê v]TaaNa c)
devTaaNauṣ-Ma" k-LPa" SaṁLPaSTaN}aMaev c)) 26))**

nāma-dheyāni mantrāḥ ca

dakṣiṇāḥ ca vratāni ca

devatānukramaṇḥ kalpau

saikalpas tantram eva ca

SYNONYMS

nāma-dheyāni—invoking the names of the demigods; *mantrāḥ*—specific hymns to offer to a particular demigod; *ca*—also; *dakṣiṇāḥ*—reward; *ca*—and; *vratāni*—vows; *ca*—and; *devatā-anukramaṇḥ*—one demigod after another; *kalpau*—the specific scripture; *saikalpau*—the specific purpose; *tantram*—a particular process; *eva*—as they are; *ca*—also.

TRANSLATION

Other necessities include invoking the different names of the demigods by specific hymns and vows of recompense, in accordance with the particular scripture, for specific purposes and by specific processes.

PURPORT

The whole process of offering sacrifice is under the category of fruitive action, and such activities are extremely scientific. They mainly depend on the process of vibrating sounds with a particular accent. It is a great science, and due to being out of proper use for more than four thousand years, for want of qualified *brahmanas*, such performances of sacrifice are no longer effective. Nor are they recommended in this fallen age. Any such sacrifice undertaken in this age as a matter of show may simply be a cheating process by the clever priestly order. But such a show of sacrifices cannot be effective at any stage. Fruitive action is being carried on by the help of material science and to a little extent by gross material help, but the materialists await a still more subtle advancement in the process of vibrating sounds on which the Vedic hymns are established. Gross material science cannot divert the real purpose of human life. They can only increase the artificial needs of life without any solution to the problems of life; therefore the way of materialistic life leads to the wrong type of human civilization. Since the ultimate aim of life is spiritual realization, the direct way of invoking the holy name of the Lord, as mentioned above, is precisely recommended by Lord Caitanya, and people of the modern age can easily take advantage of this simple process, which is tenable for the condition of the complicated social structure.

TEXT 27

**GaTaYaae MaTaYaêEv Pa[aYaiêta& SaMaPaR<aMa()
PauãzavYavEreTae SaM>aara" SaM>a*Taa MaYaa)) 27))**

gatayo matayaç caiva

präyaçcittaà samarpaëam

puruñävayavair ete

sambhäräù sambhâtä mayä

SYNONYMS

gatayaù—progress to the ultimate goal (Viṣṇu); *matayaù*—worshiping the demigods; *ca*—as also; *eva*—certainly; *prāyaścittam*—compensation; *samarpaëam*—ultimate offering; *puruṣa*—the Personality of Godhead; *avayavaiù*—from the parts of the body of the Personality of Godhead; *ete*—these; *sambhäräù*—the ingredients; *sambhâtäù*—were arranged; *mayä*—by me.

TRANSLATION

Thus I had to arrange all these necessary ingredients and paraphernalia of sacrifice from the personal bodily parts of the Personality of Godhead. By invocation of the demigods' names, the ultimate goal, Viṣṇu, was gradually attained, and thus compensation and ultimate offering were complete.

PURPORT

In this verse, special stress is given to the person of the Supreme Lord, and not to His impersonal *brahmajyoti*, as being the source of all supplies. Nārāyaṇa, the Supreme Lord, is the goal of sacrificial results, and therefore the Vedic hymns are ultimately meant for attaining this goal. Human life is thus made successful by pleasing Nārāyaṇa and getting entrance into the direct association of Nārāyaṇa in the spiritual kingdom of Vaikuntha.

TEXT 28

**wiTa SaM>a*TaSaM>aar" PauâzavYavErhMa()
TaMaev Pauâz& Yaj& TaeNaEvaYaJaMaqirMa()) 28))**

iti sambhâta-sambhäräù

puruñävayavair aham

tam eva puruṣaà yajñaà

tenaivāyajam éçvaram

SYNONYMS

iti—thus; *sambhāta*—executed; *sambhāra*—equipped myself well;
puruṣa—the Personality of Godhead; *avayavai*—by the parts and parcels;
aham—I; *tam eva*—unto Him; *puruṣam*—the Personality of Godhead;
yajñam—the enjoyer of all sacrifices; *tena eva*—by all those; *ayajam*—
worshiped; *éçvaram*—the supreme controller.

TRANSLATION

Thus I created the ingredients and paraphernalia for offering sacrifice out of the parts of the body of the Supreme Lord, the enjoyer of the sacrifice, and I performed the sacrifice to satisfy the Lord.

PURPORT

People in general are always anxious to have peace of mind or peace in the world, but they do not know how to achieve such a standard of peace in the world. Such peace in the world is obtainable by performances of sacrifice and by practice of austerity. In the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (5.29) the following prescription is recommended:

*bhoktāraà yajña-tapasāà
sarva-loka-maheçvaram
suhādaà sarva-bhūtānāà
jñātvā māà çāntim ācchati*

“The *karma-yogis* know that the Supreme Lord is the factual enjoyer and maintainer of all sacrifices and of the austere life. They also know that the Lord is the ultimate proprietor of all the planets and is the factual friend of all living entities. Such knowledge gradually converts the *karma-yogis* into pure devotees of the Lord through the association of unalloyed devotees, and thus they are able to be liberated from material bondage.”

Brahmā, the original living being within the material world, taught us the way of sacrifice. The word “sacrifice” suggests dedication of one’s own interests for satisfaction of a second person. That is the way of all activities. Every man is engaged in sacrificing his interests for others, either in the form of family, society, community, country or the entire human society. But perfection of such sacrifices is attained when they are performed for the sake of the Supreme Person, the Lord. Because the Lord is the proprietor of everything, because the Lord is the friend of all living creatures, and because He is the maintainer of the performer of sacrifice, as well as the supplier of the ingredients of sacrifices, it is He only and no one else who should be satisfied by all sacrifices.

The whole world is engaged in sacrificing energy for advancement of learning, social upliftment, economic development and plans for total improvement of the human condition, but no one is interested in sacrificing for the sake of the Lord, as it is advised in the *Bhagavad-gita*. Therefore, there is no peace in the world. If men at all want peace in the world, they must practice sacrifice in the interest of the supreme proprietor and friend of all.

TEXT 29

**TaTaSTae >a]aTar wMae Pa[JaaNaa& PaTaYaae Nav)
AYaJaNa(VYaç-MaVYaç&- Pauåz& SauSaMaaihTaa")) 29))**

tatas te bhrätara ime

prajānāà patayo nava

ayajan vyaktam avyaktaà

puruṣaà su-samāhitāu

SYNONYMS

tatau—thereafter; *te*—your; *bhrätaraù*—brothers; *ime*—these; *prajānām*—of the living creatures; *patayaù*—masters; *nava*—nine; *ayajan*—performed;

vyaktam—manifested; *avyaktam*—nonmanifested; *puruṣam*—personalities; *su-samāhitāu*—with proper rituals.

TRANSLATION

My dear son, thereafter your nine brothers, who are the masters of living creatures, performed the sacrifice with proper rituals to satisfy both the manifested and nonmanifested personalities.

PURPORT

The manifested personalities are the demigods like the ruler of the heavenly kingdom, Indra, and his associates; and the nonmanifested personality is the Lord Himself. The manifested personalities are mundane controllers of the material affairs, whereas the nonmanifested Personality of Godhead is transcendental, beyond the range of the material atmosphere. In this age of Kali the manifested demigods are also not to be seen, for space travel has completely stopped. So both the powerful demigods and the Supreme Personality of Godhead are nonmanifested to the covered eyes of the modern man. Modern men want to see everything with their eyes, although they are not sufficiently qualified. Consequently, they disbelieve in the existence of the demigods or of the Supreme God. They should see through the pages of authentic scriptures and should not simply believe their unqualified eyes. Even in these days, God can also be seen by qualified eyes tinged with the ointment of love of God.

TEXT 30

**TaTaê MaNav" k-ale/ wRiJare %zYaae_Pare)
iPaTarae ivbuDaa dETYaa MaNauZYaa" §-Tauī>aivR>auMa()) 30))**

tataç ca manavaù käle

ējire āñayo 'pare

pitaro vibudhä daityä

manuñyäu kratubhir vibhum

SYNONYMS

tataù—thereafter; *ca*—also; *manavaù*—the Manus, the fathers of mankind; *käle*—in due course of time; *éjire*—worshiped; *añayaù*—great sages; *apare*—others; *pitaraù*—the forefathers; *vibudhäù*—the learned scholars; *daityäù*—great devotees of the demigods; *manuñyäu*—mankind; *kratubhiù vibhum*—by performance of sacrifices to please the Supreme Lord.

TRANSLATION

Thereafter, the Manus, the fathers of mankind, the great sages, the forefathers, the learned scholars, the Daityas and mankind performed sacrifices meant to please the Supreme Lord.

PURPORT

The *daityas* are devotees of the demigods because they want to derive the greatest possible material facilities from them. The devotees of the Lord are *eka-niñöha*, or absolutely attached to the devotional service of the Lord. Therefore they have practically no time to seek the benefits of material facilities. Because of their realization of their spiritual identity, they are more concerned with spiritual emancipation than with material comforts.

TEXT 31

**NaaraYa<ae >aGaviTa Taidd& iviMaaihTaMa()
Ga*hqTaMaaYaaeåGau<a" SaGaaRdavGau<a" SvTa")) 31))**

näräyaëe bhagavati

tad idaà viçvam ähitam

gähéta-mäyuru-guëaù

sargädäv aguëaù svataù

SYNONYMS

nārāyaëe—unto Nārāyaṇa; *bhagavati*—the Personality of Godhead; *tat idam*—all these material manifestations; *viçvam*—all the universes; *āhitam*—situated; *gāhéta*—having accepted; *māyā*—material energies; *uru-guëaù*—greatly powerful; *sarga-ädau*—in creation, maintenance and destruction; *aguëaù*—without affinity for the material modes; *svataù*—self-sufficiently.

TRANSLATION

All the material manifestations of the universes are therefore situated in His powerful material energies, which He accepts self-sufficiently, although He is eternally without affinity for the material modes.

PURPORT

The question put by Nārada before Brahmā concerning the sustenance of the material creation is thus answered. Material actions and reactions, as the material scientist can superficially observe, are not basically ultimate truth in regard to creation, maintenance and destruction. The material energy is a potency of the Lord which is displayed in time, accepting the three qualities of goodness, passion and ignorance in the forms of Viṣṇu, Brahmā and Siva. The material energy thus works under the supreme spell of His Lordship, although He is always transcendental to all such material activities. A rich man constructs a big house by spending his energy in the shape of resources, and similarly he destroys a big house by his resources, but the maintenance is always under his personal care. The Lord is the richest of the rich because He is always fully complete in six opulences. Therefore He is not required to do anything personally, but everything in the material world is carried out by His wishes and direction; therefore, the entire material manifestation is situated in Nārāyaṇa, the Supreme Personality of Godhead. The impersonal conception of the supreme truth is due to lack of knowledge only, and this fact is clearly explained by Brahmäjé, who is supposed to be the creator of the universal affairs.

Brahmäjé is the highest authority in Vedic wisdom, and his assertion in this connection is therefore the supreme information.

TEXT 32

Sa*JaaiMa TaiàYauç-ae_h& hrae hriTa TaÜXa")
ivi& PauâzæPae<a PairPaiTa i}aXaiç-Da*k(-)) 32))

sâjâmi tan-niyukto 'haà

haro harati tad-vaçaù

viçvaà puruṣa-rüpeëa

paripäti tri-çakti-dhâk

SYNONYMS

sâjâmi—do create; *tat*—by His; *niyuktaù*—appointment; *aham*—I; *haraù*—Lord Siva; *harati*—destroys; *tad-vaçaù*—under His subordination; *viçvam*—the whole universe; *puruṣa*—the Personality of Godhead; *rüpeëa*—by His eternal form; *paripäti*—maintains; *tri-çakti-dhâk*—the controller of three energies.

TRANSLATION

By His will, I create, Lord Siva destroys, and He Himself, in His eternal form as the Personality of Godhead, maintains everything. He is the powerful controller of these three energies.

PURPORT

The conception of one without a second is clearly confirmed here. The one is Lord Väsudeva, and only by His different energies and expansions are different manifestations, both in the material and in the spiritual worlds, maintained. In the material world also, Lord Väsudeva is everything, as stated in the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (7.19). *Väsudevaù sarvam iti*: everything is

Väsudeva only. In the Vedic hymns also the same Väsudeva is held to be supreme. It is said in the *Vedas*, *väsudevät paro brahman na cänyo 'rtho 'sti tattvataù*: in fact there is no greater truth than Väsudeva. And Lord Kṛṣṇa affirms the same truth in the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (7.7). *Mattaù parataraà nänyat*: “There is nothing above Me [Lord Kṛṣṇa].” So the conception of oneness, as overly stressed by the impersonalist, is also accepted by the personalist devotee of the Lord. The difference is that the impersonalist denies personality in the ultimate issue, whereas the devotee gives more importance to the Personality of Godhead. *Srimad-Bhagavatam* explains this truth in the verse under discussion: Lord Väsudeva is one without a second, but because He is all-powerful, He can expand Himself as well as display His omnipotencies. The Lord is described here as omnipotent by three energies (*tri-çakti-dhåk*). So primarily His three energies are internal, marginal and external. This external energy is also displayed in the three modes of goodness, passion and ignorance. Similarly, the internal potency is also displayed in three spiritual modes—*saàvit*, *sandhiné* and *hlädiné*. The marginal potency, or the living entities, is also spiritual (*prakåtià viddhi me paräm*), but the living entities are never equal to the Lord. The Lord is *nirasta-såmya-atyaçaya*; in other words, no one is greater than or equal to the Supreme Lord. So the living entities, including even such great personalities as Lord Brahmä and Lord Siva, are all subordinate to the Lord. In the material world also, in His eternal form of Viṣṇu, He maintains and controls all the affairs of the demigods, including Brahmä and Siva.

TEXT 33

wiTa Tae_i>aihTa& TaaTa YaQaedMaNauPa*C^iSa)
NaaNYaÜGavTa" ik-iÄÜaVYa& SadSadaTMak-Ma()) 33))

iti te 'bhihitaà täta

yathedam anupåcchasi

nänyad bhagavataù kiïcid

bhävyaà sad-asad-åtmakam

SYNONYMS

iti—thus; *te*—unto you; *abhihitam*—explained; *tāta*—my dear son; *yathā*—as; *idam*—all these; *anupācchasi*—as you have inquired; *na*—never; *anyat*—anything else; *bhagavatau*—beyond the Personality of Godhead; *kīicit*—nothing; *bhāvyam*—to be thought ever; *sat*—cause; *asat*—effect; *ātmakam*—in the matter of.

TRANSLATION

My dear son, whatever you inquired from me I have thus explained unto you, and you must know for certain that whatever there is (either as cause or as effect, both in the material and spiritual worlds) is dependent on the Supreme Personality of Godhead.

PURPORT

The complete cosmic situation, both in the material and in the spiritual manifestations of the energies of the Lord, is working and moving first as the cause and then as the effect. But the original cause is the Supreme Personality of Godhead. Effects of the original cause become the causes of other effects, and thus everything, either permanent or temporary, is working as cause and effect. And because the Lord is the primeval cause of all persons and all energies, He is called the cause of all causes, as confirmed in the *Brahma-saṁhitā* as well as in the *Bhagavad-gīta*. The *Brahma-saṁhitā* (5.1) affirms:

*éçvaraù paramaù kãñëaù
sac-cid-ānanda-vigrahaù
anādir ādir govindaù
sarva-kāraëa-kāraëam*

And in the *Bhagavad-gīta* (10.8) it is said:

*ahaà sarvasya prabhavo
mattaù sarvaà pravartate
iti matvä bhajante mäà*

budhä bhäva-samanvitäu

So the original primeval cause is *vigraha*, the personal, and the impersonal spiritual effulgence, *brahmajyoti*, is also an effect of the Supreme Brahman (*brahmaëo hi pratiñöhäham* [14.27]), Lord Kṛṣṇa.

TEXT 34

**Na >aarTaq Mae_® Ma*zaePal/+YaTae
Na vE KvicNMae MaNaSaae Ma*za GaiTa")
Na Mae ôzqk-ai<a PaTaNTYaSaTPaQae
YaNMae ôdaETk-<#yvTaa Da*Taae hir")) 34))**

na bhäraté me 'iga mãñopalakñyate

na vai kvacin me manaso mãñä gatiù

na me hãñékäëi patanty asat-pathe

yan me hãdautkaëöhyavatä dhâto hariù

SYNONYMS

na—never; *bhäraté*—statements; *me*—mind; *a'iga*—O Nārada; *mãñä*—untruth; *upalakñyate*—prove to be; *na*—never; *vai*—certainly; *kvacit*—at any time; *me*—mine; *manasaù*—of the mind; *mãñä*—untruth; *gatiù*—progress; *na*—nor; *me*—mine; *hãñékäëi*—senses; *patanti*—degrades; *asat-pathe*—in temporary matter; *yat*—because; *me*—mine; *hãdä*—heart; *autkaëöhyavatä*—by great earnestness; *dhâtaù*—caught hold of; *hariù*—the Supreme Personality of Godhead.

TRANSLATION

O Nārada, because I have caught hold of the lotus feet of the Supreme Personality of Godhead, Hari, with great zeal, whatever I say has never proved to have been false. Nor is the progress of my mind ever deterred. Nor are my senses ever degraded by temporary attachment to matter.

PURPORT

Lord Brahmā is the original speaker of Vedic wisdom to Nārada, and Nārada is the distributor of transcendental knowledge all over the world through his various disciples, like Vyāsadeva and others. The followers of Vedic wisdom accept the statements of Brahmājé as gospel truth, and transcendental knowledge is thus being distributed all over the world by the process of disciplic succession from time immemorial, since the beginning of the creation. Lord Brahmā is the perfect liberated living being within the material world, and any sincere student of transcendental knowledge must accept the words and statements of Brahmājé as infallible. The Vedic knowledge is infallible because it comes down directly from the Supreme Lord unto the heart of Brahmā, and since he is the most perfect living being, Brahmājé is always correct to the letter. And this is because Lord Brahmā is a great devotee of the Lord who has earnestly accepted the lotus feet of the Lord as the supreme truth. In the *Brahma-saṁhitā*, which is compiled by Brahmājé, he repeats the aphorism *govindam ādi-puruṣaṁ tam ahaṁ bhajāmi*: ** “I am a worshiper of the original personality of Godhead, Govinda, the primeval Lord.” So whatever he says, whatever he thinks, and whatever he does normally in his mood are to be accepted as truth because of his direct and very intimate connection with Govinda, the primeval Lord. Sri Govinda, who pleasingly accepts the loving transcendental service of His devotees, gives all protection to the words and actions of His devotees. The Lord declares in the *Bhagavad-gītā* (9.31), *kaunteya pratijānēhi*: “O son of Kunté, please declare it.” The Lord asks Arjuna to declare, and why? Because sometimes the declaration of Govinda Himself may seem contradictory to mundane creatures, but the mundaner will never find any contradiction in the words of the Lord’s devotees. The devotees are especially protected by the Lord so that they may remain infallible. Therefore the process of devotional service always begins in the service of the devotee who appears in disciplic succession. The devotees are always liberated, but that does not mean that they are impersonal. The Lord is a person eternally, and the devotee of the Lord is also a person eternally. Because the devotee has his sense organs even at the liberated stage, he is therefore a person always. And because the devotee’s service is accepted by the Lord in full reciprocation, the Lord is also a person in His complete spiritual embodiment. The devotee’s senses, being engaged in

the service of the Lord, never go astray under the attraction of false material enjoyment. The plans of the devotee never go in vain, and all this is due to the faithful attachment of the devotee for the service of the Lord. This is the standard of perfection and liberation. Anyone, beginning from Brahmäjé down to the human being, is at once put on the path of liberation simply by his attachment in great earnestness for the Supreme Lord, Sri Kṛṣṇa, the primeval Lord. The Lord affirms this in the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (14.26):

*mää ca yo 'vyabhicäreëa
bhakti-yogena sevate
sa guëän samatétýaitän
brahma-bhüyäya kalpate*

Anyone, therefore, who is earnestly serious in heart and soul about being in intimate touch with the Personality of Godhead in the relationship of transcendental loving service will always be infallible in words and action. The reason is that the Supreme Lord is Absolute Truth, and anything earnestly dovetailed with the Absolute Truth attains the same transcendental quality. On the other hand, any amount of mental speculation on the strength of material science and knowledge without any bona fide touch with the Absolute Truth is sure to be a mundane untruth and failure, simply due to not being in touch with the Absolute Truth. Such godless, unfaithful words and actions, however materially enriched, are never to be trusted. That is the purport of this important verse. A grain of devotion is more valuable than tons of faithlessness.

TEXT 35

**Saae_h& SaMaaManaYaMaYaSTaPaaeMaYa"
Pa[JaaPaTaqNaaMai>aviNdTa" PaiTa")
AaSQaaYa YaaeGa& iNaPau<a& SaMaaihTa,
STa& NaaDYaGaC^& YaTa AaTMaSaM>av")) 35))**

so 'haà samämnäyamayas tapomayaù

prajāpaténäm abhivanditaù patiù

ästhäya yogaà nipuëää samāhitas

taà nädhyagacchaà yata ätma-sambhavaù

SYNONYMS

saù aham—myself (the great Brahmä); *samāmnäya-mayaù*—in the chain of disciplic succession of Vedic wisdom; *tapaù-mayaù*—successfully having undergone all austerities; *prajāpaténām*—of all the forefathers of living entities; *abhivanditaù*—worshipable; *patiù*—master; *ästhäya*—successfully practiced; *yogam*—mystic powers; *nipuëam*—very expert; *samāhitaù*—self-realized; *tam*—the Supreme Lord; *na*—did not; *adhyagaccham*—properly understood; *yataù*—from whom; *ätma*—self; *sambhavaù*—generated.

TRANSLATION

Although I am known as the great Brahmä, perfect in the disciplic succession of Vedic wisdom, and although I have undergone all austerities and am an expert in mystic powers and self-realization, and although I am recognized as such by the great forefathers of the living entities, who offer me respectful obeisances, still I cannot understand Him, the Lord, the very source of my birth.

PURPORT

Brahmä, the greatest of all living creatures within the universe, is admitting his failure to know the Supreme Lord despite his vast learning in the Vedic wisdom, despite his austerity, penance, mystic powers and self-realization, and despite being worshiped by the great Prajāpatis, the forefathers of the living entities. So these qualifications are not sufficient to know the Supreme Lord. Brahmäjé could understand the Lord to a little extent only when he was trying to serve Him by the eagerness of his heart (*hādaṭkaëöhyavatä*), which is the devotional service mood. Therefore, the Lord can be known only by the sincere mood of eagerness for service, and not by any amount of material qualification as scientist or speculative philosopher or by attainment of mystic powers. This fact is clearly corroborated in the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (18.54–55):

*brahma-bhūtaṁ prasannātmā
na śocati na kṛāṇāti
samaṁ sarveṇa bhūteṇa
mad-bhaktiā labhate parām*

*bhaktyā māṁ abhijānāti
yāvān yaç cāsmi tattvataṁ
tato mām tattvato jñātvā
viçate tad-anantaram*

Only self-realization, by attainment of the above high qualifications of Vedic wisdom, austerity, etc., can help one on the path of devotional service. But failing in devotional service, one remains still imperfect because even in that position of self-realization one cannot factually know the Supreme Lord. By self-realization, one is qualified to become a devotee, and the devotee, by service mood (*bhaktyā*) only, can gradually know the personality of Godhead. One should not, however, misunderstand the import of *viçate* ("enters into") as referring to merging into the existence of the Supreme. Even in material existence, one is merged in the existence of the Lord. No materialist can disentangle self from matter, for the self is merged in the external energy of the Lord. As no layman can separate butter from milk, no one can extricate the merged self from matter by acquiring some material qualification. This *viçate* by devotion (*bhaktyā*) means to be able to participate in the association of the Lord in person. *Bhakti*, or devotional service to the Lord, means to become free from material entanglement and then to enter into the kingdom of God, becoming one like Him. Losing one's individuality is not the aim of *bhakti-yoga* or of the devotees of the Lord. There are five types of liberation, one of which is called *sāyujya-mukti*, or being merged into the existence or body of the Lord. The other forms of liberation maintain the individuality of the particle soul and involve being always engaged in the transcendental loving service of the Lord. The word *viçate*, used in the verses of the *Bhagavad-gītā*, is thus meant for the devotees who are not at all anxious for any kind of liberation. The devotees are satisfied simply in being engaged in the service of the Lord, regardless of the situation.

Lord Brahmā is the first living being, who directly learned the Vedic wisdom

from the Lord (*tene brahma hādā ya ādi-kavaye*). Therefore, who can be a more learned Vedāntist than Lord Brahmā? He admits that in spite of his perfect knowledge in the *Vedas*, he was unable to know the glories of the Lord. Since no one can be more than Lord Brahmā, how can a so-called Vedāntist be perfectly cognizant of the Absolute Truth? The so-called Vedāntist, therefore, cannot enter into the existence of the Lord without being trained in the matter of *bhakti-vedānta*, or *Vedānta* plus *bhakti*. *Vedānta* means self-realization, and *bhakti* means realization of the Personality of Godhead, to some extent. No one can know the personality of Godhead in full, but at least to a certain extent one can know the Absolute Truth, the Personality of Godhead, by self-surrender and a devotional attitude, and by nothing else. In the *Brahma-saṃhitā* also, it is said, *vedeṇu durlabham*, or simply by study of *Vedānta* one can hardly find out the existence of the personality of Godhead, but the Lord is *adurlabham ātma-bhaktau*, very easily available to His devotee. Śrīla Vyāsadeva, therefore, was not satisfied simply with compiling the *Vedānta-sūtras*, but over and above this, by the advice of his spiritual master, Nārada, he compiled the *Srimad-Bhagavatam* in order to understand the real import of *Vedānta*. *Srimad-Bhagavatam* therefore, is the absolute medium by which to understand the Absolute Truth.

TEXT 36

NaTaae_SMYah& TaÀr<a& SaMaqYauza&
 >aviC^d& SvSTYaYaNa& SauMa®l/Ma()
 Yaae ùaTMaMaaYaaiv>av& SMa PaYaRGaad(
 YaQaa Na>a" SvaNTaMaQaaPare ku-Ta")) 36))

nato 'smy ahaà tac-caraëaà saméyuñäà

bhavac-chidaà svasty-ayanaà sumaìgalam

yo hy ātma-mäyā-vibhavaà sma paryagäd

yathä nabhaù svāntam athāpare kutaù

SYNONYMS

nataù—let me offer my obeisances; *asmi*—am; *aham*—I; *tat*—the Lord’s; *caraëam*—feet; *saméyuñäm*—of the surrendered soul; *bhavat-chidam*—that which stops repetition of birth and death; *svasti-ayanam*—perception of all happiness; *su-maigalam*—all-auspicious; *yaù*—one who; *hi*—exactly; *ätma-mäyä*—personal energies; *vibhavam*—potency; *sma*—certainly; *paryagät*—cannot estimate; *yathä*—as much as; *nabhaù*—the sky; *sva-antam*—its own limit; *atha*—therefore; *apare*—others; *kutaù*—how.

TRANSLATION

Therefore it is best for me to surrender unto His feet, which alone can deliver one from the miseries of repeated birth and death. Such surrender is all-auspicious and allows one to perceive all happiness. Even the sky cannot estimate the limits of its own expansion. So what can others do when the Lord Himself is unable to estimate His own limits?

PURPORT

Lord Brahmä, the greatest of all learned living beings, the greatest sacrificer, the greatest observer of the austere life, and the greatest self-realized mystic, advises us, as the supreme spiritual master of all living beings, that one should simply surrender unto the lotus feet of the Lord in order to achieve all success, even up to the limit of being liberated from the miseries of material life and being endowed with all-auspicious spiritual existence. Lord Brahmä is known as the *pitāmaha*, or the father’s father. A young man consults his experienced father about discharging his duties. So the father is naturally a good advisor. But Lord Brahmä is the father of all fathers. He is the father of the father of Manu, who is the father of mankind all over the universal planets. Therefore the men of this insignificant planet should kindly accept the instruction of Brahmäjé and would do well to surrender unto the lotus feet of the Lord rather than try to estimate the length and breadth of the Lord’s potencies. His potencies are immeasurable, as confirmed in the *Vedas*. *Paräsya çaktir vividhaiva çrüyate sväbhäviké jñäna-bala-kriyā ca* (*Çvetäçvatara Upaniñad* 6.8). He is the greatest of all, and all others, even the greatest of all living beings, namely Brahmäjé, admits that the best thing for us is to surrender unto Him. Therefore only those persons with a very poor fund of knowledge claim

that they themselves are lords of all that they survey. And what can they survey? They cannot survey even the length and breadth of a small sky in one small universe. The so-called material scientist says that he would need to live forty thousand years to reach the highest planet of the universe, being carried by a sputnik. This is also utopian because no one can be expected to live forty thousand years. Besides, when the space pilot returned from his travel, none of his friends would be present to receive him back as the greatest astronaut, as has become fashionable for modern bewildered scientific men. One scientific man, who had no belief in God, was very much enthusiastic in making plans for his material existence and therefore opened a hospital to save the living. But after opening the hospital, he himself died within six months. So one should not spoil his human life, species of life, simply for the concocted material happiness of life through increasing artificial needs in the name of advancement of economic development and scientific knowledge. Rather, one should simply surrender unto the feet of the Lord to make a solution to all miseries of life. That is the instruction of Lord Kṛṣṇa directly in the *Bhagavad-gita*, and that is the instruction of *Srimad-Bhagavatam* by Brahmājé, the supreme father of all living beings.

Anyone denying this surrendering process as recommended both in the *Bhagavad-gita* and in the *Srimad-Bhagavatam*—and, for that matter, in all authorized scriptures—will be forced to surrender unto the laws of material nature. The living entity, by his constitutional position, is not independent. He must surrender, either unto the Lord or unto material nature. Material nature is also not independent of the Lord, since the Lord Himself has claimed material nature as *mama māyā*, or “My energy” (Bg. 7.14), and as *me bhinnā prakāṭir aññadhā*, or “My separated energy in eight divisions” (Bg. 7.4). Therefore material nature is also controlled by the Lord, as He has claimed in ***Bhagavad-gita*** (9.10). *Mayādhyakñēēa prakāṭiù süyate sacarācaram*: “Under My direction only is material nature working, and thus are all things moving.” And the living entities, being superior energy to matter, have choice and discrimination either to surrender unto the Lord or to surrender unto material nature. By surrendering unto the Lord, one is happy and liberated, but by surrendering unto material nature the living entity suffers. So the end of all suffering means surrendering unto the Lord because the surrendering process itself is *bhava-cchidam* (liberation from

all material miseries), *svasty-ayanam* (perception of all happiness), and *sumaigalam* (the source of everything auspicious).

Therefore liberty, happiness and all good fortune can be attained only by surrendering unto the Lord because He is full liberty, full happiness and full auspiciousness. Such liberation and happiness are also unlimited, and they have been compared to the sky, although such liberation and happiness are infinitely greater than the sky. In our present position we can simply understand the magnitude of greatness when it is compared to the sky. We fail to measure the sky, but the happiness and liberty obtained in association with the Lord are far greater than the sky. That spiritual happiness is so great that it cannot be measured, even by the Lord Himself, not to speak of others.

It is said in the scriptures, *brahma-saukhyà tv anantam*: spiritual happiness is unlimited. Here it is said that even the Lord cannot measure such happiness. This does not mean that the Lord cannot measure it and is therefore imperfect in that sense. The actual position is that the Lord can measure it, but the happiness in the Lord is also identical with the Lord on account of absolute knowledge. So the happiness derived from the Lord may be measured by the Lord, but the happiness increases again, and the Lord measures it again, and then again the happiness increases more and more, and the Lord measures it more and more, and as such there is eternally a competition between increment and measurement, so much so that the competition is never stopped, but goes on unlimitedly *ad infinitum*. Spiritual happiness is *ānandāmbudhi-varḍhanam*, or the ocean of happiness which increases. The material ocean is stagnant, but the spiritual ocean is dynamic. In the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*, (*Ādi-līla*, Fourth Chapter) Kāvīrāja Gosvāmī has very nicely described this dynamic increment of the ocean of spiritual happiness in the transcendental person of Śrīmatī Rādhārāṣī, the pleasure potency of Lord Kṛṣṇa.

TEXT 37

**Naah& Na YaUYa& Yad*Taa& GaiTa& ivdu,
NaR vaMadedv" ik-MauTaaPare Saura")
TaNMaaYaYaa MaaeihTabuÖYaiSTvd&**

iviNaiMaRTa& caTMaSaMa& ivc+Mahe)) 37))

nāhaà na yūyaà yad-ātāà gatià vidur

na vāmadevaù kim utāpare suräù

tan-māyayā mohita-buddhayaś tv idaà

vinirmitaà cātma-samaà vicakñmahe

SYNONYMS

na—neither; *aham*—I; *na*—nor; *yūyam*—all you sons; *yat*—whose; *ātām*—factual; *gatiṁ*—movements; *viduḥ*—do know; *na*—nor; *vāmadevaù*—Lord Siva; *kim*—what; *uta*—else; *apare*—others; *suräù*—demigods; *tat*—by His; *māyayā*—by the illusory energy; *mohita*—bewildered; *buddhayaù*—with such intelligence; *tu*—but; *idam*—this; *vinirmitam*—what is created; *ca*—also; *ātma-samam*—by dint of one’s personal ability; *vicakñmahe*—observe.

TRANSLATION

Since neither Lord Siva nor you nor I could ascertain the limits of spiritual happiness, how can other demigods know it? And because all of us are bewildered by the illusory external energy of the Supreme Lord, we can see only this manifested cosmos according to our individual ability.

PURPORT

We have many times mentioned the names of twelve selected authorities (*dvādaça-mahājana*), of which Brahmā, Nārada and Lord Siva head the list as the first, second and third in order of merit of those who know something of the Supreme Lord. Other demigods, semi-demigods, Gandharvas, Cāraēas, Vidyādharaś, human beings or *asuraś* cannot possibly know fully about the potencies of the Absolute Lord, Sri Kṛṣṇa. The demigods, semi-demigods, Gandharvas, etc., are all highly intelligent persons in the upper planets, the human beings are inhabitants of the

intermediate planets, and the *asuras* are inhabitants of the lower planets. All of them have their respective conceptions and estimations of the Absolute Truth, as does the scientist or the empiric philosopher in human society. All such living entities are creatures of the material nature, and consequently they are bewildered by the wonderful display of the three modes of material nature. Such bewilderment is mentioned in the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (7.13). *Tribhir guëamayair bhävair ebhiù samam idaà jagat:* every entity, beginning from Brahmä down to the ant, is individually bewildered by the three modes of material nature, namely goodness, passion and ignorance. Everyone thinks, in terms of individual capacity, that this universe, which is manifested before us, is all in all. And so the scientist in the human society of the twentieth century calculates the beginning and end of the universe in his own way. But what can the scientists know? Even Brahmä himself was once bewildered, thinking himself the only one Brahmä favored by the Lord, but later on, by the grace of the Lord, he came to know that there are innumerable more powerful Brahmäs as well, in far bigger universes beyond this universe, and all of these universes combined together form *ekapäd-vibhüti*, or one fourth of the manifestation of the Lord's creative energy. The other three fourths of His energy are displayed in the spiritual world, and so what can the tiny scientist with a tiny brain know of the Absolute Personality of Godhead, Lord Kṛṣṇa? The Lord says, therefore, *mohitaà nābhijānāti mām ebhyaù param avyayam:* bewildered by such modes of material nature, they cannot understand that beyond these manifestations is a Supreme Person who is the absolute controller of everything. Brahmä, Nārada and Lord Siva know about the Lord to a considerable extent, and therefore one should follow the instructions of these great personalities instead of being satisfied with a tiny brain and its playful discoveries such as spacecraft and similar products of science. As the mother is the only authority to identify the father of a child, so the mother *Vedas*, presented by the recognized authority such as Brahmä, Nārada or Siva, is the only authority to inform us about the Absolute Truth.

TEXT 38

**YaSYaavTaark-MaaRi<a GaaYaiNTa ùSMadadYa")
Na Ya& ivdiNTa TatveNa TaSMaE >aGavTae NaMa")) 38))**

yasyāvatāra-karmāi

gāyanti hy asmat-ādayaù

na yaà vidanti tattvena

tasmai bhagavate namaù

SYNONYMS

yasya—whose; *avatāra*—incarnation; *karmāi*—activities; *gāyanti*—chant in glorification; *hi*—indeed; *asmat-ādayaù*—persons like us; *na*—do not; *yam*—whom; *vidanti*—know; *tattvena*—cent percent as He is; *tasmai*—unto Him; *bhagavate*—unto the personality of Godhead Sri Kṛṣṇa; *namaù*—respectful obeisances.

TRANSLATION

Let us offer our respectful obeisances unto that Supreme Personality of Godhead, whose incarnations and activities are chanted by us for glorification, though He can hardly be fully known as He is.

PURPORT

It is said that the transcendental name, form, quality, pastimes, paraphernalia, personality, etc., cannot possibly be perceived by the gross materialistic senses. But when the senses are purified by the process of hearing, chanting, remembering, and worshiping the lotus feet of the holy Deity, etc., the Lord reveals Himself proportionately to the advancement of the quality of devotional service (*ye yathā mää prapadyante*). One should not expect the Lord to be an order-supplying agent who must be present before us as soon as we desire to see Him. We must be ready to undergo the prescribed devotional duties, following the path shown by the predecessors in the disciplic succession from Brahmä, Nārada and similar authorities. As the senses are progressively purified by bona fide devotional service, the Lord reveals His identity according to the spiritual advancement of the devotee. But one who is not in the line of devotional service can

hardly perceive Him simply by calculations and philosophical speculations. Such a hard worker can present a jugglery of words before an audience, but can never know the Supreme Personality of Godhead in His personal feature. The Lord has clearly stated in the *Bhagavad-gita* that one can know Him only by devotional service. No one can know the Lord by any puffed-up material process of challenge, but the humble devotee can please the Lord by his earnest devotional activities. Thus the Lord reveals Himself proportionately before the devotee. Lord Brahmä therefore offers his respectful obeisances as a bona fide spiritual master and advises us to follow the process of *çravaëa* and *kértana*. Simply by this process, or simply by hearing and chanting the glories of the activities of the Lord's incarnation, one can certainly see within himself the identity of the Lord. We have already discussed this subject in volume one of *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, in connection with this verse:

*tac chraddadhänä munayo
jïäna-vairägya-yuktayä
paçyanty ätmani cätmänaà
bhaktyä çruta-gâhétayä*

(*Bhäg.* 1.2.12)

The conclusion is that one cannot know the Supreme Personality of Godhead fully by any method, but He can be seen and felt partially by the devotional service process of hearing, chanting, etc.

TEXT 39

**Sa Wz AaÛ" Pauåz" k-LPae k-LPae Sa*JaTYaJa")
AaTMaaTMaNYaaTMaNaaTMaaNa& Sa Sa&YaC^iT a PaaiTa c)) 39))**

sa eña ädyaù puruṣaù

kalpe kalpe sâjaty ajaù

ätmätmany ätmanätmänaà

sa saàyacchati pāti ca

SYNONYMS

saù—He; *eñau*—the very; *ädyaù*—the original Personality of Godhead; *puruṣaù*—the Mahā-Viṣṇu incarnation, a plenary portion of Govinda, Lord Kṛṣṇa; *kalpe kalpe*—in each and every millennium; *sājati*—creates; *ajaù*—the unborn; *ātmā*—self; *ātmani*—upon the self; *ātmanā*—by His own self; *ātmānam*—own self; *saù*—He; *saàyacchati*—absorbs; *pāti*—maintains; *ca*—also.

TRANSLATION

That supreme original Personality of Godhead, Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, expanding His plenary portion as Mahā-Viṣṇu, the first incarnation, creates this manifested cosmos, but He is unborn. The creation, however, takes place in Him, and the material substance and manifestations are all Himself. He maintains them for some time and absorbs them into Himself again.

PURPORT

The creation is nondifferent from the Lord, and still He is not in the creation. This is explained in the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (9.4) as follows:

*mayā tatam idaà sarvaà
jagad avyakta-mūrtinā
mat-sthāni sarva-bhūtāni
na cāhaà teñv avasthitaù*

The impersonal conception of the Absolute Truth is also a form of the Lord called *avyakta-mūrti*. *Mūrti* means “form,” but because His impersonal feature is inexplicable to our limited senses, He is the *avyakta-mūrti* form, and in that inexplicable form of the Lord the whole creation is resting; or, in other words, the whole creation is the Lord Himself, and the creation is also nondifferent from Him, but simultaneously He, as the original Personality of Godhead Sri Kṛṣṇa, is aloof from the created manifestation. The impersonalist gives stress to the impersonal form or feature of the Lord and

does not believe in the original personality of the Lord, but the Vaiñëavas accept the original form of the Lord, of whom the impersonal form is merely one of the features. The impersonal and personal conceptions of the Lord are existing simultaneously, and this fact is clearly described both in the *Bhagavad-gita* and in the *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, and also in other Vedic scriptures. Inconceivable to human intelligence, the idea must simply be accepted on the authority of the scriptures, and it can only be practically realized by the progress of devotional service unto the Lord, and never by mental speculation or inductive logic. The impersonalists depend more or less on inductive logic, and therefore they always remain in darkness about the original Personality of Godhead Sri Kṛṣṇa. Their conception of Kṛṣṇa is not clear, although everything is clearly mentioned in all the Vedic scriptures. A poor fund of knowledge cannot comprehend the existence of an original personal form of the Lord when He is expanded in everything. This imperfectness is due, more or less, to the material conception that a substance distributed widely in parts can no longer exist in the original form.

The original personality of Godhead (*ädyaù*), Govinda, expands Himself as the Mahä-Viṣṇu incarnation and rests in the Causal Ocean, which He Himself creates. The ***Brahma-saṁhitä*** (5.47) confirms this as follows:

*yaù käraëärëava-jale bhajati sma yoga-
nidräm ananta-jagad-aëöa-saroma-küpaù
ädhära-çaktim avalambya paräa sva-mürtià
govindam ädi-puruṣaà tam ahaà bhajämi*

Lord Brahmäjé says in his *Brahma-saṁhitä*, “I worship the primeval Lord Govinda, who lies down in the Causal Ocean in His plenary portion as Mahä-Viṣṇu, with all the universes generating from the pores of hair on His transcendental body, and who accepts the mystic slumber of eternity.”

So this Mahä-Viṣṇu is the first incarnation in the creation, and from Him all the universes are generated and all material manifestations are produced, one after another. The Causal Ocean is created by the Lord as the *mahat-tattva*, as a cloud in the spiritual sky, and is only a part of His different manifestations. The spiritual sky is an expansion of His personal rays, and

He is the *mahat-tattva* cloud also. He lies down and generates the universes by His breathing, and again, by entering into each universe as Garbhodakaśāyī Viṣṇu, He creates Brahmā, Siva and many other demigods for maintenance of the universe and again absorbs the whole thing into His person as confirmed in the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (9.7):

*sarva-bhūtāni kaunteya
prakāṭiā yānti māmikām
kalpa-kñāye punas tāni
kalpādaṁ visājāmy aham*

“O son of Kunté, when the *kalpa*, or the duration of the life of Brahmā, is ended, then all the created manifestations enter into My *prakāṭi*, or energy, and again, when I desire, the same creation takes place by My personal energy.”

The conclusion is that these are all but displays of the Lord’s inconceivable personal energies, of which no one can have any full information. This point we have already discussed.

TEXTS 40–41

ivéuÖ& ke-vl&/ jaNa& Pa[TYak(- SaMYaGaviSQaTaMa()
SaTYa& PaU<aRMaNaaÛNTa& iNaGauR<a& iNaTYaMaÛYaMa()) 40))
%ze ivdiNTa MauNaYa" Pa[XaaNTaaTMaeiNd]YaaXaYaa")
Yada TadevaSatakCE-iSTaraeDaqYaeTa ivPlu/TaMa()) 41))

viçuddhaà kevalaà jñānaà

pratyak samyag avasthitam

satyaà pūrēam anādy-antaà

nirguḍāà nityam advayam

āñe vidanti munayaù

praçäntätmendriyāçayäù

yadä tad eväsat-tarkais

tirodhéyeta viplutam

SYNONYMS

viçuddham—without any material tinge; *kevalam*—pure and perfect; *jñānam*—knowledge; *pratyak*—all-pervading; *samyak*—in fullness; *avasthitam*—situated; *satyam*—truth; *pūrēam*—absolute; *anādi*—without any beginning; *antam*—and so also without any end; *nirguēam*—devoid of material modes; *nityam*—eternal; *advayam*—without any rival; *āñe*—O Nārada, O great sage; *vidanti*—they can only understand; *munayaù*—the great thinkers; *praçānta*—pacified; *ātma*—self; *indriya*—senses; *āçayäù*—sheltered; *yadä*—while; *tat*—that; *eva*—certainly; *asat*—untenable; *tarkaiù*—arguments; *tiraù-dhéyeta*—disappears; *viplutam*—distorted.

TRANSLATION

The Personality of Godhead is pure, being free from all contaminations of material tinges. He is the Absolute Truth and the embodiment of full and perfect knowledge. He is all-pervading, without beginning or end, and without rival. O Nārada, O great sage, the great thinkers can know Him when completely freed from all material hankerings and when sheltered under undisturbed conditions of the senses. Otherwise, by untenable arguments, all is distorted, and the Lord disappears from our sight.

PURPORT

Here is an estimation of the Lord apart from His transcendental activities in the temporary, material creations. Māyāvāda philosophy tries to designate the Lord as contaminated by a material body when He accepts forms of incarnation. This sort of interpolation is completely denied herein by the explanation that the Lord's position is pure and unalloyed in all circumstances. According to Māyāvāda philosophy, the spirit soul, when covered by nescience, is designated as *jéva*, but when freed from such

ignorance or nescience he merges in the impersonal existence of the Absolute Truth. But here it is said that the Lord is eternally the symbol of full and perfect knowledge. This is His speciality: perpetual freedom from all material contaminations. This distinguishes the Lord from the individual, common living entities who have the aptitude for being subordinated by nescience and thus becoming materially designated. In the *Vedas* it is said that the Lord is *vijñānam ānandam*, full of bliss and knowledge. The conditioned souls are never to be compared to Him because such individual souls have the tendency to become contaminated. Although after liberation the living entity can become one with the same quality of existence as the Lord, his very tendency to become contaminated, which the Lord never has, makes the individual living entity different from the Lord. In the *Vedas* it is said, *çuddham apāpa-viddham*: the individual *ātmā* becomes polluted by sin, but the Lord is never contaminated by sins. The Lord is compared to the powerful sun. The sun is never contaminated by anything infectious because it is so powerful. On the contrary, infected things are sterilized by the rays of the sun. Similarly, the Lord is never contaminated by sins; on the contrary, the sinful living entities become sterilized by contact with the Lord. This means that the Lord is also all-pervading like the sun, and as such the word *pratyak* is used in this verse. Nothing is excluded from the existence of the Lord's potential expansions. The Lord is within everything, and He is all-covering also, without being disturbed by the activities of the individual souls. He is therefore infinite, and the living entities are infinitesimal. In the *Vedas* it is said that only the Lord alone exists, and all others' existences depend on Him. He is the generating reservoir for everyone's existential capacity; He is the Supreme Truth of all other categorical truths. He is the source of everyone's opulence, and therefore no one can equal Him in opulence. Being full of all opulences, namely wealth, fame, strength, beauty, knowledge and renunciation, certainly He is the Supreme Person. And because He is a person, He has many personal qualities, although He is transcendental to the material modes. We have already discussed the statement, *itthaà-bhūta-guëo hariù* (**Bhäg.** 1.7.10). His transcendental qualities are so attractive that even the liberated souls (*ātmārāmas*) are also attracted by them. Although possessed of all personal qualities, He is nevertheless omnipotent. Therefore, personally He has nothing to do, for everything is being carried out by His omnipotent energies. This is confirmed by the

Vedic mantras: *paräsya çaktir vividhaiva çrüyate sväbhäviké jïäna-bala-kriyä ca*. This suggests His specific spiritual form, which can never be experienced by the material senses. He can be seen only when the senses are purified by devotional service (*yam evaiña vâëute tena labhyaù*). As such, there are basic differences between the Lord and the living entities, in so many respects. No one can be compared to the Lord, as the *Vedas* declare (*ekam evädvitéyaà brahma, dvaitäd vai bhayaà bhavati*). The Lord has no competitor, and He has nothing to fear from any other being, nor can anyone be equal to Him. Although He is the root of all other beings, there are basic differences between Him and other beings. Otherwise there would have been no necessity for the statement in the previous verse that no one can know Him one hundred percent as He is (*na yaà vidanti tattvena*). That no one can fully understand Him is explained also in this verse, but the qualification for understanding to some degree is mentioned here. Only the *praçäntas*, or the unalloyed devotees of the Lord, can know Him to a greater extent. The reason is that the devotees have no demands in their lives but to be obedient servants of the Lord, while all others, namely the empiric philosophers, the mystics and the fruitive workers, all basically have some demand, and as such they cannot be pacified. The fruitive worker wants reward for his work, the mystic wants some perfection of life, and the empiric philosopher wants to merge in the existence of the Lord. Somehow or other, as long as there is a demand for sense satisfaction, there is no chance for pacification; on the contrary, by unnecessary dry speculative arguments, the whole matter becomes distorted, and thus the Lord moves still further away from our understanding. The dry speculators, however, because of their following the principles of austerity and penance, can have knowledge of the impersonal features of the Lord to some extent, but there is no chance of their understanding His ultimate form as Govinda because only the *amalätmanas*, or the completely sinless persons, can accept pure devotional service to the Lord, as confirmed in the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (7.28):

*yeñää tv anta-gataà päpaà
janänää puëya-karmaëäm
te dvandva-moha-nirmuktä
bhajante mäà dâòha-vratäù*

TEXT 42

AaÛae_vTaar" Pauâz" ParSYa
k-al/" Sv>aav" SadSaNMaNaê)
d]VYa& ivk-arae Gau<a wiNd]Yaai<a
ivra\$(Svra\$(SQaaòu cirZ<au >aUMan")) 42))

ädya 'vatärau puruṣau parasya

kālaù svabhāvaù sad-asan-maṇaḥ ca

dravyaà vikāro guëa indriyāëi

viräö svaräö sthäsnu cariñëu bhümnaù

SYNONYMS

ädyaù—first; *avatäraù*—incarnation; *puruṣau*—Käraëärëavaçäyë Viṣṇu; *parasya*—of the Lord; *kālaù*—time; *svabhāvaù*—space; *sat*—result; *asat*—cause; *manaù*—mind; *ca*—also; *dravyam*—elements; *vikāraù*—material ego; *guëaù*—modes of nature; *indriyāëi*—senses; *viräö*—the complete whole body; *svaräö*—Garbhodakaśāyī Viṣṇu; *sthäsnu*—immovable; *cariñëu*—movable; *bhümnaù*—of the Supreme Lord.

TRANSLATION

Käraëärëavaçäyë Viṣṇu is the first incarnation of the Supreme Lord, and He is the master of eternal time, space, cause and effects, mind, the elements, the material ego, the modes of nature, the senses, the universal form of the Lord, Garbhodakaśāyī Viṣṇu, and the sum total of all living beings, both moving and nonmoving.

PURPORT

That the material creation is not permanent has been discussed many times hereinbefore. The material creation is but a temporary exhibition of the material energy of the Almighty God. This material manifestation is

necessary to give a chance to the conditioned souls who are unwilling to associate with the Lord in the relationship of loving transcendental service. Such unwilling conditioned souls are not allowed to enter into the liberated life of spiritual existence because at heart they are not willing to serve. Instead, they want to enjoy themselves as imitation Gods. The living entities are constitutionally eternal servitors of the Lord, but some of them, because of misusing their independence, do not wish to serve; therefore they are allowed to enjoy the material nature, which is called *māyā*, or illusion. It is called illusion because the living beings under the clutches of *māyā* are not factually enjoyers, although they think that they are, being illusioned by *māyā*. Such illusioned living entities are given a chance at intervals to rectify their perverted mentality of becoming false masters of the material nature, and they are imparted lessons from the *Vedas* about their eternal relationship with the Supreme Lord Kṛṣṇa (*vedaṁ ca sarvair aham eva vedyam* [Bg. 15.15]). So the temporary creation of the material manifestation is an exhibition of the material energy of the Lord, and to manage the whole show the Supreme Lord incarnates Himself as the Kāraṇārēavaçāyē Viṣṇu just as a magistrate is deputed by the government to manage affairs temporarily. This Kāraṇodakaśāyī Viṣṇu causes the manifestation of material creation by looking over His material energy (*sa aikṣata*). In the first volume of this book we have already discussed to some extent the explanation of the verse *jagāhe pauruṣaṁ rūpam*. The duration of the illusory play of material creation is called a *kalpa*, and we have already discussed the creation's taking place in *kalpa* after *kalpa*. By His incarnation and potential activities, the complete ingredients of creation, namely time, space, cause, result, mind, the gross and subtle elements and their interactional modes of nature—goodness, passion and ignorance—and then the senses and their reservoir source, the gigantic universal form as the second incarnation Garbhodakaśāyī Viṣṇu, and all living beings, both moving and standing, which come out of the second incarnation, all became manifested. Ultimately, all these creative elements and the creation itself are but potential manifestations of the Supreme Lord; nothing is independent of the control of the Supreme Being. This first incarnation in the material creation, namely Kāraṇārēavaçāyē Viṣṇu, is the plenary part of the original Personality of Godhead, Sri Kṛṣṇa, described in the ***Brahma-saṁhitā*** (5.48) as follows:

*yasyaika-niçvasita-kālam athāvalambya
jévanti loma-vilajā jagad-aēða-nāthäù
viṣṇur mahän sa iha yasya kalä-viçeño
govindam ädi-puruṣaà tam ahaà bhajāmi*

All the innumerable universes are maintained only during the breathing period of Mahā-Viṣṇu, or Kāraēärēavaçäyé Viṣṇu, who is only a plenary part of Govinda, the original Personality of Godhead Lord Kṛṣṇa.

TEXTS 43–45

Ah& >avae Yaj wMae Pa[JaeXaa
d+aadYaae Yae >avdadYaê)
Svl/aeRk-Paal/a" %Gal/aek-Paal/a
Na*I/aek-Paal/aSTal/l/aek-Paal/a")) 43))
GaNDavRivÛaDarcar<aeXaa
Yae Ya+ar+aaerGaNaGaNaQaa")
Yae va %zq<aaMa*z>aa" iPaTa><aa&
dETYaeNd]iSaÖeirdaNaveNd]a")
ANYae c Yae Pa[eTaiPaXaac>aUTa,
kU-ZMaa<@YaadaeMa*GaPa+YaDaqXaa")) 44))
YaiTk-Ä l/aeke- >aGavNMahSv,
daeJa"SahSvd(bl/vTa(+aMaavTa()
é[qh□qiv>aUTYaaTMavdd(>auTaa<a|
Tatv& Par& æPavdSvæPaMa()) 45))

ahaà bhavo yajja ime prajeçä

dakñädayo ye bhavad-ädayaç ca

svarloka-päläù khagaloka-pälä

nāloka-päläs talaloka-päläù

gandharva-vidyādhara-cāraēeçä

ye yakña-rakñoraga-nāga-nāthäù

ye vä añéëäm añabhäù pitèëää

daityendra-siddheçvara-dānavendrāù

anye ca ye preta-piçāca-bhūta-

kūñmāëòā-yādo-māga-pakñy-adhéçäù

yat kīica loke bhagavan mahasvad

ojaù-sahasvad balavat kñamāvat

çré-hré-vibhūty-ātmavad adbhutārëää

tattvaà paraà rūpavad asva-rūpam

SYNONYMS

aham—myself (Brahmäjé); *bhavaù*—Lord Siva; *yajñaù*—Lord Viṣṇu; *ime*—all these; *prajā-éçäù*—the father of the living beings; *dakñā-ādayaù*—Dakñā, Maréci, Manu, etc.; *ye*—those; *bhavat*—yourself; *ādayaù ca*—and the bachelors (Sanat-kumāra and his brothers); *svarloka-pālāù*—the leaders of the heavenly planets; *khagaloka-pālāù*—the leaders of space travelers; *nāloka-pālāù*—the leaders of mankind; *talaloka-pālāù*—the leaders of the lower planets; *gandharva*—the residents of Gandharvaloka; *vidyādhara*—the residents of the Vidyādhara planet; *cāraëa-éçäù*—the leaders of the Cāraëas; *ye*—as also others; *yakñā*—the leaders of the Yakñas; *rakñā*—demons; *uraga*—snakes; *nāga-nāthäù*—the leaders of Nāgaloka (below the earth); *ye*—others; *vä*—also; *añéëäm*—of the sages; *añabhäù*—the chief; *pitèëäm*—of the forefathers; *daitya-indra*—leaders of the atheists; *siddha-éçvara*—leaders of the Siddhaloka planets (spacemen); *dānava-indrāù*—leaders of the non-Äryans; *anye*—besides them; *ca*—also; *ye*—those; *preta*—dead bodies; *piçāca*—evil spirits; *bhūta*—jinn; *kūñmāëòā*—a special type of evil spirit; *yādaù*—aquatics; *māga*—animals; *pakñi-adhéçäù*—giant eagles; *yat*—anything; *kim ca*—and everything; *loke*—in the world; *bhagavat*—possessed of *bhaga*, or extraordinary power; *mahasvat*—of a special degree; *ojaù-sahasvat*—specific mental and sensual dexterity;

balavat—possessed of strength; *kñamāvat*—possessed of forgiveness; *çré*—beauty; *hré*—ashamed of impious acts; *vibhūti*—riches; *ātmavat*—possessed of intelligence; *adbhuta*—wonderful; *arëam*—race; *tattvam*—specific truth; *param*—transcendental; *rūpavat*—as if the form of; *asva-rūpam*—not the form of the Lord.

TRANSLATION

I myself [Brahmā], Lord Siva, Lord Viṣṇu, great generators of living beings like Dakṣa and Prajāpati, yourselves [Nārada and the Kumāras], heavenly demigods like Indra and Candṛa, the leaders of the Bhūloka planets, the leaders of the earthly planets, the leaders of the lower planets, the leaders of the Gandharva planets, the leaders of the Vidyādhara planets, the leaders of the Cāraēaloka planets, the leaders of the Yakṣas, Rakṣas and Uragas, the great sages, the great demons, the great atheists and the great spacemen, as well as the dead bodies, evil spirits, satans, jinn, kṛmāḥ, great aquatics, great beasts and great birds, etc.—in other words, anything and everything which is exceptionally possessed of power, opulence, mental and perceptual dexterity, strength, forgiveness, beauty, modesty, opulence, and breeding, whether in form or formless—may appear to be the specific truth and the form of the Lord, but actually they are not so. They are only a fragment of the transcendental potency of the Lord.

PURPORT

Those in the list given above, beginning from the name Brahmājé, the first living creature within the universe, down to Lord Siva, Lord Viṣṇu, Nārada and other powerful demigods, men, supermen, sages, *āñis*, and other lower creatures of extraordinary strength and opulence, including the dead bodies, satans, evil spirits, jinn, aquatics, birds and beasts, may appear to be the Supreme Lord, but factually none of them is the Supreme Lord; every one of them possesses only a fragment of the great potencies of the Supreme Lord. The less intelligent man is surprised to see the wonderful actions of material phenomena, as the aborigines are fearful of a great thunderbolt, a great and gigantic banyan tree, or a great lofty mountain in the jungle. For such undeveloped human beings, merely the slight display

of the Lord's potency is captivating. A still more advanced person is captivated by the powers of the demigods and goddesses. Therefore, those who are simply astonished by the powers of anything in the creation of the Lord, without any factual information of the Lord Himself, are known as *çaktas*, or worshipers of the great powers. The modern scientist is also captivated by the wonderful actions and reactions of natural phenomena and therefore is also a *çakta*. These lower-grade persons gradually rise to become *sauréyas* (worshipers of the sun-god) or *gäëapatyas* (worshipers of the mass of people as *janatä janärdana* or *daridra-näräyaëa*, etc., in the form of Gaëapati) and then rise to the platform of worshiping Lord Siva in search for the ever-existing soul, and then to the stage of worshiping Lord Viṣṇu, the Supersoul, etc., without any information of Govinda, Lord Kṛṣṇa, who is the original Lord Viṣṇu. In other ways some are worshipers of race, nationality, birds, beasts, evil spirits, satans, etc. The general worship of Śanideva, the lord of distressful condition, and Sétalädevé, the goddess of smallpox, is also common to the mass of people, and there are many foolish men who worship the mass of people or the poor class of men. So different persons, societies and communities, etc., worship some of the potent manifestations of the Lord, wrongly accepting the powerful object as God. But in this verse it is advised by Brahmäjé that none of them is the Supreme Lord; they are only borrowed plumes from the original Almighty Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa. When the Lord advises in *Bhagavad-gita* to worship Him alone, it is to be understood that worshiping Lord Kṛṣṇa includes worshiping all that is mentioned, because He, Lord Kṛṣṇa, includes everyone.

When the Lord is described as formless in the Vedic literatures, it is to be understood that all these forms mentioned above, within the experience of universal knowledge, are different exhibitions of the Lord's transcendental potencies only, and none of them factually represents the transcendental form of the Lord. But when the Lord actually descends on the earth or anywhere within the universe, the less intelligent class of men also mistake Him to be one of them, and thus they imagine the Transcendence to be formless or impersonal. Factually, the Lord is not formless, nor does He belong to any of the multiforms experienced within the universal forms. One should try to know the truth about the Lord by following the instruction of Brahmäjé.

TEXT 46

Pa[aDaaNYaTaae YaaNa*z AaMaNaiNTa
I/Il/avTaaraNa(PauâzSYa >aUMa")
AaPaqYaTaa& k-<aRk-zaYaXaaeza,
NaNau§-iMaZYae Ta wMaaNa(SauPaeXaaNa()) 46))

prādhānyato yān āñña āmananti

līlavatārān puruṣasya bhūmnaù

āpéyatāà karēa-kañāya-ṣoñān

anukramiñye ta imān supeṣān

SYNONYMS

prādhānyataù—chiefly; *yān*—all those; *āñña*—O Nārada; *āmananti*—worship; *līla*—pastimes; *avatārān*—incarnations; *puruṣasya*—of the personality of Godhead; *bhūmnaù*—the Supreme; *āpéyatām*—in order to be relished by you; *karēa*—ears; *kañāya*—foul matter; *ṣoñān*—that which evaporates; *anukramiñye*—shall state one after another; *te*—they; *imān*—as they are in my heart; *su-peṣān*—all pleasing to hear.

TRANSLATION

O Nārada, now I shall state, one after another, the transcendental incarnations of the Lord known as līla-avatāras. Hearing of their activities counteracts all foul matters accumulated in the ear. These pastimes are pleasing to hear and are to be relished. Therefore they are in my heart.

PURPORT

As it was said in the beginning of *Srīmad-Bhagavatam* (1.5.8), one cannot be fully satisfied by hearing unless and until one is given a chance to hear of the transcendental activities of the Lord. So Brahmājé is also trying, in this verse, to stress the importance of narrating the transcendental pastimes of

the Lord as He comes and manifests Himself here on the surface of the material planets. Every living entity has a tendency to hear pleasing messages, and as such almost every one of us is inclined to hear news and talks broadcast by the radio stations. But the difficulty is that no one is satisfied at heart by hearing all those messages. The cause of such dissatisfaction is the incompatibility of the message with the innermost stratum of the living soul. This transcendental literature is especially prepared by Srila Vyāsadeva to give the utmost satisfaction to the people in general by narration of the activities of the Lord, as instructed by Sri Nārada Muni to Srila Vyāsadeva. Such activities of the Lord are principally of two varieties. One concerns the mundane manifestation of the material creative force, and the other deals with His pastimes in the form of different incarnations in terms of the time and place. There are innumerable incarnations of the Lord, like the waves of the river flowing constantly in and out. Less intelligent persons take more interest in the creative forces of the Lord in the material world, and, being disconnected from their relationship with the Lord, they put forward many theories of the creation in the name of scientific research. The devotees of the Lord, however, know well how the creative forces work concurrently by the action and reaction of the material energy of the Lord. Therefore they take more interest in the transcendental activities of the Lord as He incarnates Himself on the surface of the material world. *Srimad-Bhagavatam* is the history of such activities of the Lord, and people who take interest in hearing *Srimad-Bhagavatam* clear their hearts of accumulated mundane filth. There are a thousand and one rash literatures on the market, but one who has taken interest in the *Srimad-Bhagavatam* loses all interest in such filthy literatures. Sri Brahmājé is thus attempting to narrate the principal incarnations of the Lord so that they may be drunk by Nārada as transcendental nectar.

Thus end the Bhaktivedanta purports of the Second Canto, Sixth Chapter, of the Srimad-Bhagavatam, entitled "Puruña-sūkta Confirmed."

Chapter Seven

Scheduled Incarnations with Specific Functions

TEXT 1

b]øaevac

Ya}aaeÛTa" i+aiTaTal/aeÖr<aaYa ib>a]Ta(
§-aE@q& TaNau& Sak-l/YajMaYaqMaNaNTa")
ANTaMaRha<aRv oPaaGaTaMaaiddETYa&
Ta& d&í\Yaaid]iMav vJa]Darae ddar)) 1))

brahmovāca

yatrodyataù kñiti-taloddharaëäya bibhrat

krauòéà tanuà sakala-yajña-mayém anantaù

antar-mahäreava upägatam ädi-daityaà

taà daññörayädrim iva vajra-dharo dadära

SYNONYMS

brahmä uvāca—Lord Brahmä said; *yatra*—at that time (when); *udyataù*—attempted; *kñiti-tala*—the planet earth; *uddharaëäya*—for the matter of lifting; *bibhrat*—assumed; *krauòém*—pastimes; *tanum*—form; *sakala*—total; *yajña-mayém*—all-inclusive sacrifices; *anantaù*—the Unlimited; *antar*—within the universe; *mahä-arëave*—the great Garbha Ocean; *upägatam*—having arrived at; *ädi*—the first; *daityam*—demon; *tam*—him; *daññörayä*—by the tusk; *adrim*—the flying mountains; *iva*—like; *vajra-dharaù*—the controller of the thunderbolts; *dadära*—pierced.

TRANSLATION

Lord Brahmä said: When the unlimitedly powerful Lord assumed the form of a boar as a pastime, just to lift the planet earth, which was drowned in the great ocean of the universe called the Garbhodaka, the first demon [Hiraëyäkñä] appeared, and the Lord pierced him with His tusk.

PURPORT

Since the beginning of creation, the demons and the demigods, or the Vaiñëavas, are always the two classes of living beings to dominate the planets of the universes. Lord Brahmä is the first demigod, and Hiraëyäkñä is the first demon in this universe. Only under certain conditions do the planets float as weightless balls in the air, and as soon as these conditions are disturbed, the planets may fall down in the Garbhodaka Ocean, which covers half the universe. The other half is the spherical dome within which the innumerable planetary systems exist. The floating of the planets in the weightless air is due to the inner constitution of the globes, and the modernized drilling of the earth to exploit oil from within is a sort of disturbance by the modern demons and can result in a greatly harmful reaction to the floating condition of the earth. A similar disturbance was created formerly by the demons headed by Hiraëyäkñä (the great exploiter of the gold rush), and the earth was detached from its weightless condition and fell down into the Garbhodaka Ocean. The Lord, as maintainer of the whole creation of the material world, therefore assumed the gigantic form of a boar with a proportionate snout and picked up the earth from within the water of Garbhodaka. Sri Jayadeva Gosvami, the great Vaiñëava poet, sang as follows:

*vasati daçana-çikhare dharaëé tava lagnä
çaçini kalaika-kaleva nimagnä
keçava dhâta-çükara-rüpa
jaya jagadéça hare*

“O Keçava! O Supreme Lord who have assumed the form of a boar! O Lord! The planet earth rested on Your tusks, and it appeared like the moon engraved with spots.”

Such is the symptom of an incarnation of the Lord. The incarnation of the Lord is not the concocted idea of fanciful men who create an incarnation out of imagination. The incarnation of the Lord appears under certain extraordinary circumstances like the above-mentioned occasion, and the incarnation performs a task which is not even imaginable by the tiny brain of mankind. The modern creators of the many cheap incarnations may take note of the factual incarnation of God as the gigantic boar with a suitable snout to carry the planet earth.

When the Lord appeared to pick up the earth, the demon of the name Hiraëyākñā tried to create a disturbance in the methodical functions of the Lord, and therefore he was killed by being pierced by the Lord's tusk. According to Srila Jiva Gosvami, the demon Hiraëyākñā was killed by the hand of the Lord. Therefore his version is that after being killed by the hand of the Lord, the demon was pierced by the tusk. Srila Visvanatha Cakravarti Öhäkura confirms this version.

TEXT 2

JaaTaae åcerJaNaYaTa(SauYaMaaNa(SauYaj
AakU-iTaSaUNaurMaraNaQa di+a<aaYaaMa()
I/aek-}aYaSYa MahTaqMahrd(YadaïTa|
SvaYaM>auveNa MaNauNaa hirirTYaNaUç-")) 2))

jātaù rucer ajanayat suyamān suyajīa

ākūti-sūnur amarān atha dakñiëäyām

loka-trayasya mahatém aharad yad ärtià

svâyambhuvena manunä harir ity anüktaù

SYNONYMS

jātaù—was born; *ruceù*—of the wife of Prajāpati; *ajanayat*—gave birth; *suyamān*—headed by Suyama; *suyajīaù*—Suyajīa; *ākūti-sūnuù*—of the son of Äküti; *amarān*—the demigods; *atha*—thus; *dakñiëäyām*—unto the wife of the name Dakñiëä; *loka*—the planetary systems; *trayasya*—of the three; *mahatém*—very great; *aharat*—diminished; *yat*—all those; *ärtim*—distresses; *svâyambhuvena*—by the Manu named Svayambhuva; *manunä*—by the father of mankind; *hariù*—Hari; *iti*—thus; *anüktaù*—named.

TRANSLATION

The Prajāpati first begot Suyajīa, in the womb of his wife Äküti, and then Suyajīa begot demigods, headed by Suyama, in the womb of his wife

Dakñiëä. Suyajia, as the Indradeva, diminished very great miseries in the three planetary systems [upper, lower and intermediate], and because he so diminished the miseries of the universe, he was later called Hari by the great father of mankind, namely Svayambhuva Manu.

PURPORT

In order to guard against the invention of unauthorized incarnations of God by the fanciful, less intelligent persons, the name of the father of the bona fide incarnation is also mentioned in the authorized revealed scriptures. No one, therefore, can be accepted as an incarnation of the Lord if his father's name, as well as the name of the village or place in which he appears, is not mentioned by the authorized scriptures. In the *Bhāgavata Purana* the name of the Kalki incarnation, which is to take place in almost four hundred thousand years, is mentioned along with the name of His father and the name of the village in which He will appear. A sane man, therefore, does not accept any cheap edition of an incarnation without reference to the authorized scriptures.

TEXT 3

**Jaje c k-dRMaGa*he iÜJa devhUTYaa&
ñqi>a" SaMa& Navi>araTMaGaiTa& SvMaa}ae)
Oce YaYaaTMaXaMal&/ Gau<aSa®Pa³,
MaiSMaNa(ivDaUYa k-iPal/SYa GaiTa& Pa[Paede)) 3))**

jajie ca kardama-gāhe dvija devahütyäà

strébhiù samaà navabhir ätma-gatià sva-mätre

üce yayätma-çamalaà guëa-saiga-paikam

asmin vidhüya kapilasya gatià prapede

SYNONYMS

jajie—took birth; *ca*—also; *kardama*—the Prajapati named Kardama;

gāhe—in the house of; *dvija*—O *brahmana*; *devahütyām*—in the womb of Devahüti; *strébhiù*—by women; *samam*—accompanied by; *navabhiù*—by nine; *ätma-gatim*—spiritual realization; *sva-mätre*—unto His own mother; *üce*—uttered; *yayä*—by which; *ätma-çamalam*—coverings of the spirit soul; *guëa-saiga*—associated with the modes of nature; *paikam*—mud; *asmin*—this very life; *vidhüya*—being washed off; *kapilasya*—of Lord Kapila; *gatim*—liberation; *prapede*—achieved.

TRANSLATION

The Lord then appeared as the Kapila incarnation, being the son of the prajāpati brahmana Kardama and his wife, Devahüti, along with nine other women [sisters]. He spoke to His mother about self-realization, by which, in that very lifetime, she became fully cleansed of the mud of the material modes and thereby achieved liberation, the path of Kapila.

PURPORT

The instructions of Lord Kapila to His mother Devahüti are fully described in the Third Canto (Chapters 25–32) of the *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, and anyone who follows the instructions can achieve the same liberation obtained by Devahüti. The Lord spoke *Bhagavad-gita*, and thereby Arjuna achieved self-realization, and even today anyone who follows the path of Arjuna can also attain the same benefit as Sri Arjuna. The scriptures are meant for this purpose. Foolish, unintelligent persons make their own interpretations by imagination and thus mislead their followers, causing them to remain in the dungeon of material existence. However, simply by following the instructions imparted by Lord Kṛṣṇa or Lord Kapila, one can obtain the highest benefit, even today.

The word *ätma-gatim* is significant in the sense of perfect knowledge of the Supreme. One should not be satisfied simply by knowing the qualitative equality of the Lord and the living being. One should know the Lord as much as can be known by our limited knowledge. It is impossible for the Lord to be known perfectly as He is, even by such liberated persons as Siva or Brahmä, so what to speak of other demigods or men in this world. Still, by following the principles of the great devotees and the instructions

available in the scriptures, one can know to a considerable extent the features of the Lord. His Lordship Kapila, the incarnation of the Lord, instructed His mother fully about the personal form of the Lord, and thereby she realized the personal form of the Lord and was able to achieve a place in the Vaikunthaloka where, Lord Kapila predominates. Every incarnation of the Lord has His own abode in the spiritual sky. Therefore Lord Kapila also has His separate Vaikuntha planet. The spiritual sky is not void. There are innumerable Vaikuntha planets, and in each of them the Lord, by His innumerable expansions, predominates, and the pure devotees who are there also live in the same style as the Lord and His eternal associates.

When the Lord descends personally or by His personal plenary expansions, such incarnations are called *aàça*, *kalä*, *guëa*, *yuga* and *manvantara* incarnations, and when the Lord's associates descend by the order of the Lord, such incarnations are called *çaktyäveça* incarnations. But in all cases all the incarnations are supported by the invulnerable statements of the authorized scriptures, and not by any imagination of some self-interested propagandist. Such incarnations of the Lord, in either of the above categories, always declare the Supreme Personality of Godhead to be the ultimate truth. The impersonal conception of the supreme truth is just a process of negation of the form of the Lord from the mundane conception of the supreme truth.

The living entities, by their very constitution, are spiritually as good as the Lord, and the only difference between them is that the Lord is always supreme and pure, without contamination by the modes of material nature, whereas the living entities are apt to be contaminated by association with the material modes of goodness, passion and ignorance. This contamination by the material modes can be washed off completely by knowledge, renunciation and devotional service. Devotional service to the Lord is the ultimate issue, and therefore those who are directly engaged in the devotional service of the Lord not only acquire the necessary knowledge in spiritual science, but also attain detachment from material connection and are thus promoted to the kingdom of God by complete liberation, as stated in the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (14.26):

*mää ca yo 'vyabhicäreëa
bhakti-yogena sevate
sa guëän samatétyaitän
brahma-bhüyäya kalpate*

Even in the nonliberated stage, a living entity can be directly engaged in the transcendental loving service of the Personality of Godhead Lord Kṛṣṇa or His plenary expansions like Rāma and Narasiàha. Thus, with the proportionate improvement of such transcendental devotional service, the devotee makes definite progress toward *brahma-gatim* or *ätma-gatim*, and ultimately attains *kapilasya gatim*, or the abode of the Lord, without difficulty. The antiseptic potency of devotional service to the Lord is so great that it can neutralize the material infection even in the present life of a devotee. A devotee does not need to wait for his next birth for complete liberation.

TEXT 4

**A}aerPaTYaMai>ak-açTa Aah Tauíae
dtaae MaYaahiMaiTa Yad(>aGavaNa(Sa dta")
YaTPaadPaªJaParaGaPaiv}adeha
YaaeGaiÖRMaaPauâ>aYaq& YaduhEhYaaÛa")) 4))**

atrer apatyam abhikäkñata äha tuñöo

datto mayäham iti yad bhagavän sa dattaù

yat-päda-paikaja-paräga-pavitra-dehä

yogarddhim äpur ubhayéà yadu-haihayädyäù

SYNONYMS

atreù—of the sage Atri; *apatyam*—issue; *abhikäkñataù*—having prayed for; *äha*—said it; *tuñöaù*—being satisfied; *dattaù*—given over; *mayä*—by me; *aham*—myself; *iti*—thus; *yat*—because; *bhagavän*—the Personality of Godhead; *saù*—He; *dattaù*—Dattatreya; *yat-päda*—one whose feet;

paikaja—lotus; *parāga*—dust; *pavitra*—purified; *dehāu*—body; *yoga*—mystic; *āddhim*—opulence; *āpuu*—got; *ubhayém*—for both the worlds; *yadu*—the father of the Yadu dynasty; *haihaya-ādyāu*—and others, like King Haihaya.

TRANSLATION

The great sage Atri prayed for offspring, and the Lord, being satisfied with him, promised to incarnate as Atri's son, Dattatreya [Datta, the son of Atri]. And by the grace of the lotus feet of the Lord, many Yadus, Haihayas, etc., became so purified that they obtained both material and spiritual blessings.

PURPORT

Transcendental relations between the Personality of Godhead and the living entities are eternally established in five different affectionate humors, which are known as *çānta*, *dāsyā*, *sakhya*, *vātsalya* and *mādhurya*. The sage Atri was related with the Lord in the affectionate *vātsalya* humor, and therefore, as a result of his devotional perfection, he was inclined to have the Personality of Godhead as his son. The Lord accepted his prayer, and He gave Himself as the son of Atri. Such a relation of sonhood between the Lord and His pure devotees can be cited in many instances. And because the Lord is unlimited, He has an unlimited number of father-devotees. Factually the Lord is the father of all living entities, but out of transcendental affection and love between the Lord and His devotees, the Lord takes more pleasure in becoming the son of a devotee than in becoming one's father. The father actually serves the son, whereas the son only demands all sorts of services from the father; therefore a pure devotee who is always inclined to serve the Lord wants Him as the son, and not as the father. The Lord also accepts such service from the devotee, and thus the devotee becomes more than the Lord. The impersonalists desire to become one with the Supreme, but the devotee becomes more than the Lord, surpassing the desire of the greatest monist. Parents and other relatives of the Lord achieve all mystic opulences automatically because of their intimate relationship with the Lord. Such opulences include all details of material enjoyment, salvation and mystic powers. Therefore, the

devotee of the Lord does not seek them separately, wasting his valuable time in life. The valuable time of one's life must therefore be fully engaged in the transcendental loving service of the Lord. Then other desirable achievements are automatically gained. But even after obtaining such achievements, one should be on guard against the pitfall of offenses at the feet of the devotees. The vivid example is Haihaya, who achieved all such perfection in devotional service but, because of his offense at the feet of a devotee, was killed by Lord Paraçurāma. The Lord became the son of the great sage Atri and became known as Dattatreya.

TEXT 5

**Taá& TaPaae ivivDal/aek-iSaSa*+aYaa Mae
AadaE SaNaaTa(SvTaPaSa" Sa cTau"SaNaee_>aUTa()
Pa[aj-LPaSaMâvivNaíiMahaTMaTatv&
SaMYaGa(JaGaad MauNaYaae Yadc+aTaaTMaNa()) 5))**

taptaà tapo vividha-loka-sisåññayä me

ädau sanät sva-tapasaù sa catuù-sano 'bhüt

präk-kalpa-samplava-vinaññöam ihätma-tattvaà

samyag jagäda munayo yad acakñätätman

SYNONYMS

taptam—having undergone austerities; *tapau*—penance; *vividha-loka*—different planetary systems; *sisåññayä*—desiring to create; *me*—of mine; *ädau*—at first; *sanät*—from the Personality of Godhead; *sva-tapasaù*—by dint of my own penances; *saù*—He (the Lord); *catuù-sanaù*—the four bachelors named Sanat-kumära, Sanaka, Sanandana and Sanätana; *abhüt*—appeared; *präk*—previous; *kalpa*—creation; *samplava*—in the inundation; *vinaññöam*—devastated; *iha*—in this material world; *ätma*—the spirit; *tattvam*—truth; *samyak*—in complete; *jagäda*—became manifested; *munayaù*—sages; *yat*—that which; *acakñata*—saw clearly; *ätman*—the spirit.

TRANSLATION

To create different planetary systems I had to undergo austerities and penance, and the Lord, thus being pleased with me, incarnated in four *sanas* [Sanaka, Sanat-kumāra, Sanandana and Sanātana]. In the previous creation the spiritual truth was devastated, but the four *sanas* explained it so nicely that the truth at once became clearly perceived by the sages.

PURPORT

The *Viṣṇu-sahasra-nāma* prayers mention the Lord's name as *sanāt* and *sanātanatama*. The Lord and the living entities are both qualitatively *sanātana*, or eternal, but the Lord is *sanātana-tama* or the eternal in the superlative degree. The living entities are positively *sanātana*, but not superlatively, because the living entities are apt to fall to the atmosphere of noneternity. Therefore, the living entities are quantitatively different from the superlative *sanātana*, the Lord.

The word *san* is also used in the sense of charity; therefore when everything is given up in charity unto the Lord, the Lord reciprocates by giving Himself unto the devotee. This is also confirmed in the ***Bhagavad-gīta*** (4.11): *ye yathā māṁ prapadyante*. Brahmājé wanted to create the whole cosmic situation as it was in the previous millennium, and because, in the last devastation, knowledge of the Absolute Truth was altogether erased from the universe, he desired that the same knowledge again be renovated; otherwise there would be no meaning in the creation. Because transcendental knowledge is a prime necessity, the ever-conditioned souls are given a chance for liberation in every millennium of creation. This mission of Brahmājé was fulfilled by the grace of the Lord when the four *sanas*, namely Sanaka, Sanat-kumāra, Sanandana and Sanātana, appeared as his four sons. These four *sanas* were incarnations of the knowledge of the Supreme Lord, and as such they explained transcendental knowledge so explicitly that all the sages could at once assimilate this knowledge without the least difficulty. By following in the footsteps of the four Kumāras, one can at once see the Supreme Personality of Godhead within oneself.

TEXT 6

DaMaRSYa d+aduihTaYaRJaiNaí MaUTYaa |
NaaraYa<aae Nar wiTa SvTaPa"Pa[>aav")
d*îaTMaNaee >aGavTaae iNaYaMaavl/aePa&
deVYaSTvNa®Pa*TaNaai\$=Tau& Na Xaeku-")) 6))

dharmasya dakña-duhitary ajaniñña mürtyää

nārāyaëo nara iti sva-tapaù-prabhāvaù

dāñvātmano bhagavato niyamāvalopaà

devyas tv anaiga-pātanä ghaöituà na çekuù

SYNONYMS

dharmasya—of Dharma (the controller of religious principles); *dakña*—Dakña, one of the Prajāpatis; *duhitari*—unto the daughter; *ajaniñña*—took birth; *mürtyäm*—of the name Mürti; *nārāyaëaù*—Nārāyaṇa; *naraù*—Nara; *iti*—thus; *sva-tapaù*—personal penances; *prabhāvaù*—strength; *dāñvā*—by seeing; *ātmanaù*—of His own; *bhagavataù*—of the Personality of Godhead; *niyama-avalopam*—breaking the vow; *devyaù*—celestial beauties; *tu*—but; *anaiga-pātanäù*—companion of Cupid; *ghaöitum*—to happen; *na*—never; *çekuù*—made possible.

TRANSLATION

To exhibit His personal way of austerity and penance, He appeared in twin forms as Nārāyaṇa and Nara in the womb of Mürti, the wife of Dharma and the daughter of Dakña. Celestial beauties, the companions of Cupid, went to try to break His vows, but they were unsuccessful, for they saw that many beauties like them were emanating from Him, the Personality of Godhead.

PURPORT

The Lord, being the source of everything that be, is the origin of all austerities and penances also. Great vows of austerity are undertaken by

sages to achieve success in self-realization. Human life is meant for such *tapasya*, with the great vow of celibacy, or *brahmacarya*. *In the rigid life of tapasya, there is no place for the association of women.* And because human life is meant for *tapasya*, for self-realization, factual human civilization, as conceived by the system of *sanātana-dharma* or the school of four castes and four orders of life, prescribes rigid dissociation from woman in three stages of life. In the order of gradual cultural development, one's life may be divided into four divisions: celibacy, household life, retirement, and renunciation. During the first stage of life, up to twenty-five years of age, a man may be trained as a *brahmacārē* under the guidance of a bona fide spiritual master just to understand that woman is the real binding force in material existence. If one wants to get freedom from the material bondage of conditional life, he must get free from the attraction for the form of woman. Woman, or the fair sex, is the enchanting principle for the living entities, and the male form, especially in the human being, is meant for self-realization. The whole world is moving under the spell of womanly attraction, and as soon as a man becomes united with a woman, he at once becomes a victim of material bondage under a tight knot. The desires for lording it over the material world, under the intoxication of a false sense of lordship, specifically begin just after the man's unification with a woman. The desires for acquiring a house, possessing land, having children and becoming prominent in society, the affection for community and the place of birth, and the hankering for wealth, which are all like phantasmagoria or illusory dreams, encumber a human being, and he is thus impeded in his progress toward self-realization, the real aim of life. The *brahmacāri*, or a boy from the age of five years, especially from the higher castes, namely from the scholarly parents (the *brahmanas*), the administrative parents (the *kṣatriyas*), or the mercantile or productive parents (the *vaisyas*), is trained until twenty-five years of age under the care of a bona fide *guru* or teacher, and under strict observance of discipline he comes to understand the values of life along with taking specific training for a livelihood. The *brahmacārē* is then allowed to go home and enter householder life and get married to a suitable woman. But there are many *brahmacārēs* who do not go home to become householders but continue the life of *naiñōhika-brahmacārēs*, without any connection with women. They accept the order of *sannyāsa*, or the renounced order of life, knowing well that combination with women is

an unnecessary burden that checks self-realization. Since sex desire is very strong at a certain stage of life, the *guru* may allow the *brahmacārē* to marry; this license is given to a *brahmacārē* who is unable to continue the way of *naiñöhika-brahmacarya*, and such discriminations are possible for the bona fide *guru*. A program of so-called family planning is needed. The householder who associates with woman under scriptural restrictions, after a thorough training of *brahmacarya*, cannot be a householder like cats and dogs. Such a householder, after fifty years of age, would retire from the association of woman as a *vānaprastha* to be trained to live alone without the association of woman. When the practice is complete, the same retired householder becomes a *sannyāsē*, strictly separate from woman, even from his married wife. Studying the whole scheme of disassociation from women, it appears that a woman is a stumbling block for self-realization, and the Lord appeared as Nārāyaṇa to teach the principle of womanly disassociation with a vow in life. The demigods, being envious of the austere life of the rigid *brahmacārēs*, would try to cause them to break their vows by dispatching soldiers of Cupid. But in the case of the Lord, it became an unsuccessful attempt when the celestial beauties saw that the Lord can produce innumerable such beauties by His mystic internal potency and that there was consequently no need to be attracted by others externally. There is a common proverb that a confectioner is never attracted by sweetmeats. The confectioner, who is always manufacturing sweetmeats, has very little desire to eat them; similarly, the Lord, by His pleasure potential powers, can produce innumerable spiritual beauties and not be the least attracted by the false beauties of material creation. One who does not know alleges foolishly that Lord Kṛṣṇa enjoyed women in His *rāsa-līla* in Vāndāvana, or with His sixteen thousand married wives at Dvārakā.

TEXT 7

k-aMa& dhiNTa k*-iTaNaae NaNau raezd*íya
 raez& dhNTaMauTa Tae Na dhNTYaSaùMa()
 Saae_Ya& YadNTarMal&/ Pa[ivXaN(ib>aeiT
 k-aMa" k-Qa& Nau PauNarSYa MaNa" é[YaeTa)) 7))

kāmaà dahanti kâtino nanu roña-dāñöyā

roñaa dahantam uta te na dahanty asahyam

so 'yaà yad antaram alaà praviṣan bibheti

kāmaù kathaà nu punar asya manaù çrayeta

SYNONYMS

kāmam—lust; *dahanti*—chastise; *kātinaù*—great stalwarts; *nanu*—but; *roñā-dāñöyā*—by wrathful glance; *roñam*—wrath; *dahantam*—being overwhelmed; *uta*—although; *te*—they; *na*—cannot; *dahanti*—subjugate; *asahyam*—intolerable; *saù*—that; *ayam*—Him; *yat*—because; *antaram*—within; *alam*—however; *praviṣan*—entering; *bibheti*—is afraid of; *kāmaù*—lust; *katham*—how; *nu*—as a matter of fact; *punaù*—again; *asya*—His; *manaù*—mind; *çrayeta*—take shelter of.

TRANSLATION

Great stalwarts like Lord Siva can, by their wrathful glances, overcome lust and vanquish him, yet they cannot be free from the overwhelming effects of their own wrath. Such wrath can never enter into the heart of Him [the Lord], who is above all this. So how can lust take shelter in His mind?

PURPORT

When Lord Siva was engaged in severely austere meditation, Cupid, the demigod of lust, threw his arrow of sex desire. Lord Siva, thus being angry at him, glanced at Cupid in great wrath, and at once the body of Cupid was annihilated. Although Lord Siva was so powerful, he was unable to get free from the effects of such wrath. But in the behavior of Lord Viṣṇu there is no incident of such wrath at any time. On the contrary, Bhāgu Muni tested the tolerance of the Lord by purposely kicking His chest, but instead of being angry at Bhāgu Muni the Lord begged his pardon, saying that Bhāgu Muni's leg might have been badly hurt because His chest is too hard. The Lord has the sign of the foot of *bhāgupāda* as the mark of tolerance. The Lord, therefore, is never affected by any kind of wrath, so how can there be any

place for lust, which is less strong than wrath? When lust or desire is not fulfilled, there is the appearance of wrath, but in the absence of wrath how can there be any place for lust? The Lord is known as *äpta-käma*, or one who can fulfill His desires by Himself. He does not require anyone's help to satisfy His desires. The Lord is unlimited, and therefore His desires are also unlimited. All living entities but the Lord are limited in every respect; how then can the limited satisfy the desires of the unlimited? The conclusion is that the Absolute Personality of Godhead has neither lust nor anger, and even if there is sometimes a show of lust and anger by the Absolute, it should be considered an absolute benediction.

TEXT 8

**ivÖ" SaPaTNYauidTaPai}ai>ariNTa rajae
bal/ae_iPa SaàuPaGaTaSTaPaSae vNaaiNa)
TaSMaa Adad(Da]uvGaiTa& Ga*<aTae Pa[Saàae
idVYaa" STauviNTa MauNaYaae YaduPaYaRDaSTaaTa()) 8))**

viddhaù sapatny-udita-patribhir anti räjäo

bälo 'pi sann upagatas tapase vanäni

tasmä adäd dhruva-gatiä gâëate prasanno

divyäu stuvanti munayo yad upary-adhastät

SYNONYMS

viddhaù—pinched by; *sapatni*—a co-wife; *udita*—uttered by; *patribhiù*—by sharp words; *anti*—just before; *räjäo*—of the king; *bälo*—a boy; *api*—although; *san*—being so; *upagataù*—took to; *tapase*—severe penances; *vanäni*—in a great forest; *tasmä*—therefore; *adät*—gave as a reward; *dhruva-gatim*—a path to the Dhruva planet; *gâëate*—on being prayed for; *prasannaù*—being satisfied; *divyäu*—denizens of higher planets; *stuvanti*—do pray; *munayaù*—great sages; *yat*—thereupon; *upari*—up; *adhastät*—down.

TRANSLATION

Being insulted by sharp words spoken by the co-wife of the king, even in his presence, Prince Dhruva, though only a boy, took to severe penances in the forest. And the Lord, being satisfied by his prayer, awarded him the Dhruva planet, which is worshiped by great sages, both upward and downward.

PURPORT

When he was only five years old, Prince Dhruva, a great devotee and the son of Maharaja Uttānapāda, was sitting on the lap of his father. His stepmother did not like the King's patting her stepson, so she dragged him out, saying that he could not claim to sit on the lap of the King because he was not born out of her womb. The little boy felt insulted by this act of his stepmother. Nor did his father make any protest, for he was too attached to his second wife. After this incident, Prince Dhruva went to his own mother and complained. His real mother also could not take any step against this insulting behavior, and so she wept. The boy inquired from his mother how he could sit on the royal throne of his father, and the poor queen replied that only the Lord could help him. The boy inquired where the Lord could be seen, and the queen replied that it is said that the Lord is sometimes seen by great sages in the dense forest. The child prince decided to go into the forest to perform severe penances in order to achieve his objective.

Prince Dhruva performed a stringent type of penance under the instruction of his spiritual master, Sri Nārada Muni, who was specifically deputed for this purpose by the Personality of Godhead. Prince Dhruva was initiated by Nārada into chanting the hymn composed of eighteen letters, namely *oṃ namo bhagavate vāsudevāya*, and Lord Vāsudeva incarnated Himself as Pāṇigarbha, the Personality of Godhead with four hands, and awarded the prince a specific planet above the seven stars. Prince Dhruva, after achieving success in his undertakings, saw the Lord face to face, and he was satisfied that all his needs were fulfilled.

The planet awarded to Prince Dhruva Maharaja is a fixed Vaikuntha planet,

installed in the material atmosphere by the will of the Supreme Lord, Vāsudeva. This planet, although within the material world, will not be annihilated at the time of devastation, but will remain fixed in its place. And because it is a Vaikuntha planet never to be annihilated, it is worshiped even by the denizens of the seven stars situated below the Dhruva planet, as well as by the planets which are even above the Dhruva planet. Maharñi Bhāgu’s planet is situated above the Dhruva planet.

So the Lord incarnated Himself as Pāṇigarbha just to satisfy a pure devotee of the Lord. And Prince Dhruva achieved this perfection simply by chanting the hymn mentioned above, after being initiated by another pure devotee, Nārada. A serious personality can thus achieve the highest perfection of meeting the Lord and attain his objective simply by being guided by a pure devotee, who automatically approaches by dint of one’s serious determination to meet the Lord by all means.

The description of Prince Dhruva’s activities can be read in detail in the Fourth Canto of *Srimad-Bhagavatam*.

TEXT 9

**YaÜeNaMauTPaQaGaTa& iÜJavaKYavJa],
iNaZPlu/íPaaEâz>aGa& iNarYae PaTaNTaMa()
}aaTvaiQaRTaae JaGaiTa Pau}aPad& c le/>ae
duGDaa vSaUiNa vSauDaa Sak-l/aiNa YaeNa)) 9))**

yad venam utpatha-gataà dvija-väkyavajra-

niñpluñöa-pauruñä-bhagaà niraye patantam

trätvärthito jagati putra-padaà ca lebhe

dugdhä vasüni vasudhä sakaläni yena

SYNONYMS

yat—when; *venam*—unto King Vena; *utpatha-gatam*—going astray from

the righteous path; *dvija*—of the *brahmanas*; *vākya*—words of cursing; *vajra*—thunderbolt; *niñpluñña*—being burnt by; *pauruṇa*—great deeds; *bhagam*—opulence; *niraye*—into hell; *patantam*—going down; *trātvā*—by delivering; *arthita*—so being prayed for; *jagati*—on the world; *putra-padam*—the position of the son; *ca*—as well as; *lebhe*—achieved; *dugdhā*—exploited; *vasūni*—produce; *vasudhā*—the earth; *sakalāni*—all kinds of; *yena*—by whom.

TRANSLATION

Maharaja Vena went astray from the path of righteousness, and the brahmanas chastised him by the thunderbolt curse. By this King Vena was burnt with his good deeds and opulence and was en route to hell. The Lord, by His causeless mercy, descended as his son, by the name of Pāthu, delivered the condemned King Vena from hell, and exploited the earth by drawing all kinds of crops as produce.

PURPORT

According to the system of *varēācrama-dharma*, the pious and learned *brahmanas* were the natural guardians of society. The *brahmanas*, by their learned labor of love, would instruct the administrator-kings how to rule the country in complete righteousness, and thus the process would go on as a perfect welfare state. The kings or the *kñatriya* administrators would always consult the council of learned *brahmanas*. They were never autocratic monarchs. The scriptures like *Manu-saḥhitā* and other authorized books of the great sages were guiding principles for ruling the subjects, and there was no need for less intelligent persons to manufacture a code of law in the name of democracy. The less intelligent mass of people have very little knowledge of their own welfare, as a child has very little knowledge of its future well-being. The experienced father guides the innocent child towards the path of progress, and the childlike mass of people need similar guidance. The standard welfare codes are already there in the *Manu-saḥhitā* and other Vedic literatures. The learned *brahmanas* would advise the king in terms of those standard books of knowledge and with reference to the particular situation of time and place. Such *brahmanas* were not paid servants of the king, and therefore they had the

strength to dictate to the king on the principles of scriptures. This system continued even up to the time of Maharaja Candragupta, and the *brahmana* Cäëakya was his unpaid prime minister.

Maharaja Vena did not adhere to this principle of ruling, and he disobeyed the learned *brahmanas*. The broad-minded *brahmanas* were not self-interested, but looked to the interest of complete welfare for all the subjects. They wanted to chastise King Vena for his misconduct and so prayed to the Almighty Lord as well as cursed the king.

Long life, obedience, good reputation, righteousness, prospects of being promoted to higher planets, and blessings of great personalities are all vanquished simply by disobedience to a great soul. One should strictly try to follow in the footsteps of great souls. Maharaja Vena became a king, undoubtedly due to his past deeds of righteousness, but because he willfully neglected the great souls, he was punished by the loss of all the above-mentioned acquisitions. In the *Vāmana Purana* the history of Maharaja Vena and his degradation are fully described. When Maharaja Pāthu heard about the hellish condition of his father, Vena, who was suffering from leprosy in the family of a *mleccha*, he at once brought the former king to Kurukñetra for his purification and relieved him of all sufferings.

Maharaja Pāthu, the incarnation of God, descended by the prayer of the *brahmanas* to rectify the disorders on earth. He produced all kinds of crops. But, at the same time, he performed the duty of a son who delivers his father from hellish conditions. The word *putra* means one who delivers from hell, called *put*. That is a worthy son.

TEXT 10

Naa>aerSaav*z>a AaSa SaudeivSaUNau,
YaaRe vE ccar SaMad*Ga(Ja@YaaGacYaaRMa()
YaTPaarMah&SYaMa*zYa" PadMaaMaNaiNTa
SvSQa" Pa[XaaNTak-r<a" PairMauç-Sa®")) 10))

nābher asāv āñabha āsa sudevi-sūnur

yo vai cacära sama-dåg jaòà-yoga-caryäm

yat päramahaàsyam åñayaù padam ämananti

svasthaù praçänta-karaëaù parimukta-saigaù

SYNONYMS

näbheù—by Maharaja Nābhi; *asau*—the Personality of Godhead; *åñabhaù*—Rsabha; *äsa*—became; *sudevi*—Sudevé; *sünuù*—the son of; *yaù*—who; *vai*—certainly; *cacära*—performed; *sama-dåk*—equibalanced; *jaòà*—material; *yoga-caryäm*—performance of *yoga*; *yat*—which; *päramahaàsyam*—the highest stage of perfection; *åñayaù*—the learned sages; *padam*—situation; *ämananti*—do accept; *svasthaù*—self-reposed; *praçänta*—suspended; *karaëaù*—the material senses; *parimukta*—perfectly liberated; *saigaù*—material contamination.

TRANSLATION

The Lord appeared as the son of Sudevé, the wife of King Nābhi, and was known as Rsabhadeva. He performed materialistic yoga to equilibrate the mind. This stage is also accepted as the highest perfectional situation of liberation, wherein one is situated in one’s self and is completely satisfied.

PURPORT

Out of many types of mystic performances for self-realization, the process of *jaòà-yoga* is also one accepted by authorities. This *jaòà-yoga* involves practicing becoming like a dumb stone and not being affected by material reactions. Just as a stone is indifferent to all kinds of attacks and reattacks of external situations, similarly one practices *jaòà-yoga* by tolerating voluntary infliction of pain upon the material body. Such *yogis*, out of many self-infliction methods, practice plucking out the hairs on their heads, without shaving and without any instrumental help. But the real purpose of such *jaòà-yoga* practice is to get free from all material affection and to be completely situated in the self. At the last stage of his life, Emperor

Rsabhadeva wandered like a dumb madman, unaffected by all kinds of bodily mistreatment. Seeing him like a madman, wandering naked with long hair and a long beard, less intelligent children and men in the street used to spit on him and urinate on his body. He used to lie in his own stool and never move. But the stool of his body was fragrant like the smell of fragrant flowers, and a saintly person would recognize him as a *paramahamsa*, one in the highest state of human perfection. One who is not able to make his stool fragrant should not, however, imitate Emperor Rsabhadeva. The practice of *jaḍa-yoga* was possible for Rsabhadeva and others on the same level of perfection, but such an uncommon practice is impossible for an ordinary man.

The real purpose of *jaḍa-yoga*, as mentioned here in this verse, is *praçānta-karaëaù*, or subduing the senses. The whole process of *yoga*, under whatever heading it may be, is to control the unbridled material senses and thus prepare oneself for self-realization. In this age specifically, this *jaḍa-yoga* cannot be of any practical value, but on the other hand the practice of *bhakti-yoga* is feasible because it is just suitable for this age. The simple method of hearing from the right source, *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, will lead one to the highest perfectional stage of *yoga*. Rsabhadeva was the son of King Nābhi and the grandson of King Ägnédhra, and he was the father of King Bharata, after whose name this planet earth was called *Bhārata-varña*. Rsabhadeva's mother was also known as Merudevé, although her name is mentioned here as Sudevé. It is sometimes proposed that Sudevé was another wife of King Nābhi, but since King Rsabhadeva is mentioned elsewhere as the son of Merudevé, it is clear that Merudevé and Sudevé are the same person under different names.

TEXT 11

Sa}ae MaMaaSa >aGavaNa(hYaXaqrzaQaae
 Saa+aaTa(Sa YajPauâSTaPaNaqYav<aR")
 ^NdaeMaYaae Ma%MaYaae_i%l/devTaaTMaa
 vacae b>aUvuâXaTaq" iSaTaae_SYa NaSTa")) 11))

satre mamäsa bhagavän haya-çérañätho

säkñät sa yajña-puruṣas tapanéya-varëaù

chandomayo makhamayo 'khila-devatätmä

väco babhüvur uçatéù çvasato 'sya nastaù

SYNONYMS

satre—in the sacrificial ceremony; *mama*—of mine; *äsa*—appeared; *bhagavän*—the Personality of Godhead; *haya-çérañä*—with His horselike head; *atha*—thus; *säkñät*—directly; *saù*—He; *yajña-puruṣaù*—the person who is pleased by performances of sacrifice; *tapanéya*—golden; *varëaù*—hue; *chandaù-mayaù*—personified Vedic hymns; *makha-mayaù*—personified sacrifices; *akhila*—all that be; *devatä-ätmä*—the soul of the demigods; *väcaù*—sounds; *babhüvuù*—become audible; *uçatéù*—very pleasing to hear; *çvasataù*—while breathing; *asya*—His; *nastaù*—through the nostrils.

TRANSLATION

The Lord appeared as the Hayagrëva incarnation in a sacrifice performed by me [Brahmä]. He is the personified sacrifices, and the hue of His body is golden. He is the personified Vedas as well, and the Supersoul of all demigods. When He breathed, all the sweet sounds of the Vedic hymns came out of His nostrils.

PURPORT

The Vedic hymns are generally meant for sacrifices performed by fruitive workers who also want to satisfy the demigods to achieve their fruitive result. But the Lord is the personified sacrifices and personified Vedic hymns. Therefore one who is directly a devotee of the Lord is a person who has automatically both served the purposes of sacrifices and pleased the demigods. The devotees of the Lord may not perform any sacrifice or may not please the demigods as per Vedic injunctions, and still the devotees are on a higher level than the fruitive workers or the worshipers of different demigods.

TEXT 12

MaTSYaae YauGaaNTaSaMaYae MaNauNaaePal/BDa"
+aae<aqMaYaae iNai%l/JaqviNak-aYake-Ta")
ivó&iSaTaaNauå>aYae Sail/Ie/ Mau%aNMAe
AadaYa Ta}a ivJahar h vedMaaGaaRNa()) 12))

matsyo yugānta-samaye manunopalabdhaù

kñöëémayo nikhila-jéva-nikäya-ketaù

visraàsitān uru-bhaye salile mukhān me

ädäya tatra vijahāra ha veda-märgān

SYNONYMS

matsyaù—incarnation of the fish; *yuga-anta*—at the end of the millennium; *samaye*—at the time of; *manunä*—the would-be Vaivasvata Manu; *upalabdhaù*—seen; *kñöëémayaù*—up to the earthly planets; *nikhila*—all; *jéva*—living entities; *nikäya-ketaù*—shelter for; *visraàsitān*—emanating from; *uru*—great; *bhaye*—out of fear; *salile*—in the water; *mukhāt*—from the mouth; *me*—mine; *ädäya*—having taken to; *tatra*—there; *vijahāra*—enjoyed; *ha*—certainly; *veda-märgān*—all the *Vedas*.

TRANSLATION

At the end of the millennium, the would-be Vaivasvata Manu, of the name Satyavrata, would see that the Lord in the fish incarnation is the shelter of all kinds of living entities, up to those in the earthly planets. Because of my fear of the vast water at the end of the millennium, the Vedas come out of my [Brahmā's] mouth, and the Lord enjoys those vast waters and protects the Vedas.

PURPORT

During one day of Brahmā there are fourteen Manus, and at the end of

each Manu there is devastation up to the earthly planets, and the vast water is fearful even to Brahmä. So in the beginning of the would-be Vaivasvata Manu, such devastation would be seen by him. There would be many other incidents also, such as the killing of the famous Çaiḥāsura. This foretelling is by the past experience of Brahmäjé, who knew that in that fearful devastating scene, the *Vedas* would come out of his mouth, but the Lord in His fish incarnation not only would save all living entities, namely the demigods, animals, men and great sages, but would also save the *Vedas*.

TEXT 13

+aakraedDaavMardaNavYaUQaPaaNaa,
MauNMaQNaTaaMaMa*TaI/BDaYa Aaiddev")
Pa*ieNa k-C^PavPauivRdDaar Gaae}a&
iNad]a+a<aae_id]PairvTaRk-za<ak-<@U")) 13))

kñérodadhäv amara-dānava-yüthapānām

unmathnatām amāta-labdhaya ädi-devau

pāñöhena kacchapa-vapur vidadhāra gotraà

nidrākñäëo 'dri-parivarta-kañäëa-kaëöüü

SYNONYMS

kñéra—milk; *udadhau*—in the ocean of; *amara*—the demigods; *dānava*—the demons; *yütha-pānām*—of the leaders of both hosts; *unmathnatām*—while churning; *amāta*—nectar; *labdhaya*—for gaining; *ädi-devau*—the primeval Lord; *pāñöhena*—by the backbone; *kacchapa*—tortoise; *vapuù*—body; *vidadhāra*—assumed; *gotram*—the Mandara Hill; *nidrākñäëaù*—while partly sleeping; *adri-parivarta*—rolling the hill; *kañäëa*—scratching; *kaëöüü*—itching.

TRANSLATION

The primeval Lord then assumed the tortoise incarnation in order to serve as a resting place [pivot] for the Mandara Mountain, which was acting as a churning rod. The demigods and demons were churning the ocean of milk with the Mandara Mountain in order to extract nectar. The mountain moved back and forth, scratching the back of Lord Tortoise, who, while partially sleeping, was experiencing an itching sensation.

PURPORT

Although it is not in our experience, there is a milk ocean within this universe. Even the modern scientist accepts that there are hundreds and hundreds of thousands of planets hovering over our heads, and each of them has different kinds of climatic conditions. *Srimad-Bhagavatam* gives much information which may not tally with our present experience. But as far as Indian sages are concerned, knowledge is received from the Vedic literatures, and the authorities accept without any hesitation that we should look through the pages of authentic books of knowledge (*çästra-cakñurvat*). So we cannot deny the existence of the ocean of milk as stated in the *Srimad-Bhagavatam* unless and until we have experimentally seen all the planets hovering in space. Since such an experiment is not possible, naturally we have to accept the statement of *Srimad-Bhagavatam* as it is because it is so accepted by spiritual leaders like Sridhara Svämé, Jiva Gosvami, Visvanatha Cakravarti and others. The Vedic process is to follow in the footsteps of great authorities, and that is the only process for knowing that which is beyond our imagination.

The primeval Lord, being all-powerful, can do whatever He likes, and therefore His assuming the incarnation of a tortoise or a fish for serving a particular purpose is not at all astonishing. Therefore we should not have any hesitation whatsoever in accepting the statements of the authentic scriptures like *Srimad-Bhagavatam*.

The gigantic work of churning the milk ocean by the combined effort of the demigods and the demons required a gigantic resting ground or pivot for the gigantic Mandara Hill. Thus to help the attempt of the demigods the primeval Lord assumed the incarnation of a gigantic tortoise, swimming in the ocean of milk. At the same time, the mountain scratched His backbone

as He was partially sleeping and thus relieved His itching sensation.

TEXT 14

}aEiPaíPaaeå>aYaha Sa Na*iSa&hæPa&
k*-Tva >a]Mad(>a]uku-i\$=d&í\k-ral/v£-Ma()
dETYaeNd]Maaéu GadYaai>aPaTaNTaMaara,
dUraE iNaPaaTYa ivddar Na%E" Sfu-rNTaMa()) 14))

trai-piñöaporu-bhaya-hä sa nâsiàha-rüpaà

kåtvä bhramad-bhrukuöi-daàñöra-karäla-vaktram

daityendram äçu gadayäbhipatantam äräd

ürau nipätya vidadära nakhaiù sphurantam

SYNONYMS

trai-piñöapa—the demigods; *uru-bhaya-hä*—one who vanquishes great fears; *saù*—He (the Personality of Godhead); *nâsiàha-rüpa*m—assuming the incarnation Nṛsiṃha; *kåtvä*—doing so; *bhramat*—by rolling; *bhru-kuöi*—eyebrows; *daàñöra*—teeth; *karäla*—greatly fearful; *vaktram*—mouth; *daitya-indram*—the king of the demons; *äçu*—immediately; *gadayä*—with club in hand; *abhipatantam*—while falling down; *ärät*—nearby; *ürau*—on the thighs; *nipätya*—placing on; *vidadära*—pierced; *nakhaiù*—by the nails; *sphurantam*—while challenging.

TRANSLATION

The Personality of Godhead assumed the incarnation of Nṛsiṃhadeva in order to vanquish the great fears of the demigods. He killed the king of the demons [Hiraṇyakaśipu], who challenged the Lord with a club in his hand, by placing the demon on His thighs and piercing him with His nails, rolling His eyebrows in anger and showing His fearful teeth and mouth.

PURPORT

The history of Hiraṇyakaśipu and his great devotee-son Prahlāda Maharaja is narrated in the Seventh Canto of *Srimad-Bhagavatam*. Hiraṇyakaśipu became very powerful by material achievements and thought himself to be immortal by the grace of Brahmājé. Brahmājé declined to award him the benediction of immortality because he himself is not an immortal being. But Hiraṇyakaśipu derived Brahmājé's benediction in a roundabout way, almost equal to becoming an immortal being. Hiraṇyakaśipu was sure that he would not be killed by any man or demigod or by any kind of known weapon, nor would he die in day or night. The Lord, however, assumed the incarnation of half-man and half-lion, which was beyond the imagination of a materialistic demon like Hiraṇyakaśipu, and thus, keeping pace with the benediction of Brahmājé, the Lord killed him. He killed him on His lap, so that he was killed neither on the land nor on the water nor in the sky. The demon was pierced by Nṛsiṃha's nails, which were beyond the human weapons imaginable by Hiraṇyakaśipu. The literal meaning of Hiraṇyakaśipu is one who is after gold and soft bedding, the ultimate aim of all materialistic men. Such demonic men, who have no relationship with God, gradually become puffed up by material acquisitions and begin to challenge the authority of the Supreme Lord and torture those who are devotees of the Lord. Prahlāda Maharaja happened to be the son of Hiraṇyakaśipu, and because the boy was a great devotee, his father tortured him to the best of his ability. In this extreme situation, the Lord assumed the incarnation of Nṛsiṃhadeva, and just to finish the enemy of the demigods, the Lord killed Hiraṇyakaśipu in a manner beyond the demon's imagination. Materialistic plans of godless demons are always frustrated by the all-powerful Lord.

TEXT 15

ANTa"SarSYauåble/Na Pade Ga*hqTaae
Ga]ahe<a YaUQaPaiTarMbuJahSTa AaTaR")
AahedMaaidPauåzai%I/I/aek-NaaQa
TaqQaRé[v" é[v<aMa®I/NaaMaDaeYa)) 15))

antaù-sarasy uru-balena pade gâhéto

gräheëa yütha-patir ambuja-hasta ärtau

ähedam ädi-puruñäkhila-loka-nätha

tértha-çravaù çravaëa-maìgala-nämadheya

SYNONYMS

antaù-sarasi—within the river; *uru-balena*—by superior strength; *pade*—leg; *gâhétaù*—being taken up; *gräheëa*—by the crocodile; *yütha-patiù*—of the leader of the elephants; *ambuja-hastaù*—with a lotus flower in the hand; *ärtaù*—greatly aggrieved; *äha*—addressed; *idam*—like this; *ädi-puruṣa*—the original enjoyer; *akhila-loka-nätha*—the Lord of the universe; *tértha-çravaù*—as famous as a place of pilgrimage; *çravaëa-maìgala*—all good simply by hearing the name; *näma-dheya*—whose holy name is worth chanting.

TRANSLATION

The leader of the elephants, whose leg was attacked in a river by a crocodile of superior strength, was much aggrieved. Taking a lotus flower in his trunk, he addressed the Lord, saying, “O original enjoyer, Lord of the universe! O deliverer, as famous as a place of pilgrimage! All are purified simply by hearing Your holy name, which is worthy to be chanted.”

PURPORT

The history of delivering the leader of the elephants, whose leg was attacked in the river by the superior strength of a crocodile, is described in the Eighth Canto of *Srimad-Bhagavatam*. Since the Lord is absolute knowledge, there is no difference between His holy name and the personality of Godhead. The leader of the elephants was much distressed when he was attacked by the crocodile. Although the elephant is always stronger than the crocodile, the latter is stronger than the elephant when it is in the water. And because the elephant was a great devotee of the Lord in his previous birth, he was able to chant the holy name of the Lord by dint of his past good deeds. Every living entity is always distressed in this material world because this place is such that at every step one has to meet

with some kind of distress. But one who is supported by his past good deeds engages himself in the devotional service of the Lord, as confirmed in the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (7.16). Those who are supported by impious acts cannot be engaged in the devotional service of the Lord, even though they are distressed. This is also confirmed in the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (7.15). The personality of Godhead Hari appeared at once on the back of His eternal bearer, Garuòà, and delivered the elephant.

The elephant was conscious of his relation with the Supreme Lord. He addressed the Lord as *ädi-puruṣa*, or the original enjoyer. Both the Lord and the living beings are conscious and are therefore enjoyers, but the Lord is the original enjoyer because He is the creator of everything. In a family, both the father and his sons are undoubtedly enjoyers but the father is the original enjoyer, and the sons are subsequent enjoyers. A pure devotee knows well that everything in the universe is the property of the Lord and that a living entity can enjoy a thing as ordained by the Lord. A living being cannot even touch a thing which is not allotted to him. This idea of the original enjoyer is explained very nicely in the *Éçopaniñad*. One who knows this difference between the Lord and himself never accepts anything without first offering it to the Lord.

The elephant addressed the Lord as *akhila-loka-nätha*, or the Lord of the universe, who is therefore the Lord of the elephant also. The elephant, being a pure devotee of the Lord, specifically deserved to be saved from the attack of the crocodile, and because it is a promise of the Lord that His devotee will never be vanquished, it was quite befitting that the elephant called upon the Lord to protect him, and the merciful Lord also at once responded. The Lord is the protector of everyone, but He is the first protector of one who acknowledges the superiority of the Lord instead of being so falsely proud as to deny the superiority of the Lord or to claim to be equal to Him. He is ever superior. A pure devotee of the Lord knows this difference between the Lord and himself. Therefore a pure devotee is given first preference because of his full dependence, whereas the person who denies the existence of the Lord and declares himself the Lord is called *asura*, and as such he is given protection by the strength of limited power subject to the sanction of the Lord. Since the Lord is superior to everyone, His perfection is also superior. No one can imagine it.

The elephant addressed the Lord as *tértha-çravaù*, or “as famous as a place of pilgrimage.” People go to places of pilgrimage in order to be delivered from the reactions of unknown sinful acts. But one can be freed from all sinful reactions simply by remembering His holy name. The Lord is therefore as good as the holy places of pilgrimage. One can be free from all sinful reactions after reaching a place of pilgrimage, but one can have the same benefit at home or at any place simply by chanting the holy name of the Lord. For a pure devotee, there is no need to go to the holy place of pilgrimage. He can be delivered from all sinful acts simply by remembering the Lord in earnestness. A pure devotee of the Lord never commits any sinful acts, but because the whole world is full of the sinful atmosphere, even a pure devotee may commit a sin unconsciously, as a matter of course. One who commits sinful acts consciously cannot be worthy of being a devotee of the Lord, but a pure devotee who unconsciously does something sinful is certainly delivered by the Lord because a pure devotee remembers the Lord always.

The Lord’s holy name is called *çravaëa-maigala*. This means that one receives everything auspicious simply by hearing the holy name. In another place in *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, His holy name is described as *puëya-çravaëa-kértana*. It is a pious act simply to chant and hear all about the Lord. The Lord descends on this earth and acts like others in connection with the activities of the world just to create subject matters for hearing about Him; otherwise the Lord has nothing to do in this world, nor has He any obligation to do anything. He comes out of His own causeless mercy and acts as He desires, the *Vedas* and *puräëas* are full of descriptions of His different activities so that people in general may naturally be eager to hear and read something about His activities. Generally, however, the modern fictions and novels of the world occupy a greater part of people’s valuable time. Such literatures cannot do good to anyone; on the contrary, they agitate the young mind unnecessarily and increase the modes of passion and ignorance, leading to increasing bondage to the material conditions. The same aptitude for hearing and reading is better utilized in hearing and reading of the Lord’s activities. This will give one all-around benefit.

It is concluded, therefore, that the holy name of the Lord and topics in relation with Him are always worth hearing, and therefore He is called here

in this verse *näma-dheya*, or one whose holy name is worth chanting.

TEXT 16

é[uTva hirSTaMar<aaiQaRNaMaPa[MaeYa,
êṣ-aYauDa" PaTaGaraJa>auJaaiDaæ!")
cṣe-<a Naṣ-vdNa& iviNaPaaṣy TaSMaa,
ÖSTae Pa[Ga*ù >aGavaNa(k*-PaYaaeÂhar)) 16))

çrutvä haris tam araëärthinam aprameyaç

cakräyudhaù patagaräja-bhujädhirüòhaù

cakreëa nakra-vadanaà vinipäöya tasmäd

dhaste pragåhya bhagavän kåpayojjahära

SYNONYMS

çrutvä—by hearing; *hariù*—the Personality of Godhead; *tam*—him; *araëa-arthinam*—one who is in need of help; *aprameyaù*—the unlimitedly powerful Lord; *cakra*—wheel; *äyudhaù*—equipped with His weapon; *pataga-räja*—the king of the birds (Garuòà); *bhuja-adhirüòhaù*—being seated on the wings of; *cakreëa*—by the wheel; *nakra-vadanam*—the mouth of the crocodile; *vinipäöya*—cutting in two; *tasmät*—from the mouth of the crocodile; *haste*—in the hands; *pragåhya*—taking hold of the trunk; *bhagavän*—the Personality of Godhead; *kåpayä*—out of causeless mercy; *ujjahära*—delivered him.

TRANSLATION

The Personality of Godhead, after hearing the elephant's plea, felt that the elephant needed His immediate help, for he was in great distress. Thus at once the Lord appeared there on the wings of the king of birds, Garuòà, fully equipped with His weapon, the wheel [cakra]. With the wheel He cut to pieces the mouth of the crocodile to save the elephant, and He delivered the elephant by lifting him by his trunk.

PURPORT

The Lord resides in His Vaikuntha planet. No one can estimate how far away this planet is situated. It is said, however, that anyone trying to reach that planet by airships or by mindships, traveling for millions of years, will find it still unknown. Modern scientists have invented airships which are material, and the *yogis* make a still finer material attempt to travel by mindships. The *yogis* can reach any distant place very quickly with the help of mindships. But neither the airship nor the mindship has access to the kingdom of God in the Vaikunthaloka, situated far beyond the material sky. Since this is the situation, how was it possible for the prayers of the elephant to be heard from such an unlimitedly distant place, and how could the Lord at once appear on the spot? These things cannot be calculated by human imagination. All this was possible by the unlimited power of the Lord, and therefore the Lord is described here as *aprameya*, for not even the best human brain can estimate His powers and potencies by mathematical calculation. The Lord can hear from such a distant place, He can eat from there, and He can appear simultaneously in all places at a moment's notice. Such is the omnipotency of the Lord.

TEXT 17

JYaaYaaNa(Gau<aErvrJaae_PYaidTae" SauTaaNaa&
I/aek-aNa(ivcṣ-Ma wMaaNa(YadQaaiDaYaj")
+Maa& vaMaNaeNa JaGa*he i}aPadC^le/Na
YaaÁaMa*Tae PaiQa crNa(Pa[>auī>aNaR caLYa")) 17))

jyāyān guëair avarajo 'py aditeu sutānā

lokān vicakrama imān yad athādhiyajjāu

kñmā vāmanena jagāhe tripada-cchalena

yāciām āte pathi caran prabhubhir na cālyau

SYNONYMS

jyāyān—the greatest; *guḍaiu*—by qualities; *avarajaù*—transcendental; *api*—although He is so; *aditeu*—of Aditi; *sutānām*—of all the sons (known as Ādityas); *lokān*—all the planets; *vicakrame*—surpassed; *imān*—in this universe; *yat*—one who; *atha*—therefore; *adhiyajjiaù*—the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *kñmām*—all the lands; *vāmanena*—in the incarnation of Vāmana; *jagāhe*—accepted; *tripada*—three steps; *chalena*—by pretension; *yāciām*—begging; *āte*—without; *pathi caran*—passing over the right path; *prabhubhiu*—by authorities; *na*—never to be; *cālyau*—to be bereft of.

TRANSLATION

The Lord, although transcendental to all material modes, still surpassed all the qualities of the sons of Aditi, known as the Ādityas. The Lord appeared as the youngest son of Aditi. And because He surpassed all the planets of the universe, He is the Supreme Personality of Godhead. On the pretense of asking for a measurement of three footsteps of land, He took away all the lands of Bali Maharaja. He asked simply because without begging, no authority can take one's rightful possession.

PURPORT

The history of Bali Maharaja and his charity to Vāmanadeva is described in the Eighth Canto of *Srimad-Bhagavatam*. Bali Maharaja conquered all the planets of the universe by rightful possession. A king can conquer other kings by strength, and such possession is considered to be rightful. So Bali Maharaja possessed all the lands of the universe, and he happened to be charitably disposed toward the *brahmanas*. The Lord therefore pretended to be a beggar *brahmana*, and He asked Bali Maharaja for a measurement of three footsteps of land. The Lord, as the proprietor of everything, could take from Bali Maharaja all the land he possessed, but he did not do so because Bali Maharaja possessed all those lands by king's rights. When Bali Maharaja was asked by Lord Vāmana for such small charity, Bali Maharaja's spiritual master, namely Çukrācārya, objected to this proposal because he knew that Vāmanadeva was Viṣṇu Himself, pretending to be a beggar. Bali Maharaja did not agree to abide by the order of his spiritual master when he understood that the beggar was Viṣṇu Himself, and he at once agreed to

give Him in charity the land requested. By this agreement Lord Vāmana covered all the lands of the universe with His first two steps and then asked Bali Maharaja where to place the third step. Bali Maharaja was very glad to receive the Lord's remaining step upon his head, and thus Bali Maharaja, instead of losing everything he possessed, was blessed by the Lord's becoming his constant companion and doorman. So, by giving everything to the cause of the Lord, one does not lose anything, but he gains everything that he could never otherwise expect.

TEXT 18

**NaaQaaeR ble/rYaMauâ§-MaPaadXaaEc,
MaaPa" iXa%aDa*TavTaae ivbuDaaiDaPaTYaMa()
Yaae vE Pa[iTaé[uTaMa*Tae Na ick-IzRdNYa,
daTMaaNaMa® MaNaSaa hrYae_i>aMaeNae)) 18))**

nārtho baler ayam urukrama-pāda-çaucam

āpaù çikhā-dhātavato vibudhādhipatyam

yo vai pratiçrutam āte na cikérñad anyad

ātmānam aiga manasā haraye 'bhimene

SYNONYMS

na—never; *arthaù*—of any value in comparison with; *baleù*—of strength; *ayam*—this; *urukrama-pāda-çaucam*—the water washed from the feet of the personality of Godhead; *āpaù*—water; *çikhā-dhātavataù*—of one who has kept it on his head; *vibudha-adhipatyam*—supremacy over the kingdom of the demigods; *yaù*—one who; *vai*—certainly; *pratiçrutam*—what was duly promised; *āte na*—besides that; *cikérñat*—tried for; *anyat*—anything else; *ātmānam*—even his personal body; *aiga*—O Nārada; *manasā*—within his mind; *haraye*—unto the Supreme Lord; *abhimene*—dedicated.

TRANSLATION

Bali Maharaja, who put on his head the water washed from the lotus feet of the Lord, did not think of anything besides his promise, in spite of being forbidden by his spiritual master. The king dedicated his own personal body to fulfill the measurement of the Lord's third step. For such a personality, even the kingdom of heaven, which he conquered by his strength, was of no value.

PURPORT

Bali Maharaja, by gaining the transcendental favor of the Lord in exchange for his great material sacrifice, was able to have a place in Vaikunthaloka with equal or greater facilities of eternal enjoyment; therefore he was not at all the loser by sacrificing the kingdom of heaven, which he had possessed by his material strength. In other words, when the Lord snatches away one's hard-earned material possessions and favors one with His personal transcendental service for eternal life, bliss and knowledge, such taking away by the Lord should be considered a special favor upon such a pure devotee.

Material possessions, however alluring they may be, cannot be permanent possessions. Therefore one has to voluntarily give up such possessions, or one has to leave such possessions at the time of quitting this material body. The sane man knows that all material possessions are temporary and that the best use of such possessions is to engage them in the service of the Lord so that the Lord may be pleased with him and award him a permanent place in His *paraà dhäma*.

In the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (15.5–6), the *paraà dhäma* of the Lord is described as follows:

*nirmäna-mohä jita-saiga-doñä
adhyätma-nityä vinivåtta-kämäù
dvandvair vimuktäù sukha-duùkha-saàjjair
gacchanty amüòhähù padam avyayaà tat*

*na tad bhäsayate süryo
na çaçäiko na pävakaù*

*yad gatvā na nivartante
tad dhāma paramaà mama*

One who possesses more in this material world, in the shape of houses, land, children, society, friendship and wealth, possesses these things only for the time being. One cannot possess all this illusory paraphernalia, created by *māyā*, permanently. Such a possessor is more illusioned in the matter of his self-realization; therefore one should possess less or nothing, so that one may be free from artificial prestige. We are contaminated in the material world by association with the three modes of material nature. Therefore, the more one spiritually advances by devotional service to the Lord, in exchange for his temporary possessions, the more one is freed from the attachment of material illusion. To achieve this stage of life one must be firmly convinced about spiritual existence and its permanent effects. To know exactly the permanency of spiritual existence, one must voluntarily practice possessing less or only the minimum to maintain one's material existence without difficulty. One should not create artificial needs. That will help one be satisfied with the minimum. Artificial needs of life are activities of the senses. The modern advancement of civilization is based on these activities of the senses, or, in other words, it is a civilization of sense gratification. Perfect civilization is the civilization of *ātmā*, or the soul proper. The civilized man of sense gratification is on an equal level with animals because animals cannot go beyond the activities of the senses. Above the senses is the mind. The civilization of mental speculation is also not the perfect stage of life because above the mind is the intelligence, and the *Bhagavad-gita* gives us information of the intellectual civilization. The Vedic literatures give different directions for the human civilization, including the civilization of the senses, of the mind, of the intelligence, and of the soul proper. The *Bhagavad-gita* primarily deals with the intelligence of man, leading one to the progressive path of civilization of the spirit soul. And *Srimad-Bhagavatam* is the complete human civilization dealing with the subject matter of the soul proper. As soon as a man is raised to the status of the civilization of the soul, he is fit to be promoted to the kingdom of God, which is described in the *Bhagavad-gita* as per the above verses.

The primary information of the kingdom of God informs us that there is no need of sun, moon or electricity, which are all necessary in this material

world of darkness. And the secondary information of the kingdom of God explains that anyone able to reach that kingdom by adoption of the civilization of the soul proper, or, in other words, by the method of *bhakti-yoga*, attains the highest perfection of life. One is then situated in the permanent existence of the soul, with full knowledge of transcendental loving service for the Lord. Bali Maharaja accepted this civilization of the soul in exchange for his great material possessions and thus became fit for promotion to the kingdom of God. The kingdom of heaven, which he achieved by dint of his material power, was considered most insignificant in comparison with the kingdom of God.

Those who have attained the comforts of a material civilization made for sense gratification should try to attain the kingdom of God by following in the footsteps of Bali Maharaja, who exchanged his acquired material strength, adopting the process of *bhakti-yoga* as recommended in the *Bhagavad-gita* and further explained in the *Srimad-Bhagavatam*.

TEXT 19

**Tau>Ya& c Naard >a*Xa& >aGavaNa(ivv*Ö,
>aaveNa SaaDauPairTauí ovac YaaeGaMa()
jaNa& c >aaGavTaMaaTMaSaTatvdqPa&
YaÜaSaudevXar<aa ivdurÅSaEv)) 19))**

tubhyaà ca nārada bhāṣaà bhagavān vivāddha-

bhāvena sādhu paritūñā uvāca yogam

jīānā ca bhāgavatam ātma-satattva-dēpā

yad vāsudeva-ṣaraēā vidur aiṣaiva

SYNONYMS

tubhyam—unto you; *ca*—also; *nārada*—O Nārada; *bhāṣam*—very nicely; *bhagavān*—the Personality of Godhead; *vivāddha*—developed; *bhāvena*—by transcendental love; *sādhu*—your goodness; *paritūñāu*—being

satisfied; *uvāca*—described; *yogam*—service; *jñānam*—knowledge; *ca*—also; *bhāgavatam*—the science of God and His devotional service; *ātma*—the self; *sa-tattva*—with all details; *dēpam*—just like the light in the darkness; *yat*—that which; *vāsudeva-çaraëäù*—those who are souls surrendered unto Lord Vāsudeva; *viduù*—know them; *aījasā*—perfectly well; *eva*—as it is.

TRANSLATION

O Nārada, you were taught about the science of God and His transcendental loving service by the Personality of Godhead in His incarnation of Haàsävatära. He was very much pleased with you, due to your intense proportion of devotional service. He also explained unto you, lucidly, the full science of devotional service, which is especially understandable by persons who are souls surrendered unto Lord Vāsudeva, the Personality of Godhead.

PURPORT

The devotee and devotional service are two correlative terms. Unless one is inclined to be a devotee of the Lord, he cannot enter into the intricacies of devotional service. Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa wanted to explain the *Bhagavad-gita*, which is the science of devotional service, unto Sri Arjuna because Arjuna was not only His friend but a great devotee as well. The whole process is that all living entities, being constitutionally parts and parcels of the supreme living being, the Absolute Personality of Godhead, have proportionately minute independence of action also. So the preliminary qualification for entering into the devotional service of the Lord is that one become a willing cooperator, and as such one should voluntarily cooperate with persons who are already engaged in the transcendental devotional service of the Lord. By cooperating with such persons, the prospective candidate will gradually learn the techniques of devotional service, and with the progress of such learning one becomes proportionately free from the contamination of material association. Such a purificatory process will establish the prospective candidate in firm faith and gradually elevate him to the stage of transcendental taste for such devotional service. Thus he acquires a genuine attachment for the devotional service of the Lord, and

his conviction carries him on to the point of ecstasy, just prior to the stage of transcendental love.

Such knowledge of devotional service may be divided into two sections, namely preliminary knowledge of the nature of devotional service and the secondary knowledge of its execution. *Bhāgavatam* is in relation with the Personality of Godhead, His beauty, fame, opulence, dignity, attraction and transcendental qualities which attract one towards Him for exchanges of love and affection. There is a natural affinity of the living entity for the loving service of the Lord. This affinity becomes artificially covered by the influence of material association, and *Srimad-Bhagavatam* helps one very genuinely remove that artificial covering. Therefore it is particularly mentioned herein that *Srimad-Bhagavatam* acts like the lamp of transcendental knowledge. These two sections of transcendental knowledge in devotional service become revealed to a person who is a soul surrendered unto Vāsudeva; as it is said in the ***Bhagavad-gītā*** (7.19), such a great soul, fully surrendered unto the lotus feet of Vāsudeva, is very, very rare.

TEXT 20

cṣ&- c id+vivhTa& dXaSau SvTaeJaae
MaNvNTarezu MaNauv&XaDarae ib>aiTaR)
duíezu raJaSau dMa& VYadDaaTa(Svk-liTa|
SaTYae i}aPa*ï oXaTaq& Pa[QaYa&êir}aE")) 20))

cakraà ca dikñv avihataà daçasu sva-tejo

manvantareñu manu-vaàça-dharo bibharti

duñöeñu rājasu damaà vyadadhāt sva-kértià

satye tri-pañña uçatéà prathayaàç caritraiù

SYNONYMS

cakram—the Sudarçana wheel of the Lord; *ca*—as well as; *dikñu*—in all

directions; *avihatam*—without being deterred; *daçasu*—ten sides; *sva-tejaù*—personal strength; *manvantareñu*—in different incarnations of Manu; *manu-vaàça-dharaù*—as the descendant of the Manu dynasty; *bibharti*—rules over; *duñöeñu*—unto the miscreants; *rājasu*—upon the kings of that type; *damam*—subjection; *vyadadhāt*—performed; *sva-kértim*—personal glories; *satye*—in the Satyaloka planet; *tri-pañöhe*—the three planetary systems; *uçatém*—glorious; *prathayan*—established; *caritraiù*—characteristics.

TRANSLATION

As the incarnation of Manu, the Lord became the descendant of the Manu dynasty and ruled over the miscreant kingly order, subduing them by His powerful wheel weapon. Undeterred in all circumstances, His rule was characterized by His glorious fame, which spread over the three lokas, and above them to the planetary system of Satyaloka, the topmost in the universe.

PURPORT

We have already discussed the incarnations of Manu in the First Canto. In one day of Brahmä there are fourteen Manus, changing one after another. In that way there are 420 Manus in a month of Brahmä and 5,040 Manus in one year of Brahmä. Brahmä lives for one hundred years according to his calculation, and as such there are 504,000 Manus in the jurisdiction of one Brahmä. There are innumerable Brahmäs, and all of them live only during one breathing period of Mahä-Viṣṇu. So we can just imagine how the incarnations of the Supreme Lord work all over the material worlds, which comprehend only one-fourth of the total energy of the Supreme Personality of Godhead.

The *manvantara* incarnation chastises all the miscreant rulers of different planets with as much power as that of the Supreme Personality of Godhead, who punishes the miscreants with His wheel weapon. The *manvantara* incarnations disseminate the transcendental glories of the Lord.

TEXT 21

DaNvNTairê >aGavaNa(SvYaMaev k-liTaR,
NaaRMana Na*<aa& PauååJaa& åJa Aaéu hiNTa)
Yaje c >aaGaMaMa*TaaYaurvavåNDa
AaYauZYavedMaNauXaaSTYavTaqYaR l/aeke-)) 21))

dhanvantariç ca bhagavän svayam eva kértir

nämnä nåëää puru-rujää ruja äçu hanti

yajie ca bhägam amätäyur-avävarundha

äyuñya-vedam anuçästy avatérya loke

SYNONYMS

dhanvantariù—the incarnation of God named Dhanvantari; *ca*—and; *bhagavän*—the Personality of Godhead; *svayam eva*—personally Himself; *kértiù*—fame personified; *nämnä*—by the name; *nåëäm puru-rujäm*—of the diseased living entities; *rujaù*—diseases; *äçu*—very soon; *hanti*—cures; *yajie*—in the sacrifice; *ca*—also; *bhägam*—share; *amäta*—nectar; *äyuù*—duration of life; *ava*—from; *avarundhe*—obtains; *äyuñya*—of duration of life; *vedam*—knowledge; *anuçästi*—directs; *avatérya*—incarnating; *loke*—in the universe.

TRANSLATION

The Lord in His incarnation of Dhanvantari very quickly cures the diseases of the ever-diseased living entities simply by his fame personified, and only because of him do the demigods achieve long lives. Thus the Personality of Godhead becomes ever glorified. He also exacted a share from the sacrifices, and it is he only who inaugurated the medical science or the knowledge of medicine in the universe.

PURPORT

As stated in the beginning of the *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, everything emanates from the ultimate source of the Personality of Godhead; it is therefore understood in this verse that medical science or knowledge in medicine was also inaugurated by the Personality of Godhead in His incarnation Dhanvantari, and thus the knowledge is recorded in the *Vedas*. The *Vedas* are the source of all knowledge, and thus knowledge in medical science is also there for the perfect cure of the diseases of the living entity. The embodied living entity is diseased by the very construction of his body. The body is the symbol of diseases. The disease may differ from one variety to another, but disease must be there just as there is birth and death for everyone. So, by the grace of the Personality of Godhead, not only are diseases of the body and mind cured, but also the soul is relieved of the constant repetition of birth and death. The name of the Lord is also called *bhavauñadhi*, or the source of curing the disease of material existence.

TEXT 22

+a}a& +aYaaYa iviDaNaaePa>a*Ta& MahaTMaa
b]øDa]uGauIj†TaPaQa& Nark-aiTaRil/PSau)
oÖNTYaSaavviNak-<\$=k-MauGa]vqYaR,
iS}a"Saák*-Tv oâDaarPariDaeNa)) 22))

kñātraṁ kñāyāya vidhinopabhātaṁ mahātmā

brahma-dhruḡ ujjhita-pathaṁ narakārti-lipsu

uddhanty asāv avanikaēōakam ugra-véryas

triṁ-sapta-kātvā urudhāra-paraçvadhena

SYNONYMS

kñātram—the royal order; *kñāyāya*—for the sake of diminishing; *vidhinā*—by destination; *upabhātam*—increased in proportion; *mahātmā*—the Lord in the form of the great sage Paraçurāma; *brahma-dhruḡ*—the ultimate truth in Brahman; *ujjhita-patham*—those who have given up the path of the Absolute Truth; *naraka-ārti-lipsu*—desirous to suffer pain in hell;

uddhanti—exacts; *asau*—all those; *avanikaëöakam*—thorns of the world; *ugra-véryaù*—awfully powerful; *triù-sapta*—thrice seven times; *kâtvaù*—performed; *urudhära*—very sharp; *paraçvadhena*—by the great chopper.

TRANSLATION

When the ruling administrators, who are known as the kṣatriyas, turned astray from the path of the Absolute Truth, being desirous to suffer in hell, the Lord, in His incarnation as the sage Paraçuräma, uprooted those unwanted kings, who appeared as the thorns of the earth. Thus He thrice seven times uprooted the kṣatriyas with His keenly sharpened chopper.

PURPORT

The *kṣatriyas*, or the ruling administrators of any part of the universe, either on this planet or on other planets, are factually the representatives of the Almighty Personality of Godhead, and they are meant to lead the subjects towards the path of God realization. Every state and its administrators, regardless of the nature of the administration—monarchy or democracy, oligarchy or dictatorship or autocracy—have the prime responsibility to lead the citizens toward God realization. This is essential for all human beings, and it is the duty of the father, spiritual master, and ultimately the state to take up the responsibility of leading the citizens towards this end. The whole creation of material existence is made for this purpose, just to give a chance to the fallen souls who rebelled against the will of the Supreme Father and thus became conditioned by material nature. The force of material nature gradually leads one to a hellish condition of perpetual pains and miseries. Those going against the prescribed rules and regulations of conditional life are called *brahmojjhita-pathas*, or persons going against the path of the Absolute Truth, and they are liable to be punished. Lord Paraçuräma, the incarnation of the Personality of Godhead, appeared in such a state of worldly affairs and killed all the miscreant kings twenty-one times. Many *kñatriya* kings fled from India to other parts of the world at that time, and according to the authority of the *Mahābhārata*, the kings of Egypt originally migrated from India because of Paraçuräma’s program of chastisement. The kings or administrators are similarly chastised in all circumstances whenever they

become godless and plan a godless civilization. That is the order of the Almighty.

TEXT 23

ASMaTPa[SaadSauMau%" k-l/Yaa k-le/Xa
w+vaku-v&Xa AvTaqYaR GauraeiNaRdeXae)
iTaiNa(vNa& SadiYaTaaNauJa AaivveXa
YaiSMaNa(ivâDYa dXak-NDar AaiTaRMaaC^RTa()) 23))

asmāt-prasāda-sumukhaù kalayä kaleça

ikñväku-vaàça avatérya guror nideçe

tiñöhan vanaà sa-dayitānuja äviveça

yasmin virudhya daça-kandhara ärtim ärcchat

SYNONYMS

asmāt—unto us, beginning from Brahmä down to the insignificant ant;
prasāda—causeless mercy; *sumukhaù*—so inclined; *kalayä*—with His
plenary extensions; *kaleçaù*—the Lord of all potencies; *ikñväku*—Maharaja
Ikñväku, in the dynasty of the sun; *vaàçe*—family; *avatérya*—by descending
in; *guroù*—of the father or spiritual master; *nideçe*—under the order of;
tiñöhan—being situated in; *vanam*—in the forest; *sa-dayitā-anujaù*—along
with His wife and younger brother; *äviveça*—entered; *yasmin*—unto whom;
virudhya—being rebellious; *daça-kandharaù*—Ravana, who had ten heads;
ärtim—great distress; *ärcchat*—achieved.

TRANSLATION

Due to His causeless mercy upon all living entities within the universe, the Supreme Personality of Godhead, along with His plenary extensions, appeared in the family of Maharaja Ikñväku as the Lord of His internal potency, Sita. Under the order of His father, Maharaja Daçaratha, He entered the forest and lived there for considerable years with His wife

and younger brother. Ravana, who was very materially powerful, with ten heads on his shoulders, committed a great offense against Him and was thus ultimately vanquished.

PURPORT

Lord Rāma is the Supreme Personality of Godhead, and His brothers, namely Bharata, Lakṣmaṇa and Śatrughna, are His plenary expansions. All four brothers are *viṣṇu-tattva* and were never ordinary human beings. There are many unscrupulous and ignorant commentators on *Ramayana* who present the younger brothers of Lord Rāmacandra as ordinary living entities. But here in the *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, the most authentic scripture on the science of Godhead, it is clearly stated that His brothers were His plenary expansions. Originally Lord Rāmacandra is the incarnation of Vāsudeva, Lakṣmaṇa is the incarnation of Saṅkarṣṇa, Bharata is the incarnation of Pradyumna, and Śatrughna is the incarnation of Aniruddha, expansions of the Personality of Godhead. Lakṣmījé Sita is the internal potency of the Lord and is neither an ordinary woman nor the external potency incarnation of Durgā. Durgā is the external potency of the Lord, and she is associated with Lord Siva.

As stated in the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (4.7), the Lord appears when there are discrepancies in the discharge of factual religion. Lord Rāmacandra also appeared under the same circumstances, accompanied by His brothers, who are expansions of the Lord's internal potency, and by Lakṣmījé Sitadevī.

Lord Rāmacandra was ordered by His father, Maharaja Daśaratha, to leave home for the forest under awkward circumstances, and the Lord, as the ideal son of His father, carried out the order, even on the occasion of His being declared the King of Ayodhyā. One of His younger brothers, Lakṣmaṇājé, desired to go with Him, and so also His eternal wife, Sitājé, desired to go with Him. The Lord agreed to both of them, and all together they entered the Daḍākāra Forest, to live there for fourteen years. During their stay in the forest, there was some quarrel between Rāmacandra and Ravana, and the latter kidnapped the Lord's wife, Sita. The quarrel ended in the vanquishing of the greatly powerful Ravana, along

with all his kingdom and family.

Sita is Lakṣmījé, or the goddess of fortune, but she is never to be enjoyed by any living being. She is meant for being worshiped by the living being along with her husband, Sri Rāmacandra. A materialistic man like Ravana does not understand this great truth, but on the contrary he wants to snatch Sitadevé from the custody of Rāma and thus incurs great miseries. The materialists, who are after opulence and material prosperity, may take lessons from the *Ramayana* that the policy of exploiting the nature of the Lord without acknowledging the supremacy of the Supreme Lord is the policy of Ravana. Ravana was very advanced materially, so much so that he turned his kingdom, Laikā, into pure gold, or full material wealth. But because he did not recognize the supremacy of Lord Rāmacandra and defied Him by stealing His wife, Sita, Ravana was killed, and all his opulence and power were destroyed.

Lord Rāmacandra is a full incarnation with six opulences in full, and He is therefore mentioned in this verse as *kaleṣaù*, or master of all opulence.

TEXT 24

YaSMaa AdadudiDaæ!>aYaa®vePaæ
MaaGa| SaPaÛirPaur& hrvd(idDa+aae")
dUre SauôNMaiQaTaraezSauXaae<ad*íya
TaaTaPYaMaaNaMak-raerGaNaṣ-cṣ-")) 24))

yasmä adäd udadhir üòha-bhayäìga-vepo

märgaè sapady ari-puraà haravad didhakñòu

düre suhân-mathita-roña-suçoëa-dãñöyã

tätapyamäna-makaroraga-nakra-cakraù

SYNONYMS

yasmai—unto whom; *adät*—gave; *udadhiù*—the great Indian Ocean; *üòha-*

bhaya—affected by fear; *aiga-vepaù*—bodily trembling; *mārgam*—way; *sapadi*—quickly; *ari-puram*—the city of the enemy; *hara-vat*—like that of Hara (Mahādeva); *didhakñoù*—desiring to burn to ashes; *düre*—at a long distance; *su-hât*—intimate friend; *mathita*—being aggrieved by; *roña*—in anger; *su-çoëa*—red-hot; *dãñöyă*—by such a glance; *tätapyamāna*—burning in heat; *makara*—sharks; *uraga*—snakes; *nakra*—crocodiles; *cakraù*—circle.

TRANSLATION

The Personality of Godhead Rāmacandra, being aggrieved for His distant intimate friend [Sita], glanced over the city of the enemy Ravana with red-hot eyes like those of Hara [who wanted to burn the kingdom of heaven]. The great ocean, trembling in fear, gave Him His way because its family members, the aquatics like the sharks, snakes and crocodiles, were being burnt by the heat of the angry red-hot eyes of the Lord.

PURPORT

The Personality of Godhead has every sentiment of a sentient being, like all other living beings, because He is the chief and original living entity, the supreme source of all other living beings. He is the *nitya*, or the chief eternal amongst all other eternals. He is the chief one, and all others are the dependent many. The many eternals are supported by the one eternal, and thus both the eternals are qualitatively one. Due to such oneness, both the eternals constitutionally have a complete range of sentiments, but the difference is that the sentiments of the chief eternal are different in quantity from the sentiments of the dependent eternals. When Rāmacandra was angry and showed His red-hot eyes, the whole ocean became heated with that energy, so much so that the aquatics within the great ocean felt the heat, and the personified ocean trembled in fear and offered the Lord an easy path for reaching the enemy's city. The impersonalists will see havoc in this red-hot sentiment of the Lord because they want to see negation in perfection. Because the Lord is absolute, the impersonalists imagine that in the Absolute the sentiment of anger, which resembles mundane sentiments, must be conspicuous by absence. Due to a poor fund of knowledge, they do not realize that the sentiment of the

Absolute Person is transcendental to all mundane concepts of quality and quantity. Had Lord Rāmacandra's sentiment been of mundane origin, how could it disturb the whole ocean and its inhabitants? Can any mundane red-hot eye generate heat in the great ocean? These are factors to be distinguished in terms of the personal and impersonal conceptions of the Absolute Truth. As it is said in the beginning of the *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, the Absolute Truth is the source of everything, so the Absolute Person cannot be devoid of the sentiments that are reflected in the temporary mundane world. Rather, the different sentiments found in the Absolute, either in anger or in mercy, have the same qualitative influence, or, in other words, there is no mundane difference of value because these sentiments are all on the absolute plane. Such sentiments are definitely not absent in the Absolute, as the impersonalists think, making their mundane estimation of the transcendental world.

TEXT 25

v+a"SQal/SPaXaRāGanMaheNd]vah,
dNTaEivR@iMbTak-ku-BJauz O!haSaMa()
SaŪae_Sauī>a" Sah ivNaeZYaiTa darhTauR,
ivRSfU-iJaRTaEDaRNauz oÀrTaae_iDaSaENYae)) 25))

vakñāu-sthala-sparça-rugna-mahendra-vāha-

dantair viòambita-kakubjuña üòha-häsam

sadyo 'subhiù saha vineñyati dāra-hartur

visphürjitair dhanuña uccarato 'dhisainye

SYNONYMS

vakñāu-sthala—chest; *sparça*—touched by; *rugna*—broken; *mahā-indra*—the King of heaven; *vāha*—the conveyor; *dantaiù*—by the trunk; *viòambita*—illuminated; *kakup-juñaù*—all directions thus being served; *üòha-häsam*—overtaken by laughter; *sadyaù*—within no time; *asubhiù*—by the life; *saha*—along with; *vineñyati*—was killed; *dāra-hartuù*—of the one

who kidnapped the wife; *visphürjitaiù*—by the tingling of the bow;
dhanuññaù—bow; *uccarataù*—strolling fast; *adhisainye*—in the midst of the
fighting soldiers of both sides.

TRANSLATION

When Ravana was engaged in the battle, the trunk of the elephant which carried the King of heaven, Indra, broke in pieces, having collided with the chest of Ravana, and the scattered broken parts illuminated all directions. Ravana therefore felt proud of his prowess and began to loiter in the midst of the fighting soldiers, thinking himself the conqueror of all directions. But his laughter, overtaken by joy, along with his very air of life, suddenly ceased with the tingling sound of the bow of Rāmacandra, the Personality of Godhead.

PURPORT

However powerful a living being may be, when he is condemned by God no one can save him, and, similarly, however weak one may be, if he is protected by the Lord no one can annihilate him.

TEXT 26

>aUMae" SaureTarvæQaivMaidRTaaYaa"
©e-XaVYaYaaYa k-l/Yaa iSaTak*-Z<ake-Xa")
JaaTa" k-irZYaiTa JaNaaNauPal/+YaMaaGaR"
k-MaaRi<a caTMaMaihMaaePaiNabNDaNaaNa)) 26))

bhümeù suretara-varütha-vimarditäyäu

kleça-vyayäya kalayä sita-kãñëa-keçaù

jätaù kariñyati janänupalakñya-märgaù

karmäëi cätma-mahimopanibandhanäni

SYNONYMS

bhūmeù—of the entire world; *sura-itara*—other than godly persons; *varūtha*—soldiers; *vimarditāyāù*—distressed by the burden; *kleṣa*—miseries; *vyayāya*—for the matter of diminishing; *kalayā*—along with His plenary expansion; *sita-kāñṣā*—not only beautiful but also black; *keṣaù*—with such hairs; *jātaù*—having appeared; *kariṇyati*—would act; *jana*—people in general; *anupalakṇya*—rarely to be seen; *mārgaù*—path; *karmāi*—activities; *ca*—also; *ātma-mahimā*—glories of the Lord Himself; *upanibandhanāni*—in relation to.

TRANSLATION

When the world is overburdened by the fighting strength of kings who have no faith in God, the Lord, just to diminish the distress of the world, descends with His plenary portion. The Lord comes in His original form, with beautiful black hair. And just to expand His transcendental glories, He acts extraordinarily. No one can properly estimate how great He is.

PURPORT

This verse is especially describing the appearance of Lord Kṛṣṇa and His immediate expansion, Lord Baladeva. Both Lord Kṛṣṇa and Lord Baladeva are one Supreme Personality of Godhead. The Lord is omnipotent, and He expands Himself in innumerable forms and energies, and the whole unit is known as the one Supreme Brahman. Such extensions of the Lord are divided into two divisions, namely personal and differential. The personal expansions are called the *viṣṇu-tattvas*, and the differential expansions are called the *jiva-tattvas*. And in such expansional activity, Lord Baladeva is the first personal expansion of Kṛṣṇa, the Supreme Personality of Godhead.

In the *Viṣṇu Purāṇa*, as well as in the *Mahābhārata*, both Kṛṣṇa and Baladeva are mentioned as having beautiful black hair, even in Their advanced age. The Lord is called *anupalakṇya-mārgaù* or, in still more technical Vedic terms, *avāi-manasā gocaraù*: one who is never to be seen or realized by the limited sense perception of the people in general. In the ***Bhagavad-gītā*** (7.25) it is said by the Lord, *nāhaà prakāṣaù sarvasya yogamāyā-samāvātaù*. In other words, He reserves the right of not being exposed to anyone and everyone. Only the bona fide devotees can know

Him by His specific symptoms, and out of many, many such symptoms, one symptom is mentioned here in this verse, that the Lord is *sita-kāñḍa-keṣaù*, or one who is observed always with beautiful black hair. Both Lord Kṛṣṇa and Lord Baladeva have such hair on Their heads, and thus even in advanced age They appeared like young boys sixteen years old. That is the particular symptom of the Personality of Godhead. In the *Brahma-saṁhitā* it is stated that although He is the oldest personality among all living entities, He always looks like a new, youthful boy. That is the characteristic of a spiritual body. The material body is symptomized by birth, death, old age and diseases, but the spiritual body is conspicuous by the absence of those symptoms. Living entities who reside in the Vaikunthalokas in eternal life and bliss have the same type of spiritual body, without being affected by any signs of old age. It is described in the *Bhāgavatam* (Canto Six) that the party of Viṣṇudūtas who came to deliver Ajāmila from the clutches of the party of Yamarāja appeared like youthful boys, corroborating the description in this verse. It is ascertained thus that the spiritual bodies in the Vaikunthalokas, either of the Lord or of the other inhabitants, are completely distinct from the material bodies of this world. Therefore, when the Lord descends from that world to this world, He descends in His spiritual body of *ātma-māyā*, or internal potency, without any touch of the *bahiraṅgā-māyā*, or external, material energy. The allegation that the impersonal Brahman appears in this material world by accepting a material body is quite absurd. Therefore the Lord, when He comes here, has not a material body, but a spiritual body. The impersonal *brahmajyoti* is only the glaring effulgence of the body of the Lord, and there is no difference in quality between the body of the Lord and the impersonal ray of the Lord, called *brahmajyoti*.

Now the question is why the Lord, who is omnipotent, comes here to diminish the burden created upon the world by the unscrupulous kingly order. Certainly the Lord does not need to come here personally for such purposes, but He actually descends to exhibit His transcendental activities in order to encourage His pure devotees, who want to enjoy life by chanting the glories of the Lord. In the *Bhagavad-gītā* (9.13–14) it is stated that the *mahātmās*, great devotees of the Lord, take pleasure in chanting of the activities of the Lord. All Vedic literatures are meant for turning one's attention towards the Lord and His transcendental activities. Thus the

activities of the Lord, in His dealings with worldly people, create a subject matter for discussion by His pure devotees.

TEXT 27

Taaeke-Na Jaqvhr<a& YadulU/ik-k-aYaa,
S}aEMaaISak-SYa c Pada Xak-§=ae_Pav*ta")
Yad(ir®TaaNTarGaTaeNa idivSPa*XaaevaR
oNMaUl/Na& iTvTarQaaJauRNaYaaeNaR >aaVYaMa()) 27))

tokena jéva-haraëaà yad ulüki-käyäs

trai-mäsikasya ca padä çakaöo 'pavåttaù

yad riìgatäntara-gatena divi-spåçor vā

unmülanaà tv itarathärjunayor na bhävyam

SYNONYMS

tokena—by a child; *jéva-haraëam*—killing a living being; *yat*—one which; *ulüki-käyäu*—assumed the giant body of a demon; *trai-mäsikasya*—of one who is only three months old; *ca*—also; *padä*—by the leg; *çakaöaù* *apavåttaù*—turned over the cart; *yat*—one who; *riìgatä*—while crawling; *antara-gatena*—being overtaken; *divi*—high in the sky; *spåçou*—touching; *vā*—either; *unmülanam*—uprooting; *tu*—but; *itarathä*—anyone else than; *arjunayou*—of the two *arjuna* trees; *na bhävyam*—was not possible.

TRANSLATION

There is no doubt about Lord Kṛṣṇa's being the Supreme Lord, otherwise how was it possible for Him to kill a giant demon like Pūtanā when He was just on the lap of His mother, to overturn a cart with His leg when He was only three months old, to uproot a pair of arjuna trees, so high that they touched the sky, when He was only crawling? All these activities are impossible for anyone other than the Lord Himself.

PURPORT

One cannot manufacture a God by one's mental speculation or by numerical votes, as has become a practice for the less intelligent class of men. God is God eternally, and an ordinary living entity is eternally a part and parcel of God. God is one without a second, and the ordinary living entities are many without number. All such living entities are maintained by God Himself, and that is the verdict of the Vedic literatures. When Kṛṣṇa was on the lap of His mother, the demon Pūtanā appeared before His mother and prayed to nurture the child in her lap. Mother Yaçodā agreed, and the child was transferred onto the lap of Pūtanā, who was in the garb of a respectable lady. Pūtanā wanted to kill the child by smearing poison on the nipple of her breast. But when everything was complete, the Lord sucked her breast along with her very air of life, and the demon's gigantic body, said to be as long as six miles, fell down. But Lord Kṛṣṇa did not need to expand Himself to the length of the she-demon Pūtanā, although He was quite competent to extend Himself more than six miles long. In His Vāmana incarnation He posed Himself as a dwarf *brahmana*, but when He took possession of His land, promised by Bali Maharaja, He expanded His footstep to the top of the universe, extending over thousands and millions of miles. So it was not very difficult for Kṛṣṇa to perform a miracle by extending His bodily feature, but He had no desire to do it because of His deep filial love for His mother, Yaçodā. If Yaçodā had seen Kṛṣṇa in her lap extending six miles to cope with the she-demon Pūtanā, then the natural filial love of Yaçodā would have been hurt because in that way Yaçodā would have come to know that her so-called son, Kṛṣṇa, was God Himself. And with the knowledge of the Godhood of Kṛṣṇa, Yaçodāmayé would have lost the temper of her love for Kṛṣṇa as a natural mother. But as far as Lord Kṛṣṇa is concerned, He is God always, either as a child on the lap of His mother, or as the coverer of the universe, Vāmanadeva. He does not require to become God by undergoing severe penances, although some men think of becoming God in that way. By undergoing severe austerities and penances, one cannot become one or equal with God, but one can attain most of the godly qualities. A living being can attain godly qualities to a large extent, but he cannot become God, whereas Kṛṣṇa, without undergoing any type of penance, is God always, either in the lap of His mother or growing up or at any stage of growth.

So at the age of only three months He killed the Çakaöäsurā, who had remained hidden behind a cart in the house of Yaçodāmayé. And when He was crawling and was disturbing His mother from doing household affairs, the mother tied Him with a grinding pestle, but the naughty child dragged the pestle up to a pair of very high *arjuna* trees in the yard of Yaçodāmayé, and when the pestle was stuck between the pair of trees, they fell down with a horrible sound. When Yaçodāmayé came to see the happenings, she thought that her child had been saved from the falling trees by the mercy of the Lord, without knowing that the Lord Himself, crawling in her yard, had wreaked the havoc. So that is the way of reciprocation of love affairs between the Lord and His devotees. Yaçodāmayé wanted to have the Lord as her child, and the Lord played exactly like a child in her lap, but at the same time played the part of the Almighty Lord whenever it was so required. The beauty of such pastimes was that the Lord fulfilled everyone's desire. In the case of felling the gigantic *arjuna* trees, the Lord's mission was to deliver the two sons of Kuvera, who were condemned to become trees by the curse of Nārada, as well as to play like a crawling child in the yard of Yaçodā, who took transcendental pleasure in seeing such activities of the Lord in the very yard of her home.

The Lord in any condition is Lord of the universe, and He can act as such in any form, gigantic or small, as He likes.

TEXT 28

Yad(vE v]Jae v]JaPaéUNa(ivzTaaeYaPaqTaaNa(
Paal/a&STvJaqvYadNauGa]hd*íiv*íya)
TaC^uÖYae_iTaivzvqYaRivl/ael/iJaû,
MauÀa\$=iYaZYadurGa& ivhrNa(hñidNYaaMa()) 28))

yad vai vraje vraja-paçün viñatoya-pétän

päläàs tv ajévyad anugraha-dãñöi-vãñöyã

tac-chuddhaye 'ti-viña-vérya-vilola-jihvam

uccäöayiñyad uragaà viharan hradinyäm

SYNONYMS

yat—one who; *vai*—certainly; *vraje*—at Våndävana; *vraja-paçün*—the animals thereof; *viña-toya*—poisoned water; *pétän*—those who drank; *pälän*—the cowherd men; *tu*—also; *ajévayat*—brought to life; *anugraha-dâñöi*—merciful glance; *vãñöyă*—by the showers of; *tat*—that; *çuddhaye*—for purification; *ati*—exceedingly; *viña-vérya*—highly potent poison; *vilola*—lurking; *jihvam*—one who has such a tongue; *uccäöayiñyat*—severely punished; *uragam*—unto the snake; *viharan*—taking it as a pleasure; *hradinyäm*—in the river.

TRANSLATION

Then also when the cowherd boys and their animals drank the poisoned water of the River Yamunä, and after the Lord [in His childhood] revived them by His merciful glance, just to purify the water of the River Yamunä He jumped into it as if playing and chastised the venomous Kāliya snake, which was lurking there, its tongue emitting waves of poison. Who can perform such herculean tasks but the Supreme Lord ?

TEXT 29

TaTa(k-MaR idVYaiMav Yaiàixà iNa"XaYaaNa&
davaiganaa éuicvNae PairedùMaaNae)
oàeZYaiTa v]JaMaTaae_visaTaaNTak-al&/
Nae}ae iPaDaaPYa Sabl/ae_NaiDaGaMYavqYaR")) 29))

tat karma divyam iva yan niçi niùçayänaà

dävägninä çuci-vane paridahyamäne

unneñyati vrajam ato 'vasitänta-kälaà

netre pidhäpya sabalo 'nadhigamya-véryaù

SYNONYMS

tat—that; *karma*—activity; *divyam*—superhuman; *iva*—like; *yat*—which; *niçi*—at night; *niùçayānam*—sleeping carefreely; *däva-agninä*—by the glare of the forest fire; *çuci-vane*—in the dry forest; *paridahyamäne*—being set ablaze; *unneñyati*—would deliver; *vrajam*—all the inhabitants of Vraja; *ataù*—hence; *avasita*—surely; *anta-kālam*—last moments of life; *netre*—on the eyes; *pidhāpya*—simply by closing; *sa-balaù*—along with Baladeva; *anadhigamya*—unfathomable; *véryaù*—prowess.

TRANSLATION

On the very night of the day of the chastisement of the Kāliya snake, when the inhabitants of Vrajabhūmi were sleeping carefreely, there was a forest fire ablaze due to dry leaves, and it appeared that all the inhabitants were sure to meet their death. But the Lord, along with Balarāma, saved them simply by closing His eyes. Such are the superhuman activities of the Lord.

PURPORT

Although in this verse the Lord’s activity has been described as superhuman, it should be noted that the Lord’s activities are always superhuman, and that distinguishes Him from the ordinary living being. Uprooting a gigantic banyan or *arjuna* tree and extinguishing a blazing forest fire simply by closing one’s eyes are certainly impossible by any kind of human endeavor. But not only are these activities amazing to hear, but in fact all other activities of the Lord, whatever He may do, are all superhuman, as confirmed in the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (4.9). Whoever knows the superhuman activities of the Lord, due to their very transcendental nature, becomes eligible to enter the kingdom of Kṛṣṇa, and as such, after quitting this present material body, the knower of the transcendental activities of the Lord goes back home, back to Godhead.

TEXT 30

Ga*õqTa Yad(YaduPabNDaMaMauZYa MaaTaa
éuLb& SauTaSYa Na Tau TaTa(TadMauZYa MaaiTa)
YaÂ*M>aTaae_SYa vdNae >auvNaaiNa GaaePaq

Sa&vq+Ya Xai²TaMaNaa" Pa[iTabaeiDaTaaSaqTa()) 30))

gāhēéta yad yad upabandham amuñya mätä

ṣulbaà sutasya na tu tat tad amuñya māti

yaj jāmbhato 'sya vadane bhuvanāni gopé

saàvékñya ṣaṅkita-manäù pratibodhitäsét

SYNONYMS

gāhēéta—by taking up; *yat yat*—whatsoever; *upabandham*—ropes for tying; *amuñya*—His; *mätä*—mother; *ṣulbam*—ropes; *sutasya*—of her son; *na*—not; *tu*—however; *tat tat*—by and by; *amuñya*—His; *māti*—was sufficient; *yat*—that which; *jāmbhataù*—opening the mouth; *asya*—of Him; *vadane*—in the mouth; *bhuvanāni*—the worlds; *gopé*—the cowherd woman; *saàvékñya*—so seeing it; *ṣaṅkita-manäù*—doubtful in mind; *pratibodhitä*—convinced in a different way; *äsét*—was so done.

TRANSLATION

When the cowherd woman [Kṛṣṇa's foster mother, Yaçodä] was trying to tie the hands of her son with ropes, she found the rope to be always insufficient in length, and when she finally gave up, Lord Kṛṣṇa, by and by, opened His mouth, wherein the mother found all the universes situated. Seeing this, she was doubtful in her mind, but she was convinced in a different manner of the mystic nature of her son.

PURPORT

One day Lord Kṛṣṇa as the naughty child disturbed His mother Yaçodä, and she began to tie up the child with ropes just to punish Him. But no matter how much rope she used, she found it always insufficient. Thus she became fatigued, but in the meantime the Lord opened His mouth, and the affectionate mother saw within the mouth of her son all the universes situated together. The mother was astonished, but out of her deep

affection for Kṛṣṇa she thought that the Almighty Godhead Nārāyaṇa had kindly looked after her son just to protect Him from all the continuous calamities happening to Him. Because of her deep affection for Kṛṣṇa, she could never think that her very son was Nārāyaṇa, the Personality of Godhead Himself. That is the action of *yogamāyā*, the internal potency of the Supreme Lord, which acts to perfect all the pastimes of the Lord with His different types of devotees. Who could play such wonders without being God?

TEXT 31

NaNd& c Maae+YaiTa >aYaad(vā<aSYa PaaXaad(
GaaePaaNa(ible/zu iPaihTaaNa(MaYaSaUNauNaa c)
AöyaPa*Ta& iNaiXa XaYaaNaMaiTaé[Mae<a
I/aek&- ivku-<#=MauPaNaeZYaiTa Gaaeku-I&/ Sma)) 31))

nandaà ca mokñyati bhayäd varuëasya päçäd

gopän bileñu pihitän maya-sünunä ca

ahny äpâtaà niçi çayānam atiçrameëa

lokaà vikuëöham upaneñyati gokulaà sma

SYNONYMS

nandam—unto Nanda (the father of Kṛṣṇa); *ca*—also; *mokñyati*—saves; *bhayät*—from the fear of; *varuëasya*—of Varuëa, the demigod of water; *päçät*—from the clutches of; *gopän*—the cowherd men; *bileñu*—in the caves of the mountain; *pihitän*—placed; *maya-sünunä*—by the son of Maya; *ca*—also; *ahni äpâtam*—being very engaged during the daytime; *niçi*—at night; *çayānam*—lying down; *atiçrameëa*—because of hard labor; *loka*m—planet; *vikuëöham*—the spiritual sky; *upaneñyati*—He awarded; *gokulam*—the highest planet; *sma*—certainly.

TRANSLATION

Lord Kṛṣṇa saved His foster father, Nanda Maharaja, from the fear of the demigod Varuëa and released the cowherd boys from the caves of the mountain, for they were placed there by the son of Maya. Also, to the inhabitants of Våndävana, who were busy working during daytime and sleeping soundly at night because of their hard labor in the day, Lord Kṛṣṇa awarded promotion to the highest planet in the spiritual sky. All these acts are transcendental and certainly prove without any doubt His Godhood.

PURPORT

Nanda Maharaja, the foster father of Lord Kṛṣṇa, went to take his bath in the River Yamunä in the dead of night, mistakenly thinking that the night was already over; thus the demigod Varuëa took him to the Varuëa planet just to have a look at the Personality of Godhead Lord Kṛṣṇa, who appeared there to release His father. Actually there was no arrest of Nanda Maharaja by Varuëa because the inhabitants of Våndävana were always engaged in thinking of Kṛṣṇa, in constant meditation on the Personality of Godhead in a particular form of *samadhi*, or trance of *bhakti-yoga*. They had no fear of the miseries of material existence. In the *Bhagavad-gita* it is confirmed that to be in association with the Supreme Personality of Godhead by full surrender in transcendental love frees one from the miseries inflicted by the laws of material nature. Here it is clearly mentioned that the inhabitants of Våndävana were extensively busy in the hard labor of their day's work, and due to the day's hard labor they were engaged in sound sleep at night. So practically they had very little time to devote to meditation or to the other paraphernalia of spiritual activities. But factually they were engaged in the highest spiritual activities only. Everything done by them was spiritualized because everything was dovetailed in their relationship with Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa. The central point of activities was Kṛṣṇa, and as such the so-called activities in the material world were saturated with spiritual potency. That is the advantage of the way of *bhakti-yoga*. One should discharge one's duty on Lord Kṛṣṇa's behalf, and all one's actions will be saturated with Kṛṣṇa thought, the highest pattern of trance in spiritual realization.

TEXT 32

GaaePaEMaR%e Pa[iTahTae v]JaivâvaYa
deve_i>avzRiTâ PaéUNa(k*-PaYaa irr+au")
DaTaaeRiC^I/INDa]iMav SaáidNaaiNa Saá,
vzaeR MahqDa]MaNagaEk-k-re Sal/Il/Ma()) 32))

gopair makhe pratihate vraja-viplaväya

deve 'bhivarñati paçün kâpayä rirakñuù

dhartocchiléndhram iva sapta-dinäni sapta-

varño mahédhram anaghaika-kare salélam

SYNONYMS

gopaiù—by the cowherd men; *makhe*—in offering a sacrifice to the King of heaven; *pratihate*—being hampered; *vraja-viplaväya*—for devastating the whole existence of Vrajabhümi, the land of Kṛṣṇa's pastimes; *deve*—by the King of heaven; *abhivarñati*—having poured down heavy rain; *paçün*—the animals; *kâpayä*—by causeless mercy upon them; *rirakñuù*—desired to protect them; *dharta*—held up; *ucchiléndhram*—uprooted as an umbrella; *iva*—exactly like that; *sapta-dinäni*—continuously for seven days; *sapta-varñau*—although He was only seven years old; *mahédhram*—the Govardhana Hill; *anagha*—without being tired; *eka-kare*—in one hand only; *salélam*—playfully.

TRANSLATION

When the cowherd men of Våndävana, under instruction of Kṛṣṇa, stopped offering sacrifice to the heavenly King, Indra, the whole tract of land known as Vraja was threatened with being washed away by constant heavy rains for seven days. Lord Kṛṣṇa, out of His causeless mercy upon the inhabitants of Vraja, held up the hill known as Govardhana with one hand only, although He was only seven years old. He did this to protect the animals from the onslaught of water.

PURPORT

Children play with an umbrella generally known as a frog's umbrella, and Lord Kṛṣṇa, when He was only seven years old, could snatch the great hill known as the Govardhana Parvata at Våndävana and hold it for seven days continuously with one hand, just to protect the animals and the inhabitants of Våndävana from the wrath of Indra, the heavenly King, who had been denied sacrificial offerings by the inhabitants of Vrajabhümi.

Factually there is no need of offering sacrifices to the demigods for their services if one is engaged in the service of the Supreme Lord. Sacrifices recommended in the Vedic literature for satisfaction of the demigods are a sort of inducement to the sacrificers to realize the existence of higher authorities. The demigods are engaged by the Lord as controlling deities of material affairs, and according to the *Bhagavad-gita*, when a demigod is worshiped the process is accepted as the indirect method for worshiping the Supreme Lord. But when the Supreme Lord is worshiped directly there is no need of worshiping the demigods or offering them sacrifices as recommended in particular circumstances. Lord Kṛṣṇa therefore advised the inhabitants of Vrajabhümi not to offer any sacrifices to the heavenly King Indra. But Indra, not knowing Lord Kṛṣṇa in Vrajabhümi, was angry at the inhabitants of Vrajabhümi and tried to avenge the offense. But, competent as the Lord was, He saved the inhabitants and animals of Vrajabhümi by His personal energy and proved definitely that anyone directly engaged as a devotee of the Supreme Lord need not satisfy any other demigods, however great, even to the level of Brahmä, or Siva. Thus this incident definitely proved without a doubt that Lord Kṛṣṇa is the Personality of Godhead and that He was so in all circumstances, as a child on the lap of His mother, as a boy 7 years old, and as an old man of 125 years of age. In either case He was never on the level of the ordinary man, and even in His advanced age He appeared a young boy 16 years old. These are the particular features of the transcendental body of the Lord.

TEXT 33

§-l@Na(vNae iNaiXa iNaXaak-rrlXMaGaaEYaa|
raSaaeNMau%" k-l/PadaYaTaMaUiC^RTaeNa)
oÕqiPaTaSMaråJaa& v]Ja>a*ÜDaUNaa&
hTauRhRirZYaiTa iXarae DaNadaNauGaSYa)) 33))

kréòan vane niçi niçäkara-raçmi-gauryäà

räsonmukhaù kala-padäyata-mürcchitena

uddépita-smara-rujää vraja-bhâd-vadhünää

hartur hariñyati çiro dhanadänugasya

SYNONYMS

kréòan—while engaged in His pastimes; *vane*—in the forest of Våndävana; *niçi*—nocturnal; *niçäkara*—the moon; *raçmi-gauryäm*—white moonshine; *räsa-unmukhaù*—desiring to dance with; *kala-padäyata*—accompanied by sweet songs; *mürcchitena*—and melodious music; *uddépita*—awakened; *smara-rujäm*—sexual desires; *vraja-bhât*—the inhabitants of Vrajabhümi; *vadhünäm*—of the wives; *hartuù*—of the kidnappers; *hariñyati*—will vanquish; *çiraù*—the head; *dhanada-anugasya*—of the follower of the rich Kuvera.

TRANSLATION

When the Lord was engaged in His pastimes of the räsa dance in the forest of Våndävana, enlivening the sexual desires of the wives of the inhabitants of Våndävana by sweet and melodious songs, a demon of the name Çaikhacüòà, a rich follower of the treasurer of heaven [Kuvera], kidnapped the damsels, and the Lord severed his head from his trunk.

PURPORT

We should carefully note that the statements described herein are the statements of Brahmäjé to Nārada, and he was speaking to Nārada of events that would happen in the future, during the advent of Lord Kṛṣṇa. The pastimes of the Lord are known to the experts who are able to see past, present and future, and Brahmäjé, being one of them, foretold what would happen in the future. The killing of Çaikhacüòà by the Lord is a more recent incident, after the *räsa-līla*, and not exactly a simultaneous affair. In the previous verses we have seen also that the Lord’s engagement in the

affairs of the forest fire was described along with His pastimes of punishing the Kāliya snake, and similarly the pastimes of the *rāsa* dance and the killing of Çaikḥacüòà are also described herein. The adjustment is that all these incidents would take place in the future, after the time when it was being foretold by Brahmäjé to Nārada. The demon Çaikḥacüòà was killed by the Lord during His pastimes at Horikā in the month of Phālguna, and the same ceremony is still observed in India by the burning of the effigy of Çaikḥacüòà one day prior to the Lord's pastimes at Horikā, generally known as Holi.

Generally the future appearance and the activities of the Lord or His incarnations are foretold in the scriptures, and thus the pseudoincarnations are unable to cheat persons who are in knowledge of the events as they are described in the authoritative scriptures.

TEXTS 34–35

Yae c Pa[l/Mb%rdduRrke-XYairí,
 Maçe>ak&-SaYavNaa" k-iPaPaaE<@\k-aŪa")
 ANYae c XaaLvku-JabLvl/dNTavṣ-,
 Saáae+aXaMbrivdUrQaâiKMaMau:Yaa")) 34))
 Yae va Ma*Dae SaiMaiTaXaail/Na AatacaPaa"
 k-aMbaeJaMaTSYaku-âSa*ÂYakE-k-YaaŪa")
 YaaSYaNTYadXaRNaMal&/ bl/PaaQaR>aqMa,
 VYaaJaaŪYaeNa hir<aa iNal/Ya& TadqYaMa()) 35))

ye ca pralamba-khara-dardura-keçy-ariñöa-

mallebha-kaàsa-yavanäù kapi-pauëòrakädyäù

anye ca çälva-kuja-balvala-dantavakra-

saptokñä-çambara-vidüratha-rukmi-mukhyäù

ye vä mādhe samiti-çälina ätta-cäpäù

kämboja-matsya-kuru-sâijaya-kaikayädyäù

yäsyantya adarçanam alaà bala-pārtha-bhéma-

vyäjähvayena hariëä nilayaà tadéyam

SYNONYMS

ye—all those; *ca*—totally; *pralamba*—the demon named Pralamba; *khara*—Dhenukäsura; *dardura*—Bakäsura; *keçé*—the Keçé demon; *ariñöa*—the demon Ariñöäsura; *malla*—a wrestler in the court of Kaàsa; *ibha*—Kuvalayäpéöa; *kaàsa*—the King of Mathurä and maternal uncle of Kṛṣṇa; *yavanäù*—the kings of Persia and other adjoining places; *kapi*—Dvidida; *pauëòraka-ädyäù*—Pauëòraka and others; *anye*—others; *ca*—as much as; *çälva*—King Çälva; *kuja*—Narakäsura; *balvala*—King Balvala; *dantavakra*—the brother of Çiçupäla, a dead rival of Kṛṣṇa's; *saptokñä*—King Saptokñä; *çambara*—King Çambara; *vidüratha*—King Vidüratha; *rukmi-mukhyäù*—the brother of Rukmiëé, the first queen of Kṛṣṇa at Dvārakä; *ye*—all those; *vä*—either; *mådhe*—in the battlefield; *samiti-çälinaù*—all very powerful; *ätta-cäpäù*—well equipped with bows and arrows; *kämboja*—the King of Kämboja; *matsya*—the King of Dvarbhaiga; *kuru*—the sons of Dhåtaräñöra; *såijaya*—King Såijaya; *kaikaya-ädyäù*—the King of Kekaya and others; *yäsianti*—would attain; *adarçanam*—impersonal merging within the *brahmajyoti*; *alam*—what to speak of; *bala*—Baladeva, the elder brother of Kṛṣṇa; *pārtha*—Arjuna; *bhéma*—the second Päëòava; *vyäja-ähvayena*—by the false names; *hariëä*—by Lord Hari; *nilayam*—the abode; *tadéyam*—of Him.

TRANSLATION

All demonic personalities like Pralamba, Dhenuka, Baka, Keçé, Ariñöa, Cäëüra, Muñöika, Kuvalayäpéöa elephant, Kaàsa, Yavana, Narakäsura and Pauëòraka, great marshals like Sälva, Dvidida monkey and Balvala, Dantavakra, the seven bulls, Çambara, Vidüratha and Rukmé, as also great warriors like Kämboja, Matsya, Kuru, Såijaya and Kekaya, would all fight vigorously, either with the Lord Hari directly or with Him under His names of Baladeva, Arjuna, Bhéma, etc. And the demons, thus being killed, would attain either the impersonal brahmajyoti or His personal abode in the Vaikuntha planets.

PURPORT

All manifestations, in both the material and spiritual worlds, are demonstrations of the different potencies of Lord Kṛṣṇa. The Personality of Godhead Baladeva is His immediate personal expansion, and Bhéma, Arjuna, etc., are His personal associates. The Lord would appear (and He does so whenever He appears) with all His associates and potencies. Therefore the rebellious souls, like the demons and demoniac men, mentioned by names like Pralamba, would be killed either by the Lord Himself or by His associates. All these affairs will be clearly explained in the Tenth Canto. But we should know well that all the above-mentioned living entities killed would attain salvation either by being merged in the *brahmajyoti* of the Lord or being allowed to enter into the abodes of the Lord called Vaikunthas. This has already been explained by Bhéñmadeva (First Canto). All persons who participated in the Battlefield of Kurukñetra or otherwise with the Lord or with Baladeva, etc., would benefit by attaining spiritual existence according to the situation of their minds at the time of death. Those who recognized the Lord would enter Vaikuntha, and those who estimated the Lord as only a powerful being would attain salvation by merging into the spiritual existence of the impersonal *brahmajyoti* of the Lord. But every one of them would get release from material existence. Since such is the benefit of those who played with the Lord inimically, one can imagine what would be the position of those who devoutly served the Lord in transcendental relationship with Him.

TEXT 36

k-ale/Na Maqil/TaiDaYaaMavMa*XYa Na><aa&
STaaek-aYauza& SviNaGaMaae bTa dUrPaar")
AaivihRTaSTvNauYauGa& Sa ih SaTYavTYaa&
vedd]uMa& iv\$=PaXaae iv>aiJaZYaiTa SMa)) 36))

kälena mérita-dhiyäm avamāçya nèëää

stokäyuñää sva-nigamo bata düra-pärau

ävirhitas tv anuyugaà sa hi satyavatyää

veda-drumaà viöa-paço vibhajiñyati sma

SYNONYMS

kälena—in course of time; *mélita-dhiyäm*—of the less intelligent persons; *avamâçya*—considering the difficulties; *nèëäm*—of humanity at large; *stoka-äyüñäm*—of the short-living persons; *sva-nigamaù*—the Vedic literatures compiled by Him; *bata*—exactly; *dūra-päraù*—greatly difficult; *ävirhitaù*—having appeared as; *tu*—but; *anuyugam*—in terms of the age; *saù*—He (the Lord); *hi*—certainly; *satyavatyäm*—in the womb of Satyavati; *veda-drumam*—the desire tree of the *Vedas*; *viöa-paçaù*—by division of branches; *vibhajiñyati*—will divide; *sma*—as it were.

TRANSLATION

The Lord Himself in His incarnation as the son of Satyavati [Vyäsadeva] will consider his compilation of the Vedic literature to be very difficult for the less intelligent persons with short life, and thus He will divide the tree of Vedic knowledge into different branches, according to the circumstances of the particular age.

PURPORT

Herein Brahmä mentions the future compilation of *Srimad-Bhagavatam* for the short-lived persons of the Kali age. As explained in the First Canto, the less intelligent persons of the age of Kali would be not only short-lived, but also perplexed with so many problems of life due to the awkward situation of the godless human society. Advancement of material comforts of the body is activity in the mode of ignorance according to the laws of material nature. Real advancement of knowledge means progress of knowledge in self-realization. But in the age of Kali the less intelligent men mistakenly consider the short lifetime of one hundred years (now factually reduced to about forty or sixty years) to be all in all. They are less intelligent because they have no information of the eternity of life; they identify with the temporary material body existing for forty years and consider it the only basic principle of life. Such persons are described as equal to the asses and bulls. But the Lord, as the compassionate father of all living beings, imparts

unto them the vast Vedic knowledge in short treatises like the *Bhagavad-gita* and, for the graduates, the *Srimad-Bhagavatam*. The *Puranas* and the *Mahābhārata* are also similarly made by Vyāsadeva for the different types of men in the modes of material nature. But none of them are independent of the Vedic principles.

TEXT 37

deviÜza& iNaGaMavTMarina iNaiiTaaNaa&
PaUi>aRMaRYaeNa ivihTaai>ard*XYaTaUi>aR")
I/aek-aNa(ganTaa& MaiTaivMaaehMaiTaPa[I/ae>a&
vez& ivDaaYa bhu >aaZYaTa AaEPaDaMYaRMa()) 37))

deva-dviñää nigama-vartmani niñöhitanää

pürbhir mayena vihitäbhir adâçya-türbhiù

lokän ghnatää mati-vimoham atipralobhaà

veñää vidhäya bahu bhäñyata aupadharmyam

SYNONYMS

deva-dviñäm—of those who were envious of the devotees of the Lord; *nigama*—the *Vedas*; *vartmani*—on the path of; *niñöhitanäm*—of the well situated; *pürbhiù*—by rockets; *mayena*—made by the great scientist Maya; *vihitäbhiù*—made by; *adâçya-türbhiù*—unseen in the sky; *lokän*—the different planets; *ghnatäm*—of the killers; *mati-vimoham*—bewilderment of the mind; *atipralobham*—very attractive; *veñam*—dress; *vidhäya*—having done so; *bahu bhäñyate*—will talk very much; *aupadharmyam*—subreligious principles.

TRANSLATION

When the atheists, after being well versed in the Vedic scientific knowledge, annihilate inhabitants of different planets, flying unseen in the sky on well-built rockets prepared by the great scientist Maya, the

Lord will bewilder their minds by dressing Himself attractively as Buddha and will preach on subreligious principles.

PURPORT

This incarnation of Lord Buddha is not the same Buddha incarnation we have in the present history of mankind. According to Srila Jiva Gosvami, the Buddha incarnation mentioned in this verse appeared in a different Kali age. In the duration of life of one Manu there are more than seventy-two Kali-yugas, and in one of them the particular type of Buddha mentioned here would appear. Lord Buddha incarnates at a time when the people are most materialistic and preaches common-sense religious principles. Such *ahiàsä* is not a religious principle itself, but it is an important quality for persons who are actually religious. It is a common-sense religion because one is advised to do no harm to any other animal or living being because such harmful actions are equally harmful to he who does the harm. But before learning these principles of nonviolence one has to learn two other principles, namely to be humble and to be prideless. Unless one is humble and prideless, one cannot be harmless and nonviolent. And after being nonviolent one has to learn tolerance and simplicity of living. One must offer respects to the great religious preachers and spiritual leaders and also train the senses for controlled action, learning to be unattached to family and home, and enacting devotional service to the Lord, etc. At the ultimate stage one has to accept the Lord and become His devotee; otherwise there is no religion. In religious principles there must be God in the center; otherwise simple moral instructions are merely subreligious principles, generally known as *upadharma*, or nearness to religious principles.

TEXT 38

**YaùàRI/YaeZviPa SaTaa& Na hre" k-Qaa" SYau"
Paazi<@Naae iÜJaJaNaä v*zl/a Na*deva")
Svaha SvDaa vzi@iTä SMa iGarae Na Ya}a
XaaSTaa >aivZYaiTa k-le/>aRGavaNa(YauGaaNTae)) 38))**

yarhy älayeñv api satäà na hareù kathäù syuù

pãñaëòino dvija-janä våñalä nådeväù

svähä svadhä vañaò iti sma giro na yatra

çästä bhaviñyati kaler bhagavän yugänte

SYNONYMS

yarhi—when it happens; *älayeñu*—in the residence of; *api*—even; *satäm*—civilized gentlemen; *na*—no; *hareù*—of the Personality of Godhead; *kathäù*—topics; *syuù*—will take place; *pãñaëòinaù*—atheists; *dvija-janäù*—persons declaring themselves to be the higher three classes (*brahmanas*, *kṣatriyas* and *vaisyas*); *våñaläù*—the lower class *sudras*; *nå-deväù*—ministers of the government; *svähä*—hymns to perform sacrifices; *svadhä*—the ingredients to perform sacrifices; *vañaò*—the altar of sacrifice; *iti*—all these; *sma*—shall; *giraù*—words; *na*—never; *yatra*—anywhere; *çästä*—the chastiser; *bhaviñyati*—will appear; *kaleù*—of the Kali age; *bhagavän*—the Personality of Godhead; *yuga-ante*—at the end of.

TRANSLATION

Thereafter, at the end of Kali-yuga, when there exist no topics on the subject of God, even at the residences of so-called saints and respectable gentlemen of the three higher castes, and when the power of government is transferred to the hands of ministers elected from the lowborn çüdra class or those less than them, and when nothing is known of the techniques of sacrifice, even by word, at that time the Lord will appear as the supreme chastiser.

PURPORT

The symptoms of the worst conditions of the material world, at the last stage of this age, called Kali-yuga, are stated herein. The sum and substance of such conditions is godlessness. Even the so-called saints and higher castes of the social orders, generally known as the *dvija janas* or the twice-born, will become atheists. As such, all of them will practically forget even the holy name of the Lord, and what to speak of His activities. The higher

castes of society, namely the intelligent class of men guiding the destinies of the social orders, the administrative class of men guiding the law and order of the society, and the productive class of men guiding the economic development of the society, must all be properly well versed in knowledge of the Supreme Lord, knowing factually His name, quality, pastimes, entourage, paraphernalia and personalities. The saints and the higher castes or orders of the society are judged by their proportion of knowledge in the science of God, or *tattva jñāna*, and not by any kind of birthright or bodily designations. Such designations, without any knowledge of the science of God and practical knowledge of devotional service, are considered to be all decorations of dead bodies. And when there is too much inflation of these decorated dead bodies in society, there develop so many anomalies in the progressive, peaceful life of the human being. Because of the lack of training or culture in the upper section of the social orders, they are no more to be designated as the *dvija janas*, or the twice-born. The significance of being twice-born has been explained in many places in these great literatures, and again one is reminded herewith that birth, executed by the sex life of the father and the mother, is called animal birth. But such animal birth and progress of life on the animal principles of eating, sleeping, fearing and mating (without any scientific culture of spiritual life) is called the *çüdra* life, or, to be more explicit, the uncultured life of the lower class of men. It is stated herein that the governmental power of society in the Kali-yuga will be passed over to the uncultured, godless laborer classes of men, and thus the *nādevas* (or the ministers of the government) will be the *vāññalas*, or the uncultured lower-class men of society. No one can expect any peace and prosperity in a human society full of uncultured lower classes of men. The symptoms of such uncultured social animals are already in vogue, and it is the duty of the leaders of men to take note of it and try to reform the social order by introducing the principles of twice-born men trained in the science of God consciousness. This can be done by expanding the culture of *Srimad-Bhagavatam* all over the world. In the degraded condition of human society, the Lord incarnates as the Kalki *avatāra* and kills all the demonic without mercy.

TEXT 39

SaGaeR TaPaae_hMa*zYaae Nav Yae Pa[JaeXaa"

SQaaNae_Qa DaMaRMa%MaNvMaravNaqXaa")
ANTae TvDaMaRhrMaNYauvXaaSauraŪa
MaaYaaiv>aUTaYa wMaa" PauâXaiç->aaJa")) 39))

sarge tapo 'ham añayo nava ye prajeçäù

sthäne 'tha dharma-makha-manv-amarävanéçäù

ante tv adharma-hara-manyu-vaçäsurädyä

mäyä-vibhütaya imäù puru-çakti-bhäjaù

SYNONYMS

sarge—in the beginning of the creation; *tapaù*—penance; *aham*—myself; *añayaù*—sages; *nava*—nine; *ye prajeçäù*—those who would generate; *sthäne*—in the middle while maintaining the creation; *atha*—certainly; *dharma*—religion; *makha*—Lord Viṣṇu; *manu*—the father of mankind; *amara*—the demigods deputed to control the affairs of maintenance; *avanéçäù*—and the kings of different planets; *ante*—at the end; *tu*—but; *adharma*—irreligion; *hara*—Lord Siva; *manyu-vaça*—subjected to anger; *asura-ädyäù*—atheists, the enemies of the devotees; *mäyä*—energy; *vibhütayaù*—powerful representatives; *imäù*—all of them; *puru-çakti-bhäjaù*—of the supreme powerful Lord.

TRANSLATION

At the beginning of creation there are penance, myself [Brahmä], and the Prajāpatis, the great sages who generate; then, during the maintenance of the creation, there are Lord Viṣṇu, the demigods with controlling powers, and the kings of different planets. But at the end there is irreligion, and then Lord Siva and the atheists full of anger, etc. All of them are different representative manifestations of the energy of the supreme power, the Lord.

PURPORT

The material world is created by the energy of the Lord, which is manifested in the beginning of the creation by the penance of Brahmäjé, the first living being in the creation, and then there are the nine Prajāpatis, known as great sages. In the stage when the creation is maintained, there are devotional service to Lord Viṣṇu, or factual religion, the different demigods, and the kings of different planets who maintain the world. At last, when the creation is preparing to wind up, there is first the principle of irreligion, then Lord Siva along with the atheists, full of anger. But all of them are but different manifestations of the Supreme Lord. Therefore Brahmā, Viṣṇu and Mahādeva (Siva) are different incarnations of the different modes of material nature. Viṣṇu is the Lord of the mode of goodness. Brahmā is the lord of the mode of passion, and Siva is the lord of the mode of ignorance. Ultimately, the material creation is but a temporary manifestation meant to give the chance of liberation to the conditioned souls, who are entrapped in the material world, and one who develops the mode of goodness under the protection of Lord Viṣṇu has the greatest chance of being liberated by following the Vaiñṇēava principles and thus being promoted to the kingdom of God, no more to return to this miserable material world.

TEXT 40

ivZ<aaeNauR vqYaRGa<aNaa& k-TaMaae_hRTaqh
 Ya" PaaiQaRvaNYaiPa k-ivivRMaMae rJaa&iSa)
 cSk-M>a Ya" SvrhSaaS%/Taa i}aPa*i&
 YaSMaaTa(i}aSaaMYaSadNaaduâk-MPaYaaNaMa()) 40))

viñṇēor nu vérya-gaëanää katamo 'rhatéha

yaù päarthiväny api kavir vimame rajääsi

caskambha yaù sva-rahasäskhalatä tri-paññohaà

yasmät tri-sämya-sadanäd uru-kampayānam

SYNONYMS

viñëoù—of Lord Viṣṇu; *nu*—but; *vérya*—prowess; *gaëanäm*—in the matter of accounting; *katamaù*—who else; *arhati*—is able to do it; *iha*—in this world; *yaù*—one who; *pärthiväni*—the atoms; *api*—also; *kaviù*—great scientist; *vimame*—might have counted; *rajäàsi*—particles; *caskambha*—could catch; *yaù*—one who; *sva-rahäsä*—by His own leg; *askhalatä*—without being hampered; *tri-pãñöham*—the topmost planetary space; *yasmät*—by which; *tri-sämya*—the neutral state of the three modes; *sadanät*—up to that place; *uru-kampayänam*—moving very greatly.

TRANSLATION

Who can describe completely the prowess of Viṣṇu? Even the scientist, who might have counted the particles of the atoms of the universe, cannot do so. Because it is He only who in His form of Trivikrama moved His leg effortlessly beyond the topmost planet, Satyaloka, up to the neutral state of the three modes of material nature. And all were moved.

PURPORT

The highest scientific advancement of the material scientists is atomic energy. But the material scientist is not able to have an estimation of the particles of atoms contained in the whole universe. But even if one is able to count such atomic particles or is able to roll up the sky like one's bedding, even then one is unable to estimate the extent of the prowess and energy of the Supreme Lord. He is known as Trivikrama because once, in His incarnation of Vāmana, He expanded His leg beyond the highest planetary system, Satyaloka, and reached the neutral state of the modes of nature called the covering of the material world. There are seven layers of material coverings over the material sky, and the Lord could penetrate even those coverings. With His toe He made a hole through which the water of the Causal Ocean filters into the material sky, and the current is known as the sacred Ganges, which purifies the planets of the three worlds. In other words, no one is equal to the transcendently powerful Viṣṇu. He is omnipotent, and no one is equal to or greater than Him.

TEXT 41

NaaNTa& ivdaMYahMaMaq MauNaYaae_Ga]JaaSTae
MaaYaabl/SYa PauâzSYa ku-Taae_vra Yae)
GaaYaNa(Gau<aaNa(dXaXaTaaNaNa Aaiddev"
Xaezae_DauNaaiPa SaMavSYaiTa NaaSYa PaarMa()) 41))

nāntaà vidāmy aham amé munayo 'gra-jās te

māyā-balasya puruṣasya kuto 'varā ye

gāyan guëän daça-çatānana ädi-devaù

çeño 'dhunäpi samavasyati nāsya päram

SYNONYMS

na—never; *antam*—end; *vidāmi*—do I know; *aham*—myself; *amé*—and all those; *munayaù*—great sages; *agra-jäù*—born prior to you; *te*—you; *māyā-balasya*—of the omnipotent; *puruṣasya*—of the Personality of Godhead; *kutaù*—what to speak of others; *avaräù*—born after us; *ye*—those; *gāyan*—by singing; *guëän*—the qualities; *daça-çata-änanaù*—one who has ten hundred faces; *ädi-devaù*—the first incarnation of the Lord; *çeñaù*—known as Çeña; *adhunä*—until now; *api*—even; *samavasyati*—can achieve; *na*—not; *asya*—of Him; *päram*—limit.

TRANSLATION

Neither I nor all the sages born before you know fully the omnipotent Personality of Godhead. So what can others, who are born after us, know about Him? Even the first incarnation of the Lord, namely Çeña, has not been able to reach the limit of such knowledge, although He is describing the qualities of the Lord with ten hundred faces.

PURPORT

The omnipotent Personality of Godhead has primarily three potential manifestations, namely internal, external, and marginal potencies, with unlimited expansions of these three energies. As such, the potential

expansions can never be calculated by anyone because even the Personality of God Himself, as the incarnation of Çeña, cannot estimate the potencies, although He has been describing them continuously with His one thousand faces.

TEXT 42

**Yaeza& Sa Wz >aGavaNa(dYaYaedNaNTa"
SavaRTMaNaaié[TaPadae Yaid iNaVYaRI/Ik-Ma()
Tae duSTaraMaiTaTariNTa c devMaaYaa&
NaEza& MaMaahiMaiTa Daq" `ié*Gaal/>a+Yae)) 42))**

yeñää sa eña bhagavän dayayed anantaù

sarvätmanäçrita-pado yadi nirvyalékam

te dustaräm atitaranti ca deva-mäyää

naiñää mamäham iti dhéù çva-çågäla-bhakñye

SYNONYMS

yeñäm—unto those only; *saù*—the Lord; *eñaù*—the; *bhagavän*—the Personality of Godhead; *dayayet*—does bestow His mercy; *anantaù*—the unlimited potential; *sarva-ätmanä*—by all means, without reservation; *äçrita-padaù*—surrendered soul; *yadi*—if such surrender; *nirvyalékam*—without pretension; *te*—those only; *dustaräm*—insurmountable; *atitaranti*—can overcome; *ca*—and the paraphernalia; *deva-mäyäm*—diverse energies of the Lord; *na*—not; *eñäm*—of them; *mama*—mine; *aham*—myself; *iti*—thus; *dhéù*—conscious; *çva*—dogs; *çågäla*—jackals; *bhakñye*—in the matter of eating.

TRANSLATION

But anyone who is specifically favored by the Supreme Lord, the Personality of Godhead, due to unalloyed surrender unto the service of the Lord, can overcome the insurmountable ocean of illusion and can

understand the Lord. But those who are attached to this body, which is meant to be eaten at the end by dogs and jackals, cannot do so.

PURPORT

The unalloyed devotees of the Lord know the glories of the Lord in the sense that they can understand how great the Lord is and how great is His expansion of diverse energy. Those who are attached to the perishable body can hardly enter into the realm of the science of Godhead. The whole materialistic world, based on the conception of the material body as the self, is ignorant of the science of God. The materialist is always busy working for the welfare of the material body, not only his own but also those of his children, kinsmen, communitymen, countrymen, etc. The materialists have many branches of philanthropic and altruistic activities from a political, national and international angle of vision, but none of the field work can go beyond the jurisdiction of the misconception of identifying the material body with the spirit soul. Unless, therefore, one is saved from the wrong conception of the body and the soul, there is no knowledge of Godhead, and unless there is knowledge of God, all advancement of material civilization, however dazzling, should be considered a failure.

TEXTS 43–45

vedahMa® ParMaSYa ih YaaeGaMaaYaa&
YaUYa& >avê >aGavaNaQa dETYavYaR")
PaÒq MaNaee" Sa c MaNauê TadaTMaJaaê
Pa[acqNabihR%oR>aur® oTa Da]uvê)) 43))
w+vaku-rEl/Maucuku-NdivdehGaaiDa,
rgvMbrqzSaGara GaYaNaahuzaÛa")
MaaNDaa}al/kR-XaTaDaNvNauriNTadeva
devv]Taae bil/rMaUtaRrYaae idl/IPa")) 44))
SaaE>aYauRTa³iXaibdevl/iPaPPal/ad,
SaarSvTaaeÖvParaXar>aUirze<aa")
Yae_NYae iv>aqz<ahNaUMaduPaeNd]dta,
PaaQaaRiîRze<aivduré[uTadevvYaaR")) 45))

vedāham aiga paramasya hi yoga-māyāā
yūyāā bhavaç ca bhagavān atha daitya-varyāū
patné manoū sa ca manuç ca tad-ātmajāç ca
prācēnabarhir ābhur aiga uta dhruvaç ca
ikñvākur aila-mucukunda-videha-gādhi-
raghv-ambarēña-sagarā gaya-nāhuñādyāū
māndhātr-alarka-çatadhanv-anu-rantidevā
devavrato balir amūrttarayo dilēpaū
saubhary-utaika-çibi-devala-pippalāda-
sārasvatoddhava-parāçara-bhūriñēēāū
ye 'nye vibhéñaēā-hanūmad-upendradatta-
pārthārñōiñēēā-vidura-çrutadeva-varyāū

SYNONYMS

veda—know it; *aham*—myself; *aiga*—O Nārada; *paramasya*—of the Supreme; *hi*—certainly; *yoga-māyām*—potency; *yūyam*—yourself; *bhavaū*—Siva; *ca*—and; *bhagavān*—the great demigod; *atha*—as also; *daitya-varyāū*—Prahāda Maharaja, the great devotee of the Lord born in the family of an atheist; *patné*—Çatarūpā; *manoū*—of Manu; *saū*—he; *ca*—also; *manuū*—Svayambhuva; *ca*—and; *tat-ātma-jāū ca*—and his children like Priyavrata, Uttānapāda, Devahūti, etc.; *prācēnabarhiū*—Prācēnabarhi; *ābhuū*—Ābhu; *aigaū*—Aiga; *uta*—even; *dhruvaū*—Dhruva; *ca*—and; *ikñvākuū*—Ikñvāku; *aila*—Aila; *mucukunda*—Mucukunda; *videha*—Maharaja Janaka; *gādhi*—Gādhi; *raghu*—Raghu; *ambarēña*—Ambarēña; *sagarāū*—Sagara; *gaya*—Gaya; *nāhuña*—Nāhuña; *ādyāū*—and so on;

māndhātā—Māndhātā; *alarka*—Alarka; *ṣatadhanu*—Ṣatadhanu; *anu*—Anu; *rantidevāu*—Rantideva; *devavratau*—Bhéñma; *baliu*—Bali; *amūrttarayaū*—Amūrttaraya; *dilépaū*—Dilépa; *saubhari*—Saubhari; *utaika*—Utaika; *ṣibi*—Ṣibi; *devala*—Devala; *pippalāda*—Pippalāda; *sārasvata*—Sārasvata; *uddhava*—Uddhava; *parāṣara*—Parāṣara; *bhūriñēēāu*—Bhūriñēēā; *ye*—those who; *anye*—others; *vibhéñāēā*—Vibhéñāēā; *hanumat*—Hanumān; *upendra-datta*—Sukadeva Gosvami; *pārtha*—Arjuna; *ārñōiñēēā*—Arñōiñēēā; *vidura*—Vidura; *ṣrutadeva*—Ṣrutadeva; *varyāu*—the foremost.

TRANSLATION

O Nārada, although the potencies of the Lord are unknowable and immeasurable, still, because we are all surrendered souls, we know how He acts through yogamāyā potencies. And, similarly, the potencies of the Lord are also known to the all-powerful Siva, the great king of the atheist family, namely Prahlāda Maharaja, Svayambhuva Manu, his wife Ṣatarüpā, his sons and daughters like Priyavrata, Uttānapāda, Ākūti, Devahūti and Prasūti, Prācēnabarhi, Ābhu, Aiga the father of Vena, Maharaja Dhruva, Ikñvāku, Aila, Mucukunda, Maharaja Janaka, Gādhi, Raghu, Ambarēña, Sagara, Gaya, Nāhuña, Māndhātā, Alarka, Ṣatadhanve, Anu, Rantideva, Bhéñma, Bali, Amūrttaraya, Dilépa, Saubhari, Utaika, Ṣibi, Devala, Pippalāda, Sārasvata, Uddhava, Parāṣara, Bhūriñēēā, Vibhéñāēā, Hanumān, Sukadeva Gosvami, Arjuna, Ārñōiñēēā, Vidura, Ṣrutadeva, etc.

PURPORT

All the great devotees of the Lord, as mentioned above, who flourished in the past or present, and all the devotees of the Lord who will come in the future, are aware of the different potencies of the Lord along with the potency of His name, quality, pastimes, entourage, personality, etc. And how do they know? Certainly it is not by mental speculation, nor by any attempt by dint of limited instruments of knowledge. By the limited instruments of knowledge (either the senses or the material instruments like microscopes and telescopes) one cannot even fully know the Lord's material potencies, which are manifested before our eyes. For example there are many millions and billions of planets far, far beyond the scientist's

calculation. But these are only the manifestations of the Lord’s material energy. What can the scientist hope to know of the spiritual potency of the Lord by such material efforts? Mental speculations, by adding some dozens of “if’s” and “maybe’s,” cannot aid the advancement of knowledge—on the contrary, such mental speculations will only end in despair by dismissing the case abruptly and declaring the nonexistence of God. The sane person, therefore, ceases to speculate on subjects beyond the jurisdiction of his tiny brain, and as a matter of course he tries to learn to surrender unto the Supreme Lord, who alone can lead one to the platform of real knowledge. In the *Upaniñads* it is clearly said that the Supreme Personality of Godhead can never be known simply by working very hard and taxing the good brain, nor can He be known simply by mental speculation and jugglery of words. The Lord is knowable only by one who is a surrendered soul. Herein Brahmäjé, the greatest of all material living beings, acknowledges this truth. Therefore, the fruitless spoiling of energy by pursuing the path of experimental knowledge must be given up. One should gain knowledge by surrendering unto the Lord and by acknowledging the authority of the persons mentioned herein. The Lord is unlimited and, by the grace of the *yogamäyā*, helps the surrendered soul to know Him proportionately with the advance of one’s surrender.

TEXT 46

**Tae vE ivdNTYaiTaTariNTa c devMaaYaa&
ñqéUd]hU<aXabra AiPa PaaPaJaqva")
YaÛd(>auTaš-MaParaYa<aXaql/iXa+aa,
iSTaYaRGJaNaa AiPa ik-Mau é[uTaDaar<aa Yae)) 46))**

te vai vidanty atitaranti ca deva-mäyää

stré-çüdra-hüëa-çabarä api päpa-jéväù

yady adbhuta-krama-paräyaëa-çéla-çikñäs

tiryag-janä api kim u çruta-dhäraëä ye

SYNONYMS

te—such persons; *vai*—undoubtedly; *vidanti*—do know; *atitaranti*—surpass; *ca*—also; *deva-mäyäm*—the covering energy of the Lord; *stré*—such as women; *çüdra*—the laborer class of men; *hüëa*—the mountaineers; *çabaräù*—the Siberians, or those lower than the *sudras*; *api*—although; *päpa-jéväù*—sinful living beings; *yadi*—provided; *adbhuta-krama*—one whose acts are so wonderful; *paräyaëa*—those who are devotees; *çéla*—behavior; *çikñäù*—trained by; *tiryak-janäù*—even those who are not human beings; *api*—also; *kim*—what; *u*—to speak of; *çruta-dhäraëäù*—those who have taken to the idea of the Lord by hearing about Him; *ye*—those.

TRANSLATION

Surrendered souls, even from groups leading sinful lives, such as women, the laborer class, the mountaineers and the Siberians, or even the birds and beasts, can also know about the science of Godhead and become liberated from the clutches of the illusory energy by surrendering unto the pure devotees of the Lord and by following in their footsteps in devotional service.

PURPORT

Sometimes there are inquiries as to how one can surrender unto the Supreme Lord. In the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (18.66) the Lord asked Arjuna to surrender unto Him, and therefore persons unwilling to do so question where God is and to whom they should surrender. The answer to such questions or inquiries is given herein very properly. The Personality of Godhead may not be present before one's eyes, but if one is sincere in wanting such guidance the Lord will send a bona fide person who can guide one properly back home, back to Godhead. There is no need of material qualifications for making progress on the path of spiritual realization. In the material world, when one accepts some particular type of service, he is required to possess some particular type of qualification also. Without this one is unfit for such service. But in the devotional service of the Lord the only qualification required is surrender. Surrendering oneself is in one's own hand. If one likes, he can surrender immediately, without delay, and that begins his spiritual life. The bona fide representative of God is as good as God Himself. Or, in other words, the loving representative of the Lord is

more kind and more easy to approach. A sinful soul cannot approach the Lord directly, but such a sinful man can very easily approach a pure devotee of the Lord. And if one agrees to put himself under the guidance of such a devotee of the Lord, he can also understand the science of God and can also become like the transcendental pure devotee of the Lord and thus get his liberation back to Godhead, back home for eternal happiness.

So realization of the science of Godhead and relief from the unnecessary, useless struggle for existence are not at all difficult for the willing candidate. But they are very difficult for persons who are not surrendered souls but only simple, profitless speculators.

TEXT 47

XaiTa(Pa[XaaNTaMa>aYa& Pa[iTabaeDaMaa}a&
 éuÖ& SaMa& SadSaTa" ParMaaTMaTatvMa()
 XaBdae Na Ya}a Pauåk-ark-vaNa(iṣ-YaaQaaeR
 MaaYaa ParETYai>aMau%e c ivl/ÂMaaNaa)
 Tad(vE Pad& >aGavTa" ParMaSYa Pau&Saae
 b]øeiTa Yad(ivdurJaóSau%& ivXaaek-Ma()) 47))

çaçvat praçäntam abhayaà pratibodha-mätraà

çuddhaà samaà sad-asataù paramätma-tattvam

çabdo na yatra puru-kärakavän kriyärtho

mäyā paraity abhimukhe ca vilajjamänä

tad vai padaà bhagavataù paramasya puàso

brahmeti yad vidur ajasra-sukhaà viçokam

SYNONYMS

çaçvat—eternal; *praçäntam*—without disturbance; *abhayam*—without fear; *pratibodha-mätram*—a consciousness opposed to the material

counterpart; *çuddham*—uncontaminated; *samam*—without distinction; *sat-asatau*—of the cause and effect; *paramätma-tattvam*—the principle of primeval cause; *çabdau*—speculative sound; *na*—not; *yatra*—where there is; *puru-kärakavän*—resulting in fruitive action; *kriyä-arthau*—for the matter of sacrifice; *mäyā*—illusion; *paraiti*—flies away; *abhimukhe*—in front of; *ca*—also; *vilajjamänā*—being ashamed of; *tat*—that; *vai*—is certainly; *padam*—ultimate phase; *bhagavatau*—of the Personality of Godhead; *paramasya*—of the Supreme; *puäsaü*—of the person; *brahma*—the Absolute; *iti*—thus; *yat*—which; *viduü*—known as; *ajasra*—unlimited; *sukham*—happiness; *viçokam*—without grief.

TRANSLATION

What is realized as the Absolute Brahman is full of unlimited bliss without grief. That is certainly the ultimate phase of the supreme enjoyer, the Personality of Godhead. He is eternally void of all disturbances and fearless. He is complete consciousness as opposed to matter. Uncontaminated and without distinctions, He is the principle primeval cause of all causes and effects, in whom there is no sacrifice for fruitive activities and in whom the illusory energy does not stand.

PURPORT

The supreme enjoyer, the Personality of Godhead, is the Supreme Brahman or the *summum bonum* because of His being the supreme cause of all causes. The conception of impersonal Brahman realization is the first step, due to His distinction from the illusory conception of material existence. In other words, impersonal Brahman is a feature of the Absolute distinct from the material variegatedness, just as light is a conception distinct from its counterpart, darkness. But the light has its variegatedness, which is seen by those who further advance in the light, and thus the ultimate realization of Brahman is the source of the Brahman light, the Supreme Personality of Godhead, the *summum bonum* or the ultimate source of everything. Therefore, meeting the Personality of Godhead includes the realization of the impersonal Brahman as realized at first in contrast with material inebriety. The Personality of Godhead is the third step of Brahman realization. As explained in the First Canto, one must understand all three

features of the Absolute—Brahman, Paramātmā and Bhagavān.

Pratibodha-mātram is just the opposite conception of material existence. In matter there are material miseries, and thus in the first realization of Brahman there is the negation of such material inebrieties, and there is a feeling of eternal existence distinct from the pangs of birth and death, disease and old age. That is the primary conception of impersonal Brahman.

The Supreme Lord is the Supreme Soul of everything, and therefore in the supreme conception affection is realized. The conception of affection is due to the relationship of soul to soul. A father is affectionate to his son because there is some relationship of nearness between the son and the father. But that sort of affection in the material world is full of inebriety. When the Personality of Godhead is met, the fullness of affection becomes manifested because of the reality of the affectionate relationship. He is not the object of affection by material tinges of body and mind, but He is the full, naked, uncontaminated object of affection for all living entities because He is the Supersoul, or Paramātmā, within everyone's heart. In the liberated state of affairs, the full-fledged affection for the Lord is awakened.

As such, there is an unlimited flow of everlasting happiness, without the fear of its being broken as we have experienced here in the material world. The relationship with the Lord is never broken; thus there is no grief and no fear. Such happiness is inexplicable by words, and there can be no attempt to generate such happiness by fruitive activities by arrangements and sacrifices. But we must also know that happiness, unbroken happiness exchanged with the Supreme Person, the Personality of Godhead as described in this verse, transcends the impersonal conception of the *Upaniñads*. In the *Upaniñads* the description is more or less negation of the material conception of things, but this is not denial of the transcendental senses of the Supreme Lord. Herein also the same is affirmed in the statements about the material elements; they are all transcendental, free from all contamination of material identification. And also the liberated souls are not devoid of senses; otherwise there cannot be any reciprocation of unhampered spiritual happiness exchanged between them in spontaneous unbroken joy. All the senses, both of the Lord and of the

devotees, are without material contamination. They are so because they are beyond the material cause and effects, as clearly mentioned herein (*sad-asataù param*). The illusory, material energy cannot work there, being ashamed before the Lord and His transcendental devotees. In the material world the sense activities are not without grief, but here it is clearly said that the senses of the Lord and the devotees are without any grief. There is a distinct difference between the material and spiritual senses. And one should understand it without denying the spiritual senses because of a material conception.

The senses in the material world are surcharged with material ignorance. In every way, the authorities have recommended purification of the senses from the material conception. In the material world the senses are manipulated for individual and personal satisfaction, whereas in the spiritual world the senses are properly used for the purpose for which they were originally meant, namely the satisfaction of the Supreme Lord. Such sensual activities are natural, and therefore sense gratification there is uninterrupted and unbroken by material contamination because the senses are spiritually purified. And such satisfaction of the senses is equally shared by the transcendental reciprocators. Since the activities are unlimited and constantly increasing, there is no scope for material attempts or artificial arrangements. Such happiness of transcendental quality is called *brahma-saukhyam*, which will be clearly described in the Fifth Canto.

TEXT 48

**SaDY]ax(iNaYaMYa YaTaYaae YaMak-TaRheiTa&)
Jaùu" Svrai@v iNaPaaNa%iNa}aiMaNd]")) 48))**

sadhryai niyamyaya yatayo yama-karta-hetià

jahyuù svaräò iva nipäna-khanitram indraù

SYNONYMS

sadhryak—artificial mental speculation or meditation; *niyamyaya*—controlling; *yatayaù*—the mystics; *yama-karta-hetim*—the process of

spiritual culture; *jahyuù*—are given up; *svaräö*—fully independent; *iva*—as; *nipäna*—well; *khanitram*—trouble for digging; *indraù*—the controlling demigod supplying rains.

TRANSLATION

In such a transcendental state there is no need of artificial control of the mind, mental speculation or meditation, as performed by the jnanis and yogis. One gives up such processes, as the heavenly King, Indra, forgoes the trouble to dig a well.

PURPORT

A poor man in want of water digs a well and undertakes the trouble of digging. Similarly, those who are poor in transcendental realization speculate on the mind or meditate by controlling the senses. But they do not know that such control of the senses and achievement of spiritual perfection are simultaneously made possible as soon as one is factually engaged in the transcendental loving service of the Supreme Person, the Personality of Godhead. It is for this reason that the great liberated souls also desire to be associated in hearing and chanting the activities of the Lord. The example of Indra is very appropriate in this connection. King Indra of heaven is the controlling deity or demigod for arranging clouds and supplying rains in the universe, and as such he does not have to take the trouble to dig a well for his personal water supply. For him, digging a well for a water supply is simply ludicrous. Similarly, those who are factually engaged in the loving service of the Lord have attained the ultimate goal of life, and for them there is no need of mental speculation to find out the true nature of God or His activities. Nor do such devotees have to meditate upon the imaginary or real identity of the Lord. Because they are factually engaged in the transcendental loving service of the Lord, the Lord's pure devotees have already achieved the results of mental speculation and meditation. The real perfection of life is therefore to be engaged in the transcendental loving service of the Lord.

TEXT 49

Sa é[eYaSaaMaiPa iv>au>aRGavaNa(YaTaae_SYa
>aavSv>aavivihTaSYa SaTa" Pa[iSaiÖ")
dehe SvDaaTauivGaMae_NauivXaqYaRMaa<ae
VYaaeMaev Ta}a Pauåzae Na ivXaqYaRTae_Ja")) 49))

sa çreyasäm api vibhur bhagavän yato 'sya

bhäva-svabhäva-vihitasya sataù prasiddhiù

dehe sva-dhätu-vigame 'nuviçéryamäëe

vyomeva tatra puruño na viçéryate 'jaù

SYNONYMS

saù—He; *çreyasäm*—all auspiciousness; *api*—also; *vibhuù*—the master; *bhagavän*—the Personality of Godhead; *yataù*—because; *asya*—of the living entity; *bhäva*—natural modes; *sva-bhäva*—own constitution; *vihitasya*—performances; *sataù*—all good work; *prasiddhiù*—ultimate success; *dehe*—of the body; *sva-dhätu*—forming elements; *vigame*—being vanquished; *anu*—after; *viçéryamäëe*—having given up; *vyoma*—sky; *iva*—like; *tatra*—thereupon; *puruñaù*—the living entity; *na*—never; *viçéryate*—becomes vanquished; *ajaù*—due to being unborn.

TRANSLATION

The Personality of Godhead is the supreme master of everything auspicious because the results of whatever actions are performed by the living being, in either the material or spiritual existence, are awarded by the Lord. As such, He is the ultimate benefactor. Every individual living entity is unborn, and therefore even after the annihilation of the material elementary body, the living entity exists, exactly like the air within the body.

PURPORT

The living entity is unborn and eternal, and as confirmed in the ***Bhagavad-***

gita (2.30), the living entity is not exhausted even though the material elementary body is vanquished. As long as the living entity is in material existence, actions performed by him are rewarded in the next life, or even in the present life. Similarly, in his spiritual life also actions are rewarded by the Lord by the five kinds of liberation. Even the impersonalist cannot achieve the desired merging into the existence of the Supreme without being favored by the Supreme Personality of Godhead. It is confirmed in the **Bhagavad-gita** (4.11) that the Lord awards similar results, as one desires, in one's present life. The living entities are given freedom to make their choice, and the Lord awards them accordingly.

It is the duty of everyone, therefore, to worship devoutly only the Personality of Godhead to achieve his desired goal. The impersonalist, instead of speculating or meditating, can directly execute the routine devotional service of the Lord and thus easily obtain the desired goal.

The devotees, however, are naturally inclined to become associates of the Lord and not merge in the spiritual existence, as conceived by the impersonalist. The devotees, therefore, following their constitutional instincts, achieve the desired goal of becoming servitors, friends, fathers, mothers or conjugal lovers of the Lord. The devotional service of the Lord involves nine transcendental processes, such as hearing and chanting, and by performing such easy and natural devotional services the devotees achieve the highest perfectional results, far, far superior to merging into the existence of Brahman. The devotees are therefore never advised to indulge in speculating upon the nature of the Supreme or artificially meditating on the void.

One should not, however, mistakenly think that after the annihilation of this present body there is no body by which one can associate with the Lord face to face. The living entity is unborn. It is not that he is manifest with the creation of the material body. On the other hand, it is true that the material body develops only by the desire of the living entity. The evolution of the material body is due to the desires of the living being. According to the desires of the living being, the material body develops. So from the spirit soul the material body comes into existence, generated from the living force. Since the living being is eternal, he exists just like the air within the

body. Air is within and without the body. Therefore when the external covering, the material body, is vanquished, the living spark, like the air within the body, continues to exist. And by the direction of the Lord, because He is the ultimate benefactor, the living entity is at once awarded the necessary spiritual body befitting his association with the Lord in the manner of *sārūpya* (equal bodily feature), *sālokya* (equal facility to live on the same planet with the Lord), *sārñōi* (equal possession of opulence like the Lord), and *sāmépya* (equal association with the Lord).

The Lord is so kind that even if a devotee of the Lord cannot fulfill the complete course of devotional service unalloyed and uncontaminated by material association, he is given another chance in the next life by being awarded a birth in the family of a devotee or rich man so that without being engaged in the struggle for material existence the devotee can finish the remaining purification of his existence and thus immediately, after relinquishing the present body, go back home, back to Godhead. This is confirmed in the *Bhagavad-gita*.

In this connection detailed information is available in the *Bhagavat-sandarbha* of Srila Jiva Gosvami Prabhupāda. Once achieving the spiritual existence, the devotee is eternally situated there, as already discussed in the previous verse.

TEXT 50

Saae_Ya& Tae_i>aihTaSTaaTa >aGavaNa(ivi>aavNa")
SaMaaSaeNa hreNaaRNYadNYaSMaaTa(SadSaÀ YaTa()) 50))

so 'yaà te 'bhihitas tātā

bhagavān viçva-bhāvanaù

samāsena harer nānyad

anyasmāt sad-asac ca yat

SYNONYMS

saù—that; *ayam*—the same; *te*—unto you; *abhihitaù*—explained by me; *täta*—my dear son; *bhagavän*—the Personality of Godhead; *viçva-bhävanaù*—the creator of the manifested worlds; *samäsenä*—in brief; *hareù*—without Hari, the Lord; *nä*—never; *anyat*—anything else; *anyasmät*—being the cause of; *sat*—manifested or phenomenal; *asat*—noumenal; *ca*—and; *yat*—whatever there may be.

TRANSLATION

My dear son, I have now explained in brief the Supreme Personality of Godhead, who is creator of the manifested worlds. Without Him, Hari, the Lord, there are no other causes of the phenomenal and noumenal existences.

PURPORT

Since we generally have the experience of the temporary, material world and conditioned souls trying to lord it over the material worlds, Brahmäjé explained to Nārādadeva that this temporary world is the work of the external potency of the Lord and that the conditioned souls struggling here for existence are the marginal potency of the Supreme Lord, the Personality of Godhead. There is no cause for all these phenomenal activities but Him, Hari, the Supreme Lord, who is the primeval cause of all causes. This does not mean, however, that the Lord Himself is distributed impersonally. He is aloof from all these interactions of the external and marginal potencies. In the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (9.4) it is confirmed that by His potencies alone He is present everywhere and anywhere. Everything that is manifested rests on His potency only, but He, as the Supreme Personality of Godhead, is always aloof from everything. The potency and the potent are simultaneously one and different from one another.

One should not deprecate the Supreme Lord for the creation of this miserable world, just as one should not blame the king for creating a prisonhouse in the government. The prisonhouse is a necessary institution of the governmental establishment for those who are disobedient to the laws of the government. Similarly, this material world, full of miseries, is a temporary creation of the Lord for those who have forgotten Him and are

trying to lord it over the false manifestation. He, however, is always anxious to get the fallen souls back home, back to Godhead, and for this He has given so many chances to the conditioned souls via the authoritative scriptures, His representatives, and personal incarnations also. Since He has no direct attachment to this material world, He is not to be blamed for its creation.

TEXT 51

wd& >aaGavTa& NaaMa YaNMae >aGavTaaeidTaMa()
Sa°hae_Ya& iv>aUTaqNaa& TvMaeTad(ivPaul/Iku-å)) 51))

idaà bhāgavataà nāma

yan me bhagavatoditam

saìgraho 'yaà vibhüténää

tvam etad vipulé kuru

SYNONYMS

idam—this; *bhāgavatam*—the science of Godhead; *nāma*—of the name; *yat*—that which; *me*—unto me; *bhagavatā*—by the Personality of Godhead; *uditam*—enlightened; *saìgrahaù*—is the accumulation of; *ayam*—His; *vibhüténām*—of the diverse potencies; *tvam*—your good self; *etat*—this science of Godhead; *vipulé*—expand; *kuru*—do it.

TRANSLATION

O Nārada, this science of God, Srimad-Bhagavatam, was spoken to me in summary by the Supreme Personality of Godhead, and it was spoken as the accumulation of His diverse potencies. Please expand this science yourself.

PURPORT

The *Bhāgavatam* in a nutshell, spoken by the Personality of Godhead in about half a dozen verses, which will appear ahead, is the science of God, and it is the potent representation of the Personality of Godhead. He, being absolute, is nondifferent from the science of God, *Srimad-Bhagavatam*. Brahmājé received this science of Godhead from the Lord directly, and he handed over the same to Nārada, who in his turn ordered Srila Vyāsadeva to expand it. So the transcendental knowledge of the Supreme Lord is not mental speculation by the mundane wranglers, but is uncontaminated, eternal, perfect knowledge beyond the jurisdiction of material modes. The *Bhāgavata Purana* is therefore the direct incarnation of the Lord in the form of transcendental sound, and one should receive this transcendental knowledge from the bona fide representative of the Lord in the chain of disciplic succession from the Lord to Brahmājé, from Brahmājé to Nārada, from Nārada to Vyāsa, from Vyāsadeva to Sukadeva Gosvami, from Sukadeva Gosvami to Sūta Gosvami. The ripened fruit of the Vedic tree drops from one hand to another without being broken by falling suddenly from a high branch down to the earth. Therefore unless one hears the science of Godhead from the bona fide representative of the disciplic succession, as above mentioned, for one to understand the theme of the science of Godhead will be a difficult job. It should never be heard from the professional *Bhāgavatam* reciters who earn their livelihood by gratifying the senses of the audience.

TEXT 52

YaQaa hraE >aGaviTa Na*<aa& >aiÇ->aRivZYaiTa)
SavaRTMaNYai%/aDaare wiTa Sa³LPYa v<aRYa)) 52))

yathā harau bhagavati

nāëää bhaktir bhaviñyati

sarvātmany akhilādhāre

iti saikalpya varēaya

SYNONYMS

yathā—as much as; *harau*—unto the Personality of Godhead; *bhagavati*—unto the Lord; *nāëäm*—for human beings; *bhaktiù*—devotional service; *bhaviñyati*—become enlightened; *sarva-ätmani*—the Absolute Whole; *akhila-ädhäre*—unto the *summum bonum*; *iti*—thus; *saikalpya*—by determination; *varëaya*—describe.

TRANSLATION

Please describe the science of Godhead with determination and in a manner by which it will be quite possible for the human being to develop transcendental devotional service unto the Personality of Godhead Hari, the Supersoul of every living being and the summum bonum source of all energies.

PURPORT

Srimad-Bhagavatam is the philosophy of devotional service and the scientific presentation of man's relationship with the Supreme Personality of Godhead. Prior to the age of Kali there was no need for such a book of knowledge to know the Lord and His potential energies, but with the beginning of the age of Kali human society gradually became influenced by four sinful principles, namely illegitimate connection with women, intoxication, gambling and unnecessary killing of animals. Because of these basic sinful acts, man gradually became forgetful of his eternal relation with God. Therefore man became blind, so to speak, to his ultimate goal of life. The ultimate goal of life is not to pass a life of irresponsibility like the animals and indulge in a polished way in the four animal principles, namely eating, sleeping, fearing and mating. For such a blind human society in the darkness of ignorance, *Srimad-Bhagavatam* is the torchlight to see things in proper perspective. Therefore it was necessary to describe the science of God from the very beginning, or from the very birth of the phenomenal world.

As we have already explained, *Srimad-Bhagavatam* is so scientifically presented that any sincere student of this great science will be able to understand the science of God simply by reading it with attention or simply by regularly hearing it from the bona fide speaker. Everyone is hankering

after happiness in life, but in this age the members of human society, blind as they are, do not have the proper vision that the Personality of Godhead is the reservoir of all happiness because He is the ultimate source of everything (*janmādy asya yataù* [SB 1.1.1]). Happiness in complete perfection without hindrance can be achieved only by our devotional relationship with Him. And it is only by His association that we can get free of distressful material existence. Even those who are after the enjoyment of this material world can also take shelter of the great science of *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, and they will be successful at the end. Nārada is therefore requested or ordered by his spiritual master to present this science with determination and in good plan. Nārada was never advised to preach the principles of *Bhāgavatam* to earn a livelihood; he was ordered by his spiritual master to take the matter very seriously in a missionary spirit.

TEXT 53

MaaYaa& v<aRYaTaae_MauZYa wRirSYaaNauMaaedTa")
é*<vTa" é[ÖYaa iNaTYa& MaaYaYaaTMaa Na MauùiTaa)) 53))

mäyää varēayato ’muñya

éçvarasyānumodataù

çāēvataù çraddhayā nityā

māyayātmā na muhyati

SYNONYMS

mäyām—affairs of the external energy; *varēayataù*—while describing; *amuñya*—of the Lord; *éçvarasya*—of the Personality of Godhead; *anumodataù*—thus appreciating; *çāēvataù*—thus hearing; *çraddhayā*—with devotion; *nityam*—regularly; *māyayā*—by the illusory energy; *ātmā*—the living entity; *na*—never; *muhyati*—becomes illusioned.

TRANSLATION

The Lord's activities in association with His different energies should be described, appreciated and heard in accordance with the teachings of the Supreme Lord. If this is done regularly with devotion and respect, one is sure to get out of the illusory energy of the Lord.

PURPORT

The science of learning a subject matter seriously is different from the sentiments of fanatics. Fanatics or fools may consider the Lord's activities in relation with the external energy to be useless for them, and they may falsely claim to be higher participants in the internal energy of the Lord, but factually the Lord's activities in relation with the external energy and the internal energy are equally good. On the other hand, those who are not completely free from the clutches of the Lord's external energy should devoutly hear regularly about the activities of the Lord in relation with the external energy. They should not foolishly jump up to the activities of the internal energy, falsely attracted by the Lord's internal potential activities like His *rāsa-līla*. The cheap reciters of the *Bhāgavatam* are very much enthusiastic about the Lord's internal potential activities, and the pseudodevotees, absorbed in material sense enjoyment, falsely jump to the stage of liberated souls and thus fall down deeply into the clutches of external energy.

Some of them think that to hear about the pastimes of the Lord means to hear about His activities with the *gopés* or about His pastimes like lifting the Govardhana Hill, and they have nothing to do with the Lord's plenary expansions as the *puruṇāvatāras* and Their pastimes of the creation, maintenance or annihilation of the material worlds. But a pure devotee knows that there is no difference between the pastimes of the Lord, either in *rāsa-līla* or in creation, maintenance or destruction of the material world. Rather, the descriptions of such activities of the Lord as the *puruṇāvatāras* are specifically meant for persons who are in the clutches of the external energy. Topics like the *rāsa-līla* are meant for the liberated souls and not for the conditioned souls. The conditioned souls, therefore, must hear with appreciation and devotion the Lord's pastimes in relationship with the external energy, and such acts are as good as the hearing of *rāsa-līla* in the liberated stage. A conditioned soul should not imitate the activities of

liberated souls. Lord Sri Caitanya never indulged in hearing the *räsa-léla* with ordinary men.

In the *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, the science of God, the first nine cantos prepare the ground for hearing the Tenth Canto. This will be further explained in the last chapter of this canto. In the Third Canto it will be more explicit. A pure devotee of the Lord, therefore, must begin reading or hearing *Srimad-Bhagavatam* from the very beginning, and not from the Tenth Canto. We have several times been requested by some so-called devotees to take up the Tenth Canto immediately, but we have refrained from such an action because we wish to present *Srimad-Bhagavatam* as the science of Godhead and not as a sensuous understanding for the conditioned souls. This is forbidden by such authorities as Sri Brahmäjé. By reading and hearing *Srimad-Bhagavatam* as a scientific presentation, the conditioned souls will gradually be promoted to the higher status of transcendental knowledge after being freed from the illusory energy based on sense enjoyment.

Thus end the Bhaktivedanta purports of the Second Canto, Seventh Chapter, of the Srimad-Bhagavatam, entitled "Scheduled Incarnations with Specific Functions."

Chapter Eight

Questions by King Pariksit

TEXT 1

raJaaevac

b]ø<aa caeidTaae b]øNa(Gau<aa:YaaNae_Gau<aSYa c)
YaSMaE YaSMaE YaQaa Pa[ah Naardae devdXaRNa")) 1))

räjoväca

brahmaëä codito brahman

guëäakhyäne 'guëasya ca

yasmai yasmai yathä präha

närado deva-darçanaù

SYNONYMS

räjä—the King; *uväca*—inquired; *brahmaëä*—by Lord Brahmä; *coditaù*—being instructed; *brahman*—O learned *brahmana* (Sukadeva Gosvami); *guëa-äakhyäne*—in narrating the transcendental qualities; *aguëasya*—of the Lord, who is without material qualities; *ca*—and; *yasmai yasmai*—and whom; *yathä*—as much as; *präha*—explained; *näradaù*—Närada Muni; *deva-darçanaù*—one whose audience is as good as that of any demigod.

TRANSLATION

King Pariksit inquired from Sukadeva Gosvami: How did Närada Muni, whose hearers are as fortunate as those instructed by Lord Brahmä, explain the transcendental qualities of the Lord, who is without material qualities, and before whom did he speak?

PURPORT

Devarñi Närada was directly instructed by Brahmäjé, who was also directly instructed by the Supreme Lord; therefore the instructions imparted by Närada to his various disciples are as good as those of the Supreme Lord. That is the way of understanding Vedic knowledge. It comes down from the Lord by disciplic succession, and this transcendental knowledge is distributed to the world by this descending process. There is no chance, however, to receive the Vedic knowledge from mental speculators. Therefore, wherever Närada Muni goes, he represents himself as authorized by the Lord, and his appearance is as good as that of the Supreme Lord. Similarly, the disciplic succession which strictly follows the transcendental instruction is the bona fide chain of disciplic succession, and the test for such bona fide spiritual masters is that there should be no difference between the instruction of the Lord originally imparted to His

devotee and that which is imparted by the authority in the line of disciplic succession. How Nārada Muni distributed the transcendental knowledge of the Lord will be explained in later cantos.

It will appear also that the Lord existed prior to the material creation, and therefore His transcendental name, quality, etc., do not represent any material quality. Whenever, therefore, the Lord is described as *aguëa*, or without any quality, it does not mean that He has no quality, but that He has no material quality, such as the modes of goodness, passion or ignorance, as the conditioned souls have. He is transcendental to all material conceptions, and thus He is described as *aguëa*.

TEXT 2

WTad(veidTauimaC^aiMa Tatv& Tatvivda& vr)
hrerd(>auTavqYaRSYa k-Qaa I/aek-SauMa®I/a")) 2))

etat veditum icchämi

tattvaà tattva-vidäà vara

harer adbhuta-véryasya

kathä loka-sumaigaläù

SYNONYMS

etat—this; *veditum*—to understand; *icchämi*—I wish; *tattvam*—truth; *tattva-vidäm*—of those who are well versed in the Absolute Truth; *vara*—O best; *hareù*—of the Lord; *adbhuta-véryasya*—of the one who possesses wonderful potencies; *kathäù*—narrations; *loka*—for all planets; *sumaigaläù*—auspicious.

TRANSLATION

The King said: I wish to know. Narrations concerning the Lord, who possesses wonderful potencies, are certainly auspicious for living beings

in all planets.

PURPORT

Srimad-Bhagavatam, which is full of narrations of the activities of the Supreme Lord, is auspicious for all living beings residing in every planet. One who takes it as belonging to a particular sect is certainly mistaken. *Srimad-Bhagavatam* is certainly a very dear scripture for all the devotees of the Lord, but it is auspicious even for the nondevotees also because it explains that even the nondevotees hovering under the spell of material energy can be delivered from such clutches if they hear the narration of the *Srimad-Bhagavatam* with devotion and attention from the right source representing the Lord by disciplic succession.

TEXT 3

k-QaYaSv Maha>aaGa YaQaahMai%/aTMaiNa)
k*-Z<ae iNaveXYa iNa"Sa® & MaNaSTYa+Yae k-le/vrMa()) 3))

kathayasva mahābhāga

yathāham akhilātmani

kāñḍee niveṣya niṁsaigaṁ

manas tyakñye kalevaram

SYNONYMS

kathayasva—please continue speaking; *mahābhāga*—O greatly fortunate one; *yathā*—as much as; *aham*—I; *akhila-ātmani*—unto the Supreme Soul; *kāñḍee*—unto Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa; *niveṣya*—having placed; *niṁsaigaṁ*—being freed from material qualities; *manaù*—mind; *tyakñye*—may relinquish; *kalevaram*—body.

TRANSLATION

O greatly fortunate Sukadeva Gosvami, please continue narrating *Srimad-Bhagavatam* so that I can place my mind upon the Supreme Soul, Lord Kṛṣṇa, and, being completely freed from material qualities, thus relinquish this body.

PURPORT

To be fully engaged in hearing the transcendental narration described in the text of *Srimad-Bhagavatam* means to constantly associate with the Supreme Soul, Sri Kṛṣṇa. And to constantly associate with the Supreme Lord Kṛṣṇa means to be liberated from the qualities of matter. Lord Kṛṣṇa is like the sun, and material contamination is like darkness. As the presence of the sun dissipates darkness, constant engagement in the association of the Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa frees one from the contamination of the material qualities. Contamination by the material qualities is the cause of repeated birth and death, and liberation from material qualities is transcendence. Maharaja Parikṣit was now a realized soul by this secret of liberation, through the grace of Sukadeva Gosvami, for the latter had informed the King that the highest perfection of life is to be in remembrance of Nārāyaṇa at the end of life. Maharaja Parikṣit was destined to give up his body at the end of seven days, and thus he decided to continue remembering the Lord by His association with the topics of *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, and thus to quit his body in full consciousness of the presence of the Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, the Supreme Soul.

The hearing of *Srimad-Bhagavatam* performed by professional men is different from the transcendental hearing of Maharaja Parikṣit. Maharaja Parikṣit was a soul realized in the Absolute Truth, Sri Kṛṣṇa, the Personality of Godhead. The fruitive materialist is not a realized soul; he wants to derive some material benefit from his so-called hearing of *Srimad-Bhagavatam*. Undoubtedly such an audience, hearing *Srimad-Bhagavatam* from the professional men, can derive some material benefit as they desire, but that does not mean that such a pretense of hearing *Srimad-Bhagavatam* for a week is as good as the hearing of Maharaja Parikṣit.

It is the duty of the sane to hear *Srimad-Bhagavatam* from a self-realized soul and not be duped by professional men. One should continue such

hearing till the end of one's life so that one can actually have the transcendental association of the Lord and thus be liberated simply by hearing *Srimad-Bhagavatam*.

Maharaja Parikṣit had already given up all his connections with his kingdom and family, the most attractive features of materialism, but still he was conscious of his material body. He wanted to be free of such bondage also by the constant association of the Lord.

TEXT 4

é*<vTa" é[ÖYaa iNaTYa& Ga*<aTaê SvceiíTaMa()
k-ale/Na NaaiTadqgaeR<a >aGavaNa(ivXaTae ôid)) 4))

çåëvataù çraddhayä nityaà

gåëataç ca sva-ceññöitam

kälena nätidérgheëa

bhagavän viçate hãdi

SYNONYMS

çåëvataù—of those who hear; *çraddhayä*—in earnestness; *nityam*—regularly, always; *gåëataù*—taking the matter; *ca*—also; *sva-ceññöitam*—seriously by one's own endeavor; *kälena*—duration; *na*—not; *ati-dérgheëa*—very prolonged time; *bhagavän*—the Personality of Godhead Sri Kṛṣṇa; *viçate*—becomes manifest; *hãdi*—within one's heart.

TRANSLATION

Persons who hear Srimad-Bhagavatam regularly and are always taking the matter very seriously will have the Personality of Godhead Sri Kṛṣṇa manifested in their hearts within a short time.

PURPORT

Cheap devotees or materialistic devotees of the Lord are very much desirous to see the Lord personally without meeting the requisite qualifications. Such third-grade devotees should know well that material attachment and seeing the Lord face to face cannot go together. It is not such a mechanical process that the professional *Bhāgavatam* reciters can do the job on behalf of the third-grade materialistic pseudo-devotee. The professional men are useless in this connection because they are neither self-realized nor interested in the liberation of the audience. They are simply interested in maintaining the material establishment of family attachment and earning some material benefits out of the profession. Maharaja Parikṣit had no more than seven days to live, but for others Maharaja Parikṣit personally recommends that one hear *Srīmad-Bhagavatam* regularly, *nityam*, always by one's own effort and with serious devotion also. That will help one to see the Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa manifested in one's heart within no time.

The pseudo-devotee, however, is very anxious to see the Lord according to his whims, not making any serious effort to hear *Srīmad-Bhagavatam* regularly and without detachment from material benefit. That is not the way recommended by an authority like Maharaja Parikṣit, who heard and benefited by hearing *Srīmad-Bhagavatam*.

TEXT 5

Pa[iví" k-<aRrNDa]e<a SvaNaa& >aavSaraeāhMa()
DauNaaeiTa XaMal&/ k*-Z<a" Sail/I/SYa YaQaa XarTa()) 5))

praviññāu karēa-randhreēa

svānāā bhāva-saroruhā

dhunoti çamalaā kññēāu

salilasya yathā çarat

SYNONYMS

praviñöaù—thus being entered; *karëa-randhreëa*—through the holes of the ears; *svänäm*—according to one’s liberated position; *bhäva*—constitutional relationship; *saraù-ruham*—the lotus flower; *dhunoti*—cleanses; *çamalam*—material qualities like lust, anger, avarice and hankering; *kãñëaù*—Lord Kṛṣṇa, the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *salilasya*—of the reservoir of waters; *yathä*—as it were; *çarat*—the autumn season.

TRANSLATION

The sound incarnation of Lord Kṛṣṇa, the Supreme Soul [i.e. Srimad-Bhagavatam], enters into the heart of a self-realized devotee, sits on the lotus flower of his loving relationship, and thus cleanses the dust of material association, such as lust, anger and hankering. Thus it acts like autumnal rains upon pools of muddy water.

PURPORT

It is said that a single pure devotee of the Lord can deliver all the fallen souls of the world. Thus one who is actually in the confidence of a pure devotee like Nārada or Sukadeva Gosvami and thus is empowered by one’s spiritual master, as Nārada was by Brahmäjé, can not only deliver himself from the clutches of *mäyä*, or illusion, but can deliver the whole world by his pure and empowered devotional strength. The comparison to the autumnal rain that falls on muddy reservoirs of water is very appropriate. During the rainy season, all the waters of the rivers become muddy, but in the month of July-August, the autumn season, when there is a slight rainfall, the muddy waters of the rivers all over the world become at once clear. By addition of some chemical, a small reservoir of water like that of a metropolitan waterworks tank can be cleared, but by such a tiny effort it is not possible to clear up all the reservoirs of water like the rivers. A powerful pure devotee of the Lord, however, can deliver not only his personal self but also many others in his association.

In other words, the cleansing of the polluted heart by other methods (like the culture of empiric knowledge or mystic gymnastics) can simply cleanse one’s own heart, but devotional service to the Lord is so powerful that it can cleanse the hearts of the people in general, by the devotional service of

the pure, empowered devotee. A true representative of the Lord like Nārada, Sukadeva Gosvami, Lord Caitanya, the six Gosvamis and later Srila Bhaktivinoda Ōhākura and Srimad Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvaté Ōhākura, etc., can deliver all people by their empowered devotional service.

By sincere efforts to hear *Srimad-Bhagavatam* one realizes his constitutional relationship with the Lord in the transcendental humor of servitude, friendship, paternal affection or conjugal love, and by such self-realization one becomes situated at once in the transcendental loving service of the Lord. Not only were all the pure devotees like Nārada self-realized souls, but they were engaged in preaching work automatically by spiritual impetus, and thus they delivered many poor souls entangled in the material modes. They became so powerful because they sincerely followed the *Bhāgavatam* principles by regular hearing and worshiping. By such actions the accumulated material lusts, etc., become cleansed by the personal endeavor of the Lord within the heart. The Lord is always within the heart of the living being, but He becomes manifested by one's devotional service.

Purification of the heart by culture of knowledge or mystic *yoga* may be all right for the time being for an individual person, but it is like the cleansing of a small quantity of stagnant water by chemical processes. Such clarification of water may stand for the time being and the sediments settle down, but by a slight agitation everything becomes muddy. The idea is that devotional service to the Lord is the only method of cleansing the heart for good. Whereas other methods may be superficially good for the time being, there is a risk of becoming muddy again due to agitation of the mind. Devotional service to the Lord, with specific attention for hearing *Srimad-Bhagavatam* regularly and always, is the best recommended method for liberation from the clutches of illusion.

TEXT 6

**DaaETaaTMaa Pauāz" k*-Z<aPaadMaUI&/ Na MauÄiTa)
Mauç-SavRPair©e-Xa" PaaNQa" SvXar<a& YaQaa)) 6))**

dhautātmā puruṣaù kãñëa-

pāda-mūlaà na muīcati

mukta-sarva-parikleçaù

pānthaù sva-çaraëaà yathä

SYNONYMS

dhauta-ātmä—whose heart has been cleansed; *puruṣaù*—the living being; *kāñëa*—the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *pāda-mūlam*—the shelter of the lotus feet; *na*—never; *muīcati*—gives up; *mukta*—liberated; *sarva*—all; *parikleçaù*—of all miseries of life; *pānthaù*—the traveler; *sva-çaraëam*—in his own abode; *yathä*—as it were.

TRANSLATION

A pure devotee of the Lord whose heart has once been cleansed by the process of devotional service never relinquishes the lotus feet of Lord Kṛṣṇa, for they fully satisfy him, as a traveler is satisfied at home after a troubled journey.

PURPORT

One who is not a pure devotee of the Supreme Lord Kṛṣṇa is not completely cleansed in the heart. But a perfectly cleansed person never quits the devotional service of the Lord. In discharging such devotional service, as ordered by Brahmäjé to Nārada in the preaching of *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, sometimes a representative of the Lord engaged in preaching work meets various so-called difficulties. This was exhibited by Lord Nityānanda when He delivered the two fallen souls Jagäi and Mädhäi, and similarly Lord Jesus Christ was crucified by the nonbelievers. But such difficulties are very gladly suffered by the devotees in preaching because in such activities, although apparently very severe, the devotees of the Lord feel transcendental pleasure because the Lord is satisfied. Prahlāda Maharaja suffered greatly, but still he never forgot the lotus feet of the Lord. This is because a pure devotee of the Lord is so purified in his heart that he cannot leave the shelter of Lord Kṛṣṇa in any circumstances. There is no self-interest in such

service. The progress of culturing knowledge by the *jnanis* or the bodily gymnastics by the *yogis* are ultimately given up by the respective performers, but a devotee of the Lord cannot give up the service of the Lord, for he is ordered by his spiritual master. Pure devotees like Nārada and Nityānanda Prabhu take up the order of the spiritual master as the sustenance of life. They do not mind what becomes of the future of their lives. They take the matter very seriously as the order comes from the higher authority, from the representative of the Lord, or from the Lord Himself.

The example set herein is very appropriate. A traveler leaves home to search for wealth in far distant places, sometimes in the forest and sometimes on the ocean and sometimes on hilltops. Certainly there are many troubles for the traveler when he is in such unknown places. But all such troubles are at once mitigated as soon as the sense of his family affection is remembered, and as soon as he returns home he forgets all such troubles on the way.

A pure devotee of the Lord is exactly in a family tie with the Lord, and therefore he is undeterred in discharging his duty in a full affectionate tie with the Lord.

TEXT 7

YadDaaTauMaTaae b]øNa(deharM>aae_SYa DaaTauia")
Yad*C^Yaa heTauNaa va >avNTaae JaaNaTae YaQaa)) 7))

yad adhātu-mato brahman

dehārambho 'sya dhātubhiù

yadācchayā hetunā vā

bhavanto jānate yathā

SYNONYMS

yat—as it is; *adhātu-mataù*—without being materially constituted;
brahman—O learned *brahmana*; *deha*—the material body; *ärambhaù*—the
beginning of; *asya*—of the living being; *dhätubhiù*—by matter;
yadâcchayä—without cause, accidental; *hetunä*—due to some cause; *vä*—
either; *bhavantaù*—your good self; *jänate*—as you may know it; *yathä*—so
you inform me.

TRANSLATION

O learned brahmana, the transcendental spirit soul is different from the material body. Does he acquire the body accidentally or by some cause? Will you kindly explain this, for it is known to you.

PURPORT

Maharaja Pariksit, being a typical devotee, is not only satisfied by confirming the importance of hearing the *Srimad-Bhagavatam* from the representative of Brahmäjé by disciplic succession, but he is still more anxious to establish the philosophical basis of *Srimad-Bhagavatam*. *Srimad-Bhagavatam* is the science of the Supreme Personality of Godhead, and as such all questions that may arise in the mind of a serious student must be cleared by the statements of the authority. A person on the path of devotional service may inquire from his spiritual master all about the spiritual position of God and the living beings. From the *Bhagavad-gita*, as well as from the *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, it is known that qualitatively the Lord and the living beings are one. The living being in the conditioned state of material existence is subjected to many transmigrations by continuous changing of the material body. But what are the causes of the material embodiment of the part and parcel of the Lord? Maharaja Pariksit inquires about this very important matter for the benefit of all classes of candidates on the path of self-realization and devotional service to the Lord.

Indirectly it is confirmed that the Supreme Being, the Lord, makes no such material changes of body. He is spiritually whole, with no difference between His body and His soul, unlike the conditioned soul. The liberated living beings, who associate with the Lord in person, are also exactly like the Lord. Only the conditioned souls awaiting liberation are subjected to

change of bodies. How was the process first begun?

In the process of devotional service, the first step is to take shelter of the spiritual master and then inquire from the spiritual master all about the process. This inquiry is essential for immunity to all kinds of offenses on the path of devotional service. Even if one is fixed in devotional service like Maharaja Pariksit, he must still inquire from the realized spiritual master all about this. In other words, the spiritual master must also be well versed and learned so that he may be able to answer all these inquiries from the devotees. Thus one who is not well versed in the authorized scriptures and not able to answer all such relevant inquiries should not pose as a spiritual master for the matter of material gain. It is illegal to become a spiritual master if one is unable to deliver the disciple.

TEXT 8

AaSaqd(YadudraTa(PaÚ& l/aek-Sa&SQaaNal/+a<aMa()
YaavaNaYa& vE Pauåz wYataavYavE" Pa*Qak(-)
TaavaNaSaaiviTa Pa[aeç-" Sa&SQaavYavvaiNav)) 8))

äséd yad-udarät padmaà

loka-saàsthäna-lakñäëam

yävän ayaà vai puruṣa

iyattävayavaiù pāthak

tävän asäv iti proktaù

saàsthävayavavän iva

SYNONYMS

äsét—as it grew; *yad-udarät*—from whose abdomen; *padmam*—lotus flower; *loka*—world; *saàsthäna*—situation; *lakñäëam*—possessed of; *yävän*—as it were; *aya*—this; *vai*—certainly; *puruṣaù*—the Supreme

Personality of Godhead; *iyattä*—measurement; *avayavaiù*—by embodiments; *pāthak*—different; *tävän*—so; *asau*—that; *iti proktaù*—it is so said; *saàsthä*—situation; *avayavavän*—embodiment; *iva*—like.

TRANSLATION

If the Supreme Personality of Godhead, from whose abdomen the lotus stem sprouted, is possessed of a gigantic body according to His own caliber and measurement, then what is the specific difference between the body of the Lord and those of common living entities?

PURPORT

One should note how Maharaja Pariksit intelligently put questions before his spiritual master for scientific understanding of the transcendental body of the Lord. It has been described in many places before this that the Lord assumed a gigantic body, like that of Kāraṇodakaśāyī Viṣṇu, from whose hair pores innumerable universes have generated. The body of Garbhodakaśāyī Viṣṇu is described as sprouting the lotus stem within which all the planets of the universe remain, and at the top of the stem is the lotus flower on which Lord Brahmā is born. In the creation of the material world the Supreme Lord undoubtedly assumes a gigantic body, and living entities also get bodies, big or small, according to necessity. For example, an elephant gets a gigantic body according to its needs, and so also an ant gets its body according to its needs. Similarly, if the Personality of Godhead assumes a gigantic body to accommodate the universes or the planets of a particular universe, there is no difference in the principle of assuming or accepting a particular type of body in terms of necessity. A living being and the Lord cannot be distinguished simply by the difference in the magnitude of the body. So the answer depends on the specific significance of the body of the Lord, as distinguished from the body of the common living being.

TEXT 9

**AJa" Sa*JaiTa >aUTaaiNa >aUTaaTMaa YadNauGa]haTa()
dd*Xae YaeNa Tad]UPa& Naai>aPaÚSaMauÙv")) 9))**

ajaù sàjati bhütäni

bhütätmä yad-anugrahät

dadâçe yena tad-rüpaà

näbhi-padma-samudbhavaù

SYNONYMS

ajaù—one who is born without a material source; *sàjati*—creates;
bhütäni—all those materially born; *bhüta-ätmä*—having a body of matter;
yat—whose; *anugrahät*—by the mercy of; *dadâçe*—could see; *yena*—by
whom; *tat-rüpam*—His form of body; *näbhi*—navel; *padma*—lotus flower;
samudbhavaù—being born of.

TRANSLATION

Brahmä, who was not born of a material source but of the lotus flower coming out of the navel abdomen of the Lord, is the creator of all those who are materially born. Of course, by the grace of the Lord, Brahmä was able to see the form of the Lord.

PURPORT

The first living creature, Brahmä, is called *ajaù* because he did not take his birth from the womb of a mother materially born. He was directly born from the bodily expansion of the lotus flower of the Lord. Thus it is not readily understandable whether the body of the Lord and that of Brahmä are of the same quality or different. This must also be clearly understood. One thing is, however, certain: Brahmä was completely dependent on the mercy of the Lord because after his birth he could create living beings by the Lord's grace only, and he could see the form of the Lord. Whether the form seen by Brahmä is of the same quality as that of Brahmä is a bewildering question, and Maharaja Pariksit wanted to get clear answers from Srila Sukadeva Gosvami.

TEXT 10

**Sa caiPa Ya}a Pauåzae iviSQaTYauÙvaPYaYa")
Mau᳚-aTMaMaaYaa& MaaYaeXa" XaeTae SavRGauhaXaYa")) 10))**

sa cāpi yatra puruṇo

viçva-sthity-udbhavāpyayaù

muktvātma-māyāà māyeçaù

çete sarva-guhāçayaù

SYNONYMS

saù—He; *ca*—also; *api*—as He is; *yatra*—where; *puruṣaù*—the Personality of Godhead; *viçva*—the material worlds; *sthiti*—maintenance; *udbhava*—creation; *apyayaù*—annihilation; *muktvā*—without being touched; *ātma-māyām*—own energy; *māyā-éçaù*—the Lord of all energies; *çete*—does lie on; *sarva-guhā-çayaù*—one who lies in everyone's heart.

TRANSLATION

Please also explain the Personality of Godhead, who lies in every heart as the Supersoul, and as the Lord of all energies, but is untouched by His external energy.

PURPORT

Undoubtedly the form of the Lord who was seen by Brahmā must be transcendental, otherwise how could He simply look upon the creative energy without being touched? It is understood also that the same *puruṣa* lies in the heart of every living entity. This also requires proper explanation.

TEXT 11

PauåzavYavEI/aeRk-a" SaPaal/a" PaUvRk-iLPaTaa")

I/aeE-rMauZYaavYava" SaPaalE/iriTa éué[uMa)) 11))

puruñävayavair lokäù

sapäläù pürva-kalpitäù

lokair amuñyävayaväù

sa-pälair iti çuçruma

SYNONYMS

puruṣa—the universal form of the Lord (*viräö-puruṣaù*); *avayavaiù*—by different parts of the body; *lokäù*—the planetary system; *sa-päläù*—with respective governors; *pürva*—formerly; *kalpitäù*—discussed; *lokaiù*—by the different planetary systems; *amuñya*—His; *avayaväù*—different parts of the body; *sa-pälaiù*—with the governors; *iti*—thus; *çuçruma*—I heard.

TRANSLATION

O learned brahmana, it was formerly explained that all the planets of the universe with their respective governors are situated in the different parts of the gigantic body of the viräö-puruṣa. I have also heard that the different planetary systems are supposed to be in the gigantic body of the viräö-puruṣa. But what is their actual position ? Will you please explain that?

TEXT 12

YaavaNa(k-LPaae ivk-LPaae va YaQaa k-al/ae_NauMaqYaTae)
>aUTa>aVYa>avC^Bd AaYauMaaRNa& c YaTa(SaTa")) 12))

yävän kalpo vikalpo vä

yathä kälo 'numéyate

bhüta-bhavya-bhavac-chabda

äyur-mānaà ca yat sataù

SYNONYMS

yävān—as it is; *kalpaù*—the duration of time between creation and annihilation; *vikalpaù*—subsidiary creation and annihilation; *vā*—either; *yathā*—as also; *kālaù*—the time; *anuméyate*—is measured; *bhūta*—past; *bhavya*—future; *bhavat*—present; *ṣabdaù*—sound; *āyūù*—duration of life; *mānam*—measurement; *ca*—also; *yat*—which; *sataù*—of all living beings in all planets.

TRANSLATION

Also please explain the duration of time between creation and annihilation, and that of other subsidiary creations, as well as the nature of time, indicated by the sound of past, present and future. Also, please explain the duration and measurement of life of the different living beings known as the demigods, the human beings, etc., in different planets of the universe.

PURPORT

Past, present and future are different features of time to indicate the duration of life for the universe and all its paraphernalia, including the different living beings in different planets.

TEXT 13

**k-al/SYaaNauGaiTaYaaR Tau I/+YaTae_<vq b*hTYaiPa)
YaavTYa" k-MaRGaTaYaae Yaad*XaqiÜRJaSataMa)) 13))**

kālasyanugatir yā tu

lakṇyate 'ēvé bāhaty api

yāvatyaù karma-gatayo

yādāçér dvija-sattama

SYNONYMS

kālasya—of eternal time; *anugatiù*—beginning; *yä tu*—as they are; *lakñyate*—experienced; *aëvé*—small; *båhaté*—great; *api*—even; *yävatyaù*—as long as; *karma-gatayaù*—in terms of the work performed; *yādāçéù*—as it may; *dvija-sattama*—O purest of all *brahmanas*.

TRANSLATION

O purest of the brahmanas, please also explain the cause of the different durations of time, both short and long, as well as the beginning of time, following the course of action.

TEXT 14

**YaiSMaNa(k-MaRSaMaavaYaae YaQaa YaeNaaePaGa*ùTae)
Gau<aaNaa& Gaui<aNaa& cEv Pair<aaMaMa>aqPSaTaaMa()) 14))**

yasmin karma-samäväyo

yathä yenopagåhyate

guëänää guëinää caiva

pariëämam abhépsatäm

SYNONYMS

yasmin—in which; *karma*—actions; *samäväyaù*—accumulation; *yathä*—as far as; *yena*—by which; *upagåhyate*—takes over; *guëänäm*—of the different modes of material nature; *guëinäm*—of the living beings; *ca*—also; *eva*—certainly; *pariëämam*—resultant; *abhépsatäm*—of the desires.

TRANSLATION

Then again, kindly describe how the proportionate accumulation of the reactions resulting from the different modes of material nature act upon the desiring living being, promoting or degrading him among the different species of life, beginning from the demigods down to the most insignificant creatures.

PURPORT

The actions and reactions of all works in the material modes of nature, either in the minute form or in the gigantic form, are accumulated, and thus the result of such accumulated actions and reactions of *karma*, or work, become manifested in the same proportion. How such actions and reactions take place, what the different procedures are, and in what proportion they act are all subject matters of Maharaja Pariksit's inquiries from the great *brahmana* Sukadeva Gosvami.

Life in the higher planets, known as the abodes of the denizens of heaven, is obtained not by the strength of spacecraft (as is now being contemplated by the inexperienced scientists), but by works done in the mode of goodness.

Even on the very planet where we are now living, there are restrictions upon the entrance of foreigners into a country where the citizens are more prosperous. For example, the American government has many restrictions for the entrance of foreigners from less prosperous countries. The reason is that the Americans do not wish to share their prosperity with any foreigner who has not qualified himself as a citizen of America. Similarly, the same mentality is prevailing in every other planet where there are more intelligent living beings residing. The higher planetary living conditions are all in the mode of goodness, and anyone desiring to enter the higher planets like the moon, sun and Venus must qualify thoroughly by activity in complete goodness.

Maharaja Pariksit's inquiries are on the basis of proportionate actions of goodness which qualify one in this planet to be promoted to the highest regions of the universe.

Even on this planet of our present residence, one cannot achieve a good position within the social order without being qualified with proportionate good work. One cannot forcibly sit on the chair of a high-court judge without being qualified for the post. Similarly, one cannot enter into the higher planetary systems without being qualified by good works in this life. Persons addicted to the habits of passion and ignorance have no chance of entering the higher planetary systems simply by an electronic mechanism.

According to the statement of the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (9.25), persons trying to qualify themselves for promotion to the higher, heavenly planets can go there; similarly, persons trying for the Pitālokas can go there; similarly, persons trying to improve the conditions on this earth can also do that, and persons who are engaged in going back home, back to Godhead, can achieve that result. The various actions and reactions of work in the mode of goodness are generally known as pious work with devotional service, culture of knowledge with devotional service, mystic powers with devotional service and (at last) devotional service unmixed with any other varieties of goodness. This unmixed devotional service is transcendental and is called *parā bhakti*. It alone can promote a person to the transcendental kingdom of God. Such a transcendental kingdom is not a myth, but is as factual as the moon. One must have transcendental qualities to understand the kingdom of God and God Himself.

TEXT 15

>aUPaaTaal/k-ku-BVYaaeMaGa]hNa+a}a>aU>a*TaaMa()
SairTSaMaud]ÜqPaaNaa& SaM>avêETadaek-SaaMa()) 15))

bhü-pätāla-kakub-vyoma-

graha-nakñātra-bhübhātām

sarit-samudra-dvépānāà

sambhavaç caitad-okasām

SYNONYMS

bhü-pätäla—underneath the land; *kakup*—the four sides of the heavens; *vyoma*—the sky; *graha*—the planets; *nakñatra*—the stars; *bhübhâtäm*—of the hills; *sarit*—the river; *samudra*—the sea; *dvépänäm*—of the islands; *sambhavaù*—appearance; *ca*—also; *etat*—their; *okasäm*—of the inhabitants.

TRANSLATION

O best of the brahmanas, please also describe how the creation of the globes throughout the universe, the four directions of the heavens, the sky, the planets, the stars, the mountains, the rivers, the seas and the islands, as well as their different kinds of inhabitants, takes place.

PURPORT

The inhabitants of different varieties of land, etc., are differently situated, and not all of them are equal in all respects. The inhabitants of the land are different from the inhabitants of the water or the sky, and similarly the inhabitants of the different planets and stars in the sky are also different from one another. By the laws of the Lord, no place is vacant, but the creatures of one particular place are different from those of other places. Even in human society the inhabitants of the jungles or the deserts are different from those of the cities and villages. They are so made according to different qualities of the modes of nature. Such adjustment by the laws of nature is not blind. There is a great plan behind the arrangement. Maharaja Pariksit requests the great sage Sukadeva Gosvami to explain all these authoritatively, in accordance with proper understanding.

TEXT 16

**Pa[Maa<aMa<@k-aeXaSYa baùa>YaNTar>aedTa")
MahTaa& caNaucirTa& v<aaRé[MaiviNaêYa")) 16))**

pramäëam aëòa-koçasya

bähyäbhyantara-bhedataù

mahatää cānucaritaà

varëäçrama-viniçcayaù

SYNONYMS

pramäëam—extent and measurement; *aëòa-koçasya*—of the universe; *bähya*—outer space; *abhyantara*—inner space; *bhedataù*—by division of; *mahatäm*—of the great souls; *ca*—also; *anucaritam*—character and activities; *varëa*—castes; *äçrama*—orders of life; *viniçcayaù*—specifically describe.

TRANSLATION

Also, please describe the inner and outer space of the universe by specific divisions, as well as the character and activities of the great souls, and also the characteristics of the different classifications of the castes and orders of social life.

PURPORT

Maharaja Pariksit is a typical devotee of Lord Kṛṣṇa, and as such he is anxious to know the complete significance of the creation of the Lord. He wants to know the inner and outer space of the universal form. It is quite fitting for the real searcher of knowledge to know all about this. Those who are of the opinion that the devotees of the Lord are satisfied with mere sentiments can find in the inquiries of Maharaja Pariksit good lessons as to how inquisitive a pure devotee is to know things in their true perfection. The modern scientist is unable to know about the inner space of the universal horizon, and what to speak of the space which covers the universe.

Maharaja Pariksit is not satisfied with only material knowledge. He is inquisitive about the character and activities of the great souls, the devotees of the Lord. The glories of the Lord and the glories of His devotees, combined together, comprise the complete knowledge of *Srimad-Bhagavatam*. Lord Kṛṣṇa showed His mother the complete universal

creation within His mouth, while she, completely charmed by her son, wanted to look inside the mouth of the Lord just to see how much earth the child had eaten. By the grace of the Lord the devotees are able to see everything in the universe within the mouth of the Lord.

The very idea of the scientific divisions of four classes of human society and four orders of life is also inquired about herewith on the basis of individual personal quality. The four divisions are exactly like the four divisions of one's personal body. The parts and parcels of the body are nondifferent from the body, but by themselves they are only parts. That is the significance of the whole scientific system of four castes and four social orders. The value of such scientific divisions of human society can be ascertained only in terms of the proportionate development of devotional service to the Lord. Any person employed in government service, including the president, is a part and parcel of the entire government. Everyone is a government servant, but no one is the government himself. That is the position of all living entities in the government of the Supreme Lord. No one can artificially claim the supreme position of the Lord, but everyone is meant to serve the purpose of the supreme whole.

TEXT 17

**YauGaaiNa YauGaMaaNa& c DaMaaeR Yaê YauGae YauGae)
AvTaaraNaucirTa& YadaêYaRTaMa& hre")) 17))**

yugäni yuga-mänaà ca

dharmo yaç ca yuge yuge

avatäränucaritaà

yad äçcaryatamaà hareù

SYNONYMS

yugäni—the different ages; *yuga-mänam*—the duration of each age; *ca*—as well as; *dharmà*—the particular occupational duty; *yaù ca*—and which;

yuge yuge—in each and every *yuga*, or particular age; *avatāra*—the incarnation; *anucaritam*—and the activities of the incarnation; *yat*—which; *āṣṇayataṁ*—the most wonderful activities; *hareṇ*—of the Supreme Lord.

TRANSLATION

Please explain all the different ages in the duration of the creation, and also the duration of such ages. Also tell me about the different activities of the different incarnations of the Lord in different ages.

PURPORT

Lord Kṛṣṇa is the original Personality of Godhead, and all the incarnations of the Supreme Lord, although nondifferent from Him, are emanations from the Supreme. Maharaja Parikṣit inquired from the great and learned sage Sukadeva Gosvami about the different activities of such incarnations so that the incarnation of the Lord might be confirmed by His activities in the authoritative scriptures. Maharaja Parikṣit was not to be carried away by the sentiments of the common man to accept an incarnation of the Lord very cheaply. Instead he wished to accept the incarnation of the Lord by symptoms mentioned in the Vedic literatures and confirmed by an *ācārya* like Sukadeva Gosvami. The Lord descends by His internal energy without any obligation to the laws of material nature, and thus His activities are also uncommon. The specific activities of the Lord are mentioned, and one should know that the activities of the Lord and the Lord Himself are identical due to being on the absolute plane. Thus to hear the activities of the Lord means to associate with the Lord directly, and association with the Lord directly means purification from material contamination. We have already discussed this point in the previous volume.

TEXT 18

Na* <aa& SaaDaar<aae DaMaR" SaivXaezê Yaad*Xa")
é[e<aqNaa& raJazs<aa& c DaMaR" k*-C^e\zu JaqvTaaMa()) 18))

nāñāñā sādharmañ dharmañ

saviṣeñāṣ ca yādāṣaṁ

ṣreëñāṁ rājarñëëṁ ca

dharmaṁ kâcchreṇu jêvatām

SYNONYMS

nâëām—of human society; *sâdhâraëaṁ*—general; *dharmaṁ*—religious affiliation; *sa-viṣeñāṁ*—specific; *ca*—also; *yādāṣaṁ*—as they are; *ṣreëñāṁ*—of the particular three classes; *rājarñëëām*—of the saintly royal order; *ca*—also; *dharmaṁ*—occupational duty; *kâcchreṇu*—in the matter of distressed conditions; *jêvatām*—of the living beings.

TRANSLATION

Please also explain what may generally be the common religious affiliations of human society, as well as their specific occupational duties in religion, the classification of the social orders as well as the administrative royal orders, and the religious principles for one who may be in distress.

PURPORT

The common religion of all classes of human beings, regardless of whosoever and whatsoever one may be, is devotional service. Even the animals may be included in devotional service to the Lord, and the best example is set by Sri Vajrâgajé, or Hanumân, the great devotee of Lord Sri Râma. As we have already discussed, even the aborigines and cannibals can also be engaged in the devotional service of the Lord if they happen to be under the guidance of a genuine devotee of the Lord. In the *Skanda Purana* there is a narration that a hunter in the jungle became the most enlightened devotee of the Lord by the guidance of Sri Nârada Muni. Therefore devotional service to the Lord can be equally shared by every living being.

Religious affiliation in terms of different countries and cultural

circumstances is obviously not the common religion of the human being; rather, the basic principle is devotional service. Even if a particular type of religious principle does not recognize the supremacy of the Supreme Personality of Godhead, the followers still have to obey the disciplinary principles laid down by a particular leader. Such a leader of a religious sect is never the supreme leader because such a circumstantial leader comes to the position of leadership after undergoing some penance. The Supreme Personality of Godhead does not, however, require to be under disciplinary action to become leader, as we see in the activities of Lord Kṛṣṇa.

The occupational duties of the castes and the orders of society, following the principles of livelihood, also depend on the principle of devotional service. In the *Bhagavad-gita* it is stated that a person can achieve the highest perfection of life simply by awarding the results of his occupational duty unto the devotional service of the Lord. People following the principles of devotional service to the Lord can never be put into difficulty, and thus there cannot be any question of *āpad-dharma*, or religion in distress. As will be explained in this book by the greatest authority, Srila Sukadeva Gosvami, there is no religion save and except the devotional service of the Lord, though this may be presented in different forms.

TEXT 19

**TatvaNaa& PairSa&:YaaNa& I/+a<a& heTaul/+a<aMa()
PauāzaraDaNaiviDaYaaeRGaSYaaDYaaITMak-SYa c)) 19))**

tattvānāḥ parisaṅkhyānāḥ

lakṣṇāḥ hetu-lakṣṇāḥ

puruṣārādhana-vidhir

yogasyādhyātmikasya ca

SYNONYMS

tattvānām—of the elements that constitute the creation;

parisaṅkhyānam—of the number of such elements; *lakṣṇāḥ*—symptoms; *hetu-lakṣṇāḥ*—the symptoms of the causes; *puruṣa*—of the Lord; *ārādhana*—of devotional service; *vidhi*—rules and regulations; *yogasya*—of cultivation of the *yoga* system; *adhyātmikasya*—spiritual methods leading to devotional service; *ca*—also.

TRANSLATION

Kindly explain all about the elementary principles of creation, the number of such elementary principles, their causes, and their development, and also the process of devotional service and the method of mystic powers.

TEXT 20

YaaeGaeirEiYaRGaiTailR/®>a®STau YaaeiGaNaMa()
vedaePavedDaMaaR<aaiMaiTahaSaPaura<aYaae")) 20))

yogeçvaraiçvarya-gatir

liṅga-bhaṅgas tu yoginām

vedopaveda-dharmāḥ

itihāsa-purāṇayoḥ

SYNONYMS

yoga-éçvara—of the master of the mystic powers; *aiçvarya*—opulence; *gati*—advancement; *liṅga*—astral body; *bhaṅga*—detachment; *tu*—but; *yoginām*—of the mystics; *veda*—transcendental knowledge; *upaveda*—knowledge in pursuance of the *Veda* indirectly; *dharmāḥ*—of the religiosities; *itihāsa*—history; *purāṇayoḥ*—of the *Puranas*.

TRANSLATION

What are the opulences of the great mystics, and what is their ultimate realization? How does the perfect mystic become detached from the

subtle astral body? What is the basic knowledge of the Vedic literatures, including the branches of history and the supplementary Puranas?

PURPORT

The *yogeçvara*, or the master of mystic powers, can exhibit eight kinds of wonders of perfection by becoming smaller than the atom or lighter than a feather, getting anything and everything he desires, going anywhere and everywhere he likes, creating even a planet in the sky, etc. There are many *yogeçvaras* having different proficiencies in these wonderful powers, and the topmost of all of them is Lord Siva. Lord Siva is the greatest *yogé*, and he can perform such wonderful things, far beyond the ordinary living beings. The devotees of the Lord, the Supreme Personality of Godhead, do not directly practice the process of mystic powers, but, by the grace of the Lord, His devotee can defeat even a great *yogeçvara* like Durväsä Muni, who picked a quarrel with Maharaja Ambaréña and wanted to show the wonderful achievements of his mystic powers. Maharaja Ambaréña was a pure devotee of the Lord, and thus without any effort on his part the Lord saved him from the wrath of Yogesvara Durväsä Muni, and the latter was obliged to beg pardon from the King. Similarly, at the time of Draupadé's precarious position, when she was attacked by the Kurus who wanted to see her naked in the open assembly of the royal order, the Lord saved her from being stripped by supplying an unlimited length of sari to cover her. And Draupadé knew nothing of mystic powers. Therefore the devotees are also *yogeçvaras* by the unlimited power of the Lord, just as a child is powerful by the strength of the parents. They do not try to protect themselves by any artificial means, but are saved by the mercy of the parents.

Maharaja Pariksit inquired from the learned *brahmana* Sukadeva Gosvami about the ultimate destination of such great mystics or how they attain such extraordinary powers by their own efforts or by the grace of the Lord. He inquired also about their detachment from the subtle and gross material bodies. He inquired also about the purports of the Vedic knowledge. As stated in the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (15.15), the whole purport of all the *Vedas* is to know the Supreme Personality of Godhead and thus become a transcendental loving servant of the Lord.

TEXT 21

SaMâv" SavR>aUTaaNaa& iv§-Ma" Pa[iTaSax(k)-Ma")
wíaPaUTaRSYa k-aMYaaNaa& i}avGaRSYa c Yaae iviDa")) 21))

samplavaù sarva-bhütänäà

vikramaù pratisaìkramaù

iñöä-pürtasya kämyänää

tri-vargasya ca yo vidhiù

SYNONYMS

samplavaù—the perfect means or complete devastation; *sarva-bhütänäm*—of all living beings; *vikramaù*—specific power or situation; *pratisaìkramaù*—ultimate destruction; *iñöä*—performance of Vedic rituals; *pürtasya*—pious acts in terms of religion; *kämyänäm*—rituals for economic development; *tri-vargasya*—the three means of religion, economic development and sense satisfaction; *ca*—also; *yaù*—whatsoever; *vidhiù*—procedures.

TRANSLATION

Please explain unto me how the living beings are generated, how they are maintained, and how they are annihilated. Tell me also of the advantages and disadvantages of discharging devotional service unto the Lord. What are the Vedic rituals and injunctions of the supplementary Vedic rites, and what are the procedures of religion, economic development and sense satisfaction?

PURPORT

Samplavaù, in the sense of “perfect means,” is employed to denote the discharging of devotional service, and *pratisamplavaù* means just the opposite, or that which destroys the progress of devotional service. One

who is firmly situated in the devotional service of the Lord can very easily execute the function of conditional life. Living the conditional life is just like plying a boat in the middle of the ocean. One is completely at the mercy of the ocean, and at every moment there is every chance of being drowned in the ocean by slight agitation. If the atmosphere is all right, the boat can ply very easily, undoubtedly, but if there is some storm, fog, wind or cloud, there is every possibility of being drowned in the ocean. No one can control the whims of the ocean, however one may be materially well equipped. One who has crossed the oceans by ship may have sufficient experience of such dependence upon the mercy of the ocean. But one can ply over the ocean of material existence by the grace of the Lord very easily, without any fear of storm or fog. It all depends on the will of the Lord; no one can help if there is some unfortunate danger in the state of conditional life. The devotees of the Lord, however, cross the ocean of material existence without anxiety because a pure devotee is always protected by the Lord (Bg. 9.13). The Lord gives special attention to His devotees in their activities within material, conditional life (Bg. 9.29). Therefore everyone should take shelter of the lotus feet of the Lord and be a pure devotee of the Lord by all means.

One should know, therefore, from the expert spiritual master, the advantages and disadvantages of discharging devotional service, just as Maharaja Pariksit asked his spiritual master, Srila Sukadeva Gosvami. According to *Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu*, the science of devotional service, one should not eat more than what he requires to maintain body and soul together. Vegetable diets and milk are sufficient for maintenance of the human body, and therefore one has no need to eat anything more to satisfy the palate. One should also not accumulate money to become puffed up in the material world. One should earn his livelihood easily and honestly, for it is better to become a coolie for an honest livelihood than to become a great man in society by hook and crook. There is no harm if one becomes the richest man in the world by honest dealings, but one should not sacrifice the honest means of livelihood simply to accumulate wealth. Such an endeavor is harmful to devotional service. One should not talk nonsense. A devotee's business is to earn the favor of the Lord. Therefore a devotee should always glorify the Lord in His wonderful creations. A devotee should not decry the creation of the Lord, defying Him by saying

that He has created a false world. The world is not false. Factually we have to take so many things from the world for our maintenance, so how we can say that the world is false? Similarly, how can one think of the Lord as being without form? How can one become formless and at the same time have all intelligence and consciousness, direct and indirect? So there are many things for a pure devotee to learn, and he should learn them perfectly from a bona fide personality like Sukadeva Gosvami.

The favorable conditions for discharging devotional service are that one should be very enthusiastic in serving the Lord. The Lord in His form of Sri Caitanya Mahāprabhu wanted the cult of devotional service to the Lord to be preached all over the world, in every nook and corner, and therefore a pure devotee's duty is to discharge this order as far as possible. Every devotee should be very enthusiastic, not only in performing his daily rituals of devotional service, but in trying to preach the cult peacefully by following in the footsteps of Lord Caitanya. If he is not superficially successful in such an attempt, he should not be deterred from the discharge of his duty. Success or failure has no meaning for a pure devotee because he is a soldier in the field. Preaching the cult of devotional service is something like declaring war against materialistic life. There are different kinds of materialists, such as the fruitive workers, the mental speculators, the mystic jugglers, and so many others. All of them are against the existence of Godhead. They would declare that they are themselves God, although in every step and in every action they are dependent on the mercy of the Lord. Therefore a pure devotee may not associate with such gangs of atheists. A strong devotee of the Lord will not be misled by such atheistic propaganda of the nondevotees, but a neophyte devotee should be very cautious about them. A devotee should see to the right discharge of devotional service under the guidance of a bona fide spiritual master and should not stick only to the formalities. Under the direction of the bona fide spiritual master, one should see how much service is being executed, and not simply in the matter of rituals. A devotee should not hanker after anything, but he should be satisfied with things that may automatically come to him by the will of the Lord. That should be the principle of a devotional life. And all these principles are easily learned under the guidance of a spiritual master like Sukadeva Gosvami. Maharaja Parikṣit inquired from Sukadeva correctly, and one should follow his example.

Maharaja Parikṣit inquired about the process of creation, maintenance and destruction of the material world, the process of Vedic rituals and the method of executing pious activities in terms of the supplementary *Vedas* like the *Puranas* and *Mahābhārata*. As explained before, the *Mahābhārata* is the history of ancient India, and so also are the *Puranas*. Pious acts are prescribed in the supplementary *Vedas* (*smārtis*), which specifically mention digging tanks and wells for the water supply of the people in general. To plant trees on the public roads, to construct public temples and places of worship of God, to establish places of charity where the poor destitutes can be provided with foodstuff, and similar activities are called *pūrta*.

Similarly, the process of fulfilling the natural desires for sense gratification was also inquired about by the King for the benefit of all concerned.

TEXT 22

**Yaae vaNauXaaiYaNaa& SaGaR" Paaz<@SYa c SaM>av")
AaTMaNaae bNDaMaae+aaE c VYavSQaaNa& SvæPaTa")) 22))**

yo vänuçäyinää sargaù

päññaëòasya ca sambhavaù

ätmano bandha-mokñau ca

vyavasthänäà sva-rüpataù

SYNONYMS

yaù—all those; *vä*—either; *anuçäyinäm*—merged into the body of the Lord; *sargaù*—creation; *päññaëòasya*—of the infidels; *ca*—and; *sambhavaù*—appearance; *ätmanaù*—of the living beings; *bandha*—conditioned; *mokñau*—being liberated; *ca*—also; *vyavasthänam*—being situated; *sva-rüpataù*—in an unconditioned state.

TRANSLATION

Please also explain how, merged in the body of the Lord, living beings are created, and how the infidels appear in the world. Also please explain how the unconditioned living entities exist.

PURPORT

The progressive devotee of the Lord must inquire from the bona fide spiritual master how living entities merged in the body of the Lord again come back at the time of creation. There are two kinds of living entities. There are the ever-liberated, unconditioned living beings as well as the ever-conditioned living beings. Of the ever-conditioned living beings, there are two divisions. They are the faithful and the infidels. Of the faithful there are again two divisions, namely the devotees and the mental speculators. The mental speculators desire to merge into the existence of the Lord, or to become one with the Lord, whereas the devotees of the Lord desire to keep separate identities and constantly engage in the service of the Lord. The devotees who are not fully purified, as well as the empiric philosophers, become conditioned again during the next creation for further purification. Such conditioned souls become liberated by further progress of devotional service to the Lord. Maharaja Pariksit asked all these questions from the bona fide spiritual master in order to become fully equipped in the science of God.

TEXT 23

**YaQaaTMaTaN}aae >aGavaNa(iv\$-l@TYaaTMaMaaYaYaa)
ivSa*JYa va YaQaa MaaYaaMaudaSTae Saai+avd(ivi>au")) 23))**

yathätma-tantro bhagavän

vikréòaty ätma-mäyayä

visåjya vä yathä mäyäm

udäste säkñivad vibhuù

SYNONYMS

yathā—as; *ātma-tantra*—independent; *bhagavān*—the Personality of Godhead; *vikrēḍati*—enjoys His pastimes; *ātma-māyayā*—by His internal potency; *visājya*—giving up; *vā*—as also; *yathā*—as He desires; *māyām*—the external potency; *udāste*—remains; *sākṣīvat*—just as the witness; *vibhu*—the almighty.

TRANSLATION

The independent Personality of Godhead enjoys His pastimes by His internal potency and at the time of annihilation gives them up to the external potency, and He remains a witness to it all.

PURPORT

Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, being the Supreme Personality of Godhead and fountainhead of all other incarnations, is the only independent person. He enjoys His pastimes by creation as He desires and gives them up to the external energy at the time of annihilation. By His internal potency only, He kills the demon Pūtanā, even though enjoying His pastimes in the lap of His mother Yaçodā. And when He desires to leave this world He creates the pastimes of killing His own family members (Yadu-kula) and remains unaffected by such annihilation. He is the witness of everything that is happening, and yet He has nothing to do with anything. He is independent in every respect. Maharaja Parikṣit desired to know more perfectly, for a pure devotee ought to know well.

TEXT 24

**SavRMaeTaÀ >aGavNa(Pa*C^Taae Mae_NauPaUvRXa")
TatvTaae_hRSYaudahTau| Pa[PaàaYa MahaMauNae)) 24))**

sarvam etac ca bhagavan

pācchato me 'nupūrvaçau

tattvato 'rhasy udāhartuà

prapannäya mahä-mune

SYNONYMS

sarvam—all these; *etat*—inquiries; *ca*—also that I have not been able to ask; *bhagavan*—O great sage; *pācchataù*—of the inquisitive; *me*—myself; *anupūrvaçaù*—from the beginning; *tattvataù*—just in accordance with the truth; *arhasi*—may kindly be explained; *udāhartum*—as you will let know; *prapannäya*—one who is surrounded; *mahä-mune*—O great sage.

TRANSLATION

O great sage, representative of the Lord, kindly satisfy my inquisitiveness in all that I have inquired from you and all that I may not have inquired from you from the very beginning of my questionings. Since I am a soul surrendered unto you, please impart full knowledge in this connection.

PURPORT

The spiritual master is always prepared to impart knowledge to the disciple and specifically when the disciple is very inquisitive. inquisitiveness on the part of a disciple is greatly necessary for the progressive disciple. Maharaja Pariksit is a typical disciple because he is perfectly inquisitive. If one is not very inquisitive about self-realization, one need not approach a spiritual master simply to make a show of discipleship. Not only is Maharaja Pariksit inquisitive concerning all he has inquired about, but he is also anxious to know about what he has not been able to inquire. Factually it is not possible for a man to inquire about everything from the spiritual master, but the bona fide spiritual master is able to enlighten the disciple in every way for the disciple's benefit.

TEXT 25

**A}a Pa[Maa<a& ih >avaNa(ParMaeiq YaQaaTMa>aU")
APare caNauiTaiiNTa PaUveRza& PaUvRJae" k*-TaMa()) 25))**

atra pramäëaà hi bhavän

parameñöhé yathätma-bhüù

apare cänutiñöhanti

pürveñää pürva-jaiù kåtam

SYNONYMS

atra—in this matter; *pramäëam*—evidential facts; *hi*—certainly; *bhavän*—yourself; *parameñöhé*—Brahmä, the creator of the universe; *yathä*—as; *ätma-bhüù*—born directly from the Lord; *apare*—others; *ca*—only; *anutiñöhanti*—just to follow; *pürveñäm*—as a matter of custom; *pürva-jaiù*—knowledge suggested by a previous philosopher; *kåtam*—having been done.

TRANSLATION

O great sage, you are as good as Brahmä, the original living being. Others follow custom only, as followed by the previous philosophical speculators.

PURPORT

It may be argued that Sukadeva Gosvami is not the only authority of perfect knowledge in transcendence because there are many other sages and their followers. Contemporary to Vyäsadeva or even prior to him there were many other great sages, such as Gautama, Kaëäda, Jaimini, Kapila and Añöävakra, and all of them have presented a philosophical path by themselves. Patañjali is also one of them, and all these six great *åñis* have their own way of thinking, exactly like the modern philosophers and mental speculators. The difference between the six philosophical paths put forward by the renowned sages above mentioned and that of Sukadeva Gosvami, as presented in the *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, is that all the six sages mentioned above speak the facts according to their own thinking, but Sukadeva Gosvami presents the knowledge which comes down directly from Brahmäjé, who is known as *ätma-bhüù*, or born of and educated by the Almighty Personality of Godhead.

Vedic transcendental knowledge descends directly from the Personality of Godhead. By His mercy, Brahmā, the first living being in the universe, was enlightened, and from Brahmājé, Nārada was enlightened, and from Nārada, Vyāsa was enlightened. Sukadeva Gosvami received such transcendental knowledge directly from his father, Vyāsadeva. Thus the knowledge, being received from the chain of disciplic succession, is perfect. One cannot be a spiritual master in perfection unless and until one has received the same by disciplic succession. That is the secret of receiving transcendental knowledge. The six great sages mentioned above may be great thinkers, but their knowledge by mental speculation is not perfect. However perfect an empiric philosopher may be in presenting a philosophical thesis, such knowledge is never perfect because it is produced by an imperfect mind. Such great sages also have their disciplic successions, but they are not authorized because such knowledge does not come directly from the independent Supreme Personality of Godhead, Nārāyaṇa. No one can be independent except Nārāyaṇa; therefore no one's knowledge can be perfect, for everyone's knowledge is dependent on the flickering mind. Mind is material and thus knowledge presented by material speculators is never transcendental and can never become perfect. Mundane philosophers, being imperfect in themselves, disagree with other philosophers because a mundane philosopher is not a philosopher at all unless he presents his own theory. Intelligent persons like Maharaja Parikṣit do not recognize such mental speculators, however great they may be, but hear from the authorities like Sukadeva Gosvami, who is nondifferent from the Supreme Personality of Godhead by the *paramparā* system, as is specially stressed in the *Bhagavad-gita*.

TEXT 26

Na Mae_Sav" ParaYaiNTa b]øàNaXaNaadMaq)
iPabTaae_CYauTaPaqYaUzMa(Tad(vaKYaaIBDaiviNa"Sa*TaMa()) 26))

na me 'savaù parāyanti

brahmann anaçanād amé

pibato 'cyuta-péyüñam

tad väkyäbdhi-viniùsâtam

SYNONYMS

na—never; *me*—mine; *asavaù*—life; *paräyanti*—becomes exhausted; *brahman*—O learned *brahmana*; *anaçanät amé*—because of fasting; *pibataù*—because of my drinking; *acyuta*—of the infallible; *péyüñam*—nectar; *tat*—your; *väkyä-abdhi*—ocean of speech; *viniùsâtam*—flowing down from.

TRANSLATION

O learned brahmana, because of my drinking the nectar of the message of the infallible Personality of Godhead, which is flowing down from the ocean of your speeches, I do not feel any sort of exhaustion due to my fasting.

PURPORT

The disciplic succession from Brahmä, Närada, Vyäsa and Sukadeva Gosvami is particularly different from others. The disciplic successions from other sages are simply a waste of time, being devoid of *acyuta-kathä*, or the message of the infallible Lord. The mental speculators can present their theories very nicely by reason and arguments, but such reasons and arguments are not infallible, for they are defeated by better mental speculators. Maharaja Pariksit was not interested in the dry speculation of the flickering mind, but he was interested in the topics of the Lord because factually he felt that by hearing such a nectarean message from the mouth of Sukadeva Gosvami he was not feeling any exhaustion, even though he was fasting because of his imminent death.

One can indulge in hearing the mental speculators, but such hearing cannot endure for any length of time. One will be exhausted very soon from hearing such hackneyed ways of thinking, and no one in the world can be satisfied simply by hearing such useless speculations. The message of the Lord, especially from a personality like Sukadeva Gosvami, can never be tiring, even though one may be exhausted from other causes.

In some editions of the *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, the text of the last line of this verse reads *anyatra kupitād dvijāt*, which means that the King might be overwhelmed by the thought of his imminent death by snakebite. The snake is also twice-born, and its anger is compared to the cursing *brahmana* boy who was without good intelligence. Maharaja Parikṣit was not at all afraid of death, for he was fully encouraged by the message of the Lord. One who is fully absorbed in *acyuta-kathā* can never be afraid of anything in this world.

TEXT 27

SaUTa ovac

**Sa oPaaMaiN}aTaae raja k-QaaYaaiMaiTa SaTPaTae")
b]øraTaae >a*Xa& Pa[qTaae ivZ<auraTaeNa Sa&Said)) 27))**

sūta uvāca

sa upāmantrito rājā

kathāyām iti sat-pateu

brahmarāto bhāṣaà prēto

viṣṇurātena saàsadi

SYNONYMS

sūtaù uvāca—Srila Sūta Gosvami said; *saù*—he (Sukadeva Gosvami); *upāmantritaù*—thus being inquired; *rājā*—by the King; *kathāyām*—in the topics; *iti*—thus; *sat-pateu*—of the highest truth; *brahma-rātaù*—Sukadeva Gosvami; *bhāṣam*—very much; *prētaù*—pleased; *viṣṇu-rātena*—by Maharaja Parikṣit; *saàsadi*—in the meeting.

TRANSLATION

Sūta Gosvami said: Thus Sukadeva Gosvami, being invited by Maharaja Parikṣit to speak on topics of the Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa with the devotees, was

very much pleased.

PURPORT

Srimad-Bhagavatam can be legitimately discussed only among the devotees of the Lord. As the *Bhagavad-gita* was authoritatively discussed between Lord Kṛṣṇa and Arjuna (the Lord and the devotee respectively), similarly *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, which is the postgraduate study of the *Bhagavad-gita*, can also be discussed between the scholars and devotees like Sukadeva Gosvami and Maharaja Parikṣit. Otherwise the real taste of the nectar cannot be relished. Sukadeva Gosvami was pleased with Maharaja Parikṣit because he was not at all tired of hearing the topics of the Lord and was more and more anxious to hear them on and on with interest. Foolish interpreters unnecessarily tackle the *Bhagavad-gita* and *Srimad-Bhagavatam* when they have no access to the subject matter. There is no use in nondevotees' meddling with the two topmost Vedic literatures, and therefore Ṇakarācārya did not touch *Srimad-Bhagavatam* for commentation. In his commentation on the *Bhagavad-gita*, Sripāda Ṇakarācārya accepted Lord Kṛṣṇa as the Supreme Personality of Godhead, but later on he commented from the impersonalist's view. But, being conscious of his position, he did not comment on the *Srimad-Bhagavatam*.

Srila Sukadeva Gosvami was protected by Lord Kṛṣṇa (vide *Brahma-vaivarta Purana*), and therefore he is known as Brahmarāta, and Srimān Parikṣit Maharaja was protected by Viṣṇu, and thus he is known as Viṣṇurāta. As devotees of the Lord, they are always protected by the Lord. It is clear also in this connection that a Viṣṇurāta should hear *Srimad-Bhagavatam* from Brahmarāta and no one else because others misrepresent the transcendental knowledge and thus spoil one's valuable time.

TEXT 28

Pa[ah >aaGavTa& NaaMa Paura<a& b]øSaiMMaTaMa()
b]ø<ae >aGavTPa[aeç&- b]øk-LPa oPaaGaTae)) 28))

prāha bhāgavatā nāma

puräëaà brahma-sammitam

brahmaëe bhagavat-proktaà

brahma-kalpa upägate

SYNONYMS

präha—he said; *bhägavatam*—the science of the Personality of Godhead; *näma*—of the name; *puräëam*—the supplement of the *Vedas*; *brahma-sammitam*—just in pursuance of the *Vedas*; *brahmaëe*—unto Lord Brahmä; *bhagavat-proktam*—was spoken by the Personality of Godhead; *brahma-kalpe*—the millennium in which Brahmä was first generated; *upägate*—just in the beginning.

TRANSLATION

He began to reply to the inquiries of Maharaja Pariksit by saying that the science of the Personality of Godhead was spoken first by the Lord Himself to Brahmä when he was first born. Srimad-Bhagavatam is the supplementary Vedic literature, and it is just in pursuance of the Vedas.

PURPORT

Srimad-Bhagavatam is the science of the Personality of Godhead. The impersonalist always tries to misrepresent the personal feature of the Lord, not knowing the science of this great knowledge, and *Srimad-Bhagavatam* is in pursuance of the *Vedas* and scientific knowledge of the Personality of Godhead. To learn this science one should take shelter of the representative of Sri Sukadeva and follow in the footsteps of Maharaja Pariksit without foolishly attempting to interpret, thereby committing a great offense at the feet of the Lord. The dangerous ways of interpretations by the nondevotee class of men have played havoc in understanding the *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, and the careful student should be always alert in this matter if he at all wants to learn the science of Godhead.

TEXT 29

Yad(YaTa(Parqi+ad*z>a" Paa<@UNaaMaNauPa*C^iTa)
AaNauPaUVYaeR<a TaTSavRMaa:YaaTauMauPac§-Mae)) 29))

yad yat parékñid añabhaù

päëòünäm anupâcchati

änupürvyeeä tat sarvam

äkhyätum upacakrame

SYNONYMS

yat yat—whatsoever; *parékñit*—the King; *añabhaù*—the best; *päëòünäm*—in the dynasty of Päëòu; *anupâcchati*—goes on inquiring; *änupürvyeeä*—the beginning to the end; *tat*—all those; *sarvam*—fully; *äkhyätum*—to describe; *upacakrame*—he just prepared himself.

TRANSLATION

He also prepared himself to reply to all that King Pariksit had inquired from him. Maharaja Pariksit was the best in the dynasty of the Päëòus, and thus he was able to ask the right questions from the right person.

PURPORT

Maharaja Pariksit asked many questions, some of them very curiously, to know things as they are, but it is not necessary for the master to answer them in the order of the disciple's inquiries, one after the other. But Sukadeva Gosvami, experienced teacher that he was, answered all the questions in a systematic way as they were received from the chain of disciplic succession. And he answered all of them without exception.

Thus end the Bhaktivedanta purports of the Second Canto, Eighth Chapter, of the Srimad-Bhagavatam, entitled "Questions by King Pariksit."

Chapter Nine

Answers by Citing the Lord's Version

TEXT 1

é[quéuk- ovac
AaTMaMaaYaaMa*Tae raJaNa(ParSYaaNau>avaTMaNa")
Na ga\$e=TaaQaRSaMbNDa" SvPand]íuirvaÅSaa)) 1))

çré-çuka uvāca

ātma-māyām āte rājan

parasyānubhavātmanaù

na ghaöetārtha-sambandhaù

svapna-drañöur iväïjasä

SYNONYMS

çré-çukaù uvāca—Sri Sukadeva Gosvami said; *ātma*—the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *māyām*—energy; *āte*—without; *rājan*—O King; *parasya*—of the pure soul; *anubhava-ātmanaù*—of the purely conscious; *na*—never; *ghaöeta*—it can so happen; *artha*—meaning; *sambandhaù*—relation with the material body; *svapna*—dream; *drañöuù*—of the seer; *iva*—like; *äïjasä*—completely.

TRANSLATION

Sri Sukadeva Gosvami said: O King, unless one is influenced by the energy of the Supreme Personality of Godhead, there is no meaning to the relationship of the pure soul in pure consciousness with the material body. That relationship is just like a dreamer's seeing his own body working.

PURPORT

Maharaja Parikṣit's question as to how a living entity began his material life, although he is apart from the material body and mind, is perfectly answered. The spirit soul is distinct from the material conception of his life, but he is absorbed in such a material conception because of being influenced by the external energy of the Lord, called *ātma-māyā*. This has already been explained in the First Canto in connection with Vyāsadeva's realization of the Supreme Lord and His external energy. The external energy is controlled by the Lord, and the living entities are controlled by the external energy—by the will of the Lord. Therefore, although the living entity is purely conscious in his pure state, he is subordinate to the will of the Lord in being influenced by the external energy of the Lord. In the ***Bhagavad-gītā*** (15.15) also the same thing is confirmed; the Lord is present within the heart of every living entity, and all the living entity's consciousness and forgetfulness are influenced by the Lord.

Now the next question automatically made will be why the Lord influences the living entity to such consciousness and forgetfulness. The answer is that the Lord clearly wishes that every living entity be in his pure consciousness as a part and parcel of the Lord and thus be engaged in the loving service of the Lord as he is constitutionally made; but because the living entity is partially independent also, he may not be willing to serve the Lord, but may try to become as independent as the Lord is. All the nondevotee living entities are desirous of becoming equally as powerful as the Lord, although they are not fit to become so. The living entities are illusioned by the will of the Lord because they wanted to become like Him. Like a person who thinks of becoming a king without possessing the necessary qualification, when the living entity desires to become the Lord Himself, he is put in a condition of dreaming that he is a king. Therefore the first sinful will of the living entity is to become the Lord, and the consequent will of the Lord is that the living entity forget his factual life and thus dream of the land of utopia where he may become one like the Lord. The child cries to have the moon from the mother, and the mother gives the child a mirror to satisfy the crying and disturbing child with the reflection of the moon. Similarly, the crying child of the Lord is given over to the reflection, the material world, to lord it over as *karmé* and to give this up in frustration to become

one with the Lord. Both these stages are dreaming illusions only. There is no necessity of tracing out the history of when the living entity desired this. But the fact is that as soon as he desired it, he was put under the control of *ātma-māyā* by the direction of the Lord. Therefore the living entity in his material condition is dreaming falsely that this is “mine” and this is “I.” The dream is that the conditioned soul thinks of his material body as “I” or falsely thinks that he is the Lord and that everything in connection with that material body is “mine.” Thus only in dream does the misconception of “I” and “mine” persist life after life. This continues life after life, as long as the living entity is not purely conscious of his identity as the subordinate part and parcel of the Lord.

In his pure consciousness, however, there is no such misconceived dream, and in that pure conscious state the living entity does not forget that he is never the Lord, but that he is eternally the servitor of the Lord in transcendental love.

TEXT 2

**bhuæPa wva>aaiTa MaaYaYaa bhuæPaYaa)
rMaMaa<aae Gau<aeZvSYaa MaMaahiMaiTa MaNYaTae)) 2))**

bahu-rūpa ivābhāti

māyayā bahu-rūpayā

ramamäëo guëëñv asyā

mamāham iti manyate

SYNONYMS

bahu-rūpa—multiforms; *iva*—as it were; *ābhāti*—manifested; *māyayā*—by the influence of the exterior energy; *bahu-rūpayā*—in multifarious forms; *ramamäëa*—enjoying as it were; *guëëñu*—in the modes of different qualities; *asyā*—of the external energy; *mama*—mine; *aham*—I; *iti*—thus; *manyate*—thinks.

TRANSLATION

The illusioned living entity appears in so many forms offered by the external energy of the Lord. While enjoying in the modes of material nature, the encaged living entity misconceives, thinking in terms of “I” and “mine.”

PURPORT

The different forms of the living entities are different dresses offered by the illusory, external energy of the Lord according to the modes of nature the living being desires to enjoy. The external, material energy is represented by her three modes, namely goodness, passion and ignorance. So even in the material nature there is a chance of an independent choice by the living entity, and according to his choice the material energy offers him different varieties of material bodies. There are bodies, 1,100,000 worms and reptiles, 1,000,000 forms of birds, together there are 8,400,000 varieties of bodies in different planets of the universe, and the living entity is traveling by so many transmigrations according to different modes of enjoying spirit within himself. Even in one particular body the living entity changes from childhood to boyhood, from boyhood to youth, from youth to old age and from old age to another body created by his own action. The living entity creates his own body by his personal desires, and the external energy of the Lord supplies him the exact form by which he can enjoy his desires to the fullest extent. The tiger wanted to enjoy the blood of another animal, and therefore, by the grace of the Lord, the material energy supplied him the body of the tiger with facilities for enjoying blood from another animal. Similarly, a living entity desiring to get the body of a demigod in a higher planet can also get it by the grace of the Lord. And if he is intelligent enough, he can desire to get a spiritual body to enjoy the company of the Lord, and he will get it. So the minute freedom of the living entity can be fully utilized, and the Lord is so kind that He will award the living entity the same type of body he desires. The living entity's desiring is like dreaming of a golden mountain. A person knows what a mountain is, and he knows also what gold is. Out of his desire only, he dreams of a golden mountain, and when the dream is over he sees something else in his presence. He finds in his awakened state that there is neither gold nor a mountain, and what to

speak of a golden mountain.

The different positions of the living entities in the material world under multifarious manifestations of bodies are due to the misconception of “mine” and “I.” The *karmé* thinks of this world as “mine,” and the *jñāné* thinks “I am” everything. The whole material conception of politics, sociology, philanthropy, altruism, etc., conceived by the conditioned souls is on the basis of this misconceived “I” and “mine,” which are products of a strong desire to enjoy material life. Identification with the body and the place where the body is obtained under different conceptions of socialism, nationalism, family affection, and so on and so forth is all due to forgetfulness of the real nature of the living entity, and the whole misconception of the bewildered living entity can be removed by the association of Sukadeva Gosvami and Maharaja Parikṣit, as all this is explained in the *Srimad-Bhagavatam*.

TEXT 3

**YaiR vav MaihiMan Sve PariSMaNa(k-al/MaaYaYaa")
rMaeTa GaTaSaMMaaehSTYaṅ-aedaSTae Tadae>aYaMa()) 3))**

yarhi vāva mahimni sve

parasmin kāla-māyayoḥ

rameta gata-sammohas

tyaktvodāste tadobhayam

SYNONYMS

yarhi—at any time; *vāva*—certainly; *mahimni*—in the glory; *sve*—of himself; *parasmin*—in the Supreme; *kāla*—time; *māyayoḥ*—of the material energy; *rameta*—enjoys; *gata-sammohaḥ*—being freed from the misconception; *tyaktvā*—giving up; *udāste*—in fullness; *tadā*—then; *ubhayam*—both (the misconceptions of I and mine).

TRANSLATION

As soon as the living entity becomes situated in his constitutional glory and begins to enjoy the transcendence beyond time and material energy, he at once gives up the two misconceptions of life [I and mine] and thus becomes fully manifested as the pure self.

PURPORT

The two misconceptions of life, namely “I” and “mine,” are verily manifested in two classes of men. In the lower state the conception of “mine” is very prominent, and in the higher state the misconception of “I” is prominent. In the animal state of life the misconception of “mine” is perceivable even in the category of cats and dogs, who fight with one another with the same misconception of “mine.” In the lower stage of human life the same misconception is also prominent in the shape of “It is my body,” “It is my house,” “It is my family,” “It is my caste,” “It is my nation,” “It is my country,” and so on. And in the higher stage of speculative knowledge, the same misconception of “mine” is transformed into “I am,” or “It is all I am,” etc. There are many classes of men comprehending the same misconception of “I” and “mine’, in different colors. But the real significance of “I” can be realized only when one is situated in the consciousness of “*I am the eternal servitor of the Lord.*” This is pure consciousness, and the whole Vedic literatures teach us this conception of life.

The misconception of “I am the Lord,” or “I am the Supreme,” is more dangerous than the misconception of “mine.” Although there are sometimes directions in the Vedic literatures to think oneself one with the Lord, that does not mean that one becomes identical with the Lord in every respect. Undoubtedly there is oneness of the living entity with the Lord in many respects, but ultimately the living entity is subordinate to the Lord, and he is constitutionally meant for satisfying the senses of the Lord. The Lord therefore asks the conditioned souls to surrender unto Him. Had the living entities not been subordinate to the supreme will, why would the living entity be asked to surrender? Had the living being been equal in all respects, then why was he put under the influence of *māyā*? We have

already discussed many times that the material energy is controlled by the Lord. The ***Bhagavad-gita*** (9.10) confirms this controlling power of the Lord over the material nature. Can a living entity who claims to be as good as the Supreme Being control the material nature? The foolish “I” would reply that he will do so in the future. Even accepting that in the future one will be as good a controller of material nature as the Supreme Being, then why is one now under the control of material nature? The ***Bhagavad-gita*** says that one can be freed from the control of the material nature by surrendering unto the Supreme Lord, but if there is no surrender, then the living entity will never be able to control the material nature. So one must also give up this misconception of “I” by practicing the way of devotional service or firmly being situated in the transcendental loving service of the Lord. A poor man without any employment or occupation may undergo so many troubles in life, but if by chance the same man gets a good service under the government, he at once becomes happy. There is no profit in denying the supremacy of the Lord, who is the controller of all energies, but one should be constitutionally situated in one’s own glory, namely to be situated in the pure consciousness of being the eternal servitor of the Lord. In his conditional life the living entity is servant of the illusory *māyā*, and in his liberated state he is the pure, unqualified servant of the Lord. To become untinged by the modes of material nature is the qualification for entering into the service of the Lord. As long as one is a servant of mental concoctions, one cannot be completely free from the disease of “I” and “mine.”

The Supreme Truth is uncontaminated by the illusory energy because He is the controller of that energy. The relative truths are apt to be engrossed in illusory energy. The best purpose is served, however, when one is directly facing the Supreme Truth, as when one faces the sun. The sun overhead in the sky is full of light, but when the sun is not in the visible sky, all is in darkness. Similarly, when one is face to face with the Supreme Lord, he is freed from all illusions, and one who is not so is in the darkness of illusory *māyā*. The ***Bhagavad-gita*** (14.26) confirms this as follows:

*māà ca yo ’vyabhicāreëa
bhakti-yogena sevate
sa guëän samatétyaitän*

brahma-bhüyāya kalpate

So the science of *bhakti-yoga*, of worshiping the Lord, glorifying the Lord, hearing the *Srimad-Bhagavatam* from the right sources (not from the professional man but from a person who is *Bhāgavatam* in life) and being always in the association of pure devotees, should be adopted in earnestness. One should not be misled by misconceptions of “I” and “mine.” The *karmis* are fond of the conception of “mine,” the *jñanis* are fond of the conception of “I,” and both of them are unqualified to be free from the bondage of the illusory energy. *Srimad-Bhagavatam* and, primarily, the *Bhagavad-gita* are both meant for delivering a person from the misconception of “I” and “mine,” and Srila Vyāsadeva transcribed them for the deliverance of the fallen souls. The living entity has to be situated in the transcendental position where there is no more influence of time nor of the material energy. In conditioned life the living entity is subjected to the influence of time in the dream of past, present and future. The mental speculator tries to conquer the influence of time by future speculations of becoming Vāsudeva or the Supreme Lord himself by means of culturing knowledge and conquering over ego. But the process is not perfect. The perfect process is to accept Lord Vāsudeva as the Supreme in everything, and the best perfection in culturing knowledge is to surrender unto Him because He is the source of everything. Only in that conception can one get rid of the misconception of I and mine. Both *Bhagavad-gita* and the *Srimad-Bhagavatam* confirm it. Srila Vyāsadeva has specifically contributed to the illusioned living entities the science of God and the process of *bhakti-yoga* in his great literature *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, and the conditioned soul should fully take advantage of this great science.

TEXT 4

**AaTMaTatvivéuÖyQa| Yadah >aGavaNa*TaMa()
b]ø<ae dXaRYaNa(æPaMaVYal/lk-v]Taad*Ta")) 4))**

ātma-tattva-viçuddhy-arthaà

yad āha bhagavān ātam

brahmaëe darçayan rūpam

avyaléka-vratädâtaù

SYNONYMS

âtma-tattva—the science of God or that of the living entity; *viçuddhi*—purification; *artham*—goal; *yat*—that which; *äha*—said; *bhagavän*—the Personality of Godhead; *âtam*—in reality; *brahmaëe*—unto Lord Brahmä; *darçayan*—by showing; *rūpam*—eternal form; *avyaléka*—without any deceptive motive; *vrata*—vow; *ädâtaù*—worshiped.

TRANSLATION

O King, the Personality of Godhead, being very much pleased with Lord Brahmä because of his nondeceptive penance in bhakti-yoga, presented His eternal and transcendental form before Brahmä. And that is the objective goal for purifying the conditioned soul.

PURPORT

Ätma-tattva is the science of both God and the living entity. Both the Supreme Lord and the living entity are known as *ätmä*. The Supreme Lord is called Paramätmä, and the living entity is called the *ätmä*, the *brahma* or the *jéva*. Both the Paramätmä and the *jévätmä*, being transcendental to the material energy, are called *ätmä*. So Sukadeva Gosvami explains this verse with the aim of purifying the truth of both the Paramätmä and the *jévätmä*. Generally people have many wrong conceptions about both of them. The wrong conception of the *jévätmä* is to identify the material body with the pure soul, and the wrong conception of Paramätmä is to think Him on an equal level with the living entity. But both misconceptions can be removed by one stroke of *bhakti-yoga*, just as in the sunlight both the sun and the world and everything within the sunlight are properly seen. In the darkness one cannot see the sun, nor himself, nor the world. But in the sunlight one can see the sun, himself and the world around him. Srila Sukadeva Gosvami therefore says that for purification of both wrong conceptions, the Lord presented His eternal form before Brahmäjé, being fully satisfied by

Brahmā's nondeceptive vow of discharging *bhakti-yoga*. Except for *bhakti-yoga*, any method for realization of *ātma-tattva*, or the science of *ātmā*, will prove deceptive in the long run.

In the *Bhagavad-gita*, the Lord says that only by *bhakti-yoga* can one know Him perfectly, and then one can enter into the science of God. Brahmājé undertook great penance in performing *bhakti-yoga*, and thus he was able to see the transcendental form of the Lord. His transcendental form is one hundred percent spiritual, and one can see Him only by spiritualized vision after proper discharge of *tapasya* or penance, in pure *bhakti-yoga*. The form of the Lord manifested before Brahmā is not one of the forms with which we have experience in the material world. Brahmājé did not perform such severe types of penance just to see a form of material production. Therefore the question by Maharaja Pariksit about the form of the Lord is answered. The form of the Lord is *sac-cid-ānanda*, or eternal, full of knowledge and full of bliss. But the material form of the living being is neither eternal, nor full of knowledge, nor blissful. That is the distinction between the form of the Lord and that of the conditioned soul. The conditioned soul, however, can regain his form of eternal knowledge and bliss simply by seeing the Lord by means of *bhakti-yoga*.

The summary is that due to ignorance the conditioned soul is encaged in the temporary varieties of material forms. But the Supreme Lord has no such temporary form like the conditioned souls. He is always possessed of an eternal form of knowledge and bliss, and that is the difference between the Lord and the living entity. One can understand this difference by the process of *bhakti-yoga*. Brahmā was then told by the Lord the gist of *Srimad-Bhagavatam* in four original verses. Thus *Srimad-Bhagavatam* is not a creation of the mental speculators. The sound of *Srimad-Bhagavatam* is transcendental, and the resonance of *Srimad-Bhagavatam* is as good as that of the *Vedas*. Thus the topic of the *Srimad-Bhagavatam* is the science of both the Lord and the living entity. Regular reading or hearing of *Srimad-Bhagavatam* is also performance of *bhakti-yoga*, and one can attain the highest perfection simply by the association of *Srimad-Bhagavatam*. Both Sukadeva Gosvami and Maharaja Pariksit attained perfection through the medium of *Srimad-Bhagavatam*.

TEXT 5

Sa Aaiddevae JaGaTaa& Parae Gauã"
SviDaZ<YaMaaSQaaYa iSaSa*+aYaE+aTa)
Taa& NaaDYaGaC^d(d*XaMa}a SaMMaTaa&
Pa[PaÄiNaMaaR<aiviDaYaRYaa >aveTa()) 5))

sa ädi-devo jagatää paro guruù

svadhiñëyam ästhäya sisåkñayaikñata

tää nädhyagacchad dâçam atra sammatää

prapaïca-nirmäëa-vidhir yayä bhavet

SYNONYMS

saù—he; *ädi-devaù*—the first demigod; *jagatäm*—of the universe; *paraù*—supreme; *guruù*—spiritual master; *svadhiñëyam*—his lotus seat; *ästhäya*—to find the source of it; *sisåkñayä*—for the matter of creating the universal affairs; *aikñata*—began to think; *täm*—in that matter; *na*—could not; *adhyagacchat*—understand; *dâçam*—the direction; *atra*—therein; *sammatäm*—just the proper way; *prapaïca*—material; *nirmäëa*—construction; *vidhiù*—process; *yayä*—as much as; *bhavet*—should be.

TRANSLATION

Lord Brahmä, the first spiritual master, supreme in the universe, could not trace out the source of his lotus seat, and while thinking of creating the material world, he could not understand the proper direction for such creative work, nor could he find out the process for such creation.

PURPORT

This verse is the prelude for explaining the transcendental nature of the form and the abode of the Lord. In the beginning of *Srimad-Bhagavatam* it has already been said that the Supreme Absolute Truth exists in His own

abode without any touch of the deluding energy. Therefore the kingdom of God is not a myth but factually a different and transcendental sphere of planets known as the Vaikunthas. This will also be explained in this chapter.

Such knowledge of the spiritual sky far above this material sky and its paraphernalia can be known only by dint of devotional service, or *bhakti-yoga*. The power of creation by Lord Brahmā was also achieved by *bhakti-yoga*. Brahmājé was bewildered in the matter of creation, and he could not even trace out the source of his own existence. But all this knowledge was fully achieved by him through the medium of *bhakti-yoga*. By *bhakti-yoga* one can know the Lord, and by knowing the Lord as the Supreme, one is able to know everything else. One who knows the Supreme knows everything else. That is the version of all *Vedas*. Even the first spiritual master of the universe was enlightened by the grace of the Lord, so who else can attain perfect knowledge of everything without the mercy of the Lord? If anyone desires to seek perfect knowledge of everything, he must seek the mercy of the Lord, and there is no other means. To seek knowledge on the strength of one's personal attempt is a sheer waste of time.

TEXT 6

Sa icNTaYaNa(Üy+arMaek-daM>a,
SYauPaaé*<aaed(iÜGaRidTa& vcae iv>au")
SPaXaeRzu YaTzae@XaMaek-iv&Xa&
iNaiZk-ÄNaaNaa& Na*Pa Yad(DaNa& ivdu")) 6))

sa cintayan dvy-akñaram ekadämbhasy

upäçåëod dvir-gaditaà vaco vibhuù

sparçeñu yat ñoðaçam ekaviðçaà

niñkiicanänää nāpa yad dhanaà viduù

SYNONYMS

saù—he; *cintayan*—while thus thinking; *dvi*—two; *akñaram*—syllables; *ekadä*—once upon a time; *ambhasi*—in the water; *upäçåëot*—heard it nearby; *dviù*—twice; *gaditam*—uttered; *vacaù*—words; *vibhuù*—the great; *sparçeñu*—in the *sparça* letters; *yat*—which; *ñoòaçam*—the sixteenth; *ekaviàçam*—and the twenty-first; *niñkiicanänäm*—of the renounced order of life; *nåpa*—O King; *yat*—what is; *dhanam*—wealth; *viduù*—as it is known.

TRANSLATION

While thus engaged in thinking, in the water, Brahmäjé heard twice from nearby two syllables joined together. One of the syllables was taken from the sixteenth and the other from the twenty-first of the *sparça* alphabets, and both joined to become the wealth of the renounced order of life.

PURPORT

In Sanskrit language, the consonant alphabets are divided into two divisions, namely the *sparça-varëas* and the *tälavya-varëas*. From *ka* to *ma* the letters are known as the *sparça-varëas*, and the sixteenth of the group is called *ta*, whereas the twenty-first letter is called *pa*. So when they are joined together, the word *tapa*, or penance, is constructed. This penance is the beauty and wealth of the *brahmanas* and the renounced order of life. According to *Bhägavata* philosophy, every human being is meant simply for this *tapa* and for no other business, because by penance only can one realize his self; and self-realization, not sense gratification, is the business of human life. This *tapa*, or penance, was begun from the very beginning of the creation, and it was first adopted by the supreme spiritual master, Lord Brahmä. By *tapasya* only can one get the profit of human life, and not by a polished civilization of animal life. The animal does not know anything except sense gratification in the jurisdiction of eat, drink, be merry and enjoy. But the human being is made to undergo *tapasya* for going back to Godhead, back home.

When Lord Brahmä was perplexed about how to construct the material manifestations in the universe and went down within the water to find out the means and the source of his lotus seat, he heard the word *tapa*

vibrated twice. Taking the path of *tapa* is the second birth of the desiring disciple. The word *upāçāṣṭ* is very significant. It is similar to *upanayana*, or bringing the disciple nearer to the spiritual master for the path of *tapa*. So Brahmājé was thus initiated by Lord Kṛṣṇa, and this fact is corroborated by Brahmājé himself in his book the *Brahma-saṁhitā*. In the *Brahma-saṁhitā* Lord Brahmā has sung in every verse *govindam ādi-puruṣaà tam ahaà bhajāmi ***. Thus Brahmā was initiated by the Kṛṣṇa *mantra*, by Lord Kṛṣṇa Himself, and thus he became a Vaiñēava, or a devotee of the Lord, before he was able to construct the huge universe. It is stated in the *Brahma-saṁhitā* that Lord Brahmā was initiated into the eighteen-letter Kṛṣṇa *mantra*, which is generally accepted by all the devotees of Lord Kṛṣṇa. We follow the same principle because we belong to the Brahmā *sampradāya*, directly in the disciplic chain from Brahmā to Nārada, from Nārada to Vyāsa, from Vyāsa to Madhva Muni, from Madhva Muni to Mādhavendra Puré, from Mādhavendra Puré to Éçvara Puré, from Éçvara Puré to Lord Caitanya and gradually to His Divine Grace Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvaté, our divine master.

One who is thus initiated in the disciplic succession is able to achieve the same result or power of creation. Chanting of this holy *mantra* is the only shelter of the desireless pure devotee of the Lord. Simply by such *tapasya*, or penance, the devotee of the Lord achieves all perfections like Lord Brahmā.

TEXT 7

**iNaXaMYa TaÜç*-idd*+aYaa idXaae
ivl/aeKYa Ta}aaNYadPaXYaMaaNa")
SviDaZ<YaMaaSQaaYa ivMa*XYa TaiÖTa&
TaPaSYauPaaidí wvadDae MaNa")) 7))**

niçamya tad-vaktā-didākñayā diço

vilokya tatrānyad apaçyamānaù

svadhiñēyam āsthāya vimāçya tad-dhitaà

tapasy upädiñña ivädadhe manaù

SYNONYMS

niçamyä—after hearing; *tat*—that; *vaktā*—the speaker; *didāṅñayä*—just to find out who spoke; *diçaù*—all sides; *vilokya*—seeing; *tatra*—there; *anyat*—any other; *apaçyamānaù*—not to be found; *svadhiññeyam*—on his lotus seat; *ästhäya*—sit down; *vimāçya*—thinking; *tat*—it; *hitam*—welfare; *tapasi*—in penance; *upädiññaù*—as he was instructed; *iva*—in pursuance of; *ädadhe*—gave; *manaù*—attention.

TRANSLATION

When he heard the sound, he tried to find the speaker, searching on all sides. But when he was unable to find anyone besides himself, he thought it wise to sit down on his lotus seat firmly and give his attention to the execution of penance, as he was instructed.

PURPORT

To achieve success in life, one should follow the example of Lord Brahmä, the first living creature in the beginning of creation. After being initiated by the Supreme Lord to execute *tapasya*, he was fixed in his determination to do it, and although he could not find anyone besides himself, he could rightly understand that the sound was transmitted by the Lord Himself. Brahmä was the only living being at that time because there was no other creation and none could be found there except himself. In the beginning of the First Canto, in the First Chapter, first verse, of the *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, it has already been mentioned that Brahmä was initiated by the Lord from within. The Lord is within every living entity as the Supersoul, and He initiated Brahmä because Brahmä was willing to receive the initiation. The Lord can similarly initiate everyone who is inclined to have it.

As already stated, Brahmä is the original spiritual master for the universe, and since he was initiated by the Lord Himself, the message of *Srimad-Bhagavatam* is coming down by disciplic succession, and in order to receive the real message of *Srimad-Bhagavatam* one should approach the current

link, or spiritual master, in the chain of disciplic succession. After being initiated by the proper spiritual master in that chain of succession, one should engage himself in the discharge of *tapasya* in the execution of devotional service. One should not, however, think himself on the level of Brahmä to be initiated directly by the Lord from inside because in the present age no one can be accepted to be as pure as Brahmä. The post of Brahmä to officiate in the creation of the universe is offered to the most pure living being, and unless one is so qualified one cannot expect to be treated like Brahmäjé directly. But one can have the same facility through unalloyed devotees of the Lord, through scriptural instructions (as revealed in the *Bhagavad-gita* and *Srimad-Bhagavatam* especially), and also through the bona fide spiritual master available to the sincere soul. The Lord Himself appears as the spiritual master to a person who is sincere in heart about serving the Lord. Therefore the bona fide spiritual master who happens to meet the sincere devotee should be accepted as the most confidential and beloved representative of the Lord. If a person is posted under the guidance of such a bona fide spiritual master, it may be accepted without any doubt that the desiring person has achieved the grace of the Lord.

TEXT 8

idVYa& SahóabDmaMaaegadXaRNaae
iJaTaaINal/aTMaa iviJaTaae>aYaeiNd]Ya")
ATaPYaTa SMaaI%I/I/aek-TaaPaNa&
TaPaSTaPaqYaa&STaPaTaa& SaMaaihTa")) 8))

divyaà sahasrābdam amogha-darçano

jitānilātmā vijitobhayendriyaù

atapyata smākhila-loka-tāpanaà

tapas tapéyääs tapatää samāhitaù

SYNONYMS

divyam—pertaining to the demigods in the higher planets; *sahasra*—one thousand; *abdam*—years; *amogha*—spotless, without a tinge of impurity; *darçanaù*—one who has such a vision of life; *jita*—controlled; *anila*—life; *ātmā*—mind; *vijita*—controlled over; *ubhaya*—both; *indriyaù*—one who has such senses; *atapyata*—executed penance; *sma*—in the past; *akhila*—all; *loka*—planet; *tāpanam*—enlightening; *tapaù*—penance; *tapéyān*—extremely hard penance; *tapatām*—of all the executors of penances; *samāhitaù*—thus situated.

TRANSLATION

Lord Brahmā underwent penances for one thousand years by the calculations of the demigods. He heard this transcendental vibration from the sky, and he accepted it as divine. Thus he controlled his mind and senses, and the penances he executed were a great lesson for the living entities. Thus he is known as the greatest of all ascetics.

PURPORT

Lord Brahmā heard the occult sound *tapa*, but he did not see the person who vibrated the sound. And still he accepted the instruction as beneficial for him, and therefore he engaged himself in meditation for one thousand celestial years. One celestial year is equal to 6 x 30 x 12 x 1000 of our years. His acceptance of the sound was due to his pure vision of the absolute nature of the Lord. And due to his correct vision, he made no distinction between the Lord and the Lord’s instruction. There is no difference between the Lord and sound vibration coming from Him, even though He is not personally present. The best way of understanding is to accept such divine instruction, and Brahmā, the prime spiritual master of everyone, is the living example of this process of receiving transcendental knowledge. The potency of transcendental sound is never minimized because the vibrator is apparently absent. Therefore *Srimad-Bhagavatam* or *Bhagavad-gita* or any revealed scripture in the world is never to be accepted as an ordinary mundane sound without transcendental potency.

One has to receive the transcendental sound from the right source, accept it as a reality and prosecute the direction without hesitation. The secret of

success is to receive the sound from the right source of a bona fide spiritual master. Mundane manufactured sound has no potency, and as such, seemingly transcendental sound received from an unauthorized person also has no potency. One should be qualified enough to discern such transcendental potency, and either by discriminating or by fortunate chance if one is able to receive the transcendental sound from the bona fide spiritual master, his path of liberation is guaranteed. The disciple, however, must be ready to execute the order of the bona fide spiritual master as Lord Brahmä executed the instruction of his spiritual master, the Lord Himself. Following the order of the bona fide spiritual master is the only duty of the disciple, and this completely faithful execution of the order of the bona fide spiritual master is the secret of success.

Lord Brahmä controlled his two grades of senses by means of sense perception and sense organs because he had to engage such senses in the execution of the order of the Lord. Therefore controlling the senses means engaging them in the transcendental service of the Lord. The Lord's order descends in disciplic succession through the bona fide spiritual master, and thus execution of the order of the bona fide spiritual master is factual control of the senses. Such execution of penance in full faith and sincerity made Brahmäjé so powerful that he became the creator of the universe. And because he was able to attain such power, he is called the best amongst all the *tapasvés*.

TEXT 9

TaSMaE Svl/aek&- >aGavaNa(Sa>aaiJaTa"
SaNdXaRYaaMaaSa Par& Na YaTParMa()
VYaPaeTaSa&©e-XaivMaaehSaaßSa&
Svd*íviÛPauRâzEri>aíuTaMa()) 9))

tasmai sva-lokaà bhagavän sabhäjitaù

sandarçayäm äsa paraà na yat-param

vyapeta-saikleça-vimoha-sädhvasaà

sva-dāñöavadbhir puruṣair abhiñöutam

SYNONYMS

tasmai—unto him; *sva-lokam*—His own planet or abode; *bhagavān*—the Personality of Godhead; *sabhājitaù*—being pleased by the penance of Brahmā; *sandarçayām äsa*—manifested; *param*—the supreme; *na*—not; *yat*—of which; *param*—further supreme; *vyapeta*—completely given up; *saikleça*—five kinds of material afflictions; *vimoha*—without illusion; *sādhvasam*—fear of material existence; *sva-dāñöa-vadbhiù*—by those who have perfectly realized the self; *puruṣaiù*—by persons; *abhiñöutam*—worshiped by.

TRANSLATION

The Personality of Godhead, being thus very much satisfied with the penance of Lord Brahmā, was pleased to manifest His personal abode, Vaikuntha, the supreme planet above all others. This transcendental abode of the Lord is adored by all self-realized persons freed from all kinds of miseries and fear of illusory existence.

PURPORT

The troubles of penance accepted by Lord Brahmā were certainly in the line of devotional service (*bhakti*). Otherwise there was no chance that Vaikuntha or *svalokam*, the Lord's personal abodes, would become visible to Brahmäjé. The personal abodes of the Lord, known as Vaikunthas, are neither mythical nor material, as conceived by the impersonalists. But realization of the transcendental abodes of the Lord is possible only through devotional service, and thus the devotees enter into such abodes. There is undoubtedly trouble in executing penance. But the trouble accepted in executing *bhakti-yoga* is transcendental happiness from the very beginning, whereas the trouble of penance in other processes of self-realization (*jñāna-yoga*, *dhyāna-yoga*, etc.), without any Vaikuntha realization, ends in trouble only and nothing more. There is no profit in biting husks without grains. Similarly, there is no profit in executing troublesome penances other than *bhakti-yoga* for self-realization.

Executing *bhakti-yoga* is exactly like sitting on the lotus sprouted out of the abdomen of the transcendental Personality of Godhead, for Lord Brahmā was seated there. Brahmājé was able to please the Lord, and the Lord was also pleased to show Brahmājé His personal abode. Srila Jiva Gosvami, in the comments of his *Krama-sandarbha* annotation of *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, cites quotations from the *Garga Upaniṣad* Vedic evidence. It is said that Yājñavalkya described the transcendental abode of the Lord to Gärgé, and that the abode of the Lord is situated above the highest planet of the universe, namely Brahmāloka. This abode of the Lord, although described in revealed scriptures like the *Bhagavad-gita* and the *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, remains only a myth for the less intelligent class of men with a poor fund of knowledge. Herein the word *sva-dāññāvadbhīu* is very significant. One who has actually realized his self realizes the transcendental form of one's self. Impersonal realization of self and the Supreme is not complete, because it is just an opposite conception of material personalities. The Personality of Godhead and the personalities of devotees of the Lord are all transcendental; they do not have material bodies. The material body is overcast with five kinds of miserable conditions, namely ignorance, material conception, attachment, hatred and absorption. As long as one is overwhelmed by those five kinds of material miseries, there is no question of entering into the Vaikunthalokas. The impersonal conception of one's self is just the negation of material personality and is far from the positive existence of personal form. The personal forms of the transcendental abode will be explained in the following verses. Brahmājé also described the highest planet of the Vaikunthaloka as Goloka Vāndāvana, where the Lord resides as a cowherd boy keeping transcendental *surabhi* cows and surrounded by hundreds and thousands of goddesses of fortune.

*cintāmaëi-prakara-sadmasu kalpa-vākñā-
lakñävâteñu surabhér abhipālayantam
lakñmé-sahasra-çata-sambhrama-sevyamānaà
govindam ädi-puruṣaà tam ahaà bhajāmi*

(*Brahma-saṁhitā* 5.29)

The statement of the *Bhagavad-gita*, *yad gatvā na nivartante tad dhāma paramaà mama* [Bg. 15.6], is also confirmed herewith. *param* means

transcendental Brahman. Therefore, the abode of the Lord is also Brahman, nondifferent from the Supreme Personality of Godhead. The Lord is known as Vaikuntha, and His abode is also known as Vaikuntha. Such Vaikuntha realization and worship can be made possible by transcendental form and sense.

TEXT 10

**Pa[vTaRTae Ya}a rJaSTaMaSTaYaae"
Satv& c iMaé[& Na c k-al/ivṣ-Ma")
Na Ya}a MaaYaa ik-MauTaaPare hre,
rNauv]Taa Ya}a SauraSauraicRTaa")) 10))**

pravartate yatra rajas tamas tayoù

sattvaà ca miçraà na ca kâla-vikramaù

na yatra mâyä kim utäpare harer

anuvratä yatra suräsurärcitäu

SYNONYMS

pravartate—prevail; *yatra*—wherein; *rajaù tamaù*—the modes of passion and ignorance; *tayoù*—of both of them; *sattvam*—the mode of goodness; *ca*—and; *miçram*—mixture; *na*—never; *ca*—and; *kâla*—time; *vikramaù*—influence; *na*—neither; *yatra*—therein; *mâyä*—illusory, external energy; *kim*—what; *uta*—there is; *apare*—others; *hareù*—of the Personality of Godhead; *anuvratäù*—devotees; *yatra*—wherein; *sura*—by the demigods; *asura*—and the demons; *arcitäu*—worshiped.

TRANSLATION

In that personal abode of the Lord, the material modes of ignorance and passion do not prevail, nor is there any of their influence in goodness. There is no predominance of the influence of time, so what to speak of the illusory, external energy; it cannot enter that region. Without

discrimination, both the demigods and the demons worship the Lord as devotees.

PURPORT

The kingdom of God, or the atmosphere of the Vaikuntha nature, which is called the *tripād-vibhūti*, is three times bigger than the material universes and is described here, as also in the *Bhagavad-gita*, in a nutshell. This universe, containing billions of stars and planets, is one of the billions of such universes clustered together within the compass of the *mahat-tattva*. And all these millions and billions of universes combined together constitute only one fourth of the magnitude of the whole creation of the Lord. There is the spiritual sky also; beyond this sky are the spiritual planets under the names of Vaikuntha, and all of them constitute three fourths of the entire creation of the Lord. God's creations are always innumerable. Even the leaves of a tree cannot be counted by a man, nor can the hairs on his head. However, foolish men are puffed up with the idea of becoming God Himself, though unable to create a hair of their own bodies. Man may discover so many wonderful vehicles of journey, but even if he reaches the moon by his much advertised spacecraft, he cannot remain there. The sane man, therefore, without being puffed up, as if he were the God of the universe, abides by the instructions of the Vedic literature, the easiest way to acquire knowledge in transcendence. So let us know through the authority of *Srimad-Bhagavatam* of the nature and constitution of the transcendental world beyond the material sky. In that sky the material qualities, especially the modes of ignorance and passion, are completely absent. The mode of ignorance influences a living entity to the habit of lust and hankering, and this means that in the Vaikunthalokas the living entities are free from these two things. As confirmed in the *Bhagavad-gita*, in the *brahma-bhūta* stage of life one becomes free from hankering and lamentation. Therefore the conclusion is that the inhabitants of the Vaikuntha planets are all *brahma-bhūta* living entities, as distinguished from the mundane creatures who are all compact in hankering and lamentation. When one is not in the modes of ignorance and passion, one is supposed to be situated in the mode of goodness in the material world. Goodness in the material world also at times becomes contaminated by touches of the modes of passion and ignorance. In the Vaikunthaloka, it is

unalloyed goodness only.

The whole situation there is one of freedom from the illusory manifestation of the external energy. Although illusory energy is also part and parcel of the Supreme Lord, illusory energy is differentiated from the Lord. The illusory energy is not, however, false, as claimed by the monist philosophers. The rope accepted as a snake may be an illusion to a particular person, but the rope is a fact, and the snake is also a fact. The illusion of water on the hot desert may be illusion for the ignorant animal searching for water in the desert, but the desert and water are actual facts. Therefore the material creation of the Lord may be an illusion to the nondevotee, but to a devotee even the material creation of the Lord is a fact, as the manifestation of His external energy. But this energy of the Lord is not all. The Lord has His internal energy also, which has another creation known to be the Vaikunthalokas, where there is no ignorance, no passion, no illusion and no past and present. With a poor fund of knowledge one may be unable to understand the existence of such things as the Vaikuntha atmosphere, but that does not nullify its existence. That spacecraft cannot reach these planets does not mean that there are no such planets, for they are described in the revealed scriptures.

As quoted by Srila Jiva Gosvami, we can know from the *Nārada-pāñcarātra* that the transcendental world or Vaikuntha atmosphere is enriched with transcendental qualities. These transcendental qualities, as revealed through the devotional service of the Lord, are distinct from the mundane qualities of ignorance, passion and goodness. Such qualities are not attainable by the nondevotee class of men. In the *Padma Purana*, *Uttara-khaṇḍa*, it is stated that beyond the one-fourth part of God's creation is the three-fourths manifestation. The marginal line between the material manifestation and the spiritual manifestation is the Virajā River, and beyond the Virajā, which is a transcendental current flowing from the perspiration of the body of the Lord, there is the three-fourths manifestation of God's creation. This part is eternal, everlasting, without deterioration, and unlimited, and it contains the highest perfectional stage of living conditions. In the *Sāikhya-kaumudī* it is stated that unalloyed goodness or transcendence is just opposite to the material modes. All living entities there are eternally associated without any break, and the Lord is

the chief and prime entity. In the *Āgama Puranas* also, the transcendental abode is described as follows: The associated members there are free to go everywhere within the creation of the Lord, and there is no limit to such creation, particularly in the region of the three-fourths magnitude. Since the nature of that region is unlimited, there is no history of such association, nor is there end of it.

The conclusion may be drawn that because of the complete absence of the mundane qualities of ignorance and passion, there is no question of creation nor of annihilation. In the material world everything is created, and everything is annihilated, and the duration of life between the creation and annihilation is temporary. In the transcendental realm there is no creation and no destruction, and thus the duration of life is eternal unlimitedly. In other words, everything in the transcendental world is everlasting, full of knowledge and bliss without deterioration. Since there is no deterioration, there is no past, present and future in the estimation of time. It is clearly stated in this verse that the influence of time is conspicuous by its absence. The whole material existence is manifested by actions and reactions of elements which make the influence of time prominent in the matter of past, present and future. There are no such actions and reactions of cause and effects there, so the cycle of birth, growth, existence, transformations, deterioration and annihilation—the six material changes—are not existent there. It is the unalloyed manifestation of the energy of the Lord, without illusion as experienced here in the material world. The whole Vaikuntha existence proclaims that everyone there is a follower of the Lord. The Lord is the chief leader there, without any competition for leadership, and the people in general are all followers of the Lord. It is confirmed in the *Vedas*, therefore, that the Lord is the chief leader and all other living entities are subordinate to Him, for only the Lord satisfies all the needs of all other living entities.

TEXT 11

**XYaaMaavdaTaa" XaTaPa}al/aecNaa"
iPaXa®vña" Sauăc" SauPaeXaSa")
SaveR cTaubaRhv oiNMazNMai<a,
Pa[vek-iNaZk-a>ar<aa" SauvcrSa")) 11))**

çyämävadätäù çata-patra-locanäù

piçaiga-vasträù surucaù supeçasaù

sarve catur-bähava unmiñan-maëi-

praveka-niñkäbharaëäù suvarcasaù

SYNONYMS

çyäma—sky-bluish; *avadätäù*—glowing; *çata-patra*—lotus flower; *locanäù*—eyes; *piçaiga*—yellowish; *vasträù*—clothing; *su-rucaù*—greatly attractive; *su-peçasaù*—growing youthful; *sarve*—all of them; *catuù*—four; *bähavaù*—hands; *unmiñan*—rising luster; *maëi*—pearls; *praveka*—superior quality; *niñka-äbharaëäù*—ornamental medallions; *su-varcasaù*—effulgent.

TRANSLATION

The inhabitants of the Vaikuntha planets are described as having a glowing sky-bluish complexion. Their eyes resemble lotus flowers, their dress is of yellowish color, and their bodily features very attractive. They are just the age of growing youths, they all have four hands, they are all nicely decorated with pearl necklaces with ornamental medallions, and they all appear to be effulgent.

PURPORT

The inhabitants in Vaikunthaloka are all personalities with spiritual bodily features not to be found in the material world. We can find the descriptions in the revealed scriptures like *Srimad-Bhagavatam*. Impersonal descriptions of transcendence in the scriptures indicate that the bodily features in Vaikunthaloka are never to be seen in any part of the universe. As there are different bodily features in different places of a particular planet, or as there are different bodily features between bodies in different planets, similarly the bodily features of the inhabitants in Vaikunthaloka are completely different from those in the material universe. For example, the four hands are distinct from the two hands in this world.

TEXT 12

Pa[val/vEdUYaRMa*<aal/vcRSa")
PairSfu-rTku-<@I/MaaEil/Maaail/Na")) 12))

pravāla-vaidūrya-māëāla-varcasaù

parisphurat-kuëðala-mauli-mālinaù

SYNONYMS

pravāla—coral; *vaidūrya*—a special diamond; *māëāla*—celestial lotus; *varcasaù*—rays; *parisphurat*—blooming; *kuëðala*—earring; *mauli*—heads; *mālinaù*—with garlands.

TRANSLATION

Some of them are effulgent like coral and diamonds in complexion and have garlands on their heads, blooming like lotus flowers, and some wear earrings.

PURPORT

There are some inhabitants who have attained the liberation of *sārūpya*, or possessing bodily features like those of the Personality of Godhead. The *vaidūrya* diamond is especially meant for the Personality of Godhead, but one who achieves the liberation of bodily equality with the Lord is especially favored with such diamonds on his body.

TEXT 13

>a]aiJaZ<au>aYaR" PairTaae ivraJaTae
I/SaiÜMaaNaavil/i>aMaRhaTMaNaaMa()
ivÜaeTaMaaNa" Pa[MadaetaMaaÜui>a"
SaivÜud>a]avil/i>aYaRQaa Na>a")) 13))

bhräjiñëubhir yaù parito viräjate

lasad-vimänävalibhir mahätmanäm

vidyotamānaù pramadottamädyubhiù

savidyud abhrävalibhir yathä nabhaù

SYNONYMS

bhräjiñëubhiù—by the glowing; *yaù*—the Vaikunthalokas; *paritaù*—surrounded by; *viräjate*—thus situated; *lasat*—brilliant; *vimāna*—airplanes; *avalibhiù*—assemblage; *mahä-ätmanäm*—of the great devotees of the Lord; *vidyotamānaù*—beautiful like lightning; *pramada*—ladies; *uttama*—celestial; *adyubhiù*—by complexion; *sa-vidyut*—with electric lightning; *abhrävalibhiù*—with clouds in the sky; *yathä*—as it were; *nabhaù*—the sky.

TRANSLATION

The Vaikuntha planets are also surrounded by various airplanes, all glowing and brilliantly situated. These airplanes belong to the great mahätmas or devotees of the Lord. The ladies are as beautiful as lightning because of their celestial complexions, and all these combined together appear just like the sky decorated with both clouds and lightning.

PURPORT

It appears that in the Vaikuntha planets there are also airplanes brilliantly glowing, and they are occupied by the great devotees of the Lord with ladies of celestial beauty as brilliant as lightning. As there are airplanes, so there must be different types of carriages like airplanes, but they may not be driven machines, as we have experience in this world. Because everything is of the same nature of eternity, bliss and knowledge, the airplanes and carriages are of the same quality as Brahman. Although there is nothing except Brahman, one should not mistakenly think that there is only void and no variegatedness. Thinking like that is due to a poor fund of knowledge; otherwise no one would have such a misconception of voidness in Brahman. As there are airplanes, ladies and gentlemen, so there must be cities and houses and everything else just suitable to the particular planets.

One should not carry the ideas of imperfection from this world to the transcendental world and not take into consideration the nature of the atmosphere, as completely free from the influence of time, etc., as described previously.

TEXT 14

é[qYaR}a æiPa<YauåGaaYaPaadYaae"
k-raeiTa MaaNa& bhuDaa iv>aUiTai>a")
Pa[e«& ié[Taa Yaa ku-SauMaak-raNauGaE,
ivRGaqYaMaaNaa iPa[Yak-MaR GaaYaTaq)) 14))

çréṛ yatra rūpiëy urugäya-pädayoṁ

karoti mānaà bahudhā vibhūtibhiṁ

preikhaà çritā yā kusumākarānugair

vigéyamānā priya-karma gāyaté

SYNONYMS

çréṁ—the goddess of fortune; *yatra*—in the Vaikuntha planets; *rūpiëé*—in her transcendental form; *urugäya*—the Lord, who is sung of by the great devotees; *pädayoṁ*—under the lotus feet of the Lord; *karoti*—does; *mānam*—respectful services; *bahudhā*—in diverse paraphernalia; *vibhūtibhiṁ*—accompanied by her personal associates; *preikham*—movement of enjoyment; *çritā*—taken shelter of; *yā*—who; *kusumākara*—spring; *anugaiṁ*—by the black bees; *vigéyamānā*—being followed by the songs; *priya-karma*—activities of the dearmost; *gāyaté*—singing.

TRANSLATION

The goddess of fortune in her transcendental form is engaged in the loving service of the Lord's lotus feet, and being moved by the black bees, followers of spring, she is not only engaged in variegated pleasure—service to the Lord, along with her constant companions—but is also

engaged in singing the glories of the Lord's activities.

TEXT 15

ddXaR Ta}aai%l/SaaTvTaa& PaiTa&
ié[Ya" PaiTa& YajPaiTa& JaGaTPaiTaMa()
SauNaNdNaNdPa[bl/ahR<aaidi>a"
SvPaazRdaGa]E" PairSaeivTa& iv>auMa()) 15))

dadarça tatrākhila-sātvatāà patià

çriyaù patià yajña-patià jagat-patim

sunanda-nanda-prabalārhaëädibhiù

sva-pārñadāgraiù parisevitaà vibhum

SYNONYMS

dadarça—Brahmā saw; *tatra*—there (in Vaikunthaloka); *akhila*—entire; *sātvatām*—of the great devotees; *patim*—the Lord; *çriyaù*—of the goddess of fortune; *patim*—the Lord; *yajña*—of sacrifice; *patim*—the Lord; *jagat*—of the universe; *patim*—the Lord; *sunanda*—Sunanda; *nanda*—Nanda; *prabala*—Prabala; *arhaëa*—Arhaëa; *ädibhiù*—by them; *sva-pārñada*—own associates; *agraiù*—by the foremost; *parisevitam*—being served in transcendental love; *vibhum*—the great Almighty.

TRANSLATION

Lord Brahmā saw in the Vaikuntha planets the Personality of Godhead, who is the Lord of the entire devotee community, the Lord of the goddess of fortune, the Lord of all sacrifices, and the Lord of the universe, and who is served by the foremost servitors like Nanda, Sunanda, Prabala and Arhaëa, His immediate associates.

PURPORT

When we speak of a king it is naturally understood that the king is accompanied by his confidential associates, like his secretary, private secretary, aide-de-camp, ministers and advisers. So also when we see the Lord we see Him with His different energies, associates, confidential servitors, etc. So the Supreme Lord, who is the leader of all living entities, the Lord of all devotee sects, the Lord of all opulences, the Lord of sacrifices and the enjoyer of everything in His entire creation, is not only the Supreme Person, but also is always surrounded by His immediate associates, all engaged in their loving transcendental service to Him.

TEXT 16

>a*TYaPa[Saadai>aMau%& d*GaaSav&
Pa[SaàhaSaaâ<al/aecNaaNaNaMa()
ik-rqi\$=Na& ku-<@il/Na& cTau>auRJa&
PaqTaa&éuk&- v+aiSa l/i+aTa& ié[Yaa)) 16))

bhâtya-prasädäbhimukhaà dâg-äsavaà

prasanna-häsäruëa-locanānanam

kiréöinaà kuëòalinaà catur-bhujaà

pétäàçukaà vakñasi lakñitaà çriyä

SYNONYMS

bhâtya—the servitor; *prasäda*—affection; *abhimukham*—favorably facing; *dâk*—the very sight; *äsavam*—an intoxication; *prasanna*—very much pleased; *häsa*—smile; *aruëa*—reddish; *locana*—eyes; *ānanam*—face; *kiréöinam*—with helmet; *kuëòalinam*—with earrings; *catuù-bhujam*—with four hands; *péta*—yellow; *aàçukam*—dress; *vakñasi*—on the chest; *lakñitam*—marked; *çriyä*—with the goddess of fortune.

TRANSLATION

The Personality of Godhead, seen leaning favorably towards His loving

servitors, His very sight intoxicating and attractive, appeared to be very much satisfied. He had a smiling face decorated with an enchanting reddish hue. He was dressed in yellow robes and wore earrings and a helmet on his head. He had four hands, and His chest was marked with the lines of the goddess of fortune.

PURPORT

In the *Padma Purana*, *Uttara-khaṇḍa*, there is a full description of the *yoga-péöha*, or the particular place where the Lord is in audience to His eternal devotees. In that *yoga-péöha*, the personifications of religion, knowledge, opulence and renunciation are all seated at the lotus feet of the Lord. The four *Vedas*, namely *Āk*, *Sāma*, *Yajur* and *Atharva*, are present there personally to advise the Lord. The sixteen energies headed by Caëòà are all present there. Caëòà and Kumuda are the first two doorkeepers, at the middle door are the doorkeepers named Bhadra and Subhadra, and at the last door are Jaya and Vijaya. There are other doorkeepers also, named Kumuda, Kumudäkñā, Puëòàréka, Vāmana, Çaikukarëa, Sarvanetra, Sumukha, etc. The Lord's palace is well decorated and protected by the above-mentioned doorkeepers.

TEXT 17

ADYahR<aqYaaSaNaMaaiSQaTa& Par&
v*Ta& cTau"zae@XaPaÄXaiç-i>a")
Yauç&- >aGaE" SvEirTar}a caDa]uvE"
Sv Wv DaaMaNa(rMaMaa<aMaqìrMa()) 17))

adhyarhaëéyāsanam āsthitaà paraà

vātaà catuè-ñòòaçā-pāica-çaktibhiù

yuktaà bhagaiù svair itaratra cādhruvaiù

sva eva dhāman ramamäëam éçvaram

SYNONYMS

adhyarhaëéya—greatly worshipable; *äsanam*—throne; *ästhitam*—seated on it; *param*—the Supreme; *vâtam*—surrounded by; *catuù*—four, namely *prakâti*, *puruṣa*, *mahat* and ego; *ñoḍaça*—the sixteen; *pañca*—the five; *çaktibhiù*—by the energies; *yuktam*—empowered with; *bhagaiù*—His opulences; *svaiù*—personal; *itaratra*—other minor prowesses; *ca*—also; *adhruvaiù*—temporary; *sve*—own; *eva*—certainly; *dhäman*—abode; *ramamäëam*—enjoying; *éçvaram*—the Supreme Lord.

TRANSLATION

The Lord was seated on His throne and was surrounded by different energies like the four, the sixteen, the five, and the six natural opulences, along with other insignificant energies of the temporary character. But He was the factual Supreme Lord, enjoying His own abode.

PURPORT

The Lord is naturally endowed with His six opulences. Specifically, He is the richest, He is the most powerful, He is the most famous, He is the most beautiful, He is the greatest in knowledge, and He is the greatest renouncer as well. And for His material creative energies, He is served by four, namely the principles of *prakâti*, *puruṣa*, *mahat-tattva* and ego. He is also served by the sixteen, namely the five elements (earth, water, air, fire and sky), the five perceptive sense organs (the eye, ear, nose, tongue and skin), and the five working sense organs (the hand, the leg, the stomach, the evacuation outlet and the genitals), and the mind. The five includes the sense objects, namely form, taste, smell, sound and touch. All these twenty-five items serve the Lord in the material creation, and all of them are personally present to serve the Lord. The insignificant opulences numbering eight (the *añña-siddhis*, attained by *yogis* for temporary overlordship) are also under His control, but He is naturally full with all such powers without any effort, and therefore He is the Supreme Lord.

The living being, by severe penance and performance of bodily exercises, can temporarily attain some wonderful power, but that does not make him the Supreme Lord. The Supreme Lord, by His own potency, is unlimitedly more powerful than any *yogé*, He is unlimitedly more learned than any

jïäné, He is unlimitedly richer than any wealthy person, He is unlimitedly more beautiful than any beautiful living being, and He is unlimitedly more charitable than any philanthropist. He is above all; no one is equal to or greater than Him. Nor can anyone reach His level of perfection in any of the above powers by any amount of penance or yogic demonstrations. The *yogis* are dependent on His mercy. Out of His immensely charitable disposition He can award some temporary powers to the *yogis* because of the *yogis* hankering after them, but to His unalloyed devotees, who do not want anything from the Lord save and except His transcendental service, the Lord is so pleased that He gives Himself in exchange for unalloyed service.

TEXT 18

TaÕXaRNaaúadPairPlu/TaaNTarae
ôZYataNau" Pa[eMa>araé[ul/aecNa")
NaNaaMa PaadaMbuJaMaSYa ivìSa*Ga(
YaTa(PaarMah&SYaeNa PaQaaDaGaMYaTae)) 18))

tad-darçanähläda-pariplutäntaro

hãñyat-tanuù prema-bharäçru-locanaù

nanäma pädämbujam asya viçva-sâg

yat päramahaàsyena pathädhigamyate

SYNONYMS

tat—by that audience of the Lord; *darçana*—audience; *ähläda*—joy; *paripluta*—overwhelmed; *antaraù*—within the heart; *hãñyat*—full in ecstasy; *tanuù*—body; *prema-bhara*—in full transcendental love; *açru*—tears; *locanaù*—in the eyes; *nanäma*—bowed down; *päda-ambujam*—under the lotus feet; *asya*—of the Lord; *viçva-sâk*—the creator of the universe; *yat*—which; *päramahaàsyena*—by the great liberated soul; *pathä*—the path; *adhigamyate*—is followed.

TRANSLATION

Lord Brahmä, thus seeing the Personality of Godhead in His fullness, was overwhelmed with joy within his heart, and thus in full transcendental love and ecstasy, his eyes filled with tears of love. He thus bowed down before the Lord. That is the way of the highest perfection for the living being [paramahamsa].

PURPORT

In the beginning of the *Srimad-Bhagavatam* it is stated that this great literature is meant for the *paramahamsas*. *Paramo nirmatsarääà satäm*, i.e. the *Srimad-Bhagavatam* is meant for persons completely free from malice. In the conditioned life the malicious life begins from the top, namely bearing malice against the Supreme Personality of Godhead. The Personality of Godhead is an established fact in all the revealed scriptures, and in the *Bhagavad-gita* the personal feature of the Supreme Lord is especially mentioned, so much so that the last portion of the great literature has emphatically stressed that one should surrender unto the Personality of Godhead to be saved from the miseries of life. Unfortunately, persons with impious backgrounds do not believe in the Personality of Godhead, and everyone wants to become God himself without any qualification. This malicious nature in the conditioned soul continues even up to the stage when a person wants to be one with the Lord, and thus even the greatest of the empiric philosophers speculating on becoming one with the Supreme Lord cannot become a *paramahamsa* because the malicious mind is there. Therefore the *paramahamsa* stage of life can be attained only by those who are fixed in the practice of *bhakti-yoga*. This *bhakti-yoga* begins if a person has the firm conviction that simply discharging devotional service to the Lord in full transcendental love can elevate him to the highest perfectional stage of life. Brahmäjé believed in this art of *bhakti-yoga*; he believed in the instruction of the Lord to execute *tapa*, and he discharged the function with great penance and thus achieved the great success of seeing the Vaikunthalokas and the Lord also by personal experience. No one can reach the abode of the Supreme Lord by any mechanical means of the mind or machine, but one can reach the abode of the Vaikunthalokas simply by following the process of *bhakti-yoga*

because the Lord can be realized only through the *bhakti-yoga* process. Lord Brahmäjé was actually sitting on his lotus seat, and from there, by executing the process of *bhakti-yoga* in great seriousness, he could see the Vaikunthalokas with all variegatedness as well as the Lord in person and His associates.

Following in the footsteps of Lord Brahmä, any person, even up to this day, can attain the same perfection by following the path of the *paramahamsa* as recommended herein. Lord Caitanya also approved of this method of self-realization for men in this age. One should first, with all conviction, believe in the Personality of Godhead Sri Kṛṣṇa, and without making efforts to realize Him by speculative philosophy, one should prefer to hear about Him from the *Srimad Bhagavad-gita* and later from the text of the *Srimad-Bhagavatam*. One should hear such discourses from a person *Bhägavatam* and not from the professional man, or from the *karmé*, *jïäné* or *yogé*. That is the secret of learning the science. One does not need to be in the renounced order of life; he can remain in his present condition of life, but he must search out the association of a bona fide devotee of the Lord and hear from him the transcendental message of the Lord with faith and conviction. That is the path of the *paramahamsa* recommended herein. Amongst various holy names of the Lord, He is also called *ajita*, or one who can never be conquered by anyone else. Yet He can be conquered by the *paramahamsa* path, as practically realized and shown by the great spiritual master Lord Brahmä. Lord Brahmä has personally recommended this *paramahamsa-panthäù* in his own words as follows:

*jïäne prayäsam udapäsya namanta eva
jévanti san-mukharitää bhavadéya-värtäm
sthäne sthitäù śruti-gatää tanu-väi-manobhir
ye präyaço 'jita jito 'py asi tais tri-lokyäm*

Lord Brahmä said, “O my Lord Kṛṣṇa, a devotee who abandons the path of empiric philosophical speculation aimed at merging in the existence of the Supreme and engages himself in *hearing* Your glories and activities from a bona fide *sādhū*, or saint, and who lives an honest life in the occupational engagement of his social life, can conquer Your sympathy and mercy even though You are *ajita*, or unconquerable.” (**Bhäg.** 10.14.3) That is the path of

the *paramahamsas*, which was personally followed by Lord Brahmä and later recommended by him for attaining perfect success in life.

TEXT 19

**Ta& Pa[qYaMaa<a& SaMauPaiSQaTa& k-iv&
Pa[JaaivSaGaeR iNaJaXaaSaNaahR<aMa()
b>aaz wRziTSMaTaXaaeicza iGara
iPa[Ya" iPa[Ya& Pa[qTaMaNaa" k-re SPa*XaNa()) 19))**

taà préyamäëaà samupasthitaà kavià

prajā-visarge nija-çäsanärhaëam

babhāña éñat-smita-çociñä girä

priyaù priyaà préta-manäù kare spāçan

SYNONYMS

tam—unto Lord Brahmä; *préyamäëam*—worthy of being dear; *samupasthitam*—present before; *kavim*—the great scholar; *prajā*—living entities; *visarge*—in the matter of creation; *nija*—His own; *çäsana*—control; *arhaëam*—just suitable; *babhāñe*—addressed; *éñat*—mild; *smita*—smiling; *çociñä*—with enlightening; *girä*—words; *priyaù*—the beloved; *priyam*—the counterpart of love; *préta-manäù*—being very much pleased; *kare*—by the hand; *spāçan*—shaking.

TRANSLATION

And seeing Brahmä present before Him, the Lord accepted him as worthy to create living beings, to be controlled as He desired, and thus being much satisfied with him, the Lord shook hands with Brahmä and, slightly smiling, addressed him thus.

PURPORT

The creation of the material world is not blind or accidental. The living entities who are ever conditioned, or *nitya-baddha*, are thus given a chance for liberation under the guidance of His own representative like Brahmä. The Lord instructs Brahmä in Vedic knowledge in order to diffuse this knowledge to the conditioned souls. The conditioned souls are forgetful souls in their relationship with the Lord, and thus a period of creation and the process of dissemination of Vedic knowledge are necessary activities of the Lord. Lord Brahmä has a great responsibility in delivering the conditioned souls, and therefore he is very dear to the Lord.

Brahmā also does his duty very perfectly, not only by generating the living entities but also by spreading his party for reclaiming the fallen souls. The party is called the Brahma-sampradāya, and any member of this party to date is naturally engaged in reclaiming the fallen souls back to Godhead, back home. The Lord is very much anxious to get back His parts and parcels, as stated in the *Bhagavad-gita*. No one is more dear than the one who takes the task of reclaiming the fallen souls back to Godhead.

There are many renegades from the Brahma-sampradāya whose only business is to make men more forgetful of the Lord and thus entangle them more and more in material existence. Such persons are never dear to the Lord, and the Lord sends them deeper into the darkest region of matter so that such envious demons may not be able to know the Supreme Lord.

Anyone, however, preaching the mission of the Lord in the line of the Brahma-sampradāya is always dear to the Lord, and the Lord, being satisfied with such a preacher of the authorized *bhakti* cult, shakes hands with him in great satisfaction.

TEXT 20

é[q>aGavaNauvac
TvYaah& TaaeizTa" SaMYaGa(vedGa>aR iSaSa*+aYaa)
icr& >a*TaeNa TaPaSaa duSTaaez" kU-ṣ=YaaeiGaNaMa()) 20))

çré-bhagavān uvāca

tvayāhaà toñitaù samyag

veda-garbha sisākñayä

ciraà bhâtena tapasä

dustoñaù küöa-yoginäm

SYNONYMS

çré-bhagavän uväca—the all-beautiful Personality of Godhead said; *tvayä*—by you; *aham*—I am; *toñitaù*—pleased; *samyak*—complete; *veda-garbha*—impregnated with the *Vedas*; *sisākñayä*—for creating; *ciram*—for a long time; *bhâtena*—accumulated; *tapasä*—by penance; *dustoñaù*—very hard to please; *küöa-yoginäm*—for the pseudo mystics.

TRANSLATION

The beautiful Personality of Godhead addressed Lord Brahmä: O Brahmä, impregnated with the Vedas, I am very much pleased with your long accumulated penance with the desire for creation. Hardly am I pleased with the pseudo mystics.

PURPORT

There are two kinds of penance: one for sense gratification and the other for self-realization. There are many pseudo mystics who undergo severe penances for their own satisfaction, and there are others who undergo severe penances for the satisfaction of the senses of the Lord. For example, the penances undertaken to discover nuclear weapons will never satisfy the Lord because such a penance is never satisfactory. By nature's own way, everyone has to meet death, and if such a process of death is accelerated by anyone's penances, there is no satisfaction for the Lord. The Lord wants every one of His parts and parcels to attain eternal life and bliss by coming home to Godhead, and the whole material creation is meant for that objective. Brahmä underwent severe penances for that purpose, namely to regulate the process of creation so that the Lord might be satisfied.

Therefore the Lord was very much pleased with him, and for this Brahmä was impregnated with Vedic knowledge. The ultimate purpose of Vedic knowledge is to know the Lord and not to misuse the knowledge for any other purposes. Those who do not utilize Vedic knowledge for that purpose are known as *küöa-yogis*, or pseudo transcendentalists who spoil their lives with ulterior motives.

TEXT 21

**vr& vrYa >ad]& Tae vreXa& Maai>avaiH^TaMa()
b]øH^\eYa"Pairé[aMa" Pau&Saa& MaÕXaRNAaviDa")) 21))**

varaà varaya bhadraà te

vareçaà mähiväichitam

brahmaï chreyaù-pariçrämaù

puàsää mad-darçanävadhiù

SYNONYMS

varam—benediction; *varaya*—just ask from; *bhadram*—auspicious; *te*—unto you; *vara-éçam*—the giver of all benediction; *mä (mäm)*—from Me; *abhiväichitam*—wishing; *brahman*—O Brahmä; *çreyaù*—the ultimate success; *pariçrämaù*—for all penances; *puàsäm*—for everyone; *mat*—My; *darçana*—realization; *avadhiù*—up to the limit of.

TRANSLATION

I wish you good luck. O Brahmä, you may ask from Me, the giver of all benediction, all that you may desire. You may know that the ultimate benediction, as the result of all penances, is to see Me by realization.

PURPORT

The ultimate realization of the Supreme Truth is knowing and seeing face to

face the Personality of Godhead. Realization of the impersonal Brahman and localized Paramātmā features of the Personality of Godhead is not ultimate realization, When one realizes the Supreme Lord, one does not struggle hard to perform such penances. The next stage of life is to discharge devotional service to the Lord just to satisfy Him. In other words, one who has realized and seen the Supreme Lord has attained all perfection because everything is included in that highest perfectional stage. The impersonalists and the pseudo mystics, however, cannot reach this state.

TEXT 22

**MaNaqizTaaNau>aavae_Ya& MaMa l/aek-avl/aek-NaMa()
YaduPaé[uTYa rhiSa ck-QaR ParMa& TaPa")) 22))**

manéñitānubhāvo 'yāà

mama lokāvalokanam

yad upaṣṛutya rahasi

cakārtha paramaà tapaù

SYNONYMS

manéñita—ingenuity; *anubhāvaù*—perception; *ayam*—this; *mama*—My; *loka*—abode; *avalokanam*—seeing by actual experience; *yat*—because; *upaṣṛutya*—hearing; *rahasi*—in great penance; *cakārtha*—having performed; *paramam*—highest; *tapaù*—penance.

TRANSLATION

The highest perfectional ingenuity is the personal perception of My abodes, and this has been possible because of your submissive attitude in the performance of severe penance according to My order.

PURPORT

The highest perfectional stage of life is to know the Lord by actual perception, by the grace of the Lord. This can be attained by everyone who is willing to discharge the act of devotional service to the Lord as enjoined in the revealed scriptures that are standard and accepted by the bona fide *ācāryas*, spiritual masters. For example, the *Bhagavad-gītā* is the approved Vedic literature accepted by all the great *ācāryas*, such as Čaikara, Rāmānuja, Madhva, Caitanya, Visvanatha, Baladeva, Siddhānta Sarasvaté and many others. In that *Bhagavad-gītā* the Personality of Godhead, Sri Kṛṣṇa, asks that one always be mindful of Him, always be His devotee, always worship Him only, and always bow down before the Lord. And by doing so one is sure to go back home, back to Godhead, without any doubt. In other places also the same order is there, that one give up all other engagements and fully surrender unto the Lord without hesitation. And the Lord will give such a devotee all protection. These are the secrets of attaining the highest perfectional stage. Lord Brahmā exactly followed these principles without any superiority complex, and thus he attained the highest perfectional stage of experiencing the abode of the Lord and the Lord Himself with all His paraphernalia. Impersonal realization of the effulgence of the Lord's body is not the highest perfectional stage, nor is the stage of Paramātmā realization. The word *manéñita* is significant. Everyone is falsely or factually proud of his so-called learning. But the Lord says that the highest perfectional stage of learning is to know Him and His abode, devoid of all illusion.

TEXT 23

**Pa[TYaaidí& MaYaa Ta}a TviYa k-MaRivMaaeihTae)
TaPaae Mae ôdYa& Saa+aadaTMaah& TaPaSaae_Naga)) 23))**

pratyādiñöaà mayä tatra

tvayi karma-vimohite

tapo me hādayaà säkñäd

ätmähaà tapaso 'nagha

SYNONYMS

pratyädiñöam—ordered; *mayä*—by Me; *tatra*—because of; *tvayi*—unto you; *karma*—duty; *vimohite*—being perplexed; *tapaù*—penance; *me*—Me; *hådayam*—heart; *säkñät*—directly; *ätmä*—life and soul; *aham*—Myself; *tapasaù*—of one who is engaged in penance; *anagha*—O sinless one.

TRANSLATION

O sinless Brahmä, you may know from Me that it was I who first ordered you to undergo penance when you were perplexed in your duty. Such penance is My heart and soul, and therefore penance and I are nondifferent.

PURPORT

The penance by which one can see the Personality of Godhead face to face is to be understood as devotional service to the Lord and nothing else because only by discharging devotional service in transcendental love can one approach the Lord. Such penance is the internal potency of the Lord and is nondifferent from Him. Such acts of internal potency are exhibited by nonattachment for material enjoyment. The living entities are engaged in the conditions of material bondage because of their propensity for overlordship. But by engagement in the devotional service of the Lord one becomes detached from this enjoying spirit. The devotees automatically become detached from worldly enjoyment, and this detachment is the result of perfect knowledge. Therefore the penance of devotional service includes knowledge and detachment, and that is the manifestation of the transcendental potency.

One cannot enjoy material illusory prosperity if he desires to return home, back to Godhead. One who has no information of the transcendental bliss in the association of the Lord foolishly desires to enjoy this temporary material happiness. In the *Caitanya-caritāmāta* it is said that if someone sincerely wants to see the Lord and at the same time wants to enjoy this material world, he is considered to be a fool only. One who wants to remain here in the material world for material enjoyment has no business

entering into the eternal kingdom of God. The Lord favors such a foolish devotee by snatching all that he may possess in the material world. If such a foolish devotee of the Lord tries to recoup his position, then the merciful Lord again snatches away all that he may have possessed. By such repeated failures in material prosperity he becomes very unpopular with his family members and friends. In the material world the family members and friends honor persons who are very successful in accumulating wealth by any means. The foolish devotee of the Lord is thus put into forcible penance by the grace of the Lord, and at the end the devotee becomes perfectly happy, being engaged in the service of the Lord. Therefore penance in devotional service of the Lord, either by voluntary submission or by being forced by the Lord, is necessary for attaining perfection, and thus such penance is the internal potency of the Lord.

One cannot, however, be engaged in the penance of devotional service without being completely free from all sins. As stated in the *Bhagavad-gita*, only a person who is completely free from all reactions of sins can engage himself in the worship of the Lord. Brahmājé was sinless, and therefore he faithfully discharged the advice of the Lord, “*tapa tapa*,” and the Lord, being satisfied with him, awarded him the desired result. Therefore only love and penance combined can please the Lord, and thus one is able to attain His complete mercy. He directs the sinless, and the sinless devotee attains the highest perfection of life.

TEXT 24

**Sa*JaaiMa TaPaSaEved& Ga]SaaiMa TaPaSaa PauNa")
ib>aiMaR TaPaSaa ivi& vqYa | Mae duêr& TaPa")) 24))**

sâjâmi tapasaivedaà

grasâmi tapasâ punaù

bibharmi tapasâ viçvaà

véryaà me duçcaraà tapaù

SYNONYMS

sājāmi—I create; *tapasā*—by the same energy of penance; *eva*—certainly; *idam*—this; *grasāmi tapasā*—I do withdraw also by the same energy; *punaù*—again; *bibharmi*—do maintain; *tapasā*—by penance; *viçvam*—the cosmos; *véryam*—potency; *me*—My; *duçcaram*—severe; *tapaù*—penance.

TRANSLATION

I create this cosmos by such penance, I maintain it by the same energy, and I withdraw it all by the same energy. Therefore the potential power is penance only.

PURPORT

In executing penance, one must be determined to return home, back to Godhead, and must decide to undergo all types of tribulations for that end. Even for material prosperity, name and fame, one has to undergo severe types of penance, otherwise no one can become an important figure in this material world. Why, then, are there severe types of penance for the perfection of devotional service? An easygoing life and attainment of perfection in transcendental realization cannot go together. The Lord is more clever than any living entity; therefore He wants to see how painstaking the devotee is in devotional service. The order is received from the Lord, either directly or through the bona fide spiritual master, and to execute that order, however painstaking, is the severe type of penance. One who follows the principle rigidly is sure to achieve success in attaining the Lord's mercy.

TEXT 25

b]øaevac

**>aGavNa(SavR>aUTaaNaaMaDYa+aae_viSQaTaae GauhaMa()
ved ùPa[iTaåÖeNa Pa[jaNaeNa ick-lizRTaMa()) 25))**

brahmoväca

bhagavan sarva-bhütänäm

adhyakñö 'vasthito guhäm

veda hy apratiruddhena

prajñänena cikérñitam

SYNONYMS

brahmä uväca—Lord Brahmä said; *bhagavan*—O my Lord; *sarva bhütänäm*—of all living entities; *adhyakñä*—director; *avasthita*—situated; *guhäm*—within the heart; *veda*—know; *hi*—certainly; *apratiruddhena*—without hindrance; *prajñänena*—by superintelligence; *cikérñitam*—endeavors.

TRANSLATION

Lord Brahmä said: O Personality of Godhead, You are situated in every living entity's heart as the supreme director, and therefore You are aware of all endeavors by Your superior intelligence, without any hindrance whatsoever.

PURPORT

The *Bhagavad-gita* confirms that the Lord is situated in everyone's heart as the witness, and as such He is the supreme director of sanction. The director is not the enjoyer of the fruits of action, for without the Lord's sanction no one can enjoy. For example, in a prohibited area a habituated drunkard puts forward his application to the director of drinking, and the director, considering his case, sanctions only a certain amount of liquor for drinking. Similarly, the whole material world is full of many drunkards, in the sense that each and every one of the living entities has something in his mind to enjoy, and everyone desires the fulfillment of his desires very strongly. The almighty Lord, being very kind to the living entity, as the father is kind to the son, fulfills the living entity's desire for his childish satisfaction. With such desires in mind, the living entity does not actually

enjoy, but he serves the bodily whims unnecessarily, without profit. The drunkard does not derive any profit out of drinking, but because he has become a servant of the drinking habit and does not wish to get out of it, the merciful Lord gives him all facilities to fulfill such desires.

The impersonalists recommend that one should become desireless, and others recommend banishing desires altogether. That is impossible; no one can banish desires altogether because desiring is the living symptom. Without having desires a living entity would be dead, which he is not. Therefore, living conditions and desire go together. perfection of desires may be achieved when one desires to serve the Lord, and the Lord also desires that every living entity banish all personal desires and cooperate with His desires. That is the last instruction of the *Bhagavad-gita*. Brahmäjé agreed to this proposal, and therefore he is given the responsible post of creating generations in the vacant universe. Oneness with the Lord therefore consists of dovetailing one's desires with the desires of the Supreme Lord. That makes for the perfection of all desires.

The Lord, as the Supersoul in the heart of every living being, knows what is in the mind of each living entity, and no one can do anything without the knowledge of the Lord within. By His superior intelligence, the Lord gives everyone the chance to fulfill his desires to the fullest extent, and the resultant reaction is also awarded by the Lord.

TEXT 26

**TaQaiPa NaaQaMaanaSYa NaaQa NaaQaYa NaaiQaTaMa()
Paravre YaQaa æPae JaaNaqYaa& Tae TvæiPa<a")) 26))**

tathäpi nāthamānasya

nātha nāthaya nāthitam

parāvare yathā rūpe

jānéyää te tv arüpiëaù

SYNONYMS

tathā api—in spite of that; *nāthamānasya*—of the one who is asking for; *nātha*—O Lord; *nāthaya*—please award; *nāthitam*—as it is desired; *para-avare*—in the matter of mundane and transcendental; *yathā*—as it is; *rūpe*—in the form; *jānéyām*—may it be known; *te*—Your; *tu*—but; *arūpiēaù*—one who is formless.

TRANSLATION

In spite of that, my Lord, I am praying to You to kindly fulfill my desire.
May I please be informed how, in spite of Your transcendental form, You
assume the mundane form, although You have no such form at all.

TEXT 27

YaQaaTMaMaaYaaYaaeGaeNa NaaNaaXaÇ-yuPab*&ihTaMa()
ivlu/MPaNa(ivSa*JaNa(Ga*õNa(ib>a]daTMaaNaMaaTMaNaa)) 27))

yathātma-māyā-yogena

nānā-çakty-upabāhitam

vilumpan visājan gāhēan

bibhrad ātmānam ātmanā

SYNONYMS

yathā—as much as; *ātma*—own; *māyā*—potency; *yogena*—by combination; *nānā*—various; *çakti*—energy; *upabāhitam*—by combination and permutation; *vilumpan*—in the matter of annihilation; *visājan*—in the matter of generation; *gāhēan*—in the matter of acceptance; *bibhrat*—in the matter of maintenance; *ātmānam*—own self; *ātmanā*—by the self.

TRANSLATION

And [please inform me] how You, by Your own Self, manifest different energies for annihilation, generation, acceptance and maintenance by combination and permutation.

PURPORT

The whole manifestation is the Lord Himself by diffusion of His different energies only, namely the internal, external and marginal, just as the sunlight is the manifestation of the energy of the sun planet. Such energy is simultaneously one with and different from the Lord, just as the sunshine is simultaneously one with and different from the sun planet. The energies are acting by combination and permutation by the indication of the Lord, and the acting agents, like Brahmā, Viṣṇu and Siva, are also different incarnations of the Lord. In other words, there is nothing but the Lord, and still the Lord is different from all such manifestive activities. How it is so will be explained later on.

TEXT 28

**§-I@SYaMaaegaSa³LPa O<aRNAai>aYaRQaae<auRTae)
TaQaa TaiÜzYaa& Daeih MaNaqza& MaiYa MaaDav)) 28))**

kréòasy amogha-saikalpa

ürëanābhir yathorëute

tathä tad-viñayäà dhehi

manéñäà mayi mädhava

SYNONYMS

kréòasi—as You play; *amogha*—infallible; *saikalpa*—determination; *ürëanābhiù*—the spider; *yathä*—as much as; *ürëute*—covers; *tathä*—so and so; *tat-viñayäm*—in the subject of all those; *dhehi*—do let me know; *manéñäm*—philosophically; *mayi*—unto me; *mädhava*—O master of all energies.

TRANSLATION

**O master of all energies, please tell me philosophically all about them.
You play like a spider that covers itself by its own energy, and Your
determination is infallible.**

PURPORT

By the inconceivable energy of the Lord, every creative element has its own potencies, known as the potency of the element, potency of knowledge and potency of different actions and reactions. By a combination of such potential energies of the Lord there is the manifestation of creation, maintenance and annihilation in due course of time and by different agents like Brahmā, Viṣṇu and Maheṣvara. Brahmā creates, Viṣṇu maintains, and Lord Siva destroys. But all such agents and creative energies are emanations from the Lord, and as such there is nothing except the Lord, or the one supreme source of different diversities. The exact example is the spider and spider's web. The web is created by the spider, and it is maintained by the spider, and as soon as the spider likes, the whole thing is wound up within the spider. The spider is covered within the web. If an insignificant spider is so powerful as to act according to its will, why can't the Supreme Being act by His supreme will in the creation, maintenance and destruction of the cosmic manifestations? By the grace of the Lord, a devotee like Brahmā, or one in his chain of disciplic succession, can understand the almighty Personality of Godhead eternally engaged in His transcendental pastimes in the region of different energies.

TEXT 29

**>aGaviC^i+aTaMah& k-rvai<a ùTaiNd]Ta")
NaehMaaNa" Pa[JaaSaGa| bDYaeYa& YadNauGa]haTa()) 29))**

bhagavac-chikñitam ahaà

karaväëi hy atandritaù

nehamänaù prajā-sargaà

badhyeyaà yad-anugrahät

SYNONYMS

bhagavat—by the Personality of Godhead; *çikñitam*—taught; *aham*—myself; *karaväëi*—by acting; *hi*—certainly; *atandritaù*—instrumental; *na*—never; *ihamänaù*—although acting; *prajā-sargam*—generation of the living entities; *badhyeyam*—be conditioned; *yat*—as a matter of fact; *anugrahät*—by the mercy of.

TRANSLATION

Please tell me so that I may be taught in the matter by the instruction of the Personality of Godhead and may thus act instrumentally to generate living entities, without being conditioned by such activities.

PURPORT

Brahmäjé does not want to become a speculator dependent on the strength of his personal knowledge and conditioned to material bondage. Everyone should know in clear consciousness that one is, in the execution of all activities, an instrument. A conditioned soul is instrumental in the hands of the external energy, *guëa-mayé mäyä*, or the illusory energy of the Lord, and in the liberated stage the living entity is instrumental to the will of the Personality of Godhead directly. To be instrumental to the direct will of the Lord is the natural constitutional position of the living entity, whereas to be an instrument in the hands of the illusory energy of the Lord is material bondage for the living entity. In that conditioned state, the living entity speculates on the Absolute Truth and His different activities. But in the unconditioned stage the living entity directly receives knowledge from the Lord, and such a liberated soul acts flawlessly, without any speculative habit. The ***Bhagavad-gita*** (10.10–11) confirms emphatically that the pure devotees, who are constantly engaged in the loving transcendental service of the Lord, are directly advised by the Lord, so much so that the devotee unwaveringly makes progress on the path home, back to Godhead. Pure devotees of the Lord are therefore not proud of their definite progress, whereas the nondevotee speculator is in the darkness of illusory energy

and is very much proud of his misleading knowledge based on speculation without any definite path. Lord Brahmā wanted to be saved from that pitfall of pride, although he was posted in the most exalted position within the universe.

TEXT 30

YaavTa(Sa%a Sa:YauirveXa Tae k*-Ta"
Pa[JaaivSaGaeR iv>aJaiMa >aae JaNaMa()
Aiv@-vSTae Pairk-MaRi<a iSQaTaae
Maa Mae SaMauàÖMadae_JaMaaiNaNa")) 30))

yāvat sakhā sakhyur iveça te kâtaù

prajā-visarge vibhajāmi bho janam

aviklavas te parikarmaëi sthito

mā me samunnaddha-mado 'ja mäninaù

SYNONYMS

yāvat—as it is; *sakhā*—friend; *sakhyuù*—unto the friend; *iva*—like that; *éça*—O Lord; *te*—You; *kâtaù*—have accepted; *prajā*—the living entities; *visarge*—in the matter of creation; *vibhajāmi*—as I shall do it differently; *bhoù*—O my Lord; *janam*—those who are born; *aviklavaù*—without being perturbed; *te*—Your; *parikarmaëi*—in the matter of service; *sthitaù*—thus situated; *mā*—may it never be; *me*—unto me; *samunnaddha*—resulting arise; *madaù*—madness; *aja*—O unborn one; *mäninaù*—thus being thought of.

TRANSLATION

O my Lord, the unborn, You have shaken hands with me just as a friend does with a friend [as if equal in position]. I shall be engaged in the creation of different types of living entities, and I shall be occupied in Your service. I shall have no perturbation, but I pray that all this may not

give rise to pride, as if I were the Supreme.

PURPORT

Lord Brahmā is definitely situated in the humor of friendship with the Lord. Every living being is eternally related with the Personality of Godhead in one of five different transcendental humors, namely *çānta*, *dāsyā*, *sakhya*, *vātsalya* and *mādhurya*. We have already discussed these five kinds of humors in relationship with the Personality of Godhead. It is clearly exhibited herein that Lord Brahmā is related to the Personality of Godhead in the transcendental humor of friendship. A pure devotee may be related with the Lord in any one of the transcendental humors, even in the humor of parenthood, but the devotee of the Lord is always a transcendental servitor. No one is equal to or greater than the Lord. That is the version of the *Bhagavad-gita*. Brahmājé, although eternally related with the Lord in the transcendental humor of friendship, and although entrusted with the most exalted post of creating different grades of living entities, is still conscious of his position, that he is neither the Supreme Lord nor supremely powerful. It is possible that some extremely powerful personality, within or without the universe, may sometimes show more power than the Lord Himself. Still the pure devotee knows that this power is a *vibhūti* delegated by the Lord, and such a delegated powerful living entity is never independent. Sri Hanumānjé crossed the Indian Ocean by jumping over the sea, and Lord Sri Rāmacandra engaged Himself in marching over the bridge, but this does not mean that Hanumānjé was more powerful than the Lord. Sometimes the Lord gives extraordinary powers to His devotee, but the devotee knows always that the power belongs to the Personality of Godhead and that the devotee is only an instrument. The pure devotee is never puffed up like the nondevotee class of men who falsely think that they are God. It is astonishing to see how a person who is being kicked by the laws of the Lord's illusory energy at every step can falsely think of becoming one with the Lord. Such thinking is the last snare of the illusory energy offered to the conditioned soul. The first illusion is that he wants to become Lord of the material world by accumulating wealth and power, but when he is frustrated in that attempt he wants to be one with the Lord. So both becoming the most powerful man in the material world and desiring to become one with the Lord are

different illusory snares. And because the pure devotees of the Lord are surrendered souls, they are above the illusory snares of *māyā*. Because Lord Brahmā is a pure devotee, even though the first dominating deity in the material world and therefore able to do many wonderful things, he would never, like the nondevotee with a poor fund of knowledge, have the audacity to think of becoming one with the Lord. People with a poor fund of knowledge should take lessons from Brahmā when they are puffed up with the false notion of becoming God.

Factually Lord Brahmā does not create the living entities. In the beginning of the creation he is empowered to give different bodily shapes to the living entities according to their work during the last millennium. Brahmājé's duty is just to wake the living entities from their slumber and to engage them in their proper duty. The different grades of living entities are not created by Brahmājé by his capricious whims, but he is entrusted with the task of giving the living entities different grades of body so that they can work accordingly. And still he is conscious that he is only instrumental, so that he may not think of himself as the Supreme Powerful Lord.

Devotees of the Lord are engaged in the specific duty offered by the Lord, and such duties are successfully carried out without hindrance because they are ordained by the Lord. The credit of success goes not to the doer but to the Lord. But persons with a poor fund of knowledge take the credit of success into their own accounts and give nothing to the credit of the Lord. That is the symptom of the nondevotee class of men.

TEXT 31

é[q>aGavaNauvac
jaNa& ParMaGauù& Mae Yad(ivjaNaSaMaiNvTaMa()
SarhSYa& Tad®& c Ga*ha<a GaidTa& MaYaa)) 31))

çré-bhagavān uvāca

jīānā parama-guhyā me

yad vijīāna-samanvitam

sarahasyaà tad-aìgaà ca

gãhãëa gaditaà mayä

SYNONYMS

çré-bhagavän uväca—the personality of Godhead said; *jñanam*—knowledge acquired; *parama*—extremely; *guhyam*—confidential; *me*—of Me; *yat*—which is; *vijñana*—realization; *samanvitam*—coordinated; *sa-rahasyam*—with devotional service; *tat*—of that; *aìgam ca*—necessary paraphernalia; *gãhãëa*—just try to take up; *gaditam*—explained; *mayä*—by Me.

TRANSLATION

The Personality of Godhead said: Knowledge about Me as described in the scriptures is very confidential, and it has to be realized in conjunction with devotional service. The necessary paraphernalia for that process is being explained by Me. You may take it up carefully.

PURPORT

Lord Brahmä is the topmost devotee of the Lord within the universe, and therefore the Personality of Godhead replied to his four principal inquiries in four important statements, which are known as the original *Bhägavatam* in four verses. These were Brahmä's questions: (1) What are the forms of the Lord both in matter and in transcendence? (2) How are the different energies of the Lord working? (3) How does the Lord play with His different energies? (4) How may Brahmä be instructed to discharge the duty entrusted to Him? The prelude to the answers is this verse under discussion, wherein the Lord informs Brahmä that knowledge of Him, the Supreme Absolute Truth, as it is stated in the revealed scriptures, is very subtle and cannot be understood unless one is self-realized by the grace of the Lord. The Lord says that Brahmä may take the answers as He explains them. This means that transcendental knowledge of the absolute Supreme Being can be known if it is made known by the Lord Himself. By the mental speculation of the greatest mundane thinkers, the Absolute Truth cannot be understood. The mental speculators can reach up to the standard of

impersonal Brahman realization, but, factually, complete knowledge of transcendence is beyond the knowledge of impersonal Brahman. Thus it is called the supreme confidential wisdom. Out of many liberated souls, someone may be qualified to know the Personality of Godhead. In the *Bhagavad-gita* it is also said by the Lord Himself that out of many hundreds of thousands of people, one may try for perfection in human life, and out of many liberated souls, one may know Him as He is. Therefore, the knowledge of the Personality of Godhead may be attained by devotional service only. *Rahasyam* means devotional service. Lord Kṛṣṇa instructed Arjuna in the *Bhagavad-gita* because He found Arjuna to be a devotee and friend. Without such qualifications, one cannot enter into the mystery of the *Bhagavad-gita*. Therefore, one cannot understand the Personality of Godhead unless one becomes a devotee and discharges devotional service. This mystery is *love of Godhead*. Therein lies the main qualification for knowing the mystery of the Personality of Godhead. And to attain the stage of transcendental love of Godhead, regulative principles of devotional service must be followed. The regulative principles are called *vidhi-bhakti*, or the devotional service of the Lord, and they can be practiced by a neophyte with his present senses. Such regulative principles are mainly based on hearing and chanting of the glories of the Lord. And such hearing and chanting of the glories of the Lord can be made possible in the association of devotees only. Lord Caitanya therefore recommended five main principles for attaining perfection in the devotional service of the Lord. The first is association with devotees (hearing); second is chanting the glories of the Lord; third, hearing *Srimad-Bhagavatam* from the pure devotee; fourth, residing in a holy place connected with the Lord; and fifth, worshiping the Deity of the Lord with devotion. Such rules and regulations are parts of devotional service. So, as requested by Lord Brahmā, the personality of Godhead will explain all about the four questions put forward by Brahmā, and others also which are parts and parcels of the same questions.

TEXT 32

**YaavaNah& YaQaa>aavae Yad]UPaGau<ak-MaRk-")
TaQaEv TatvivjaNaMaSTau Tae MadNauGa]haTa()) 32))**

yävän ahaà yathä-bhävo

yad-rüpa-guëa-karmakaù

tathaiva tattva-vijñanam

astu te mad-anugrahät

SYNONYMS

yävän—as I am in eternal form; *aham*—Myself; *yathä*—as much as; *bhävaù*—transcendental existence; *yat*—those; *rüpa*—various forms and colors; *guëa*—qualities; *karmakaù*—activities; *tathä*—so and so; *eva*—certainly; *tattva-vijñanam*—factual realization; *astu*—let it be; *te*—unto you; *mat*—My; *anugrahät*—by causeless mercy.

TRANSLATION

All of Me, namely My actual eternal form and My transcendental existence, color, qualities and activities—let all be awakened within you by factual realization, out of My causeless mercy.

PURPORT

The secret of success in understanding the intricacies of knowledge of the Absolute Truth, the Personality of Godhead, is the causeless mercy of the Lord. Even in the material world, the father of many sons discloses the secret of his position to the pet sons. The father discloses the confidence unto the son whom he thinks worthy. An important man in the social order can be known by his mercy only. Similarly, one must be very dear to the Lord in order to know the Lord. The Lord is unlimited; no one can know Him completely, but one's advancement in the transcendental loving service of the Lord can make one eligible to know the Lord. Here we can see that the Lord is sufficiently pleased with Brahmäjé, and therefore He offers His causeless mercy to him so that Brahmäjé may have the factual realization of the Lord by His mercy only.

In the *Vedas* also it is said that a person cannot know the Absolute Truth Personality of Godhead simply by dint of mundane education or intellectual gymnastics. One can know the Supreme Truth if one has unflinching faith in the bona fide spiritual master as well as in the Lord. Such a faithful person, even though illiterate in the mundane sense, can know the Lord automatically by the mercy of the Lord. In the *Bhagavad-gita* also, it is said that the Lord reserves the right of not being exposed to everyone, and He keeps Himself concealed from the faithless by His *yoga-mäyā* potency.

To the faithful the Lord reveals Himself in His form, quality and pastimes. The Lord is not formless, as wrongly conceived by the impersonalist, but His form is not like one that we have experienced. The Lord discloses His form, even to the extent of measurement, to His pure devotees, and that is the meaning of *yävān*, as explained by Srila Jiva Gosvami, the greatest scholar of *Srimad-Bhagavatam*.

The Lord discloses the transcendental nature of His existence. The mundane wranglers make mundane conceptions of the form of the Lord. It is said in the revealed scriptures that the Lord has no mundane form; therefore persons with a poor fund of knowledge conclude that He must be formless. They cannot distinguish between the mundane form and the spiritual form. According to them, without a mundane form one must be formless. This conclusion is also mundane because formlessness is the opposite conception of form. Negation of the mundane conception does not establish a transcendental fact. In the *Brahma-saṁhitā* it is said that the Lord has a transcendental form and that He can utilize any one of His senses for any purpose. For example, He can eat with His eyes, and He can see with His leg. In the mundane conception of form, one cannot eat with one's eyes or see with his leg. That is the difference between the mundane body and the spiritual body of *sac-cid-ānanda*. A spiritual body is not formless; it is a different type of body, of which we cannot conceive with our present mundane senses. Formless therefore means devoid of mundane form, or possessing a spiritual body of which the nondevotee can have no conception by the speculative method.

The Lord discloses to the devotee His unlimited varieties of transcendental bodies, all identical with one another with different kinds of bodily

features. Some of the transcendental bodies of the Lord are blackish, and some of them are whitish. Some of them are reddish, and some are yellowish. Some of them are four-handed and some of them two-handed. Some of them are like the fish, and some are like the lion. All these different transcendental bodies of the Lord, without any differential category, are disclosed to the devotees of the Lord by the mercy of the Lord, and thus the impersonalists' false arguments claiming the formlessness of the Supreme Truth do not appeal to a devotee of the Lord, even though such a devotee may not be very advanced in devotional service.

The Lord has unlimited numbers of transcendental qualities, and one of them is His affection for His unalloyed devotee. In the history of the mundane world we can appreciate His transcendental qualities. The Lord incarnates Himself for the protection of His devotees and for the annihilation of the faithless. His activities are in relationship with His devotees. *Srimad-Bhagavatam* is full of such activities of the Lord in relationship with His devotees, and the nondevotees have no knowledge of such pastimes. The Lord lifted the Govardhana Hill when He was only seven years old and protected His pure devotees at Våndävana from the wrath of Indra, who was overflowing the place with rain. Now this lifting of the Govardhana Hill by a seven-year-old boy may be unbelievable for the faithless, but for the devotees it is absolutely believable. The devotee believes in the almighty potency of the Lord, while the faithless say that the Lord is almighty but do not believe it. Such men with a poor fund of knowledge do not know that the Lord is the Lord eternally and that one cannot become the Lord by meditation for millions of years or by mental speculation for billions of years.

The impersonal interpretation of the mundane wranglers is completely refuted in this verse because it is clearly stated here that the Supreme Lord has His qualities, form, pastimes and everything that a person has. All these descriptions of the transcendental nature of the Personality of Godhead are factual realizations by the devotee of the Lord, and by the causeless mercy of the Lord they are revealed to His pure devotee, and to no one else.

TEXT 33

AhMaevaSaMaevaGa]e NaaNYad(YaTa(SadSaTa(ParMa()
Paêadh& YadeTaÀ Yaae_vìXaZYaeTa Saae_SMYahMa()) 33))

aham eväsam evägre

nänyad yat sad-asat param

paçcäd ahaà yad etac ca

yo 'vaçiñyeta so 'smy aham

SYNONYMS

aham—I, the Personality of Godhead; *eva*—certainly; *äsam*—existed; *eva*—only; *agre*—before the creation; *na*—never; *anyat*—anything else; *yat*—all those; *sat*—the effect; *asat*—the cause; *param*—the supreme; *paçcät*—at the end; *aham*—I, the Personality of Godhead; *yat*—all these; *etat*—creation; *ca*—also; *yaù*—everything; *avaçiñyeta*—remains; *saù*—that; *asmi*—I am; *aham*—I, the Personality of Godhead.

TRANSLATION

Brahmä, it is I, the Personality of Godhead, who was existing before the creation, when there was nothing but Myself. Nor was there the material nature, the cause of this creation. That which you see now is also I, the Personality of Godhead, and after annihilation what remains will also be I, the Personality of Godhead.

PURPORT

We should note very carefully that the personality of Godhead is addressing Lord Brahmä and specifying with great emphasis Himself, pointing out that it is He, the Personality of Godhead, who existed before the creation, it is He only who maintains the creation, and it is He only who remains after the annihilation of the creation. Brahmä is also a creation of the Supreme Lord. The impersonalist puts forth the theory of oneness in the sense that Brahmä, also being the same principle of “I” because he is an emanation

from the I, the Absolute Truth, is identical with the Lord, the principle of I, and that there is thus nothing more than the principle of I, as explained in this verse. Accepting the argument of the impersonalist, it is to be admitted that the Lord is the creator I and that the Brahmā is the created I. Therefore there is a difference between the two “I’s,” namely the predominator I and the predominated I. Therefore there are still two I’s, even accepting the argument of the impersonalist. But we must note carefully that these two I’s are accepted in the Vedic literature (*Kaṛṇopaniṣad*) in the sense of quality. The *Kaṛṇopaniṣad* says:

*nityo nityānā cetanaḥ cetanānām
eko bahūnā yo vidadhāti kāmān*

The creator “I” and the created “I” are both accepted in the *Vedas* as qualitatively one because both of them are *nityas* and *cetanas*. But the singular “I” is the creator “I,” and the created “I’s” are of plural number because there are many “I’s” like Brahmā and those generated by Brahmā. It is the simple truth. The father creates or begets a son, and the son also creates many other sons, and all of them may be one as human beings, but at the same time from the father, the son and the grandsons are all different. The son cannot take the place of the father, nor can the grandsons. Simultaneously the father, the son and the grandson are one and different also. As human beings they are one, but as relativities they are different. Therefore the relativities of the creator and the created or the predominator and the predominated have been differentiated in the *Vedas* by saying that the predominator “I” is the feeder of the predominated “I’s,” and thus there is a vast difference between the two principles of “I.”

In another feature of this verse, no one can deny the personalities of both the Lord and Brahmā. Therefore in the ultimate issue both the predominator and predominated are persons. This conclusion refutes the conclusion of the impersonalist that in the ultimate issue everything is impersonal. This impersonal feature stressed by the less intelligent impersonalist school is refuted by pointing out that the predominator “I” is the Absolute Truth and that He is a person. The predominated “I,” Brahmā, is also a person, but he is not the Absolute. For realization of one’s self in

spiritual psychology it may be convenient to assume oneself to be the same principle as the Absolute Truth, but there is always the difference of the predominated and the predominator, as clearly pointed out here in this verse, which is grossly misused by the impersonalists. Brahmā is factually seeing face to face his predominator Lord, who exists in His transcendental eternal form, even after the annihilation of the material creation. The form of the Lord, as seen by Brahmā, existed before the creation of Brahmā, and the material manifestation with all the ingredients and agents of material creation are also energetic expansions of the Lord, and after the exhibition of the Lord's energy comes to a close, what remains is the same Personality of Godhead. Therefore the form of the Lord exists in all circumstances of creation, maintenance and annihilation. The Vedic hymns confirm this fact in the statement *vāsudevo vā idam agra āsén na brahmā na ca ṣaṅkara eko nārāyaṇa āsén na brahmā neṣāna*, etc. Before the creation there was none except Vāsudeva. There was neither Brahmā nor Ṣaṅkara. Only Nārāyaṇa was there and no one else, neither Brahmā nor Éṣāna. Sripāda Ṣaṅkarācārya also confirms in his comments on the *Bhagavad-gīta* that Nārāyaṇa, or the Personality of Godhead, is transcendental to all creation, but that the whole creation is the product of *avyakta*. Therefore the difference between the created and the creator is always there, although both the creator and created are of the same quality.

The other feature of the statement is that the supreme truth is Bhagavān, or the Personality of Godhead. The Personality of Godhead and His kingdom have already been explained. The kingdom of Godhead is not void as conceived by the impersonalists. The Vaikuntha planets are full of transcendental variegatedness, including the four-handed residents of those planets, with great opulence of wealth and prosperity, and there are even airplanes and other amenities required for high-grade personalities. Therefore the Personality of Godhead exists before the creation, and He exists with all transcendental variegatedness in the Vaikunthalokas. The Vaikunthalokas, also accepted in the *Bhagavad-gīta* as being of the *sanātana* nature, are not annihilated even after the annihilation of the manifested cosmos. Those transcendental planets are of a different nature altogether, and that nature is not subjected to the rules and regulations of material creation, maintenance or annihilation. The existence of the Personality of Godhead implies the existence of the Vaikunthalokas, as the

existence of a king implies the existence of a kingdom.

In various places in *Srimad-Bhagavatam* and in other revealed scriptures the existence of the Personality of Godhead is mentioned. For example, in *Srimad-Bhagavatam* (2.8.10), Maharaja Parikṣit asks:

*sa cāpi yatra puruṇo
viṣva-sthity-udbhavāpyayaṁ
muktvātma-māyāṁ māyeṣaṁ
ṣete sarva-guhācayāṁ*

“How does the Personality of Godhead, the cause of creation, maintenance and annihilation, who is always freed from the influence of the illusory energy and is the controller of the same, lie in everyone’s heart?” Similar also is a question of Vidura’s:

*tattvānāṁ bhagavaṁ teṇāṁ
katidhā pratisaṁkramaṁ
tatremaṁ ka upāséran
ka u svid anuṣerate*

(**Bhāg.** 3.7.37)

Sridhara Svāmī explains this in his notes: “During the annihilation of the creation, who serves the Lord lying on the Ćeṇa, etc.” This means that the transcendental Lord with all His name, fame, quality and paraphernalia exists eternally. The same confirmation is also in the *Kāṣṭhā-khaṇḍa* of the *Skanda Purana* in connection with *dhruva-carita*. It is said there:

*na cyavante ’pi yad-bhaktā
mahatyāṁ pralayāpadi
ato ’cyuto ’khile loke
sa ekaṁ sarvago ’vyayaṁ*

Even the devotees of the Personality of Godhead are not annihilated during the period of the entire annihilation of the material world, not to speak of the Lord Himself. The Lord is ever-existent in all three stages of material

change.

The impersonalist adduces no activity in the Supreme, but in this discussion between Brahmā and the Supreme Personality of Godhead the Lord is said to have activities also, as He has His form and quality. The activities of Brahmā and other demigods during the maintenance of the creation are to be understood as the activities of the Lord. The king, or the head executive of a state, may not be seen in the government offices, for he may be engaged in royal comforts. Yet it should be understood that everything is being done under his direction and everything is at his command. The Personality of Godhead is never formless. In the material world He may not be visible in His personal form to the less intelligent class of men, and therefore He may sometimes be called formless. But actually He is always in His eternal form in His Vaikuntha planets as well as in other planets of the universes as different incarnations. The example of the sun is very appropriate in this connection. The sun in the night may not be visible to the eyes of men in the darkness, but the sun is visible wherever it has risen. That the sun is not visible to the eyes of the inhabitants of a particular part of the earth does not mean that the sun has no form.

In the ***Bāhad-āraēyaka Upaniñad*** (1.4.1) there is the hymn *ātmaivedam agra āsēt puruṣa-vidhaù*. This *mantra* indicates the Supreme Personality of Godhead (Kṛṣṇa) even before the appearance of the *puruṣa* incarnation. In the ***Bhagavad-gīta*** (15.18) it is said that Lord Kṛṣṇa is Puruñottama because He is the supreme *puruṣa*, transcendental even to the *puruṣa-akñara* and the *puruṣa-kñara*. The *akñara-puruṣa*, or the Mahā-Viṣṇu, throws His glance over *prakāti*, or material nature, but the Puruñottama existed even before that. The ***Bāhad-āraēyaka Upaniñad*** therefore confirms the statement of the ***Bhagavad-gīta*** that Lord Kṛṣṇa is the Supreme Person (Puruñottama).

In some of the *Vedas* it is also said that in the beginning only the impersonal Brahman existed. However, according to this verse, the impersonal Brahman, which is the glowing effulgence of the body of the Supreme Lord, may be called the immediate cause, but the cause of all causes, or the remote cause, is the Supreme Personality of Godhead. The Lord's impersonal feature is existent in the material world because by

material senses or material eyes the Lord cannot be seen or perceived. One has to spiritualize the senses before one can expect to see or perceive the Supreme Lord. But He is always engaged in His personal capacity, and He is eternally visible to the inhabitants of Vaikunthaloka, eye to eye. Therefore He is materially impersonal, just as the executive head of the state may be impersonal in the government offices, although he is not impersonal in the government house. Similarly, the Lord is not impersonal in His abode, which is always *nirasta-kuhakam*, as stated in the very beginning of the *Bhägavatam*. Therefore both the impersonal and personal features of the Lord are acceptable, as mentioned in the revealed scriptures. This Personality of Godhead is very emphatically explained in the *Bhagavad-gita* in connection with the verse *brahmaëo hi pratiñöhäham* (Bg. 14.27). Therefore in all ways the confidential part of spiritual knowledge is realization of the Personality of Godhead, and not His impersonal Brahman feature. One should therefore have his ultimate aim of realization not in the impersonal feature but in the personal feature of the Absolute Truth. The example of the sky within the pot and the sky outside the pot may be helpful to the student for his realization of the all-pervading quality of the cosmic consciousness of the Absolute Truth. But that does not mean that the individual part and parcel of the Lord becomes the Supreme by a false claim. It means only that the conditioned soul is a victim of the illusory energy in her last snare. To claim to be one with the cosmic consciousness of the Lord is the last trap set by the illusory energy, or *daivé mäyä*. Even in the impersonal existence of the Lord, as it is in the material creation, one should aspire for personal realization of the Lord, and that is the meaning of *paçcäd ahaà yad etac ca yo 'vaçiñyeta so 'smy aham*.

Brahmäjä also accepted the same truth when he was instructing Närada. He said:

*so 'yaà te 'bhihitas täta
bhagavän viçva-bhävanaù*

(**Bhäg.** 2.7.50)

There is no other cause of all causes than the Supreme Personality of Godhead, Hari. Therefore this verse *aham eva* never indicates anything

other than the Supreme Lord, and one should therefore follow the path of the Brahma-sampradāya, or the path from Brahmājé to Nārada, to Vyāsadeva, etc., and make it a point in life to realize the Supreme Personality of Godhead, Hari, or Lord Kṛṣṇa. This very confidential instruction to the pure devotees of the Lord was also given to Arjuna and to Brahmā in the beginning of the creation. The demigods like Brahmā, Viṣṇu, Maheṣvara, Indra, Candra and Varuṇa are undoubtedly different forms of the Lord for execution of different functions; the different elemental ingredients of material creation, as well as the multifarious energies, also may be of the same Personality of Godhead, but the root of all of them is the Supreme Personality of Godhead, Sri Kṛṣṇa. One should be attached to the root of everything rather than bewildered by the branches and leaves. That is the instruction given in this verse.

TEXT 34

%Tae_Qa| YaTa(Pa[TaqYaeTa Na Pa[TaqYaeTa caTMaiNa)
TaiÜÜadaTMaNaae MaaYaa& YaQaa>aaSaae YaQaa TaMa")) 34))

āte 'rthāṇi yat pratéyeta

na pratéyeta cātmani

tad vidyād ātmano māyāṁ

yathābhāso yathā tamaṇi

SYNONYMS

āte—without; *artham*—value; *yat*—that which; *pratéyeta*—appears to be; *na*—not; *pratéyeta*—appears to be; *ca*—and; *ātmani*—in relation to Me; *tat*—that; *vidyāt*—you must know; *ātmanaṁ*—My; *māyām*—illusory energy; *yathā*—just as; *ābhāsaṁ*—the reflection; *yathā*—as; *tamaṇi*—the darkness.

TRANSLATION

O Brahmä, whatever appears to be of any value, if it is without relation to Me, has no reality. Know it as My illusory energy, that reflection which appears to be in darkness.

PURPORT

In the previous verse it has already been concluded that in any stage of the cosmic manifestation—its appearance, its sustenance, its growth, its interactions of different energies, its deterioration and its disappearance—all has its basic relation with the existence of the Personality of Godhead. And as such, whenever there is forgetfulness of this prime relation with the Lord, and whenever things are accepted as real without being related to the Lord, that conception is called a product of the illusory energy of the Lord. Because nothing can exist without the Lord, it should be known that the illusory energy is also an energy of the Lord. The right conclusion of dovetailing everything in relationship with the Lord is called *yoga-māyā*, or the energy of union, and the wrong conception of detaching a thing from its relationship with the Lord is called the Lord's *daivé māyā*, or *mahā-māyā*. Both the *māyās* also have connections with the Lord because nothing can exist without being related to Him. As such, the wrong conception of detaching relationships from the Lord is not false but illusory.

Misconceiving one thing for another thing is called illusion. For example, accepting a rope as a snake is illusion, but the rope is not false. The rope, as it exists in the front of the illusioned person, is not at all false, but the acceptance is illusory. Therefore the wrong conception of accepting this material manifestation as being divorced from the energy of the Lord is illusion, but it is not false. And this illusory conception is called the reflection of the reality in the darkness of ignorance. Anything that appears as apparently not being “produced out of My energy” is called *māyā*. The conception that the living entity is formless or that the Supreme Lord is formless is also illusion. In the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (2.12) it was said by the Lord in the midst of the battlefield that the warriors standing in front of Arjuna, Arjuna himself, and even the Lord had all existed before, they were existing on the Battlefield of Kurukñetra, and they would all continue to be individual personalities in the future also, even after the annihilation of the present body and even after being liberated from the bondage of material

existence. In all circumstances, the Lord and the living entities are individual personalities, and the personal features of both the Lord and living beings are never abolished; only the influence of the illusory energy, the reflection of light in the darkness, can, by the mercy of the Lord, be removed. In the material world, the light of the sun is also not independent, nor is that of the moon. The real source of light is the *brahmajyoti*, which diffuses light from the transcendental body of the Lord, and the same light is reflected in varieties of light: the light of the sun, the light of the moon, the light of fire, or the light of electricity. So the identity of the self as being unconnected with the Supreme Self, the Lord, is also illusion, and the false claim “*I am the Supreme*” is the last illusory snare of the same *māyā*, or the external energy of the Lord.

The *Vedānta-sūtra* in the very beginning affirms that everything is born from the Supreme, and thus, as explained in the previous verse, all individual living entities are born from the energy of the supreme living being, the Personality of Godhead. Brahmā himself was born from the energy of the Lord, and all other living entities are born from the energy of the Lord through the agency of Brahmā; none of them has any existence without being dovetailed with the Supreme Lord.

The independence of the individual living entity is not real independence, but is just the reflection of the real independence existing in the Supreme Being, the Lord. The false claim of supreme independence by the conditioned souls is illusion, and this conclusion is admitted in this verse.

Persons with a poor fund of knowledge become illusioned, and therefore the so-called scientists, physiologists, empiric philosophers, etc., become dazzled by the glaring reflection of the sun, moon, electricity, etc., and deny the existence of the Supreme Lord, putting forward theories and different speculations about the creation, maintenance and annihilation of everything material. The medical practitioner may deny the existence of the soul in the physiological bodily construction of an individual person, but he cannot give life to a dead body, even though all the mechanisms of the body exist even after death. The psychologist makes a serious study of the physiological conditions of the brain, as if the construction of the cerebral lump were the machine of the functioning mind, but in the dead body the

psychologist cannot bring back the function of the mind. These scientific studies of the cosmic manifestation or the bodily construction independent of the Supreme Lord are different reflective intellectual gymnastics only, but at the end they are all illusion and nothing more. All such advancement of science and knowledge in the present context of material civilization is but an action of the covering influence of the illusory energy. The illusory energy has two phases of existence, namely the covering influence and the throwing influence. By the throwing influence the illusory energy throws the living entities into the darkness of ignorance, and by the covering influence she covers the eyes of men with a poor fund of knowledge about the existence of the Supreme Person who enlightened the supreme individual living being, Brahmä. The identity of Brahmä with the Supreme Lord is never claimed herein, and therefore such a foolish claim by the man with a poor fund of knowledge is another display of the illusory energy of the Lord. The Lord says in the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (16.18–20) that demoniac persons who deny the existence of the Lord are thrown more and more into the darkness of ignorance, and thus such demoniac persons transmigrate life after life without any knowledge of the Supreme Personality of Godhead.

The sane man, however, is enlightened in the disciplic succession from Brahmäjé, who was personally instructed by the Lord, or in the disciplic succession from Arjuna, who was personally instructed by the Lord in the *Bhagavad-gita*. He accepts this statement of the Lord:

*ahaà sarvasya prabhavo
mattaù sarvaà pravartate
iti matvä bhajante mäà
budhä bhäva-samanvitäù*

(Bg. 10.8)

The Lord is the original source of all emanations, and everything that is created, maintained and annihilated exists by the energy of the Lord. The sane man who knows this is actually learned, and therefore he becomes a pure devotee of the Lord, engaged in the transcendental loving service of the Lord.

Although the reflectory energy of the Lord displays various illusions to the eyes of persons with a poor fund of knowledge, the sane person knows clearly that the Lord can act, even from far, far beyond our vision, by His different energies, just as fire can diffuse heat and light from a distant place. In the medical science of the ancient sages, known as the *Āyur-veda*, there is definite acceptance of the Lord's supremacy in the following words:

*jagad-yoner anicchasya
cid-ānandaika-rūpiṇa
puṇaso 'sti prakāṭir nityā
praticchāyeva bhāsvata*

*acetanāpi caitanya-
yogena paramātmana
akarod viçvam akhilam
anityam nāōākākātim*

There is one Supreme Person who is the progenitor of this cosmic manifestation and whose energy acts as *prakāṭi*, or the material nature, dazzling like a reflection. By such illusory action of *prakāṭi*, even dead matter is caused to move by the cooperation of living energy of the Lord, and the material world appears like a dramatic performance to the ignorant eyes. The ignorant person, therefore, may even be a scientist or physiologist in the drama of *prakāṭi*, while the sane person knows *prakāṭi* as the illusory energy of the Lord. By such a conclusion, as confirmed by the *Bhagavad-gita*, it is clear that the living entities are also a display of the Lord's superior energy (*parā prakāṭi*), just as the material world is a display of the Lord's inferior energy (*aparā prakāṭi*). The superior energy of the Lord cannot be as good as the Lord, although there is very little difference between the energy and the possessor of the energy, or the fire and the heat. Fire is possessed of heat, but heat is not fire. This simple thing is not understood by the man with a poor fund of knowledge who falsely claims that the fire and heat are the same. This energy of the fire (namely heat) is explained here as a reflection, and not directly fire. Therefore the living energy represented by the living entities is the reflection of the Lord, and never the Lord Himself. Being the reflection of the Lord, the existence of the living entity is dependent on the Supreme Lord, who is the original light.

This material energy may be compared to darkness, as actually it is darkness, and the activities of the living entities in the darkness are reflections of the original light. The Lord should be understood by the context of this verse. Nondependence of both the energies of the Lord is explained as *māyā*, or illusion. No one can make a solution of the darkness of ignorance simply by the reflection of light. Similarly, no one can come out of material existence simply by the reflected light of the common man; one has to receive the light from the original light itself. The reflection of sunlight in the darkness is unable to drive out the darkness, but the sunlight outside the reflection can drive out the darkness completely. In darkness no one can see the things in a room. Therefore a person in the dark is afraid of snakes and scorpions, although there may not be such things. But in the light the things in the room can be clearly seen, and the fear of snakes and scorpions is at once removed. Therefore one has to take shelter of the light of the Lord, as in the *Bhagavad-gita* or the *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, and not the reflective personalities who have no touch with the Lord. No one should hear *Bhagavad-gita* or *Srimad-Bhagavatam* from a person who does not believe in the existence of the Lord. Such a person is already doomed, and any association with such a doomed person makes the associater also doomed.

According to the *Padma Purana*, within the material compass there are innumerable material universes, and all of them are full of darkness. Any living being, beginning from the Brahmās (there are innumerable Brahmās in innumerable universes) to the insignificant ant, are all born in darkness, and they require factual light from the Lord to see Him directly, just as the sun can be seen only by the direct light of the sun. No lamp or man-made torchlight, however powerful it may be, can help one see the sun. The sun reveals itself. Therefore the action of different energies of the Lord, or the Personality of Godhead Himself, can be realized by the light manifested by the causeless mercy of the Lord. The impersonalists say that God cannot be seen. God can be seen by the light of God and not by man-made speculations. Here this light is specifically mentioned as *vidyāt*, which is an order by the Lord to Brahmā. This direct order of the Lord is a manifestation of His internal energy, and this particular energy is the means of seeing the Lord face to face. Not only Brahmā but anyone who may be graced by the Lord to see such merciful direct internal energy can also

realize the Personality of Godhead without any mental speculation.

TEXT 35

YaQaa MahaiNTa >aUTaaiNa >aUTaezUÀavceZvNau)
Pa[ivíaNYaPa[ivíaiNa TaQaa Taezu Na TaeZvhMa()) 35))

yathā mahānti bhūtāni

bhūteñüccāvaceñv anu

praviñöäny apraviñöäni

tathā teñu na teñv aham

SYNONYMS

yathā—just as; *mahānti*—the universal; *bhūtāni*—elements; *bhūteñu ucca-avaceñu*—in the minute and gigantic; *anu*—after; *praviñöäni*—entered; *apraviñöäni*—not entered; *tathā*—so; *teñu*—in them; *na*—not; *teñu*—in them; *aham*—Myself.

TRANSLATION

O Brahmā, please know that the universal elements enter into the cosmos and at the same time do not enter into the cosmos; similarly, I Myself also exist within everything created, and at the same time I am outside of everything.

PURPORT

The great elements of material creation, namely earth, water, fire, air and ether, all enter into the body of all manifested entities—the seas, mountains, aquatics, plants, reptiles, birds, beasts, human beings, demigods and everyone materially manifested—and at the same time such elements are differently situated. In the developed stage of consciousness, the human being can study both physiological and physical science, but the

basic principles of such sciences are nothing but the material elements and nothing more. The body of the human being and the body of the mountain, as also the bodies of the demigods, including Brahmā, are all of the same ingredients—earth, water, etc.—and at the same time the elements are beyond the body. The elements were created first, and therefore they entered into the bodily construction later, but in both circumstances they entered the cosmos and also did not enter. Similarly, the Supreme Lord, by His different energies, namely the internal and external, is within everything in the manifested cosmos, and at the same time He is outside of everything, situated in the kingdom of God (Vaikunthaloka) as described before. This is very nicely stated in the ***Brahma-saṁhitā*** (5.37) as follows:

*ānanda-cinmaya-rasa-pratibhāvitābhis
tābhir ya eva nija-rūpatayā kalābhiḥ
goloka eva nivasaty akhilātma-bhūto
govindam ādi-puruṣaṁ tam ahaṁ bhajāmi*

“I worship the Personality of Godhead, Govinda, who, by expansion of His internal potency of transcendental existence, knowledge and bliss, enjoys in His own and expanded forms. Simultaneously He enters into every atom of the creation.”

This expansion of His plenary parts is also more definitely explained in the same ***Brahma-saṁhitā*** (5.35) as follows:

*eko 'py asau racayituṁ jagad-aṁśa-koṭiṁ
yac-chaktir asti jagad-aṁśa-cayā yad-antaḥ
aṁśāntara-stha-paramāṇu-cayāntara-sthaḥ
govindam ādi-puruṣaṁ tam ahaṁ bhajāmi*

“I worship the Personality of Godhead, Govinda, who, by one of His plenary portions, enters into the existence of every universe and every particle of the atoms and thus unlimitedly manifests His infinite energy all over the material creation.”

The impersonalists can imagine or even perceive that the Supreme Brahman is thus all-pervading, and therefore they conclude that there is no

possibility of His personal form. Herein lies the mystery of His transcendental knowledge. This mystery is transcendental love of Godhead, and one who is surcharged with such transcendental love of Godhead can without difficulty see the Personality of Godhead in every atom and every movable or immovable object. And at the same time he can see the Personality of Godhead in His own abode, Goloka, enjoying eternal pastimes with His eternal associates, who are also expansions of His transcendental existence. This vision is the real mystery of spiritual knowledge, as stated by the Lord in the beginning (*sarahasyaà tad-aìgaà ca*). This mystery is the most confidential part of the knowledge of the Supreme, and it is impossible for the mental speculators to discover by dint of intellectual gymnastics. The mystery can be revealed through the process recommended by Brahmäjé in his ***Brahma-saṁhitā*** (5.38) as follows:

*premäjijana-cchurita-bhakti-vilocanena
santaù sadaiva hādayeñu vilokayanti
yaà çyāmasundaram acintya-guëa-svarüpaà
govindam ädi-puruṣaà tam ahaà bhajämi*

“I worship the original Personality of Godhead, Govinda, whom the pure devotees, their eyes smeared with the ointment of love of Godhead, always observe within their hearts. This Govinda, the original Personality of Godhead, is Çyāmasundara with all transcendental qualities.”

Therefore, although He is present in every atom, the Supreme Personality of Godhead may not be visible to the dry speculators; still the mystery is unfolded before the eyes of the pure devotees because their eyes are anointed with love of Godhead. And this love of Godhead can be attained only by the practice of transcendental loving service of the Lord, and nothing else. The vision of the devotees is not ordinary; it is purified by the process of devotional service. In other words, as the universal elements are both within and without, similarly the Lord’s name, form, quality, pastimes, entourage, etc., as they are described in the revealed scriptures or as performed in the Vaikunthalokas, far, far beyond the material cosmic manifestation, are factually being televised in the heart of the devotee. The man with a poor fund of knowledge cannot understand, although by

material science one can see things far away by means of television. Factually, the spiritually developed person is able to have the television of the kingdom of God always reflected within his heart. That is the mystery of knowledge of the Personality of Godhead.

The Lord can award anyone and everyone liberation (*mukti*) from the bondage of material existence, yet He rarely awards the privilege of love of Godhead, as confirmed by Nārada (*muktia dadhāti karhicit sma na bhakti-yogam*). This transcendental devotional service of the Lord is so wonderful that the occupation keeps the deserving devotee always rapt in psychological activities, without deviation from the absolute touch. Thus love of Godhead, developed in the heart of the devotee, is a great mystery. Brahmājé previously told Nārada that the desires of Brahmājé are never unfulfilled because he is always absorbed in the transcendental loving service of the Lord; nor has he any desire in his heart save and except the transcendental service of the Lord. That is the beauty and mystery of the process of *bhakti-yoga*. As the Lord's desire is infallible because He is *acyuta*, similarly the desires of the devotees in the transcendental service of the Lord are also *acyuta*, infallible. This is very difficult, however, for the layman to understand without knowledge of the mystery of devotional service, as it is very difficult to know the potency of touchstone. As touchstone is rarely found, a pure devotee of the Lord is also rarely to be seen, even amongst millions of liberated souls (*koöiñv api mahämune*). Out of all kinds of perfections attained by the process of knowledge, *yoga* perfection in devotional service is the highest of all and the most mysterious also, even more mysterious than the eight kinds of mystic perfection attained by the process of yogic performances. In the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (18.64) the Lord therefore advised Arjuna about this *bhakti-yoga*:

*sarva-guhyatamaà bhüyaù
çåëu me paramaà vacaù*

“Just hear from Me again about the most confidential part of the instructions in *Bhagavad-gita*.” The same was confirmed by Brahmājé to Nārada in the following words:

idaà bhägavataà nāma

*yan me bhagavatoditam
saìgraho 'yaà vibhüténää
tvam etad vipulékuru*

Brahmäjé said to Nārada, “Whatever I have spoken to you about the *Bhāgavatam* was explained to me by the Supreme Personality of Godhead, and I am advising you to expand these topics nicely so that people may easily understand the mysterious *bhakti-yoga* by transcendental loving service to the Lord.” It is to be noted here that the mystery of *bhakti-yoga* was disclosed to Brahmäjé by the Lord Himself. Brahmäjé explained the same mystery to Nārada, Nārada explained it to Vyāsa, Vyāsa explained it to Sukadeva Gosvami, and that same knowledge is coming down in the unalloyed chain of disciplic succession. If one is fortunate enough to have received the knowledge in the transcendental disciplic succession, surely he will have the chance to understand the mystery of the Lord and that of the *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, the sound incarnation of the Lord.

TEXT 36

**WTaavdev iJajaSYa& TatviJajaSauNaaTMaNa")
ANvYaVYaiTarek-a>Yaa& YaTa(SYaaTa(SavR}a SavRda)) 36))**

etāvad eva jijñāsyā

tattva-jijñāsunātmanaù

anvaya-vyatirekābhyā

yat syāt sarvatra sarvadā

SYNONYMS

etāvat—up to this; *eva*—certainly; *jijñāsyam*—is to be inquired; *tattva*—the Absolute Truth; *jijñāsunā*—by the student; *ātmanaù*—of the Self; *anvaya*—directly; *vyatirekābhyām*—indirectly; *yat*—whatever; *syāt*—it may be; *sarvatra*—in all space and time; *sarvadā*—in all circumstances.

TRANSLATION

A person who is searching after the Supreme Absolute Truth, the Personality of Godhead, most certainly search for it up to this, in all circumstances, in all space and time, and both directly and indirectly.

PURPORT

To unfold the mystery of *bhakti-yoga*, as it is explained in the previous verse, is the ultimate stage of all inquiries or the highest objective for the inquisitive. Everyone is searching after self-realization in different ways—by *karma-yoga*, by *jñāna-yoga*, by *dhyāna-yoga*, by *rāja-yoga*, by *bhakti-yoga*, etc. To engage in self-realization is the responsibility of every living entity developed in consciousness. One who is developed in consciousness certainly makes inquiries into the mystery of the self, of the cosmic situation and of the problems of life, in all spheres and fields—social, political, economic, cultural, religious, moral, etc.—and in their different branches. But here the goal of all such inquiries is explained.

The *Vedānta-sūtra* philosophy begins with this inquiry about life, and the *Bhāgavatam* answers such inquiries up to this point, or the mystery of all inquiries. Lord Brahmā wanted to be perfectly educated by the Personality of Godhead, and here is the answer by the Lord, finished in four nutshell verses, from *aham eva* to this verse, *etāvad eva*. This is the end of all self-realization processes. Men do not know that the ultimate goal of life is Viṣṇu, or the Supreme Personality of Godhead, due to being bewildered by the glaring reflection in the darkness, and as such everyone is entering into the darkest region of material existence, driven by the uncontrolled senses. The whole material existence has sprung up because of sense gratification, desires based principally on the sex desire, and the result is that in spite of all advancement of knowledge, the final goal of all the activities of the living entities is sense gratification. But here is the real goal of life, and everyone should know it by inquiries put before a bona fide spiritual master expert in the science of *bhakti-yoga*, or from a living personality of *Bhāgavatam* life. Everyone is engaged in various kinds of scriptural inquiries, but the *Srimad-Bhagavatam* gives answers to all of the various students of self-realization: this ultimate objective of life is not to be searched out without great labor

or perseverance. One who is imbued with such sincere inquiries must ask the bona fide spiritual master in the disciplic succession from Brahmäjé, and that is the direction given here. Because the mystery was disclosed before Brahmäjé by the Supreme Personality of Godhead, the mystery of all such inquiries regarding self-realization must be put before such a spiritual master, who is directly the representative of the Lord, acknowledged in that disciplic succession. Such a bona fide spiritual master is able to clear up the whole thing by evidence from the revealed scriptures, both direct and indirect. Although everyone is free to consult the revealed scriptures in this connection, one still requires the guidance of a bona fide spiritual master, and that is the direction in this verse. The bona fide spiritual master is the most confidential representative of the Lord, and one must receive direction from the spiritual master in the same spirit that Brahmäjé received it from the Personality of Godhead, Lord Kṛṣṇa. The bona fide spiritual master in that bona fide chain of disciplic succession never claims to be the Lord Himself, although such a spiritual master is greater than the Lord in the sense that he can deliver the Lord by his personally realized experience. The Lord is not to be found simply by education or by a good fertile brain, but surely He can be found by the sincere student through the transparent medium of the bona fide spiritual master.

The revealed scriptures give directions directly to this end, but because the bewildered living entities are blinded by the glaring reflection in the darkness, they are unable to find the truth of the revealed scriptures. For example, in the *Bhagavad-gita* the whole direction is targeted toward the personality of Godhead Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, but for want of a bona fide spiritual master in the line of Brahmäjé or the direct hearer, Arjuna, there are different distortions of the revealed knowledge by many unauthorized persons who just want to satisfy their own whims. Undoubtedly the *Bhagavad-gita* is accepted as one of the most brilliant stars in the horizon of the spiritual sky, yet the interpretations of this great book of knowledge have so grossly been distorted that every student of the *Bhagavad-gita* is still in the same darkness of glaring material reflections. Such students are hardly enlightened by the *Bhagavad-gita*. In the *Gétā* practically the same instruction is imparted as in the four prime verses of the *Bhāgavatam*, but due to wrong and fashionable interpretations by unauthorized persons, one cannot reach the ultimate conclusion. In the *Bhagavad-gita* (18.61) it is

clearly said:

*éçvaraù sarva-bhütänäà
håd-deçe 'rjuna tiñöhäti
bhrämayan sarva-bhütäni
yanträrüöhäni mäyayä*

The Lord is situated in the hearts of all living beings (as Paramätmä), and He is controlling all of them in the material world under the agency of His external energy. Therefore it is clearly mentioned that the Lord is the supreme controller and that the living entities are controlled by the Lord. In the same ***Bhagavad-gita*** (18.65) the Lord directs as follows:

*man-manä bhava mad-bhakto
mad-yäjä mäà namaskuru
mäm evaiñyasi satyaà te
pratijäne priyo 'si me*

It is clear from this verse of the *Bhagavad-gita* that the direction of the Lord is that one should be God-minded, a devotee of the Lord, a worshiper of the Lord, and must offer all obeisances unto Lord Kṛṣṇa. By so doing, the devotee will undoubtedly go back to Godhead, back to home.

Indirectly it is said that the whole Vedic social construction of human society is so made that everyone acts as a part and parcel of the complete body of the Lord. The intelligent class of men, or the *brahmanas*, are situated on the face of the Lord; the administrative class of men, the *kṣatriyas*, are situated on the arms of the Lord; the productive class of men, the *vaisyas*, are situated on the belt of the Lord; and the laborer class of men, the *sudras*, are situated on the legs of the Lord. Therefore the complete social construction is the body of the Lord, and all the parts of the body, namely the *brahmanas*, the *kṣatriyas*, the *vaisyas* and the *sudras*, are meant to serve the Lord's whole body conjointly; otherwise the parts become unfit to be coordinated with the supreme consciousness of oneness. Universal consciousness is factually achieved by coordinated service of all concerned to the Supreme Personality of Godhead, and that alone can insure total perfection. Therefore even the great scientists, the

great philosophers, the great mental speculators, the great politicians, the great industrialists, the great social reformers, etc., cannot give any relief to the restless society of the material world because they do not know the secret of success as mentioned in this verse of the *Bhāgavatam*, namely that one must know the mystery of *bhakti-yoga*. In the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (7.15) also it is said:

*na mää duñkåtino müòhäu
prapadyante narādhamäu
mäyayāpahāta-jjānā
āsuraà bhāvam āçritäu*

Because the so-called great leaders of human society are ignorant of this great knowledge of *bhakti-yoga* and are always engaged in ignoble acts of sense gratification, bewildered by the external energy of the Lord, they are stubborn rebels against the supremacy of the Supreme Personality of Godhead, and they never agree to surrender unto Him because they are fools, miscreants and the lowest type of human beings. Such faithless nonbelievers may be highly educated in the material sense of the term, but factually they are the greatest fools of the world because by the influence of the external, material nature all their so-called acquisition of knowledge has been made null and void. Therefore all advancement of knowledge in the present context of things is being misused by cats and dogs fighting with one another for sense gratification, and all acquisition of knowledge in science, philosophy, fine arts, nationalism, economic development, religion and great activities are being spoiled by being used as dresses for dead men. There is no utility in the dresses used for covering a coffin of a dead body save getting false applause from the ignorant public. The *Srimad-Bhagavatam* therefore says again and again that without attainment of the status of *bhakti-yoga*, all the activities of human society are to be considered absolute failures only. It is said:

*parābhavas tävad abodha-jāto
yāvan na jijjāsata ātma-tattvam
yāvat kriyās tävad idaà mano vai
karmātmakaà yena çaréra-bandhaù*

(**Bhäg.** 5.5.5)

As long as one is blind to inquiring after self-realization, all material activities, however great they may be, are all different kinds of defeat because the aim of human life is not fulfilled by such unwanted and profitless activities. The function of the human body is to attain freedom from material bondage, but as long as one is fully absorbed in material activities, his mind will be overwhelmed in the whirlpool of matter, and thus he will continue to be encaged in material bodies life after life.

*evaà manaù karma-vaçaà prayuikte
avidyayätmany upadhéyamäne
prétir na yävan mayi väsudeve
na mucyate deha-yogena tävat*

(**Bhäg.** 5.5.6)

It is one's mind that generates different kinds of bodies for suffering different kinds of material pangs. Therefore as long as the mind is absorbed in fruitive activities, the mind is understood to be absorbed in nescience, and thus one is sure to be subjected to material bondage in different bodies again and again until one develops a transcendental love for Godhead, Väsudeva, the Supreme Person. To become absorbed in the transcendental name, quality, form and activities of the Supreme Person, Väsudeva, means to change the temper of the mind from matter to absolute knowledge, which leads one to the path of absolute realization and thus frees one from the bondage of material contact and encagements in different material bodies.

Srila Jiva Gosvami Prabhupäda therefore comments on the words *sarvatra sarvadä* in the sense that the principles of *bhakti-yoga*, or devotional service to the Lord, are apt in all circumstances; i.e., *bhakti-yoga* is recommended in all the revealed scriptures, it is performed by all authorities, it is important in all places, it is useful in all causes and effects, etc. As far as all the revealed scriptures are concerned, he quotes from the *Skanda Purana* on the topics of Brahmä and Närada as follows:

*saàsäre 'smin mahä-ghore
janma-måtyu-samäkule
püjanaà väsudevasya
tärakaà vädibhiù småtam*

In the material world, which is full of darkness and dangers, combined with birth and death and full of different anxieties, the only way to get out of the great entanglement is to accept loving transcendental devotional service to Lord Väsudeva. This is accepted by all classes of philosophers.

Srila Jiva Gosvami also quotes another common passage, which is found in three *Puranas*, namely the *Padma Purana*, *Skanda Purana* and *Lìga Purana*. It runs as follows:

*äloöya sarva-çästräni
vicärya ca punaù punaù
idam ekaà suniñpannaà
dhyeyo nārāyaëaù sadä*

“By scrutinizingly reviewing all the revealed scriptures and judging them again and again, it is now concluded that Lord Nārāyaṇa is the Supreme Absolute Truth, and thus He alone should be worshiped.”

The same truth is also indirectly described in the *Garuða Purana* as follows:

*päraà gato 'pi vedänäà
sarva-çästrārtha-vedy api
yo na sarveçvare bhaktas
taà vidyät puruñädhamam*

“Even though one may have gone to the other side of all the *Vedas*, and even though one is well versed in all the revealed scriptures, if one is not a devotee of the Supreme Lord, he must be considered the lowest of mankind.” Similarly, it is also stated in ***Srimad-Bhagavatam*** (5.18.12) indirectly as follows:

yasyästi bhaktir bhagavaty akiicanä

*sarvair guëais tatra samäsate suräù
haräv abhaktasya kuto mahad-guëä
mano-rathenäsati dhävato bahiù*

One who has unflinching devotion unto the Supreme Personality of Godhead must have all the good qualities of the demigods, and contrarily one who is not a devotee of the Lord must be hovering in the darkness of mental speculation and thus must be engaged in material impermanence. **Srimad-Bhagavatam** (11.11.18) says:

*çabda-brahmaëi niñëäto
na niñëäyät pare yadi
çramas tasya çrama-phalo
hy adhenum iva rakñataù*

“One may be well versed in all the transcendental literature of the *Vedas*, but if he fails to be acquainted with the Supreme, then it must be concluded that all of his education is like the burden of a beast or like one’s keeping a cow without milking capacity.”

Similarly, the liberty of discharging loving transcendental service to the Lord is invested in everyone, even the women, the *sudras*, the forest tribes, or any other living beings born in sinful conditions.

*te vai vidanty atitaranti ca deva-mäyää
stré-çüdra-hüëa-çabarä api päpa-jéväù
yady adbhuta-krama-paräyaëa-çélaçikñäs
tiryag-janä api kimu çruta-dhäraëä ye*

(Bhäg. 2.7.46)

The lowest of human beings can be elevated to the highest stage of devotional life if they are trained by the bona fide spiritual master well versed in the transcendental loving service of the Lord. If the lowest can be so elevated, then what to speak of the highest, who are well versed in the Vedic knowledge? The conclusion is that devotional service to the Lord is open for all, regardless of who they are. That is the confirmation of its

application for all kinds of performers of the service.

Therefore the devotional service of the Lord with perfect knowledge through the training of a bona fide spiritual master is advised for everyone, even if one happens not to be a human being. This is confirmed in the *Garuḍa Purana* as follows:

*kéöa-pakñi-mägäëää ca
harau sannyasta-cetasäm
ürdhväm eva gatià manye
kià punar jñäninää nãëäm*

“Even the worms, birds and beasts are assured of elevation to the highest perfectional life if they are completely surrendered to the transcendental loving service of the Lord, so what to speak of the philosophers amongst the human beings?”

Therefore there is no need to seek properly qualified candidates for discharging devotional service to the Lord. Let them be either well behaved or ill trained, let them be either learned or fools, let them be either grossly attached or in the renounced order of life, let them be liberated souls or desirous of salvation, let them be inexpert in the discharge of devotional service or expert in the same, all of them can be elevated to the supreme position by discharging devotional service under the proper guidance. This is also confirmed in the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (9.30,32) as follows:

*api cet su-duräcäro
bhajate mäm ananya-bhäk
sädhur eva sa mantavyau
samyag vyavasito hi saù*

*mää hi pätha vyapäçritya
ye 'pi syuù päpa-yonayaù
striyo vaiçyäs tathä çüdräs
te 'pi yänti parää gatim*

Even if a person is fully addicted to all sorts of sinful acts, if he happens to

be engaged in the loving transcendental service of the Lord under proper guidance, he is to be considered the most perfect holy man without a doubt. And thus any person, whatsoever and whosoever he or she may be—even the fallen woman, the less intelligent laborer, the dull mercantile man, or even a man lower than all these—can attain the highest perfection of life by going back home, back to Godhead, provided he or she takes shelter of the lotus feet of the Lord in all earnestness. This sincere earnestness is the only qualification that can lead one to the highest perfectional stage of life, and unless and until such real earnestness is aroused, there is a difference between cleanliness or uncleanness, learning or nonlearning, in the material estimation. Fire is always fire, and thus if someone touches the fire, knowingly or unknowingly, the fire will act in its own way without discrimination. The principle is: *harir harati pāpāni duñña-cittair api smātaù*. The all-powerful Lord can purify the devotee of all sinful reactions, just as the sun can sterilize all sorts of infections by its powerful rays. “Attraction for material enjoyment cannot act upon a pure devotee of the Lord.” There are hundreds and thousands of aphorisms in the revealed scriptures. *Ātmārāmāṣ ca munayaù*: “Even the self-realized souls are also attracted by the transcendental loving service of the Lord.” *Kecit kevalayā bhaktyā vāsudeva-parāyaēāù*: [SB 6.1.15] “Simply by hearing and chanting, one becomes a great devotee of Lord Vāsudeva.” *Na calati bhagavat-padāravindāl lavanimiñārdham api sa vaiñēavāgryaù*: “A person who does not move from the lotus feet of the Lord even for a moment or a second is to be considered the greatest of all Vaiñēava s.” *Bhagavat-pārñadatā prāpte mat-sevayā pratētaà te*: “The pure devotees are convinced of attaining the association of the Personality of Godhead, and thus they are always engaged in the transcendental loving service of the Lord.” Therefore in all continents, in all planets, in all universes, devotional service to the Lord, or *bhakti-yoga*, is current, and that is the statement of the *Srimad-Bhagavatam* and allied scriptures. Everywhere means in every part of the creation of the Lord. The Lord can be served by all the senses, or even simply by the mind. The South Indian *brahmana* who served the Lord simply on the strength of his mind also factually realized the Lord. Success is guaranteed for a devotee who fully engages any one of his senses in the mode of devotional service. The Lord can be served by any ingredient, even the most common commodity—a flower, a leaf, a fruit or a little water, which are available in any part of the universe and without cost—and thus

the Lord is served universally by the universal entities. He can be served simply by hearing, He can be served simply by chanting or reading about His activities, He can be served simply by adoring Him and accepting Him.

In the *Bhagavad-gita* it is stated that one can serve the Lord by offering the result of one's own work; it does not matter what one does. Generally men may say that whatever they are doing is inspired by God, but that is not all. One should actually work on behalf of God as a servant of God. The Lord says in the *Bhagavad-gita* (9.27):

*yat karoṇi yad aṇāsi
yaj juhoṇi dadāsi yat
yat tapasyasi kaunteya
tat kuruṇva mad-arpaṇam*

Do whatever you like or whatever may be easier for you to do, eat whatever you may eat, sacrifice whatever you can sacrifice, give whatever you may give in charity, and do whatever you may undertake in penance, but everything must be done for Him only. If you do business or if you accept some employment, do so on behalf of the Lord. Whatever you may eat, you may offer the same to the Lord and be assured that He will return the food after eating it Himself. He is the complete whole, and therefore whatever He may eat as offered by the devotee is accepted because of the devotee's love, but again it is returned as *prasāda* for the devotee so that he can be happy by eating. In other words, be a servant of God and live peacefully in that consciousness, ultimately returning home, back to Godhead.

It is said in the *Skanda Purana*:

*yasya smṛtyā ca nāmoktyā
tapo-yajña-kriyādiṇu
nūnaṁ sampūrṇatām eti
sadyo vande tam acyutam*

"I offer my obeisances unto Him, the infallible, because simply by either remembering Him or vibrating His holy name one can attain the perfection

of all penances, sacrifices or fruitive activities, and this process can be universally followed.” It is enjoined (**Bhäg.** 2.3.10):

*akämaù sarva-kämo vä
mokña-käma udära-dhéù
tévreëa bhakti-yogena
yajeta puruṣaà param*

Though a person be full of desires or have no desires, he may follow this path of infallible *bhakti-yoga* for complete perfection.” One need not be anxious to propitiate each and every demigod and goddess because the root of all of them is the Personality of Godhead. As by pouring water on the root of the tree one serves and enlivens all the branches and leaves, so by rendering service unto the Supreme Lord one automatically serves every god and goddess without extraneous effort. The Lord is all-pervading, and therefore service unto Him is also all-pervading. This fact is corroborated in the *Skanda Purana* as follows:

*arcite deva-deveçe
çaikha-cakra-gadä-dhare
arcitäù sarva-deväù syur
yataù sarva-gato hariù*

When the Supreme Lord, the personality of Godhead, who carries in His hands a conchshell, wheel, club and lotus flower, is worshiped, certainly all other demigods are worshiped automatically because Hari, the personality of Godhead, is all-pervading. Therefore, in all cases, namely nominative, objective, causative, dative, ablative, possessive and supportive, everyone is benefited by such transcendental loving service to the Lord. The man who worships the Lord, the Lord Himself who is worshiped, the cause for which the Lord is worshiped, the source of supply, the place where such worship is done, etc.—everything is benefited by such an action.

Even during the annihilation of the material world, the process of *bhakti-yoga* can be applied. *Kälena nañöä pralaye väëëyam*: the Lord is worshiped in devastation because He protects the *Vedas* from being annihilated. He is worshiped in every millennium or *yuga*. As it is said in **Srimad-Bhagavatam**

(12.3.52):

*kåte yad dhyäyato viṣṇuà
tretäyää yajato makhaiù
dväpare paricaryäyää
kalau tad dhari-kértanät*

In the *Viṣṇu Purana* it is written:

*sa hānis tan mahac chidraà
sa mohaù sa ca vibhramaù
yan-muhūrtaà kñāëaà väpi
väsudevaà na cintayet*

“If even for a moment remembrance of Väsudeva, the Supreme Personality of Godhead, is missed, that is the greatest loss, that is the greatest illusion, and that is the greatest anomaly.” The Lord can be worshiped in all stages of life. For instance, even in the wombs of their mothers Maharaja Prahlāda and Maharaja Parikṣit worshiped the Lord; even in his very childhood, at the age of only five years, Dhruva Maharaja worshiped the Lord; even in full youth, Maharaja Ambarēña worshiped the Lord; and even at the last stage of his frustration and old age Maharaja Dhātārāñña worshiped the Lord. Ajāmila worshiped the Lord even at the point of death, and Citraketu worshiped the Lord even in heaven and in hell. In the *Narasiñha Purana* it is said that as the hellish inhabitants began to chant the holy name of the Lord they began to be elevated from hell towards heaven. Durvāsā Muni has also supported this view: *mucyeta yan-nāmny udite nārako ’pi*. “Simply by chanting the holy name of the Lord the inhabitants of hell became released from their hellish persecution.” So the conclusion of *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, as given by Sukadeva Gosvami to Maharaja Parikṣit, is:

*etan nirvidyamānānām
icchatām akuto-bhayam
yoginää nāpa nirëetaà
harer nāmānukértanam*

“O King, it is finally decided that everyone, namely those in the renounced

order of life, the mystics, and the enjoyers of fruitive work, should chant the holy name of the Lord fearlessly to achieve the desired success in their pursuits.” (**Bhäg.** 2.1.11)

Similarly, as indicated indirectly in various places in revealed scriptures:

1. Even though one is well versed in all the *Vedas* and scriptures, if one is not a devotee of the Supreme Lord, the Personality of Godhead, he is considered to be the lowest of mankind.
2. In the *Garuòà Purana*, *Båhan-nåradéya Purana* and *Padma Purana*, the same is repeated: What is the use of Vedic knowledge and penances for one who is devoid of devotional service to the Lord?
3. What is the comparison of thousands of *prajäpatīs* to one devotee of the Lord?
4. Sukadeva Gosvami said (**Bhäg.** 2.4.17) that neither the ascetic, nor one who is greatly munificent, nor one who is famous, nor the great philosopher, nor the great occultist, nor anyone else can achieve the desired result without being engaged in the service of the Lord.
5. Even if a place is more glorious than heaven, if there is no glorification of the Lord of Vaikuntha or His pure devotee, it should at once be quitted.
6. The pure devotee refuses to accept all the five different types of liberation in order to be engaged in the service of the Lord.

The final conclusion, therefore, is that the glories of the Lord must be always and everywhere proclaimed. One should hear about His glories, one should chant about His glories, and one should always remember His glories because that is the highest perfectional stage of life. As far as fruitive work is concerned, it is limited to an enjoyable body; as far as *yoga* is concerned, it is limited to the acquirement of mystic power; as far as empiric philosophy is concerned, it is limited to the attainment of transcendental knowledge; and as far as transcendental knowledge is concerned, it is limited to attainment of salvation. Even if they are adopted,

there is every chance of discrepancies in discharging the particular type of functions. But adoption of the transcendental devotional service of the Lord has no limit, nor is there fear of falling down. The process automatically reaches the final stage by the grace of the Lord. In the preliminary stage of devotional service there is an apparent requisite for knowledge, but in the higher stage there is no necessity of such knowledge. The best and guaranteed path of progress is therefore engagement in *bhakti-yoga*, pure devotional service.

The cream of *Srimad-Bhagavatam* in the foregoing four *çloka*s is sometimes squeezed out by the impersonalist for different interpretations in their favor, but it should be carefully noted that the four *çloka*s were first described by the Personality of Godhead Himself, and thus the impersonalist has no scope to enter into them because he has no conception of the Personality of Godhead. Therefore, the impersonalist may squeeze out any interpretations from them, but such interpretations will never be accepted by those who are taught in the disciplic succession from Brahmä, as will be cleared up in the following verses. Besides that, the *śruti* confirms that the Supreme Truth Absolute Personality of Godhead never reveals Himself to anyone who is falsely proud of his academic knowledge. The *śruti-mantra* clearly says (*Kaöha Upaniñad* 1.2.23):

*näyam ätmä pravacanena labhyo
na medhayä na bahudhā çrutena
yam evaiñä vâëute tena labhyas
tasyaiñä ätmä vivâëute tanuà sväm*

The whole matter is explained by the Lord Himself, and one who has no approach to the Lord in His personal feature can rarely understand the purport of *Srimad-Bhagavatam* without being taught by the *bhägavatas* in the disciplic succession.

TEXT 37

**WTaNMaTa& SaMaaiTaï ParMae<a SaMaaiDaNaa)
>avaNa(k-LPaivk-LPaezu Na ivMauùiTa k-ihRicTa()) 37))**

etan mataà samätiñöha

parameëa samädhinä

bhavän kalpa-vikalpeñu

na vimuhyati karhicit

SYNONYMS

etat—this; *matam*—the conclusion; *samätiñöha*—remain fixed; *parameëa*—by the supreme; *samädhinä*—concentration of the mind; *bhavän*—yourself; *kalpa*—intermediate devastation; *vikalpeñu*—in the final devastation; *na vimuhyati*—will never bewilder; *karhicit*—anything like complacency.

TRANSLATION

O Brahmä, just follow this conclusion by fixed concentration of mind, and no pride will disturb you, neither in the partial nor in the final devastation.

PURPORT

As in the *Bhagavad-gita*, Tenth Chapter, the Personality of Godhead, Lord Kṛṣṇa, has summarized the whole text in four verses, namely, *ahaà sarvasya prabhavaù*, etc., so the complete *Srimad-Bhagavatam* has also been summarized in four verses, as *aham eväsam evägre*, etc. Thus the secret purpose of the most important Bhāgavatite conclusion has been explained by the original speaker of the *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, who was also the original speaker of the *Bhagavad-gita*, the Personality of Godhead, Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa. There are many grammarians and nondevotee material wranglers who have tried to present false interpretations of these four verses of the *Srimad-Bhagavatam* but the Lord Himself advised Brahmäjé not to be deviated from the fixed conclusion the Lord had taught him. The Lord was the teacher of the nucleus of *Srimad-Bhagavatam* in four verses, and Brahmä was the receiver of the knowledge. Misinterpretation of the word

aham by the word jugglery of the impersonalist should not disturb the mind of the strict followers of the *Srimad-Bhagavatam*. *Srimad-Bhagavatam* is the text of the Personality of Godhead and His unalloyed devotees, who are also known as the *bhāgavatas*, and any outsider should have no access to this confidential literature of devotional service. But unfortunately the impersonalist, who has no relation to the Supreme Personality of Godhead, sometimes tries to interpret *Srimad-Bhagavatam* by his poor fund of knowledge in grammar and dry speculation. Therefore, the Lord warns Brahmā (and, through Brahmā, all future devotees of the Lord in the disciplic succession of Brahmā) that one should never be misled by the conclusion of the so-called grammarians or by other men with a poor fund of knowledge, but must always fix the mind properly, via the *paramparā* system. No one should try to give a new interpretation by dint of mundane knowledge. And the first step, therefore, in pursuance of the system of knowledge received by Brahmā, is to approach a bona fide *guru* who is the representative of the Lord following the *paramparā* system. No one should try to squeeze out his own meaning by imperfect mundane knowledge. The *guru*, or the bona fide spiritual master, is competent to teach the disciple in the right path with reference to the context of all authentic Vedic literature. He does not attempt to juggle words to bewilder the student. The bona fide spiritual master, by his personal activities, teaches the disciple the principles of devotional service. Without personal service, one would go on speculating like the impersonalists and dry speculators life after life and would be unable to reach the final conclusion. By following the instructions of the bona fide spiritual master in conjunction with the principles of revealed scriptures, the student will rise to the plane of complete knowledge, which will be exhibited by development of detachment from the world of sense gratification. The mundane wranglers are surprised that one can detach himself from the world of sense gratification, and thus any attempt to be fixed in God realization appears to them to be mysticism. This detachment from the sensory world is called the *brahma-bhūta* stage of realization, the preliminary stage of transcendental devotional life (*parā bhakti*). The *brahma-bhūta* stage of life is also known as the *ātmārāma* stage, in which one is fully self-satisfied and does not hanker for the world of sense enjoyment. This stage of full satisfaction is the proper situation for understanding the transcendental knowledge of the Personality of

Godhead. The ***Srimad-Bhagavatam*** (1.2.20) affirms this:

*evaà prasanna-manaso
bhagavad-bhakti-yogataù
bhagavat-tattva-vijñānā
mukta-saigasya jāyate*

Thus in the completely satisfied stage of life, exhibited by full detachment from the world of sense enjoyment as a result of performing devotional service, one can understand the science of God in the liberated stage.

In this stage of full satisfaction and detachment from the sensory world, one can know the mystery of the science of God with all its confidential intricacies, and not by grammar or academic speculation. Because Brahmā qualified himself for such reception, the Lord was pleased to disclose the purpose of *Srimad-Bhagavatam*. This direct instruction by the Lord to any devotee who is detached from the world of sense gratification is possible, as stated in the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (10.10):

*teñāà satata-yuktānā
bhajatāà prēti-pūrvakam
dadāmi buddhi-yogaà taà
yena mām upayānti te*

Unto the devotees who are constantly engaged in the Lord's transcendental loving service (*prēti-pūrvakam*), the Lord, out of His causeless mercy upon the devotee, gives direct instructions so that the devotee may make accurate progress on the path returning home, back to Godhead. One should not, therefore, try to understand these four verses of *Srimad-Bhagavatam* by mental speculation. Rather, by direct perception of the Supreme Personality of Godhead, one is able to know all about His abode, Vaikuntha, as was seen and experienced by Brahmājé. Such Vaikuntha realization is possible by any devotee of the Lord situated in the transcendental position as a result of devotional service.

In the *Gopāla-tāpané Upaniñad* (*śruti*) it is said, *gopa-veço me puruṣaù purastād āvirbabhuva*: the Lord appeared before Brahmā as a cowboy, that

is, as the original Personality of Godhead, Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, Govinda, who is later described by Brahmājé in his ***Brahma-saṃhitā*** (5.29):

*cintāmaëi-prakara-sadmasu kalpa-våkñā-
lakñävâteñu surabhér abhipālayantam
lakñmé-sahasra-çata-sambhrama-sevyamānaà
govindam ädi-puruşaà tam ahaà bhajämi*

Brahmājé desires to worship the original personality of Godhead, Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, who resides in the topmost Vaikuntha planet, known as Goloka Våndävana, where He is in the habit of keeping *surabhi* cows as a cowboy and where He is served by hundreds and thousands of goddesses of fortune (the *gopés*) with love and respect.

Therefore Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa is the original form of the Supreme Lord (*kåñëas tu bhagavän svayam*). This is also clear from this instruction. The Supreme Personality of Godhead is Lord Kṛṣṇa, and not directly Nārāyaṇa or the *puruşa-avatāras*, which are subsequent manifestations. Therefore *Srimad-Bhagavatam* means consciousness of the Supreme Personality of Godhead Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, and *Srimad-Bhagavatam* is the sound representation of the Lord as much as the *Bhagavad-gita* is. Thus the conclusion is that *Srimad-Bhagavatam* is the science of the Lord in which the Lord and His abode are perfectly realized.

TEXT 38

é[qéuk- ovac
SaMPa[idXYaEvMaJaNaee JaNaaNaa& ParMaeiNaMa()
PaXYaTaSTaSYa Tad(æPaMaaTMaNaae NYaå<aÖir")) 38))

çré-çuka uvāca

sampradiçyaivam ajano

janänäà parameñöhinam

paçyatas tasya tad rūpam

ätmano nyaruëad dhariù

SYNONYMS

çré-çukaù uväca—Sri Sukadeva Gosvami said; *sampradiçya*—fully instructing Brahmäjé; *evam*—thus; *ajanaù*—the Supreme Lord; *janänäm*—of the living entities; *parameñöhinam*—unto the supreme leader, Brahmä; *paçyataù*—while he was seeing; *tasya*—His; *tat rūpam*—that transcendental form; *ätmanaù*—of the Absolute; *nyaruëat*—disappeared; *hariù*—the Lord, the Personality of Godhead.

TRANSLATION

Sukadeva Gosvami said to Maharaja Pariksit: The Supreme Personality of Godhead, Hari, after being seen in His transcendental form, instructing Brahmäjé, the leader of the living entities, disappeared.

PURPORT

In this verse it is clearly mentioned that the Lord is *ajanaù*, or the Supreme Person, and that He was showing His transcendental form (*ätmano rūpam*) to Brahmäjé while instructing him in the summarization of *Srimad-Bhagavatam* in four verses. He is *ajanaù*, or the Supreme Person, amongst *janänäm*, or all persons. All living entities are individual persons, and amongst all such persons Lord Hari is supreme, as confirmed in the *śruti-mantra*, *nityo nityänää cetanaç cetanänäm*. So there is no place for impersonal features in the transcendental world as there are impersonal features in the material world. Whenever there is *cetana*, or knowledge, the personal feature comes in. In the spiritual world everything is full of knowledge, and therefore everything in the transcendental world, the land, the water, the tree, the mountain, the river, the man, the animal, the bird—everything—is of the same quality, namely *cetana*, and therefore everything there is individual and personal. *Srimad-Bhagavatam* gives us this information as the supreme Vedic literature, and it was personally instructed by the Supreme Personality of Godhead to Brahmäjé so that the leader of the living entities might broadcast the message to all in the universe in order to teach the supreme knowledge of *bhakti-yoga*.

Brahmäjé in his turn instructed Nārada, his beloved son, the same message of *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, and Nārada, in his turn, taught the same to Vyāsadeva, who again taught it to Sukadeva Gosvami. Through Sukadeva Gosvami's grace and by the mercy of Maharaja Parikṣit we are all given *Srimad-Bhagavatam* perpetually to learn the science of the Absolute Personality of Godhead, Lord Kṛṣṇa.

TEXT 39

ANTaihRTaeiNd]YaaQaaRYa hrYae ivihTaaÅil/")
SavR>aUTaMaYaae ivi& SaSaJaeRd& Sa PaUvRvTa()) 39))

antarhitendriyārthāya

haraye vihitāijaliù

sarva-bhūtamayo viçvaà

sasarjedaà sa pūrvavat

SYNONYMS

antarhita—on the disappearance; *indriya-arthāya*—unto the Personality of Godhead, the objective of all senses; *haraye*—unto the Lord; *vihita-aījaliù*—in folded hands; *sarva-bhūta*—all living entities; *mayaù*—full of; *viçvam*—the universe; *sasarja*—created; *idam*—this; *saù*—he (Brahmäjé); *pūrvavat*—exactly like before.

TRANSLATION

On the disappearance of the Supreme Personality of Godhead, Hari, who is the object of transcendental enjoyment for the senses of devotees, Brahmä, with folded hands, began to re-create the universe, full with living entities, as it was previously.

PURPORT

The Supreme Personality of Godhead, Hari, is the object for fulfilling the senses of all living entities. Illusioned by the glaring reflection of the external energy, the living entities worship the senses instead of engaging them properly in fulfilling the desires of the Supreme.

In the ***Hari-bhakti-sudhodaya*** (13.2) there is the following verse:

*akñëoù phalaà tvädâça-darçanaà hi
tanoù phalaà tvädâça-gätra-saigaù
jihvä-phalaà tvädâça-kértanaà hi
sudurlabhä bhägavatä hi loka*

“O devotee of the Lord, the purpose of the visual sense is fulfilled simply by seeing you, and to touch your body is the fulfillment of bodily touch. The tongue is meant for glorifying your qualities because in this world a pure devotee of the Lord is very difficult to find.”

Originally the senses of the living entity were awarded for this purpose, namely to engage them in the transcendental loving service of the Lord or that of His devotees, but the conditioned souls, illusioned by the material energy, became captivated by sense enjoyment. Therefore the whole process of God consciousness is meant to rectify the conditional activities of the senses and to re-engage them in the direct service of the Lord. Lord Brahmä thus engaged his senses in the Lord by re-creating the conditioned living entities to act in the re-created universe. This material universe is thus created and annihilated by the will of the Lord. It is created to give the conditioned soul a chance to act to return home, back to Godhead, and servants like Brahmäjé, Nārada-jé, Vyäsajé and their company become busy with the same purpose of the Lord: to reclaim the conditioned souls from the field of sense gratification and return them to the normal stage of engaging the senses in service of the Lord. Instead of doing so, i.e. converting the actions of the senses, the impersonalists began to make the conditioned souls sense-less, and the Lord also senseless. That is improper treatment for the conditioned souls. The diseased condition of the senses may be treated by curing the defect, but not uprooting the senses altogether. When there is some disease in the eyes, the eyes may be cured to see properly. Plucking out the eyes is no treatment. Similarly, the whole

material disease is based on the process of sense gratification, and liberation from the diseased condition is re-engagement of the senses to see the beauty of the Lord, hear His glories, and act on His account. Thus Brahmäjé created the universal activities again.

TEXT 40

Pa[JaaPaiTaDaRMaRPaiTarek-da iNaYaMaaNa(YaMaaNa()
>ad]& Pa[JaaNaaMaiNvC^àaiTaiTa(SvaQaRk-aMYaYaa)) 40))

prajāpatir dharma-patir

ekadā niyamān yamān

bhadraà prajānām anvicchann

ātiñöhat svārtha-kāmyayā

SYNONYMS

prajā-patiù—the forefather of all living entities; *dharma-patiù*—the father of religious life; *ekadā*—once upon a time; *niyamān*—rules and regulations; *yamān*—principles of control; *bhadram*—welfare; *prajānām*—of the living beings; *anvicchan*—desiring; *ātiñöhat*—situated; *sva-artha*—own interest; *kāmyayā*—so desiring.

TRANSLATION

Thus once upon a time the forefather of living entities and the father of religiousness, Lord Brahmä, situated himself in acts of regulative principles, desiring self-interest for the welfare of all living entities.

PURPORT

One cannot be situated in an exalted position without having undertaken a regulative life of rules and regulations. An unrestricted life of sense gratification is animal life, and Lord Brahmä, in order to teach all concerned

within the jurisdiction of his generations, taught the same principles of sense control for executing higher duties. He desired the welfare of all as servants of God, and anyone desiring the welfare of the members of his family and generations must conduct a moral, religious life. The highest life of moral principles is to become a devotee of the Lord because a pure devotee of the Lord has all the good qualities of the Lord. On the other hand, one who is not a devotee of the Lord, however qualified he may be in the mundane sense of the term, cannot be qualified with any good quality worthy of the name. The pure devotees of the Lord, like Brahmā and persons in the chain of disciplic succession, do not do anything to instruct their subordinates without acting accordingly themselves.

TEXT 41

**Ta& Naard" iPa[YaTaMaae irKQaadaNaaMaNauv]Ta")
éué[UzMaa<a" Xaqle/Na Pa[é[Yae<a dMaeNa c)) 41))**

taà nāradaù priyatamo

rikthādānām anuvrataù

çuçrũñamäëaù çélena

praçrayeëa damena ca

SYNONYMS

tam—unto him; *nāradaù*—the great sage Nārada; *priyatamaù*—very dear; *riktha-ādānām*—of the inheritor sons; *anuvrataù*—very obedient; *çuçrũñamäëaù*—always ready to serve; *çélena*—by good behavior; *praçrayeëa*—by meekness; *damena*—by sense control; *ca*—also.

TRANSLATION

Nārada, the most dear of the inheritor sons of Brahmā, always ready to serve his father, strictly follows the instructions of his father by his mannerly behavior, meekness and sense control.

TEXT 42

**MaaYaa& ivividzNa(ivZ<aaeMaaRYaeXaSYa MahaMauiNa")
Maha>aaGavTaae raJaNa(iPaTar& PaYaRTaaezYaTa()) 42))**

mäyää vividiñan viñëor

mäyeçasya mahä-muniù

mahä-bhägavato räjan

pitaraà paryatoñayat

SYNONYMS

mäyäm—energies; *vividiñan*—desiring to know; *viñëoü*—of the Personality of Godhead; *mäyä-éçasya*—of the master of all energies; *mahä-muniù*—the great sage; *mahä-bhägavataù*—the first-class devotee of the Lord; *räjan*—O King; *pitaram*—unto his father; *paryatoñayat*—very much pleased.

TRANSLATION

Nārada very much pleased his father and desired to know all about the energies of Viṣṇu, the master of all energies, for Nārada was the greatest of all sages and greatest of all devotees, O King.

PURPORT

Lord Brahmä, being the creator of all living beings in the universe, is originally the father of several well-known sons, like Dakña, the *catuù-sanas*, and Nārada. In three departments of human knowledge disseminated by the *Vedas*, namely fruitive work (*karma-käëòa*), transcendental knowledge (*jñäna-käëòa*), and devotional service (*upäsanä-käëòa*), Devarñi Nārada inherited from his father Brahmä devotional service, whereas Dakña inherited from his father fruitive work, and Sanaka, Sanātana, etc., inherited from their father information about *jñäna-käëòa*,

or transcendental knowledge. But out of them all, Nārada is described here as the most beloved son of Brahmā because of good behavior, obedience, meekness and readiness to render service unto the father. And Nārada is famous as the greatest of all sages because of his being the greatest of all devotees. Nārada is the spiritual master of many famous devotees of the Lord. He is the spiritual master of Prahlāda, Dhruva and Vyāsa, down to the forest animal hunter Kirāta. His only business is to turn everyone to the transcendental loving service of the Lord. Therefore all these features of Nārada make him the dearest son of his father, and all this is due to Nārada's being a first-class devotee of the Lord. The devotees are always anxious to know more and more about the Supreme Lord, the master of all energies. As confirmed in the **Bhagavad-gītā** (10.9):

*mac-cittā mad-gata-prāḥā
bodhayantaṁ parasparam
kathayantaś ca mān nitya
tūṅyanti ca ramanti ca*

The Supreme Lord is unlimited, and His energies are also unlimited. No one can know them completely. Brahmājé, being the greatest living entity within this universe and being directly instructed by the Lord, must know more than anyone within this universe, although such knowledge may not be complete. Thus it is the duty of everyone to ask about the unlimited Lord from the spiritual master in the disciplic succession of Brahmā, which descends from Nārada to Vyāsa, from Vyāsa to Sukadeva and so on.

TEXT 43

**Tauí& iNaXaaMYa iPaTar& I/aek-aNaa& Pa[iPaTaaMahMa()
devizR" PairPaPa[C^ >avaNa(YaNMaaNauPa*C^iTa)) 43))**

tūṅhānā niṣāmya pitaraṁ

lokānānā prapitāmahaṁ

devarṇīnāṁ paripapraccha

bhavän yan mänupâcchati

SYNONYMS

tuñöam—satisfied; *niçämya*—after seeing; *pitaram*—the father; *lokänäm*—of the whole universe; *prapitāmaham*—the great-grandfather; *devarñiù*—the great sage Nārada; *paripapraccha*—inquired; *bhavän*—yourself; *yat*—as it is; *mä*—from me; *anupâcchati*—inquiring.

TRANSLATION

The great sage Nārada also inquired in detail from his father, Brahmä, the great-grandfather of all the universe, after seeing him well satisfied.

PURPORT

The process of understanding spiritual or transcendental knowledge from the realized person is not exactly like asking an ordinary question from the schoolmaster. The schoolmasters in the modern days are paid agents for giving some information, but the spiritual master is not a paid agent. Nor can he impart instruction without being authorized. In the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (4.34), the process of understanding transcendental knowledge is directed as follows:

*tad viddhi praëipätena
paripraçnena sevayä
upadekñyanti te jïänaà
jïäninas tattva-darçinaù*

Arjuna was advised to receive transcendental knowledge from the realized person by surrender, questions and service. Receiving transcendental knowledge is not like exchanging dollars; such knowledge has to be received by service to the spiritual master. As Brahmäjé received the knowledge directly from the Lord by satisfying Him fully, similarly one has to receive the transcendental knowledge from the spiritual master by satisfying him. The spiritual master's satisfaction is the means of assimilating transcendental knowledge. One cannot understand

transcendental knowledge simply by becoming a grammarian. The *Vedas* declare (**Çvetäçvatara Upaniñad** 6.23):

*yasya deve parä bhaktir
yathä deve tathä gurau
tasyaite kathitā hy arthāu
prakāçante mahātmanaù*
[ÇU 6.23]

“Only unto one who has unflinching devotion to the Lord and to the spiritual master does transcendental knowledge become automatically revealed.” Such relationship between the disciple and the spiritual master is eternal. One who is now the disciple is the next spiritual master. And one cannot be a bona fide and authorized spiritual master unless one has been strictly obedient to his spiritual master. Brahmäjé, as a disciple of the Supreme Lord, received the real knowledge and imparted it to his dear disciple Nārada, and similarly Nārada, as spiritual master, handed over this knowledge to Vyāsa and so on. Therefore the so-called formal spiritual master and disciple are not facsimiles of Brahmā and Nārada or Nārada and Vyāsa. The relationship between Brahmā and Nārada is reality, while the so-called formality is the relation between the cheater and cheated. It is clearly mentioned herewith that Nārada is not only well behaved, meek and obedient, but also self-controlled. One who is not self-controlled, specifically in sex life, can become neither a disciple nor a spiritual master. One must have disciplinary training in controlling speaking, anger, the tongue, the mind, the belly and the genitals. One who has controlled the particular senses mentioned above is called a *gosvämé*. Without becoming a *gosvämé* one can become neither a disciple nor a spiritual master. The so-called spiritual master without sense control is certainly the cheater, and the disciple of such a so-called spiritual master is the cheated.

One should not think of Brahmäjé as a dead great-grandfather, as we have experience on this planet. He is the oldest great-grandfather, and he is still living, and Nārada is also living. The age of the inhabitants of the Brahmaloaka planet is mentioned in the *Bhagavad-gita*. The inhabitants of this small planet earth can hardly calculate even the duration of one day of Brahmā.

TEXT 44

TaSMaa wd& >aaGavTa& Paura<a& dXal/+a<aMa()
Pa[aeć&- >aGavTaa Pa[ah Pa[qTa" Pau}aaYa >aUTak*-Ta()) 44))

tasmā idaà bhāgavatā

purāëaà daça-lakñāëam

proktaà bhagavatā prāha

prétau putrāya bhūta-kāt

SYNONYMS

tasmai—thereupon; *idam*—this; *bhāgavatam*—the glories of the Lord or the science of the Lord; *purāëam*—Vedic supplement; *daça-lakñāëam*—ten characteristics; *proktam*—described; *bhagavatā*—by the Personality of Godhead; *prāha*—said; *prétau*—in satisfaction; *putrāya*—unto the son; *bhūta-kāt*—the creator of the universe.

TRANSLATION

Thereupon the supplementary Vedic literature, Srimad-Bhagavatam, which was described by the Personality of Godhead and which contains ten characteristics, was told with satisfaction by the father [Brahmā] to his son Nārada.

PURPORT

Although the *Srimad-Bhagavatam* was spoken in four verses, it had ten characteristics, which will be explained in the next chapter. In the four verses it is first said that the Lord existed before the creation, and thus the beginning of the *Srimad-Bhagavatam* includes the *Vedānta* aphorism *janmādy asya* [SB 1.1.1]. *Janmādy asya* is the beginning, yet the four verses in which it is said that the Lord is the root of everything that be, beginning from the creation up to the supreme abode of the Lord, naturally explain

the ten characteristics. One should not misunderstand by wrong interpretations that the Lord spoke only four verses and that therefore all the rest of the 17,994 verses are useless. The ten characteristics, as will be explained in the next chapter, require so many verses just to explain them properly. Brahmäjé had also advised Nārada previously that he should expand the idea he had heard from Brahmäjé. Sri Caitanya Mahāprabhu instructed this to Srila Rūpa Gosvami in a nutshell, but the disciple Rūpa Gosvami expanded this very elaborately, and the same subject was further expanded by Jiva Gosvami and even further by Sri Visvanatha Cakravarti Ōhākura. We are just trying to follow in the footsteps of all these authorities. So *Srimad-Bhagavatam* is not like ordinary fiction or mundane literature. It is unlimited in strength, and however one may expand it according to one's own ability, *Bhāgavatam* still cannot be finished by such expansion. *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, being the sound representation of the Lord, is simultaneously explained in four verses and in four billion verses all the same, inasmuch as the Lord is smaller than the atom and bigger than the unlimited sky. Such is the potency of *Srimad-Bhagavatam*.

TEXT 45

**Naard" Pa[ah MauNaYae SarSvTYaaSTa\$e= Na*Pa)
DYaaYaTae b]ø ParMa& VYaaSaaYaaMaTaTaeJaSae)) 45))**

nāradaù prāha munaye

sarasvatyäs taöe nāpa

dhyäyate brahma paramaà

vyäsäyāmita-tejase

SYNONYMS

nāradaù—the great sage Nārada; *prāha*—instructed; *munaye*—unto the great sage; *sarasvatyäu*—of the River Sarasvaté; *taöe*—on the bank; *nāpa*—O King; *dhyäyate*—unto the meditative; *brahma*—Absolute Truth; *paramam*—the Supreme; *vyäsäya*—unto Srila Vyāsadeva; *amita*—

unlimited; *tejase*—unto the powerful.

TRANSLATION

In succession, O King, the great sage Nārada instructed Srimad-Bhagavatam unto the unlimitedly powerful Vyāsadeva, who meditated in devotional service upon the Supreme Personality of Godhead, the Absolute Truth, on the bank of the River Sarasvaté.

PURPORT

In the Fifth Chapter of the First Canto of *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, Nārada instructed the great sage Vyāsadeva as follows:

*atho mahā-bhāga bhavān amogha-dāk
çuci-çravāu satya-rato dhāta-vratau
urukramasyākhila-bandha-muktaye
samādhinānusmara tad viceññitam*

“O greatly fortunate, pious philosopher, your name and fame are universal, and you are fixed in the Absolute Truth with spotless character and infallible vision. I ask you to meditate upon the activities of the Personality of Godhead, whose activities are unparalleled.”

So in the disciplic succession of the Brahma-sampradāya, the practice of *yoga* meditation is not neglected. But because the devotees are *bhakti-yogis*, they do not undertake the trouble to meditate upon the impersonal Brahman; as indicated here, they meditate on *brahma paramam*, or the Supreme Brahman. Brahman realization begins from the impersonal effulgence, but by further progress of such meditation, manifestation of the Supreme Soul, Paramātmā realization, takes place. And progressing further, realization of the Supreme Personality of Godhead is fixed. Sri Nārada Muni, as the spiritual master of Vyāsadeva, knew very well the position of Vyāsadeva, and thus he certified the qualities of Srila Vyāsadeva as fixed in the Absolute Truth with great vow, etc. Nārada advised meditation upon the transcendental activities of the Lord. Impersonal Brahman has no activities, but the Personality of Godhead has many activities, and all such

activities are transcendental, without any tinge of material quality. If the activities of the Supreme Brahman were material activities, then Nārada would not have advised Vyāsadeva to meditate upon them. And the *paraà brahma* is Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, as confirmed in the *Bhagavad-gita*. In the Tenth Chapter of the *Bhagavad-gita*, when Arjuna realized the factual position of Lord Kṛṣṇa, he addressed Lord Kṛṣṇa in the following words:

*paraà brahma paraà dhāma
pavitraà paramaà bhavān
puruṣaà çāçvataà divyam
ädi-devam ajaà vibhum*
[Bg. 10.12]

*āhus tvām āñayaù sarve
devarñir nāradas tathā
asito devalo vyāsaù
svayaà caiva bravēñi me*

Arjuna summarized the purpose of the *Bhagavad-gita* by his realization of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa and thus said, “My dear Personality of Godhead, You are the Supreme Absolute Truth, the Original Person in the eternal form of bliss and knowledge, and this is confirmed by Nārada, Asita, Devala and Vyāsadeva, and, above all, Your personal self has also confirmed it.” (Bg. 10.12–13)

When Vyāsadeva fixed his mind in meditation, he did it in *bhakti-yoga* trance and actually saw the Supreme Person with *māyā*, the illusory energy, in contraposition. As we have discussed before, the Lord’s *māyā*, or illusion, is also a representation because *māyā* has no existence without the Lord. Darkness is not independent of light. Without light, no one can experience the contraposition of darkness. However, this *māyā*, or illusion, cannot overcome the Supreme Personality of Godhead, but stands apart from Him (*apāçrayam*).

Therefore, perfection of meditation is realization of the Personality of Godhead along with His transcendental activities. Meditation on the impersonal Brahman is a troublesome business for the meditator, as

confirmed in the **Bhagavad-gita** (12.5): *kleṣo 'dhikataras teñām avyaktāsakta-cetasām*.

TEXT 46

**YaduTaah& TvYaa Pa*íae vEraJaaTa(PauâzaiddMa()
YaQaaSaqtaduPaa:YaaSTae Pa[énaNaNYaa&ê k*-TSNaXa")) 46))**

yad utāhaà tvayä pãñöö

vairäjät puruñäd idam

yathäsét tad upäkhyäste

praçñän anyäàç ca kâtsnaçaù

SYNONYMS

yat—what; *uta*—is, however; *aham*—I; *tvayä*—by you; *pãñöö*—I am asked; *vairäjät*—from the universal form; *puruñät*—from the Personality of Godhead; *idam*—this world; *yathä*—as it; *äsét*—was; *tat*—that; *upäkhyäste*—I shall explain; *praçñän*—all the questions; *anyän*—others; *ca*—as well as; *kâtsnaçaù*—in great detail.

TRANSLATION

O King, your questions as to how the universe became manifested from the gigantic form of the Personality of Godhead, as well as other questions, I shall answer in detail by explanation of the four verses already mentioned.

PURPORT

As stated in the beginning of the *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, this great transcendental literature is the ripened fruit of the tree of Vedic knowledge, and therefore all questions that can be humanly possible regarding the universal affairs, beginning from its creation, are all answered

in the *Srimad-Bhagavatam*. The answers depend only on the qualification of the person who explains them. The ten divisions of *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, as explained by the great speaker Srila Sukadeva Gosvami, are the limitation of all questions, and intelligent persons will derive all intellectual benefits from them by proper utilization.

Thus end the Bhaktivedanta purports of the Second Canto, Ninth Chapter, of the Srimad-Bhagavatam, entitled "Answers by Citing the Lord's Version."

Chapter Ten

Bhāgavatam Is the Answer to All Questions

TEXT 1

é[quéuk- ovac
A}a SaGaaeR ivSaGaRê SQaaNa& Paaez<aMaUTaYa")
MaNvNTareXaaNauk-Qaa iNaraeDaae Mauiç-raé[Ya")) 1))

çré-çuka uvāca

atra sargo visargaç ca

sthānaà poñāëam ütayaù

manvantareçānukathä

nirodho muktir āçrayaù

SYNONYMS

çré-çukaù uvāca—Sri Sukadeva Gosvami said; *atra*—in this *Srimad-Bhagavatam*; *sargaù*—statement of the creation of the universe; *visargaù*—statement of subcreation; *ca*—also; *sthānam*—the planetary systems; *poñāëam*—protection; *ütayaù*—the creative impetus; *manvantara*—changes of Manus; *éça-anukathäù*—the science of God;

nirodhaù—going back home, back to Godhead; *muktiù*—liberation;
äçrayaù—the *summum bonum*.

TRANSLATION

Sri Sukadeva Gosvami said: In the Srimad-Bhagavatam there are ten divisions of statements regarding the following: the creation of the universe, subcreation, planetary systems, protection by the Lord, the creative impetus, the change of Manus, the science of God, returning home, back to Godhead, liberation, and the *summum bonum*.

TEXT 2

dXaMaSYa ivéuÖyQa | NavaNaaiMah I/+a<aMa()
v<aRYaiNTa MahaTMaaNa" é[uTaeNaaQaeRNa caÅSaa)) 2))

daçamasya viçuddhy-arthaà

navänäm iha lakñäëam

varëayanti mahätmänaù

çrutenärthena cäijasä

SYNONYMS

daçamasya—of the *summum bonum*; *viçuddhi*—isolation; *artham*—purpose; *navänäm*—of the other nine; *iha*—in this *Srimad-Bhagavatam*; *lakñäëam*—symptoms; *varëayanti*—they describe; *mahä-ätmänaù*—the great sages; *çrutena*—by Vedic evidences; *arthena*—by direct explanation; *ca*—and; *aijäsä*—summarily.

TRANSLATION

To isolate the transcendence of the *summum bonum*, the symptoms of the rest are described sometimes by Vedic inference, sometimes by direct explanation, and sometimes by summary explanations given by the great

sages.

TEXT 3

>aUTaMaa}aeiNd]YaiDaYaa& JaNMa SaGaR odaôTa")
b]ø<aae Gau<avEzMYaaiÜSaGaR" PaaEâz" SMa*Ta")) 3))

bhüta-mätrendriya-dhiyää

janma sarga udähâtaù

brahmaëo guëa-vaiñamyäd

visargaù pauruññaù smâtaù

SYNONYMS

bhüta—the five gross elements (the sky, etc.); *mätträ*—objects perceived by the senses; *indriya*—the senses; *dhiyäm*—of the mind; *janma*—creation; *sargaù*—manifestation; *udähâtaù*—is called the creation; *brahmaëaù*—of Brahmä, the first *puruṣa*; *guëa-vaiñamyät*—by interaction of the three modes of nature; *visargaù*—re-creation; *pauruññaù*—resultant activities; *smâtaù*—it is so known.

TRANSLATION

The elementary creation of sixteen items of matter—namely the five elements [fire, water, land, air and sky], sound, form, taste, smell, touch, and the eyes, ears, nose, tongue, skin and mind—is known as sarga, whereas subsequent resultant interaction of the modes of material nature is called visarga.

PURPORT

In order to explain the ten divisional symptoms of the *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, there are seven continuous verses. The first of these under reference pertains to the sixteen elementary manifestations of earth, water, etc.,

with material ego composed of material intelligence and mind. The subsequent creation is a result of the reactions of the above-mentioned sixteen energies of the first *puruṣa*, the Mahā-Viṣṇu incarnation of Govinda, as later explained by Brahmā in his treatise ***Brahma-saṁhitā*** (5.47) as follows:

*yaù kâraëärëava-jale bhajati sma yoga-
nidräm ananta-jagad-aëða-sa-roma-küpaù
ädhâra-çaktim avalambya paräà sva-mürtià
govindam ädi-puruṣaà tam ahaà bhajämi*

The first *puruṣa* incarnation of Govinda, Lord Kṛṣṇa, known as the Mahā-Viṣṇu, goes into a *yoga-nidrā* mystic sleep, and the innumerable universes are situated in potency in each and every hair hole of His transcendental body.

As mentioned in the previous verse, *çrutena* (or with reference to the Vedic conclusions), the creation is made possible from the Supreme Personality of Godhead directly by manifestation of His particular energies. Without such a Vedic reference, the creation appears to be a product of material nature. This conclusion comes from a poor fund of knowledge. From Vedic reference it is concluded that the origin of all energies (namely internal, external and marginal) is the Supreme Personality of Godhead. And as explained hereinbefore, the illusory conclusion is that creation is made by the inert material nature. The Vedic conclusion is transcendental light, whereas the non-Vedic conclusion is material darkness. The internal potency of the Supreme Lord is identical with the Supreme Lord, and the external potency is enlivened in contact with the internal potency. The parts and parcels of the internal potency which react in contact with the external potency are called the marginal potency, or the living entities.

Thus the original creation is directly from the Supreme Personality of Godhead, or Parambrahman, and the secondary creation, as a reactionary result of the original ingredients, is made by Brahmā. Thus the activities of the whole universe are started.

TEXT 4

iSQaiTavCEku-<#=ivJaYa" Paaez<a& TadNauGa]h")
MaNvNTarai<a SaÖMaR OTaYa" k-MaRvaSaNa")) 4))

sthitir vaikuëöha-vijayaù

poñaëaà tad-anugrahaù

manvantaräëi sad-dharma

ütayaù karma-väsanäù

SYNONYMS

sthitì—the right situation; *vaikuëöha-vijayaù*—the victory of the Lord of Vaikuntha; *poñaëam*—maintenance; *tad-anugrahaù*—His causeless mercy; *manvantaräëi*—the reign of the Manus; *sat-dharmaù*—perfect occupational duty; *ütayaù*—impetus to work; *karma-väsanäù*—desire for fruitive work.

TRANSLATION

The right situation for the living entities is to obey the laws of the Lord and thus be in perfect peace of mind under the protection of the Supreme Personality of Godhead. The Manus and their laws are meant to give right direction in life. The impetus for activity is the desire for fruitive work.

PURPORT

This material world is created, maintained for some time, and again annihilated by the will of the Lord. The ingredients for creation and the subordinate creator, Brahmä, are first created by Lord Viṣṇu in His first and second incarnations. The first *puruṣa* incarnation is Mahä-Viṣṇu, and the second *puruṣa* incarnation is the Garbhodakaśāyī Viṣṇu, from whom Brahmä is created. The third *puruṣa avatära* is the Kṣīrodakaśāyī Viṣṇu, who lives as the Supersoul of everything in the universe and maintains the creation generated by Brahmä. Siva is one of the many sons of Brahmä, and he annihilates the creation. Therefore the original creator of the universe is

Viṣṇu, and He is also the maintainer of the created beings by His causeless mercy. As such, it is the duty of all conditioned souls to acknowledge the victory of the Lord and thus become pure devotees and live peacefully in this world, where miseries and dangers are always in existence. The conditioned souls, who take this material creation as the place for satisfaction of the senses and thus are illusioned by the external energy of Viṣṇu, remain again to be subjected to the laws of material nature, creation and destruction.

In the *Bhagavad-gita* it is said that beginning from the topmost planet of this universe down to the lowest planet, Pātāla-loka, all are destructible, and the conditioned souls may travel in space either by good or bad work or by modern spacecraft, but they are sure to die everywhere, although the duration of life in different planets is different. The only means to attain eternal life is to go back home, back to Godhead, where there is no more rebirth as in the material planets. The conditioned souls, being unaware of this very simple fact because of forgetting their relationship with the Lord of Vaikuntha, try to plan out a permanent life in this material world. Being illusioned by the external energy, they thus become engaged in various types of economic and religious development, forgetting that they are meant for going back home, back to Godhead. This forgetfulness is so strong due to the influence of *māyā* that the conditioned souls do not at all want to go back to Godhead. By sense enjoyment they become victims of birth and death repeatedly and thus spoil human lives which are chances for going back to Viṣṇu. The directive scriptures made by the Manus in different ages and millenniums are called *sad-dharma*, good guidance for the human beings, who should take advantage of all the revealed scriptures for their own interest, to make life's successful termination. The creation is not false, but it is a temporary manifestation just to give a chance for the conditioned souls to go back to Godhead. The desire to go back to Godhead and functions performed in that direction form the right path of work. When such a regulative path is accepted, the Lord gives all protection to His devotees by His causeless mercy, while the nondevotees risk their own activities to bind themselves in a chain of fruitive reactions. The word *sad-dharma* is significant in this connection. *Sad-dharma*, or duty performed for going back to Godhead and thus becoming His unalloyed devotee, is the only pious activity; all others may pretend to be pious, but actually they are

not. It is for this reason only that the Lord advises in the *Bhagavad-gita* that one give up all so-called religious activities and completely engage in the devotional service of the Lord to become free from all anxieties due to the dangerous life of material existence. To work situated in *sad-dharma* is the right direction of life. One's aim of life should be to go back home, back to Godhead, and not be subjected to repeated births and deaths in the material world by getting good or bad bodies for temporary existence. Herein lies the intelligence of human life, and one should desire the activities of life in that way.

TEXT 5

AvTaaraNaucirTa& hreêaSYaaNauviTaRNaaMa()
Pau&SaaMaqXak-Qaa" Pa[aeç-a NaaNaa:YaaNaaePab*&ihTaa")) 5))

avatäränucaritaà

hareç cäsyänuvartinäm

puàsäm éça-kathäù proktä

nänäkhyänopabâhitäù

SYNONYMS

avatära—incarnation of Godhead; *anucaritam*—activities; *hareù*—of the Personality of Godhead; *ca*—also; *asya*—of His; *anuvartinäm*—followers; *puàsäm*—of the persons; *éça-kathäù*—the science of God; *proktäù*—is said; *nänä*—various; *äkhyäna*—narrations; *upabâhitäù*—described.

TRANSLATION

The science of God describes the incarnations of the Personality of Godhead and His different activities together with the activities of His great devotees.

PURPORT

During the course of the existence of the cosmic manifestation, the chronology of history is created, recording the activities of the living entities. People in general have a tendency to learn the history and narrations of different men and times, but due to a lack of knowledge in the science of Godhead, they are not apt to study the history of the incarnations of the Personality of Godhead. It should always be remembered that the material creation is created for the salvation of the conditioned souls. The merciful Lord, out of His causeless mercy, descends to various planets in the material world and acts for the salvation of the conditioned souls. That makes the history and narrations worth reading. *Srimad-Bhagavatam* offers such transcendental topics of the Lord in relationship with great devotees. Therefore the topics of the devotees and the Lord are to be given respectful aural reception.

TEXT 6

iNaraeDaae_SYaaNauXaYaNaMaaTMaNa" Sah XaiÇ-i>a")
MauiÇ-ihRTvaNYaQaaæPa& SvæPae<a VYaviSQaiTa")) 6))

nirodho 'syānuçayanam

ātmanaù saha çaktibhiù

muktir hitvänyathä rūpaà

sva-rüpeëa vyavasthitiù

SYNONYMS

nirodhaù—the winding up of the cosmic manifestation; *asya*—of His; *anuçayanam*—the lying down of the *puruṣa* incarnation Mahā-Viṣṇu in mystic slumber; *ātmanaù*—of the living entities; *saha*—along with; *çaktibhiù*—with the energies; *muktiù*—liberation; *hitvä*—giving up; *anyathä*—otherwise; *rūpam*—form; *sva-rüpeëa*—in constitutional form; *vyavasthitiù*—permanent situation.

TRANSLATION

The merging of the living entity, along with his conditional living tendency, with the mystic lying down of the Mahā-Viṣṇu is called the winding up of the cosmic manifestation. Liberation is the permanent situation of the form of the living entity after he gives up the changeable gross and subtle material bodies.

PURPORT

As we have discussed several times, there are two types of living entities. Most of them are ever liberated, or *nitya-muktas*, while some of them are ever conditioned. The ever-conditioned souls are apt to develop a mentality of lording over the material nature, and therefore the material cosmic creation is manifested to give the ever-conditioned souls two kinds of facilities. One facility is that the conditioned soul can act according to his tendency to lord it over the cosmic manifestation, and the other facility gives the conditioned soul a chance to come back to Godhead. So after the winding up of the cosmic manifestation, most of the conditioned souls merge into the existence of the Mahā-Viṣṇu Personality of Godhead, lying in His mystic slumber, to be created again in the next creation. But some of the conditioned souls, who follow the transcendental sound in the form of Vedic literatures and are thus able to go back to Godhead, attain spiritual and original bodies after quitting the conditional gross and subtle material bodies. The material conditional bodies develop out of the living entities' forgetfulness of their relationship with Godhead, and during the course of the cosmic manifestation, the conditioned souls are given a chance to revive their original status of life with the help of revealed scriptures, so mercifully compiled by the Lord in His different incarnations. Reading or hearing of such transcendental literatures helps one become liberated even in the conditional state of material existence. All the Vedic literatures aim at devotional service to the Personality of Godhead, and as soon as one is fixed upon this point, he at once becomes liberated from conditional life. The material gross and subtle forms are simply due to the conditioned soul's ignorance and as soon as he is fixed in the devotional service of the Lord, he becomes eligible to be freed from the conditioned state. This devotional service is transcendental attraction for the Supreme on account of His being the source of all pleasing humors. Everyone is after some pleasure of humor for enjoyment, but does not know the supreme source

of all attraction (*raso vai saù rasaà hy eväyaà labdhvānandé bhavati*). The Vedic hymns inform everyone about the supreme source of all pleasure; the unlimited fountainhead of all pleasure is the Personality of Godhead, and one who is fortunate enough to get this information through transcendental literatures like *Srimad-Bhagavatam* becomes permanently liberated to occupy his proper place in the kingdom of God.

TEXT 7

**Aa>aaSaê iNaraeDaê YaTae_STYaDYavSaqYaTae)
Sa Aaé[Ya" Par& b]ø ParMaaTMaeiTae XaBÛTae)) 7))**

ābhāsaç ca nirodhaç ca

yato 'sty adhyavaséyate

sa āçrayaù paraà brahma

paramātmeti çabdyate

SYNONYMS

ābhāsaù—the cosmic manifestation; *ca*—and; *nirodhaù*—and its winding up; *ca*—also; *yataù*—from the source; *asti*—is; *adhyavaséyate*—become manifested; *saù*—He; *āçrayaù*—reservoir; *param*—the Supreme; *brahma*—Being; *paramātmä*—the Supersoul; *iti*—thus; *çabdyate*—called.

TRANSLATION

The supreme one who is celebrated as the Supreme Being or the Supreme Soul is the supreme source of the cosmic manifestation as well as its reservoir and winding up. Thus He is the Supreme Fountainhead, the Absolute Truth.

PURPORT

Synonyms for the supreme source of all energies, as explained in the very

beginning of the *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, are *janmädy asya yataù* [SB 1.1.1], *vadanti tat tattva-vidas tattvaà yaj jïanam advayam/ brahmeti paramätmeti bhagavän iti çabdyate*, called Parambrahma, Paramätmä or Bhagavän. The word *iti* used here in this verse completes the synonyms and thus indicates Bhagavän. This will be further explained in the later verses, but this Bhagavän ultimately means Lord Kṛṣṇa because the *Srimad-Bhagavatam* has already accepted the Supreme Personality of Godhead as Kṛṣṇa. *Kṛṣṇas tu bhagavän svayam*. The original source of all energies, or the *summum bonum*, is the Absolute Truth, which is called Parambrahma, etc., and Bhagavän is the last word of the Absolute Truth. But even with the synonyms for Bhagavän, such as Nārāyaṇa, Viṣṇu and Puruṇa, the last word is Kṛṣṇa, as confirmed in the *Bhagavad-gita: ahaà sarvasya prabhavo mattaù samaà pravartate* [Bg. 10.8], etc. Besides that, the *Srimad-Bhagavatam* is the representation of Lord Kṛṣṇa as a sound incarnation of the Lord.

*kãñëe sva-dhämopagate
dharma-jïänädibhiù saha
kalau nañöa-dâçäm eñau
puräëärko 'dhunoditaù*

(**Bhäg.** 1.3.43)

Thus by general conclusion Lord Kṛṣṇa is the ultimate source of all energies, and the word Kṛṣṇa means that. And to explain Kṛṣṇa or the science of Kṛṣṇa, the *Srimad-Bhagavatam* has been prepared. In the First Canto of *Srimad-Bhagavatam* this truth is indicated in the questions and answers by Sūta Gosvami and great sages like Çaunaka, and in the First and Second Chapters of the canto this is explained. In the Third Chapter this subject is more explicit, and in the Fourth Chapter even more explicit. In the Second Canto the Absolute Truth as the personality of Godhead is further emphasized, and the indication is the Supreme Lord Kṛṣṇa. The summary of *Srimad-Bhagavatam* in four verses, as we have already discussed, is succinct. This Supreme Personality of Godhead in the ultimate issue is confirmed by Brahmä in his *Brahma-saṁhitä* as *éçvaraù paramaù kãñëau sac-cid-änanda-vigrahaù* [Bs. 5.1]. So it is concluded in the Third Canto of the *Srimad-Bhagavatam*. The complete subject matter is elaborately

explained in the Tenth and Eleventh Cantos of the *Srimad-Bhagavatam*. In the matter of the changes of the Manus or *manvantaras*, such as the Svayambhuva-*manvantara* and Caksusa-*manvantara*, as they are discussed in the Third, Fourth, Fifth, Sixth and Seventh Cantos of *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, Lord Kṛṣṇa is indicated. In the Eighth Canto the Vaivasvata-*manvantara* explains the same subject indirectly, and in the Ninth Canto the same purport is there. In the Twelfth Canto the same is further explained, specifically regarding the different incarnations of the Lord. Thus it is concluded by studying the complete *Srimad-Bhagavatam* that Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa is the ultimate *summum bonum*, or the ultimate source of all energy. And according to the grades of worshipers, the indications of the nomenclature may be differently explained as Nārāyaṇa, Brahmā, Paramātmā, etc.

TEXT 8

Yaae_DYaaITMak-ae_Ya& Pauâz" Saae_SaavevaiDadEivk-")
 YaSTa}aae>aYaivC^ed" Pauâzae ùaiDa>aaEiTak-")) 8))

yo 'dhyātmiko 'yaà puruṣaù

so 'säv evādhidaivikaù

yas tatrobhaya-vicchedaù

puruṇo hy ādhibhautikaù

SYNONYMS

yaù—one who; *adhyātmikaù*—is possessed of the sense organs; *ayam*—this; *puruṣaù*—personality; *saù*—he; *asau*—that; *eva*—also; *adhidaivikaù*—controlling deity; *yaù*—that which; *tatra*—there; *ubhaya*—of both; *vicchedaù*—separation; *puruṣaù*—person; *hi*—for; *ādhibhautikaù*—the visible body or the embodied living entity.

TRANSLATION

The individual person possessing different instruments of senses is called the adhyātmic person, and the individual controlling deity of the senses is called adhidaivic. The embodiment seen on the eyeballs is called the adhibhautic person.

PURPORT

The supreme controlling *summum bonum* is the personality of Godhead in His plenary portion of Paramātmā, or the Supersoul manifestation. In the *Bhagavad-gita* (10.42) it is said:

*athavā bahunaitena
kiā jīātena tavārjuna
viññābhyāham idaṁ kātsnam
ekāñçena sthito jagat*

All the controlling deities like Viṣṇu, Brahmā and Siva are different manifestations of the Paramātmā feature of the Supreme Personality of Godhead Sri Kṛṣṇa, who exhibits himself in such manners by entering into each and every universe generated from Him. But still apparently there are divisions of the controller and controlled. For example, in the food-controlling department the controller of food is a person made of the same ingredients as the person who is controlled. Similarly, each and every individual in the material world is controlled by the higher demigods. For example, we have our senses, but the senses are controlled by superior controlling deities. We cannot see without light, and the supreme controller of light is the sun. The sun-god is in the sun planet, and we, the individual human beings or any other being on this earth, are all controlled by the sun-god as far as our eyes are concerned. Similarly, all the senses we have are controlled by the superior demigods, who are also as much living entities as we are, but one is empowered while the other is controlled. The controlled living entity is called the adhyātmic person, and the controller is called the adhidaivic person. All these positions in the material world are due to different fruitive activities. Any individual living being can become the sun-god or even Brahmā or any other god in the upper planetary system by a higher grade of pious work, and similarly one becomes controlled by the higher demigods by lower grades of fruitive activities. So

every individual living entity is subject to the supreme control of the Paramātmā, who puts everyone in different positions of the controller and the controlled.

That which distinguishes the controller and controlled, i.e. the material body, is called the adhibhautic *puruṣa*. The body is sometimes called *puruṣa*, as confirmed in the *Vedas* in the following hymn: *sa vā eṇa puruṇṇo 'nna-rasamaya*. This body is called the *anna-rasa* embodiment. This body depends on food. The living entity which is embodied does not eat anything, however, because the owner is spirit in essence. The material body requires replacement of matter for the wearing and tearing of the mechanical body. Therefore the distinction between the individual living entity and controlling planetary deities is in the *anna-rasamaya* body. The sun may have a gigantic body, and the man may have a smaller body, but all these visible bodies are made of matter; nonetheless, the sun-god and the individual person, who are related as the controller and the controlled, are the same spiritual parts and parcels of the Supreme Being, and it is the Supreme Being who places different parts and parcels in different positions. And thus the conclusion is that the Supreme Person is the shelter of all.

TEXT 9

**Wk-Maek-Tara>aave Yada NaaePal/>aaMahe)
i}aTaYa& Ta}a Yaae ved Sa AaTMaa Svaé[Yaaé[Ya")) 9))**

ekam ekatarābhāve

yadā nopalabhāmahe

tritayaà tatra yo veda

sa ātmā svāçrayāçrayaù

SYNONYMS

ekam—one; *ekatara*—another; *abhāve*—in the absence of; *yadā*—because; *na*—does not; *upalabhāmahe*—perceptible; *tritayam*—in three stages;

tatra—there; *yaù*—the one; *veda*—who knows; *saù*—he; *ätmä*—the Supersoul; *sva*—own; *äçraya*—shelter; *äçrayaù*—of the shelter.

TRANSLATION

All three of the above-mentioned stages of different living entities are interdependent. In the absence of one, another is not understood. But the Supreme Being who sees every one of them as the shelter of the shelter is independent of all, and therefore He is the supreme shelter.

PURPORT

There are innumerable living entities, one dependent on the other in the relationship of the controlled and the controller. But without the medium of perception, no one can know or understand who is the controlled and who is the controller. For example, the sun controls the power of our vision, we can see the sun because the sun has its body, and the sunlight is useful only because we have eyes. Without our having eyes, the sunlight is useless, and without sunlight the eyes are useless. Thus they are interdependent, and none of them is independent. Therefore the natural question arises concerning who made them interdependent. The one who has made such a relationship of interdependence must be ultimately completely independent. As stated in the beginning of the *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, the ultimate source of all interdependent objectives is the complete independent subject. This ultimate source of all interdependence is the Supreme Truth or Paramätmä, the Supersoul, who is not dependent on anything else. He is *sväçrayäçrayaù*. He is only dependent on His self, and thus He is the supreme shelter of everything. Although Paramätmä and Brahman are subordinate to Bhagavän, because Bhagavän is Puruñottama or the Superperson, He is the source of the Supersoul also. In the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (15.18) Lord Kṛṣṇa says that He is the Puruñottama and the source of everything, and thus it is concluded that Sri Kṛṣṇa is the ultimate source and shelter of all entities, including the Supersoul and Supreme Brahman. Even accepting that there is no difference between the Supersoul and the individual soul, the individual soul is dependent on the Supersoul for being liberated from the illusion of material energy. The individual is under the clutches of illusory energy, and therefore although qualitatively

one with the Supersoul, he is under the illusion of identifying himself with matter. And to get out of this illusory conception of factual life, the individual soul has to depend on the Supersoul to be recognized as one with Him. In that sense also the Supersoul is the supreme shelter. And there is no doubt about it.

The individual living entity, the *jéva*, is always dependent on the Supersoul, Paramätmä, because the individual soul forgets his spiritual identity whereas the Supersoul, Paramätmä, does not forget His transcendental position. In the *Bhagavad-gita* these separate positions of the *jéva-ätmä* and the Paramätmä are specifically mentioned. In the Fourth Chapter, Arjuna, the *jéva* soul, is represented as forgetful of his many, many previous births, but the Lord, the Supersoul, is not forgetful. The Lord even remembers when He taught the *Bhagavad-gita* to the sun-god some billions of years before. The Lord can remember such millions and billions of years, as stated in the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (7.26) as follows:

*vedähaà samatétäni
vartamänäni cärjuna
bhaviñyäëi ca bhütäni
mäà tu veda na kaçcana*

The Lord in His eternal blissful body of knowledge is fully aware of all that happened in the past, that which is going on at the present and also what will happen in the future. But in spite of His being the shelter of both the Paramätmä and Brahman, persons with a poor fund of knowledge are unable to understand Him as He is.

The propaganda of the identity of cosmic consciousness with the consciousness of the individual living entities is completely misleading because even such a person or individual soul as Arjuna could not remember his past deeds, although he is always with the Lord. And what can the tiny ordinary man, falsely claiming to be one with the cosmic consciousness, know about his past, present and future?

TEXT 10

Pauāzæ_<@& iviNai>aRŪ YadaSaaE Sa iviNaGaRTa")
AaTMaNaae_YaNaMaiNvC^àPaae_óa+aqC^uic" éucq")) 10))

puruño 'ëðàà vinirbhidyā

yadāsau sa vinirgataù

ätmano 'yanam anvicchann

apo 'sräkñéc chuciù çucéù

SYNONYMS

puruṣaù—the Supreme Person, Paramātmā; *aëðam*—the universes;
vinirbhidyā—making them each separately situated; *yadā*—when; *asau*—
the same; *saù*—He (the Lord); *vinirgataù*—came out; *ätmanaù*—of Himself;
ayanam—lying in place; *anvicchan*—desiring; *apaù*—water; *asräkñét*—
created; *çuciù*—the most pure; *çucéù*—transcendental.

TRANSLATION

After separating the different universes, the gigantic universal form of the Lord [Mahā-Viṣṇu], which came out of the causal ocean, the place of appearance for the first puruṣa-avatāra, entered into each of the separate universes, desiring to lie on the created transcendental water [Garbhodaka].

PURPORT

After analysis of the living entities and the Supreme Lord, Paramātmā, the independent source of all other living beings, Srila Sukadeva Gosvami is now presenting the prime necessity for devotional service to the Lord, which is the only occupational business of all living entities. The Supreme Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa and all His plenary portions and extensions of plenary portions are nondifferent from one another, and thus the supreme independence is in each and every one of them. In order to prove this, Sukadeva Gosvami (as promised to King Parikṣit) describes herein the

independence of the *puruṣa-avatāra* Personality of Godhead, even in the sphere of the material creation. Such activities of the Lord are also transcendental, and therefore they are also *līlā*, or pastimes, of the absolute Lord. Such pastimes of the Lord are very conducive to the hearers for self-realization in the field of devotional service. Some may argue, why not then relish the transcendental *līlā* of the Lord as exhibited in the land of Mathurā and Vāndāvana, which are sweeter than anything in the world? Srila Visvanatha Cakravarti Ōhākura replies that the pastimes of the Lord in Vāndāvana are meant to be relished by advanced devotees of the Lord. Neophyte devotees will misunderstand such supreme transcendental activities of the Lord, and therefore the Lord's pastimes in the material sphere related to creation, maintenance and destruction are verily relishable by the *prākāṭa*, or mundane devotees of the Lord. As the *yoga* system mainly based on bodily exercises is meant for the person who is too much attached to the bodily conception of existence, similarly the Lord's pastimes related to the creation and destruction of the material world are for those who are too materially attached. For such mundane creatures the functions of the body and the functions of the cosmic world through physical laws in relationship with the Lord are also therefore included in understanding of the lawmaker, the Supreme Personality of Godhead. The scientists explain the material functions by so many technological terms of material law, but such blind scientists forget the lawmaker. The *Srimad-Bhagavatam* points out the lawmaker. One should not be amazed by the mechanical arrangement of the complicated engine or dynamo, but one should praise the engineer who creates such a wonderful working machine. That is the difference between the devotee and the nondevotee. Devotees are always full with praising the Lord, who directs the physical laws. In the ***Bhagavad-gītā*** (9.10) the direction of the Lord upon the material nature is described as follows:

*mayādhyakñeëa prakāṭiù
süyate sacarācaram
hetunānena kaunteya
jagad viparivartate*

“The material nature full of physical laws is one of My different energies; therefore it is neither independent nor blind. Because I am

transcendentally all-powerful, simply by My glancing over material nature, the physical laws of nature work so wonderfully. The actions and reactions of the physical laws work on that account, and thus the material world is created, maintained and annihilated again and again.”

Men with a poor fund of knowledge, however, become astonished by studying the physical laws both within the construction of the individual body and within the cosmic manifestation, and foolishly they decry the existence of God, taking it for granted that the physical laws are independent, without any metaphysical control. The ***Bhagavad-gita*** (9.11) replies to this foolishness in the following words:

*avajānanti mää müòhā
mānuñéà tanum āçritam
paraà bhāvam ajānanto
mama bhūta-maheçvaram*

“The foolish men [*müòhää*] do not know the Personality of Godhead in His eternal form of bliss and knowledge.” The foolish man thinks of the transcendental body of the Lord as something like his own, and therefore he cannot think of the unlimited controlling power of the Lord, who is not visible in the acting of the physical laws. The Lord is, however, visible to the naked eyes of people in general when He descends Himself by His own personal potency. Lord Kṛṣṇa incarnated Himself as He is and played very wonderful parts as the Lord Himself, and the ***Bhagavad-gita*** concerns such wonderful actions and knowledge. Yet foolish men will not accept Lord Kṛṣṇa as the Supreme Lord. Generally they consider the infinitesimal and infinite features of the Lord because they themselves are unable to become either the infinitesimal or the infinite, but one should know that the infinite and infinitesimal sizes of the Lord are not His highest glories. The most wonderful manifestation of the Lord’s power is exhibited when the infinite Lord becomes visible to our eyes as one of us. Yet His activities are different from those of the finite beings. Lifting a mountain at the age of seven years and marrying sixteen thousand wives in the prime of His youth are some of the examples of His infinite energy, but the *müòhas*, after seeing them or hearing about them, decry them as legendary and take the Lord as one of them. They cannot understand that the Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, although in the form

of a human being by His own potency, is still the Supreme Lord with full potency as the supreme controller.

When, however, the *müðhas* give submissive and aural reception to the messages of the Lord as in the *Srimad Bhagavad-gita* or in the *Srimad-Bhagavatam* through the channel of disciplic succession, such *müðhas* also become devotees of the Lord by the grace of His pure devotees. And for this reason only, either in the *Bhagavad-gita* or in the *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, the pastimes of the Lord in the material world are delineated for the benefit of those men with a poor fund of knowledge.

TEXT 11

**TaaSvvaTSaqTa(SvSa*íaSau Sahó&PairvTSaraNa()
TaeNa NaaraYa<aae NaaMa YadaPa" PauåzaeÜva")) 11))**

täsv avätsét sva-sãñöäsu

sahasraà parivatsarän

tena nārāyaëo nāma

yad äpaù puruñodbhaväù

SYNONYMS

täsu—in that; *avätsét*—resided; *sva*—own; *sãñöäsu*—in the matter of creation; *sahasram*—one thousand; *parivatsarän*—years of His measurement; *tena*—for that reason; *nārāyaëaù*—the Personality of Godhead named Nārāyaṇa; *nāma*—name; *yat*—because; *äpaù*—water; *puruṣa-udbhaväù*—emanated from the Supreme Person.

TRANSLATION

That Supreme Person is not impersonal and therefore is distinctively a nara, or person. Therefore the transcendental water created from the Supreme Nara is known as nāra. And because He lies down on that water,

He is known as Nārāyaṇa.

TEXT 12

d]VYa& k-MaR c k-al/ê Sv>aavae Jaqv Wv c)
YadNauGa]hTa" SaiNTa Na SaiNTa YaduPae+aYaa)) 12))

dravyaà karma ca kâlaç ca

svabhävo jéva eva ca

yad-anugrahataù santi

na santi yad-upekñayä

SYNONYMS

dravyam—physical elements; *karma*—action; *ca*—and; *kâlaù*—time; *ca*—also; *sva-bhâvaù jévaù*—the living entities; *eva*—certainly; *ca*—also; *yat*—whose; *anugrahataù*—by the mercy of; *santi*—exist; *na*—does not; *santi*—exist; *yat-upekñayä*—by negligence.

TRANSLATION

One should definitely know that all material ingredients, activities, time and modes, and the living entities who are meant to enjoy them all, exist by His mercy only, and as soon as He does not care for them, everything becomes nonexistent.

PURPORT

The living entities are the enjoyers of the material ingredients, time, modes, etc., because they want to lord it over the material nature. The Lord is the supreme enjoyer, and the living entities are meant to assist the Lord in His enjoyment and thus participate in the transcendental enjoyment of everyone. The enjoyer and the enjoyed both participate in enjoyment, but, deluded by the illusory energy, the living entities want to become the

enjoyer like the Lord, although they are not meant for such enjoyment. The *jivas*, the living entities, are mentioned in the *Bhagavad-gita* as the Lord's superior nature, or *parā prakāṭi*, and so also it is mentioned in the *Viṣṇu Purāṇa*. Therefore the living entities are never the *puruṣas*, or the factual enjoyers. As such, the spirit of enjoyment by the living entity in the material world is false. In the spiritual world the living entities are pure in nature, and therefore they are associates in the enjoyment of the Supreme Lord. In the material world the spirit of enjoyment of the living entities by dint of their own actions (*karma*) gradually fades by the laws of nature, and thus the illusory energy dictates in the ears of the conditioned souls that they should become one with the Lord. This is the last snare of the illusory energy. When the last illusion is also cleared off by the mercy of the Lord, the living entity again becomes reinstated in his original position and thus becomes actually liberated. For this attainment of liberation from the material clutches, the Lord creates the material world, maintains it for some time (one thousand years of His measurement, as stated in the previous verse), and then again annihilates it by His will. The living entities are therefore completely dependent on the mercy of the Lord, and all their so-called enjoyments by scientific improvement are crushed into dust when the Lord desires.

TEXT 13

Wk-ae NaaNaaTvMaiNvC^Na(YaaeGaTaLPaaTa(SaMauiTQaTa")
vqYa| ihr<MaYa& devae MaaYaYaa VYaSa*JaTa(i}aDaa)) 13))

eko nānātvam anvicchan

yoga-talpāt samutthitau

véryaà hiraëmayaà devo

māyayā vyaśājat tridhā

SYNONYMS

eka—He, one alone; *nānātvam*—varieties; *anvicchan*—so desiring; *yoga-*

talpät—from the bedstead of mystic slumber; *samutthitaù*—thus generated; *véryam*—the semina; *hiraëmayam*—golden hue; *devaù*—the demigod; *mäyayä*—by the external energy; *vyasåjat*—perfectly created; *tridhä*—in three features.

TRANSLATION

The Lord, while lying on His bed of mystic slumber, generated the seminal symbol, golden in hue, through external energy out of His desire to manifest varieties of living entities from Himself alone.

PURPORT

In the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (9.7–8) the creation and annihilation of the material world are stated as follows:

*sarva-bhütäni kaunteya
prakåtià yänti mämikäm
kalpa-kñaye punas täni
kalpådau visåjämy aham*

*prakåtià sväm avañöabhya
visåjämi punaù punaù
bhüta-grämam imaà kåtsnam
avaçaà prakåter vaçät*

“At the end of each millennium the creative forces, namely the material nature and the living entities who struggle in the material nature, all merge together into the transcendental body of the Lord, and again when the Lord desires to manifest them, all of them are again displayed by the Lord.

“Therefore the material nature is working under the control of the Lord. All of them, under the agency of material nature and under the control of the Lord, are thus repeatedly created and annihilated by the will of the Lord.”

As such, before the creation or manifestation of the material cosmic world, the Lord exists as total energy (*mahä-samañöi*), and thus desiring Himself

to be diffused to many, He expands Himself further into multitotal energy (*samaññöi*). From the multitotal energy He further expands Himself into individuals in three dimensions, namely adhyätmic, adhidaivic and adhibhautic, as explained before (*vyaññöi*). As such, the whole creation and the creative energies are nondifferent and different simultaneously. Because everything is an emanation from Him (the Mahä-Viṣṇu or Mahä-samaññöi), nothing of the cosmic energies is different from Him; but all such expanded energies have specific functions and display as designed by the Lord, and therefore they are simultaneously different from the Lord. The living entities are also similar energy (marginal potency) of the Lord, and thus they are simultaneously one with and different from Him.

At the stage of nonmanifestation, the living energies remain potent in the Lord, and when they are let loose in the cosmic manifestation they are exhibited differently in terms of different desires under the modes of nature. Such differential manifestations of the living energies are conditional states of the living entities. The liberated living entities, however, in the *sanätana* (eternal) manifestation, are unconditionally surrendered souls, and therefore they are not subject to the conditions of creation and annihilation. So this creation takes place by the glance of the Lord from His bedstead of mystic slumber. And thus all the universes and the lord of the universe, Brahmä, are again and again manifested and annihilated.

TEXT 14

**AiDadEvMaQaaDYaaTMaMaiDa>aUTaiMaiTa Pa[>au")
AQaEk&- PaaEåz& vqYa| i}aDaai>aÛTa TaC^*<au)) 14))**

adhidaivam athädhyätmam

adhibhütam iti prabhuù

athaikaà pauruññaà véryaà

tridhābhidyata tac chāëu

SYNONYMS

adhidaivam—the controlling entities; *atha*—now; *adhyātmam*—the controlled entities; *adhibhūtam*—the material bodies; *iti*—thus; *prabhuḥ*—the Lord; *atha*—in this way; *ekam*—one only; *pauruṇām*—of His Lordship; *véryam*—potency; *tridhā*—in three; *abhidyata*—divided; *tat*—that; *çāḍu*—just hear from me.

TRANSLATION

Just hear from me how the potency of His Lordship divides one into three, called the controlling entities, the controlled entities and the material bodies, in the manner mentioned above.

TEXT 15

**ANTa"Xarqr Aak-aXaaTa(PauāzSYa ivceíTa")
AaeJa" Sahae bl&/ Jaje TaTa" Pa[a<aae MahaNaSau")) 15))**

antaḥ çaréra ākāçāt

puruṣasya viceññōataḥ

ojaḥ saho balaḥ jajñe

tataḥ prāḇo mahān asuḥ

SYNONYMS

antaḥ çarére—within the body; *ākāçāt*—from the sky; *puruṣasya*—of Mahā-Viṣṇu; *viceññōataḥ*—while so trying, or willing; *ojaḥ*—the energy of the senses; *sahaḥ*—mental force; *balam*—bodily strength; *jajñe*—generated; *tataḥ*—thereafter; *prāḇaḥ*—the living force; *mahān asuḥ*—the fountainhead of everyone's life.

TRANSLATION

From the sky situated within the transcendental body of the manifesting Mahā-Viṣṇu, sense energy, mental force and bodily strength are all generated, as well as the sum total of the fountainhead of the total living force.

TEXT 16

ANauPa[a<aiNTa Ya& Pa[a<aa" Pa[a<aNTa& SavRJaNTauzu)
APaaNaNTaMaPaaNaiNTa NardeviMavaNauGaa")) 16))

anuprāēanti yaà prāēāù

prāēantaà sarva-jantuñu

apānantam apānanti

nara-devam ivānugāù

SYNONYMS

anuprāēanti—follow the living symptoms; *yam*—whom; *prāēāù*—senses; *prāēantam*—endeavoring; *sarva-jantuñu*—in all living entities; *apānantam*—stop endeavoring; *apānanti*—all others stop; *nara-devam*—a king; *iva*—like; *anugāù*—the followers.

TRANSLATION

As the followers of a king follow their lord, similarly when the total energy is in motion, all other living entities move, and when the total energy stops endeavoring, all other living entities stop sensual activities.

PURPORT

The individual living entities are completely dependent on the total energy of the supreme *puruṣa*. No one has independent existence, just as no electric lamp has independent effulgence. Each and every electrical instrument depends fully on the total powerhouse, the total powerhouse

depends on the reservoir of water for generating electricity, water depends on the clouds, the clouds depend on the sun, the sun depends on creation, and the creation depends on the movement of the Supreme Personality of Godhead. Thus the Supreme Personality of Godhead is the cause of all causes.

TEXT 17

**Pa[a<aeNaai+aPaTaa +auTa(Ta* @NTara JaaYaTae iv>aae")
iPaPaaSaTaae Ja+aTaê Pa[ax(Mau%& iNari>aÛTa)) 17))**

präëenäkñipatä kñut tåò

antarä jâyate vibhoù

pipäsato jakñataç ca

präi mukhaà nirabhidyata

SYNONYMS

präëena—by the living force; *äkñipatä*—being agitated; *kñut*—hunger; *tåò*—thirst; *antarä*—from within; *jâyate*—generates; *vibhoù*—of the Supreme; *pipäsataù*—being desirous to quench the thirst; *jakñataù*—being desirous to eat; *ca*—and; *prak*—at first; *mukham*—the mouth; *nirabhidyata*—was opened.

TRANSLATION

The living force, being agitated by the viräo-puruṣa, generated hunger and thirst, and when He desired to drink and eat, the mouth opened.

PURPORT

The process by which all living beings in the womb of the mother develop their sense organs and sense perceptions appears to follow the same principles in the case of the *viräo-puruṣa*, the sum total of all living entities.

Therefore the supreme cause of all generation is not impersonal or without desire. The desires for all kinds of sense perception and sense organs exist in the Supreme, and thus they take place in the individual persons. This desire is the nature of the supreme living being, the Absolute Truth. Because He has the sum total of all mouths, the individual living entities have mouths. Similarly with all other senses and sense organs. Here the mouth is the symbolic representation of all sense organs, for the same principles apply to the others also.

TEXT 18

**Mau%TaSTaalu/ iNai>aRà& iJaûa Ta}aaePaJaaYaTae)
TaTaae NaaNaarSaae Jaje iJaûYaa Yaae_iDaGaMYaTae)) 18))**

mukhataṣ tālu nirbhinnā

jihvā tatropajāyate

tato nānā-raso jajīe

jihvayā yo 'dhigamyate

SYNONYMS

mukhataṣ—from the mouth; *tālu*—the palate; *nirbhinnam*—being generated; *jihvā*—the tongue; *tatra*—thereupon; *opajāyate*—becomes manifested; *tataṣ*—thereupon; *nānā-rasaṣ*—various tastes; *jajīe*—became manifested; *jihvayā*—by the tongue; *yaṣ*—which; *adhigamyate*—become relished.

TRANSLATION

From the mouth the palate became manifested, and thereupon the tongue was also generated. After this all the different tastes came into existence so that the tongue can relish them.

PURPORT

This gradual process of evolution suggests the explanation of the controlling deities (*adhidaiva*) because Varuëa is the controlling deity for all relishable juices. Therefore the mouth becomes the resting place for the tongue, which tastes all the different juices, of which the controlling deity is Varuëa. This suggests, therefore, that Varuëa was also generated along with the development of the tongue. The tongue and the palate, being instrumental, are *adhibhūtam*, or forms of matter, but the functioning deity, who is a living entity, is *adhidaiva*, whereas the person undergoing the function is *adhyātma*. Thus the three categories are also explained as to their birth after the opening of the mouth of the *viräö-puruṣa*. The four principles mentioned in this verse serve to explain the three main principles, namely the *adhyātma*, *adhidaiva* and *adhibhūtam*, as explained before.

TEXT 19

ivv+aaeMauR%Taae >aUManae viövaRGa(VYaaôTa& TaYaae")
Jale/ cETaSYa Sauicr& iNaraeDa" SaMaJaaYaTa)) 19))

vivakñor mukhato bhūmno

vahnir vāg vyāhātā tayou

jale caitasya sucirā

nirodhaū samajāyata

SYNONYMS

vivakñou—when there was a need to speak; *mukhataū*—from the mouth; *bhūmnaū*—of the Supreme; *vahniū*—fire or the controlling deity of fire; *vāk*—vibration; *vyāhātā*—speeches; *tayou*—by both; *jale*—in the water; *ca*—however; *etasya*—of all these; *suciram*—a very, very long time; *nirodhaū*—suspension; *samajāyata*—did continue.

TRANSLATION

When the Supreme desired to speak, speeches were vibrated from the mouth. Then the controlling deity Fire was generated from the mouth. But when He was lying in the water, all these functions remained suspended.

PURPORT

The peculiarity of the gradual development of the different senses is simultaneously supported by their controlling deities. It is to be understood, therefore, that the activities of the sense organs are controlled by the will of the Supreme. The senses are, so to speak, offering a license for the conditioned souls, who are to use them properly under the control of the controlling deity deputed by the Supreme Lord. One who violates such controlling regulations has to be punished by degradation to a lower status of life. Consider, for example, the tongue and its controlling deity, Varuëa. The tongue is meant for eating, and men, animals and birds each have their different tastes because of different licenses. The taste of human beings and that of the swine are not on the same level. The controlling deity, however, awards or certifies a particular type of body when the particular living entity develops a taste in terms of different modes of nature. If the human being develops taste without discrimination, as does the swine, then the controlling deity is certainly certified for the next term to award him the body of a swine. The swine accepts any kind of foodstuff, including stools, and a human being who has developed such indiscriminate taste must be prepared for a degraded life in the next life. Such a life is also God's grace because the conditioned soul desired a body like that for perfectly tasting a particular type of foodstuff. If a man gets the body of a swine it must be considered the grace of the Lord because the Lord awards the facility. After death the next body is offered by superior control, not blindly. A human being, therefore, must be on his guard as to what sort of body he is going to have in the next life. An irresponsible life of indiscrimination is risky, and that is the declaration of all scriptures.

TEXT 20

**NaaiSake- iNari>aÛeTaa& daeDaUYaiTa Na>aSviTa)
Ta}a vaYauGaRNDavhae ga}a<aae NaiSa iJaga*+aTa")) 20))**

näsike nirabhidyetää

dodhüyati nabhasvati

tatra väyur gandha-vaho

ghrääo nasi jighåkñataù

SYNONYMS

näsike—in the nostrils; *nirabhidyetäm*—being developed; *dodhüyati*—rapidly blowing; *nabhasvati*—air respiration; *tatra*—thereupon; *väyuù*—air; *gandha-vahaù*—smelling odor; *ghrääaù*—sense of smell; *nasi*—in the nose; *jighåkñataù*—desiring to smell odors.

TRANSLATION

Thereafter, when the supreme puruṣa desired to smell odors, the nostrils and respiration were generated, the nasal instrument and odors came into existence, and the controlling deity of air, carrying smell, also became manifested.

PURPORT

The nasal instrument, odor, and the controlling deity air, smelling, etc., all became manifested simultaneously when the Lord desired to smell. The Vedic *mantras* confirm this statement in the *Upaniñads'* statement that everything is first desired by the Supreme before the subordinate living entity can act upon it. The living entity can see only when the Lord sees, the living entity can smell when the Lord smells, and so on. The idea is that the living entity cannot do anything independently. He can simply think of doing something independently, but he cannot act independently. This independence in thinking is there by the grace of the Lord, but the thinking can be given shape by the grace of the Lord, and therefore the common saying is that man proposes and God disposes. The whole explanation is on the subject of the absolute dependence of the living entities and absolute independence of the Supreme Lord. Less intelligent persons claiming to be

on an equal level with God must first prove themselves to be absolute and independent, and then they must substantiate their claim to being one with God.

TEXT 21

YadaTMaiNa iNaral/aek-MaaTMaaNa& c idd*+aTa")
iNai>aRàe ùi+a<aq TaSYa JYaaeiTaê+auGauR<aGa]h")) 21))

yadätmani nirälokaṁ

ätmänā ca didākñataù

nirbhinne hy akñiëé tasya

jyotiḥ cakñur guëa-grahaù

SYNONYMS

yadä—while; *ätmani*—unto Himself; *nirälokaṁ*—without any light; *ätmänam*—His own transcendental body; *ca*—also other bodily forms; *didākñataù*—desired to look upon; *nirbhinne*—due to being sprouted; *hi*—for; *akñiëé*—of the eyes; *tasya*—of Him; *jyotiù*—the sun; *cakñuù*—the eyes; *guëa-grahaù*—the power of seeing.

TRANSLATION

Thus when everything existed in darkness, the Lord desired to see Himself and all that was created. Then the eyes, the illuminating god Sun, the power of vision and the object of sight all became manifested.

PURPORT

The universe is by nature dense darkness, and therefore the total creation is called *tamas*, or darkness. The night is the real feature of the universe, for then one cannot see anything, including oneself. The Lord, out of His causeless mercy, first desired to see Himself and all the creation as well,

and thus the sun became manifested, the power of vision for all living entities became possible, and the objects of vision were also manifested. This means that the whole phenomenal world became visible after the creation of the sun.

TEXT 22

baeDYaMaaNaSYa %oizi>araTMaNaSTaiÂga*+aTa")
k-<aaŒ c iNari>aÛeTaa& idXa" é[ae}a& Gau<aGa]h")) 22))

bodhyamānasya āñibhir

ātmanas taj jighāṅṅataù

karēau ca nirabhidyetā

diṣaù çrotraà guëa-grahaù

SYNONYMS

bodhyamānasya—desiring to understand; *āñibhiù*—by the authorities; *ātmanaù*—of the Supreme Being; *taj*—that; *jighāṅṅataù*—when He desired to take up; *karēau*—the ears; *ca*—also; *nirabhidyetām*—became manifested; *diṣaù*—the direction or the god of air; *çrotram*—the power of hearing; *guëa-grahaù*—and the objects of hearing.

TRANSLATION

By development of the desire of the great sages to know, the ears, the power of hearing, the controlling deity of hearing, and the objects of hearing became manifested. The great sages desired to hear about the Self.

PURPORT

As stated in the *Bhagavad-gita*, by advancement of knowledge one should try to know about the Supreme Lord, the *summum bonum* of everything.

Knowledge does not mean knowledge only of the laws of nature or physical knowledge, which are working by the direction of the Lord. The scientists are eager to hear about the physical laws working in material nature. They are eager to hear through the medium of radio and television about things taking place far away from them on other planets, but they should know that the power of hearing and the instruments for hearing were given to them by the Lord for hearing about the Self, or about the Lord. Unfortunately the power of hearing is misused in hearing the vibrations of mundane affairs. The great sages were interested in hearing about the Lord through Vedic knowledge and nothing more. That is the beginning of aural reception of knowledge.

TEXT 23

**vSTauNaae Ma*duk-ai#=NYal/gauGauvaeRZ<aXaqTaTaaMa()
iJaga*+aTaSTvx(iNai>aRàa TaSYaa& raeMaMahqâha")
Ta}a caNTabRihvaRTaSTvca l/BDaGau<aae v*Ta")) 23))**

vastuno mându-käöhinya-

laghu-gurv-oñëa-çétatäm

jighâkñatas tvaì nirbhinnä

tasyäà roma-mahé-ruhäu

tatra cäntar bahir vätas

tvacä labdha-guëo vâtaù

SYNONYMS

vastunaù—of all matter; *mându*—softness; *käöhinya*—hardness; *laghu*—lightness; *guru*—heaviness; *oñëa*—warmness; *çétatäm*—coldness; *jighâkñataù*—desiring to perceive; *tvak*—the touch sensation; *nirbhinnä*—distributed; *tasyäm*—in the skin; *roma*—hairs on the body; *mahé-ruhäu*—as well as the trees, the controlling deities; *tatra*—there; *ca*—also; *antaù*—

within; *bahiù*—outside; *vātaù tvacä*—the sense of touch or the skin; *labdha*—having been perceived; *guëaù*—objects of sense perception; *vātaù*—generated.

TRANSLATION

When there was a desire to perceive the physical characteristics of matter, such as softness, hardness, warmth, cold, lightness and heaviness, the background of sensation, the skin, the skin pores, the hairs on the body and their controlling deities (the trees) were generated. Within and outside the skin is a covering of air through which sense perception became prominent.

PURPORT

The physical characteristics of matter, such as softness, are subjects of sense perception, and thus physical knowledge is the subject matter of the touch sensation. One can measure the temperature of matter by touching with the hand, and one can measure the weight of an object by lifting it with the hand and thus estimate its heaviness or lightness. The skin, the skin pores and the hairs on the body are all interdependent with the touch sensation. The air blowing within and outside the skin is also an object of sense perception. This sense perception is also a source of knowledge, and therefore it is suggested here that physical or physiological knowledge is subordinate to the knowledge of the Self, as above mentioned. Knowledge of Self can expand to the knowledge of phenomena, but physical knowledge cannot lead to knowledge of the Self.

There is, however, an intimate relation between the hairs on the body and the vegetation on the body of the earth. The vegetables are nourishment for the skin both as food and medicine, as stated in the Third Canto: *tvacam asya vinirbhinnäà viviçur dhiñëyam oñadhéù*.

TEXT 24

**hSTaaE ååhTauSTaSYa NaaNaak-MaRick-IzRYaa)
TaYaaESTau bl/vaiNaNd] AadaNaMau>aYaaé[YaMa()) 24))**

hastau ruruhatus tasya

nänä-karma-cikérñayä

tayos tu balavän indra

ädänam ubhayäçrayam

SYNONYMS

hastau—the hands; *ruruhatu*—manifested; *tasya*—His; *nänä*—various; *karma*—work; *cikérñayä*—being so desirous; *tayo*—of them; *tu*—however; *balavän*—to give strength; *indra*—the demigod in heaven; *ädänam*—activities of the hand; *ubhaya-äçrayam*—dependent on both the demigod and the hand.

TRANSLATION

Thereafter when the Supreme Person desired to perform varieties of work, the two hands and their controlling strength, and Indra, the demigod in heaven, became manifested, as also the acts dependent on both the hands and the demigod.

PURPORT

In every item we can note with profit that the sense organs of the living entity are never independent at any stage. The Lord is known as the Lord of the senses (Hãñékeça). Thus the sense organs of the living entities are manifested by the will of the Lord, and each organ is controlled by a certain type of demigod. No one, therefore, can claim any proprietorship of the senses. The living entity is controlled by the senses, the senses are controlled by the demigods, and the demigods are the servants of the Supreme Lord. That is the arrangement in the system of creation. The whole thing is controlled ultimately by the Supreme Lord, and there is no independence either of the material nature or of the living entity. The illusioned living entity who claims to be the lord of his senses is under the clutches of the external energy of the Lord. As long as a living entity

continues to be puffed up by his tiny existence, he is to be understood to be under the stringent control of the external energy of the Lord, and there is no question of liberation from the clutches of illusion (*mäyā*), however much one may declare himself a liberated soul.

TEXT 25

**GaiTa& iJaGaQzTa" PaadaE ååhaTae_i>ak-aiMak-aMa()
PaÛya& Yaj" SvYa& hVYa& k-MaRi>a" iṣ-YaTae Na*i>a")) 25))**

gatià jigéñataù pädau

ruruhäte 'bhikämikäm

padbhyäà yajiaù svayaà havyaà

karmabhiù kriyate nābhiù

SYNONYMS

*gati*m—movement; *jigéñataù*—so desiring; *pädau*—the legs; *ruruhäte*—being manifested; *abhikämikäm*—purposeful; *padbhyäm*—from the legs; *yajiaù*—Lord Viṣṇu; *svayam*—personally Himself; *havyam*—the duties; *karmabhiù*—by one's occupational duty; *kriyate*—caused to be done; *nābhiù*—by different human beings.

TRANSLATION

Thereupon, because of His desiring to control movement, His legs became manifested, and from the legs the controlling deity named Viṣṇu was generated. By His personal supervision of this act, all varieties of human being are busily engaged in dutiful occupational sacrifice.

PURPORT

Every human being is engaged in his particular occupational duty, and such activities are visible as men go hither and thither. This is very prominently

visible in big cities of the world: people are going all over the cities with great concern, from one place to another. This movement is not limited only to the cities, but is also visible outside the cities from one place to another, or from one city to another, by different means of vehicles. Men are moving by cars and rails on the roads, by subways within the earth and by planes in the sky for the purpose of business success. But in all these movements the real purpose is to earn wealth for comfortable life. For this comfortable life the scientist is engaged, the artist is engaged, the engineer is engaged, the technician is engaged, all in different branches of human activity. But they do not know how to make the activities purposeful to fulfill the mission of human life. Because they do not know this secret, all their activities are targeted towards the goal of sense gratification without control, and therefore by all this business they are unknowingly entering into the deep regions of darkness.

Because they have been captivated by the external energy of the Supreme Lord, they have completely forgotten the Supreme Lord Viṣṇu, and thus they have taken it for granted that this life, as presently manifested under the conditions of material nature, is all in all for enjoying the highest amount of sense gratification. But such a wrong conception of life cannot give anyone the desired peace of mind, and thus in spite of all advancement in knowledge by use of the resources of nature, no one is happy in this material civilization. The secret is that at every step they should try to execute sacrifices toward the path of world peace. The ***Bhagavad-gita*** (18.45–46) also advises the same secret in the following verses.

*sve sve karmaëy abhiratau
saàsiddhià labhate naraù
sva-karma-niratau siddhià
yathä vindati tac chãëu*

*yatau pravãttir bhütänäà
yena sarvam idaà tatam
sva-karmaëä tam abhyarcya
siddhià vindati mänavaù*

The Lord said to Arjuna: “Just hear from Me how one can attain the highest perfection in life simply by discharging his specified occupational duty. Man can attain the highest perfection of life by worshiping the Supreme Lord and by performing sacrifice for the sake of the Supreme Lord Viṣṇu, who is all-pervading and by whose control every living being acquires his desired facilities, according to his personal propensity.”

There is no harm in having different propensities in life because every human being is proportionately independent to chalk out the plan of his life by different occupations, but one should make it a point in his life to know perfectly well that he is not independent absolutely. One is certainly under the control of the Supreme Lord and under different agencies. Knowing this, one should make it a point that by his work and the result of his labor he serves the Supreme Lord as prescribed by the authorities expert in the transcendental loving service of the Supreme Lord Viṣṇu. For performing such occupational duties of life the leg is the most important instrument of the body because without the help of the legs one cannot move from one place to another, and therefore the Lord has special control over the legs of all human beings, which are meant for performing *yajñas*.

TEXT 26

**iNari>aŪTa iXaénae vE Pa[JaaNaNdaMa*TaaIQaRNa")
oPaSQa AaSaqTa(k-aMaaNaa& iPa[Ya& Tadu>aYaaé[YaMa()) 26))**

nirabhidyata çiçno vai

prajānandāmātārthinaù

upastha äsét kāmānāà

priyaà tad-ubhayāçrayam

SYNONYMS

nirabhidyata—came out; *çiçnaù*—the genitals; *vai*—certainly; *prajā-
ānanda*—sex pleasure; *amāta-arthinaù*—aspiring to taste the nectar;

upasthaù—the male or female organ; *äsét*—came into existence; *kāmānām*—of the lustful; *priyam*—very dear; *tat*—that; *ubhaya-āçrayam*—shelter for both.

TRANSLATION

Thereupon, for sexual pleasure, begetting offspring and tasting heavenly nectar, the Lord developed the genitals, and thus there is the genital organ and its controlling deity, the Prajāpati. The object of sexual pleasure and the controlling deity are under the control of the genitals of the Lord.

PURPORT

The heavenly pleasure for the conditioned soul is sexual pleasure, and this pleasure is tasted by the genitals. The woman is the object of sexual pleasure, and both the sense perception of sexual pleasure and the woman are controlled by the Prajāpati, who is under the control of the Lord's genitals. The impersonalist must know from this verse that the Lord is not impersonal, for He has His genitals, on which all the pleasurable objects of sex depend. No one would have taken the trouble to maintain children if there were no taste of heavenly nectar by means of sexual intercourse. This material world is created to give the conditioned souls a chance for rejuvenation for going back home, back to Godhead, and therefore generation of the living being is necessary for upkeep of the purpose of creation. Sexual pleasure is an impetus for such action, and as such one can even serve the Lord in the act of such sexual pleasure. The service is counted when the children born of such sexual pleasure are properly trained in God consciousness. The whole idea of material creation is to revive the dormant God consciousness of the living entity. In forms of life other than the human form, sexual pleasure is prominent without any motive of service for the mission of the Lord. But in the human form of life the conditioned soul can render service to the Lord by creating progeny suitable for the attainment of salvation. One can beget hundreds of children and enjoy the celestial pleasure of sexual intercourse, provided he is able to train the children in God consciousness. Otherwise begetting children is on the level of the swine. Rather, the swine is more expert than

the human being because the swine can beget a dozen piglets at a time, whereas the human being can give birth to only one at a time. So one should always remember that the genitals, sexual pleasure, the woman and the offspring are all related in the service of the Lord, and one who forgets this relationship in the service of the Supreme Lord becomes subjected to the threefold miseries of material existence by the laws of nature. Perception of sexual pleasure is there even in the body of the dog, but there is no sense of God consciousness. The human form of life is distinct from that of the dog by the perception of God consciousness.

TEXT 27

oiTSaSa*+aaeDaaRTauMal&/ iNari>aÛTa vE GaudMa()
TaTa" PaaYauSTaTaae iMa}a oTSaGaR o>aYaaé[Ya")) 27))

utsisâkñor dhātu-malā

nirabhidyata vai gudam

tataù päyus tato mitra

utsarga ubhayäçrayaù

SYNONYMS

utsisâkñor—desiring to evacuate; *dhātu-malam*—refuse of eatables; *nirabhidyata*—became open; *vai*—certainly; *gudam*—the evacuating hole; *tataù*—thereafter; *päyù*—the evacuating sense organ; *tataù*—thereafter; *mitraù*—the controlling demigod; *utsargaù*—the substance evacuated; *ubhaya*—both; *äçrayaù*—shelter.

TRANSLATION

Thereafter, when He desired to evacuate the refuse of eatables, the evacuating hole, anus, and the sensory organ thereof developed along with the controlling deity Mitra. The sensory organ and the evacuating substance are both under the shelter of the controlling deity.

PURPORT

Even in the matter of evacuating stool, the refuse is controlled, so how can the living entity claim to be independent?

TEXT 28

AaiSaSa*PSaae" Paur" PauYaaR Naai>aÜarMaPaaNaTa")
Ta}aaPaaNaSTaTaae Ma*TYau" Pa*Qaṛ-Mau>aYaaé[YaMa()) 28))

äsisāpsoù puraù puryā

nābhi-dvāram apānataù

tatrāpānas tato mātyuù

pāthaktvam ubhayāçrayam

SYNONYMS

äsisāpsoù—desiring to go everywhere; *puraù*—in different bodies;
puryäù—from one body; *nābhi-dvāram*—the navel or abdominal hole;
apānataù—was manifested; *tatra*—thereupon; *apānaù*—stopping of the
vital force; *tataù*—thereafter; *mātyuù*—death; *pāthaktvam*—separately;
ubhaya—both; *āçrayam*—shelter.

TRANSLATION

Thereafter, when He desired to move from one body to another, the navel and the air of departure and death were combinedly created. The navel is the shelter for both, namely death and the separating force.

PURPORT

The *prāëa-vāyu* continues the life, and the *apāna-vāyu* stops the living force. Both the vibrations are generated from the abdominal hole, the navel. This navel is the joint from one body to the other. Lord Brahmā was

born of the abdominal hole of Garbhodakaśāyī Viṣṇu as a separate body, and the same principle is followed even in the birth of any ordinary body. The body of the child develops from the body of the mother, and when the child is separated from the body of the mother, it is separated by cutting the navel joint. And that is the way the Supreme Lord manifested Himself as separated many. The living entities are therefore separated parts, and thus they have no independence.

TEXT 29

**AaidTSaaeràPaaNaaNaaMaaSaNa(ku-+YaN}aNaa@Ya")
NaŪ" SaMaud]aê TaYaaeSTauii" PauíiSTadaé[Yae)) 29))**

äditsor anna-pānānām

äsan kukñi-antra-nādayaù

nadyaù samudrāç ca tayos

tuñöiù puñöis tad-äçraye

SYNONYMS

äditsoù—desiring to have; *anna-pānānām*—of food and drink; *äsan*—there became; *kukñi*—the abdomen; *antra*—the intestines; *nādayaù*—and the arteries; *nadyaù*—the rivers; *samudrāù*—seas; *ca*—also; *tayaù*—of them; *tuñöiù*—sustenance; *puñöiù*—metabolism; *tad*—of them; *äçraye*—the source.

TRANSLATION

When there was a desire to have food and drink, the abdomen and the intestines and also the arteries became manifested. The rivers and seas are the source of their sustenance and metabolism.

PURPORT

The controlling deities of the intestines are the rivers, and those of the arteries, the seas. Fulfillment of the belly with food and drink is the cause of sustenance, and the metabolism of the food and drink replaces the waste of the bodily energies. Therefore, the body's health is dependent on healthy actions of the intestines and the arteries. The rivers and the seas, being the controlling deities of the two, keep the intestines and the arteries in healthy order.

TEXT 30

iNaidDYaaSaaeraTMaMaaYaa& ôdYa& iNari>aÔTa)
TaTaae MaNaêNd] wiTa Sa^aLPa" k-aMa Wv c)) 30))

nididhyäsor ätma-mäyää

hådayaà nirabhidyata

tato manaç candra iti

saikalpaù käma eva ca

SYNONYMS

nididhyäsoù—being desirous to know; *ätma-mäyäm*—own energy;
hådayam—the location of the mind; *nirabhidyata*—was manifested;
tataù—thereafter; *manaù*—the mind; *candraù*—the controlling deity of the mind, the moon; *iti*—thus; *saikalpaù*—determination; *kämaù*—desire;
eva—as much as; *ca*—also.

TRANSLATION

When there was a desire to think about the activities of His own energy, then the heart (the seat of the mind), the mind, the moon, determination and all desire became manifested.

PURPORT

The heart of every living entity is the seat of the Supersoul, Paramātmā, a plenary expansion of the Supreme Personality of Godhead. Without His presence the living entity cannot get into the working energy according to his past deeds. The living entities who are conditioned in the material world are manifested in the creation in terms of respective inclinations inherent in them, and the requisite material body is offered to each and every one of them by the material energy under the direction of the Supersoul. This is explained in the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (9.10). When, therefore, the Supersoul is situated in the heart of the conditioned soul, the requisite mind is manifested in the conditioned soul, and he becomes conscious of his occupation as one is conscious of his duty after waking up from slumber. Therefore the material mind of the living entity develops when the Supersoul sits on his heart, after which the mind, the controlling deity (moon), and then the activities of the mind (namely thinking, feeling and willing) all take place. The activities of the mind cannot begin without the manifestation of the heart, and the heart becomes manifested when the Lord wants to see the activities of the material creation.

TEXT 31

**TvKcMaRMaa&SaâiDarMaedaeMaÂaiSQaDaaTav")
>aUMYaâeJaaeMaYaa" Saá Pa[a<aae VYaaeMaaMbuvaYauia")) 31))**

tvak-carma-mäàsa-rudhira-

medo-majjästhi-dhätavaù

bhümy-ap-tejomayäù sapta

präëo vyomämbu-väyubhiù

SYNONYMS

tvak—the thin layer on the skin; *carma*—skin; *mäàsa*—flesh; *rudhira*—blood; *medaù*—fat; *majjä*—marrow; *asthi*—bone; *dhätavaù*—elements; *bhümi*—earth; *ap*—water; *tejaù*—fire; *mayäù*—predominating; *sapta*—seven; *präëaù*—breathing air; *vyoma*—sky; *ambu*—water; *väyubhiù*—by

the air.

TRANSLATION

The seven elements of the body, namely the thin layer on the skin, the skin itself, the flesh, blood, fat, marrow and bone, are all made of earth, water and fire, whereas the life breath is produced by the sky, water and air.

PURPORT

The construction of the whole material world is prominently made by three elements, namely earth, water and fire. But the living force is produced by sky, air and water. So water is the common element in both the gross and subtle forms of all material creation, and it should be noted herewith that due to necessity, water, being most prominent in the material creation, is the principal element of all the five. This material body is thus an embodiment of the five elements, and the gross manifestation is perceived because of three, namely earth, water, and fire. Sensations of touch are perceived due to the thin layer on the skin, and bone is as good as hard stone. The breathing air of life is produced of sky, air and water, and therefore open air, regular bath and ample space in which to live are favorable for healthy vitality. Fresh produce from the earth like grains and vegetables, as well as fresh water and heat, is good for the upkeep of the gross body.

TEXT 32

**Gau<aaTMak-aNaqiNd]Yaai<a >aUTaaidPa[>ava Gau<aa")
MaNa" SavRivk-araTMaa buiÖivRjaNaæiPa<aq)) 32))**

guëätmakänéndriyäëi

bhütädi-prabhavä guëäù

manaù sarva-vikärätmä

SYNONYMS

guëa-ätmakäni—attached to the qualities; *indriyäëi*—the senses; *bhüta-ädi*—material ego; *prabhaväù*—influenced by; *guëäù*—the modes of material nature; *manaù*—the mind; *sarva*—all; *vikära*—affection (happiness and distress); *ätmä*—form; *buddhiù*—intelligence; *vijjāna*—deliberation; *rūpië*—featuring.

TRANSLATION

The sense organs are attached to the modes of material nature, and the modes of material nature are products of the false ego. The mind is subjected to all kinds of material experiences (happiness and distress), and the intelligence is the feature of the mind's deliberation.

PURPORT

Illusioned by the material nature, the living entity identifies with false ego. More clearly, when the living entity is entrapped by the material body, he at once identifies with the bodily relationships, forgetting his own identity as spirit soul. This false ego associates with different modes of material nature, and thus the senses become attached to the modes of material nature. Mind is the instrument for feeling different material experiences, but intelligence is deliberative and can change everything for the better. The intelligent person, therefore, can attain salvation from the illusion of material existence by proper use of intelligence. An intelligent person can detect the awkward position of material existence and thus begin to inquire as to what he is, why he is subjected to different kinds of miseries, and how to get rid of all miseries, and thus, by good association, an advanced intelligent person can turn towards the better life of self-realization. It is advised, therefore, that an intelligent person associate with the great sages and saints who are on the path of salvation. By such association, one can receive instructions which are able to slacken the conditioned soul's attachment for matter, and thus the intelligent man gradually gets rid of the illusion of matter and false ego and is promoted to the real life of

eternity, knowledge and bliss.

TEXT 33

WTaÙGavTaae æPa& SQaUI&/ Tae VYaaôTa& MaYaa)
Maùaidi>aêavr<aErîi>abRihrav*TaMa()) 33))

etat bhagavato rūpā

sthūlaà te vyāhātaà mayā

mahy-ādibhiḥ cāvaraēair

añöabhir bahir ävātam

SYNONYMS

etat—all these; *bhagavataù*—of the Personality of Godhead; *rūpam*—form; *sthūlam*—gross; *te*—unto you; *vyāhātam*—explained; *mayā*—by me; *mahé*—the planets; *ādibhiù*—and so on; *ca*—unlimitedly; *avaraēaiù*—by coverings; *añöabhiù*—by eight; *bahiù*—external; *ävātam*—covered.

TRANSLATION

Thus by all this, the external feature of the Personality of Godhead is covered by gross forms such as those of planets, which were explained to you by me.

PURPORT

As explained in the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (7.4), the separated material energy of the Personality of Godhead is covered by eight kinds of material coverings: earth, water, fire, air, sky, mind, intelligence and false ego. All these are emanations from the Personality of Godhead as His external energy. These coverings are just like the covering of clouds for the sun. The cloud is a creation of the sun, yet it actually covers the eyes so that one cannot see the sun. The sun cannot be covered by the clouds. The cloud can at utmost

extend a few hundreds of miles in the sky, but the sun is far greater than millions of miles. So a hundred-mile covering is not competent to cover millions of miles. Therefore, one of the various energies of the Supreme Personality of Godhead cannot, of course, cover the Lord. But these coverings are created by Him to cover the eyes of the conditioned souls who want to lord it over the material nature. Actually the conditioned souls are covered by the illusory creative cloud of matter, and the Lord reserves the right of not being exposed to their eyes. Because they have no eyes of transcendental vision and because they cannot see the Personality of Godhead, they therefore deny the existence of the Lord and the transcendental form of the Lord. The covering of the gigantic material feature is accepted by such men with a poor fund of knowledge, and how this is so is explained in the following verse.

TEXT 34

**ATa" Par& SaU+MaTaMaMaVYač&- iNaivRXaez<aMa()
ANaaidMaDYaiNaDaNa& iNaTYa& vax(MaNaSa" ParMa()) 34))**

ataù paraà sūkñmatamam

avyaktaà nirviṣeñāëam

anädi-madhyā-nidhanaà

nityaà väi-manasaù param

SYNONYMS

ataù—therefore; *param*—transcendental; *sūkñmatamam*—finer than the finest; *avyaktam*—unmanifested; *nirviṣeñāëam*—without material features; *anädi*—without beginning; *madhyā*—without an intermediate stage; *nidhanam*—without end; *nityam*—eternal; *vāk*—words; *manasaù*—of the mind; *param*—transcendental.

TRANSLATION

Therefore beyond this [gross manifestation] is a transcendental manifestation finer than the finest form. It has no beginning, no intermediate stage and no end; therefore it is beyond the limits of expression or mental speculation and is distinct from the material conception.

PURPORT

The gross external body of the Supreme is manifested at certain intervals, and thus the external feature or form of the Supreme Personality of Godhead is not the eternal form of the Lord, which has no beginning, no intermediate stage and no end. Anything which has a beginning, interim and end is called material. The material world is begun from the Lord, and thus the form of the Lord, before the beginning of the material world, is certainly transcendental to the finest, or the finer material conception. The ether in the material world is considered to be the finest. Finer than the ether is mind, intelligence, and false ego. But all eight of the outward coverings are explained as outer coverings of the Absolute Truth. The Absolute Truth is therefore beyond the expression and speculation of the material conception. He is certainly transcendental to all material conceptions. This is called *nirviṣeṣā*. One should not, however, misunderstand *nirviṣeṣā* as being without any transcendental qualifications. *Viṣeṣā* means qualities. Therefore *nir* added to it means that he has no material qualities or variegatedness. This nullifying expression is described in four transcendental qualifications, namely unmanifested, transcendental, eternal, and beyond the conception of mind or word. Beyond the limits of words means negation of the material conception. Unless one is transcendently situated, it is not possible to know the transcendental form of the Lord.

TEXT 35

**AMauNaq >aGavd]UPae MaYaa Tae ùNauvi<aRTae)
o>ae AiPa Na Ga*õiNTa MaaYaaSa*íe ivPaiêTa")) 35))**

amuné bhagavad-rüpe

mayä te hy anuvarëite

ubhe api na gähëanti

mäyä-sãñöe vipaçcitaù

SYNONYMS

amuné—all these; *bhagavat*—unto the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *rüpe*—in the forms; *mayä*—by me; *te*—unto you; *hi*—certainly; *anuvarëite*—described respectively; *ubhe*—both; *api*—also; *na*—never; *gähëanti*—accepts; *mäyä*—external; *sãñöe*—being so manifested; *vipaù-citaù*—the learned one who knows.

TRANSLATION

Neither of the above forms of the Lord, as just described unto you from the material angle of vision, is accepted by the pure devotees of the Lord who know Him well.

PURPORT

The impersonalists think of the Absolute Personality of Godhead in two different ways, as above mentioned. On the one hand they worship the Lord in His *viçva-rüpa*, or all-pervading universal form, and on the other they think of the Lord's unmanifested, indescribable, subtle form. The theories of pantheism and monism are respectively applicable to these two conceptions of the Supreme as gross and subtle, but both of them are rejected by the learned pure devotees of the Lord because they are aware of the factual position. This is very clearly mentioned in the Eleventh Chapter of the *Bhagavad-gita*, which records Arjuna's experience of the *viçva-rüpa* of the Supreme Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa.

adãñöa-pürvaà hãñito 'smi dãñövä
bhayena ca pravyathitaà mano me
tad eva me darçaya deva rüpaà
praséda deveça jagan-niväsa

(Bg. 11.45)

Arjuna, as a pure devotee of the Lord, never previously saw the contemplated universal form of the Lord (*viçva-rūpa*), but when he did see it, his curiosities were satisfied. But he was not happy to see such a form of the Lord because of his attachment as a pure devotee. He was afraid to see the gigantic form of the Lord. He therefore prayed to the Lord to assume His four-handed Nārāyaṇa or Kṛṣṇa form, which alone could please Arjuna. Undoubtedly the Lord has the supreme potency to exhibit Himself in multifarious forms, but the pure devotees of the Lord are interested in His forms as eternally exhibited in the abode of the Lord, known as the *tripād-vibhūti* or kingdom of God. The Lord in the *tripād-vibhūti* abode exhibits Himself in two forms, either with four hands or with two hands. The *viçva-rūpa* exhibited in the material manifestation has unlimited hands and unlimited dimensions with everything unlimited. The pure devotees of the Lord worship Him in His Vaikuntha forms as Nārāyaṇa or Kṛṣṇa. Sometimes the same Vaikuntha forms of the Lord are in the material world also by His grace as Sri Rāma, Sri Kṛṣṇa, Sri Narasiṅhadeva, etc., and thus the pure devotees also worship them. Usually the features shown in the material world have no existence in the Vaikuntha planets, and thus they are not accepted by the pure devotees. What the pure devotees worship from the very beginning are eternal forms of the Lord existing in the Vaikuntha planets. The nondevotee impersonalists imagine the material forms of the Lord, and ultimately they merge in the impersonal *brahmajyoti* of the Lord, whereas the pure devotees of the Lord are worshipers of the Lord both in the beginning and also in the perfect stage of salvation, eternally. The worship of the pure devotee never stops, whereas the worship of the impersonalist stops after his attainment of salvation, when he merges in the impersonal form of the Lord known as the *brahmajyoti*. Therefore the pure devotees of the Lord are described here as *vipaścita*, or the learned who are in the knowledge of the Lord perfectly.

TEXT 36

**Sa vaCYavack-TaYaa >aGavaNa(b]øæPaDa*k(-)
NaaMaæPaiṣ-Yaa Datae Sak-MaaRk-MaRk-" Par")) 36))**

sa väcyä-väcakatayä

bhagavän brahma-rüpa-dhåk

näma-rüpa-kriyä dhatte

sakarmäkarmakaù paraù

SYNONYMS

saù—He; *väcyä*—by His forms and activities; *väcakatayä*—by His transcendental qualities and entourage; *bhagavän*—the Personality of Godhead; *brahma*—absolute; *rüpa-dhåk*—by accepting visible forms; *näma*—name; *rüpa*—form; *kriyä*—pastimes; *dhatte*—accepts; *sa-karma*—engaged in work; *akarmakaù*—without being affected; *paraù*—transcendence.

TRANSLATION

He, the Personality of Godhead, manifests Himself in a transcendental form, being the subject of His transcendental name, quality, pastimes, entourage and transcendental variegatedness. Although He is unaffected by all such activities, He appears to be so engaged.

PURPORT

Whenever there is a need of material creation, the transcendental Personality of Godhead accepts forms in the material world for creation, maintenance and destruction. One should be intelligent enough to know His activities in truth and not be biased to conclude that He descends to the material world by accepting a form created by material nature. Any form accepted from the material nature has its affection for everything done in the material world. A conditioned soul who accepts a material form for undergoing a certain term of material activities is subjected to the laws of matter. But here in this verse it is clearly stated that although the forms and activities of the Lord appear to be the same as those of a conditioned soul, they are supernatural and impossible for the conditioned soul. He, the

Supreme Personality of Godhead, is always unaffected by such activities. In the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (4.14) the Lord says:

*na mää karmäëi limpanti
na me karma-phale spåhä
iti mää yo 'bhijänäti
karmabhir na sa badhyate*

The Lord is never affected by the activities which He apparently performs by His different incarnations and personalities, nor does He have any desire to achieve success by fruitive activities. The Lord is full by His different potencies of wealth, strength, fame, beauty, knowledge and renunciation, and thus He has no reason for physical exertion like the conditioned soul. Therefore an intelligent person who can distinguish between the transcendental activities of the Lord and the activities of the conditioned souls is also not bound by the reactions of activities. The Lord as Viṣṇu, Brahmä and Siva conducts the three modes of material nature. From Viṣṇu is born Brahmä, and from Brahmä is born Siva. Sometimes Brahmä is a separated part of Viṣṇu, and sometimes Brahmä is Viṣṇu Himself. Thus Brahmä creates the different species of life all over the universe, which means that the Lord creates the whole manifestation either by Himself or through the agency of His authorized deputies.

TEXTS 37–40

**Pa[JaaPaTaqNMaNaUNa(devaNa*zqNa(iPaTa*Ga<aaNa(Pa*Qak(-)
iSaÖcar<aGaNDavaRNA(ivÛaDa]aSaurGauùk-aNa()) 37))
ik-àraPSarSaae NaaGaaNa(SaPaaRNA(ik-MPauåzaàraNa()
MaaTa> r+a"iPaXaaca&ê Pa[eTa>aUTaivNaaYak-aNa()) 38))
kU-ZMaa<@aeNMaadveTaal/aNa(YaaTauDaaNaaNa(Ga]haNaiPa)
%GaaNMa*GaaNa(PaéUNa(v*+aaNa(iGarqà*Pa SarqSa*PaaNa()) 39))
iÛivDaaêTauivRDaa Yae_NYae Jal/SQal/Na>aaEk-Sa")
ku-Xal/aku-Xal/a iMaé[a" k-MaR<aa& GaTaYaiSTvMaa")) 40))**

prajā-patén manün devän

añén pitå-gaëän pāthak

siddha-cäraëa-gandharvân

vidyâdhrâsura-guhyakân

kinnarâpsaraso nâgân

sarpân kimpuruñân narân

mâtè rakñaù-piçäcäàç ca

preta-bhûta-vinäyakân

küñmäëdonmäda-vetälân

yätudhânân grahân api

khagân mâgân paçün vâkñân

girén nâpa sarésâpân

dvi-vidhâç catur-vidhâ ye 'nye

jala-sthala-nabhaukasaù

kuçaläkuçalä miçräù

karmaëää gatayas tv imäù

SYNONYMS

prajā-patén—Brahmä and his sons like Dakña and others; *manün*—the periodical heads like Vaivasvata Manu; *devân*—like Indra, Candra and Varuëa; *añén*—like Bhågu and Vasiñöha; *pitâ-gaëân*—the inhabitants of the Pitâ planets; *pâthak*—separately; *siddha*—the inhabitants of the Siddha planet; *cäraëa*—the inhabitants of the Cäraëa planet; *gandharvân*—the inhabitants of the Gandharva planets; *vidyâdhra*—the inhabitants of the Vidyâdhara planet; *asura*—the atheists; *guhyakân*—the inhabitants of the

Yakña planet; *kinnara*—the inhabitants of the Kinnara planet; *apsarasaù*—the beautiful angels of the Apsarā planet; *nāgān*—the serpentine inhabitants of Nāgaloka; *sarpān*—the inhabitants of Sarpaloka (snakes); *kimpuruñān*—the monkey-shaped inhabitants of the Kimpuruṣa planet; *narān*—the inhabitants of earth; *mātā*—the inhabitants of Mātāloka; *rakñāu*—the inhabitants of the demoniac planet; *piçācān*—the inhabitants of Piçācaloka; *ca*—also; *preta*—the inhabitants of Pretaloka; *bhūta*—the evil spirits; *vināyakān*—the goblins; *kūñmāēōa*—will-o’-the-wisp; *unmāda*—lunatics; *vetālān*—the jinn; *yātudhānān*—a particular type of evil spirit; *grahān*—the good and evil stars; *api*—also; *khagān*—the birds; *māgān*—the forest animals; *paçūn*—the household animals; *vākñān*—the ghosts; *girēn*—the mountains; *nāpa*—O King; *sarēsāpān*—reptiles; *dvi-vidhāu*—the moving and the standing living entities; *catuù-vidhāu*—living entities born from embryos, eggs, perspiration and seeds; *ye*—others; *anye*—all; *jala*—water; *sthala*—land; *nabha-okasaù*—birds; *kuçala*—in happiness; *akuçalāu*—in distress; *miçrāu*—in mixed happiness and distress; *karmaēām*—according to one’s own past deeds; *gatayaù*—as result of; *tu*—but; *imāu*—all of them.

TRANSLATION

O King, know from me that all living entities are created by the Supreme Lord according to their past deeds. This includes Brahmā and his sons like Dakña, the periodical heads like Vaivasvata Manu, the demigods like Indra, Candra and Varuēa, the great sages like Bhāgu, Vyāsa and Vasiñōha, the inhabitants of Pitāloka and Siddhaloka, the Cāraēas, Gandharvas, Vidyādharas, Asuras, Yakñas, Kinnaras and angels, the serpentine, the monkey-shaped Kimpuruṣas, the human beings, the inhabitants of Mātāloka, the demons, Piçācas, ghosts, spirits, lunatics and evil spirits, the good and evil stars, the goblins, the animals in the forest, the birds, the household animals, the reptiles, the mountains, the moving and standing living entities, the living entities born from embryos, from eggs, from perspiration and from seeds, and all others, whether they be in the water, land or sky, in happiness, in distress or in mixed happiness and distress. All of them, according to their past deeds, are created by the Supreme Lord.

PURPORT

The varieties of living entities are mentioned in this list, and, with no exception from the topmost planet down to the lowest planet of the universe, all of them in different species of life are created by the Almighty Father, Viṣṇu. Therefore no one is independent of the Supreme Personality of Godhead. In the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (14.4) the Lord therefore claims all living entities as His offspring in the following verse:

*sarva-yoniṅṅu kaunteya
mūrtayaṁ sambhavanti yāṁ
tāsāṁ brahma mahad yonir
ahaṁ béja-pradaṁ pitā*

The material nature is compared to the mother. Although every living being is seen to come out of the mother's body, it is still a fact that the mother is not the ultimate cause of such a birth. The father is the ultimate cause of birth. Without the father's seed, no mother can give birth to a child. Therefore the living beings in different varieties of forms and positions within the innumerable universes are all born of the seeds of the Almighty Father, the Personality of Godhead, and only to the man with a poor fund of knowledge they appear to be born of the material nature. Being under the material energy of the Supreme Lord, all living entities beginning from Brahmā down to the insignificant ant are manifested in different bodies according to their past deeds.

The material nature is one of the energies of the Lord (Bg. 7.4). The material nature is inferior in comparison to the living entities, the superior nature. The superior nature and inferior nature of the Lord combine to manifest all universal affairs.

Some of the living entities are relatively happy in better conditions of life, whereas others are in distressed conditions of life. But factually, none of them are actually happy in material conditional life. No one can be happy in prison life, although one may be a first-class prisoner and another a third-class prisoner. The intelligent person should not try to be promoted from third-class prison life to first-class prison life, but should try to be released

from the prison altogether. One may be promoted to first-class prisoner, but the same first-class prisoner is again degraded to a third-class prisoner in the next term. One should try to be free from prison life and go back home, back to Godhead. That is the real goal for all types of living entities.

TEXT 41

Satv& rJaSTaMa wiTa iTaó" SaurNa*Naark-a")
Ta}aaPYaekE-k-Xaae raJaNa(i>aÛNTae GaTaYaiñDaa)
YadEkE-k-Tarae_NYaa>Yaa& Sv>aav oPahNYaTae)) 41))

sattvaà rajas tama iti

tisraù sura-nå-nārakäù

taträpy ekaikaço räjan

bhidyante gatayas tridhä

yadaikaikataro 'nyäbhyäà

sva-bhäva upahanyate

SYNONYMS

sattvam—the mode of goodness; *rajaù*—the mode of passion; *tamaù*—the mode of darkness; *iti*—thus; *tisraù*—the three; *sura*—demigod; *nå*—human being; *nārakäù*—one who is suffering hellish conditions; *tatra api*—even there; *ekaikaçaù*—another; *räjan*—O King; *bhidyante*—divide into; *gatayaù*—movements; *tridhä*—three; *yadä*—at that time; *ekaikatarau*—one in relation with another; *anyäbhyäm*—from the other; *sva-bhävaù*—habit; *upahanyate*—develops.

TRANSLATION

According to the different modes of material nature—the mode of goodness, the mode of passion and the mode of darkness—there are

different living creatures, who are known as demigods, human beings and hellish living entities. O King, even a particular mode of nature, being mixed with the other two, is divided into three, and thus each kind of living creature is influenced by the other modes and acquires its habits also.

PURPORT

The living entities individually are being conducted by a particular mode of nature, but at the same time there is every chance of their being influenced by the other two. Generally, all conditioned souls in the material encagement are influenced by the mode of passion because every one of them is trying to lord it over the material nature to fulfill his individual desire. But in spite of the individual mode of passion, there is always the chance of being influenced by the other modes of nature by association. If one is in good association he can develop the mode of goodness, and if in bad association he may develop the mode of darkness or ignorance. Nothing is stereotyped. One can change his habit by good or bad association, and one has to become intelligent enough to discriminate between good and bad. The best association is the service of the devotees of the Lord, and by that association one can become the highest qualified man by the grace of the Lord's pure devotees. As we have already seen in the life of Srila Nārada Muni, he became the topmost devotee of the Lord simply by the association of pure devotees of the Lord. By birth he was the son of a maidservant and had no knowledge of his father and no academic education, even of the lowest status. But simply by associating with the devotees and by eating the remnants of their foodstuff, he gradually developed the transcendental qualities of the devotees. By such association, his taste for chanting and hearing the transcendental glories of the Lord became prominent, and because the glories of the Lord are nondifferent from the Lord, he got direct association with the Lord by means of sound representation. Similarly, there is the life of Ajāmila (Sixth Canto), who was the son of a *brahmana* and was educated and trained properly in the discharge of the duties of a *brahmana*, but who in spite of all this, because he contacted the bad association of a prostitute, was put into the path of the lowest quality of *caḍḍāla*, or the last position for a human being. Therefore the *Bhāgavatam* always recommends the

association of the *mahat*, or the great soul, for opening the gate of salvation. To associate with persons engaged in lording it over the material world means to enter into the darkest region of hell. One should try to raise himself by the association of the great soul. That is the way of the perfection of life.

TEXT 42

Sa Wved& JaGaÖaTaa >aGavaNa(DaMaRæPaDa*k(-)
PauZ<aaiTa SQaaPaYaNa(ivi& iTaYaRx(NarSauraidi>a")) 42))

sa evedaà jagad-dhätä

bhagavän dharma-rüpa-dhåk

puñëäti sthāpayan viçvaà

tiryai-nara-surädibhiù

SYNONYMS

saù—He; *eva*—certainly; *idam*—this; *jagat-dhätä*—the maintainer of the entire universe; *bhagavän*—the Personality of Godhead; *dharma-rüpa-dhåk*—assuming the form of religious principles; *puñëäti*—maintains; *sthāpayan*—after establishing; *viçvam*—the universes; *tiryak*—living entities lower than the human beings; *nara*—the human beings; *sura-ädibhiù*—by the demigodly incarnations.

TRANSLATION

He, the Personality of Godhead, as the maintainer of all in the universe, appears in different incarnations after establishing the creation, and thus He reclaims all kinds of conditioned souls amongst the humans, the nonhumans and the demigods.

PURPORT

The Supreme Personality of Godhead Viṣṇu incarnates Himself in different societies of living entities to reclaim them from the clutches of illusion, and such activities of the Lord are not limited only to human society. He incarnates Himself even as a fish, hog, tree and many other forms, but less intelligent persons who have no knowledge of Him deride Him even if He is in human society as a human being. The Lord therefore says in the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (9.11):

*avajānanti mää müòhä
mänuñéà tanum äçritam
paraà bhävam ajänanto
mama bhüta-maheçvaram*

As we have already discussed in the previous verses, it is concluded that the Lord is never a product of the material creation. His transcendental position is always unchanged. He is the eternal form of knowledge and bliss, and He executes His almighty will by His different energies. As such, He is never the subject of reactions for any of His acts. He is transcendental to all such conceptions of actions and reactions. Even if He is visible in the material world, the exhibition is only of His internal energy, for He is above the good and bad conceptions of this material world. In the material world the fish or the hog may be considered lower than the man, but when the Lord appears as a fish or hog, He is neither of them in the material conception. It is His causeless mercy that He appears in every society or species of life, but He is never to be considered one of them. Conceptions of the material world such as good and bad, lower and upper, important and insignificant, are estimations of the material energy, and the Supreme Lord is transcendental to all such conceptions. The words *paraà bhävam*, or transcendental nature, can never be compared to the material conception. We should not forget that the potencies of the Almighty Lord are always the same and do not decrease because the Lord assumes the form of a lower animal. There is no difference between Lord Sri Rāma, Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa and His incarnations as a fish and hog. He is all-pervading and simultaneously localized at any and every place. But the foolish person with a poor fund of knowledge, for want of that *paraà bhävam* of the Lord, cannot understand how the Supreme Lord can take the form of a man or a fish. One compares everything to one's own standard of knowledge, as the frog in the well

considers the sea to be like the well. The frog in the well cannot even think of the sea, and when such a frog is informed of the greatness of the sea, it takes the conception of the sea as being a little greater than the well. As such, one who is foolish about the transcendental science of the Lord will find it difficult to understand how Lord Viṣṇu can equally manifest Himself in every society of living entities.

TEXT 43

**TaTa" k-al/aiGanåd]aTMaa YaTSa*iiMadMaaTMaNa")
SaiàYaC^iTa TaTa(k-ale/ gaNaaNaqk-iMavaiNal/")) 43))**

tataù kälägni-rudrätmä

yat sañöam idam ätmanaù

sanniyacchatì tat käle

ghananékam ivänilaù

SYNONYMS

tataù—thereafter, at the end; *käla*—destruction; *agni*—fire; *rudra-ätmä*—in the form of Rudra; *yat*—whatever; *sañöam*—created; *idam*—all these; *ätmanaù*—of His own; *sam*—completely; *niyacchatì*—annihilates; *tat käle*—at the end of the millennium; *ghana-anékam*—bunches of clouds; *iva*—like that of; *anilaù*—air.

TRANSLATION

Thereafter, at the end of the millennium, the Lord Himself in the form of Rudra, the destroyer, will annihilate the complete creation as the wind displaces the clouds.

PURPORT

This creation is very appropriately compared to clouds. Clouds are created

or situated in the sky, and when they are displaced they remain in the same sky without manifestation. Similarly, the whole creation is made by the Supreme Personality of God in His form of Brahmä, it is maintained by Him in the form of Viṣṇu, and it is destroyed by Him in the form of Rudra, or Siva, all in due course. This creation, maintenance and destruction are nicely explained in the **Bhagavad-gita** (8.19–20) as follows:

*bhüta-grämaù sa eväyaà
bhütvä bhütvä praléyate
rätry-ägame 'vaçaù pärtha
prabhavaty ahar-ägame*

*paras tasmät tu bhävo 'nyo
'vyakto 'vyaktät sanätanaù
yaù sa sarveñu bhüteñu
naçyatsu na vinaçyati*

The nature of the material world is that it is first created very nicely, then it develops very nicely and stays for a great number of years (even beyond the calculation of the greatest mathematician), but after that it is again destroyed during the night of Brahmä, without any resistance, and at the end of the night of Brahmä it is again manifested as a creation to follow the same principles of maintenance and destruction. The foolish conditioned soul who has taken this temporary world as a permanent settlement has to learn intelligently why such creation and destruction take place. The fruitive actors in the material world are very enthusiastic in the creation of big enterprises, big houses, big empires, big industries and so many big, big things out of the energy and ingredients supplied by the material agent of the Supreme Lord. With such resources, and at the cost of valuable energy, the conditioned soul creates, satisfies his whims, but unwillingly has to depart from all his creations and enter into another phase of life to create again and again. To give hope to such foolish conditioned souls who waste their energy in this temporary material world, the Lord gives information that there is another nature, which is eternally existent without being occasionally created or destroyed, and that the conditioned soul can understand what he should do and how his valuable energy may be utilized. Instead of wasting his energy in matter, which is sure to be

destroyed in due course by the supreme will, the conditioned soul should utilize his energy in the devotional service of the Lord so that he can be transferred to the other, eternal nature, where there is no birth, no death, no creation, no destruction, but permanent life instead, full of knowledge and unlimited bliss. The temporary creation is thus exhibited and destroyed just to give information to the conditioned soul who is attached to temporary things. It is also meant to give him a chance for self-realization, and not for sense gratification, which is the prime aim of all fruitive actors.

TEXT 44

wTQaM>aaveNa k-iQaTaae >aGavaNa(>aGavtaMa")
NaeTQaM>aaveNa ih Par& d]íuMahRiNTa SaUrYa")) 44))

ittham-bhāvena kathito

bhagavān bhagavattamaù

nettham-bhāvena hi paraà

drañöum arhanti sürayaù

SYNONYMS

ittham—in these features; *bhāvena*—the matter of creation and destruction; *kathitaù*—described; *bhagavān*—the Personality of Godhead; *bhagavat-tamaù*—by the great transcendentalists; *na*—not; *ittham*—in this; *bhāvena*—features; *hi*—only; *param*—most glorious; *drañöum*—to see; *arhanti*—deserve; *sürayaù*—great devotees.

TRANSLATION

The great transcendentalists thus describe the activities of the Supreme Personality of Godhead, but the pure devotees deserve to see more glorious things in transcendence, beyond these features.

PURPORT

The Lord is not only the creator and destroyer of the material manifestations of His different energies. He is more than a simple creator and destroyer, for there is His feature of *ānanda*, or His pleasure feature. This pleasure feature of the Lord is understood by the pure devotees only, and not by others. The impersonalist is satisfied simply by understanding the all-pervasive influence of the Lord. This is called Brahman realization. Greater than the impersonalist is the mystic who sees the Lord situated in his heart as Paramātmā, the partial representation of the Lord. But there are pure devotees who take part in the direct pleasure (*ānanda*) potency of the Lord by factual reciprocation of loving service. The Lord in His abode called the Vaikuntha planets, which are eternal manifestations, always remains with His associates and enjoys transcendental loving services by His pure devotees in different transcendental humors. The pure devotees of the Lord thus undergo a practice of that devotional service to the Lord during the manifestation of the creation and take full advantage of the manifestation by qualifying themselves to enter into the kingdom of God. The ***Bhagavad-gita*** (18.55) confirms this:

*bhaktyā mām abhijānāti
yāvān yaç cāsmi tattvataù
tato mää tattvato jïätvä
viçate tad-anantaram*

By development of pure devotional service one can factually know the Lord as He is and thus be trained in the bona fide service of the Lord and be allowed to enter into the direct association of the Lord in so many capacities. The highest glorious association with the Lord is made possible in the planet of Goloka Våndävana, where Lord Kṛṣṇa enjoys Himself with the *gopés* and His favorite animals, the *surabhi* cows. A description of this transcendental land of Kṛṣṇa is given in the *Brahma-saṃhitā*, which is considered by Lord Sri Caitanya to be the most authentic literature in this connection.

TEXT 45

**NaaSYa k-MaRi<a JaNMaadaE ParSYaaNauivDaqYaTae)
k-Ta*RTvPa[iTazeDaaQa| MaaYaYaaraeiPaTa& ih TaTa()) 45))**

näsya karmaëi janmädau

parasyänuvidhéyate

kartâtva-pratiñedhärthaà

mäyayäropitaà hi tat

SYNONYMS

na—never; *asya*—of the creation; *karmaëi*—in the matter of; *janma-ädau*—creation and destruction; *parasya*—of the Supreme; *anuvidhéyate*—it is so described; *kartâtva*—engineering; *pratiñedha-artham*—counteract; *mäyayä*—by the external energy; *äropitam*—is manifested; *hi*—for; *tat*—the creator.

TRANSLATION

There is no direct engineering by the Lord for the creation and destruction of the material world. What is described in the Vedas about His direct interference is simply to counteract the idea that material nature is the creator.

PURPORT

The Vedic direction for the creation, maintenance and destruction of the material world is this: *yato vä imäni bhütäni jäyante. yena jätäni jévanti. yat prayanty abhisaàviçanti*, i.e., everything is created by Brahman, after creation everything is maintained by Brahman, and after annihilation everything is conserved in Brahman. Gross materialists without any knowledge of Brahman, Paramätmä or Bhagavän conclude material nature to be the ultimate cause of the material manifestation, and the modern scientist also shares this view that the material nature is the ultimate cause of all the manifestations of the material world. This view is refuted by all Vedic literature. The Vedänta philosophy mentions that Brahman is the fountainhead of all creation, maintenance and destruction, and *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, the natural commentation on the Vedänta philosophy, says,

janmädy asya yato 'nvayäd itarataç cärtheñv abhijïaù svaräö [SB 1.1.1], etc.

Inert matter is undoubtedly energy with potential to interact, but it has no initiative of its own. *Srimad-Bhagavatam* therefore comments on the aphorism *janmädy asya* by saying *abhijïaù* and *sväräö*, i.e., the Supreme Brahman is not inert matter, but He is supreme consciousness and is independent. Therefore inert matter cannot be the ultimate cause of the creation, maintenance and destruction of the material world. Superficially material nature appears to be the cause of creation, maintenance and destruction, but material nature is set into motion for creation by the supreme conscious being, the Personality of Godhead. He is the background of all creation, maintenance and destruction, and this is confirmed in the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (9.10):

*mayädhyakñëëa prakâtiù
süyate sa-caräcaram
hetunänena kaunteya
jagad viparivartate*

The material nature is one of the energies of the Lord, and she can work under the direction of the Lord (*adhyakñëëa*). When the Lord throws His transcendental glance over the material nature, then only can the material nature act, as a father contacts the mother, who is then able to conceive a child. Although it appears to the layman that the mother gives birth to the child, the experienced man knows that the father gives birth to the child. The material nature therefore produces the moving and standing manifestations of the material world after being contacted by the supreme father, and not independently. Considering material nature to be the cause of creation, maintenance, etc., is called “the logic of nipples on the neck of a goat.” The *Caitanya-caritämäta* by Srila Kṛṣṇadäsa Kaviräja Gosvami describes this logic of *ajä-gala-stana-nyäya* as follows (as explained by His Divine Grace Sri Srimad Bhaktisiddhanta Sarasvaté Gosvami Maharaja): “The material nature, as the material cause, is known as *pradhäna*, and as efficient cause is known as *mäyä*. But since it is inert matter, it is not the remote cause of creation.” Kaviräja Gosvami states as follows:

ataeva kãñëa müla-jagat-käraëa

prakāti— —kāraëa yaiche ajä-gala-stana

(Cc. **Ädi** 5.61)

Because Kāraëärëavaçäyë Viṣṇu is a plenary expansion of Kṛṣṇa, it is He who electrifies the matter to put it in motion. The example of electrification is quite appropriate. A piece of iron is certainly not fire, but when the iron is made red-hot, certainly it has the quality of fire through its burning capacity. Matter is compared to the piece of iron, and it is electrified or made red-hot by the glance or manipulation of the supreme consciousness of Viṣṇu. Only by such electrification is the energy of matter displayed in various actions and reactions. Therefore the inert matter is neither efficient nor the material cause of the cosmic manifestation. Sri Kapiladeva has said:

*yatholmukäd visphuliügäd
dhümäd väpi sva-sambhavät
apy ätmatvenäbhimatäd
yathägniù pāthag ulmukät*

(**Bhäg.** 3.28.40)

The original fire, its flame, its sparks and its smoke are all one, for fire is still fire yet is different from the flame, flame is different from sparks, and sparks are different from the smoke. In every one of them, namely in the flames, in the sparks and in the smoke, the integrity of fire is present, yet all of them are differently situated with different positions. The cosmic manifestation is compared to the smoke because when smoke passes over the sky so many forms appear, resembling many known and unknown manifestations. The sparks are compared to living entities, and the flames are compared to material nature (*pradhāna*). One must know that each and every one of them is effective simply because of being empowered by the quality of the original fire. Therefore all of them, namely the material nature, the cosmic manifestation and the living entities, are but different energies of the Lord (fire). Therefore those who accept the material nature as the cosmic manifestation's original cause (*prakāti*, the cause of creation according to Sāikhya philosophy) are not correct in their conclusion. The material nature has no separate existence without the Lord. Therefore,

setting aside the Supreme Lord as the cause of all causes is the logic of *ajā-gala-stana-nyāya*, or trying to milk the nipples on the neck of a goat. The nipples on the neck of a goat may seem like sources of milk, but to try to get milk from such nipples will be foolish.

TEXT 46

AYa& Tau b]ø<a" k-LPa" Saivk-LPa odaôTa")
iviDa" SaaDaar<aae Ya}a SaGaaR" Pa[ak*-TavEk*-Taa")) 46))

ayaà tu brahmaëaù kalpaù

savikalpa udähåtaù

vidhiù sädhäraëo yatra

sargäù prakåta-vaikåtäù

SYNONYMS

ayam—this process of creation and annihilation; *tu*—but; *brahmaëaù*—of Brahmä; *kalpaù*—his one day; *sa-vikalpaù*—along with the duration of the universes; *udähåtaù*—exemplified; *vidhiù*—regulative principles; *sädhäraëaù*—in summary; *yatra*—wherein; *sargäù*—creation; *prakåta*—in the matter of material nature; *vaikåtäù*—disbursement.

TRANSLATION

This process of creation and annihilation described in summary herein is the regulative principle during the duration of Brahmä’s one day. It is also the regulative principle in the creation of mahat, in which the material nature is dispersed.

PURPORT

There are three different types of creation, called *mahä-kalpa*, *vikalpa* and *kalpa*. In the *mahä-kalpa* the Lord assumes the first *puruṣa* incarnation as

Kāraṇodakaśāyī Viṣṇu with all the potencies of the *mahat-tattva* and the sixteen principles of creative matter and instruments. The creative instruments are eleven, the ingredients are five, and all of them are products of *mahat*, or materialistic ego. These creations by the Lord in His feature of Kāraṇodakaśāyī Viṣṇu are called *mahā-kalpa*. The creation of Brahmā and dispersion of the material ingredients are called *vikalpa*, and the creation by Brahmā in each day of his life is called *kalpa*. Therefore each day of Brahmā is called a *kalpa*, and there are thirty *kalpas* in terms of Brahmā's days. This is also confirmed in the ***Bhagavad-gīta*** (8.17) as follows:

*sahasra-yuga-paryantam
ahar yad brahmaëo viduù
rätìà yuga-sahasrëntäà
te 'ho-rätra-vido janäù*

In the upper planetary system the duration of one complete day and night is equal to one complete year of this earth. This is accepted even by the modern scientist and attested by the astronauts. Similarly, in the region of still higher planetary systems the duration of day and night is still greater than in the heavenly planets. The four *yugas* are calculated in terms of the heavenly calendars and accordingly are twelve thousand years in terms of the heavenly planets. This is called a *divya-yuga*, and one thousand *divya-yugas* make one day of Brahmā. The creation during the day of Brahmā is called *kalpa*, and the creation of Brahmā is called *vikalpa*. When *vikalpas* are made possible by the breathing of Mahā-Viṣṇu, this is called a *mahā-kalpa*. There are regular and systematic cycles of these *mahā-kalpas*, *vikalpas* and *kalpas*. In answer to Maharaja Parikṣit's question about them, Sukadeva Gosvami answered in the *Prabhāsa-khaëòa* of the *Skanda Purana*. They are as follows:

*prathamau çveta-kalpaç ca
dvitéyo néla-lohitaù
vāmadevas tâtéyas tu
tato gāthāntaro 'paraù*

rauravaù païcamaù proktaù

*ñañöhaù präëa iti smâtaù
saptamo 'tha bâhat-kalpaù
kandarpö 'ñöama ucyate*

*sadyötha navamaù kalpa
éçäno daçamaù smâtaù
dhyäna ekädaçaù proktas
tathä särasvato 'paraù*

*trayodaça udänas tu
garuò 'tha caturdaçaù
kaurmaù païcadaço jïeyaù
paurëamäsé prajäpateù*

*ñöodaço nãrasiàhas tu
samädhis tu tato 'paraù
ägneyo vişṇujaù sauraù
soma-kalpas tato 'paraù*

*dväviàço bhävanaù proktaù
supumän iti cäparaù
vaikuëöhaç cärñöiñas tadvad
valé-kalpas tato 'paraù*

*saptaviàço 'tha vairäjo
gauré-kalpas tathäparaù
mäheçvaras tathä proktas
tripuro yatra ghätitaù
pitâ-kalpas tathä cänte
yaù kuhür brahmaëaù smâtä*

Therefore the thirty *kalpas* of Brahmä are: (1) Çveta-kalpa, (2) Nélalohita, (3) Vãmadeva, (4) Gäthäntara, (5) Raurava, (6) Präëa, (7) Bâhat-kalpa, (8) Kandarpa, (9) Sadyötha, (10) Éçäna, (11) Dhyäna, (12) Särasvata, (13) Udäna, (14) Garuò, (15) Kaurma, (16) Nãrasiàha, (17) Samädhi, (18) Ägneya, (19) Vişṇuja, (20) Saura, (21) Soma-kalpa, (22) Bhävana, (23) Supuma, (24) Vaikuntha, (25) Arciña, (26) Valé-kalpa, (27) Vairäja, (28)

Gauré-kalpa, (29) Mäheçvara, (30) Paitā-kalpa.

These are Brahmā's days only, and he has to live months and years up to one hundred, so we can just imagine how many creations there are in *kalpas* only. Then again there are *vikalpas*, which are generated by the breathing of Mahā-Viṣṇu, as stated in the *Brahma-saṁhitā* (*yasyaika-niçvasita-kālam athāvalambya jévanti loma-vilajā jagadaëða-nāthäù* [Bs. 5.48]). The Brahmäs live only during the breathing period of Mahā-Viṣṇu. So the exhaling and inhaling of Viṣṇu are *mahā-kalpas*, and all these are due to the Supreme Personality of Godhead, for no one else is the master of all creations.

TEXT 47

PairMaa<a& c k-al/SYa k-LPal/+a<aivGa]hMa()
YaQaa PaurSTaaÜya:YaaSYae PaaÚ& k-LPaMaQaae é*<au)) 47))

parimäëaà ca kälasya

kalpa-lakñäëa-vigraham

yathä purastäd vyäkhyäsyë

pädmaà kalpam atho çäëu

SYNONYMS

parimäëam—measurement; *ca*—also; *kälasya*—of time; *kalpa*—a day of Brahmä; *lakñäëa*—symptoms; *vigraham*—form; *yathä*—as much as; *purastät*—hereafter; *vyäkhyäsyë*—shall be explained; *pädmam*—by the name Pädma; *kalpam*—the duration of a day; *atho*—thus; *çäëu*—just hear.

TRANSLATION

O King, I shall in due course explain the measurement of time in its gross and subtle features with the specific symptoms of each, but for the present let me explain unto you the Pädma-kalpa.

PURPORT

The present duration of a *kalpa* of Brahmā is called the Varāha-kalpa or Çvetavarāha-kalpa because the incarnation of the Lord as Varāha took place during the creation of Brahmā, who was born on the lotus coming out of the abdomen of Viṣṇu. Therefore this Varāha-kalpa is also called Pādma-kalpa, and this is testified by *ācāryas* like Jiva Gosvami as well as Visvanatha Cakravarti Öhäkura in pursuance of the first commentator, Svāmé Sridhara. So there is no contradiction between the Varāha and the Pādma-kalpa of Brahmā.

TEXT 48

XaaENak- ovac

Yadah Naae >avana(SaUTa +ataa >aaGavTaaetaMa")
ccar TaqQaaRiNa >auvSTYaṁ-a bNDaUNa(SauduSTYaJaaNa()) 48))

çaunaka uvāca

yad āha no bhavān sūta

kñattā bhāgavatottamaù

cacāra tērthāni bhuvas

tyaktvā bandhūn sudustyajān

SYNONYMS

çaunakaù uvāca—Sri Çaunaka Muni said; *yat*—as; *āha*—you said; *naù*—unto us; *bhavān*—your good self; *sūta*—O Sūta; *kñattā*—Vidura; *bhāgavata-uttamaù*—one of the topmost devotees of the Lord; *cacāra*—practiced; *tērthāni*—places of pilgrimage; *bhuvaù*—on the earth; *tyaktvā*—leaving aside; *bandhūn*—all relatives; *su-dustyajān*—very difficult to give up.

TRANSLATION

Çaunaka Rsi, after hearing all about the creation, inquired from Sūta Gosvami about Vidura, for Sūta Gosvami had previously informed him how Vidura left home, leaving aside all his relatives, who were very difficult to leave.

PURPORT

The *āñis* headed by Çaunaka were more anxious to know about Vidura, who met Maitreya Rsi while traveling to the pilgrimage sites of the world.

TEXTS 49–50

+atau" k-aEXaarveSTaSYa Sa&vadae_DYaaTMaSa&ié[Ta")
YaÜa Sa >aGava&STaSMaE Pa*íStatvMauvac h)) 49))
b]Uih NaSTaidd& SaaEMYa ivdurSYa ivceiíTaMa()
bNDauTYaaGaiNaiMata& c YaQaEvaGaTavaNa(PauNa")) 50))

kñattuù kauçäraves tasya

saàvädo 'dhyätma-saàçritaù

yad vä sa bhagaväàs tasmai

pãñöas tattvam uväca ha

brühi nas tad idaà saumya

vidurasya viceññöitam

bandhu-tyäga-nimittaà ca

yathaivägatavän punaù

SYNONYMS

kñattuù—of Vidura; *kauçäraveù*—as that of Maitreya; *tasya*—their;
saàvädaù—news; *adhyätma*—in the matter of transcendental knowledge;

saàçritaù—full of; *yat*—which; *vä*—anything else; *saù*—he; *bhagavän*—His Grace; *tasmai*—unto him; *pãñöaù*—inquired; *tattvam*—the truth; *uväca*—answered; *ha*—in the past; *brühi*—please tell; *naù*—unto us; *tat*—those matters; *idam*—here; *saumya*—O gentle one; *vidurasya*—of Vidura; *viceñöitam*—activities; *bandhu-tyäga*—renouncing the friends; *nimittam*—the cause of; *ca*—also; *yathä*—as; *eva*—also; *ägatavän*—came back; *punaù*—again (at home).

TRANSLATION

Çaunaka Rsi said: Let us know, please, what topics were discussed between Vidura and Maitreya, who talked on transcendental subjects, and what was inquired by Vidura and replied by Maitreya. Also please let us know the reason for Vidura’s giving up the connection of his family members, and why he again came home. Please also let us know the activities of Vidura while he was in the places of pilgrimage.

PURPORT

Sri Sūta Gosvami was narrating the topics of the creation and destruction of the material world, but it appears that the *āñis* headed by Çaunaka were more inclined to hear of transcendental subjects, which are on a higher level than the physical. There are two classes of men, namely those too addicted to the gross body and the material world, and others, on the higher level, who are interested more in transcendental knowledge. *Srimad-Bhagavatam* gives facility to everyone, both to the materialist and to the transcendentalist. By hearing *Srimad-Bhagavatam* in the matter of the Lord’s glorious activities both in the material world and in the transcendental world, men can derive equal benefit. The materialists are more interested in the physical laws and how they are acting, and they see wonders in those physical glamors. Sometimes, due to physical glamors, they forget the glories of the Lord. They should know definitely that physical activities and their wonders are all initiated by the Lord. The rose in the garden gradually takes its shape and color to become beautiful and sweet not by a blind physical law, although it appears like that. Behind that physical law is the direction of the complete consciousness of the Supreme Lord, otherwise things cannot take shape so systematically. The artist draws

a picture of a rose very nicely with all attention and artistic sense, and yet it does not become as perfect as the real rose. If that is the real fact, how can we say that the real rose has taken its shape without intelligence behind the beauty? This sort of conclusion is due to a poor fund of knowledge. One must know from the above description of creation and annihilation that the supreme consciousness, being omnipresent, can take care of everything with perfect attention. That is the fact of the omnipresence of the Supreme Lord. Persons, still more foolish than the gross materialists, however, claim to be transcendentalists and claim to have such supreme all-pervading consciousness, but offer no proof. Such foolish persons cannot know what is going on behind the next wall, yet they are falsely proud of possessing the cosmic, all-pervading consciousness of the Supreme Person. For them also, hearing of *Srimad-Bhagavatam* is a great help. It will open their eyes to see that simply by claiming supreme consciousness one does not become supremely conscious. One has to prove in the physical world that he has such supreme consciousness. The *āñis* of Naimiñāraëya, however, were above the gross materialists and the false transcendentalists, and thus they were always anxious to know the real truth in transcendental matters, as discussed by authorities.

TEXT 51

SaUTa ovac

**raja Parqi+aTaa Pa*íae YadvaecNMahaMauiNa")
TaÜae_i>aDaaSYae é*<auTa raj" Pa[énaNauSaarTa")) 51))**

süta uväca

räjñä parékñitā pññöo

yad avocan mahä-muniù

tad vo 'bhidhäsyë çäëuta

räjñau praçñänusärataù

SYNONYMS

sūtaù uvāca—Sri Sūta Gosvami replied; *rājīā*—by the King; *parékñitā*—by Parikṣit; *pāññaù*—as asked; *yat*—what; *avocat*—spoke; *mahā-muniù*—the great sage; *tat*—that very thing; *vaù*—unto you; *abhidhāsye*—I shall explain; *çāñuta*—please hear; *rājīaù*—by the King; *praçna*—question; *anusārataù*—in accordance with.

TRANSLATION

Sri Sūta Gosvami explained: I shall now explain to you the very subjects explained by the great sage in answer to King Parikṣit’s inquiries. Please hear them attentively.

PURPORT

Any question that is put forward may be answered by quoting the authority, and that satisfies the saner section. That is the system even in the law court. The best lawyer gives evidence from the past judgment of the court without taking much trouble to establish his case. This is called the *paramparā* system, and learned authorities follow it without manufacturing rubbish interpretations.

éçvaraù paramaù kññēaù
sac-cid-ānanda-vigrahaù
anādir ādir govindaù
sarva-kāraēa-kāraēam

(*Brahma-saṁhitā* 5.1)

Let us all obey the Supreme Lord, whose hand is in everything, without exception.

Thus end the Bhaktivedanta purports of the Second Canto, Tenth Chapter, of the Srimad-Bhagavatam, entitled “Bhāgavatam Is the Answer to All Questions.”

END OF THE SECOND CANTO

ⁱEven fifty years ago, the social structure of all Indians was so arranged that they would not read any literature that was not connected with the activities of the Lord. They would not play any drama not connected with the Lord. They would not organize a fair or ceremony not connected with the Lord. Nor would they visit a place that was not holy and sanctified by the pastimes of the Lord. Therefore even the common man in the village would talk about *Rāmāyaṇa* and *Mahābhārata*, *Gétā* and *Bhāgavatam*, even from his very childhood. But by the influence of the age of Kali, they have been dragged to the civilization of the dogs and hogs, laboring for bread without any sense of transcendental knowledge.

ⁱⁱHuman life is meant for earning values. This life is called *arthadam*, or that which can deliver values. And what is the greatest value of life? It is to return home, back to Godhead, as indicated in the ***Bhagavad-gétā*** (8.15). One's selfishness must be aimed at the point of going back to Godhead. The ass does not know his self-interest, and it works very hard for others only. A person who works very hard for others only, forgetting his personal interest available in the human form of life, is compared to the ass. In the *Brahma-vaivarta Purāṇa* it is said:

*açétià caturaç caiva
lakñäàs täi jéva-jätiñu
bhramadbhiù puruñaiù präpyaà
mänuñyaà janma-paryayät

tad apy abhalatäà jätaù
teñäm ätmäbhimäninäm
varäkäëäm anäçritya
govinda-caraëa-dvayam*

The human life is so important that even the demigods in the higher planets sometimes aspire for a human body on this earth because in the human body only can one easily go back to Godhead. In spite of having obtained such an important body, if one does not re-establish his lost eternal relation with Govinda, Lord Kāñḍea, he is certainly a fool who has forgotten his self-interest. This human form of material body is obtained by a gradual process of evolution to one body after another in the cycle of 8,400,000 varieties of life. And the poor man, forgetting this importance for

his own interest, involves himself in so many illusory engagements for uplifting the position of others as a leader of political emancipation and economic development. There is no harm in trying for political emancipation or economic development, but one should not forget the real aim of life: all such philanthropic activities must be dovetailed to returning to Godhead. One who does not know this is compared to the ass who works only for others, without their of his own welfare in mind.

*iii*yasya deve parā bhaktir
yathā deve tathā gurau
tasyaite kathitā hy arthau
prakāṣante mahātmanaù

“Unto those great souls who have implicit faith in both the Lord and the spiritual master, all the imports of Vedic knowledge are automatically revealed.” (*Çvetāçvatara Upaniñad* 6.23)

*ataù çré-kāñëa-nāmādi
na bhaved grāhyam indriyaiù
sevonmukhe hi jihvādau
svayam eva sphuraty adaù*

“No one can understand Kāñëa as He is by the blunt material senses. But He reveals Himself to the devotees, being pleased with them for their transcendental loving service unto Him.” (*Bhakti-rasāmāta-sindhu* 1.2.234)

*bhaktyā mām abhijānāti
yāvān yaç cāsmi tattvataù
tato mää tattvato jīātvā
viçate tad-anantaram*

“One can understand the Supreme Personality as He is only by devotional service. And when one is in full consciousness of the Supreme Lord by such devotion, he can enter into the kingdom of God.” (Bg. 18.55)

These are Vedic instructions. One must have full faith in the words of the spiritual master and similar faith in the Supreme Personality of Godhead. Then the real knowledge of *ātmā* and Paramātmā and the distinction between matter and spirit will be automatically revealed. This *ātma-tattva*,

or spiritual knowledge, will be revealed within the core of a devotee's heart because of his having taken shelter of the lotus feet of a *mahājana* such as Prahāda Mahārāja.

*ivtad-vijñānārthaà sa gurum evābhigacchet
samiṭ-pāṇiṁ śrotriyaà brahma-niñōham*

“To understand these things properly, one must humbly approach, with firewood in hand, a spiritual master who is learned in the *Vedas* and firmly devoted to the Absolute Truth.”

[Muṇḍaka Upaniṣad 1.2.12]

*vyasya deve parā bhaktir
yathā deve tathā gurau
tasyaite kathitā hy arthāṁ
prakāṣante mahātmanaḥ*

“Unto those great souls who have implicit faith in both the Lord and the spiritual master, all the imports of Vedic knowledge are automatically revealed.” (*Çvetāçvatara Upaniṣad* 6.23)

*ataṁ śré-kāñēa-nāmādi
na bhaved grāhyam indriyaiḥ
sevonmukhe hi jihvādau
svayam eva sphuraty adaḥ*

“No one can understand Kāñēa as He is by the blunt material senses. But He reveals Himself to the devotees, being pleased with them for their transcendental loving service unto Him.” (*Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu* 1.2.234)

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